

Tafsir Ibn Kathir — Modular Volume 3

Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

Audited English narrative — redundant narrations removed

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Module 21

Surah 19: Maryam

Surah 19: Maryam

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3390–3434]

Opening The Tafslr of Surah Maryam (Chapter - 19) Which was revealed in Makkah Muhammad bin Ishaq recorded a Hadith of Umm Salamah 1 1 in his Sirah, and

The Story of Zakariyya and His Supplication for a Son The discussion about the separate letters has already preceded at the beginning of Surat Al-Baqarah. Concerning Allah's statement, *Wa inna nundhiha biha* A reminder of the mercy of your Lord. This means that this is a reminder of Allah's mercy upon His servant Zakariyya. 111 Yahya bin Ya'mar recited it, *Wa inna nundhiha biha* He has reminded of your Lord's mercy to His servant Zakariyya. The word Zakariyya in the Ayah has been recited with elongation and also shortened. Both recitations are well-known. He was a great Prophet from the Prophets of the Children of Israel. In Sahih

meaning, I have become weak and feeble in strength. and gray hair has Ashta'al oti my head,} means the gray hair has burned into the black hair. The intent is to inform of weakness and old age, and its external and internal traces. Concerning Allah's statement, *Wa inna nundhiha biha* I and I have never been unblessed in my invocation to You, O my Lord! This means, I have not experienced from You except that You would respond to my supplication and that You would never refuse me in whatever I ask of You. Concerning His statement, *Wa inna nundhiha biha* Cri ci i And verily, I fear Mawali after me,} Mujahid, Qatadah and As-Suddi, all said, In saying the word Mawali, he (Zakariyya) meant his succeeding relatives.

The reason for his fear was that he was afraid that the generation that would succeed him would be a wicked generation. Thus, he asked Allah for a son who would be a Prophet after him, who would guide them with his prophethood and that which was revealed to him. In response to this I would like to point out that he was not afraid of them inheriting his wealth. For a Prophet is too great in status, and too lofty in esteem to become remorseful over his wealth in this fashion. A Prophet would not disdain to leave his wealth to his successive relatives, and thus ask to have a son who would receive his inheritance instead of them. This is one angle of argument. The second argument is that Allah did not mention that Zakariyya was wealthy. On the contrary, he was a carpenter who ate from the earnings of his own hand. This type of person usually does not have a mass of wealth. Amassing At-Tabari 18:144.

228 Tafslr Ibn Kathir wealth is not something normal for Prophets, for verily, they are the most abstemious in matters of this worldly life. The third argument is that it is confirmed in the Two Sahih, in more than one narration, that the Messenger of Allah said, *Wa inna nundhiha biha* We (the Prophets) do not leave behind inheritance (of wealth). Whatever we leave behind, then it is charity. In a narration recorded by At-Tirmidhi with an authentic chain of narrations, he said, *Wa inna nundhiha biha* We, Prophets do not leave behind inheritance (of wealth). Therefore, the meaning in these Hadiths restricts the meaning of

Zakariyya's statement, 4So give me from yourself an heir. Who shall inherit me,} inheritance of prophethood. For this reason Allah said, J" Cft i and inherit (also) the posterity of Ya'qub.} This is similar to Allah's statement, 4And Sulayman inherited from Daid.}[27:16] This means that he inherited prophethood from him. If this had meant wealth, he would not have been singled with it among his other brothers. There also would have been no important benefit in mentioning it if it was referring to wealth. It is already well-known and established in all of the previous laws and divinely revealed creeds, that the son inherits the wealth of his father. Therefore, if this was not referring to a specific type of inheritance, then Allah would not have mentioned it. All of this is supported and affirmed by what is Al-Bari 6 :227 , Muslim 3 :1383 2] Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 5 :234

Manm (7) (Part-16) in the authentic Hadith: dWc Prophets do not leave behind any inheritance (of wealth). Whatever we leave behind, then it is charity . [1 ' Mujahid said concerning his statement, J' iWho shall inherit me, and inherit (also) the posterity of Ya'qub.} [19:6] His inheritance was knowledge, and Zakariyya was one of the descendants of Ya'qub. 121 " Hushaym said, Ismail bin Abi Khalid informed us that Abu Salih commented about the Ayah: iwho shall inherit me, and inherit (also) the posterity of Ya'qub.} He would be a Prophet like his forefathers were Prophets. 13 Allah's statement, iU i and make him, my Lord, one with whom You are well- pleased!} means Make him pleasing to You (Allah) and your creation. Love him and make him beloved to your creatures, in both his religion and his character. Jt* Oi 1 fgf-. Art 47. (Allah said:) O Zakariyya! Verily, We give you the good news of a son, whose name will be Yahyd. We have given that name to none before (him)."} Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 5 :234 |2! At-Jabari 18:146. At-Tabari 18:146.

r. Jj 3 Tfl/sfr Ibt Kathir r*e USt 31 CpC^sy i o-a*?4- Oi^V4^A clt"Uc pJJ 'S^~^~^JL^l Cp xljJJ 4V-4^ Ll*^" dJJS^JIS0 5J^l v*^-'o^ . The acceptance of His Supplication This statement implies what is not mentioned, that his supplication was answered. It was said to him, A 2\$ ^ W*> 4(Alldh said:) "O Zakariyya! Verily, We give you the glad tidings of a son, whose name will be Yahyd..."> Similarly Allah, the Exalted, said; , / ' |i/ * / X / ^ f V ^- Ji ajj ISj.'hsAj Uj i'*L iut . " < l> AJJJ ~_iA*JU IjA J T*, *l jjl "i.^ j is^uf ^-. ji * 'J--'J "if w sii tiJj that time Zakariyya invoked his Lord, saying: "O my Lord! Grant me from Yoti, a good offspring. You are indeed the All-Hearer of invocation ." Then the angels called him, while he was standing in prayer in the MihrdbJ11 (saying): "Allah, gives you glad tidings of Yahyd, confirming (believing in) the word from Allah, noble, keeping away from sexual relations with women, a Prophet, from among the righteous.">[3:38-39] Allah said, m A private place of worship

iWe have given that name to none before (him).} Qatadah, Ibn Jurayj and Ibn Zayd said, This means that no one had this name before him. 1 11 Ibn Jarir preferred tljis interpretation, may Allah have mercy upon him. ck o-dj v==y 4 4^ ji i; # oj iE ju v;cL 48. He said: "My Lord! Hoio can I have a son, when my wife is barren, and 1 have reached the extreme old age."} 49. He said: "Thus your Lord says: 'It is easy for Me. Certainly I have created you before, when you had been nothing!' ">[19:8-9] His amazement after the acceptance of His Supplication Zakariyya was amazed when his supplication was answered and he was given the good news of a son. He became extremely overjoyed and asked how this child would be born to him, and in what manner he would come. This was particularly amazing because his wife was an old woman who was barren and had not given birth to any children in her entire life. Even Zakariyya himself had become old and advanced in years, his bones had become

feeble and thin, and he had no potent semen or vigor for sexual intercourse. The Answer of the Angel
 He said :? That is, the angel, in his response to Zakariyya and his Was amazement. 4 ci* jb "Thus says
 your Lord : 'It is easy for Me...' " } (i| At-Tabari 18:148.

Meaning the birth of the son will be from you and from this wife of yours and not from any other
 (woman). ieasy Meaning, it is simple and easy for Allah to do. Then he (the angel) mentioned to him
 that which is more amazing than what he was asking about. The angel said that the Lord said, iCertainly
 I have created you before, when you had been nothing!} This is similar to Allah s statement, 4 i Up. p
 jLj]f j: oj-. jt ojl iHas there not been over man a period of time, when he was not a thing worth
 mentioning?} [76:1) j\$3 jte isi; 4 ti} . He [Zakariyyd] said: My Lord! Appoint for me a sign." He said:
 "Your sign is that you shall not speak unto mankind for three nights, though having no bodily defect."}
 ill. Then he came out to his people from the Mihrab and he indicated to them by signs to glorify [Allah]
 in the morning and in the afternoon.} The Sign of the Pregnancy Allah, the Exalted, informed about
 Zakariyya that he said, tj 'j' iHe (Zakariyyd) said: "My Lord! Appoint for me a sign."} Give me a sign
 and a proof of the existence of that which You have promised me, so that my soul will be at rest and my
 heart will be at ease with Your promise. Similarly Ibrahim said, i&j d? Oijr j JI* aj-fi ifj -ff} iMy Lord!
 Shoiv me how You give life to the dead. He (Allah)

Maryam (10-11) (Part-16) said: Do you not believe?" He said: "Yes (I believe), but to put my heart at
 ease."^[2:260] Then Allah says, i&X jlft 4He said: "Your sign is..."> meaning, Your sign will be... 4that
 you shall not speak unto mankind for three nights, though having no bodily defect. Meaning, your
 tongue will be prevented from speaking ior three nights while you are healthy and fit, without ajiy
 sickness or illness. Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Wahb, As- Suddi, Qatadah and others said, His tongue
 was arrested without any sickness or illness. Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, He used to recite
 and glorify Allah, but was not able to speak to his people except by gestures. Awfi reported that Ibn
 Abbas said, 4three nights, though having no bodily defect. The nights were consecutive. However, the
 first statement that is reported from him and the majority is more correct. This Ayah is similar to what
 Allah, the Exalted, said in Sut^ah Al Imran, he - . Ljj 4He said: "O my Lord! Make a sign for
 me." (Allah) said^ "Your sign is that you shall not speak to mankind for three days except with signals.
 And remember your Lord much, and glorify (Him) in the afternoon and in the morning.^[3:41] This is a
 proof that he did not speak to his people for these three nights and their days as well.Tabari 18:152. At-
 Tabari 18:152.

ieexcept with signals.) Meaning, with bodily gestures, this is why Allah says in this noble Ayah, S; & gk)
 iThen he came out to his people from the Mihrdb) referring to the place where he was given the good
 news of the child. 4 t ihe indicated to them by signs Meaning he made a gesture to them that was subtle
 and swift. ito glorify [Allah] in the morning and in the afternoon.) That they should be agreeable to
 what he was commanded to do during these three days, to increase in his deeds and gratitude to Allah
 for what He had given him. Mujahid said,)he indicated to them by signs) He made a gesture. Wahb and
 Qatadah said the same. 121 fyj Aj fji * (A-J . bU*- i-ri 412. (ft was said to his son) : 0 Yahya! Hold fast
 to the Scripture." And We gave him wisdom while yet a child.) 413. And Hanan from Us, and
 Zakatan, and he was pious,) 414. And dutiful to his parents, and he was not arrogant or disobedient.)

415. And Salam (peace) be on him the day he was born, and the day he dies, and the day he will be raised up to life (again)! At-Jabari 18:153. At-Tabari 18:154.

The Birth of the Boy and His Characteristics This also implies what is not mentioned, that this promised boy was born and he was Yahya. There is also the implication that Allah taught him the Book, the Tawrah which they used to study among themselves. The Prophets who were sent to the Jews used to rule according to the Tawrah, as did the scholars and rabbis among them. He was still young in age when Allah gave him this knowledge. This is the reason that Allah mentioned it. parents, He says, Because of how Allah favored him and his deeds, as Wi 4.) jh s="J' 40 Yahya! Hold fast to the Scripture [the Tawrah].} Means, Learn the Book with strength. In other words, learn it well, with zeal and studious effort. 4^ jgii 4And We gave him wisdom while yet a child.} This means he was given understanding, knowledge, fortitude, diligence and zeal for good and the pursuit of good. He was blessed with these characteristics even though he was young Allah said, 4& ji 4And (made him) Hanan from Us,} [19:13] Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, c/j 6&-j} 4And Hanan from Us,} This means mercy from Us. Ikrimah, Qatadah and Ad-Dahhak all said the same. Ad-Dahhak added, Mercy that; no one would be able to give except Us. Qatadah added, With it, Allah had mercy upon Zakariyya. Mujahid said, hi At-Tabari 18:156. Tabari 18:156.

iii fcZ-j} iArid Hanan from Us,} This was gentleness from His Lord upon him. 111 The apparent meaning is that Allah's statement Hanan (affection, compassion) is directly related to His statement, iand We gave him wisdom while yet a child.} meaning, We gave him wisdom, compassion and purity. This means that he was a compassionate man, who was righteous. Hanan means the love for affection and tenderness (towards others). Concerning Allah's statement, iand Zakatan,} This is related to His statement, iAnd Hanan} The word Zakah means purity from filth, wickedness and sins. Qatadah said, The word Zakah means the righteous deed. Ad-Dahhak and Ibn Jurayj both said, The righteous deed is the pure (Zakah) deed. 131 Al-Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said, "&} iand Zakatan,} This means that he was a blessing. iand he was pious.} (19 :13) At-Tabari 18:156. At-Tabari 18:159. At-Tabari 18:159.

Maruam (12-15) (Part-16) meaning that he was pure and had no inclination to do sins Allah said; yji-Suit iAnd dutiful to his parents, and he was not arrogant or disobedient After Allah mentioned Yahya's obedience to his Lord and that Allah created him full of mercy, purity and piety, He attached to it his obedience to his parents and his good treatment of them. Allah mentioned that he refrained from disobeying them in speech, actions, commands and prohibitions. Due to this Allah says, iatid he was not arrogant or disobedient.} Then, after mentioning these beautiful characteristics, Allah mentions his reward for this, vi-ri fyj (y. iAnd Salam (peace) be on him the day he was born, and the day he dies, and the day he will be raised up to life (again)!)} This means that he had security and safety in these three circumstances. Sufyan bin Tjaynah said, The loneliest that a man will ever feel is in three situations. The first situation is on the day that he is born, when he sees himself coming out of what he was in. The second situation is on the day that he dies, when he sees people that he will not see anymore. The third situation is on the day when he is resurrected, when he sees himself in the great gathering. Allah has exclusively honored Yahya, the son of Zakariyya, by granting him peace in these situations. Allah says, y , > ' > T -v. fyj - b iAnd Salam (peace) be on him the day he was born, and the day he dies, and the day he will be raised up to life (again)!)} This narration was reported by Ibn Jarir,

from Ahmad bin Mansur Al-Marwazi, from Sadaqah bin Al-Fadl, from Sufyan bin TJaynah. At-Jabari 18:159, Ad-DurrAl-Manthur5:486.

r*n 1/rt) '-*(y j (* j 4-^*b^>-cr>; / y . > * ' "'1 . . , Z^/, ,*** C^cJIs L\$J Li\$J] [lL-yl^ U Lc iii) til ^sTJs\$&i&fiigjiZiffiji C"*yy I'll'V ' " 1,4c.y4j^A \^ ^jJjJB -*. ^ * JL /- ^*> ^ *->'* ^ A. y / / ^ Ia"-L>"U IX Uj^ ^ ^ ^ 'Sx' ~ ' =vjIa la / / ,/j' > ^ . / > ^ ^ (- vi^Ji' 4 bl Lflii ,j" OJUu' (i/> ojje vi' ^~Jj (+i[Ul_JU kCtr vJl> 10^ yj LjJ J^i V s /" ^J > " ol '&'* J~*y\ c)[*~&j Jy~j 0 L*jJ, Jti ^ wLL " .ft ^z rraj * &'* > l* - " '- (HJ ["Jc 4 ^iri 4' 'A' lk{ > J \$ '& -i^j jli i /"***" i.: // / >/' 's' ' 4-r^j *^j'y 4^ylL^ ' t> 426. And mention in the Book, Maryam, when she withdrew in seclusion from her family to place facing east.} 427. She placed a screen before them; then We sent to her Our Ruh, and he appeared before her in the form of a man in all respects.} 428. She said: "Verily, I seek refuge with the Most Gracious (Allah) from you, if you do fear Allah." } 19. (The angel) said: "1 am only a messenger from your Lord, (to announce) to you the gift of a righteous son." } 420. She said: "How can I have a son when no man has touched me, nor am I Baghiyya?" } 422. He said: "Thus says your Lord: That is easy for Me (Allah). And (We wish) to appoint him as a sign to mankind and a mercy from Us (Allah), and it is a matter (already) decreed (by Allah). "

The Story of Maryam and Al-Masih (*isa) I After Allah, the Exalted, mentioned the story of Zakariyya, and that He blessed him with a righteous, purified and blessed child even in his old age while his wife was barren, He then mentions the story of Maryam. Allah informs of His granting her a child named Isa without a father being involved (in Her pregnancy). Between these two stories there is an appropriate and similar relationship. Due to their closeness in meaning, Allah mentioned them here together, as well as in Surahs Al Imran and Al-Anbiya . Allah has mentioned these stories to show His servants His ability, the might of His authority and that He has power over all things. Allah says, i'&J&X 4 i And mention in the Book, Maryam She was Maryam bint Imran from the family lineage of Dawud. She was from a good and wholesome family of :he Children of Israel. Allah mentioned the stoiy of her mother s pregnancy with her in Surah Al Imran, and that s he (Maryam s mother) dedicated her freely for the service of Allah. This meant that she dedicated the child (Maryam) to the service of the Masjid of the Sacred House (in Jerusalem). Thus, they (Zakariyya, Maryam s mother and Maryam) were similar in that aspect. her Lord (Allah) accepted her with goodly acceptance. He made her grow in a good manner. 3:37) Thus, Maryam was raised among the Children of Israel in an honorable way. She was one of the female worshippers, v eil- known for her remarkable acts of worship, devotion md perseverance. She lived under the care of her brother-in-law, Zakariyya, who was a Prophet of the Children of Israel at hat time. He was a great man among them, whom they would refer to in their religious matters. Zakariyya saw astonishing miracles occur from her that amazed him. j* 'Jk ilS Ui jtf lijy Jio CjS"

iEvety time Zakaiyya altered the Mihrdb to (visit) her, he found her supplied with sustenance. He said: "O Maryam! From where have you got this?" She said, "This is from Allah." Verily, Allah provides to whom He wills, without limit. [3 :37] It has been mentioned that he would find her with winter fruit during the summer and summer fruit during the winter. This has already been explained in Surah Al Imran. Then, when Allah wanted to grant her His servant and Messenger, Isa, one of the five Great Messengers. 44-/ ' 44 1st ishe zoithdrezv in seclusion from her family to place facing [19 :16] This means that she withdrew from them and secluded herself from them. She went to the eastern side of the

Sacred Masjid (in Jerusalem). It is reported from Ibn Abbas that he said, Verily, I am the most knowledgeable of Allah's creation of why the Christians took the east as the direction of devotional worship. They did because of Allah's statement, ﴿وَإِذْ أَخَذْنَا مِنَ النَّبِيِّينَ مِيثَاقَهُمْ لَعَنَّاهُمْ وَرَأَى جِبْرِيلُ مُصَوِّدًا عَلَيْهِمْ كِفَايَتَهُمْ إِذِ اتَّخَذُوا آلِهَتَهُمْ آلِهَةً﴾. Therefore, they took the birthplace of Isa as their direction of worship. 111 Concerning Allah's statement, ﴿وَإِذْ أَخَذْنَا مِنَ النَّبِيِّينَ مِيثَاقَهُمْ لَعَنَّاهُمْ وَرَأَى جِبْرِيلُ مُصَوِّدًا عَلَيْهِمْ كِفَايَتَهُمْ إِذِ اتَّخَذُوا آلِهَتَهُمْ آلِهَةً﴾. This means that she hid herself from them and concealed herself. Then, Allah sent Jibril to her. ﴿وَإِذْ أَخَذْنَا مِنَ النَّبِيِّينَ مِيثَاقَهُمْ لَعَنَّاهُمْ وَرَأَى جِبْرِيلُ مُصَوِّدًا عَلَيْهِمْ كِفَايَتَهُمْ إِذِ اتَّخَذُوا آلِهَتَهُمْ آلِهَةً﴾. [19:17 At-Tabari 18:162. The chain for this particular narration has a deficiency in it. Ibn Kathir mentions a number of narrations about this Ayah, after which he says, And Allah knows best.

This means that he came to her in the form of a perfect and complete man. Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah, Ibn Jurayj, Wahb bin Munabbih and As-Suddi all commented on Allah's statement, ﴿وَإِذْ أَخَذْنَا مِنَ النَّبِيِّينَ مِيثَاقَهُمْ لَعَنَّاهُمْ وَرَأَى جِبْرِيلُ مُصَوِّدًا عَلَيْهِمْ كِفَايَتَهُمْ إِذِ اتَّخَذُوا آلِهَتَهُمْ آلِهَةً﴾. It means Jibril. ﴿وَإِذْ أَخَذْنَا مِنَ النَّبِيِّينَ مِيثَاقَهُمْ لَعَنَّاهُمْ وَرَأَى جِبْرِيلُ مُصَوِّدًا عَلَيْهِمْ كِفَايَتَهُمْ إِذِ اتَّخَذُوا آلِهَتَهُمْ آلِهَةً﴾. She said: "Verily, I seek refuge with the Most Gracious from you, if you do fear Allah." This means that when the angel (Jibril) appeared to her in the form of a man, while she was in a place secluded by herself with a partition between her and her people, she was afraid of him and thought that he wanted to rape her. Therefore, she said, ﴿وَإِذْ أَخَذْنَا مِنَ النَّبِيِّينَ مِيثَاقَهُمْ لَعَنَّاهُمْ وَرَأَى جِبْرِيلُ مُصَوِّدًا عَلَيْهِمْ كِفَايَتَهُمْ إِذِ اتَّخَذُوا آلِهَتَهُمْ آلِهَةً﴾. Verily, I seek refuge with the Most Gracious from you, if you do fear Allah. She meant, If you fear Allah, as a means of reminding him of Allah. This is what is legislated in defense against (evil), so that it may be repulsed with ease. Therefore, the first thing she did was try to make him fear Allah, the Mighty and Sublime. Ibn Jarir reported from Asim that Abu Wa'il said when mentioning the story of Maryam, She knew that the pious person would refrain (from committing evil) when she said, ﴿وَإِذْ أَخَذْنَا مِنَ النَّبِيِّينَ مِيثَاقَهُمْ لَعَنَّاهُمْ وَرَأَى جِبْرِيلُ مُصَوِّدًا عَلَيْهِمْ كِفَايَتَهُمْ إِذِ اتَّخَذُوا آلِهَتَهُمْ آلِهَةً﴾. "Verily, I seek refuge with the Most Gracious from you, if you do fear Allah." He said: "I am only a messenger from your Lord..." This means that the angel said to her in response, and in order to remove the fear that she felt within herself, I am not what you think, but I am the messenger of your Lord. By this he means; Allah has sent me to you. ﴿وَإِذْ أَخَذْنَا مِنَ النَّبِيِّينَ مِيثَاقَهُمْ لَعَنَّاهُمْ وَرَأَى جِبْرِيلُ مُصَوِّدًا عَلَيْهِمْ كِفَايَتَهُمْ إِذِ اتَّخَذُوا آلِهَتَهُمْ آلِهَةً﴾. It is said that when she mentioned the (Name of the) Most Beneficent (Ar-Rahman), Jibril fell away; and returned to his true form (as an angel). He responded, ﴿وَإِذْ أَخَذْنَا مِنَ النَّبِيِّينَ مِيثَاقَهُمْ لَعَنَّاهُمْ وَرَأَى جِبْرِيلُ مُصَوِّدًا عَلَيْهِمْ كِفَايَتَهُمْ إِذِ اتَّخَذُوا آلِهَتَهُمْ آلِهَةً﴾. At-Jabari 18:163. Tabari 18:164.

﴿وَإِذْ أَخَذْنَا مِنَ النَّبِيِّينَ مِيثَاقَهُمْ لَعَنَّاهُمْ وَرَأَى جِبْرِيلُ مُصَوِّدًا عَلَيْهِمْ كِفَايَتَهُمْ إِذِ اتَّخَذُوا آلِهَتَهُمْ آلِهَةً﴾. I am only a messenger from your Lord, to provide to you the gift of a righteous son. ﴿وَإِذْ أَخَذْنَا مِنَ النَّبِيِّينَ مِيثَاقَهُمْ لَعَنَّاهُمْ وَرَأَى جِبْرِيلُ مُصَوِّدًا عَلَيْهِمْ كِفَايَتَهُمْ إِذِ اتَّخَذُوا آلِهَتَهُمْ آلِهَةً﴾. She said: "How can I have a son..." This means that Maryam was amazed at this. She said, How can I have a son? She said this to mean, In what way would a son be born to me when I do not have a husband and I do not commit any wicked acts (i.e. fornication)? For this reason she said, ﴿وَإِذْ أَخَذْنَا مِنَ النَّبِيِّينَ مِيثَاقَهُمْ لَعَنَّاهُمْ وَرَأَى جِبْرِيلُ مُصَوِّدًا عَلَيْهِمْ كِفَايَتَهُمْ إِذِ اتَّخَذُوا آلِهَتَهُمْ آلِهَةً﴾. when no man has touched me, nor am I Baghiyya? The Baghiyya is a female fornicator. For this reason, a Hadith has been reported prohibiting the money earned from Baghiyya. ﴿وَإِذْ أَخَذْنَا مِنَ النَّبِيِّينَ مِيثَاقَهُمْ لَعَنَّاهُمْ وَرَأَى جِبْرِيلُ مُصَوِّدًا عَلَيْهِمْ كِفَايَتَهُمْ إِذِ اتَّخَذُوا آلِهَتَهُمْ آلِهَةً﴾. He said: "Thus said your Lord: That is easy for Me (Allah)..." This means that the angel said to her in response to her question, Verily, Allah has said that a boy will be born from you even though you do not have a husband and you have not committed any lewdness. Verily, He is Most Able to do whatever He wills. Due to this, he (Jibril) conveyed Allah's Words, ﴿وَإِذْ أَخَذْنَا مِنَ النَّبِيِّينَ مِيثَاقَهُمْ لَعَنَّاهُمْ وَرَأَى جِبْرِيلُ مُصَوِّدًا عَلَيْهِمْ كِفَايَتَهُمْ إِذِ اتَّخَذُوا آلِهَتَهُمْ آلِهَةً﴾. And (We wish) to appoint him as a sign to mankind. This means a proof and a sign for mankind of the power of their Maker and Creator, Who diversified them in their creation. He created their father, Adam, without a male (father) or female (mother). Then, He created Hawwa (Adam's spouse) from a male (father) without a female (mother). Then, He created the rest of their progeny from male and female, Ahmad 1:235, Al-Bukhari 2237, Muslim 1567.

except Isa. He caused Isa to be born from a female without, a male. Thus, Allah completed the four types of creation (of the human being), which proves the perfection of His power and the magnificence of His authority. There is no god worthy of worship except Him and there is no true Lord other than Him. Concerning Allah's statement, and a mercy from Us,} This means, We will make this boy a mercy from Allah and a Prophet from among the Prophets. He will call to the worship of Allah and monotheistic belief in Him. This is as Allah, the Exalted, said in another Ayah, 4 pfs j) t J* ii- 'nil' 0) 4 (4^=VJ t;jJ' i(Remember) when the angels said : "O Maryam! Verily, Allah gives you the good news of a Word from Him, his name will be Al-Masih, 'Isa, the son of Maryam, held in honor in this world and in the Hereafter, and he will be one of those who are near to Allah. And he will speak to the people, in the cradle and in manhood, and he will be one of the righteous .> (3 :45-46 This means that he will call to the worship of his Lord in his cradle and while an adult. Concerning His statement, j\ : (J\ &} and it is a matter (already) decreed (by Allah).} This is the completion of Jibril's dialogue with Maryam. [He informed her that this matter was preordained by Allah's power and will. Muhammad bin Ishaq said, 41' fra -* &>} and it is a matter (already) decreed (by Allah).} This means that Allah determined to do this, so there is no avoiding it. m At-Tabari 18:165.

4 ;^r;U--ju UJj c-i^= UIa jld 422. So she conceived him, and she withdrew with him to a remote place.} }23 . And the pains of childbirth drove her to the trunk of a date palm. She said: Would that I had died before this, and had been forgotten and out of sight!"} The Conception and the Birth Allah, the Exalted, informs about Maryam that when Jibril had spoken to her about what Allah said, she accepted the decree of Allah. Many scholars of the predecessors (Salaf) have mentioned that at this point the angel (who was Jibril) blew into the opening of the garment that she was wearing. Then the breath descended until it entered into her vagina and she conceived the child by the leave of Allah. Muhammad bin Ishaq said, When she conceived him and filled her water jug (at a well), she returned (to her people). After this, her menstrual bleeding ceased and she experienced what the pregnant woman experiences of sickness, hunger, change of color and there was even a change in the manner of her speech. After this, no people came to visit any house like they did the house of Zakariyya. The word spread among the Children of Israel and the people were saying, Verily, her partner (in fornication) was Yusuf, because there was no one else in the temple with her except him. So she hid herself from the people and placed a veil between herself and them. No one saw her and she did not see anyone else. Allah said; 4And the pains of childbirth drove her to the trunk of a date palm.} This means that her pains of labor compelled her to go to the trunk of a date-palm tree that was at the place where she had secluded herself. The scholars differed over its location. As- Suddi said, Her place of seclusion was to the east and that

was where she would pray at the Sacred House of Jerusalem. Wahb bin Munabbih said, She ran away and when she reached an area between Ash-Sham¹²¹ and Egypt, she was overcome by labor pains. ' In another narration from Wahb, he said, This took place eight miles from the Sacred House of Jerusalem in a village that was known Bayt Al-Lahm (Bethlehem). 4 * I say, there are Hadiths above; the Isra. (Night Journey of the Prophet (s)) that are reported An-Nasab on the authority of Anas, and Al-Bayhaqi on the authority of Shadad bin Aws, that say that this took place Bait Al-Lahm. Allah knows best. This is what is well known that the people all relate from each other. The Christians have no doubt held that the place of this occurrence was Bethlehem and this is what all the people relate. It has been related in) a

Hadith also, if the Hadith is authentic. Allah says, informing about her. Jie is ut * * A / // ,//y \Xa Jj cJUy 4She said: Would that I had died before this, and had been forgotten and out of sight!" In this is an evidence of the permissibility to wish for death when a calamity strikes. She knew that she was going to be tested with the birth, the people would not assist her, and they would not believe her story. After she was known as a devout worshipper among them, they now thought that she had become a fornicating whore. She said, jj j-. {Would that I had died before this,} [2 | [31 I4 1 (61 At-Tabari 18:161. Greater Syria At-Tabari 18:170. At-Jabari 18:170. An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 1 :22 1 . Most scholars consider the text that include Bethlehem as a place of prayer on the night of Isra' to be unauthentic Dald ilAn-Nubuwwah 2 :355

She said this to mean before this situation. iand I had been forgotten and out of sight!} This means, I wish I had not been created and I was nothing. This was mentioned by Ibn Abbas. 1 11 Qatadah said, iand I had been forgotten and out of sight!} This means something unknown, forgotten and no one knew who I was. sb** lily Ji If*?6 oi j ty/ , > / /< { // / f// V, ^ // OjJb \Jt Uj* wife jS 1/y* Cf*^, 424. 77ien he cried unto her from below her, saying: Grieve not: your Lord has provided a Sariy under you. } 425. "And shake the trunk of date palm towards you, it will let fall fresh ripe dates upon you."} 426. "So eat and drink and rejoice. And if you see any human being, say: Verily, I have vowed a fast for the Most Gracious so I shall not speak to any human being today,"} What was said to Her after the Birth Some reciters read the Ayah as, (Who was below her) Meaning the one who was below her called to her. Others recited it as, ifrom below her} With the meaning of a preposition (from) instead of a pronoun (who). The scholars of Tafsir have differed over the interpretation of who was calling out. Al- Awfi and others m At-Tabari 18:172.

reported from Ibn Abbas that he said, oi }Then cried unto her from below her,} This is referring to Jibril * because Isa did not speak until she brought him to her people. Similarly, Said bin Jubayr, Ad-Dahhak, Amr bin Maymun, As-Suddi and Qatadah all said, Verily, this is referring to the angel Jibril. 121 This means that he (Jibril) called out to her from the bottom of the valley. Mujahid said, iThen cried unto her from below her,} This is referring to Isa bin Maryam. Likewise, Abdur-Razzaq reported from Ma mar that Qatadah said that Al-Hasan said, This is referring to her son (Isa). This is also one of the two opinions reported from Said bin Jubayr - that it was her son i, Isa, speaking. Said said, Have you not heard Allah saying, iThen she pointed to him.} Ibn Zayd and Ibn Jarir preferred this opinion in his Tafsir. Allah said, iGrieve not He called to her saying, Do not grieve. lili iyour Lord has provided a Sariy under you.} Sufyan Ath-Thawri and ShulDah reported from Abu Ishaq that Al-Bara bin Azib said, Tb- kl J*} iyour Lord has provided a Sariy under you.} At-Tabari 18:173. Tabari 18:173.

This means a small stream. 111 Likewise, Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, Sariy means a river. ' Amr bin Maymun held the same view, as he said, It means a river for her to drink from. ' Mujahid said, It means river in the Syrian language. ' Sato bin Jubayr said, Sariy is a small flowing river. 's * Others said that Sariy refers to Isa. This was said by Al-Hasan, Ar-Rabl bin Anas, Muhammad bin Abbad bin Jafar, and it is one of the two opinions reported from Qatadah. It is also the view of Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam. However, the first view seems to be the most obvious meaning. For this reason, Allah said after it, tit, 4And shake the trunk of date palm towards you,4 meaning, Grab the trunk of the date-palm tree and shake it towards yourself. Therefore, Allah blessed her by giving her

food and drink. Then He said, *Isa My 4It ivill let fall fresh ripe dates upon you . So eat and drink and rejoice. Meaning to be happy. This is why Amr bin Maymun said, Nothing is better for the woman confined in childbed than dried dates and fresh dates. Then he recited this noble Ayah.*⁶ Concerning Allah's statement, *And if you see any human being,* } This means any person that you see, At-Tabari 18:175. At-Tabari 18:176. ' At-Tabari 18:176. ' At-Tabari 18:176. ' At-Tabari 18:176. ⁶ At-Tabari 18:179.

*-yf *y* CiJA. 41 44-*} 4Say : Verily, I have vowed a fast unto the Most Gracious (Allah) so I shall not speak to any human being today.}* Meaning, by signaling with gestures, not a statement speech. This is so that she does not negate her oath itself, pii=J A>} 4so I shall not speak to any human being today.} Anas bin Malik commented on, *iA~A ojji; 4', have vowed a fast unto the Most Gracious}* He said; A vow of silence. * Likewise said Ibn Abbas and Ad-Dahhak. The meaning here is that in their Law, when fasting, it was forbidden for them to eat and speak. As-Suddi, Qatadah ajid Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd have all stated this view. Abdur- Rahman bin Zayd said, When Isa said to Maryam, *4Grieve not}* She said, How can I not grieve when you are with me and I have no husband nor am I an owned slave woman? What excuse do I have with the people? Woe unto me, if I had only died before this, and had been a thing forgotten and unknown. Then, Isa said to her, I will suffice you with a statement, *(4^=' by*> It^A iyj 44-* '-**-* y; bb}* 4And if you see any human being, say : Verily, I have vowed] a fast unto the Most Gracious so I shall not speak to any\ human being this day. } All of this is from the speech of Isa to his mother. Wahb said the same as well. Tabari 18:182-183. At-Tabari 18:182-183. At-Tabari 18:183, Al-Qurtubi 11 :98.

mm r-v hot /. * *'*? > * ' ' f \ i " -. / ^ "C "l-f ^ -iai ^ ^>*Ujfcru l)jy*^i~djC^=\a^KjL* (_ji*>-Jf|p^ v " / / / / f" // ,x / y i . I . x // 4-4!^!^?&P Vjk=r)j Oi -r \>~t "'-ls j3J j*~j ~~A JJb "_JJ_ ls h jn^! " " % ye Xa vf;> ., a> lr*' o^ U iy/A oi-lji vs (la> *iL*^ oiK^ l*y O* "Jl ijJU OjU-li Jfc iWjllij "j ^J 33f Gp'* ji' ^ (* ci) lC* h:~t ^%iM^^ pj a^i i!hJ \$:&. \j ;r>;iiii ijii: cs.j '-a- f- fji i> rT, - 14' Then she brought him to her people, carrying him. They said: "O Mary! Indeed you have brought a thing Fariy."> "O sister of Harm! Your father was not a man who used to commit adultery, nor your mother was an unchaste woman." } /i\ / < " >:LSj" dJ .a) 429. Then she pointed to him. They said: How can we talk to one who is a child in the cradle?" } 430. He said: Verily , I am a servant of Allah, He has given me the Scripture and made me a Prophet; } 431. And He has made me blessed wherever I be, and has enjoined on me [Axusatii] Salah and Zakdh, as long as I live." } 432. And to be dutiful to my mother, and made me not arrogant, unblessed." } 433. And Salam (peace) be upon me the day I was born, and the day I die, and the day I shall be raised alive!" }

Maryam with Al-Masih before the People, Their Rejection of Her and His Reply to Them Allah, the Exalted, informs of Maryam's situation when she was commanded to fast that day and not to speak to any human being. For verily, her affair would be taken care of and her proof would be established. Thus, she accepted the command of Allah and she readily received His decree. She took her child and brought him to her people, carrying him. When they saw her like this they made a big deal about her situation and they sternly protested against it, and ! iThey said: O Mary! Indeed you have brought a thing Fariy Fariy means a mighty thing. This was said by Mujahid, Qatadah, As-Suddi and others.^ ' Ibn Abi Hatim reported from Nawf Al-Bikall that he said, Her people went out searching for her, she

was from a family that was blessed with prophethood and nobility. However, they could not find any trace of her. They came across a cow herder and they asked him, Have you seen a girl whose description is such and such? He replied, No, but tonight I saw my cows doing something that I've never seen them do before. They asked, What did you see? He said, Tonight I saw them prostrating in the direction of that valley. 121 Abdullah bin Ziyad said (adding to the narration), I memorized from Sayyar that he (the cattle herder) said, I saw a radiant light. So they went towards the direction that he told him, and Maryam was coming towards them from that direction. When she saw them she sat down and she was holding her child in her lap. They came towards her until they were standing over her. ! iThey said: O Mary! Indeed you have brought a mighty thing (Fariy)." At-Tabari 18:185. 121 At-Tabari 18:187.

iThen she pointed to him.} She indicated, Speak to him. They then said, After she has come to us with this calamity, she now commands us to speak to one who is a child in the cradle! 111 As-Suddi said, When she pointed to him they became angry and said, Her mocking us, to the extent of commanding us to speak to this child, is worse to us than her fornication. itt4340^^ iThey said: "How can we talk to one who is a child in the cradle?"} This means, How can someone speak who is in his cradle, in the state of infancy and a child? Isa said, ju 4Verily, I am a servant of Allah,} The first thing that he said was a declaration of the lofty honor of his Lord and His being free of having a child. Also, he affirmed that he himself was a worshipper of his Lord. Allah said, it 33r \$He has given me the Scripture and made me a Prophet.} This was a declaration of innocence for his mother from the immorality that was attributed to her. Nawf Al-Bikall said, When they said what they said to his mother, he (Isa) was nursing from her breast. At their statement he released the breast from his mouth and reclined on his left saying, it ii > iVerily, I am a servant of Allah, He has given me the Scripture and made me a Prophet.} And he continued speaking until he said, it- } 111 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur5:507.Tabari 18:189.

254 Tafsir Ibn Kathir ias long as I live.}" Concerning his statement, 4And He has made me blessed wherever I be, Mujahid, Amr bin Qays and Ath-Thawri all said that this means, And He made me a teacher of goodness. * In another narration from Mujahid, he said, A person of great benefit. Ibn Jarir reported from Wuhayb bin Al-Ward, a freed slave of the Bani Makhzum tribe, that he said, A scholar met another scholar who had more knowledge than himself. So he said to him, May Allah have mercy upon you, what acts of mine should I perform openly? The other replied, Commanding good and forbidding evil, for verily, it is the religion of Allah, which He sent His Prophets with to His servants. The scholars have indeed agreed upon the statement of Allah, 4And He has made me blessed wherever I be,} Then it was said, What was his blessing? He (Wuhayb) replied, 'Commanding good and forbidding evil wherever he was. His saying, 4and He has enjoined on me [Awasdni] Salah and Zakdh, as long as I live .} This is similar to the statement of Allah to Muhammad jfa, 4And worship your Lord until there comes unto you the certainty (i.e. death).} [15:99] Abdur-Rahman bin Al-Qasim reported from Malik bin Anas that he commented on Allah's statement, At-Tabari 18:191. At-Tabari 18:191. * At-Tabari 18:191.

Maryam (27-33) (Part-16) iand He has enjoined on me [Awasdni] Salah and Zakdh, as long as I live. He said, Allah informed him of what would be of his affair until his death. This is the firmest evidence against the people who deny Allah's preordained decree. ,1) Concerning Allah's statement, 44& 4And

to be dutiful to my mother.} This means, He (Allah) has commanded me to treat my mother well. He mentioned this after mentioning obedience to his Lord, Allah. This is because Allah often combines the command to worship Him with obedience to the parents. This is similar to Allah's statement, 4And your Lord has decreed that you worship none but Him and that you be dutiful to your parents.} [17:23] And He, the Exalted, said, fV 3* J%=& 4Cive thanks to Me and to your parents. Unto Me is the final destination .} [31:14] Concerning his statement, 4^ 'jL*- iand He made me not arrogant, unblessed .} This means, He (Allah) has not made me too proud or arrogant to worship Him, obey Him and be dutiful to my mother, and thus be unblessed; Concerning Allah's statement, 4 rr ^ cfj fyj 4And Salam (peace) be upon me the day I was born, and the day I die, and the day I shall be raised alive!} This is his affirmation that Tie is a worshipper of Allah, the Mighty and Sublime, and that he is a creature created by Allah. He (Isa) will live, die and be resurrected, just like the HI Al-Qurtubi 11:103. That is, he understood Awsdni with (its alternative meaning: He decreed for me. .

256 Tafslr Ibn Kathlr other creatures that Allah has created. However, he will have peace in these situations, which are the most difficult situations for Allah's creatures. May Allah's peace and blessings be upon him. J jl), C. f-j* {j) -i>>" 'jc* oiliu *ji jjj ffdcs) jji Qu fit iji 4-]5f7"* ^y, 4r*~* ciSJJ Jr*. . Shc/i is 7sfl, son 0/ Maryam. Qawlul-Haqq [it is a statement of truth] about which they doubt (or dispute).} 435. It befits not (the majesty of) Allah that He should beget a son. Glorified be He. Wlten He decrees a thing, He only says to it: "Be!" - and it is.} 436. [Isa said] : "And verily, Allah is my Lord and your Lord. So ivorship Him. That is the straight path."} 437. Then the sects differed, so ivoe unto the disbelievers from the meeting ofa great Day.} Isa is the Servant ofAllah and not His Son Allah, the Exalted, says to His Messenger Muhammad jg, This is the story which We have related to you about Isa, upon him be peace. 4-jja-j *j> i(It is) a statement of truth about which they doubt.} This means that the people of falsehood and the people of truth are in disagreement, of those who believe in him and those who disbelieve believe in him. For this reason most of the reciters recited this Ayah with Qawlul-Haqq (statement of truth) as the subject, referring to Isa himself. Asim and Abdullah bin Amir both recited it Qawlul-Haqq (statement of truth) referring to the story in its entirety that the people differed about. It is reported from Ibn Masftd that he recited it as Qalal-Haqq, which means that he (Isa) said the truth. The recitation of the Ayah with the Qawlul-Haqq being the subject referring to Isa, is the most apparent meaningTabari 18:194.

grammatically. It has support for it in the statement of Allah [after the story of Isa], 4(This is) the truth from your Lord, so be not of those who doubt> [3:60] When Allah mentioned that He created him as a servant and a Prophet, He extolled Himself, the Most Holy, by saying, 4It befits not (the maiesht of) Allah that He should beset a son. Glorified be He.} Means glory be unto Him, He is far exalted above that which these ignorant, wrongdoing, transgressing people say about Him. 4m jr i!& 0 ! iWhen He decrees a thing, He only says to it: "Be! - and if I is.} Whenever He wants something, He merely commands it and it happens as He wills. This is as Allah says, j*j' 'jC> y'J ii' oj& &j oi iVerily, the likeness of 'Isa before Allah is the likeness of Adam. He created him from dust, then said to him: "Be and he was. (This is) the truth from your Lord, so be not of those ivho doubt.} [3:59-60] Isa commanded the Worship of Allah Alone, then the People differed afterHim Allah said; ; / .<' > " *' .V ^ XS> 4 jhjij Jp AS' 4And verily, Allah is my Lord and your Lord. So worship Him. That is the straight

path.} Among those things which Isa said to his people while he was in his cradle is that Allah was his Lord and their Lord, and] he commanded them to worship Him alone. He said,

258 Tafslr Ibn Kathtr iSo ivorship Him. That is the straight path .) Meaning, That which I have come to you with from Allah is the straight path. This means that the path is correct; whoever follows it will be rightly guided and whoever opposes it will deviate and go astray. Allah s statement, "M) iThen the sects differed,) means that the opinions of the People of the Book differed concerning Isa even after the explanation of his affair and the clarification of his situation. They disagreed about his being the servant of Allah, His Messenger, and His Word that He cast upon Maryam and a spirit from Himself. So a group of them - who were the majority of the Jews (may Allah s curses be upon them) - determined that he was a child of fornication and that his speaking in his cradle was merely sorcery. Another group said that it was Allah Who was speaking (not Isa). Others said that he (Isa) was the son of Allah. Some said that he was the third part of a divine trinity with Allah. Yet, others said that he was the servant of Allah and His Messenger. This latter view is the statement of truth, which Allah guided the believers to. A report similar with this meaning has been reported from Amr bin Maymun, Ibn Jurayj, Qatadah and others from the Salaf (predecessors) and the Khalaf (later generations). Allah said, oi i& Jo*) iso zoee unto the disbelievers from the meeting ofa great Day.) This is a threat and severe warning for those who lie about Allah, invent falsehood and claim that He (Allah) has a son. However, Allah has given them respite until the Day of Resurrection, and He has delayed their term out of gentleness and confident reliance upon His divine decree overcoming them. Verily, Allah does not hasten the affair of those who disobey Him. This has been related in a Hadith collected in the Two Sahihs,

cilL sA>-i lil JUKU ^U2 iul jj Verily, Allah gives respite to the wrongdoer until He seizes him and he will not be able to escape Hima Then, the Messenger of Allah recited the Ayah, i m i.4 U} / & k ui. jtftit 5L\ hi 5a /c/i is the punishment of your Lord when He punishes the towns while they are doing wrong. Verily, His punishment is painful, (and) severe [11:102) In the Two Sahilis it is also reported that the Messenger Allah 5e said, pf ur. aJ j JuL j* "l jJ- 'f L*jJ "No one is more patient with something harmful that he hears than Allah. Verily, they attribute to Him a son, while He is the One Wlw provides them sustenance and good health ."[21 Allah says. 4 i\ IjJj lyJu- jZ *liUi TIAi LA 0;l^==y^ "And many a township did I give respite while it was given to wrongdoing. Then I punished it. And to me is the (final) return (of all).} [22:48] Allah, the Exalted, also says, fj) Jt-ji o .ltll !"-* Viik ii 4 J .V 4Consider not that Allah is unaware of that which the wrongdoers do, but He gives them respite up to a Day when the eyes will stare in horror.}\ 14:42] This is the reason that Allah says here, tf. 4t-l* jt jiy? iSo woe unto the disbelievers from the meeting of a great Fath Al-Bari 8 :205 , Muslim 4 : 1997 Fath Al-Bari 10:527, Muslim 4 :2160.

Day.) referring to the Day of Resurrection. It has been related in an authentic Hadlth that is agreed upon (in Al-Bukhari and Muslim), on the authority of TJbadah bin As-Samit who said that the Messenger of Allah sg said, j\j ojlp V ajJ-j Jill VI iJ) V Cl? Jtfd jUij jf_j f)\ UliJ? IjjCJl jLS La 41| 4JJ I olA^ioeyer testifies that there is no deity worthy of worship except Allah alone, Who has no partners, and that Muhammad is His servant and Messenger, and that Isa was Allah's servant and Messenger, and His Word that He cast upon Maryam, and a spirit from Him, and that Paradise and Hell are both real, then Allah will admit him into Paradise regardless of whatever he did.] s/y.* '<*' .'iu > > ' i\i tZiSst > * > 4

Qp fa ctj ^ A> fa ^ h 438. How clearly will they see and hear, the Day when they will appear before Us! But the wrongdoers today are in plain error.) 439. And warn them of the Day of grief and regrets, when the case has been decided, while (now) they are in a state of carelessness, and they believe not.) 440. Verily, We will inherit the earth and whatsoever is thereon. And to Us they all shall be returned.) The Disbeliever's warning of the Day of Distress Allah, the Exalted, says informing about the disbelievers on the Day of Resurrection that they will be made to have the clearest hearing and sight. This is as Allah says, a. ..j b/tfu? I j il j&)) 4And if you only could see when the criminals hang their heads FathAl-Bari 6:546, Muslim 1 :57.

before their Lord (saying) : Our Lord! We have now seen and heard."} [32:12] They will say that when it will not benefit them, nor will it be of any use to them. If they had used these senses properly before seeing the torment, then it would have brought them some benefit and saved them from the Allah's punishment. This is why Allah says, rr. }How clearly will they (disbelievers) see and hear,} This means that no one will hear and see better than they will. (j> } the day when they will appear before Us.} The Day of Resurrection. }But the wrongdoers today are...} now, in the life of this! world, 4...in plain error.} They do not hear, see or think. When they are requested to follow guidance, they are not guided and they succumb to those things that do not benefit them. Then, Allah says, iAnd warn them of the Day of grief and regrets,} warn the creation of the Day of Distress, ^& iwhen the case has been decided,} when the people of Paradise and the people of Hell will be sorted out, and everyone will reach his final abode which he was destined to remain in forever. ip. iwhile (now) they are} today, in the present life of this world.

262 Tafslr Ibn Kathir iin a state of carelessness.) with the warning of the Day of grief and regret, they are heedless. iand they believe not.) meaning they do not believe that it is true. Imam

"gjj i a. & j gi)i jil "77ic people of this life are in the state of heedlessness of this lifeV Thus recorded Imam

^ rn r*A Italia T > y^ -t x, '&ck)J&\ c 4^Jla Sr-Md^ dJUuj^j U^t^ii Utitli jU.>!) I <^ *WJi liy^ kiLIJju"oUitioibj^ll^ JU '-4)o'W ojxioUj iiu jt.i^jfr^t Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Hazm bin Abi Hazm Al-Quta ! said, Umar bin Abdul-Aziz wrote to Abdul-Hamid bin Abdur-Rahman, who was the governor of Kufah: Thus, to proceed: Verily, Allah prescribed death for His creatures when He created them and He determined their final destination. He said in that which He revealed in His truthful Book, which He guarded with His knowledge and made His angels testify to its preservation, that He will inherit the earth and all who are on it, and they will all be returned to Him. 441. And mention in the Book, Ibrahim. Verily, he was a man of truth, a Prophet. 442. When he said to his father : "O my father! Why do you worship that which hears not, sees not and cannot avail you in anything?"} Ibn Abi Hatim 7 : 2410.

265Siirah 19. Maryam (41-45) (Part-16) 443. "O my father! Verily, there has come to me the knowledge of that which came not unto you. So follow me, I will guide you to the straight path."} 444. "O my father! Worship not Shaytan. Verily, Shaytan has been a rebel against the Most Gracious."} 445. O my father! Verily, I fear lest a torment from the Most Gracious should overtake you, so that you become a companion of Shaytan."} Ibrahim's Admonition of His Father Allah, the Exalted, tells His

Prophet, Muhammad 4And mention in the Book, Ibrahim.} Recite this to your people who are worshipping idols and mention to them what happened with Ibrahim, the intimate Friend (Khalit) of the Most Beneficent. These idol worshippers (Arabs) are his descendants and they claim to follow his religion. Inform them that he was a truthful Prophet. Tell them about what took place with his father and how he forbade him from worshipping idols. Ibrahim said, 4 dU Sfj my father! Why do you worship that which hears not, sees] not and cannot avail you in anything?} Meaning that these idols will not benefit you, nor can tljey protect you from any harm. jiJ U jiff *^ -** til 40 my father! Verily, there has come to me the knowledge of that which came not unto you.} This means, Even though I am from your loins and you see me as inferior to you because I am your son, know that I have received knowledge from Allah that you do not know anil it has not reached you. luS 4Sofollow me, I will guide you to the straight path.} I

meaning, a straight path that will cany you to the desired objective and save you from that which is dreaded (Hell). 40 my father! Worship not Shaytan.) This is means, Do not obey him by worshipping these idols. He invites to this (idolatry) and he is pleased with it. This is as Allah says, S^*^' sj fSU xfjS ff) 4Did I not command you, O Children of Adam, that you should not worship Shaytan . Verily, he is a plain enemy to you.) (36:60] Allah also says, V! iThey invoke nothing but females [idols] besides Him (Allah), and they invoke nothing but Shaytdn, a persistent rebel 1 [4:117] Concerning Allah s statement, * c x# u) iVerily, Shaytdn has been a rebel against the Most Gracious.) This means obstinate and too arrogant to obey his Lord. Therefore, Allah expelled him and made him an outcast. Therefore, do not follow him or you will become like him. S' 4 40 my father! Verily, I fear lest a torment from the Most Gracious should overtake you,) because of your associating partners with Allah and your disobedience in what I am commanding you with. lu SjSi" 4so that you become a companion ofShaytdn .) This means, there will be no one who will protect you, or help you, or assist you, except Iblls. However, neither he, nor anyone else, has any power over the outcome of matters.

Si ral i 19. Maryam (46-48) (Part-16 Following him will only cause you to be surrounded by the torment (of Allah). This is as Allah says, & ^ ^ Jj'jc Allah, We indeed sent (Messengers) to the nations before you, but Shaytan made their deeds fair seeming to them. So he is their helper today (in this world), and theirs will be a painful torment. [16:63] JU n lit* ' } oJ fjfi ly cJ 4-^J f of ot fjy-oi Uj fJ - 'j ! y tii"- ^ xjj ^ A - - 1 . Vllil jf Vi jfj yj S . He (the father) said: "Do you revile my gods, O Ibrahim If you stop not (this), I will La arjumannak . So get away from me Maliyan."} . Ibrahim said: "Peace be on you! I will ask forgiveness of my Lord for you. Verily, He is unto me Hajfyyan .} . And I shall turn away from you and from those whom you invoke besides Allah. And I shall call upon my Lord, and I certainly hope that l shall not be unblessed in my invocation to my Lord."} The Reply ofIbrahim s Father Allah, the Exalted, informs of the reply of Ibrahim s father to his son, Ibrahim, in reference to what he was calling him [to. He said, you revile my gods, O Ibrahim?} This means, Ifyou do not want to worship them (the idols) and you are not pleased with them, then at least stop cursing, abusing, and reviling them. For verily, ifyou do not cease, I will punish you, curse you ^nd revile you. This is the meaning of his statement; iLa arjumannaka

Ibn Abbas, As-Suddi, Ibn Jurayj, Ad-Dahhak and others said this. 111 ' Concerning His statement, iSo get awayfrom me Maliyati .} Mujahid, Tkrimah, Said bin Jubayr and Mujahid bin Ishaq all said,

Maliyan means forever."121 Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, For a long time."131 As-Suddi said, &#>} 4So get away from me safely Maliyan .} This means forever. 141 Ali bin Abi Talhah and Al- Awfi both reported that Ibn Abbas said, 4So get away from me safely Maliyan. This means to go away in peace and safety before you are afflicted with a punishment from me. Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah, Atiyah Al-Jadali, Malik and others said the same. This is also the view preferred by Ibn Jarir. The Reply of Allah's Friend (Khalit) With this, Ibrahim said to his father, f&} iPeace be on you!} This is as Allah said concerning the description of the believers, &} iand when the foolish address them (with bad words) they say , "Salaman [peace]."} [25:63] Allah also says, v0 % pj &A u tfg ^ i; At-Tabari 18:205. At-Tabari 18:205,206. At-Tabari 18:205. At-Tabari 18:206.

Sitrah 19. Maruam (46-48) (Part-16) 269 4Arid when they hear Al-Laghwa (false speech), they withdraw from it and say: "To us our deeds, and to you your deeds. Peace be to you. We seek not (the way of) the ignorant. } [28:55]

The meaning of Ibrahim's statement to his father,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3434-3451]

iPeace be on you!} You will not receive any insult or harm from me. This is due to the respect and honor of fatherhood. 41 will ask forgiveness of my Lord for you.} meaning But, I will ask Allah to guide you and forgive you for your sin. ^^ >\$} iVerily, He is unto me Hafiyya.} Ibn Abbas and others said that Hafvyyan means, Kind. j Meaning, since He guided me to worship Him and direct my religious devotion to Him alone. As-Suddi said, Al-Hafi is Cj Who is concerned with his (Ibrahim's) affair. Thus, Ibrahim sought forgiveness for his father for a very long time, even after he migrated to Ash-Sham. He continued to seek forgiveness for him even after building the Sacred Masjid (in Makkah) and after the birth of his two sons, Ismail and Ishaq. This can be seen in his statement, fX\$VOX 4& iOur Lord! Forgive me and my parents, and (all) the believers on the Day when the reckoning will be established.} [14:41] From this tradition, during the beginning stages of Islam, jthe Muslims used to seek forgiveness for their relatives and their family members who were polytheists. They did this following the way of Ibrahim, the Khalil (Friend) of Allah, until Allah revealed, Jabari 18:207.

lii fC. bv \ ijlte i\ ,*Z jd\j -j 111! JjK" J. it > s >> ' Oji JjAyO ilndeed there has been an excellent example for you in Ibrahim and those with him, iwhen they said to their people: "Verily, you are free from you and whatever you worship besides Allah.") [60:4] Until Allah's statement, 4 jj ji' Oi ilM lAlpI \aj of Jy 4Except the saying of Ibrahim to his father: "Verily , I will ask forgiveness (from Allah) for you, but I have no power to do anything for you before Allah.") [60:4] meaning, except for this statement, so do not follow it. Then Allah explains that Ibrahim abandoned this statement and retracted it. Allah, the Exalted, says, \ dp:PM P? C) 411 is not (proper) for the Prophet and those who believe to ask Allah's forgiveness for the idolators.) [9:113] Until Allah's statement, 0 A \jmi fa? Pi Zjfl PZO '& kk&& 5 4And Ibrahim's invoking for his father's forgiveness was only because of a promise he had made to him. But when it became clear to him that he is an enemy of Allah, he dissociated himself from him. Verily, Ibrahim was AwwdhJ forbearing.) [9:114] Concerning Allah's statement, i4& 4*&& Cjppj) 4And I shall turn away from you and from those whom you invoke besides Allah. And I shall call upon

my Lord,) This means, And I worship my Lord alone, associating no partners with Him. See the Tafsir of Stirat At-Tawbah 9:114.

1 sp ^} ! 41 certainly hope that I shall not be unblessed in my invocation to my Lord.} The word Asa (I hope) here means that which will necessarily occur and not that which is hoped for from the impossible. For verily, he (Ibrahim) is the leader of the Prophets other than Muhammad %. illftjj ..I'.Lyj UL>> ^ OJXM" oYJ tiJ*rj llit-j 449. So when he had turned away from them and from those whom they worshipped besides Allah, We gave him Ishaq and Ya'qub, and each one of them We made a Prophet.} 450. And We gave them of Our mercy, and We granted them Sidqin 'Aliyyan on the tongues.} Allah gave Ibrahim Ishaq and Ya'qub Allah, the Exalted, says that when the Friend of Allah (Ibrahim) withdrew from his father and his people for the sake of Allah, Allah gave him in exchange those who were better than them. He gave him Ishaq (Isaac) and Ya'qub (Jacob), meaning his son, Ishaq, and Ishaq's son, Ya'qub. This is Allah said in another Ayah, 4 vliyijuj4 as 4 and Ya'qub, a grandson.} (21:72) Also, Allah says, 4 and after Ishaq, of Ya'qub.} [11:71] There is no difference of opinion about Ishaq being the father of Ya'qub. This is what is recorded in the Qur'an in Suran Al-Baqarah. jL u ijlli St JI* H oJf C-jyYYs fly Sljhl* ijij 40r were you witnesses when death approached Ya'qub? Wlten

272 fakir Ibn Kathir he said unto his sons, "What will you worship after me?" They said, "We shall worship your God the God of your fathers, Ibrahim, Istna'il and Ishaq.">[2:133] Allah only mentioned Ishaq and Ya'qub here to show that He made Prophets from among his descendants and successors in order to give him relief and happiness in his life. This is why Allah says, i and each one of them We made a Prophet [19:49] If Ya'qub had not become a Prophet in the lifetime of Ibrahim, then Allah would not have limited the promise of prophethood to him, but He would have mentioned his son Yusuf as well. For verily, Yusuf was also a Prophet, just as the Messenger of Allah sg said in a Hadith whose authenticity is agreed upon, when he was asked who was the best of people. He jg said, ^ tsT)1 Cjtpuu jB Prophet of Allah, Yusuf, the son of the Prophet of Allah Ya'qub, the son of the Prophet of Allah Ishaq, the son of the Friend of Allah Ibrahim. >,l> In another wording of this Hadith, he said, Ji ^ j> i Verily, the noble one is the son of the noble one, who is the son of the noble one, zoho is the son of the noble one. That is Yusuf, the son of Ya'qub, the son of Ishaq, the son of Ibrahim.* Concerning Allah's statement, i And We gave them of Our mercy, and We granted Sidqin Aliyyan on the tongues Fath Al-Bari 8 :212 . '2| Fath Al-Bari 6 :460 .

Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, Sidqin Aliyyan means the good praise. As-Suddi and Malik bin Anas said the same thing. Ibn Jarir said, Allah only said Aliyyan (loftiness, exalted) because all of the religions commend them and mention them with praises, may Allah's peace and blessing be upon them all. 12' Jx jt 2; :M te& a* ar k j fcr* w /0 , T . And mention in the Book, Musa. Verily, he was Mukhlisan and he was a Messenger, (and) a Prophet.} 452. And We called him from the right side of the Mount (Tiir), and made him draw near to Us for a talk with him.} 453. And We granted him his brother Harun, (also) a Prophet, out of Our mercy.} Mentioning Musa and Harun After Allah had mentioned Ibrahim, the Friend of Allah, aiid commended him, he next mentioned Al-Kalim (the one spoken to by Allah directly). Allah said, i And mention in the Book, Musa. Verily, he was Mukhlisan} Ath-Thawri reported from Abdul-Aziz bin Rafi , from Alsu Lubabah that he said, The Disciples (of Isa) said, O Spirit of Allah, inform us about the one who is Mukhlis (purely devoted) to Allah. He said, That

is one who does a deed solely for Allah and he does not like for the people to praise him. Others recited the word as Mukhlas, which means that he was chosen. This is as Allah says, j[} 4 Verily, I have chosen you above men.} [7:144] Concerning Allah's statement, At-Tabari 18:208. At-Tabari 18:208.

iatid he was a Messenger, (and) a Prophet. Allah combined these two descriptions for him. For verily, he was one of the greatest Messengers and one of the five Messengers of Strong Will. They are NOh, Ibrahim, Musa, Isa and Muhammad. May the blessings of Allah be upon them and all of the Prophets. Allah said, s-C Jt iAnd We called him from the side of the Ti/r> means Mount ight} It was on the right side of Musa when he went seeking a burningwood from that fire. He saw its glow in the distance, so he set out towards it and found it on the right side of the mountain from his direction, at the edge of the valley that he was in. This is when Allah, the Exalted, spoke to him and called out to him. Allah summoned him to come near and He conversed Ayah with him. Concerning His statement, / , S / 1 j' * \ 4And We granted him his brother Hariin, (also) a Prophet, out of Our mercy This means, We responded to his request and his plea on behalf of his brother and We made him a Prophet as well. This is as Allah says in another Ayah, cJ SO 6l y, y iAnd my brother Hariin he is more eloquent in speech than me: so send him with me as a helper to confirm me. Verily, I fear that they will belie me .^ [28:34] Also, Allah said, 4 "*[!]" 4(Allah said:) "You are granted your request, O Musa."} [20:36] He also said,

c5ia cs\$# 4So se;uf /or Harfm. And they have a charge of crime against me, and Ifear they ivill kill me.} [26:13-14] Because of this, some of the Salaf (predecessors) said, No one in this life pleaded on behalf of someone else more than Musa pleaded for his brother to be a Prophet. Allah, the Exalted said, 4And We granted him his brother Harm, (also) a Prophet, out of Our mercy.} ..nit st Vj-y o^j Al 4 iiJ o&y 'iPifj 454. And mention in the Book, Ismd'tl. Verily, he was true to what he promised, and he was a Messenger, (and) a Prophet.} 455. And he would enjoin on his family and his people the Saldh and the Zakdh, and his Lord was pleased with him.} Mentioning Isma fl Here Allah has commended Ismail, the son of Ibrahim, the Friend of Allah. He (Ismail) is the father of all of the Arabs of the Hijaz because he was true to what he promised. Ibn Jurayj said, He did not make any promise to his Lord, except that he fulfilled it. He never obligated himself to do any act of worship with a vow, except that he fulfilled it and carried it out, giving it its full due. Some said, 5> >} 4(he was) true to what he promised.} This was said about him because he said to his father, 4 0} Jit 41fAllah wills you willfind me of the patient.} [37:102] So he was truthful in that. Being true to one's promise is one m At-Tabari 18 :2 1 1

of the praiseworthy characteristics, just as breaking one's promise is of the detested characteristics. Allah, the Exalted, says, i U \JJa J ISC 1 C l C 1\$ iO you who believe! Why do you say that which you do not do? Most hateful it is with Allah that you say that which you do not do.} [61:2-3] The Messenger of Allah jg said, lilj ii-jib-l JLPj lijj t . Ijl : Xt'i'll "77ie sign of the hypocrite is three things. When he speaks, he lies; when he promises, he breaks his promise; and when he is entrusted with something, he is disloyal to his trust. Thus, if these are the characteristics of the hypocrites, then behaving contraiy to these is a characteristic of the true believer. For this reason, Allah commended His servant and Messenger Ismail, for he was true to his promise. Likewise, the Messenger of Allah jg was true to his promise. He did not promise anyone anything, except that he fulfilled his promise to that person. He also commended Abu Al- As bin Ar-Rabl , the husband of his daughter Zaynab, by saying, 1J. J>? "He spoke to me and he told me the truth, and he promised me and hefulfilled his promise to me." When the

Prophet ﷺ died, the Khalifah (his successor), Abu Bakr As-Siddiq said, Whoever received any promise from the Messenger of Allah ﷺ or was owed any debt by him, then let him come to me and I will fulfill it on his behalf. So Jabir bin Abdullah came and related that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, "The wealth of Bahrain comes (to me), then I would give you such and such and such." Al-Bukhari no. 33,2682,2749,6095 Al-Bari 5:380.

This meant that he would fill his hands with wealth. Therefore, when the wealth of Bahrain came (to them), Abu Bakr commanded Jabir to come and fill his hands from that wealth. Then, he commanded him to do so again, until he collected five hundred Dirhams. Then, Abu Bakr gave him its double along with it. (i.e. one thousand extra Dirhams). Concerning Allah's statement, 'And he was a Messenger, (and) a Prophet.' In this is a proof of Ismail's favored status over his brother, Ishaq. Ishaq was only described as being a Prophet, but Isma'il was described with both prophethood and messengership. It is confirmed in Sahih Muslim that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, 'Verily, Allah chose Isma'il from the sons of Ibrahim.' Then, Imam Muslim mentions the rest of the Hadith in its entirety. However, this statement proves the correctness of what we have said. Allah said, 'And he would enjoin on his family and his people the Salath and the Zakah, and his Lord was pleased with him.' This is also a beautiful form of praise, a commendable quality, and an upright characteristic. He was commanded in this way because of his persistence in obedience of his Lord, and enjoining his family to do so. This is as Allah said to His Messenger ﷺ, 'And enjoin the Salath on your family, and be patient with them.' [20:132] Also, Allah, the Exalted, said, 'I have chosen Isma'il.' Fath Al-Bari 4:554. 4:1782.

And you who believe! Protect yourselves and your families against a Fire (Hell) whose fuel is men and stones, over which are (appointed) angels stern (and) severe, who disobey not, (from executing) the commands they receive from Allah, but do that which they are commanded. [66:6] This means to command them to do good, forbid them from evil and do not neglect them. If you do so, and they obey your command, the Fire (of Hell) will not devour them on the Day of Resurrection. It has been reported in a Hadith from Abu Hurayrah that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, 'If a man gets up at night to pray and he wakes his wife. If she refuses to get up, he sprinkles water in her face. May Allah have mercy upon a woman who gets up at night to pray and she wakes her husband. If she refuses to get up, she sprinkles water in his face.' This Hadith was recorded by

Jarir bin Sulayman reported from Sufyan reported from 'Ubayd bin 'Umayr that 'Ubayd bin 'Umayr said, 'I heard the Messenger of Allah ﷺ say, 'We raised him a high station.' This means the fourth heaven. Al-Hasan and others said concerning Allah's statement, 'We raised him a high station.' This means Paradise. 'We raised him a high station.' Those were they unto whom Allah bestowed His grace from among the Prophets, of the offspring of Adam, and of those whom We carried (in the ship) with Nuh, and of the offspring of Ibrahim and Israel, and from among those whom We guided and chose. When the Ayat of the Most Gracious were recited unto them, they fell down prostrate and weeping. These Prophets are the Chosen Ones Allah, the

Exalted, says that these Prophets (were favored), tjut this does not mean only these Prophets who were mentioned in this Surah. Rather, it is referring to all of those who were m At-Tabari 18 :213

Prophets. Allah merely changes the implication of the discussion from specific individuals to the entire group of Prophets. Ji y " j*"1 qy"ip ithey unto whom Allah bestowed His grace from among the Prophets, of the offspring of Adam.} As-Suddi and Ibn Jarir both said, That which is meant by the offspring of Adam is Idris, and what is meant by the offspring of those whom We carried with Nuh is Ibrahim, and what is meant by the offspring of Ibrahim is Ishaq, Ya'qflb and IsmaH, and what is meant by the offspring of Israll is Musa, Harun, Zakariyya, Yayha and Isa bin Maryam. Ibn Jarir said, And that is the distinction of their genealogies, even though Adam gathers all of them (as their original father). This is because among them is he who was not a descendant of those who were on the ship with Nuh, and he that is Idris. For verily, he was the grandfather of Nuh. I say that this is the most apparent meaning, which concludes that Idris is amongst the pillars of Nuh s ancestral lineage. The view that this Ayah refers to the ancestral lineage of the Prophets, is the fact that it is similar to Allah s statement in Surah Al-An am, >\$ ~!-Vj jj. y o?J ot j ^ l-- ; fejj j\ f *?? ^ <>>' s K* 'SS\>' 'VujAj *a U"jb y*yj y J1 rrii oij 3* bLjii iAnd that was our proof which We gave Ibrahim against his people. We raise whom We will in degrees. Certainly your Lord is All-Wise, All-Knowing. And We bestowed upon him Isliq and Ya'qub, each of them We guided ; and before him We guided Nuh, and among his progeny Dawiid, Sulayman,Tabari 18:214.

Ayyub, Yusuf, Musa and Hdriin. Thus do We reivard the doers ofgood. And Zakariyya, and Yahya, and Tsd and Ilyas, each one of them was of the righteous. And Isma'il and Al- Yasd' and Yunus and Lilt and each one of them We preferred above the Alamin. And also some of their fathers and their progeny and their brethem, We chose them, and We guided them to the straight path.>[6:83-87] Until Allah s statement, iThey are those whom Allah had guided. So follow their guidance.) [6:90] Allah, the Exalted, says, inside p (A -dj c O 40f some of them We have related to you their story. And of some We have not related to you their story.) [40:78] In Sahih Al-Bukhari it is reported from Mujahid that he asked Ibn Abbas, Is there a prostration in Surah Sad?" Ibn Abbas replied, Yes. Then he recited, ilii cjjJ' iThey are those whom Allah had guided. So folloiv their guidance.) [6:90] Ibn Abbas then said, So your Prophet is one of those who have been commanded to follow them. And he is of those who should be followed. - referring to Dawud. Allah, the Exalted, said in this noble Ayah, 4&j p iWhen the Ayah of the Most Gracious were recited unto them, I they fell down prostrate and weeping This means that when they heard the Words of Allih, (i) Fath Al-Bari 8:14. The reference is to Ayah no. 24 of Sad (38) where it is mentioned that DawQd , peace be upon him prostrated Since Allah ordered following what they were guided to in thlese Ayat of Al-An'am, then we should also prostrate at the mention of the Prophets prostrations , according to Ibn Abbas

282 TafsJr Ibn Kathir mentioning His proofs and evidences, they prostrated to their Lord in humility, humbleness, praise and thanks for the great favors they were blessed with. The word Bukiyān at the end of the Ayah means those who are crying, and it is the plural of BakL Due to this the scholars agree that it is legislated to prostrate upon reading this Ayah, in following them and adhering to their manner of worship. > UjaL * t jpL,i"l t ib. ijf* ^ x - 5 s *> / ^ ///< * %y ws / / 1/ / ^ , Sfj alJL ij^Uvu UiV 459. 77ien, f/iere /ias succeeded them a posterity who have lost the Saldh and havefollmoed lusts. So they

will meet Ghayy . 460. Except those who repent and believe, and work righteousness. Such will enter Paradise and they will not be wronged in aught . They were succeeded by Wicked People and Good People After Allah mentioned the party of blessed ones - the Prophets and those who followed them by maintaining the limits set by Allah and His commandments, fulfilling what Allah ordered and avoiding His prohibitions - then He mentions, {there has succeeded them a posterity.) This means later generations. iwho have lost Saldh Losing their prayers is when they do not consider the prayers obligatory. Therefore they lose, because the prayer is the pillar and foundation of the religion. It is the best of the servants deeds. Thus, these people will occupy themselves with worldly desires and delights, and they will be pleased with the life of this world. They will be tranquil and at ease in the worldly appetites. Therefore, these people will meet with Ghayy, which means loss on the Day of Resurrection. Al-Awzal reported from Mtisa bin Sulayman, who reported from Al-Qasim bin Mukhaymirah that he said concerning Allah's statement,

^ I' y-U.1 ^ ^ iThen, there has succeeded them a posterity who have lost the Saldh> This means that they will not keep up with the proper times of the prayer, because if it meant complete abandonment of the prayer, this would be disbelief. 1 11 It is also reported that it was said to Ibn Mas*ud, Allah often mentions the prayer in the Qur'an. He says, iThose who neglect their Saldh.} [107:5] And He says, iThose who remain constant in their Saldh.} [70:23] And He says, iWlw guard their Saldh.}" [23:9] Then, Ibn Mas*ud said, This means at its designated times. The people said, We thought that this was referring to the abandonment of the prayer. He replied, That would be disbelief. 121 Masruq said, No one who guards the five daily prayers will be written among the heedless. In their neglect is destruction. Their neglect is delaying them past their fixed times. 131 Al-Awza! reported from Ibrahim bin Zayd that Umar bin Abdul- Az!z recited the Ayah, iThen, there has succeeded them a posterity who have lost the Saldh and have followed lusts. So they will meet Ghayy.} Then, he said, Their loss was not their abandonment of the prayers, but it was by not offering them during their proper At-Jabari 18:215. At-Jabari 18:216. At-Jabari 18:216.

and prescribed times. Allah said, 4So they will meet Ghayy.} Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn Abbas that he said, 4& iSo they will meet Ghayy.} This means loss. '2 ' Qatadah said, This means evil. 3' Sufyan Ath-Thawri, Shu bah and Muhammad bin Ishaq all reported from Abu Ishaq As-Sabll, who reported from Abu TJBaydah, who reported from Abdullah bin MasMd that he said, 4Li* Cijfc iSo they will meet Ghayy This is a valley in the Hellfire which is very deep and its food is filthy. 14 ' Al-A mash reported from Ziyad, who reported from Abu lyad, who commented Allah's statement, 4So they will meet Ghayy. He said, This is a valley in Hell made of puss and blood. Allah said, <>*** Cl" 4Except those who repent and believe and work righteousness This means, Except those who recant from giving up the prayers and following the desires, for verily, Allah will accept their repentance, give them a good end and make them of those who inherit the Garden of Delight (Paradise). For this reason Allah says, Tabifii 18:21%. Tabari :21\$. TabaM . At-Tabari 18:2T&.

Maruam (61-63) (Part-16) 4Such will enter Paradise and they will not be wronged in aught.) This is because repentance wipes away that which was before it. In another Hadith, the Prophet jg said, Si vJiJi *The one who repents from sin is like he who has no sin." l 11 Because of this, those who repent will not lose anything from the (good) deeds that they did. They will not be he^d accountable for what they

did before their repentance, thus causing a decrease in their reward for deeds that they do after their repentance. That is because whatever they did before repenting is lost, forgotten and not taken to account. This is an honor from the Most Generous and a kindness from the Most Gentle. This is an exception that is made for these people, similar to Allah's statement in Surah Al-Furqan, 4And those who invoke not any other god along with Allah, nor kill such person as Allah has forbidden, except for just cause...) until Allah's statement, iatid Allah is Oft-Forgiving, , # fe v 0k. x& Uit ja* \$& Z) " ^\$xl (They will enter) 'Adn Gardens which the Most Gracious has promised to His servants in the unseen. Verily, His promise must come to pass.) They shall not hear therein any Laghw, but only Salam. And they will have therein their sustenance, morning and afternoon.) Such is the Paradise which We shall give as an inheritance to those ofOur servants who had Taqwa.) Ibn Majah 2 :1420.

The Description of the Gardens of the Truthful and

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3451–3454]

ThoseWho repent Allah, the Exalted, says that the Gardens (of Paradise), which the penitent will enter, will be Gardens of Adn, meaning, eternity. These are Gardens that the Most Beneficent promises His servants in the unseen. This means that these Gardens are from the unseen things that they believe in, even though they have never witnessed them. They believe in the unseen out of their strong conviction and the strength of their faith. Concerning Allah's statement, 4&U Jit iVerily, His promise must come to pass.} This affirms the fact that this will occur, and that it is a settled matter. Allah does not break His promise, nor does He change it. This is similar to His statement, iHis promise is certainly to be accomplished.} [73:18] This means that His promise will be and there is no avoiding it. Allah's statement here, imust come to pass.} This means that it will come to His servants who are striving towards it and they will reach it. There are those commentators who said, imnst come to pass.} This means it is coming, because everything that comes to you, you also come to it. This is as the Arabs say, Fifty years came to me, and I came to fifty years. They both mean the same thing (I m fifty years old). Concerning Allah's statement, OjICj v} iThey shall not hear therein any Laghio.} This means that in these gardens of Paradise there is no ignorant, wasteful and useless speech, like there is in this life. He said,

Man/am (61-63) (Part-16) 4...but only Salam This Allah's statement, vi^ is an indifferent exception, similar i liL Mi % j v> 4No Laghw will they hear therein, nor any sinful speech. But only the saying of: Salam! Salam!) [56:25-26] Concerning His statement, 4And they will have therein their sustenance , morning and afternoon This means, in what is similar to mornings and evenings. This does not mean that there is a night and a day (in Paradise), but they will be living in times that alternate. They will know its lighted times from its lights and illumination. This is as Imam

Man/am (64-65) (Part-16) Firdaws. In it they shall dwell forever.} [23:10-1 1] iA!j o& Uj jJJ'i Uj UIU-Uj Cjji U /J iiljj jXt JjAii l'j.f} 4 A Ji -fixA i-i-eli Uj Jfjiij Cij ^ I 464. And we descend not except by the command ofyour Lord. To Him belongs what is before us and what is behind us, and

what is between those two; and your Lord is never forgetful.}

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 3454]

465. Lord of the heavens and the earth, and all that is between them, so worship Him and abide patiently in His worship. Do you know of any who is similar to Him?} The Angels do not descend, except by Allah's Command Imam

Tafsir of this Ayah.12] Al-'Awfi reported from Ibn 'Abbas that

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3454–3478]

he said, Jibril was kept from visiting the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, so he was disturbed and grieved because of this. Then, Jibril came to him and said, O Muhammad, 'Il ^j} 4And we descend not except by the command of your Lord.} I Allah said, U A} j (3J Ahmad 1 :231 Fath Al-Bari 8 :282 At-Tabari 18:222. This is also reported by others from Ibn Abbas. See the previous reference

\$To Him belongs what is before us and what is behind us,} It has been said that the meaning of what is before us refers to that which is in this life and what is behind us refers to the Hereafter. iand zuhat is between those two; } This means what is between two blows of the Sur. This is the opinion of Abu Al-Aliyah, Ikrimah and Mujahid. This was also stated by Said bin Jubayr and Qatadah in one narration from them. As-Suddi and Ar-Rabi bin Anas¹¹¹ held this opinion as well. It has also been said, iCJ 'JZ iwhat is before its} means the future matters of the Hereafter. iGl iivhat is behind us,} means what has taken place in this life, M Cj} iwhat is between those two;} means what happens between this life and the Hereafter. A statement like this explanation has been reported from Ibn Abbas, Said bin Jubayr, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah, Ibn Jurayj and Ath-Thawri.¹²¹ Ibn Jarir also preferred this latter interpretation. And Allah knows best. Concerning Allah's statement, i~> iand your Lord is never forgetful,}^ Mujahid said, This means that your Lord has not forgotten you. Allah said, iLord of the heavens and the earth, and all that is between them,} At-Tabari 18:224. Tabari 18:224, Al-Qurtubi 11 :Tabari 18:225.

J r\ . mm" - I,yUiL"j rJ'oj La ,AJ_iCoJi &s 01.gd "ii - " J " - .".'><?"; c*f' ,i.- -->{* **&", :v*""]- JU', 2^i e- jvy L iA"~.- He created all of that, He is the Disposer of its affairs, He is the Legislator over it and He is in absolute control of it, having no one to oppose His decisions. ji .*xJ J&Z&j i-^xj^ i iso worship Him and abide patiently in his worship. Do you know of any who is similar to Him?} Ali bin Abi Talhah related that Ibn Abbas said that this means, Do you know any comparison or something similar to the Lord? ¹¹¹ Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Qatadah, Ibn Jurayj and others all said the same.¹²¹ Ikrimah related that Ibn Abbas said, There is no name named Ar-Rahman (the Most Beneficent) other than Him, Blessed and Exalted is He. Most Holy is His Name. S? ot i-ii- i ^="j; Vji " >.1 J d-i C 'i.l Sfv'j} / " . '{<" t" *: ' I ' /i*"" .. / -> >' sOf/J *>* >-" O^kyJlj pfj/s-aO 4 ir, \$ ^ ?v6* J* ii3 jT 0# <(66. Anrf man sai/s: "kWien / am dead, shall I then be raised up alive?"} 4?^ La"- ^ l Jla j)JC-a' flp '3 G' Olirili)' }j At-Tabari 18:226. At-Tabari 18:226. [31 Al-Qurtubi 11 :130

Gf 24 gSap It cUj4 .ji' iAnd matt says: When I am dead, shall I then be raised up alive?" Does not man remember that We created him before, while he was nothing?} Allah uses the beginning of creation as a proof for its repetition. This means that He, the Exalted, created the human being while he was

nothing. So can he not repeat this creation after the human had actually become something? Similarly Allah says; /i', > Ci'Tn ..If "'V n. _y f IjXf, ISAH iAnd He it is Who originates the creation, then He will repeat it; and this is easier for Him.} [30:27] In the Sahih it is recorded that the Messenger of Allah sg said, fST j;l i\j pj fjTp ^jS :,JU; &l JyiA ipJl Jjl J-lJj US' jJ Jjai ijt\ 4-jjSj Ul ji ^JJI Iwill Jli-Sll IjIj IjJj ^ jl *ijii J;l5| "bt Utj fc ^jA j^aL Uif \\$k 2 JJj^ fJj jo; (U uAllah, the Exalted said, "The son of Adam denies Me and he has no right to deny Me. The son of Adam harms Me and he has no right to harm Me. His denial of Me is his statement that I will never repeat His creation like I created him the first time. Yet, the second creation is not more difficult upon Me than the first. His harming Me is his statement that I have a son. Yet, I am One Alone, the Self-Sufficient Whom all creatures need. He Who does not beget children, nor was He born and there is none coequal or comparable unto Him." 111 Concerning Allah's statement, ik iSo by your Lord, surely We shall gather them together, and IM Ahmad 2 :350

the Shayiitin,} The Lord, Blessed be He the Most High, swears by His Noble Self that He will definitely gather all of those who worshipped other than Allah and their devils as well. 4^ f'-**! -Hrlr^d ithen We shall bring them round Hell, Jithiyya.} Al- Awfi related that Ibn Abbas said, This means sitting and it is similar to His statement, iAnd you will see each nation Jathiyah .| [45:28] As-Suddi commented on the word Jithiyya, It means standing. It has been reported from Murrah that Ibn Mas'ud said the same. Concerning Allah's statement, 4&~ m ft iThen indeed We shall drag out from every sect This means from every nation. This is what Mujahid said. iAll those who were worst in obstinate rebellion against the Most Gracious.} Ath-Thawri reported from Ali bin Al-Aqmar, from Abu Al-Ahwas, from Ibn Mas'ud that he said, The first of them will be bound to the last of them until their number is complete. Then, they will be brought all together. Then, Allah will begin with the greatest of them in crime and continue in succession. That is Allah's statement, 4 cpy & y oi "f} iThen indeed We shall drag out from every sect all those zoho Tabari 18:227. At-Tabari 18:228.

were worst in obstinate rebellion against the Most Gracious.^ This is similar to Allah's statement, UZja Cije. Cj JjU 4Until they will be gathered all together in the Fire. The last of them iwill say to the first of them : "Our Lord! These misled us, so give them a double torment of the Fire. } Until His saying, iFor what you used to earn.} [7:38-39] The first of them will say to the last of them: Your were not better than us, so taste the torment for what you used to earn. Concerning Allah's statement, 4' v; .&r? ^ jU os|v f} iThen, verily, We know best those iwho are most toorthy of being burnt therein.} Then, at this point Allah attaches one piece of information to another. The meaning here is that Allah best knows which of His creatures deserve to be burned in the fire of Hell and remain there forever and who deserves to have his punishment doubled. This is as He says in the Ayah that was previous y mentioned, i'opl V p, ti} 4He iwill say: "For each one there is double (torment), but you knoiv not."} [7:38] CjSvjiii! jjl j f v' , UijL ^ "5/ u!. 4:Vr 471. There is not one of you but will pass over it (Hell); this is with your Lord, a decree which must be accomplished.} 472. Then We shall save those who had Taqwa. And We shall leave the ivrongdoers in it, Jithiyya.} Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 5 :533

' j'i "L"J V) jdll is! is! "No one of the Muslims who has had three children, zuho all died, will be touched by the Hellfire, except for an oath that must be fidfilled .s' 1 Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam commented on Allah's statement, VI j&i iThere is not one of you but will pass over it;} The passing of the Muslims (over the Hellfire) means their passing over a bridge that is over it. But the

passing of the idolaters over the Hellfire refers to their admission to the Fire. As-Suddi reported from Murrah, from Ibn Mas'ud, that he said concerning Allah's statement, *lasi- isfij* this is with your Lord; a Hatman decree.} An oath that must be fulfilled. 121 Mujahid said, Hatman means preordainment. ' Ibn Jurayj said the same.14 Concerning Allah's statement, *o jji'* Then We shall save those who had Taqwd.} When all of the creatures passed over the Hellfire, and those disbelievers and the disobedient people who are destined to fall into it because of their disobedience, Allah will save the believers and the righteous people from it because of their deeds. Therefore, their passing over the bridge and their speed will be based upon their deeds that they did in this life. Then, the believers who performed major sins will be allowed intercession. The angels, the Prophets and the believers will all intercede. Thus, a large number of the sinners will be allowed to come out of Hell. The fire will have devoured much of their Fath Al-Bari 3 : 142 , Muslim 4 :2028 Tabari 18:237. Tabari 18:237. Tabari 18:237.

298 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir bodies, except the places of prostration on their faces. Their removal from the Hellfire will be due to the faith in their hearts. The first to come out will be he who has the weight of a Dinar of faith in his heart. Then, whoever has the next least amount after him. Then, whoever is next to that after him, and so forth. This will continue until the one who has the tiniest hint of faith in his heart, equal to the weight of an atom. Then, Allah will take out of the Fire whoever said *La ilaha illalldh*, even one day of his entire life, even if he never performed any good deed. After this, no one will remain in the Hellfire, except those it is obligatory upon to remain in the Hellfire forever. This has been reported in many authentic Hadiths from the Messenger of Allah This is why Allah says, *^ v'* 'On 'tj jjjj iThen We shall save those who had Taqwd. And We shall leave the wrongdoers in it, Jithyya. > |1) UJL* j - c/j JU ^ jl} Oi 473. And when Our clear Ayat are recited to them, those who disbelieve say to those who believe: Which of the two groups has the best dwellings and the finest Nadiyyan? > 474. And how many a generation have We destroyed before them, wlv were better in wealth, goods and outward appearance?} The Disbelievers boast over Their good Fortune in the World Allah, the Exalted, informs that when the clear, evident Ayat of Allah are recited to the disbelievers, they reject them and turn away. They say about those who believe, while boasting to them and arguing that their false religion is correct, i best dwellings and the finest Nadiyyan. [i] Fath Al-Bari 13:48.

Man/am (73-74) (Part-16) This means the best houses, with the loftiest levels and the finest Nadiyyan, which are meeting rooms for men to gather and discuss matters. Thus, this means that their meeting rooms are full of more people who come to attend. In this they were saying, How can we be upon falsehood while we are in this manner of successful living? These people were actually those who were concealed in the house of Al-Arqam bin Abi Al-Arqam and its likes from the other houses. This is as All&h says about them, i And those who disbelieve saij of those iwho believe: "Had it been a good thing, they (the weak and the poor) would not have preceded us thereto!" [46:11] Nuh's people said, 4 ! opSjV' &\$} i "Shall we believe in you, when the weakest (of the people) follow you?" [26:111] And Allah says, 2 i Thus Wc have tried some of them with others, that they might say : "Is it these (poor believers) whom Allah has favored among us? Does not Allah know i best those iwho are grateful?" [6:53] This is why Allah refuted their doubts: Jt 4h i And hoio many a generations have We destroyed before them} This means, How many nations and generations did jWe destroy of those who denied (this message) due to their disbelief? i iwho were better in wealth, goods and outward appearance?} This

means that they were better than these present people in wealth, possessions, looks and appearance. Al-A'mash reported from Abu Zibyan, who reported from Ibn Abbas that he said concerning the Ayah,

dwelling and finest Nadiyyan.) Position [Maqam] means home, Nadi means place of gathering, wealth refers to material possessions and outward appearance is how they look physically. 111 Al-Awfi said that Ibn Abbas said, Position [Afaqam] means dwelling, Nadi means place of gathering and the blessing and happiness that they were living in. This is as Allah says about the people of Fir'awn when He destroyed them and related the story of their situation in the Qur'an, its!&& iHow many gardens and springs that they [Fir'awn's people] left behind, and green crops and honored places [Maqam] .) (44:25-26) Therefore, position [Afaqdm] refers to their dwellings and splendid bounties, and Nadi is the places of gathering and meeting where they used to congregate. Allah said while relating the story to His Messenger jg of what happened with the people of Lut, iAnd practice Al-Munkar (evil deeds) in your meeting places [Nadiyakum].) [29:29] The Arabs call a place of gathering a Nadl W 475. Say: whoever is in error, the Most Gracious will extend [circumstances] for him, until, when they see that which they were promised, either the torment or the Hour, they will come to know who is worst in position, and who is weaker in forces.) At-Tabari 18:239,241. At-Tabari 18:239.

Maryam (73-75) (Part-16 The Rebellious Person is given Respite but He is not forgotten Allah, the Exalted, says, 4Say} This means, O Muhammad, say to these people who are associating partners with their Lord, while claiming to follow the truth, that they are really following falsehood. 4whoever is in error This means, *be they from us or from you. 4& 4the Most Gracious will extend [circumstances]for him> This means that the Most Beneficent will give him respite in that which he is in, until he meets his Lord and his appointed time will have arrived. <\$4' iiL; 'ij 4until, when they see that which they were promised, either the torment} that will strike him, ll t0 4or the Hour that will come suddenly, 4they will come to know} at that time. 4who is worst in position, and who is weaker in forces.} This is in refutation of their argument about their nice dwellings and splendid places of gathering. This is a challenge against the idolators who claim that they were following guidance in what they were doing. This is similar to the challenge that Allah mentions about the Jews when He says, r 4 3SI ! & * A p -pj o> 6 (&

302 Tafslr Ibn Katfur 40 you Jews! If you pretend that you are friends of Allah, to the exclusion of (all) other people, then long for death if you are truthful.} [62:6] Meaning, Supplicate for death to come to those who are following falsehood among us if you truly claim to be upon the truth. If you are true, then this supplication will not harm you. But they refused to do so. An extensive discussion of this has already preceded in Surat Al-Baqarah, and to Allah is the praise. Likewise, Allah mentioned the challenge that was given to the Christians in Surah Al 'Imrdn, when they were persistent in their disbelief and continued in their transgression. They refused to give up their exaggerating claim that Isa was the son of Allah. Therefore, Allah mentioned His arguments and proofs against the worship of Isa, and that he was merely a creature like Adam. After this, Allah said, 'jhj jii j* AOi. d sp2 ^ jto; iThen whoever disputes with you about him after (all this) knowledge that has come to you, say: "Come, let 11s call our sons and your sons, our women and your women, ourselves and yourselves - then we pray and invoke (sincerely) the curse of Allah upon those who lie."} [3:61] However, they (the Christians) also retreated from this challenge. 4 ^ ~J Cly bt, -*i- c. .lfrjv o'JJS \jx~iA iii bfjj} 476. And Allah

increases in guidance those who walk aright. And the righteous good deeds that last are better with your Lord for reward and better for resort.} Increasing Guidance of Those Who are guided After Allah mentions the extended time and respite that is allowed to those who are in misguidance, increasing them in misguidance, He informs of the increase in guidance of those who are rightly guided. Similarly He says, For these discussions, see volume one, the Tafslrof SfiratAl-Baqarah (2 :94), and volume two, the Tafslrof SurahAl Imran (3:61).

^Amf whenever there comes down a Surah, some of them say : Winch of you has had his faith increased by it? } [9:124] And the following Ayah also shows this. Concerning Allah's statement, 4And the righteous good deeds that last^ Its explanation has already preceded in Surat Al-Kahf along with a lengthy discussion concerning it and the related Hadiths. 4(they) are better with your Lord for reward.} meaning the recompense and reward. 4v 4and better for resort. meaning in the final outcome, the re for its doer. suit JCjt AiA f ^\X"l w */U Ja jji: u ^ j>; u 4i&: '-j ^ yJz=> ,va 477. Hooe i/oii seen /i" to/10 disbelieved in Our Aydt and said: I shall certainly be given wealth and children [if I live again]. } 478. Has he known the Unseen or has he taken a covenant from the Most Gracious?} 479. Nay, We shall record what he says, and We shall increase his torment;} 480. And We shall inherit from him all that he speaks of, and he shall come to Us alone.} See volume six, the Tafslr of Surat Al-Kahf (18 :46)

304 Tafslr Ibn Kathir Refuting the Disbelievers Who claim that They will be given Wealth and Children in the Hereafter Imam

Maruam (77-80) (Part-16) 41 shall certainly be given wealth and children. Meaning, on the Day of Resurrection. In other words, Does he know what he will have in the Hereafter, to such an extent that he can swear to it? Aii Ji} 4or has he taken a covenant from the Most Gracious?} Or has he received a promise from Allah that he will be given these things? It has already been stated that in Sahih Al-Bukhdri it is mentioned that covenant means an agreement. Concerning Allah's statement, 4Nay,} This is a participle that opposes what came before it and gives emphasis to what follows it. i 4We shall record what he says,} what he is seeking, and his idea that he has given himself about what he hopes for, and his disbelief in Allah the Most Great. y'iii' ck *A 4We shall increase his torment.} This is referring to what will happen in the abode of the Hereafter, because of his saying his disbelief in Allah in this life. <& U&} 4And We shall inherit from him all that he speaks of,} His wealth and children. It means, We will take all of this from him, in opposition to his claim that he will be given more wealth and children in the Hereafter than he had in this life. To the contrary, in the Hereafter that which he had in this life will be taken from him. This is why Allah says, 4And he shall come to Us alone.} without wealth or children. pr'6 yZ' '*,'3* iyfh .' * \$ ^ m FathAl-Bari4:273.

-L"i l2j (> Ji"jo ii tgptf |Ujji tliijl C j5 jA^lju> 462 . And they have taken gods besides Allah, that they might give them honor, power and glory.} Nay, but they will deny their worship of them, and xvill become their adversaries.} 483. See you not that We have sent the Slrayattn against the disbelievers to push them to do evil.} 484. So make no haste against them; We only count out to them a (limited) number.} The Idols of the Polytheists will deny Their Worship Allah, the Exalted, informs about the disbelievers who associate partners with their Lord, that they have taken gods besides Allah, so that these gods may be a source of honor and might for them. They think that these gods give them power and make them victorious. Then, Allah mentions that the matter is not as they claim, and it will not be

as they hope. He says, iNay, but they will deny their worship of them,} on the Day of Judgement. 4ti-f
oj j} iand will become their adversaries.} This means that they will be foes in a state other than what
they think about these gods. This is similar to Allah s statement. u* t?. di 5 V "a' ojj cA; j iAnd who is
more astray than one who calls upon, besides Allah, such as will not answer him till the Day
ofResurrection and who are (even) unaware of their calls to them? And when mankind are gathered,
they will become their enemies and will deny their worshipping.} (46:5-6) As-Suddi said,

iNay, but they ivill deny their ivorship of them,} This means their worshipping of the idols. 111 Allah
said, djftj} iand will become their adversaries for from these gods. As-Suddi said, contrary to what they
hoped oj f} iand will become their adversaries.} They will be in severe opposition and argument. Ad-
Dahhak said, iand ivill become their adversaries.} This means enemies. 121 The Power ofthe Devils
over the Disbelievers Concerning Allah s statement, 4 'r '3 ft j. \$} iSee you not that We have sent the
Shayatin against the disbelievers to push them to do evil.} Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn Abbas said,
They will lead them astray with temptation. [31 Al- Awfi said that Ibn Abbas said, They will incite them
against Muhammad jg and his Companions. 141 Qatadah said, They will harass them and disturb them
until they disobey Allah. 151 Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd said, This is similar to Allah s statement, At-
Tabari 18:251. At-Tabari 18:250. At-Tabari 18:251. 141 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 5 :538 At-Tabari 18:252.

A A o"V"4\$ Jfi& cr"? 0*Jt }And whosoever turns away blindly from the remembrance of the Most
Gracious, We appoint for him a Shaytdn to be a companionfor him.} ll} [43:36] Concerning Allah s
statement, 4lfsfo J2 Gfc iSo make no haste against them; We only count out to them a (limited)
number.} This means, Do not be hasty with the punishment that is going to befall them, O Muhammad.
Sm 4l'Ve only count out to them a number.} This means, We are only delaying them for a fixed
appointment whose time is numbered. They are destined for that and there is no escaping the torment of
Allah and His exemplary punishment. Allah says, iAnd consider not that Allah is unaware of that which
the wrongdoers do.} [14:42] And He says, 4So give a respite to the disbelievers; deal gently with them
for a while.} [86:17] And Allah says, 4tLi[iS';*) 'fd &[] 4We postpone the punishment only so that
they may increase in sinfidness.} [3:178] 4iX 31 jr XU ^lJ} At-Tabari 18:252.

^ rn vs.4We let them enjoyfor a Mite while, then in the Ilf , . tfr. ***" ^ ^ to (enter) a great >>',
A\$t*.s., .'it' \ torment.} [31:24] lac4u4A3250O"ifc4^ il^ ikai^ ia5 n' . .XX4 .1ST* JWfl- .It " . - -t
En) yl But o^xj' J uL*Ju'^^i i vgj certainly, your destina- OS&C^,fcS\$3& to" is ,fe > Fire "> vgl As-
Suddi said, '4We only count out to thei \ "*" J~T ^ - " f - number.} means years, months, days and oiO
0 ,.< f , . ,r ,A ft :^Sft 4 \ iiOif sfcs v 4 !^lii*^r4'4 -* ' 435. The Day We shall gather tlthose with Taqwa
unto the Most Gracious (Allah), like a delegation.} 436. And We shall drive the criminals to Hell, in a
thirsty state.} 437. None shall have the power of intercession, but such a one as has received permission
(or promise) from the Most Gracious (Allah).} The Condition of the Righteous and the Criminals on
theDay ofResurrection Allah, the Exalted, informs about His righteous friends, who feared Him in the
life of this world. They followed His

310 Tafsxr Ibn Kathir Messengers and believed in what the Messengers told them. They obeyed them in
what they commanded them and abstained from that which they prohibited. Allah explains that He will
gather these people on the Day of Resurrection like a delegation that has come to Him. A Wafd
(delegation) is a group that arrives while riding and from it comes the word Wufud. (arriving). They

will come riding upon noble steeds of light from the riding animals of the Hereafter. They will arrive before the Best Receiver of delegations at the abode of His honor and pleasure. In reference to the criminals, who denied the Messengers and opposed them, they will be driven violently to the Hellfire. Allah says, in a thirsty state.} This means parched and thirsting for drink. This was stated by Ata , Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and many others. Here it will be said, iWhich of the hvo groups is best in Maqant (position) and the finest Nadiyyan (meeting place).}\19:73] Ibn Abi Hatim reported from Amr bin Qays Al-Mulal, who reported from Ibn Marzuq that he said, iThe Day We shall gather those ivith Taqiva unto the Most Gracious, like a delegation.} When the believer comes forth from his grave, he will meet the most handsome form he has ever seen and it will have the nicest fragrance. He will say, Who are you? The being will reply, You do not know me? The believer will say, No, but Allah has made you sweet smelling with a handsome face. The being will say, I am your righteous deeds. This is how you use to beautify and apply fragrance to your deeds in the worldly life. I was riding upon you in the entire length of your worldly life, so will you not ride upon me now? So the believer will therefore mount the creature. This is the meaning of Allah s statement, At-Tabari 18 :253 , Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 5 :541

iThe Day We shall gather those with Taqwd unto the Most Gracious, like a delegation .} Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, 4The Day We shall gather those with Taqwa unto the Most Gracious, like a delegation. Riding. 111 His saying, 4And We shall drive the criminals to Hell, in a thirsty state.} This means parched and thirsty. 4None shall have the power of intercession,} There will be no one who can intercede for them like the believers who intercede for each other. Allah says about them, HiQ }Noto we have no intercessors, nor a close friend.} [26:100- 101] Allah said, 4but such a one as has received permission (or promise) from the Most Gracious.} This is a separate exclusion, which means, But those who have taken a covenant with the Most Beneficent. This covenant is the testimony that none has the right to jbe worshipped but Allah, and upholding of its rights and implications. Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, 4'i+i 1' X*& but such a one as has received permission (or promise) from the Most Gracious At-Tabari 8 :380

312 Tafsir IbtI Kathir The promise is the testimony that none has the right to be worshipped but Allah, that the person accepts that all power and strength belong to Allah and he only places his hope with Allah alone. a j ojJii'j &eL-=C\ jjSi &U s. c\$\$ i# oi a# ^^ \$\$\$ %jm 4^^- 4 tA' 4SS. And they say: "The Most Gracious (Allah) has begotten a son."} 489. Indeed you have broughtforth (said) a thing Idda.} i90. Whereby the heavens are almost tom, and the earth is split asunder, and the mountains Hadda .} 491 . That they ascribe a son to the Most Gracious. 492. But it is not suitable for the Most Gracious that He should beget a son.} 493. There is none in the heavens and the earth but comes unto the Most Gracious as a slave.} 494. Verily, He knows each one of them, and has counted them a full counting.} 495. And everyone of them will come to Him alone on the Day ofResurrection.} The Stern Rejection ofattributing a Son to Allah After Allah affirms in this noble Surah that Isa was a worshipper and servant of Allah and He mentioned his birth from Maryam without a father, He then begins refuting those who claim that He has a son. Holy is He and far Exalted is He above such description. Allah says, Juft 0S5I' Jus! ijGj} 4And they say: "The Most Gracious has begotten a son. iiT At-Jabari 18:257.

Maryam (88-95) (Part-16) Indeed you have brought forth) This means, In this statement of yours. 4a thing Idda.) Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Qatadah and Malik all said, Terrible. It has been said that it is pronounced Iddan, Addan, and Addan with elongation on the first vowel. All three of these pronunciations are known, but the most popular is the first. Allah said; && \$ J >\k=t) iWhereby the heavens are almost torn, and the earth is split asunder, and the mountains Hadda, that they ascribe a son to the Most Gracious .) that is, out of their high esteem for Allah, when they hear this statement of wickedness coming from the Children of Adam.

The reason for this is that these are creatures of Allah and

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3478–3481]

they are established upon His Tawhid and the fact that there is no deity worthy of worship except Him. He has no partners, no peer, no child, no mate and no coequal. Rather, He is th^e One, Self-Sufficient Master, Whom all creatures are in need of. Ibn Jarir reported that Ibn Abbas said concerning Allah's statement, ij J ; >& jOS jij IL fvia; iWhereby the heavens are almost torn, and the earth is split asunder, and the mountains Hadda, that they ascribe a son to the Most Gracious.) Verily, the heavens, the earth, the mountains and all creatures - except for humans and Jinns - are frightened by the associating of partners with Allah. Creation will almost cease existing before the association of partners with Allah, due to His Greatness. Just as the idolator does not benefit bjy his good deeds because of associating partners with Allah, we hope that Allah would forgive the sins of those who believed in

Maryam (88-95) (Part-16) This is due to its anger on behalf of Allah, the Mighty arid Sublime. 4and the mountains Hadda Ibn Abbas said, This means to be torn down. Sa'id bin Jubayr said, Haddan means some of it is broken by other parts of it in succession. Imam

iThere is none in the heavens and the earth but comes unto the Most Gracious as a slave. Verily, He knows each one of them, and has counted them a full counting.} He knows their number from the time He created them, until

the Day of Resurrection, male and female, both the small and

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3481–3484]

the large of them. iAnd everyone of them will come to Him alone on the Day of Resurrection .} This means that there will be no helper for him and no one to save him, except Allah alone, Who has no partners. He judges His creatures as He wills and He is the Most Just, Who does not do even an atom s weight of injustice. He will not wrong anyone. UiU 1. v'-jjjl fit J4 &3jS 'fij S-0, jipss 496. Verily, those who believe and work deeds of righteousness, the Most Gracious will bestow love for them.} 497. So, We have made this easy in your own tongue, only that you may give glad tidings to those who have Taqwd, and warn with it the people that are Ludda.} 498. And how many a generation before them have We destroyed! Can you find a single one of them or hear even a whisper of them?} Allah places Love of the Righteous People in the Hearts Allah, the Exalted, informs about His believing servants, who work righteous deeds - deeds that He is pleased with because they are in accordance with the legislation of Muhammad s - that He plants love for them in the hearts of His righteous servants. This is something

that is absolutely necessary and there is no avoiding it. This has been reported in authentic Hadlths of the Messenger of Allah jg in various different ways. Imam

Man/am (96-98) (Part-16 : Jli U"Ai :Jlii jd.pr lii IJup >-~^~t 'M^ Op :JIS U"*i vL- 2i' 3J jit j? V Ipj I.Lp t lil il jl j ^ Jjjl ;LL^J' J l SlQ p iJ;J>- *-^?~* JI" U^i t JI** Jjrr jw jit !-a"7i : jli to^Juuti U^ii ">' i*! ! "U-Ul Jat ^ a^iijS/l^ Lj"J l -J *. Verily, whenever Allah loves a servant of His, He calls Jibril and says, O fibril, verily I love so-and-so, so love him. Tims, Jibril will love him. Then, he (Jibril) will call out to the dwellers of the heavens, "Verily, Allah loves so-and-so, so you too must love him." Then the dwellers of the heavens love him and he will be given acceptance in the earth. Whenever Allah hates a servant ofHis, He calls Jibril and says, "O Jibril, verily I hate so-and-so, so hate him." Thus, Jibril will hate him. Then, he (Jibril) will call out amongst the dwellers of the heavens, "Verily, Allah hates so-and-so, so you too must hate him." Then the dwellers of the heavens hate him and hatred for him will be placed in the earth." ll]

for them . " [19:96] This was also reported by Muslim and At-Tirmidhi and At- Tirmidhi said, Hasan Sahib . 121 The Qur an descended to give Glad Tidings and to warn Allah said; iSo, We have made this easy} meaning the Qur an. 4in your own tongue,} This is an address to Prophet Muhammad jg and it means that the Qur an is in the pure, complete and eloquent Arabic language. 4that you may give glad tidings to those who have Taqwd,} those who respond to Allah and believe in His Messenger sg, iand want with it the people zoho are Ludda.} meaning, the people who have deviated away from the truth and are inclined towards falsehood. His saying, ijj o; (4ft -9f} 4And how many a generation before them have We destroyed!} means from the nations that disbelieved in the signs of Allah and rejected His Messengers. 4Can you find a single one of them or hear even a whisper of them?} Meaning, have you seen any of them or even heard a whisper Abdur-Razzaq 10:450. ^ Muslim 4 : 1031 , Tuhfat Al-Ahuiadhi 8 :608

Man/am (96-98) (Part-16) from them. Ibn Abbas, Abu Al- Aliyah, Ikrimah, Al-Hasan Alj- Basri, Said bin Jubayr, Ad-Dahhak and Ibn Zayd all saidj, This means any sound. Al-Hasan and Qatadah both said that this means, Do you see with your eye, or hear anv sound? 121

Module 22

Surah 20: Ta-Ha

Surah 20: Ta-Ha

PDF pages 3485–3586

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 3485]

Opening 320 Tafsir Ibt Kathir The Tafsirof Surah TaHa (Chapter - 20)

Which was revealed at Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3485–3497]

if In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. . j o'tyjf viUc Cijil C uj 4 Uj 4 ^ /J i f jt jlii & Jr\$y J\$ \ 'j f \ y , 'yf tfi jyiv oij i) ujil Uj :L:Vt Jj% 41. Ta Ha.} 42. We have not sent down the Qur'an unto you to cause you distress,} 43. But only as a Reminder to those ivhofear (Allah).} 44. A revelation from Him Wlw created the earth and high heavens.} 45. The Most Gracious Istawd the Throne.} 46. To Him belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is on the earth, and all that is between them, and all that is under the soil.} 47. And if you speak aloud, then verily, He knows the secret and that which is yet more hidden.} 48. Allah! There is no God but Him! To Him belong the Best Names.} The Qur'an is a Reminder and a Revelation from Allah We have already discussed the separated letters at the beginning of Surah Al-Baqarah, so there is no need to repeat its discussion here. Allah says, 4i j Jjdc- (jf X.)

<\$We have not doivn the Qur'an unto you to cause you distress, Juwaybir reported that Ad-Dahhak said, When Allah sent the Qur'an down to His Messenger jg, he and his Companions adh- ered to it. Thus, the idolators of the Quraysh said, This Qur'an was only reve- aled to Muhammad to cause him distress. Therefore, Allah revealed, i t'. 4Ta Ha. We have not sent down the Qur'an unto you to cause you distress, but only as a Reminder to those whofear (Allah). The matter is not like the people of falsehood claim. Rather, whomever Allah gives knowledge to, it is because Allah wants him to have an abundance of good. This like what is confirmed in the Two Sahihs on the authority of Ibn Mas'ud, who said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, 1Whomever Allah wants good for, then He gives him the understanding of the religion.^ Mujahid commented on Allah s statement, \ *jk f Asj \ -'j V//' _ / \$ CP'J&A jl" .y: iiUj ' bu ^p(X*^ jlii ^ /ff /i^ sJ-aA Al-Qurtubi 11 :167. 121 Path Al-Bari l :\97, Muslim 2:719.

Jii (jgli L\$> 4We have not sent dmvn the Qur'an unto you to cause you distress,} This is like His statement, 'jCL U recite as much of the Qur'an as may be easy (for you).} [73 :20] For, the people used to hang ropes at their chests (to hang on to when tired) in the prayer. 1 11 Qatadah said, jCfil \$ Z} }We have not sent down the Qur'an unto you to cause you distress,} No, by Allah, He did not make it a thing of distress. Rather, He made it a mercy, a light and a guide to Paradise. ,2) Allah said, iBut only as a Reminder to those whofear (Allah).} Allah revealed His Book and sent His Messenger^ as a mercy for

His servants, so that the person who reflects may be reminded. Thus, a man will benefit from what he hears of the Book of Allah, it is a remembrance in which Allah revealed what He permits and prohibits. His saying, }A Revelation from Him (Allah) Who has created the earth and high heavens.} means, This Qur'an, which has come to you, O Muhammad, is a revelation from your Lord. He is the Lord of everything and its King. He is Most Able to do whatever He wills. He created the earth with its low depths and dense regions. He created the lofty heavens with their high altitudes and At-Tabari 18:269. [2i At-Tabari 18:269.

Ta Ha (1-8) (Part-16) subtleties. It has been reported in a Hadith, which At-Tirmidhi and others graded as authentic, that the density of each sky of the heavens is the distance of five hundred years travel and the distance between it and the next heaven is also five hundred years.¹¹¹ Concerning Allah's statement, iThe Most Gracious Istawd the Throne.} A discussion concerning this has already preceded in Surat Al-A'raf, so there is no need to repeat it here. ¹²¹ The safest path to take in understanding this, is the way of the Salaf (predecessors). Their way was to accept that which has been reported concerning this from the Book and the Sunnah without describing it, reinterpreting it, resembling it to creation, rejecting it, or comparing it to attributes of the creatures. Concerning Allah's statement, f Cj L2 ,; Cj jgi\ 4 uj iTo Him belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is on the earth, and all that is between them, and all that is under the soil.} This means all of this is owned by Him and in His grasp. It is all under His control, will, intent and judgement. He created all of this, He owns it and He is the God of all of it. There is no true God other than He and no Lord other than He. Concerning Allah's statement, iand all that is under the soil.} Muhammad bin KaT) said, This means that which is beneath the seventh earth. ¹³¹ Concerning Allah's statement, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9:185. The scholars consider this text to be authentic only from one of the Companions See volume four, the Tafsir of Surat Al-A'raf (7 :54) At-Tabari 18:271

Muhammad), He is Allah, there is no God except Him. He the Owner of the Best Names and the most lofty attributes. jQ' Jfc jJ jl jyii is i9. And has there come to you the story of Musa?} 410. When he saw a fire, he said to his family: "Wait! Verily, I have seen a fire; perhaps I can bring you some burning brand therefrom, or find some guidance at the fire." } A Discussion of the Message of Musa From this point, Allah begins to mention the story of Musa, how revelation began to come to Him, and Allah's speaking directly to him. This occurred after Musa had completed the time agreed upon between he and his father-in-law that he would herd sheep. He was traveling with his family, and it has been said that he was headed for the land of Egypt, after having been away from it for more than ten years. He had his wife with him and he became lost on the way during a cold, wintery night. Therefore, he settled down, making a camp between some mountain passes and mountains that were covered with snow, sleet, dense clouds, darkness and fog. He began to try to make a fire with a kindling device he had with him, in order to produce some light, as was customary. However, it would not kindle anything and it even stopped giving off sparks. While he was in this condition, he saw a fire from the side of the mountain. It appeared to him to be a fire glowing from the right side of the mountain from where he was. He then announced the good news to his family saying, 4.0? * Qi iVerily, I have seen a fire; perhaps I can bring you some burning brand} This means a flame from a fire. In another Ayah he said, ior a burning firebrand.} [28:29]^ This is a coal that has a burning flame. 46&J pi}

that you may warm yourselves.) [28:29] This proves that it was in fact cold weather at that time. Concerning his statement, isome burning brand This proves that it was dark. In reference to his statement, iorfind some guidance at thefire.'} This means someone who can guide me to the road. This proves that he lost the road. This is as Ath-Thawri reported from Abu Said Al-ASvar, from Ikrimah, from Ibn Abbas that he said concerning Allah s statement, jt jJ \$} iorfind some guidance at thefire.} This means someone who will guide me to the road. They were cold and had lost their way. Then, when he (Musa) saw the fire he said, Either 1 will find someone who can guide us to the road, or at least I can bring you all some fire that you can kindle with. [1 flj j) j'jitj ofi dliu (\$iy Ijili jb} ^-) iJ V ii' Ijl jjj) ^ oik 'i o* aJ Vi . U-> {J-ii jf IfUi-i alf t w* . 'ts IV ^ '..a. ill. And when he came to it (the fire), he was called by name: "O Musa!"} 112. "Verily, I am your Lord! So take offyour shoes; you are in the sacred valley, Tuwa."} 113. "And I have chosen you. So listen to that which will be revealed (to you)" } 114. "Verily, I am Allah! There is no God but Me, so worship m At-Tabari 18:277.

Me, and perform Salah forMy remembrance."} 415. Verily, the Hour is coming - and 1 am almost hiding it - that every person may be rewarded for that which he strives. 4 416. Therefore, let not the one who believes not therein, but follows his own lusts, divert you therefrom, lest you perish."} The First Revelation to Musa Allah, the Exalted, says, 40U} 4And when he came to it,} This is referring to the fire when he approached it. 4He was called by name: "O Musa!"} In another Ayah it says, 4>& 4He was calledfrom the right side of the valley, in the blessed place, from the tree: "O Musa! Verily, I am Allah."}[28 :30 However, here Allah says, A&j \$ 4Verily, I am your Lord!} meaning, the One Who is talking to you and addressing you, 4So take offyour shoes;} Ali bin Abi Talib, Abu Dharr, Abu Ayyub and others of the Salaf said, They (his sandals) were from the skin of a donkey that was not slaughtered. It has also been said that he was only commanded to remove his sandals due to respect for the blessed spot. Concerning Allah s statement, m At-Tabari 18 :278

328 Tafslr Ibn KathTr iTinva Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn Abbas said, It is the name of the valley. 111 Others have said the same. This is merely mentioned as something to give more explanation to the story. It has also been said that it is a figure of speech, which comes from the command to place his feet down. It has also been said that it means doubly sacred and that Tuwa is something that has repetitious blessings. However, the first opinion is most correct. It is similar to Allah s statement, /p {/> " * . v \ , \V-, \Sy* ijo&W aljJb iWhen his Lord called him in the sacred valley of Tuwa.} [79:16] Allah s statement, GV; > 4And I have chosen you.'} is similar to His statement, 41 have chosen you above men by My Messages, and by My speaking (to you).} [7:144] This means over all human beings of that time. It has also been said that Allah said, O Musa, do you know why I chose to speak to you directly out of all of the people? Musa said, No. Allah then said, Because 1 have not made anyone humble himself as much as you have humbled yourself. Concerning Allah s statement, 4&y. Q tf2&} 4So listen to that which will be revealed.} Now listen to what I say to you and what I reveal to you. ') [V lii 3 -J) [} 4 Verily, I am Allah! There is no Cod but Me,} This is the first obligation upon all responsible people of age, that they know that there is no God worthy of worship except m At-Tabari 18:281.

Allah alone, Who has no partners. Concerning Allah s statement, iso worship Me,} This means, Single Me out alone for worship, and establish My worship without associating anything with Me. iand perform Salah forMy remembrance.} It has been said that this means, Pray in order to remember Me. It

has also been said that it means, And establish the prayer whenever you remember Me. There is a supporting evidence for this second statement in a Hadith recorded by Imam Ahmad from Anas, who said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, *لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ* 'Whenever one of you sleeps past the prayer, or he forgets to pray, then let him pray when he remembers it. For verily, Allah said, *وَأَقِمِ الصَّلَاةَ لِذِكْرِي* And perform Salah for My remembrance.' In the Two Sahih's it is reported from Anas that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, *مَنْ نَامَ بَعْدَ الصَّلَاةِ أَوْ نَسِيَهَا فَلْيُحْسِبْ أَنْ يَكُونَ نَامًا* 'Whoever slept past tire prayer, or forgot it, then his expiation is that he prays it when he remembers it. There is no expiation for it other than *فِي* 21 Concerning Allah's statement, *وَأَقِمِ الصَّلَاةَ لِذِكْرِي* Verily, the Hour is coming} This means that it is established and there is no avoiding it. It will be and it is inevitable. Concerning Allah's statement, *وَأَقِمِ الصَّلَاةَ لِذِكْرِي* m Ahmad 3:184. Al-Bari 2 :84 , Muslim 1 :477

Tafsir Ibn Kathir 1 am almost hiding it} Ad-Dahhak related from Ibn Abbas that he used to recite it as, I almost kept it hidden - from myself. Ibn Abbas then would say, Because nothing is ever hidden from Allah's Self. Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn Abbas that he said, 1 am almost hiding it This means that no one knows its appointed time except Me (Allah)."131 Allah also said, *وَأَقِمِ الصَّلَاةَ لِذِكْرِي* Heavy is its burden through the heavens and the earth. It shall not come upon you except all of a sudden.} [7:187] This means that its knowledge weighs heavily upon the dwellers of the heavens and the earth. Concerning Allah's statement, *وَأَقِمِ الصَّلَاةَ لِذِكْرِي* that every person may be rewarded for that which he strives.} I will establish it and it is inevitable. I will certainly reward every person who does something, according to what he did. *فَمَنْ يَعْمَلْ مِثْقَالَ ذَرَّةٍ خَيْرًا يَرَهُ* So whosoever does good equal to the weight of an atom shall see it. And whosoever does evil equal to the weight of an atom shall see it.} [99:7-8] You are only being requited for what you used to do.} [52:16] Allah said, *وَأَقِمِ الصَّلَاةَ لِذِكْرِي* Therefore, let not divert you the one who believes not therein,} Fath Al-Qadir 3 :361 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 5 :563 At-Tabari 18:285.

Ar-Ramdhani 3 ^ Q ^-< Sijabij j_-Iuicliil'ol. C'jJ A^VlijL^ii\jS\$'j A-cli ^ fS<* > "" > S*"Z * > *. ' { "" ^jjijuj \$ j ^ j-p"j4:o&yif ^ JL^ 'JBy^cji^-*J* lA !) IaitJ150 l^LilU0&jr^i </v . ""i^ f. ii->'J0 \$JUj' 24&0 j Jli0V^li^oCi0 cTi)jS3lj0j J3Jls i^waujc-aito^ .uy-uj^ii-a / l"*// / J//.-^ .tx ^ ^ ^ ^ # K\$ sy* u C-AJJ" The address here is directed towards all individuals who are responsible (and capable of taking heed to this message). This means, Do not follow the way of the person who does not believe in the Hour (Day of Judgement) and he only pursues his desires in this worldly life. He disobeys his Lord and only follows his desires. Whoever behaves like these people, then verily he has failed and lost. 4lest you perish. This means that you will be destroyed and ruined. / <. ?*-i:i *// / ^ / > ** ! X \ , J Alt Jp 4And what will his wealth avail him when he goes down (in destruction)?} [92:11] 'Sj crt^*& Ift J^j ! SW i J> Jtt ijv'.y.jii. jL-;! iSjij Uj> V_> & . JU 1^ . ^ 'iji Li^iJU ,v?^| Jtt ^jls Ij-i T.-?n -J 417. "And w/iaf is that in your right hand, O Musa?"} 418. He said: "This is my stick, whereon I lean, and wherewith I beat down branches for my sheep, and wherein I find other uses."} 419. (Allah) said: "Cast it down, O Musa!"}

332 Ta/sir Ibn Kathir . He cast it down, and behold! It was a snake, moving quickly.} 421 . Allah said : "Grasp it and fear not ; We shall return it to its former state."} The Stick of Musa turned into a Snake This was a proof from Allah for Musa and a great miracle. This was something that broke through the boundaries of

what is considered normal, thus, it was a brilliant evidence

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3497–3547]

that none but Allah could do. It was also a proof that no one could come with the likes of this (from mankind) except a Prophet who was sent (by Allah). Concerning Allah's statement, } iAnd what is that in your right hand, O Musa?} Some of the scholars of Tafsir have said, He (Allah) only said this to him in order to draw his attention to it. It has also been said, He only said this to him in order to affirm for him what was in his hand. In other words, that which is in your right hand is a stick that you are familiar with. You will see what We are about to do to it now. iAnd what is that in your right hand, O Musa?} This is an interrogative phrase for the purpose of affirmation. s&} iHe said: "This is my stick, whereon I lean..." } I lean on it while I am walking. iand whemoith I beat down branchesfor my sheep,} This means, I use it to shake the branches of trees so that the leaves will fall for my sheep to eat them. Abdur-Rahman bin Al-Qasim reported from Imam Malik that he said, [It is] when a man places his staff into a branch and shakes it so that its leaves and fruit will fall without breaking the stick. It

333 Surat 20 IB. Ha.-35) (Part-16) is not the same as striking or beating. ' 11 Maymun bin Mahran also said the same. Concerning his statement, 'nj} \$and wherein I find other uses.} This means other benefits, services and needs besides this. Some of the scholars took upon themselves the burden of mentioning many of these obscure uses. Concerning Allah's statement, i(Alldh) said: "Cast it down, O Musa!" } Throw down this stick that is in your right hand, O MQsa. ctt iHe cast it down, and behold! It was a snake, moving quickly.} This means that the stick changed into a huge snake, like a long python, and it moved with rapid movements. It moved as if it were the fastest type of small snake. Yet, it was in the form of the largest snake, while still having the fastest of movements. i moving quickly.} moving restlessly. Concerning Allah's statement, iWe shall return it to its former state.} the form that it was in, as you recognized it before. uiC j; sj- jA It (0* 'AJcL ^Aj} d Ja> 4 gt' ft &j. dl lilt 4 \$\$> ink ^g 4 i\$yi m && \$ in* * \$\$ \$-0 ,l ' Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 5 :564 .

334 TafsTr Ibn Kathir 422. And press your (right) hand to your (left) side: it will come forth ivhite (and shining), ivithout any disease as another sign } 423. That We may shoiv you (some) ofOur greater signs." } 424. Go to Fir'awn! Verily, he has transgressed. } 425. He said : "O my Lord! Open for me my chest." } 426. "And ease my taskfor me;" } 427. And loosen the bwtfrom my tongue," } 428. Tltat they understand my speech." } 429. And appointfor me a helperfrom myfamily, } 430. Hanoi, my brother. } 431. "Increase my strength with him," } 432. "And let him share my task," } 433. That we may glorify You much," } 434. And remember You much," } 435. Verily, You are ever seeing us." } The Hand ofMusa turning White without any Disease This is the second sign of Musa. That is Allah has commanded him to place his hand into the opening of his garment, as is clearly stated in another Ayah. It mentioned here merely as a passing reference, saying: oil ill (Ji5,\j} 4Attd press your hand to your side :} Allah said in another Ayah, dXj j,^&& 4And draw your hand close to your side to be freefrom fear. These are two signsfrom your Lord to Fir'awn and his chiefs.} [28:32] Mujahid said, jt ill LLi-ij} 4And press your hand to your side :}

This means put your palm under your upper arm. 11 ' When MOsa put his hand into the opening of his garment and brought it out, it came out shining as if it were a half moon. Concerning His statement, hi

'O'- }it will come forth white, without any disease} This means without any leprosy, ailment, or disfigurement. This was stated by Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak, As-Suddi and others.¹² Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, He brought it out, and by Allah, it was as if it were a lamp. From this Musa knew that he had surely met his Lord, the Mighty and Sublime. ³¹ This is why Allah says, && hi hx-ji} iThat We may show you (some) of Our greater signs.} Allah commanded Musa to go to Fir awn to convey the Message Allah said, k &Jt di^} }Co to Fir'axon! Verily, he has transgressed.} This means, Go to Fir awn, the king of Egypt, whom you left Egypt fleeing from, and invite him to the worship of Allah alone, Who has no partners. Command him to treat the Children of Israel well and to not torment them. For verily, he has transgressed, oppressed, preferred the worldly life and forgotten the Most High Lord. The Supplication of Musa i(Musa) said "O my Lord! Open for me my chest, and ease my task for me."} Tabari 18:297. Tabari 18:297,298. Tabari 18:298.

Musa requested his Lord to expand his chest for his mission. For verily, He was commanding him with a great task and a weighty affair. He was sending him to the mightiest king on the face of the earth at that time. He was the most arrogant and severe of all people in his disbelief, and He had the largest army and the most powerful kingdom. He was the most tyrannical and the most obstinate of rulers. His case was such that he claimed not to know Allah at all, and that he knew of no god for his subjects other than himself. Along with this, Musa lived in his home for a period of time as a child. He stayed in Fir awn's own room and slept on his bed. Then, after this, he killed one of their people and feared that they would retaliate by killing him in return. Thus, he fled from them and remained an outlaw during this entire time. Then, after all of this, His Lord sent him to them as a wamer calling them to worship Allah alone, without associating partners with Him. This is why he said, iO my Lord! Open for me my chest, and ease my task for me.} This means, I cannot perform this task if You do not help me, aid me and support me. life oi iAnd loosen the knot from my tongue, that they understand my speech.} This is referring to the lisp that he had. This lisp was a result of an incident when he was presented a date and a hot coal stone and he placed the coal on his tongue instead of the date. A detailed explanation of this story is forthcoming in the following chapters. However, he did not ask Allah to remove this affliction all together. Rather, he asked for removal of his stammering so the people would understand what he intended in his speech. He was only asking for what was necessary to deliver his message. If he had asked for the removal of his affliction in its entirety, it would have been cured for him. However, the Prophets do not ask for any more than what is required. Therefore, he was left with the remnants of this accident that took place with his tongue. Allah informed of what Fir awn said concerning him,

Ta Ha (22-35) (Part-16) Sv+i y> isM 'ji j* S*- y \$\$ 4Am] not better than this one who is despicable and can scarcely express himself clearly?⁴³ :52 This means that he is not eloquent in speech. Concerning Allah's statement, '&\$ oj !/.y 4 iAnd appoint for me a helper from my family, Harun, my brother. This was also a request from Musa concerning something not pertaining to himself. That was his request for the assistance of his brother, Harun. Ath-Thawri reported from AbU Said, from Ikrimah, who said that Ibn Abbas said, Harun was made a Prophet at the same moment that Musa was made a Prophet. ¹¹ Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that A ishah went out intending to perform 'Umrah and stopped to camp among some bedouins. While she was among them she heard a man say, Which brother in this life was the most beneficial to his brother? The people said, We do not know. The man said, By Allah, I know. A ishah said, I said to myself about his swearing, that he should not swear such an oath, singling

himself out as knowing what person was of most benefit to his brother. The man said, It is MUsa, when he asked for prophethood to be bestowed upon his brother. Then A ishah said, By Allah, he has spoken truthfully. This is why Allah commended Musa by saying, iAnd he was honorable before Allah.\$[33:69] Concerning MUsa s statement, .ft ilncrease my strength with him.\$ Mujahid said, This means to makemy back strong. Ad-DurrAl-Manthur5:567.

4And let him share my task.} make him my consultant in this matter. 1\$ sy 4That we may glorify You much, and remember You much .} Mujahid said, A servant of Allah is not considered of those who remember Allah much until he remembers Allah while standing, sitting and lying down. 111 Concerning his statement, iVerily, You are ever seeing us. This means in Your choosing us, giving us the prophethood and sending us to Your enemy, Fir'awn. So unto You is all praise for this. cH di zz4 k 4 Jj j^j 4 ii.fc 3r^\ 4 * '4 4 j 4^zj~ym "&0 ji \ f:V & tij 4^' o; l4ij oiij 0> Vj l" atuiy 436. (Allah) said: "You are granted your request, O Musa!" 437. "And indeed We conferred a favor on you another time (before)."} 438. "When We inspired your mother with that which We inspired."} 439. "Saying: Put him (the child) into the Tabut and put it into the river; then the river shall cast it up on the bank, and there, an enemy of Mine and an enemy of his shall take him.' And I endued you with lovefrom Me, in order that you may be brought up underMy Eye."} 440. "When your sister went and said: Shall I show you one who will nurse him?' So We restored you to your mother, that she might cool her eyes and she slwuld not grieve. Then you did kill a man, but We saved you from great distress and tried you with a heavy trial. } Al-Qurtubi 14:186.

Glad Tidings of the acceptance of Musa s Supplication and the Reminder ofthe Previous Blessings This is a response from Allah to His Messenger, Musa, for what he requested from His Lord. It also contains a reminder of Allah s previous favors upon him. The first was inspiring his mother when she was breastfeeding him and she feared that Fir awn and his chiefs would kill him. Musa was bom during a year in which they (Fir'awn s people) were killing all of the male children. So she placed him in a case and cast him into the river. The river carried him away and she became grieved and distressed, as Allah mentioned about her when He said, & LjJaii\j J X}! .*J sijJ o o! iAnd the heart of the mother ofMusa became empty. She was very near to disclose his (case) had We not strengthened her heart.} [28:10] So the river carried him to the home of Fir awn. iThen the people of Fir'awn picked him up, that he might becomefor them an enemy and a (cause of) grief.} (28:8) Means that this was a destined matter, decreed by Allah. They were killing the male children of the Israelites for fear of Musa s arrival. Therefore, with Allah having the great authority and the most perfect power, He determined that Musa would not be raised except upon Fir'awn s own bed. He would be sustained by Fir'awn s food and drink, while receiving the love of Fir'awn and his wife. This is why Allah said, 4c?* ciHc 1) Jj jit, j Jje iand there, an enemy of Mine and an enemy of his shall take him. And I endued you with lovefrom Me,} This means that I made your enemy love you. Salamah bin Kuhayl said, 4 lia &,} iAnd I endued you with lovefrom Me,}

This means, I made My creatures love you. 11 ' iitt order that you may be brought up underMy Eye.} Abu Imran Al-Jawni said, This means, *You will be raised under Allah s Eye. Concerning Allah s statement, 4When your sister went and said: 'Shall I show you one who will nurse him?' So We restored you to your mother, that she might cool her eyes} When he was accepted into the house of Fir awn,

women were brought in attempts to find someone who might be able to nurse him. But he refused to breast feed from any of them. Allah, the Exalted, says, {And We had already forbidden (other) foster suckling mothers for him} [28:12] Then, his sister came and said, {Shall I direct you to a household who will rear him for you, and look after him in a good manner?} [28:12] She meant, Shall I guide you to someone who can nurse him for you for a fee? So she took him and they went with her to his real mother. When her breast was presented to him, he took it and they (Fir'awn's family) were extremely happy for this. Thus, they hired her to nurse him and she achieved great happiness and comfort because of him, in this life and even more so in the Hereafter. Allah, the Exalted, says here, {So We restored you to your mother, that she might cool her eyes and she should not grieve.} Tabari 18:303. Al-Qadir3:367.

Ta Ha (40-44) (Part-16 This means that she should not grieve over you. {Then you killed man,} This means that he killed a Coptic person (the people of Egypt, Fir'awn's people). 4^ {O! But We saved you from great distress This is what he was feeling due to Fir'awn's family intending to kill him. So he fled from them until he came to the water of the people of Madyan. This is when the righteous man said to him, O! Fear you not. You have escaped from the people who are wrongdoers.} [28:25] 633&S HIGM'3 Vi A *>.^ x xx lljls 1^viLiisUl iioisj V)Ifile x > X xx xx X * * > xx*x * < . X x " xx / ^ Z*^x x Xj^ XX jjX x^^ X T'xX "" xttjt- *x ^yii JjU, j ^ J Is (jljl yifl.Us^ s tf Jis(Ij^ j33jo^J^^Jj3> 'Tf^ "/", V*Y*i/ "/ * x x^ XX x / /. * *? . X i-*** ^c^i < *!* jo* ^ o^* |T o^ju Jjk\ 05~? ^J*r & iH * iss &\$&i 'aii ja\$& 3 i Zbir* ') 440. Then you stayed a number of years with the people of Madyan . Then you came here according to the fixed term which I ordained (for you), O Musa!} 441 . And I have chosen you for Myself.} 442. Go you and your brother with My Ayat, and do not, you both, slacken and become weak in My remembrance.}

i< lil ilUkJl ^jjJl i j!j Jli 3li jt l^* tjjA-ji !(Jli t ^_nj : jii uAdam and Musa met and Musa said, You are the one who made things difficult for mankind and you caused them to be evicted from Paradise." Adam said, Are you the one whom Allah chose for His Message, and He selected you for Himself and He revealed the Tawrah to you?" Musa replied, "Yes." Then Adam said, "Did you find that it was preordained upon me before He (Allah) created me?" Musa replied, "Yes." Therefore, Adam defeated Musa's argument.^ Both

means that he has rebelled and become haughty and insolent against Allah and he has disobeyed Him. d# i id ti% % iAnd speak to him mildly, perhaps he may accept admonition or fear (Allah).} This Ayah contains a great lesson. Even though Fir'awn was the most insolent and arrogant of people and Musa was the friend of Allah among His creation at that time, Musa was still commanded to speak to Fir'awn with mildness and softness. Therefore, their invitation to him was with gentle, soft and easy speech that is used by one who is a close friend. This is so that the message may have more effect on the souls, and so it would have deeper and more beneficial results. This is as Allah, the Exalted, says, i^ \ 'jt\$ iXii jg;^ ilnvite (mankind) to the way of your Lord with wisdom and fair preaching, and argue with them in a way that is better.} [16:125] Concerning Allah's statement. {perhaps he may accept admonition or fear (Allah).} This means that perhaps he will recant from that which he is in of misguidance and destruction, if for he will fear} meaning that he will become obedient due to fear of Allah. This is as Allah says, {For such who desires to remember or desires to show his gratitude.} [25:62] Thus, to

remember means to recant from that which is dangerous, and fear means to attain obedience. ujil l' V JI" o' 3' L3* -1* J 13] L

^L 1 % ji&i \$ j-jG 'C& tg^uS <> J v'jJ' J 4j -6 U) ;; iy!SjLif ,> j* .iCj illL 445. Bof/i 0/ them said: Our Lord! Verily, ive fear lest he should hasten to punish us or lest he should transgress."} 446. He (Allah) said: "Fear not, verily, I am xoith you both, hearing and seeing 447. So go you both to him, and say: 'Verily, we are both Messengers of your Lord, so let the Children of Israel go with us, and torment them not; indeed, toe have come with a sign from your Lord! And peace will be upon him who follows the guidance!'" } 448. 'Truly, it has been revealed to us that the torment ivill be for him who denies, and turns away.' " } Musa s fear ofFir'awn and Allah s strengtheningHim Allah, the Exalted, informs that MQsa and Harun pleaded to Allah, expressing their grievance to him: 4(" o' 3 4Verily, ive fear lest he should hasten to punish us or lest he should transgress.) They meant that Fir awn might seize them unexpectedly with a punishment, or transgress against them by tormenting them, when they actually did not deserve it. Ad-Dahhak reported from Ibn Abbas that he said that transgress here means, To exceed the bounds. 4He (Allah) said: Fear not, verily, I am with you both, hearing and seeing." } meaning; Do not fear him (Fir awn), for verily, I am with you and I hear your speech and his speech as well. I see your place and I see his place as well. Nothing is hidden from Me of l 1 * Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 5 :580

346 Tafslr Ibn Kathtr your affair. Know that his forehead is in My Hand, and he does not speak, breathe, or use any force, except by My leave and after My command. I am with you by My protection, My help and My support. 4So go you both to him, and say: "Verily, we are both Messengers ofyour Lord. Musa admonishes Fir*awn Concerning his statement, ^indeed, We have come with a signfrom your Lord!} meaning with evidence and a miracle from your Lord. 4And peace will be upon him whofollows the guidance!} meaning, peace be upon you if you follow the guidance. Because of this, when the Messenger of Allah jg wrote a letter to Heraclius, the emperor ofRome, beginning with, ji> \$\\ jii J^ ^ . ii 4ii vltj; 4jlpJu i JLtU LI 1 ^jA jjL 4)1 o/n f/ie Name ofAllah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. From Muhammad, the Messenger of Allah, to Heraclius the emperor ofRome. Peace be upon him whofollows the guidance. Tims, to proceed: Verily, 1 invite you xoith the invitation of Islam . So accept Islam and you will be safe, and Allah will give you a double reward."|11 Due to this, Musa and Harun said to Fir awn, if && % U\ 'A a q f: ' f 4And peace will be upon him who follows the guidance! Truly, Fath Al-Bdri 1 :42

it has been revealed to us that the torment will be for him who denies, and turns away In His flawless revelation, Allah has revealed to us that torment is prepared exclusively for those who reject the signs of Allah and turn away from His obedience. As Allah says, i j, \ SX !: & * ft 4Then for him ivho transgressed all bounds, and preferred the life ofthis world, Verily, his abode will be Hellfire [79:37-39] Allah, the Exalted, also says, iTherefore I have warned you of a blazing Fire. None shall enter it save the most wretched. Wlw denies and turns away.} [92:14-16] Allah also says, 4So he neither believed nor prayed! But on the contrary, he belied and turned away.} [75:31-32] This means that he denied with his heart and turned away by his actions. jC Li jli ;. v'cfJ> Jr if CfJ' L; Cs3j oli Af.J-Oi SfJ ? ' i t< 1 Sf ..C Fir"awn said: "Wlw then, O Musa, is the Lord of you two?"} 450. [Musa] said: "Our Lord is He Who gave to each thing its form and nature, then guided it aright."} 451. [Fir atvn] said: "What about the generations ofold?"} 452. [Musa] said: "The knowledge thereof is with my Lord, in a Record. My

Lord neither errs nor forgets." The Conversation between Musa and Fir'awn Allah, the Exalted, informs about Fir'awn that he said to Musa, in his rejection of the existence of a Supreme Maker and Creator, Who is the God of everything and his own Lord and Owner:

{Who then, O Musa, is the Lord of you two?} meaning Who is the one who called you forth and sent you? For verily, I do not know him and I have not given you any god other than myself. i(Mfisa) said: "Our Lord is He Who gave to each thing its form and nature, then guided it aright. } Ali bin Abi Talhah related that Ibn Abbas said, He is saying that He created a mate for everything. 1 11 Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn Abbas said, He made the man a man, and the donkey a donkey and the sheep a sheep. Layth bin Abi Sulaym reported from Mujahid that he said, He gave everything its form. Ibn Abi Najih said that Mujahid said, He fashioned the creation of every moving creature. Said bin Jubayr said concerning His statement, \$L i(Who) gave to each thing its form and nature, then guided it aright.} He gave each of His creatures what is suitable for its creation. ' Therefore, He did not give man the form of a wild beast, nor did He give wild beasts the form of the dog. Likewise, the dog's form is not like the sheep's. He also gave creature a suitable spouse, and He influenced everything towards that mate. There is no species of creation that is exactly like another species. They are different in their actions, their forms, their sustenance and their mating. Some of the scholars of Tafsir have said that this statement, He gave to each thing its form and nature, then guided it aright, is similar to Allah's statement, 4b iAnd Who has measured; and then guided.} [87:3] 111 AMabari 18:316. Al-Qurtubi 11:204.

4 ^ i & *cjj1 juJy . W?io /las made earth for you like a bed; and has opened ways for you therein, and has sent down loater (rain) from the sky. And We have brought forth with it various kinds of vegetation .} 454. Eat and pasture your cattle; verily, in this are Aydt for men of understanding.} 455. ThereofWe created you, and into it We shall return you, andfrom it We shall bring you out once again.} 456. And indeed We shoived him (Fir'awn) all Our Aydt, but he denied and refused.} The Completion ofMusa's Reply to Fir'awn This is from the completion of Musa's speech concerning the description of His Lord when Fir'awn asked him about Him. He (Musa) said, sity 4He Who gave to each thing itsform and nature, then guided it aright.} Then, Fir'awn attempted to present some argumentative rebuttal during Musa's reply. Yet, Musa continued by saying, He is the One Who made the earth as a bed for you. Some recited the word as Mihadan and others recited it as Mahdan, which means a place of rest that you settle down upon. It also may mean that which you stand upon, sleep upon or travel upon its back. 4&J.qp JCj} 4and has opened waysfor you therein.} This means, 'He made roads for you to walk upon their shoulders. This is just as He, the Exalted, said. 4And placed therein broad highways for them to pass through, that they may be guided.} [21:31]

iatid has sent down waterfrom the sky. And We have brought forth with it various kinds ofvegetation .} referring to the various species of plants, such as vegetation and fruits. Some are sour, some are sweet, some are bitter and there are other kinds as well. iEat and pasture your cattle (therein);} meaning, something that is food for you and a palatable fruit for you, and something that is for your cattle as fodder for them, both green and dry. 4 Verily, in this are Ayat.} This means proofs, signs and evidences. jjii ifor men of understanding.} meaning those who possess correct and upright intelligence realizing that there is no god worthy of worship except Allah, and there is no true Lord other than Him. b6p P4 ^ThereofWe created you, and into it we shall return you, and from it We shall bring you out once

again.} meaning, the earth is your beginning. For your father, Adam, was created with dirt from the surface of the earth. You also will be returned to the earth. This means that you will become dirt when you die and decay. The statement, And from it We shall bring you out once again, means, 4 jJL) iyliSj i (j>} iOn the Day when He loill call you, and you will answer ivith His praise and obedience, and you will think that you have stayed (in this world) but a little while!} [17:52] This Ayah is similar to Allah s statement, / . / > . * s * * > - y* . / "'i . . 4He said: "Therein you shall live, and therein you shall die, andfrom it you shall be brought out."} [7:25]

Jr j?" -^5U-J^cJ is \j 0 llsr^oJUllaj-JJUi^pdi\j<_ \$js Lijb ;i 'll <^ -1'i >-'*> "' ' . > "' . Y" >-JJJl il^Jiy'jr-sJ ' >' \\'". <&> , 'Crif ' ' JzJo^4l^ -^iyjJ ^<&>&' 0^TgiljgfcI^ t'" a>\liii showed Fir'awn all of the Signs but He did not believe Concerning Allah s statement, 'J& (jt &X i# Q} 4And indeed We showed him (Fir'awn) all Our Aydt, but he denied and refused.} This means that the proofs, signs and evi- dences were establi- shed against Fir'awn and he saw them with his own eyes, but he still denied and rejec- ted them due to his disbelief, abstinence and transgression. This is as Allah, the Exalted, says, 4}jkj lit (tr- 1 I*: 4And they belied them wrongfidly and arrogantly, though they themselves were convinced thereof. [27:14] LX jX-l* **f- y"~" r&uCSi ,av .iyy^i ^L*Ji ot bligl 'j (yj 3U ^.iSy /ULX V Ucy> lillijj iA0 457. He (Fir'awn) said : Have you come to drive us out ofour land with your magic, O Musa?"} 458. Then verily, we can produce magic tire like thereof; so appoint a meeting between us and you, which neither we nor you shall fail to keep, in an open place where both shall have a

just and equal chance."} 459. (Musa) said: "Your appointed meeting is the day of the festival, and let the people assemble when the sun has risen (forenoon)."} Fir'awn describes Musa's Proofs as being Magic and TheirAgreement to hold a Contest Allah, the Exalted, informs of what Fir'awn said to Musa when he showed him the great proof. This great sign to Fir'awn was Musa casting down his stick which became a huge snake, and his pulling his hand out from under his arm while it was glowing white without any illness. At this, Fir'awn said, This is magic that you have brought to us to bewitch us and conquer the people, so that they will follow you. Then you will outnumber us. Fir'awn then said, Your plan will not work. We have magic just like yours, so do not let yourself be deceived by that what you are doing. 4so appoint a meeting between us and you,} Meaning, a day that we can come together to present some of our magic to confront yours. It will be at a specified place and time. With this, Musa said to them, 4Your appointed meeting is the day offestival,} That was the day of their celebration and their New Year s festivity. It was a holiday for them when they took vacation from their work and came together for a large gathering. This day was selected so that all of the people could witness the power of Allah to do whatever He wills. They would see the miracles of the prophets and the futility of magic to contest the supernatural prophetic powers. This is why Musa said, 4S Zk 4and let the people assemble} meaning all ofthem. 4Z> 4when the sun has risen (forenoon).}

meaning in the morning, just before noon. In this way the contest will be most visible, well lit, apparent and obvious in plain view. This is the way of the Prophets. Their work is always clear and apparent. It is never something hidden, or something for sale. This is why he did not say that the meeting should be at night, but rather, it was to be held during the bright part of the day. Ibn Abbas said, The day of their festivity was the day of As/tCrd . 111 As-Suddi, Qatadah and Ibn Zayd said, It was the day of their great celebration. Said bin Jubayr said, It was the day of their great bazaar. These statements are not

contradictory. I say that Allah destroyed Fir'awn and his armies on a day similar to this, just as is confirmed in the SahihJ21 Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, It was a flat place where all of the people were on the same level, having an equal view of the event. There was nothing there that would obstruct the view so that some people could see what others did not. 131 m==* (Jp ii/Xi V -* -fl . V,cjS Jr ^"i Oyyj C at J&rj*-. i? W if. * " gil Z> &Sp }p i60. So Fir'awn withdmv, devised his plot and theti came back.} 461 . Musa said to them : "Woe unto you! Invent not a lie against Allah, lest He should destroy you completely by a torment. And surely, he ivho invents a lie (against Allah) ivill fail miserably 462 Then they debated one with another what they must do, and they kept their talk secret.} 463. They said: "Verily, these are two magicians. Their object is to drive you outfrom your land with magic, and to take you awayfrom your exemplary way."} 111 Ad-DurrAl-Manthu.r4 :540 , that is the 10th ofMuharram. 121 Path Al-Bari 8 :288 At-Tabari 18:323.

464. So devise your plot, and then assemble in line. And whoever overcomes this day loill be indeed successful ."4 The Meeting of the Two Parties, Musa's Propagation of the Message and the Magicians Allah, the Exalted informs that when Fir'awn and Musa agreed to an appointed meeting at a specified place and time, Fir'awn began to gather some magicians from the cities of his kingdom. Every person who had any affiliation with magic at that time was summoned, and magic was very widespread and in demand at that time. This is as Allah says, 4And Fir'awn said: Bring me every ivell-versed sorcerer."4 [10:79] Then, the day came. It was the day when all of the people gathered, which was well-known, being the day of the festival. Fir'awn was there sitting upon his throne surrounded by the elite officials of his kingdom. The subjects were all standing on his right and his left. Then, Musa came forward leaning upon his stick accompanied by his brother Harun. The magicians were standing in front of Fir'awn in rows and he was prodding them, inciting them and encouraging them to do their best on this day. They wanted to please him and he was promising them and inspiring them. They said, oJ b} pj& (3\$ ^ ^ ol & ofo iWill there surely be a rewardfor us ifwe are the winners? He (Fir'awn) said: Yes, and you shall then verily be of those brought near (to myself)."} [26:41-42] V 3} 4M.iisa said to them : "Woe unto you! Invent not a lie against Allah..."} This means, Do not make an illusion before the people of something that is not reeil, making it appear as if it were a creature, when it is not really a creature. If you do this, then you would be lying on Allah.

ilest He (Allah) should destroy you completely by a torment . This means, He will destroy you with a destructive punishment that will not spare anything, or anyone. 4 ...And surely, he who invents a lie will fail miserably. Tlten they debated one with another what they must do,} It has been said that this means that they argued among themselves. So one of them said, This is not the speech of a magician, but it is the speech of a Prophet. Another said, No, he is only a magician. There are other opinions that have been mentioned about what they discussed. And Allah knows best. Allah s statement, iand they kept their talk secret.} means, they held secret counsel among themselves about this matter. 4They said: "Verily, these are two [Hadhan] magicians..."} This is a way of speaking with some of the Arabs and this Ayah has been recited according to the grammar of their dialect. There are also others who recite it as, j)) Which carries the same meaning, Verily, these are two [Hadhayn] magicians. This is the popular style of language in Arabic grammar. The grammarians have extensive discussions in reply to the first recitation and its grammatical explanation, but this is not the place for such a discussion. The main point is that the magicians said among themselves, You all know that this man and his brother (Musa

and HarQn) are two knowledgeable magicians who are quite aware of the skill of magic. They want to defeat you and your people today and conquer the people, causing the masses to follow them. They want to fight against Fir'awn and his armies, and they are seeking victory over him. And their ultimate goal is to expel

you from your land. Concerning Allah's statement, and to take you away from your exemplary way.} This means, they want to expose this way (of yours) openly, which is magic. For verily, they were considered great because of their magic. They had wealth and sustenance because of this magic. They were actually saying, If these two (Musa and Harun) are victorious, they will destroy you and expel you from your land. In doing so, they will be the first individuals to do so, and they will be given great power of leadership without you. Ibn Abbas mentioned concerning Allah's statement, and to take you away from your exemplary way.} This means their kingdom, which they were in, and their livelihood. 111 Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd said, This superior way means that which they were upon. i p pg*. \&} iSo devise your plot, and assemble in line.} This means, All of you come together in one row, and throw that which is in your hands at one time in order to dazzle the eyes (of the people) and defeat this man and his brother. iAnd whoever overcomes this day will be indeed successful.} meaning Between you and us. As for us (the magicians), we have been promised to be given an abundance of power and sovereignty. And in reference to him (Musa), He will gain great leadership. pit*; ijill J; Jt" (> Jj' o' ,jtt J Ul d Ui^ S&. ^ Uij U oL _ * j L 111 An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :396.

358 Tafslr Ibn Kathfr 4 jjr* vi/ li*" pU Ijaf Jjte 465. They said: "O Musa! Either you throiv first or xoe he the first to throio?"} 166. [Musa] said: Nay, throio you (first)!" Then behold! their ropes and their sticks, by their magic, appeared to him as though they movedfast.} 167. So Musa conceivedfear in himself.} 468. We (Allah) said: "Fear not! Surely, you will have the upper hand."} 469. And throiv that which is in your right hand! It will swallow up that which they have made. That which they have made is only a magician's trick, and the magician will never be successful, to whatever amount (of skill) he may attain. } 470. So the magicians fell doivn prostrate. They said: "We believe in the Lord ofHdriin and Musa."} The Competition, Musa's Victory, and the Magician's Faith Allah, the Exalted, informs about the magicians when they met Musa, that they said to Musa, i'S J Zfr 4 Either you throiv first..."} meaning, you go first. 4 5' j; ju Jy jfid ji ui_, 4"or we be the first to throiv?" (Musa) said: Nay, throiv you (first)!"} This means, you magicians should go first so that we can see what magic you are going to perform and so that the true state of their affair will become obvious to the people. SM p <: 4Then behold! their ropes and their sticks, by their magic, appeared to him as though they moved fast.} In another Ayah it says that when they threw,

Ta Ha (65-70) (Part-16 {Then said: "By the might of Fir'awn, it is we who will certainly win!"} [26:44] And Allah, the Exalted, says, iThey bexoitched the eyes of the people, and struck terror into them, and they displayed a great magic.} [7:116] Here, He says in this Surah, S*. (^C*r iThen behold! their ropes and their sticks, by their magic, appeared to him as though they movedfast.} They were a large numbered group and each one of them threw a stick and a rope until the valley became full of snakes piled on top of each other. Concerning Allah's statement, 4 ip.&y *** i-? iSo Musa conceivedfear in himself.} This means that he feared for the people that they would be tested and deceived by their magic before he could even have a chance to throw what was in his right hand. Thus, Allah revealed to

him at the right moment, to throw what was in his right hand, which was the stick. When he did so, it swallowed what they had made. It became a huge, monstrous creature with legs, a neck, a head and fangs. It went after these ropes and sticks until none of them remained, except that it was devoured and swallowed by this beast. At the same time, the magicians and all of the people were watching with their own eyes, seeing this amazing event in broad daylight. Thus, the miracle was performed and the evidence was clear. The truth prevailed and the magic was proven to be falsehood. This is why Allah said, / ' ' , / ' / I > ^ M / i ' ' ' / ; \ XtU* \yLm0 Li)7 iThat which they have made is only a magician's trick, and the magician will never be successful, to whatever amount (of skill) he may attain.} So when the magicians saw the event and witnessed it with

their own eyes, while they were knowledgeable of the various tricks and methods in the sciences of magic, they knew with conviction that what Musa had done was not magic or illusionary tricks. They recognized that it was the truth without any doubt. They knew that no one had any power to do this except for One Who says for a thing Be, and it is. Therefore, when this happened, they fell down into prostration to Allah. They said, We believe in the Lord of all that exists, the Lord of Musa and Hartin! This is why Ibn Abbas and Ubayd bin TJmayr both said, At the beginning of the day they were magicians and at the end of the day they were outstanding witnesses of faith. The Number of Magicians Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn Abbas said, The magicians were seventy men who were magicians in the morning, but witnesses of faith by the time evening came. Ibn Abi Hatim also reported that Al-Awza! said, When the magicians fell down in prostration, Paradise was raised up before them until they were looking at it. 131 It is reported from Said bin Jubayr that he said concerning Allah s statement, 4<& iSo the magicians fell dawn prostrate They saw their places (in Paradise) made clear before them while they were in their prostration. Tkrimah and Al-Qasim bin Abi Bizzah both said the same. 471. (Fir'awn) said: "Believe you in him before I give you At-Tabari 18:340, 13:36. Ibn Abi Hatim 7:2428. At-Tabari 18:334. * At-Tabari 18:334.

permission? Verily, he is your chiefwho has taught you magic. So I will surely cut off your hands and feet on opposite sides, and I will surely crucify you on the trunks of date palms, and you shall surely know which of us can give the severe and more lasting torment. } 472. They said: We prefer you not over what have come to us of the clear signs and to Him (Allah) Wlw created us. So, decree whatever you desire to decree, for you can only' decree (regarding) this life of the world.'" } 473. Verily, we have believed in our Lord, that He may forgive us our faidts, and the magic to which you did compel us. And Allah is better as regards reward in comparison to your reward, and more lasting."} Fir'awn s turning against the Magicians, His threateningThem and Their Reply Allah, the Exalted, informs of Fir awn s disbelief, obstinance, transgression and haughtiness against the truth in favor of falsehood. When he saw what he saw of the magnificent miracle and the great sign, and he saw those whose help he sought accept faith in the presence of all of the people, and he was absolutely defeated, he began to behave arrogantly and cast accusations. He resorted to using his esteemed honor and might against the magicians. He warned them and threatened them saying, if p:} iBelieve you in him (Musa)} This means, Do you have faith in him? ip 3K 3 f3} ibefore I give you permission?} meaning, I have not commanded you to do so, by which you have rebelled against me. Then he said a statement that he, the magicians and all creatures knew was a forgery and an utter lie. i'jp 4 pp Z\} iVerily, he is your chiefwho has taught you magic.} meaning You all only took your magic from Musa and you

have made an agreement with him against me and my subjects, that you would help him be victorious. Allah says in another Ayah, *iSurely, this is a plot which you have plotted in the city to drive out its people, but you shall come to know.* [7:123] Then he began threatening them. He said to them, *iSo I will surely cut off your hands and feet on opposite sides, and I will surely crucify you on the trunks of date palms,* meaning, I will certainly make an example of you, I will kill you in a public execution. Ibn Abbas said, Thus, he was the first person to ever do this (public execution, crucifixion). This was reported by Ibn Abi Hatim. Concerning Allah's statement, *& 1 u;1&%} 4And you shall surely know which of us can give the severe and more lasting torment .}* This means, You say that my people and I are astray and that you (magicians), Musa and his people are following correct guidance, but you will come to know who will be punished and remain punished. So when he attacked with this and threatened them, their souls eased them because of their belief in Allah, the Mighty and Sublime. They exclaimed, *4 Zjt U Je j3 j J iThey said: V\le prefer you not over what have come to us of the clear signs..."}* meaning, We do not choose you over the guidance and conviction that we have received. *and to Him (Allah) Who created us.}* It could be that they were swearing, By He Who has created *m At-Jabari 13:34.*

us. It also could be connected in meaning to the clear signs mentioned before it. In this case it would mean, We do not prefer you over our Originator and Creator, Who produced us from a beginning that was nothing. He created us from clay (or mud). Therefore, He alone deserves worship and humility and you do not (Fir'awn)! *iSo decree what you desire to decree, Do whatever you wish and whatever your hands are able to achieve. ifor you can only decree (regarding) this life of the world.}* meaning, You only have power in this world and it is a world that will come to an end. Verily, we are hoping in the eternal abode. *U jiJ t , fc\ Z{}* 4 Verily, we have believed in our Lord, that He may forgive us our faults,} Whatever evils that we did. It specifically means, which we were forced to do of magic, in order to oppose the sign of Allah and the miracle of His Prophet. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn Abbas said concerning Allah's statement, *and the magic to which you compelled us.}* Fir'awn took forty boys from the Children of Israel and commanded that they be taught magic at Al-Farama. He said, Teach them knowledge that no one in the land knows. Ibn Abbas then said, They were of those who believed in Musa and they were of those who said, *^ A fort at the shore of Egypt, between Al-Arish, which is a town in Northern Egypt, on the Mediterranean and Al-Fustat, which is the ancient Islamic city south of present-day Cairo. See Mu jam Al- Butdan.*

J rn ftp?&P\SPpPiA> PPp\y^S. -' '. T'-^i""Ti ^i " i-C". . '!. " -Y. j ui" iyy j^LSll^w UcaSII J V iCw^ sscj^p:ju ^ - ^ / ^ SS Zt,. M fvt|^S? &> ir/' " 'is' XtS 9- *C Ep 0**!^cyu^vVV * .Si sjox a jo c; &> ^Jof j. 4We /woe believed in our Lord, that He may forgive us our faults, and the magic to which you did compel us.}* 111 Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said the same.¹²¹ Allah's statement, *XM" j,t{' !> J*- 4And Allah is better as regards reward in comparison to your reward, and more lasting . means, He is better for us than you. i^j} and more lasting.}* More lasting in reward than what you promised us and made us aspire to. It is apparent that Fir'awn (may Allah curse him) was bent upon their punishment, and that what he did to them was a mercy from Allah for them. This is why Ibn Abbas and others of the Salaf said, They woke up in that morning as magicians, but they became witnesses of faith by the evening. *jj> ji U*y .^jlj ">*j iQteA 'tj Ifj OjX ^ *- jJ 06 UjJi A) Pi 0 /!^ J& k& zfri oj < p.4\$*

i%& * i]> 474. Verily, whoever comes to his Lord as a criminal, then 111 Ad-DurrAl-Mcmthur 5:587.Jabari 18:341.

Ta Ha (74-76) (Part-16 surely, for him is Hell, wherein he will neither die nor live.) i75. But whoever comes to Him as a believer, and has done righteous good deeds, for such are the high ranks,} 476. Adn Gardens, under which rivers flow, wherein they will abide forever, and such is the reward of those who purify themselves.} The Magicians admonish Fir'awn The clear intent of this is to be a completion of what the magicians admonished Fir'awn with. They warned him of the vengeance of Allah and His eternal and everlasting punishment. They also encouraged him to seek Allah s eternal and endless reward. They said, %4. o iVerily, whoever comes to his Lord as a criminal,} This means, whoever meets Allah on the Day of Judgment while being a criminal. it% Cifk V f+r * hf} itthen surely, for him is Hell, wherein he will neither die nor live.} This is similar to Allah s statement, 4Neither will it have a complete killing effect on them so that they die, nor shall its torment be lightened for them. Thus do We requite every disbeliever!} [35:36] Allah also said, -5 ^<#3i%&4< 4But it will be avoided by the wretched, who will enter the great Fire. There he will neither die nor live.} [87: 11-13] ^ YV Lljf. And they will cry : O Malik (Keeper of Hell)! Let your Lord made an end of us." He will say: "Verily, you shall abide forever. } [43:77]

ojjtiU 4)1 jU3li lili i LIS U" 1>-jS iLL* c^Jl 1 liijS/l "Paradise has one hundred levels and between each level is a distance like the distance between the sky and the earth. Al- Firdaws is the name of the highest of its levels. From it springs thefour rivers and the Throne is above it. Therefore, ivhen you ask Allah, then ask Him for Al-FirdawsJ1,1 This narration was also recorded by

1^.) 4Adn Gardens, meaning established as a residence. It is merely used here in reference to the high ranks mentioned previously. 4'^i. jiJiVf ja sffr} iunder which riversflow, wherein they will abideforever,} meaning that they will abide in it for eternity. <& *& iand such is tire reward of those who purify themselves.} One who purifies himself from dirt, filth and associating partners with Allah. This is the person who worships Allah alone, without ascribing partners to Him, and he follows the Messengers in the good they came with all that they claim. Vj fejJ 4-ijH ll UK ti tij> j^A vin'L* cl &y> iJJ j} HI A*J" &J. vo(*T f V* o; ("*" / , " . And indeed We revealed to Musa: "Travel by night with My servants and strike a dry path for them in the sea, fearing neither to be overtaken nor being afraid."} 478. Then Fir'awn pursued them with his hosts, but the sea [Al-Yamm] completely ovenvhelmed them and covered them up.} 479. And Fir'awn led his people astray, and he did not guide them.} The Children of Israel leave Egypt Allah, the Exalted, informs that He commanded Musa to journey at night with the Children of Israel, when Fir'awn refused to release them and send them with Musa. He was to take them away from Fir'awn s captivity. Allah expounds upon this in Surahs other than this noble Surah. Musa left with the Children of Israel, and when the people of Egypt awoke in the morning they found that not a single one of them remained in Egypt. Fir'awn became extremely furious. He sent callers into all of the cities to gather together his army from all of his

lands and provinces. He said to them, (3 jirjj iVerily, these indeed are but a small band. And verily, they have done what has enraged us.} [26:54-55] Then when he gathered his army and organized his troops, he set out after them and they followed them at dawn when the sun began to rise. Hji} 4And when the two hosts saw each other} [26:61] This means that each person of the two parties was looking at the

other party. dp J @ ley 4The companions ofMusa said: "We are sure to be overtakett." (Musa) said: Nay, verily, with me is my Lord. He will guide me."} [26:61-62] MQsa stopped with the Children of Israel and the sea was in front of them and Fir'awn was behind them. Then, at that moment, Allah revealed to Musa, 3, ft *is*&} 4And strike a dry path for them in the sea.} So Musa struck the sea with his stick and he said, Split for me, by the leave of Allah. Thus, it split, and each separate part of the water became like a huge mountain. Then, Allah sent a wind to the land of the sea and it burned the soil until it became diy like the ground that is on land. For this reason Allah said, > Vic V L-k (j iand strike a dry path for them in the sea, fearing neither to be overtaken...} This means being caught by Fir'awn. 4 Z %} inor being afraid.} meaning, Do not be afraid of the sea drowning your people. Then, Allah, the Exalted, said,

J JSKS^ r\v iSg^siiSi ,^J^y i p Z* >/ ><> ^," "Z ^ /,, CSybJi&ijfnC LA0\Cj jfcLitjJjjo^tiCyI^Sj5GUjli ^CsJ JI5l \^Iag. . 4*a Li^KiSjl^JLjiljwe bliiJU l_j)U iThen Fir'awn pursued them with his hosts, but the sea [Al-Yamm] com- pletely overwhelmed them Al-Yamm means the sea. i iand covered them up.} meaning, coveredthem up with a thing that was well-familiar to them in such a situa- tion, asAllah states; u 051 z^pt} i(i)& 4And He destroyed the overthrown cities. So there covered them that which did cover.} [53:53-54] As Fir'awn pursued them into the sea, misled his people and did not lead them to the path of correct guidance, likewise, he will go ahead of his people on the Day of Resurrection, and will lead them in to the Hellfire. And evil indeed is the place to which they are led. > jjP iX~ - 0 '\$0 I# p0 ji ^} Pyj \s? *- " \0u 'tj f0ijj U 0:1. it0 4 ^L,iSXJt\ f Ut*> ^f-j <>"Lj0 Jj j A . KjOSyk Jui t^s0 480. O Children of Israel! We delivered you from your enemy, and We made a covenant with you on the right side of the Mount, and We sent down to you manna and quail,}

(Saying) eat of the Tayyibdt wherewith We have provided you, and commit no transgression or oppression therein , lest My anger should justly descend on you. And he on whom My anger descends, he is indeed perished .4 482. And verily, I am indeed forgiving to him who repents, believes and does righteous deeds, and then Ihtadd.4 A Reminder for the Children of Israel of Allah s Favors uponThem Allah reminds of His tremendous favors upon the Children of Israel and His numerous blessings. He saved them from their enemy, Fir awn, and He relieved their eyes by drowning him and his hosts all at one time while they watched. Allah said, 4And We drowned Fir'awn people while you ivere looking. [2:50]

other Surahs. Manna was a sweet substance that descended upon them from the sky and the quail [Sa/ tfd] was a type of bird that would fall down to them. They would fill every pot with them as ample provisions until the following day. This was a kindness and a mercy from Allah upon them. It was a manifestation of Allah s good treatment of them. For this reason Allah says, iEat of the Tayyibdt wherewith We have provided you, and commit no transgression or oppression therein, lest My anger should justly descend on you.} This means, Eat from this sustenance which I have provided for you, and do not transgress against My sustenance by taking it without necessity or you will be opposing what I have commanded you. ilestMy anger should justly descend on you.} This means, I will become angry with you. -U" JXc jaj} iAnd he on whom My anger descends, he is indeed perished.} Ali bin Abi Talhah related that Ibn Abbas said, This means that he will indeed be made miserable. 111 Concerning Allah s statement, sfj ^ i j^i} iAnd verily, I am indeedforgiving to him who repents, believes and does

righteous good deeds,} meaning, Whoever turns to Me in repentance, then I will accept his repentance regardless of whatever sin he did. Allah, the Exalted, even accepts the repentance of the Children of Israel who worshipped the calf. Concerning Allah's statement, itf} m At-Tabari 18:347.

iwho repents,> This means to turn away from what one was involved in of disbelief, associating partners with Allah, disobedience of Allah or hypocrisy. Concerning Allah's statement, iand believes This means the person's belief in his heart. 4&P iand does righteous deeds,} his action with his bodily limbs. Concerning Allah's statement, 4and then Ihtada .} Ali bin Abi Talhah related that Ibn Abbas said, This means that he then does not doubt. Qatadah said, iattd then Ihtada.} This means he adheres to Islam until he dies. We see here that there is a specific order in which these things are presented. This is similar to Allah's saying, pt ip yrU of& iThen he became one of those who believed and recommended one another to perseverance and patience and recommended one another to pity and compassion .} [90:17] Li-J cyy j* -v " -dJuo It* J&y llSi ji CU jli sf. oi pj* (i pji JU' L_l"- \Jl Jli 0* !jLyl b r liCLj ^- *iy UiliJ l* [pli JwicSJgy p 2>} s-- IJC yiii *_> /J IjLI*. p ay'i ' jjl pj' oj X> !s+ ft X> X?* -*-\$?" gy. 'iP ip 4 r*.'ii"i At-Jabari 18:347.

374 Tafslr Ibn Kathir 483 . "And what made you hasten from your people, O Musa?4 484. He said: "Tim/ are close on my footsteps, and I hastened to You, O my Lord, that You might be pleased."4 485. (Allah) said: "Verily, We have tried your people in your absence, and As-Sdmiri has led them astray."4 486. Tfien Musa returned to his people in a state of anger and sorrozv [Asifj. He said: "O my people! Did not your Lord promise you a fair promise? Did theti the promise seem to you long in coming? Or did you desire that wrath should descend from your Lord on you, that you broke your promise to me?" 487. They said: "We broke not the promise to you, of our own will, but we xvere made to carry the weight of the ornaments of the people, then we cast them, and that was ivhat As-Samin suggested."4 488. Then he took out for them a calfwhich was mooing. They said: "This is your god, and the god of Musa," but he had forgotten. 489. Did they not see that it could not return them a word (for answer), and that it had no power either to harm them or to do them good? Musa goes to the Appointment with Allah and the Children of Israel succumb to worship the Calf Allah relates what happened when Musa traveled with the Children of Israel after Fir awn's destruction. jli '* \$ U J**-' y*-* *+> Jf'- ^ ^ x e3# * s 32 k s s&s pi 4And they came upon a people devoted to some of idols. They said: "O Musa! Make for us god as they have gods." He said : "Verily, you are a people who know not. Verily, these people will be destroyed for that which they are engaged in. And all that they are doing is in vain."} [7:138-139] Then, Allah made a covenant with Musa of thirty nights after which He added to them ten more nights. Thus, they were forty nights in all. The covenant was that he was to fast these

number of days, during both the day and night. Thus, Mflsa made haste to go to the Mountain and he left his brother, Harun, in charge over the Children of Israel. This iswhy Allah says, ,U Jtt i And what made you hastenfrom your people, O Miisd?" He said: They are close on my footsteps."} These means that they have arrived and are settled near the Mountain. J Qej} iatid I hastened to You, O my Lord, that You might pleased.} meaning, So You will be more pleased with me. be i(Allah) said: Verily, We have tried your people in your absence, and As-Sdmin has led them astray."} Allah informs His Prophet, Musa, of what happened to the Children of Israel after he left them, and their deification of the calf that As-Samiri had made for them. During this time period, Allah wrote for Musa the Tablets,

which contained the Tawrah. Allah said, *iyi } jfl *&zy tly J-^=* uj 4 f \^fk=-j} ^ ijji-t ilujj i* And We wrote for him on the Tablets the lesson to be drawn from all things and the explanation for all things (and said): "Hold unto these with firmness, and enjoin your people to take the better therein. I shall show you the home of evildoers." } [7 :145] This means, I will show you the final outcome of what will happen to those who abandon My obedience and oppose My command. Concerning Allah's statement, *i* Then Miisa returned to his people in a state of anger and sorrow [Asif]. }

376 Tafslr Ibtî Kathîr This means that after Allah informed him of what they were doing, he became extremely angry and upset with them. He was very worried for them. During this time he received the Tawrah, which contained their Shari'ah (Law), this was a great honor for them. For they were a people who used to worship other than Allah. Every person with sound reason and good sense could see that what they were doing was false and foolish. This is why Allah said that he (Musa) returned to them in a state of anger and sorrow. The word for sorrow used here is Asif, which is used to emphasize to the severity of his anger. Mujahid said, In a state of anger and sorrow means worried. Qatadah and As-Suddi said, Asif here means in a state of sadness because of what his people had done after him. "- 'Jej (iS2> jliHe (Miisa) said: "O my people! Did not your Lord promise you a fair promise? ..." } This means, Did He not promise you in that which I have spoken to you, every good in this life and in the Hereafter, and the good end in the final outcome of things? You have already witnessed how He helped you defeat your enemy (Fir'awn) and He made you victorious over him and He blessed you with other bounties as well through His help. } Did then the promise seem to you long in coming? } meaning, in waiting for what Allah had promised you and forgetting His previous favors and the covenant that He made with you before. *i* Or did you desire that wrath should descend from your Lord on you, } The word Or here means Nay, but. It is used here to separate between a previous item and a coming item. It is as if it is saying, Nay, but you want to make permissible the anger At-Tabari 18:350. At-Tabari 18:350.

of your Lord upon you by what you have done. Therefore, you have broken your promise to me. The Children of Israel said in reply to Musa's blame and rebuke, *i\ L -il-AcyuU 4* We broke not our promise to you of our own will, } Meaning by our power and our choice. Then, they began making lame excuses and they told him how they got rid of that which they were carrying of Coptic jewelry that they had borrowed from them (the Egyptian Copts) when they left Egypt. Therefore they cast it, meaning that they threw it away. Thus, it became a calf that made a moaning sound that would gradually rise in pitch. This calf was an ordeal, a hindrance and test. This is why Allah said, *^ g& Jit4^ i"* ...that was what As-Samirî suggested." Then he took out (of the fire) for them (a statue of) a calf which was mooing. } ^ Muhammad bin Ishaq reported that Ibn Abbas said, *i* This is your god, and the god of Musa. } So they became religiously devoted to it (the calf) and they loved it with a love that they had never loved anything else with before. Allah then says, *^* but he had forgotten. } This means that he abandoned what he was following of the religion of Islam. This is referring to As-Samiri.¹² * Allah says in refuting them and rebuking them, and also explaining to them their folly and foolishness in that which they had done, *4* Did they not see that it could not return them a word (for answer), and that it had no power either to harm them or to do than good? } 111 Tarikh At-Tabari 1 :422, At-Tabari 18:355. Tarikh At-Tabari 1 :424,425

O my people! You are being tried in this, and verily, your Lord is (Allah) the Most Gracious, so follow me and obey my order. 491. They said: "We will not stop worshipping it, until Musa returns to us.

Harun prohibits them from worship of Calf and the Persistence of the Children of Israel in doing so Allah, the Exalted, informs of Harun's attempt to prohibit them from worshipping the calf and his telling them that this was only a test for them. He told them that their Lord was the Most Beneficent, Who created everything and decreed for everything its just measure. He is the Owner of the Mighty Throne, the One Who does whatever He wants. 4 ^ so follow me and obey my order. Meaning, Follow me in that which I am commanding you with and leave that which I forbid you from. iThey said : "We will not stop worshipping it, until Musa returns to us."} meaning, We will not cease in our worship of this calf until we hear what Musa has to say about it. So they opposed Harun in this matter and they fought against him, nearly killing him. v fKi && &} . (JJ pj ftCj-P. xjf. Jju J Ipfl Pi fj jfp, 51X> 192. (Musa) said: "O Harun! What prevented you when you saw them going astray;" } 193. "That you followed me not (according to my advice to you)? Have you then disobeyed my order?" } 194. He (Harun) said: "O son of my mother! Seize (me) not by my beard, nor by my head! Verily, I feared lest you should say You have caused a division among the Children of Israel, and you have not respected my word!" } What happened between Musa and Harun after Musa returned Allah informs of what happened when Musa returned to his people and saw the great matter that had taken place among them. With this he became filled with anger and he threw

down the Divine Tablets that he had in his hand. Then, he grabbed his brother Harun by his head and pulled him towards himself. We expounded upon this previously in Surat Al-A'raf, where we mentioned the Hadith, cguj's ji jT "Information is not the same as observation.^ Then, he began to blame his brother, Harun, by saying, \$What prevented you when you saw them going astray; that you followed me not?} meaning, You should have informed me of this matter as soon as it happened. iHave you then disobeyed my order?} In that which I entrusted to you, referring to Musa's statement, jZ \$Jx} iReplace me among my people, act in the right way and follow not the way of the mischief-makers.}[7:142] 4He (Harun) said: O son of my mother! } This mentioning of the mother was Harun's attempt to soften Musa's anger, because he was Musa's biological brother and they had the same parents. The mentioning of the mother here is more delicate and profound in bringing about gentleness and mildness. This is why he said, 40 son of my mother! Seize (me) not by my beard, nor by my head!} This was Harun's excuse to Musa for being delayed from coming to him and informing him of the great mishap that Ahmad 1:271.

r\A mmyi yOlbi ,aj ojff&\$ tety 0^S\%p.J^z b\j Jfc\$ S-iyipijJie/-^l -) -MH^^"3y^J J13f\p C\$+ -1Ja>*L33U Jlj3 J\ ^// / ij, . / >/ < * > . "" ^ x #/" "4> (ill O ^J^viA! (-Aife *- "Mill. ^llLj^iJ =3 ^J_ys> jhellVcfJM^Uil (^i took place. He said, ^cAii- ^\} iVerily, I feared} meaning, I was afraid to come after you and inform you of this, because I thought you might accuse me of leaving them alone and causing division between them. 4 &#> iand you have not respected my word!} This means, And you did not take care of what I commanded you to do when I left you in charge of them." Ibn Abbas said, Harun was respectful and obedient to Musa. ot Omauj *aj I^/v^ jv* U-j u->/noj JL> Lj ^ cJ_y* dfyx s L^X.i S& * ^ii cijj^ di^ J 3% fe, V j> CfJ ^ * V ufl lit E3l ^^ J^=> 495. (Miisa) said: "And what is the matter with

you. O Samiri?"} 496. (Samiri) said: I saw what they saw not, so I took a (Qabdah) handful (of dust) from the (hoof) print of the (i| At-Jabari 18:359.

messenger and threio it. Thus my inner self suggested to me."} 497. Musa said: "Then go away! And verily, your (punishment) in this life will be that you will say: 'Touch me not)' and verily, you have a promise that will not fail. And look at your god to which you have been devoted. We ivill certainly bum it, and scatter its particles in the sea."} . Your God is only Allah, there is no God but Him. He has fidl knowledge of all things.} How As-Samir made the Calf Musa said to As-Samiri, What caused you to do what you did? What presented such an idea to you causing you to do this? Muhammad bin Ishaq reported from Ibn Abbas that he said, As-Samiri was a man from the people of Bajarma, a people who worshipped cows. He still had the love of cow worshipping in his soul. However, he acted as though he had accepted Islam with the Children of Israel. His name was Musa bin Zafar. Qatadah said, He was from the village of Samarra. 2 4 ii JLi^ i(Sdmiri) said: "I saw what they saw not."} This means, I saw Jibril when he came to destroy Fir awn. iso I took a handful (Qabdah) from the print of the messenger} This means from the hoof print of his (Jibril s) horse. 3 ' This is

what is well-known with many of the scholars of Tafsir, rather

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3547–3554]

most of them. Mujahid said, iso I took a handful (Qabdah) from the print of the messenger} From under the hoof of Jibril s horse. He also said, The word Qabdah means a palmful, and it is also that which is grasped by the tips of the fingers. Mujahid said, As-Samiri 111 Tdrikh At-Tabari 1:424. 2| At-Tabari 18:363.Tabari 18:362.

threw what was in his hand onto the jewelry of the Children of Israel and it became molded into the body of a calf, which made a light moaning sound. The wind that blew into it was the cause of its sound. Thus, he said, iand I threw it This means, I threw it along with those who were throwing (jewelry). iThus my inner self suggested to me.} This means that his soul considered it something good and it was pleasing to his self. The Punishment of As-Samiri and the burning of the Calf Thereupon, Y jyu J 4^ v-fcjk J^S} i(Musa) said: Then go aioay! And verily, your (punishment) in this life ivill he that you will say: Touch me not. " } This means, Just as you took and touched what was not your right to take and touch of the messenger s foot print, such is your punishment in this life, that you will say, Do not touch (me). This means, You will not touch the people and they will not touch you. &&} iand verily, you have a promise This means on the Day of Resurrection. ithat will not fail.} you will have no way to escape it. Qatadah said, Y JyS oty ithat you ivill say: Touch me not.'} This is referring to a m At-Tabari 18:362.

384 Tafsir Ibn Kathir punishment for them and their remnants (i.e. those who have their disease) today still say Do not touch. Concerning Allah s statement, 4\$ci 3 ^y & if)} iand verily, you have a promise that will not fail.} Al-Hasan, Qatadah and Abu Nahlk said, You will not be absent from it. 11 4And look at your god} that which you worshipped, 4to which you have been devoted.} that which you established worship of, which was the calf. AA y4 # iYour God is only Allah, there is no God but Him. He has full knmoledge of all things.} Mtisa was saying to them, This is not your god. Your God is only Allah, the

One Whom there is no true God except Him. Worship is not befitting to anyone except Him. For everything is in need of Him and everything is His servant. Concerning the statement, sly j =" *)} 4He has fill knowledge of all things.} The word 71m (knowledge) is in the accusative case for distinction. It means that He is the All-Knower of everything. 40* ft} 4(Allah) surrounds all things in (His) knowledge.} (65:12) And He says, t J-& %} 4And (He) keeps count of all things.} [72:28] Therefore, IM At-Tabari 18 :364

Mi*-^ v> iNot even the weight of a speck of dust escapes His knowledge (34:3| He also says, V}^% yC" ^Vf 4Nof /e/falls, but He knows it. There is not a grain in the darkness of the earth nor anything fresh or dry, but is written in a Clear Record.} [6:59] And He says, #> t ^ ^ i. => 4 J* j&S 4"jj jit > VI ^:Vt j iib 4And no moving creature is there on earth but its provision is due from Allah. And He knows its dwelling place and its deposit. All is in a Clear Book.} [11:6] The Ayat that mention this are numerous. , J* .. ^ ,]; ^~~= V W) ^ JJj ji U ^ iiUL 4_raij i99 . Thus We relate to you some information of what happened before. And indeed We have given you from Us a Reminder.} 4100. Whoever turns away from it, verily, they will bear a heavy burden on the Day of Resurrection.} 4101. They will abide in that - and evil indeed will it be to load for them on the Day of Resurrection .} The Entire Qur'an is the Remembrance of Allah and mentioning the Punishment of Those Who turn away from It Allah, the Exalted, is saying to Prophet Muhammad sg, We have told you (O Muhammad) the story of Musa and what happened with him, Fir'awn and his armies, just as it actually happened. Likewise, We relate to you the information of the past just as it happened, without any increase or decrease. We

also gave you a remembrance from Us, the Mighty Qur'an, no falsehood comes to it from before it or behind it. It is a revelation from One Most Wise, Most Praiseworthy. No Prophet was given any Book like it or more complete than it, since the time of the previous Prophets who were sent, until their being sealed off with the coming of Muhammad No Prophet was given any Book containing as much information as the Qur'an about what has past and what would be. The judgement concerning the distinction between mankind is taken from it. Therefore, Allah says about it, iWhoever turns away from it, i This means whoever denies it and turns away from following its commands and instructions, while seeking guidance from other than it, then Allah will mislead him and send him on the path to Hell. This is why Allah says, iWhoever turns away from it, verily, they will bear a heavy burden on the Day of Resurrection .> Burden here means sin. This is as Allah says, ij iBut those of the sects that reject it , the Fire will be their promised meeting place. [11:17] This applies generally to whoever the Qur'an reaches of the Arabs, the non-Arabs, the People of the Book and others. This is as Allah says, iThat 1 may therewith warn you and whomsoever it may reach. [6:19] The Qur'an is a final warning for everyone it reaches. Whoever follows it, then he is rightly guided and whoever opposes it and turns away from it, then he is misguided. He will be wretched in this life, and he is promised that on the Day of Resurrection his abode will be the Hellfire. For this reason Allah says,

4i-i 4\$ j< jyA joji ^PWioewer turns away from it, verily, they will bear a heavy burden on the Day of Resurrection. They will abide in that.} [20 :100-101] They will not be able to avoid this or escape it. 4And evil indeed will it be that load for them on the Day of Resurrection .} '4fc*:r p [*"4 (*f-" Ojr^ .Jit.liy Xg j&j J> gfi (X. &4 & k tip# 4102. The Day when the Siir will be blown: that Day, We shall gather the criminals blue-eyed .)> 4103. They will speak in a very low voice to each other

(saying) : "You stayed not longer than ten. 4 4104. We know very well what they will say, when the best among them in knowledge and wisdom will say: "You stayed no longer than a day! \$ The Blowing of the Siir and the Day of Resurrection It has been confirmed in a Hadith that the Messenger of Allah was asked about the Sur and he replied, It is a horn that will be blown into." It has been related in a Hadith about the Siir, on the authority of Abu Hurayrah that it is a huge horn that has circumference as large as the heavens and the earth. The angel Israfil will blow into it. 121 Another Hadith has been related which states that the Prophet ﷺ said, "J j i^j j l f j j j 0)1 ,Jdl Ji O/iJl v_~^L4j JjIS d How can I be comfortable when the one with the horn is Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9:116. At-Tabarani in At-Tawal no.36.

holding it in his lips and his forehead is leaning forward, waiting to be given permission (to blow it). The people said, O Messenger of Allah, what should we say? He said, Jz iii &J- : \JJ> *Say: Allah is sufficient for us and what a good protector He is. Upon Allah we place our trust. s Concerning His statement, fry 'J&jf 4And We shall gat\ver the criminals blue-eyed. It has been said that this means having blue eyes due to the severity of their horrifying situation. iThey will speak in a very low voice to each other. Ibn Abbas said, This means whispering among themselves. This means that some of them will be saying to others, 4jgJol" 4You stayed not longer than ten> meaning in the abode of the worldly life, you only tarried there for a little while. The time was equivalent to ten days or so. Allah, the Exalted, then says, io)A 4We know very well what they will say,\$ This means in their condition of conversing amongst themselves. Si iwhen the best among them in knowledge and wisdom will say;} TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 9:117.Tabari 18:371.

Ta Ha (102-104) (Part-16) the one with perfect intelligence amongst them, it*% iYou stayed no longer than a day!} This is because on the Day of Judgement they will sense the shortness of the worldly life within themselves. For the worldly life, with its repetitious time periods and successive nights, days and hours, is as if it is just one day. For this reason, on

the Day of Resurrection the disbelievers will think the worldly

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3554–3566]

life was very short. By this they mean to prevent thie establishment of the evidence against them due to the shortness of time that they had. Allah says about this, > K: (y (Mr iAnd on the Day that the Hour will be established, the criminals will swear that they stayed not but an hour} until His statement. vbut you knew not. } [30:55-56] Allah also says, pz& *a t jj} 4Did We not give you lives long enough, so that whosoever would receive admonition could receive it? And the wamer came to you.} [35:37] Allah, the Exalted, also says, & } ji* jfjji j } VI 4(Allah will say): What number of years did you stay on earth? They will say: "We stayed a day or part of a day. Ask of those who keep account." He (Allah) will say: "You stayed not but a little, if you had only known!"} [23:112-114] This means that you only remained in it (the earth) a little while. If you only knew, you would have preferred the eternal life over the temporal life. Yet, you conducted yourselves in an evil manner. You gave the present, temporary life precedence over the eternal and everlasting life.

390 Tafsir Ibt Kathir Ijj i] jj 'i Icli J Jii JLU fjkjy>} yii ^Z*-j % ^y- V jfM Vj 4^ -Ji il05. And they ask you concerning the mountains. Say: "My Lord will blast them and scatter them as particles of dust."}

4106. Then He shall leave it as a level smooth plain."} 4107. "You will see therein no crookedness nor curve."} 4108. On that Day mankind will follow strictly (the voice of) Allah's caller, no crookedness (that is without going to the right or left of that voice) will they follow him (Allah's caller). And all voices will be humbled for the Most Gracious (Allah), and nothing shall you hear except Hamsa.} The destruction of the Mountains, and the Earth becomes a Smooth Plain Allah says, 4And they ask you concerning the mountains.} This is a question, will they remain on the Day of Resurrection or will they cease to exist? itejf, i+U 4Sm/: "My Lord will blast them and scatter them as particles of dust."} This means that He will take them away from their places, wipe them out and remove them completely. iThen He shall leave it} referring to the earth; &} 4as a level smooth plain.} This means one expanse spread out. The word Qa means a piece of land that is level and the word Safsa is used to place emphasis on this meaning. It has also been said that Safsa means that which has no vegetation

growing in it. The first meaning is preferred, even though the second meaning is also included by necessity. In reference 1:0 this, Allah says, / / "v 4 'yf Vj Ujc. i^iYou will see therein no crookedness nor curve meaning, on that Day you will not see in the earth any valley, hill, or any place, whether low or elevated. Ibn Abbas, Ikrimah, Mujahid, Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah and others of the Salaf all said the same. The People will rush towards the Voice of the Caller iOn that Day mankind will follow strictly Allah's caller, no crookedness will they follow him> On the Day, they see these conditions and these frightening sights, they will hastily respond to the caller. Wherever they are commanded to go, they will rush to it. If they had been like this in the worldly life, it would have been more beneficial for them, but here it does not benefit them. This is as Allah says, 4How clearly will they see and hear, the Day when they will appear before Us! [19:38] Allah also says, 4hastening towards the caller> Concerning Allah's statement, 4And all voices will be humbledfor the Most Gracious Ibn Abbas said, This means they will be silent. 12 ' As-Suddi also said the same.Tabari 18 : 372 , Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 5 :598,599Tabari 18:374.

J r\ K b^vj Ov yjlljS f: - - ".if - *. "A ', ij&j, ,/ qp \r ==> ^ *T * v ^ **rn\ * l\ T **^ ^ ^ ^ |;-JJ I a ^-"a --pUUIa /n |v"J ga ^A.Ja ^v-:-ira^^ Jr"i>- J^tl **}i-JiL**^ jy **^ \. '-** t\^- It > > -r"" .a. rfh/r 'gCJs j6j CL aV^LUIJsUi 4& -Jj 4And nothing shall you hear except Hamsa.} Sa Id bin Jubayr related that Ibn Abbas said, This means the steps of feet. 111 Ikrimah, Mujahid, Ad- Dahhak, Ar-Rabi bin Anas, Qatadah, Ibn Zayd and others all said the same.12 Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn Abbas said, idiAnd nothing shall you hear except Hamsa.} Hamsa means a hidden voice. * This has also been reported from Ikrimah and Ad-Dahhak. Said bin Jubayr said, 4And nothing shall you hear except Hamsa.} Hamsa means the secret speech and the steps of feet. Uj |* -J dj\i U ,Vy ^ ?JD ^ o* j^j>} & :j& \$ t& * % {&- 4109. On that day no intercession shall avail, except the one At-Jabari 18:374. At-Jabari 18:375. At-Jabari 18:375.

.Surah 20. Ta Ha (109-112) (Part-16) 393 for whom the Most Gracious has given permission and whose word is acceptable to Him 4110. He knows what happens to them, and what will happen to them, but they will never encompass anything of His knowledge.} 4111. And (all) faces shall be humbled before the Ever Living, the Sustainer. And he who carried wrongdoing, will be indeed a complete failure.} 4112. And he who works deeds of righteousness, while he is a believer, then he will have no fear of injustice, nor of any curtailment.} The Intercession and the Recompense Allah, the Exalted, says, 4On

that day} the Day of Resurrection, 'i} 4no intercession shall avail.} meaning with Him (Allah). 4^y \$ (s(i} 0*\$ 4 oil &\} 4except the one for whom the Most Gracious has given permission and whose word is acceptable to Him.} This is similar to His statement, T*X L^jil li 4Who is he that can intercede with Him except with His permission?} [2 :255] It is also similar to His statement, iCj il' oit o' oj is?M 4And there are many angels in the heavens, whose intercession will avail nothing except after Allah has given leave for whom He wills and is pleased with.} [53 :26] He also says,

i f"j <>"->' p. ^j. VjAnd they cannot intercede except for him with whom He pleased. And they stand in awe for fear of Him.} [21:28] He also says, 4/J P yj} is ^Intercession with Him profits not except for him in whom He permits .} [34:23] And He says, 4 r*X}y^> Jtij jpll J ja 'j\ {ffi fy u f } 4The Day that Ar-Ruh and the angels will stand forth in rows, they will not speak except him whom the Most Gracious allows, and he will speak what is right.} [78:38] In the Two_ Sahih's it is reported from the leader of the Children of Adam and the Noblest of all the creatures to Allah, Muhammad jg: ;|ttOMl V gzZj tljL"-lo 4) I *~< j*j Sl.v j\ U :JjZ p u jf ;U U _pij p ipJl i lj>- jjpj - "/ wi// come under the Throne and I will fall down into prostration. Then, I will be inspired to make praises (of Allah) that I am not able to recall them now. Allah will leave me in this condition as long as He wishes. Then, He will say, "O Muhammad, raise your head. Speak and you will be heard, intercede and your intercession will be accepted." Then, a designated group will be allowed for me (to intercede on their behalf). Allah will then enter them into Paradise and I will return (to repeat the process again). s The Prophet sg mentioned doing this four times. May Allah s blessings and peace be upon him and the rest of the Prophets as well. In another Hadith it also mentions that he said, Of Zf- Jliif J> jl If jliJl m Fath Al-Bari 8 :247, Muslim 1 :184.

ijtw I J -..3 A-ii j IS" j0 l jiiL 4-ii jt j\ s jji l ty*-y. l : 3yt y 1 ixL>- ^ ^ Ir* J& S? L^^ ->? 53 nAllah, the Exalted, will say, "Bring out of the Fire whoever has a seed's weight of faith in his heart." So a large number of people will be brought out. Then He will say, "Bring out of the Fire whoever has a half of a seed's weight of faith in his heart. Bring out whoever has the weight of a speck of dust in his heart. Bring out whoever has the weight of the smallest and tiniest particle of dust of faith in his heart. And the Hadith continues. Concerning Allah s statement, Uj jj Oy u iHc knows what happens to them and what will happen to them,} He encompasses all creation with His knowledge. but they will never encompass anything of His knowledge.} This is like His statement, iAnd they will never encompass anything of His knowledge except that which He wills.} [2:255] Concerning Allah s statement, & </4 :j\$^ iAnd (all) faces shall be humbled before the Ever Living, the Sustainer.} Ibn Abbas and others said, This means that the creatures will be humbled, submissive and compliant to their Compeller, the Ever Living, Who does not die, the Sustainer of all, Who does not sleep. ,2! He is the maintainer of everything. He 111 Path Al-Bari 13:481.Jabari 18:377, 378.

396 Tafslr Ibn Kathir determines the affairs of everything and preserves everything. He is perfect in His Self. He is the One Whom everything is in need of and whom nothing could survive without. Concerning His statement, iAnd he who carried wrongdoing, will be indeed a complete failure. meaning on the Day of Resurrection. For verily, Allah will give every due right to the one who deserved it. Even the ram who lost its horn will be given revenge against the one who had horns. In the Sahih, it is recorded that the Prophet jg said, {ji pLLI l Ifclij ^iii" dBeware of wrongdoing (or oppression), for

verily, wrongdoing will be darknesses on the Day of Resurrection ." And the true failure is for whoever meets Allah while associating partners with Him. Allah the Exalted says, i"Verily, associating partners with Me is the great wrongdoing. Allah s statement, iAnd he. who works deeds of righteousness, while he is a believer, then he will have no fear of injustice, nor of any curtailment After Allah mentions the wrongdoers and their threat, He then commends the pious people and mentions the judgement they receive. Their judgement is that they will not be wronged nor oppressed. This means that their evils will not be increased and their good deeds will not be decreased. This was stated by Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and others. Zulm means an increase that comes from the sins of others being placed upon the person, andHadmmeans a decrease. Ahmad 2:106. Similar wording is with Muslim 4:1996. At-Tabari 18:379, 380.

\$\$\$ 4\$ U H. <&>^ pj jij p-j i bj j' jP S(j j"J' dp> ii' jP" 4\$ e ji> 4223. And tints We have sent it down as a Qur'an in Arabic, and have explained therein in detail the warnings, in order that they may have Taqwd, or that it may cause them to have a lessonfrom it.} 4114. Then High above all be Allah, the True King. And be not in haste with the Qur'an before its revelation is completed to you, and say: "My Lord! Increase me in knowledge."} The Qur an was revealed so that the People would have Taqwdand reflect After Allah, the Exalted, mentions that on the Day of Judgement both the good and the evil will be recompensed and there is no avoiding it, He then explains that the Qur &n was revealed as a bringer of glad tidings and a warner in the clear and eloquent Arabic language. There is no confusion or deficiency in it. 4And thus We have sent it down as a Qur'an in Arabic, and have explained therein in detail the warnings, in order that they may have Taqwd of,} This means: so that they will leave off sins, forbidden things and lewd abominations. }or that it may cause them to have a lessonfrom it.} This means: to produce acts of obedience and deeds that will bring one closer to Allah. 4 dP' iThen High above all be Allah, the True King.} This means: Most Holy and Majestic is He, the True King, Who is Himself the Truth and His promise is true. Likewise, His threat is true, His Messengers are true, the Paradise is true,

398 Tafsir Ibtî KathTr the Hellfire is true and everything from Him is true. His justice is that He does not punish anyone before warning them sending Messengers to them and granting excuses to His creatures, so that no one will have any argument or doubt (on Judgment Day). The Command to the Prophet ss; to listen to the Qur anwhen it is revealed without making haste to recite it Concerning Allah s statement, O' J-i* irt O'v-ill; J*Co \$And be not in haste ivith the Qur'an before its revelation is completed to you,} This is similar to Allah s statement, 4 r iMove not your tongue to make haste therewith. It is for {is to collect it and to give you the ability to recite it. And when We have recited it to you, then follow its recital. Then it is for Us to made it clear (to you).>(75:16-19) It is confirmed in the Sahih on the authority of Ibn Abbas, who said that the Messenger of Allah m, used to go through great pains to retain the revelation. In doing so he used to move his tongue rapidly with its recital . Then, Allah revealed this Ayah. This means that whenever Jibril would say anAyah, the Prophet m, would say it with him due to his eagerness to memorize it. Then, Allah guided him to thatwhich was easier and lighter in this matter, to relieve him of this difficulty. Allah said, iMove not your tongue to make haste therewith. It is for Us to collect it and to give you the ability to recite it.} [75:16-17] Meaning, We will gather it in your chest, then you will recite it to the people without forgetting anything of it. m Path Al-Bari 1 :39

J ry W>^ f Si k f SZ0\$ &')W j3^ l*ifr ^J3vj ^iAlSJ^aij iiiiil ijj @cs^S/jQ jjlo^j^Xi'Si ^And when We have recited it to you, then follow its recital. T\hen it is for Us to made it clear (to you).} [75:18-19] And He said in this Ayah, jJi iri d/PP & 4And be not in litiste with the Qur an before its revelation is completed to you,} This is a command to the Prophet sfe to listen quietly: Then, when the angel (Jibril) completes reciting to you, you recite it after him. 4and say: "My Lord! Increase me in knowledge. } meaning, Give me more knowledge from You. Ibn Uyaynah said, The Prophet sg did not cease increasing (in knowledge) until Allah, the Mighty and Sublime, took him (i.e. he died). *^L3j & if) *A p> & P* di^ | Vi iu-pj ^ J" 'j " o) iji* ".(V.*' CfrAfi, '-?*>*' fp ^ ^^^ il Vl =i "'Kdr'. ^ ^J jii' d* viljj Ja J'i cO-j> /// y'j > ' ' s" c^t' " ' /<' y *" .i' / / / " / yn *,f .t fjU U ouu^ Lipy u_i OA-4 yu 4 AM v 1" /VJ ^r*r <* *, y .y . i-r Pjp tJjj ota^t JLA^f ^ uUp_JAfr^jiwJrs~aM -"If " . . ,\i ' i > .

4115. And indeed We made a covettant with Adam before, but heforgot, and Wefound on his part nofirm willpower.} ill6. And (remember) when We said to the angels: Prostrate yourselves to Adam." They prostrated themselves (all) except Iblfs; he refused .. Then We said: O Adam! Verily, this is an enemy to you and to your toife. So let him not get you both out of Paradise, so that you will be distressed."} 4118. You ivilt never be hungry therein nor naked."} 4119. "And you (ivill) suffer not from thirst therein nor from the sun's heat."} 4120 . Then Sltaytan whispered to him, saying : "O Adam! Shall I lead you to the Tree of Eternity and to a kingdom that will never waste away?"} 4121. Then they both ate of the Tree, and so their private parts became manifest to them, and they began to cover themselves with the leaves of the Paradise for their covering. Thus Adam disobeyd his Lord, so he went astray.} 4122. Then his Lord chose him, and turned to him with forgiveness, and gave him guidance.} The Story ofAdam and Iblis Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn Abbas said, Verily, man was named Insan only because he was given a covenant, but he forgot it (Nasiya) . Ali bin Abi Talhah reported the same'2' from Ibn Abbas. Mujahid and Al-Hasan said that he forgot means, He abandoned it. 13 ' Concerning Allah s statement, 4}'& Ui10 4And when We said to the angels: "Prostrate yourselves to Adam."} He, Allah mentions how Adam was honored and what respect was given to him. He mentions how He favored him over many At-Tabari 18:383. At-Tabari 18:383. 3| At-Tabari 18:383.

of those whom He created. A discussion of this story has already preceded in Surat Al-Baqarah, Surat Al-A raf, Surat Al- Hijr and Surat Al-Kahf. It will also be mentioned again at the end of Surah Sad. In this story, Allah mentions the creation of Adam and that He commanded the angels to prostrate to Adam as a sign of honor and respect. He also explains the enmity of Iblls for the Children of Adam and for their father, Adam, before them. Due to this Allah says, iThey prostrated themselves (all) except Iblis; he refused.} This means that he refrained from prostrating and becamje arrogant. ^C Xtrjtjj jJl jj* \j j) fjlii biii> iThen We said: "O Adam! Verily, this is an enemy to you and to your wife..."} here wife refers to Hawwa . 4So let him not get you both out of Paradise, so that you will be distressed.} meaning, Do not be hasty in doing something that will get you expelled from Paradise, or else you will be fatigued, discomforted and worried, seeking your sustenance. But here, in Paradise, you live a life of ease with no burdens and no difficulties. H vf iu i{ } 4 Verily, you will never be hungry therein nor naked.}

The reason that Allah combined hunger and nakedness |is

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3566–3570]

because hunger is internal humiliation, while nakedness is external humiliation. 4And you (will) suffer not from thirst therein nor from the sun's heat.} These two characteristics are also opposites. Thirst is the internal heat and being parched from lack of water, while the

O Adam! Shall I lead you to the Tree of Eternity and to a kingdom that will never waste away?

tlil "d *j[S jib^ *' ' j'" 43Li Ji>- Cyfi- faj lll ml 'fi. O Ijj li Jjli i,U 4iP kj." o ."JL)1 U-b t U ablli aL^-jlli o^ ayw OJL>- 13 ' ~? S\ v^aiji iLLaw^1 j Jj iN v-ij la :JU 5 p-"j : jli ^xU-i 4 Verily , Allah created Adam as a tall man with an abundance of hair on his head. He looked like a clothed palm tree. Then, when he tasted (the fruit of) the tree, his clothes fell off ofhim The first thing that became exposed was his private parts. So when he noticed his nakedness, he tried to run back into Paradise. However, in the process a tree caught hold of his hair (i.e. his hair urns tangled in a tree), so he ripped his hair out. Then, the Most Beneficent called out to him saying, "O Adam, are you fleeing from me?" When he heard the Words of the Most Beneficent, he said, "No my Lord, but I am ashamed. If I repent and recant would You let me return to Paradise?" Allah replied, "Yes." 111 This is the meaning of Allah s statement, y)t . 0 J. fX #3} iThen Adam received from his Lord Words. And his Lord pardoned him.} [2:37] However, this narration has a break in the chain of transmission between Al-Hasan and Ubayy bin Ka*b. Al-Hasan did not hear this Hadith from Ubayy. It is questionable as to whether this narration can be correctly attributed to the Prophet sg Allah said, 4 j-i' Jjj Ji l. ,-f liij} 4And they began to cover themselves with the leaves of the Paradisefor their covering.}Tabari 12:354. As the author noted, this Hadith is riot authentic. It was recorded with a connected chain by Al-Hakim, who considered it authentic. Adh-Dhahabi agreed. However, the chain contains Yahya bin Damrah , whose biography is unknown

some of you are an enemy to some others. Then if there comes to you guidance from Me, then whoever follows My guidance he shall neither go astray nor shall be distressed.} 4124. But whosoever turns away from My Reminder, verily, for him is a life ofhardship, and We shall raise him up blind on

the Day of Resurrection."}

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3570–3586]

4125. He will say: "O my Lord! Why have you raised me up blind, while I had sight (before)."} 4126. (Allah) will say: "Like this Our Ayat came unto you, but you disregarded them, and so this Day, you will be neglected."} The Descent ofAdam to the Earth and the Promise of Good for the Guided and Evil for the Transgressors Allah says to Adam, Hawwa and Iblls, Get down from here:, all of you. This means each ofyou should get out of Paradise. We expounded upon this in Surah Al-Baqarah. &o# 4Some ofyou as enetnies to others.} [2:36] He (Allah) was saying this to Adam and his progeny and Iblls and his progeny. 1 Concerning Allah s statement, 4& jf. fy} 4Then if there comes to you guidancefrom Me,} Abu Al- Aliyyah said, This (guidance) means the Prophets, the Messengers and the evidence. 4C& VJ J~j*i Vi j^} 4Tl\en whoever follows My guidance he shall neither go astray nor shall be distressed.} Ibn Abbas said, He will not be misguided in this life and he will not be distressed in the Hereafter. 0* Iff} * * At-Tabari 1 :549. At-Tabari 18:389.

iBut whosoever turns aioayfromMy Reminder,} This means, Whoever opposes my command and what I have revealed to My Messenger, then he has turned away from it, neglected it and taken his guidance from other than it. iverily, foi him is a life ofhardship,} meaning, his life will be hard in this world. He will have no tranquillity and no expanding of his breast (ease). Rather, his chest will be constrained and in difficulty due to his misguidance. Even if he appears to be in comfort outwardly and he wears whatever he likes, eats whatever he likes and lives wherever he wants, he will not be happy. For verily, his heart will not have pure certainty and guidance. He will be in agitation, bewilderment and doubt. He will always be in confusion and a state of uncertainty. This is from the hardship of life. Concerning His statement, iand We shall raise him up blind on the Day of Resurrection.} Mujahid, Abu Salih and As-Suddi said, This means he will have no proof. 1 '* Ikrimah said, He will be made blind to everything except Hell. This is as Allah says, / * >> f- ii t rfr -A' rji iAttd We shall gather them together on the Day of Resurrecti on their faces, blind, dumb and deaf; their abode will be Hell.} [17 :97] This is why Allah says, 40 my Lord! Why have you raised me up blind, while I had sight (before).} This means in the life of this world. L> Lx.' At-Tabari 18 :394.395

Ta Ha (127) (Part-16 {(Allah) will say: Like this Our Ayat came unto you, but you disregarded than, and so this Day, you will be neglected.> Meaning, When you turned away from the signs of Allah and dealt with them in the manner of one who does not remember them after they were conveyed to you. You neglected them, turned away from them and were heedless of them. Therefore, today We will treat you in the manner of one who has forgotten you. "L_] ' y 1 - ^ -a ' jXJU So this Day We shall forget them as they forgot their meeting of this Day.} [7:51] For verily, the punishment will be a retribution that is based upon the type of deed that was done. However, forgetting the words of the Qur an, while understanding its meaning and acting upon its legislation, is not included in the meaning of this specific threat. Yet, forgetting the words of the Qur an has been warned against from a different aspect. It has been reported in the Sunnah that it is absolutely forbidden and there is a serious threat against one who forgets Qur an (that he previously memorized). A.fZBt-Sv -"/t s.&i f > ' .t ' "s:\ 4327. And thus do We requite him who transgresses beyond bounds and believes not in the Ayat of his Lord; and the torment of the Hereafter isfar more severe and more lasting.} Severe Torment for Him Who bounds transgresses beyond Allah says: Thus We do requite those who transgress beyond bounds and belie the Ayat of Allah in this world and in the Hereafter. 4For than is a torment in the life of this world, and certainly, harder is the tormait of the Hereafter. And they have no defender or protector against Allah.} [13:34] Therefore Allah said, ifftj iL' yfi\ ftej}

, >. -V' *"-i-lv v rn smm" ~Vri 4and the torment of the Hmaft r i\$ far ,r*r' ' k- '-T -- - ' vere and more lasting .} meaning: a more " > ' " :?". grievous and more painful penalty than of this world they wiU remain therein, they ^ will abide forever in *uch torme t A "f ___ ' s. Messenger ^ said to both husband and >-/. ' '? r--"r {, ' . '>' wife who took an oath, ^ when the husband accused his wife of committing illegal sexual intercourse: ;p-rp^)\3^ LajljSfJ! *jSUj 3r? VlijJl O'-ip j[" uup g.'iCU' "Verily , the torment of \ ""SAk. '- ' this worldly life is more insignificant, compared \$\$/ (LxJlj^jhX to f/ie punishment of the ' ^ =JI HereafterV JjV oj5 Jib j 6] rt^- i X*" " (4 " 1 'f> 'fi oj>>. C& JjiS j3j ftj) o J j * ilftJ V-" ^** 'ijli* Sb -^ gjd* J4 pr*j iy-:^y 4128. Is it not a guidance for them (to know) how many generations We have destroyed before them, in whose dwellings they walk? Verily, in this are signs indeed for men of

understanding.} <(129. And had it not been for a Word that went forth before from your Lord, and a term determined, (their punishment) Muslim 2:1131.

must necessarily have come (in this world). 4130. So bear patiently what they say, and glorify the praises of your Lord before the rising of the sun, and before its setting, and during some hours of the night, and at the ends of the day, that you may become pleased with the reward which Allah shall give you.} thi Many Nations were destroyed and in Them is a Lesson Allah, the Exalted, says, ifr. 4Is it not a guidance for them...?} This is addressed to those who reject what the Prophet came to them with: *We destroyed those who denied Messengers from the previous nations before them. They showed open hostility, so now there is not trace of them none of them are left. This is witnessed by the empty home that these people left behind, and which others have not inherited, moving about in the dwellings of those of the past, 45 4 '\$} iVerily, in this are signs indeed for men of understanding .} This means those who have sound intellect and common understanding. This is as Allah says, "i * X' ' " At * A.U f > / \ j Ifr jyu jbu Lj- jyCJ iw ;Ct iHave they not traveled through the land, and have they hearts wherever with to understand and ears wherever with to hear? Verily, it is not the eyes that grow blind, but it is the hearts which are in the breasts that grow blind.} [22 :46 Allah also said in Surah Alif Lam Mim As-Sajdah, 4Is it not a guidance for them : how many generations We have destroyed before them in whose dwellings they walk about?} [32 :26] Then, Allah, the Exalted, says,

410 Tafslr Ibn Kathir 3 && jtsrLbt&> }And had it not been for a Word that went forth before from your Lord, and a term determined (their punishment), must necessarily have come (in this world).} [20:129] This means that if it were not for the Word that had already preceded from Allah - that He would not punish anyone until the proof had been established against him and the punishment would take place at an appointed time that He has already determined for these rejecters - then the punishment would certainly seize them immediately. The Command to be patient and perform the Five daily Prayers Allah comforts His Prophet is, by saying to him, 4So bear patiently what they say,} This means, Be patient concerning their rejection of you. 4And glorify the praises of your Lord before the rising of the sun,} This is speaking of the Morning (Fajr) prayer. i% iand before its setting,} This is speaking of the Mid-afternoon (Asr) prayer. This has been mentioned in the Two Sahih on the authority of Jarir bin Abdullah Al-Bajali, who said, Once we were sitting with the Messenger of Allah jfe when he looked up at the moon on a night when it was full. He said, ji ^i iojj V lx" jj'j lis Verily, you all will see your Lord (in the Hereafter) just as you see this moon and you will not have to crowd together to see Him . Therefore, if you are able to not miss a prayer before sunrise (Fajr) and before sunset (Asr), then you should do soJ

Ta Ha (128-130) (Part-16 Then he recited this Ayah. Imam

*Allah , the Exalted, says, O people of Paradise. They will reply, We are here at Your service and Your pleasure our Lord." He will then say, Are you all pleased?" They will reply, Why should we not be pleased our Lord, when You have given us what You have not given any others of Your creation?" Allah will then say, Verily, I am going to give you something better than that." They will say, "And what thing could be better than that? Allah will say, I have allowed for you My pleasure, so I will never be angry with you again after this .**** In another Hadith, it states that it will be said, Sja Uj ojijZj : o_v-5 ji Jjjj xj. j[JaI j&l j&j Syi 14IJI JaiJl JA U 4)1 y tvJj ""0 people of Paradise, verily you all have an appointed

promise with Allah that He would like to fulfill for you." They will say, "And what is that? Has He not already enlightened our faces, made our Scales (of good deeds) heavy, saved us from the Hellfire and entered us into Paradise?" Then, the veil will be lifted and they will gaze upon Him (Allah). By Allah, He has not given them anything better than the opportunity to look upon Him, and that is the increase (extra blessing). "< *'1 ,rV -Xu I*' ' Jf Xuj *j V-" SxA* lA> p-r-l Vjl>< u JI liCue o-u: yjf 4131 . And strain not your eyes in longing for the things We have given for enjoyment to various groups of them, the splendor of the life of this world, that We may test them thereby. But the provision of your Lord is better and more lasting. 4132. And enjoin Salah on your family, and be patient in offering them. We talk not of you a provision : We provide for you. And the good end is for those who have Taqwa 111 Path AVBQri 1)1:423. 4 :332

Do not look at the enjoyment of the wealthy, be patient in the worship of Allah. Allah, the Exalted, says to His Prophet Muhammad (s), Do not look at what these people of luxury and their likes and peers have of nice comforts. For verily, it is only short-lived splendor and a feeble bounty, which We are using to test them with. And very few of My servants are truly thankful. Mujahid said various groups of them , This means the wealthy people. ^ This means, Verily, We have given you (O Muhammad) better than that which We have given them. This is just as Allah says in another Ayah, i&Cl VxL ? tSjyP*' oi C- J 2C h))> i And indeed, We have bestowed upon you seven repeatedly recited verses, and the Grand Qur'an. Look not with your eyes ambitiously. \$ [15:87-88] Likewise, that which Allah has stored for His Messenger (j) in the Hereafter is something extremely great. It is an unlimited reward that cannot be described. This is as Allah says, 4 And verily, your Lord will give you so that you shall be well- pleased. \$ [93:5] For this reason, Allah says, i But the provision of your Lord is better and more lasting. In the Sahih it is recorded that T Jmar bin Al-Khattab entered upon the Messenger of Allah (j) while he was in the small room in which he had separated himself from his wives after he had vowed to stay away from them. When he came in, he saw him (the Prophet (s)) lying down upon a sandy straw mat. There was nothing in the house except a pile of sand, tree pods and some hanging equipment. Umar's eyes filled with tears (upon seeing this), so the Messenger of Allah (j) said to him, Tabari 17:141.

that We may test them thereby. So that We may put them to trial. ' Concerning Allah's statement, i And enjoin the Salah on your family, and be patient in offering them.} This means to save them from the punishment of Allah by the establishment of the prayer, and you also be patient in performing it. This is as Allah says, 4'jk ij j \JSC itff (\$ } i O you who believe! Ward off yourselves and your families against a Fire (Hell).} [66:6] Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Zayd bin Aslam reported from his father that he and Yarfa would sometimes spend the night at Umar bin Al-Khattab (s). Umar had a certain time of night that he would get up and pray. However, sometimes he would not get up for it. Then, we would say, He is not going to get up like he usually does. When he would awaken, he would make his family get up as well. He would say, And enjoin the Salah on your family, and be patient in offering them. W Allah said; J* \ijj y} 4 We ask not of you a provision: We provide for you.} This means that if you establish the prayer, your sustenance will come to you from where you did not expect. This is as Allah says, o t W/1 , a] J U c)1 f j *j f > } And whosoever has Taqwa of Allah, He will make a way for him to get out (from every difficulty). And He will provide him. At-Tabari 18:405. At-Tabari 18:406.

from (sources) he never could imagine [65:2-3] Allah also says, 4 ii Styj U) &j 4And I (AlldJi) created not the Jinn and mankind except that they should worship Me (Alone). until, \$&& iVerily, Allah is the All-Provider, Owner of Power, the Most Strong.> [51:56-58] Thus, Allah says, 0* Jr 4We ask not of you a provision : We provide for you.} Verily,

Ta Ha (133-135) (Part-16) wealth will be placed in his heart. The worldly life will come to him anyway (in spite of his not seeking Concerning Allah s statement, iAnd the good end is for those ivho have Taqwa> This means the good end in this life and in the Hereafter. In the Hereafter the good end will be Paradise for whoever feared Allah. In the Sahih it is reported that the Messenger of Allah & said, jlj _lo f lijl Ulj j IL> iilij j \j i Jt ilii jLS iilAJ lllil ^ jl kilJi "J saw in my dream tonight a vision as if we were in the home of Uqbah bin Rafi and we were given fresh Ibn Tab dates. Therefore, I interpreted this dream to mean that the good final outcome (Aqibah) is for us in this world along with lofty (Rifa'ah) positions, and that our religion is good (Tab). [21 b i< a. jvr'li ijll) Liyjj Vj) *j' Jr* at {fr -3 Xj-y cJLj VjJ Cj . "Jj oj y'jju - -iit i,'.if ' ?>"-: ? <*-,'* - ;. = -JV" O' 0>*tc i O-JJ/J cN==* J" ,r> . J-s-> .r' 0*J 4133. They say : "Why does he not bring us a sign from his Lord?" Has there not come to them the proof of that which is in the former papers (Scriptures)?} 4134. And if We had destroyed them with a torment before this, they would surely have said : "Our Lord! If only You had sent us a Messenger, we should certainly have followed Your Ayat, before we were humiliated and disgraced 4135. Say: "Each one is waiting, so wait you too; and you shall blow who are they that are on As-Sirat As-Sawi, and ivho are they that have let themselves be guided." 4 1,1 Ibn Majah 2:1375. ^ Muslim 4 : 1779 . Ibn Tab is the name of a popular kind of date

The signs are only with Allah, and I am only a plain wamer.

zTiere was not any Prophet except that he was given signs that caused men to believe. That which I have been given is a revelation that Allah has revealed to me, so I hope that I have the most followers among them (the Prophets) on the Day of Resurrection . "1 ' In this Hadith, the Prophet jfe only mentioned the greatest of the signs that he was given, which is the Qur an. However, he did have other miracles, which were innumerable and limitless. These miracles have all been recorded in the books that discuss them, and they have been affirmed in the places that mention them. Then Allah says, \ j j)> 4And if We had destroyed them with a torment before this, they ivould surely have said : "Our Lord! If only You had sent us a Messenger..."} This means, If We had destroyed these rejecting people before We sent this Noble Messenger to them and revealed the Mighty Book to them, they would have said, iOur Lord! If only You had sent us a Messenger,} meaning, before you destroyed us, so we could have believed in him and followed him. This is like Allah said, ji-i J oi 4we should certainly have followed Your Aydt, before we were humiliated and disgraced.} Allah, the Exalted, explains that these rejecters are stubborn and obstinate and they will not believe. 4Even if every sign should come them, until they see the paitifid torment.} [10:97] This is as Allah says, HI Fath Al-Bari 8 :6 19 , Muslim 1 : 134

&SB&2 l&f 4And i/iis is a blessed Book which We have sent down, so follow it and have Taqwa (of Allah), that you may receive mercy. Until His statement, tyiT ^UtUiUbC UJ Allah also says, /**_,* */ { "-.'>-> / " \ iAnd they swore by Allah their most binding oath that if a wamer came to them, they would be more guided than any of the nations (before them) . [35:42] cX-JJJ *' (ir j% 0^ M*r iAnd they swear their strongest oaths by Allah, that if there came to them a sign, they would surely believe

therein. [6: 109] to the completion of those Aydt. Then, Allah says, Say, O Muhammad, to those who deny you, oppose you and continue in their disbelief and obstinace. iEach one is waiting,} among you and us; 4so wait you too;} This is a command to await (anticipate). 0-* liy&- iand you shall know who are they that are on As-Sirat As- Sawi.} This means the straight road. 4&

4And who are they that have let themselves be guided. meaning guidance to the truth and the path of right guidance. This is similar to Allah s statement, O_i 4And they will know, when they see the torment, who it is that is most astray from the path!) [25:42] And Allah said, 4'f^Vi lit o 4Tomorrow they will come to know who is liar, the insolent one!) [54:26]

Module 23

Surah 21: Al-Anbiya, Surah 22: Al-Hajj

Surah 21: Al-Anbiya

PDF pages 3587–3680

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 3587]

Opening 422 Tafsir Ibn Kathir The Tafsir of Surah Al-Anbiya (Chapter - 21)

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3587–3595]

Abdullah said, Banu Israil, Al-Kahf, Maryam, Ta Ha and Al-Anbiya - they are among the earliest and most beautiful Surahs and they are my treasure. 12 -S > In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. ,v i' - ; -r ' { ' } ot u J (**>' * Y! rii ji t#^ i ; c \$ -Ji & 4 j>"p j; 3* ^ < #8 44 > j; iii.1 j; - liiif ^ ^;V5 (%-f^ ut {"frb1 b . . jfjl J 47. Drayys near for mankind their reckoning, while they turn away in heedlessness 42. Comes not unto them an admonition from their Lord as a recent revelation but they listen to it while they play . 43. With their hearts occupied. Those who do wrong, conceal their private counsels, (saying): "Is this more than a human being like you? Will you submit to magic while you see it? } 44. He said: "My Lord knows what is said in the heavens and on earth. And He is the All-Hearer, the All-Knower 111 Surah Al-Isra . Al-Bari, 4 :289

45. Nay, they say: "These are mixed up false dreams! Nay, he has invented it! - Nay, he is a poet! Let him then bring us an Ayah like the ones that were sent before!"} 46. Not one of the toons of those which We destroyed, believed before them; will they then believe.} The Hour is at hand but People are heedless This is a warning from Allah of the approach of the Hour, and that people are heedless of it, i.e., they are not working for it or preparing for it.

424 Tafsir Ibn Kathir have, which has been altered and distorted, and they have added things and taken things away, when your Book is the most recently revealed from Allah, and you read it pure and unadulterated?

Al-Anbiya' (1-6) (Part-17) The Disbelievers Ideas about the Qur'an and the Messenger their demand for a Sign and the Refutation of that ss rj6 iNay, they say: These are mixed up false dreams! Nay, he has invented it!..."} Here Allah tells us of the stubbornness and heresy of the disbelievers, and the various things they said about the Qur'an, and how they were confused and misguided about it. Sometimes they described it as magic, and sometimes they described it as poetry, or mixed up false dreams, or a fabrication. As Allah says: 4 !VNL^ . 1"- \u LL iSee what examples they have put forward for you. So they have gone astray, and never can they find a way} [17:48] fojljV' J-j' U ss> /ibj 4Let him then bring us an Ayah like the ones that were sent before!} They were referring to the she-camel of Salih, and the signs of Musa and Isa. And Allah says, ioj5 v. J V* St'S o' L> 4And nothing stops Us from sending the Ayat but that the people of old denied them.} [17:59]. So Allah said here: 0* cix. 1} }Not one of the

towns of those which We destroyed, believed before them; will they then believe?} None of the peoples to whom Messengers were sent were given a sign at the hands of their Prophet and believed. On the contrary, they disbelieved and We destroyed them as a result. Would these people believe in a sign if they saw it? Not at all! In fact,

...\$J ,0j-ty, Y <&j <^&=> Ui (>* /i * J==* p-r*U jM 4-UJi iTruly, those, against whom the Word of your Lord has been justified, will not believe. Even if every sign should come to them, until they see the painful torment.} [10:96-97], Indeed, they witnessed clear signs and definitive proof at the hands of the Messenger of Allah signs which were far clearer and more overwhelming than any that had been witnessed in the case of any other Prophet, may the blessings and peace of Allah be upon them all. "A -s - > . - A', 'til i- Lit ^ > 't ./ ^ ^ X v tij saj, (p L pj_j =OJl > Gj|"Lial^="l)'V "'- ill'x <" ;x ,7^' XX . > X-X*, X .X*x d :. * i i-,jU X > 'X XX^Vxv- Xx "-X -X*x^ .XX tp i4xil ^= V j^S o] ^soylt jil Jj3t 5s> ^ dJM C&JS U 1^' ? ;v;^i gf c; ^ ^ cj ^ *-/.Lij And We sent not before you but men to whom We revealed. So ask the people of the Reminder if you do not know.} 48. And We did not place them in bodies that did not eat food, nor were they immortals.} 49. Then We fulfilled to them the promise. So We saved them and those whom We willed, but We destroyed Al-Musrifin .}

The Messengers are no more than Human Beings Here Allah refutes those who denied that human Messengers could be sent: Zrj^\\ CLli 4And We sent not before you but men to whom We revealed.} meaning, all the Messengers who came before you were men, human beings. There were no angels among them. This is like the Ayat tfy1 7L-j 71 Zj} 4And We sent not before you any but men unto whom We revealed, from among the people of townships} [12:109] Si 'e-H 4Sfly: 7 aw not a nezv thing among the Messengers...} [46:9] Allah tells us that the previous nations denied that and said: it/4- 4 Shall mere men guide us?"} [64:6]. So Allah says here: 4So ask the people of the Reminder if you do not ktmv.} meaning, ask the people of knowledge among the nations such as the Jews and Christians and other groups: were the Messengers who came to you human beings or angels? Indeed they were human beings. This is a part of the perfect blessing of Allah towards His creation: He sent to them Messengers from among themselves so that they could receive the Message from them and learn from them. 4And We did not place them in bodies that did not eat food...} meaning, rather they had bodies that ate food, as Allah says: 430a 4 oA-^J S* iXi Zf} 4And We never sent before you any of the Messengers but verily, they ate food and walked in the markets} [25:20]

428 Tafslr Ibn Kathir meaning, they were human beings who ate and drank like all other people, and they went to the marketplaces to earn a living and engage in business; that did not affect them adversely or reduce their status in any way, as the idolators imagined. jylt VjJ jipV' J^="t j/jf Ijci)C) ix % 4i& ji eg?^# they say ; "Why does this Messenger eat food, and walk about in the markets. Why is not an angel sent down to him to be a wamer with him? Or (why) has not a treasure been granted to him, or why has he not a garden whereof he may eat?"} [25:7-8] inor were they immortals) meaning, in this world; on the contrary, they lived, then they died. **> ^ ^ j) iAnd We granted not to any human being immortality before you) [21:34] But what distinguished them from others was that they received revelation from Allah, and the angels brought down to them from Allah His rulings concerning His creation, what He commanded and what He prohibited. JLJiju. 'f) iTheti We fulfilled to them the promise.) the promise that their Lord made to destroy the evildoers. Allah fulfilled His promise and did

that. He says: 4So We saved them and those whom We willed,) meaning, their followers among the believers, 4but We destroyed Al-Musrifin .) meaning, those who disbelieved the Message brought by the Messengers.

&0 *csn %& * e*- 'M * *} |J*] 111'C u dji Ua4 iJU" r i uv; gii ia -rf^ *c 4 ^'-Uar jp- 4-Ui cJ'j Ci 420. Indeed, We have sent down for you a Book in which there is Dhikrukum. Will you not then understand?} 411. Hoiv many a town given to wrongdoing, have We destroyed, and raised up after them another people!} 412. Then, when they sensed Our torment, behold, they (tried to) flee from it.} 413. Flee not, but return to that wherein you lived a luxurious life, and to your homes, in order that you may be questioned.} 414. They cried: "Woe to us! Certainly we have been wrongdoers."} 415. And that cry of theirs ceased not, till We made them as a field that is reaped, extinct.} The Virtue of the Qur'an Here Allah points out the noble status of the Qur'an and urges them to recognize its worth: i&>" &== XB 4Indeed, We have sent down for you a Book in which there is Dhikrukum}. Ibn Abbas said: Honor for you. 4Will you not then understand?} means, will you not understand this blessing, and accept it? This is like the Ayah: opj 4And verily, this is indeed a Reminder for you and your people, and you will be questioned.} [43:44] m At-Tabari,21:611.

How the Evildoers were destroyed

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3595–3611]

j* ILL-j fZf} iHoiv many a town given to ivrongdoing, have We destroyed,} meaning, they were very many. This is like the Ayah: U i& fif} 4And how many generations have We destroyed after Ntlh!} Ot 4And many a toivnship did We destroy while they ivere given to ivrongdoing, so that it lie in ruins} (22:45). 4 L*j" ^ iand raised up after them another people!} means, another nation which came after them. i^ili Oi} iThen, when they sensed Our torment,} when they realized that the torment would undoubtedly come upon them, just as their Prophet had warned them, (*" 4behold, they (tried to) flee from it.} they tried to run away. frj U j] i_ "j} 4Flee not, but return to that wherein you lived a luxurious life, and to your homes,} This is a way of ridiculing them. It will be said to them by way of ridicule: Do not run away from the coming torment; go back to the delights and luxuries and fine homes in which you were living. Qatadah said, Mocking them. 4in order that you may be questioned} about whether you gave thanks for what you had.

Ai-Anbiva (16-20) (Part-17) S' ei T3 4They cried: "Woe to us! Certainly we have been ivrong- doers. } They will confess their sins when it will be of no benefit to them. Ci*" JjSj cJ'j ^ ^ " >- ' .L 4And that cry of theirs ceased not, till We made them as a field that is reaped, extinct .} meaning, they will keep on saying that, admitting their wrong- doing, until We harvest them as it were, and their movements and voices come to a stop. rJl asSSi rrr zmm <* *^ ^ S' * * S S " S ^ ^ Lid UbAjOuL^ ^ SCXJ J4 1U cJ 1j i'b 2' 1i fij^l i . ^ygiVj "i " rj' yp ojlmC ^ ,;> / / A^ > > ^ x > j > ": 0 "u*L bj^ ;i5-.c2j^ U-jiAi Uj , "LZJi LiU ,s >.s* **/" / Zj> / "> ,',r >>' ". , , -rf ~ r-' . *-.,v < ,S> U? Jiy* i5*}j j* LU ,^*-b5 J-biJ' Jf ijji J* zy^cj^* \^-=> *J ^ o^So-^ V /X^ Cr*J ufJj' - * tj j4 ,Jj ,Jy^u / I ^ ! ' " y // < / / > i / ./" V jtpb Jd> . . We created not the heavens and the earth and all that is between them for play> 427. Had We intended to take a pastime. We cohM surely have taken it from Us, if We were going to do (that).} 418. Nay, We

fling the truth against the falsehood, so it destroys it, and behold, it disappears. And woe to you for that which you ascribe.}

419. To Him belongs whosoever is in the heavens and on earth. And those who are near Him are not too proud to worship Him, nor are they weary. 420. They glorify His praises night and day, they never slacken.} Creation was made with Justice and Wisdom Allah tells us that He created the heavens and the earth in truth, i.e. with justice. 4that He may requite those who do evil with that which they have done, and reward those who do good, with what is best.} [53:31]. He did not create all that in vain or for (mere) play: 01 !& U& jij* ^ Cj J'ij itZli QIC j} 4i\$J# 4And We created not the heaven and the earth and all that is between them without purpose! That is the consideration of those who disbelieve! Then woe to those who disbelieve from the Fire!} [38:27] 4\ vi{^t" 0) (Li Of OiieV jgis o' TL\$ \$} 4Had We intended to take a pastime, We could surely have taken it from Us, if We were going to do (that).} Ibn Abi Najlh said, narrating from Mujahid: 4 (Li oi (fr o'i y} 4Had We intended to take a pastime. We could surely have taken it from Us,} Meaning, From Ourselves, He is saying, *We would not have created Paradise or Hell or death or the resurrection or the Reckoning. 11 Af-Tabari, 18:421.

Al-Anbiya' (16-20) (Part-17 4if We were going to do (that).} Qatadah, ' As-Suddi, Ibrahim An-Nakha i and Mughlrah bin Miqdam said: This means, We will not do that. Mujahid said, every time the word 4if} is used in the Qur'an, it is a negation. 121 4^f)' 4Nay, We fling the truth against the falsehood,} means, *We explain the truth and thus defeat falsehood. Allah says: 4%v> % iso it destroys it, and behold, it disappears.} it is fading and vanishing. 4And woe to you} O you who say that Allah has offspring. 4jJluu *} 4for that which you ascribe.} that which you say and fabricate. Then Allah informs of the servitude of the angels, and how they persevere in worship night and day: Everything belongs to Allah and serves Him i " ". .trr- J o* Ajf 4To Him belongs whosoever is in the heavens and on earth. And those who are near Him} i.e., the angels. 4-itM o* iare not too proud to worship Him,} they do not feel proud and do not refuse to worship Him. This is like the Ayah At-Jabari, 18:420. Ad-Durr Al-Manthur, 5:620.

iAl-Masili will never be proud to reject being a servant of Allah, nor the angels who are the near. And ivlisoever rejects His worship and is proud, then He will gather them all together unto Himself.} [4:172] inor are they weary.} means, they do not get tired or feel bored. 4'^xfju_ V jlpb Jji iThey glorify His praises night and day, they never slacken .} They persist in their worship night and day, obeying Allah to the utmost, and they are able to do this, as Allah says: \j> jjCiuj iif v> iwho do not disobey Allah in ivhat He commands them, but do what they are commanded [66:6] foj & 4[hy. *, j) ^ &h 421 . Or have they taken (for worship) gods from the earth who raise the dead?} 422. Had there been therein (in the heavens and the earth) gods besides Allah, then verily, both would have been ruined. Glorified be Allah, the Lord of the Throne, (High is He) above all that (evil) they associate with Him!} 423. He cannot be questioned as to what He does, while they will be questioned.} Refutation of false gods Allah denounces those who take other gods instead of Him: 4 jfjil Jt i*!'* \ ff} 40r have they taken gods from the earth who raise the dead?} meaning, can they bring the dead back to life and bring them forth from the earth? They cannot do any of that, so how can they make them rivals to Allah and worship them alongside Him? Then Allah tells us that if there were another god besides Him,

Al-Anbiyd' (21-23) (Part-17) the heavens and the earth would be ruined: tifj ck \$} 4Had there been therein gods} means, in the heavens and the earth, itthen verily, both would have been ruined.} This is like the Ayah: (*+ **; vjll. U_i jjJi Jt A" l*j -d> Oi "> 4 iV > U-e ja*> Je 4No son did Allah beget, nor is there any god along with Him Then each god tvould have taken away ivhat he had created, and some would have tried to overcome others! Glorified be Allah aborve all that they attribute to Him!) [23:91], And Allah says here: 1' >. ' ? ' . "u ' i; XU jy!" yj *lll iGlorified be Allah, the Lord of the Throne, above all that they associate with Him!) meaning, glorified be He above what they say about Him having offspring or partners; glorified and exalted and sanctified be He far above all the lies that they fabricate. 4 , jli u- jll; 4He cannot be questioned about what He does, while they will be questioned.} He is the Ruler Whose rule cannot be overturned and none can object to it, because of His might, majesty, pride, knowledge, wisdom, justice and subtlety. iwhile they will be questioned.} means, He is the One Who will ask His creation about what they did. This is like the Ayah: ;4& S 4So, by your Lord, I'Ve shall certainly call all of them to account. For all that they used to do.} [15:92-93] its aa.% .

4And He protects (all), white against Whom there is no protector} [23:88] o* j* % 'ji j&S. !>-' j* *A'* j* \jX^ } y J3 \$3i Cfy c -j oj Ci-jjJ Cj^ i*+" J. -/>>. .. * >-rr tf it. 'j. . Or have they taken for worship gods besides Him? Say: Bring your proof. This is the Reminderfor those with me and the Reminder for those before me." But most of them know not the Truth, so they are averse.} 425. And We did not send any Messenger before you but We revealed to him (saying): "There is no God but I, so worship Me."} 40r have they taken for worship gods besides Him? Say:} - O Muhammad - 4Bring your proof.} your evidence for what you Eire saying. 4This is the Reminderfor those with me} means, the Qur an. 4and the Reminder for those before me} means, the previous Books, unlike what you claim. Each Book was revealed to each Prophet who was sent with the message that there is no god except Allah, but you idolators do not recognize the truth, so you turn away from it. Allah says: 4 1'K "0 VI -dl V A A\ 4And We did not send any Messenger before you but We revealed to him (saying) : "There is no god but I..."}

438 TafsTr Ibn Kathir 427 . They speak not until He has spoken, and they act on His command.} 428. He knoius ivhat is before them, and what is behind them, and they cannot intercede except for him ivith whom He is pleased. And they stand in aweforfear ofHim. 429. And if any of Hum should say: "Verily , I am a god besides Him," such We should recompense xoith Hell. Thus We recompense the wrongdoers. The Refutation ofThose Who claim that the Angels are the Daughters of Allah; description of their Deeds and Status Here Allah refutes those who claim that He has offspring among the angels - exalted and sanctified be He. Some of the Arabs believed that the angels were the daughters of Allah, but Allah says: s#s .tu, t 4Glory to Him! They are but honored servants. meaning, the angels are servants of Allah who are honored by Him and who hold high positions of noble status. They obey Him to the utmost in all their words and deeds. 4They speak not until He has spoken, and they act on His command.} meaning, they do not initiate any matter before Him or go against His commands; on the contrary, they hasten to do as He commands, and He encompasses them with His knowledge so that nothing whatsoever is hidden from Him. lij J '&> {&.&} 4He knows what is before them, and what is behind them,} 4and they cannot intercede except for him xoith xvhom He is pleased.} This is like the Ayat.

4 fity. i"X* jiis ijjSi li &*> <\$W7io is he that can intercede with Him except with His permission?} [2:255) 0 ^ intercession with Him profits not except for him whom He permits [34:23]. There are many Ayat which say similar things. 4-&U- Ik iAnd theyforfear ofHim} means, because ik cy] (*-ri ; i>*j . V they fear Him. < i . f iAnd they stand in awe. And if any of them should say : "Verily, Iam a god besides Him, } meaning, whoever claims to be a god instead of Allah, i.e., alongside Allah, 4smc/i We should recompense with Hell. Thus We recompense the wrongdoers.} meaning, everyone who says this. This is a conditional sentence, and the condition stated does not necessarily have to take place. This is like the Ayat 4> & iSay: "If the Most Gracious had a son, then I am the first of worshippers."} [43:81] is &ssj ai? 2=3& \$} ilf you join others in worship with Allah, (then) surely, (all) your deeds will be in vain, and you will certainly be among the losers.} [39:65]

4 ^ - k--Lv { l} iX o * L? jlpjj J2 430. Have not those who disbelieve known that the heavens and the earth were joined together as one united piece, then We parted them? And We have made from water every living thing. Will they not then believe?} 432 . And We have placed on the earth firm mountains, lest it should shake with them, and We placed therein broad highways for them to pass through, that they may be guided.} 432. And We have made the heaven a roof, safe and well- guarded. Yet they turn awayfrom its signs}. 433. And He it is Who has created the night and the day, and the sun and the moon, each in an orbitfloating.} The Signs ofAllah in the Heavens and the Earth and in the Night and the Day Here Allah tells of His perfect might and power in His creation and subjugation of all things. &4 iHave not those who disbelieve knotvn} means, those who deny His Divine nature and worship others instead of Him, do they not realize that Allah is the One Who is Independent in His powers of creation and is running the affairs of all things with absolute power? So how can it be appropriate to worship anything else beside Him or to associate others in worship with Him? Do they not see that the heavens and the earth were joined together, i.e. in the beginning they were all one piece, attached to one another and piled up on top of one another, then He separated them from one another, and made the heavens seven and the earth seven, placing the air between the earth and the lowest heaven. Then He caused rain to fall from the sky and vegetation to grow from the earth. He says: i'oUy. Sj O^rj} iAnd We have made from water every living thing. Will they not then believe?}

Al-Anbiua' (30-33) (Part-17) meaning, they see with their own eyes how creation develops step by step. All of that is proof of the existence of the Creator Who is in control of all things and is able to do whatever He wills. In everything there is a Sign ofHim, showing thatHe is One. Sufyan Ath-Thawri narrated from his father from Ikrimah that Ibn Abbas was asked; Did the night come first or the day? He said, Do you think that when the heavens and the earth were joined together, there was anything between them except darkness? Thus you may know that the night came before the day. 111 Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn TJmar said that a man came to him and questioned him about when the heavens and earth were joined together then they were parted. He said, Go to that old man (Shaykh) and ask him, then come and tell me what he says to you. So he went to Ibn Abbas and asked him. Ibn Abbas said: Yes, the heavens were joined together and it did not rain, and the earth was joined together and nothing grew. When living beings were created to populate the earth, rain came forth from the heavens and vegetation came forth from the earth. The man went back to Ibn TJmar and told him what had been said. Ibn TJmar said, Now I know that Ibn Abbas has been given knowledge of the Qur an. He has spoken the truth, and this is how it was. Ibn TJmar said: I did not like the daring attitude of Ibn Abbas

in his Tafsir of the Qur'an, but now I know that he has been given knowledge of the Qur'an. '21 Said bin Jubayr said: The heavens and the earth were attached to one another, then when the heavens were raised up, the earth became separate from them, and this is their parting which was mentioned by Allah in His Book. Al-Hasan and Qatadah said, They were joined together, then they were separated by this air. J-tCs'Tabari, 18:433. ' Ibn Abi Hatim , 8 :2450

iAnd We have made from water every living thing> meaning, the origin of every living thing is in water. Imam

Al-Anbiud' (30-33) (Part-17 through,} means, mountain passes through which they may travel from region to region, country to country. As we can see, the mountains form barriers between one land and another, so Allah created gaps - passes - in the mountains so that people may travel from here to there. So He says: 4that they may be guided.} l Lii tiMrf} iAnd We have made the heaven a roof, safe and loell-guarded.} means, covering the earth like a dome above it. This is like the Ayah, *. V Ajtj l .1; 4With Hands We constructed the heaven. Verily, We are able to extend the vastness of space thereof.} [51:47] = cij 4By the heaven and Him Who built it.} [91:5] 4, ? (pj Jt (i&j SS' XjS\ j'. 'jjJt 4Have they not looked at the heaven above them, hoiu We have made it and adorned it, and there are no rifts in it?} [50:6]. The building and making described here refers to the raising of the dome, as when the Messenger of Allah said, *Islam is built on five, n11 i.e., five pillars, which can only refer to a tent as familiar among the Arabs. ill*#} 4safe and well-guarded.} means, high and protected from anything reaching it. Mujahid said, Raised up. m Fath Al-Bari, 1 :64.Tabari, 18:436.

ref* Cfy* cf iYet they him away from its signs.} This is like the Ayah: (C-S> Oii^; ufjV'j j /j'" oi lio" many a sign in the heavens and the earth they pass by, while they are averse therefrom} [12:105]. They do not think about how Allah has created it, so vast and high, and adorned it with heavenly bodies both stationary and moving by night and day, such as the sun which completes its circuit in one day and night, until it completes its allotted time, which no one knows except Allah, Who created it and subjugated it and directed its course. Then Allah says, drawing attention to some of His signs, / y ^ "*" 4* /// /ly, ij&j 6^- fj} iAnd He it is Who has created the night and the day,} meaning, the one with its darkness and stillness, and the other with its light and human interaction; sometimes the one is longer while the other is shorter, then they switch. iand the sun and the moon,} the sun with its own light and its own path and orbit and allotted time, and the moon which shines with a different light and travels on a different path and has its own allotted time. ieach in an orbit floating.} means, revolving. Ibn Abbas said, They revolve like a spinning wheel, in a circle. 111 This is like the Ayah i(He is the) Cleaver of the daybreak. He has appointed the night for resting, and the sun and the moon for reckoning. Such is the measuring of the All-Mighty, the All-Knowing.} At-Tabari, 20:520 , 521

Al-Anbiud' (34-35) (Part-17) (6:96] * "t! * < 7- jt-fi C-j jJiJ' iji t"j^)t'. ili jJsiT. 'M 434. And We granted not to any human being immortality before you; then if you die, would they live forever?} 435. Everyone is going to taste death, and We shall test you with evil and with good by way of trial. And to Us you will be returned.} No One has been granted Immortality in this World &"- 4And We granted not to any human being immortality before you;} means, O Muhammad. 4%S\} 4immortality means, in this world. On the contrary, 4Whatsoever is on it (the earth) will perish. And the Face of your Lord full of majesty and honor will remain forever.} [55:26-27]. 6\$} 4then if you die} means, O Muhammad,

4ojJtoLi ^ } 4would they live forever?} means, they hope that they will live forever after you, but that will not happen; everything will pass away. So Allah says: oEveryone is going to taste death,} 4&i J&, } 4and We shall test you with evil and with good by way of trial.}

Meaning, We shall test you, sometimes with difficulties and sometimes with ease, to see who will give thanks and who will be ungrateful, who will have patience and who will despair. Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn Abbas: iand We shall test you} means, We will test you, i*^i J\> iwith evil and with good by way of trial.} means, with difficulties and with times of prosperity, with health and sickness, with richness and poverty, with lawful and unlawful, obedience and sin, with guidance and misguidance. iAnd to Us you will be returned.} means, and We will requite you according to your deeds. (^+11* !i " vi _i Sji -iJ'v /.f .V" A* " > 'r,? " > ' > Jk 436. And when those who disbelieved see you, they take you not except for mockery (saying) : "Is this the one who talks about your gods?" While they disbelieve at the mention of the Most Gracious.} 437. Man is created ofhaste. I will show you My Ayat. So ask Me not to hasten (them).}

How the Idolators mocked the Prophet^

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3611–3652]

Allah tells His Prophet jg: }And when those who disbelieved see you,} meaning, the disbelievers of the Quraysh, such as Abu Jahl and his like. 4u>-" vi ^i m At-Tabari , 18 :440

Al-Anbiua' (36-37) (Part-17 ithey take you not exceptfor mockery} means, they make fun ofyou and insult you, saying, i"Is this the one who talks about your gods?"} meaning, is this the one who insults your gods and ridicules your intelligence? Allah says: 0MiM iWhile they disbelieve at the mention of the Most Gracious.} meaning, they disbelieve in Allah and yet they mock the Messenger of Allah jg. As Allah says: GUj o\ ii'^ vi 4 iiJ itgpuf.& ^ ^ jJjg, % \4& iAnd when they see you, they treat you only in mockery (saying): "Is this the one whom Allah has sent as a Messenger? He would have nearly misled usfrom our gods, had it not been that we were patient and constant in their worship!" And they will know, when they see the torment, who it is that is most astrayfrom the path!} [25:41-42] i)fd It i+rff&} iMati is created ofhaste.} This is like the Ayah: iy.fy 'M iand man is ever hasty} [17:11], in all matters. The reason why the haste of man is mentioned here is that when mention is made of those who mock the Messenger jg, (the believers) will want to avenge them swiftly, and that so should happen sooner. Allah says, if** i & \$Man is created of haste.} because He delays (the punishment) until a time when, once He seizes him, He will never let him go. He delays it, then He hastens it; He waits, then He does not delay any longer. So He says:

Al-Anbiud' (38-40) (Part-17) 4Atid they say: "When will this promise (come to pass), ifyou are truthful".} And Allah says o* " > V oj-" S;i* jUj 4If only those who disbelieved knew (the time) when they will not be able to ward off the Firefrom their faces, norfrom their backs,} meaning, if only they knew for certain that it will inevitably come to pass, they would not seek to hasten it. If only they knew how the torment will overwhelm them from above them and from beneath their feet. rfZ ,yj jl5l> ft ^ fi} iThey shall have coverings of Fire, above them and coverings (ofFire) beneath them [39:16] w * t>. S . "| r** toe iTheirs ivill be a bed ofHell (Fire), and over them coverings (of Hellfire)} [7:41], And in this

Ayah Allah says: ft. V f=→r} iwheti they will not be able to ward off the Fire from their faces, nor from their backs,} And Allah says: iTheir garments will be of tar, and fire will cover their faces} [14:50]. The torment will surround them on all sides, 4and they will not be helped.} means, and they will have no helper. This is like the Ayah 4And they have no guardian against Allah} [13:34]. (*+& 4Nay, it will come upon them all of a sudden} means, the Fire will

& ii'C jaj 4 Verily, Messengers were denied before you, but with patience they bore the denial, and they were hurt ; till Our help reached them, and none can alter the Words of Allah. Surely, there has reached you the information (news) about the Messengers (before you)} [6:34]. Then Allah mentions His favor for His creatures; He protects them by night and by day, taking care of them and watching over them with His Eye that never sleeps. UM fo iSay : "Wlw can guard and protect you in the night or it} the day from the Most Gracious?"} means, other than the Most Gracious Himself? jL i *! "' > . ' * I'V>^JJ 0* JiT iNay, but they turn away from the remembrance of their Lord.} means, they do not recognize the blessings and favor of Allah towards them; they turn away from His signs and blessings. iOr have they gods wlw can guard them from Us?} This is a rhetorical question aimed at denouncing and rebuking. The meaning is, do they have any gods who can protect them and take care of them other than Us? It is not as they imagine or as they claim. Allah says: 4 y} }They have no power to help themselves,} these gods on whom they rely instead of Allah cannot even help themselves. iL; inor can they be protected from Us.} Al- Awfi reported from Ibn Abbas, Nor can they be guarded from Us. 111 hi At-Tabari, 18:448.

Al-Anbiyd' (44-47) (Part-17) Al-Hasan Al-Basri said: This means the victory of Islam over disbelief. 11 The meaning is: Do they not learn a lesson from the fact that Allah supported those (believers) against their enemies, He destroyed the disbelieving nations and the evil- doing townships, and He saved His believing servants? So Allah says: ils it then they who will overcome?} meaning, on the contrary, they are the ones who will be overcome, who will be defeated, humiliated and brought low. iSay : I warn you only by the revelation meaning, I only convey to you the warning of Allah s punishment and vengeance, and this is no more than that which Allah reveals to me. But this is of no benefit to the one whom Allah has made blind and has put a seal over his hearing and his heart. He says: C 'jeJU' 4But the deaf will not hear the call, (even) when they are warned . 4And if a breath of the torment of your Lord touches them, they will surely, cry: "Woe unto us! Indeed we have been wrongdoers!"} If these disbelievers were affected by the slightest touch of Allah s punishment, they would confess their sins and admit that they had wronged themselves in this world. JLi) jtLlu Vi li.*-j)tiigjjJill 4And We shall set up Balances of justice on the Day of Resurrection, then none will be dealt with unjustly in anything.} meaning, We shall set up the Balances of justice on the Day li) A(-Tabari, 1 :494.

454 Tafstr Ibn Kathir of Resurrection. The majority of scholars state that it is one Balance, and the plural form is used here to reflect the large number of deeds which will be weighed therein. Jij>- oi of) Jlii (ti-bS then none will be dealt with unjustly in anything. And if there be the weight of a mustard seed, We ivill bring it. And sufficient are We to take account. This is like the Ayat 4Q 4: Jk Sij> iand your Lord treats no one with injustice> [18:49] 4;:J;tL^ ii'i iSurely, Allah wrongs not even of the weight of speck of dust, but if there is any good. He doubles it, and gives from Him a great reward. [4:40] Jfj'A

j A j j' f-e- d\j t. til" 4 .?', " Ol 4 0 my son! If it be equal to the weight of a grain of mustard seed, and though it be in a rock, or in the heavens or in the earth, Allah will bring it forth. Verily, Allah is Subtle, Well- Aware."^ [31:16] In the Two SahXhs it was recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah sg said: Jl jliLiJ i jLJtl f U Q jlills' p ;laW^ *ji I fcoJu^ "1 Two words which are light on the tongue, heavy in the Balance and beloved to Ar-Rahman: "Subhdn Alldhi wa bi hamdihi, Subhdn Alldhil 'Azmi (Glory and praise be to Allah, Glory be to Allah the Almighty)."^ Fat* Al-Bari, 13:547; Muslim, 4:2072.

* <&; ^ e C JSj> JJ JijC;^u& j i? jyj pij wiliC S. And indeed We granted to Musa and Harun the criterion, and a shining light and a Reminder for those who have Taqwa.) 449. Tlwse who fear their Lord in the unseen, and they are afraid of the Hour.) 450. And this is a blessed Reminder which We have sent down; will you then deny it?) The Revelation of the Tawrah and the Qur an We have already noted that Allah often mentions Musa and Muhammad together - may the peace and blessings of Allah be upon them both - and He often mentions their Books together as well. He says: 4i f& ojJLli) (Lvu'* f) 4And indeed We granted to Musa and Harun the criterion Mujahid said, This means the Scripture. 111 Abu Salih said: The Tawrah. Qatadah said: The Tawrah, what it permits and it forbids, and how Allah differentiated between truth and falsehood. 121 In conclusion, we may say that the heavenly Books included the distinction between truth and falsehood, guidance and misguidance, transgression and the right way, lawful and unlawful, and that which will fill the heart with light, guidance, fear of Allah and repentance. So Allah says: 4% {% vL& 'd&K) 4the criterion, and a shining light and a Reminder for those who have Taqwa.) meaning, a reminder and exhortation for them. Then He describes them as: 4Those wlvfear their Lord in the unseen.) This is like the Ayah: At-Tabari, 18:453. At-Tabari, 18:453.

Al-Anbiya' (51-56) (Part-17) &rJ X) / sc- y^i iWfxo feared the Most Gracious in the unseen and came zoith a repent- ing hearty [50:33] .. *)l? Oj * - _ {jJAS i: 5& A iVerily, those ivho fear their Lord unseen, theirs will be forgiveness and a great reward.) [67:12] iand they are afraid of theHour.) means, they fear it. Then Allah says: ijO% iAnd this is a blessed Reminder which We have salt down;) means, the Magnificent Qur an, which falsehood cannot approach, from before it or behind it, revealed by the All-Wise, Worthy of all praise. mmm V,Jj agtfHyT rrT / -V ^ _> *> "C > > , *> <* ' <" OjJj @ ^=s />>, "S.- Wt' >" " > i * -t" GSjJJ a jUs jtJo Jis .a&j <* ' S li " TC" ##4{jap jJibj <& /> 4wi// yow then deny it?) means, will you deny it when it is the utmost in clarity and truth? "jCa l* ,^ *A^ ^ p -Ub jSi JU "fe^xfc- Q UU'i kJuj ij!U 'Vr ti 4*j]??j J: Jtt C^osj"dl' ot cJ ^ *y# 'IsS'pJs* ^a-> 4 f^=5Mt) ^ jj _ j'i c? \$5 tfXX* JfXb y> ' 451 . And indeed We bestowed aforetime on Ibrahim his

guidance, andWe ivere Well-Acquainted with him.} . When he said to his father and his people: What are these images to which you are devoted?"} . They said: "Wefound ourfathers worshipping them."} . He said: "Indeed you and your fathers have been in manifest error."} . They said: "Have you brought us the Truth, or are you one of those who play about?"} . He said: "Nay, your Lord is the Lord of the heavens and the earth, Who created them and to that I am one of the ivitnesses. } The Story ofIbrahim and his People Allah tells us about His close Friend Ibrahim, peace be upon him, and how He bestowed upon him guidance aforetime, i.e., from an early age He inspired him with truth and evidence against his people, as Allah says elsewhere: iAnd that was Our proof ivhich We gave Ibrahim against his people} [6:83]. The point here is that Allah is telling us that He gave guidance to Ibrahim aforetime,

i.e., He had already guided him at an early age. ^ & } i and We were Well-Acquainted with him. } means, and he was worthy of that. Then Allah says: iWhen he said to his father and his people: "What are these images, to which you are devoted?" } This is the guidance which he had been given during his youth: his denunciation of his people's worship of idols instead of Allah. Ibrahim said: - 01 -ff '1 (> } 4 "What are these images, to which you are devoted? } meaning, which you worship with such devotion.

^ \Luj "j)U^ iThey said: "We found our fathers worshipping them." } means, they had no other evidence apart from the misguided actions of their forefathers. Ibrahim said: 4yJ p&o& 'P 4Indeed you and your fathers have been in manifest error. } meaning, Speaking to your fathers whose actions you cite as evidence would be the same as speaking to you. Both you and they are misguided and are not following any straight path. When he called their intelligence into question, and said that their fathers were misguided and belittled their gods. iThey said: "Have you brought us the Truth, or are you one of those who play about?" } They said: These words that you are saying, are you speaking in jest or are you telling the truth? For we have never heard such a thing before. i&fr jf&jp& S. js" 4He said: "Nay, your Lord is the Lord of the heavens and the earth. Who created them..." } meaning, your Lord, beside Whom there is no other god, is the One Who created the heavens and the earth and all that they contain; He 'is the One Who initiated their creation; He is the Creator of all things. iand to that I am one of the witnesses. } means, and I bear witness that there is no God other than Him and no Lord except Him. vj xs S JM&& S |" Jyti yl" (JiiJ

1e6: e] ipuvif lifiu (sty) ifftm (tuaiff) SupJLqs mail } uodn pauutf atf uaqi i/dfiy atp aipj si stqx 'lopi } sa33iq aqj joj jdaaxa pe uiaq; paqseuis aq stream ^ s333td Of utaiff aqouq 3i{ osP ^rrr unq preaq peq ajdoad atp jo auios pire i'sqavq mod. patutif puo dvmv auo8 3(ion nod J3)/u sfopt mod aoj uvjd v fofd // m/s / i{Vffy dq puy\$ 4%f psfZ f tf\ 5 piBs peq aq psqj ajojaq /Cep aqj Xjuo sbm jj ,-qois ure j, pres an , qjiM jno 3uiuioua jou noX are unqBjq i q, pres ptre unq dq passed jfoqi [BAtsaj Jiaqj ajejqapo o} jno jua/a unqBjq i jo aidoad aqj uaq^ [po,sepi uqi] qBqnpqv, uiojj SBMqv -IV nqy moaj pajjodaj beqsi nqy - ajBjqapa oj jno o p/no/a Xaqj qotq/a jBAtsaj b peq Xaqx [BApsaj Jiaqj oj jno iusm Aaqj uaqM sqaBq jiaqj paturq ptre de/toa auo3 pBq Xaqj jaye tuaqj yCojjsap ptre tuaqj qeajq oj -a-i s/opi Jiaqj jsureSe jojd oj preaq aidoad siq jo auios qaiq/a qjBO ire 3joms unqejqi uaqx sjopi aqq difoiq unqejqjmoh i'/ fivads two dmp Ji 'utaiff dsV V PfP tuaiff Jo fsaSSiq aiff '3110 stiff dv^,, '-ptvs apf -ggp illituti{vjqi o 'spo8 mo ot stiff suop svif oifm. suo aiff nod auy :pws datfi 4"-dfifS3f dviu daiff fviff 'afdodd aiff Jo sada aip auojaq imif Suuq uatfL,, :ptvs daifi igp i./mwqipw3 sj H(n 'Utaiff tsuwSv Supffvf umu Sunod v pivaq 3M,, :p\vs daq 09p in SJaopSuoj(ti aiffJo 3110 aq paapui fsmu 3f{ ispoS mo of stiff auop svif oiffy/ ; ptvs daif -gg} ill Of tunf fifSitu datff fviff 'utaiff Jo fS3S8tq aiff fdaaxa saoadt of uiaiff ayfouq aq os 85} 4,, 'sqavqmod paiwtf puv dvmv auoS aovtf nod uafjv sfopt mod uoj uv\ d v fofd //m/s j ifvffy dq puy /)> 09P

Al-Anbim' (57-63) (Part-17 *k 4that they might turn to it.} It was said that he put a hammer in the hands of the biggest idol so that the people would think that it had become jealous on its own account and objected to these smaller idols being worshipped alongside it, so it had broken them. iThey said: Who has done this to our gods? He must indeed be one of the wrongdoers." } When they came back and saw what Ibrahim had done to their idols, humiliating them and lowering their status, proving that they were not divine and that those who worshipped them were fools. iThey said: "Who has done this to our

gods? He must indeed be one of the wrongdoers."} because of this action of his. iThey said: We heard a young man talking against than, who is called Ibrahim."} Those who had heard him swearing to plot against them said, we heard a young man talking about them, and they said that he was called Ibrahim. 4^ 3 -ti *y b yii" iThey said: "Then bring him before the eyes of the people..."} meaning, in front of a large audience so that all the people could be present. This was Ibrahim s ultimate purpose, so that he could tell this great gathering about the extent of their ignorance and how foolish they were to worship idols which could not defend themselves from harm or help themselves, so how could they ask them for help? S ju CM ill lli S3: iThey said : "Are you the one who has done this to our gods.

O Ibrahim?" He said: Nay, this one, the biggest of them did it..." referring to the one he had left alone and had not broken. iAsk them, if they can speak!) He was hoping that they would admit of their own volition that these idols could not speak and that this idol would not say anything because it was inanimate. In the Two Sahihs it was recorded from Abu Hurayrah that the Messenger ofAllah jg said: 1 ' 4" ^ ijt Or-i j~i- u iSO)l kSj. jl Ibrahim , upon him be peace, did not tell lies except on three occasions, two for the sake ofAllah - when he said : iNay, this one, the biggest ofthem did it.) and when he said: ipf i!> iVerily, I am sick) [37:89]. Vji* Jy itjU. y, l]Zj : Jli b -4 ' *** ij^rj * Jy -i* : Jlii jJ-j . jli . I . J li 31^XJl ;Jia li : Jlii t 3l>"i aJI ce 4\$ Ji 3^ 14 : Jtii IjL. JI JLili t J; (* jil tj? 4^ "x* 'ili . UTy Jp cisij jl llii fli jU jL-*3i] 1& JLili J-jli nJ ci -^ J 4il j^pjl : Jlii iljjjJi Ijblf .Lj.(i ijJlia Jia J-ii 4>-(i iSJUl 41JS jio i.xJ"l jl l^lljj JUj-fi ijJlia i l^lll ^jjjili -p.ii 2i' ^il : Jlii ioUa-,w L jJ tijJl ; Jlii Cr? <_r*^ * oLili oJlai-fj o>-^>-ti . ^ :cJli : Jlij iOU"

Al-Anbiua (64-67) (Part-17) "and when he was traveling in the land of one of the tyrants, and Sarah was with him; when he made camp, a man came to the tyrant and said, "A man has made camp in your land and with him is a woman who is the most beautiful ofpeople. The tyrant sent for Ibrahim, and asked him, "Wltat is the relationship of this woman to you?" He said, She is my sister." The tyrant said, "Go and send her to me." So Ibrahim went to Sarah and said, "Tins tyrant asked me about you, and I told him that you are my sister, so do not let him think that J am lying. For you are indeed my sister according to the Book of Allah, and there are no Muslims on the earth apart from you and I." So Ibrdltlm brought her to him, then he stood and prayed. When she entered upon the tyrant, he reached for her desirously once he saw her. But he suffered a severe seizure. So. he said, "Pray to Allah for me and 1 will not harm you." So she prayed for him and it released him . Then he reached far her desirously, but he was stricken similarly before or worse. This continued three times, and each time he said the same as he had said the first time. Then he called the closest of his guards and said, "You have not brought me a human being, you have brought me a devil! Take her out and give her Hajar. So she was taken out and given Hajar, and she went back. When Ibrahim realized that she had come back, he finished his prayer and turned around. He said, "Wlrat happened?" She said, Allah took care of the evil disbeliever's plot, and he gave me Hajar as a servant." Muhammad bin Sirin said, When Abu Hurayrah narrated this Hadith, he said, This is your mother, O sons of the water of the heaven. > 1 > cfa& jSj j. *- j fa' ^ f ^ , ..j*; H h] jfa jJIUi J [fa*r %& faZ. * t ^"\$ 3d 3# u' Sui fa o/i oi QS0. So they turned to themselves and said: "Verily you are the wrongdoers. } m Fath Al-Bari, 6 :447 ; Muslim , 4 -.1840

Al-Anbiyd' (68-70) (Part-17) rrv Cjp flp j\yUyIs i^JJ (S*Ao^r-[i&2&juc| Ijli JvJ * /. di'^Ki^ui,U.;jUi <./**** ^ > i ^ -1'.*^ . ' ' /. " >> Jlli ^Vi ^"- Jj" k- ^^VJ-laU. -.-Jf- Aa' Jjij '.1 *vaji "r , ^ *itr^ij "j^>-

\$<^ U&0 Ciz\$ J^Tjili)j ' < " -t ":' i ^ t-o_J 4j3li ^Sf t3 meaning, if they can- not speak and they can neither benefit you nor harm you, then why do you worship them instead of Allah? &, oj i . ^ ./ ^ TAoy'i* "5L* "J" jjj upon you, and upon that which you worship besides Allah! Have you then no sense?} Do you not realize the extent of the mis- guidance and extreme disbelief which you are following, which no one could accept butonewho is an igno- rant and evil wrong- doer? He defeated them in argument and leftthem with noway out. Allah said: y d* &>}} iAnd that was Our proof which We gave Ibrahim against his people [6:83] </// J * V ./ / St*. , / > > *^v' "- i " >>./ - ./x Jjc- Lli J o/ u) * /" 4(^> 4r-iV' -ii '-f ,j~ } \ 468. They said: "Bum him and help your gods, ifyou will be doing."} 469. We said: "O fire! Be you cool and safetyfor Ibrahim!"} 470. And they wanted to harm him, but We made them the worst losers.}

466 Tafstr Ibn Kathir How Ibrahim was thrown into the Fire and how Allah controlled it When theirargumentswere refutedand their incapabilitybecame clear,when truthwasmade manifestand falsehoodwas defeated, they resorted to using their power and strength, and said: i"Burti him and help your gods, ifyou will be doing."} So they gathered together a huge amount*ofwood. As-Suddi said, I if a woman was sick, she would make a vow that if she recovered she would bring wood to bum Ibrahim. Then they made a hole in the ground and set it aflame, and it burned with huge sparks and immense flames. There had never been a fire like it. They put Ibrahim, peace be upon him, into a catapult, at the suggestion of a nomadic Kurdish than from Persia. 111 Shu'ayb Al-Jaba i said, His name was Hayzan, and Allah caused the earth to swallow him up, and he will remain sinking into it until the Day of Resurrection. When they threw him he said, Sufficient for me is Allah, and He is the best disposer of affairs. 121 This is similar to what

AI-Anbiua' (71-75) (Part-17) 40 fire! Be you cool and safety for Ibrahim!}, and there was no fire left on earth that was not extinguished. Ibn Abbas and Abu Al- Aliyah said: Were it not for the fact that Allah said, 4and safety}, Ibrahim would have been harmed by its coldness. Qatadah said: On that day there was no creature that did not try to extinguish the fire for Ibrahim, except for the gecko. Az-Zuhri said: The Prophet jg commanded that it should be killed, and called it a harmful vermin. 4 4And they roanted to harm him, but We made them the loorst losers.} they were defeated and humiliated, because they wanted to plot against the Prophet of Allah, but Allah planned against them and saved him from the fire, and thus they were defeated. ; V\^nJLUJ jsfji JJ tiylj iSij tLjlj y* , l_J]y4j '2'-: - .< V<? >?. \ 'C' - s.- a s' >' "' 471 . And We resated him and Lilt to the land which We have blessedfor the nations.} 472. And We bestowed upon him Ishaq, and Ya'qub Ndfilatan. Each one We made righteous.} 473. And We made than leaders, guiding by Our command, and We revealed to than the doing of good deeds, performing Salah, and the giving of Zakah, and of Us (Alone) they were * J

the worshippers.} 4.74. And (remember) Lut, We gave him wisdom and knowledge, and We saved himfrom the town who practised Al- Khaba'ithP1 Verily, they were a people given to evil, and were rebellious.} 475. And We admitted him to Our mercy; truly, he was of the righteous.} The Migration ofIbrahim to Ash-Sham (Greater Syria), accompaniedby Lut Allah tells us that He saved Ibrahim from the fire lit by his people, and brought him out from among them, migrating to the land ofAsh-Sham, to the sacred regions thereof. 4And We bestowed upon him IsItaq, and Ya'qub Nafilatan .} Ata and Mujahid said, Nafilatan means as a gift. ' Ibn 'Abbas, Qatadah131 and Al-Hakam bin TJaynah14 said,

The gift of a son who has a son, meaning that Ya'qub was the son of Ishaq, as Allah says: 4But We gave her glad tidings of Ishaq, and after Ishaq, of Ya'qub [11:71]. Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, He asked for one [son], and said, 0; 4 v 4 My Lord! Grant me from the righteous."} So Allah gave him Ishaq, and gave him Ya'qub in addition. 4*& %} 4Each one We made righteous.} means, both of them were good and righteous people. Meaning filthy, evil behavior.Tabari, 18:471. Ibid. Ad-DurrAl-Manthur5 :643

4And We made them leaders,} means, examples to be followed. } iguiding by Our command,} inviting to Him by His leave. Allah says: 4'tjk=>)\ 'Qfi ifyj &&& We revealed to them the doing ofgood deeds, performing Salah, and the giving ofZakdh,} Here the general is followed by the specific. iand of Us (Alone) they were the worshippers.} means, they did what they enjoined others to do. The Prophet Lut Then Allah mentions Lilt, whose full name was Lilt bin Haran bin Azar. He believed in Ibrahim and followed him, and migrated with him, as Allah says: Jj o\ JSj lj) %&Q} 4So Liit believed in him. He (Ibrahim) said: "I will emigrate for the sake ofmy Lord"} [29:26]. Allah gave him wisdom and knowledge; He sent Revelation to him, made him a Prophet and appointed him to Sadum (Sodom) and its vicinity, but they rejected him and resisted him, so Allah utterly destroyed them, as He tells us in several places in His Book. Allah says; xsss.' . ' >{ i 7- . > 4and We saved him from the town who practised Al-Khabd'ith. Verily, they were a people given to evil, and were rebellious. And Weadmittedhim toOurmercy ; truly, hewasofthe righteous " 'Jxz ij C%} A*'-*' '* t *> , >****

476. And (remember) Niih, when he cried (to Us) aforetime. We answered to his invocation and saved him and his family from the great distress.} 477. We helped him against the people who denied Our Ayat. Verily, theywere apeoplegiven to evil . SoWedrmvnedthem all . Nuh and His People Allah tells us how He responded to His servant and Messenger Nuh, peace be upon him, when he prayed to Him against his people for their disbelief in him: , f >*L> 4Then he invoked his Lord (saying): "I have been overcome, so help (me)!"} [54:10] 'Jj 'ji-r" (Uj* o\ S&l ujiiV' je j'S> 'j Cf) fy itij} l> ijut 4And Niih said: "My Lord! Leave not any inhabitatit of the disbelievers on the earth! If You leave them, they will mislead Your servants, and they will beget none but wicked disbelievers} [71:26-27]. So Allah says here, ifc'j j* t l& i[] 4And (remember) Niih, when he cried (to Us) aforetime. We answered to his invocation and saved him and hisfamily} meaning, those who believed with him, as Allah says elsewhere: ,iZ 1: tj &\$,} 4 . . .and your family - except him against whom the Word has already gone forth - and those who believe. And none believed with him, except afew} [1 1:40]. 11} 4from the great dis- tress.} meaning, from difficulty, rejection and harm. For he remained among them for one thousand years less

Al-Anbiud' (78-82) (Part-17) H2KJ8SS rrA ^ flfty. calling them to --' 'Y 'i'^ ^ <{Vp Ovi 1 Allah, and no one had believed in him except for a few. His people were plotting against him and advising one another century after century, generation after generation, to opposehim. < XZii %> 4We helped him against the people^ means, We saved him and helped him against the people, m & #' *v: r>.^ />- (*> iU iwho denied Our Ayat. Verily, they were a peo- ple given to evil. So We drowned thetn all.} meaning, Allah drowned them all, and not one of them was left on the face of the earth, as their Prophet had prayed would happen to them. /j& (U* oJ-ii ^fp. ^ ^ JC5J' tLS ui; ^="j Jci: ^ ^ L =,J Ijj Qfp Jjfi jfffi Uy^ iirfle juuilj ., / / > // y . "// >' . ^ wj > * * -d 04 v jA) J~ 478. And (remember) Dawud and

Sulayman, when they gave judgement in the case of the field in which the sheep of certain [*V 1i*r\-*} _y- ^ l^> ->]. ' ijJu^j j^^cWr' 'Z' >/^ >*" x/' ^ /V > ^ < "//

people had Nafashat; and We were witness to their judgement.} 479. And We made Sulayman to understand (the case); and to each of them We gave wisdom (Hukm) and knowledge. And We subjected the mountains and the birds to glorify Our praises along with Dawud. And it was We Who were the doer (of all these things). 480. And We taught him the making of metal coats of mail (for battles), to protect you in your fighting. Are you then grateful?} 481. And to Sulayman (We subjected) the wind strongly raging, running by his command towards the land which We had blessed. And of everything We are the All-Knower.} 482. And of the Shayatin were some who dived for him, and did other work besides that; and it was We Who guarded them.} Dawud and Sulayman and the Signs which They were given; the Story of the People whose Sheep pastured at Night in the Field [Abu] Ishaq narrated from Murrah from Ibn Mas'ud: That crop was grapes, bunches of which were dangling. 111 This was also the view of Shurayh. 121 Ibn Abbas said: Nafash means grazing. 131 Shurayh, Az-Zuhri and Qatadah said: Nafash only happens at night. 14 ' Qatadah added, [and] Al-Haml is grazing during the day. 151 > 't 4And (remember) Dawud and Sulayman, when they gave judgement in the case of the field in which the sheep of certain people had pastured at night;} Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn Mas'ud said: Grapes which had grown and their bunches were spoiled by the sheep. .Dawud At-Tabari, 18:474. At-Tabari 18:475. At-Tabari 18:477, 478. ,4) At-Jabari 18:477, 478. |S| At-Tabari 18:477.

Al-Anbiva' (78-82) (Part-17) (David) ruled that the owner of the grapes should keep the sheep. Sulayman (Solomon) said, 'Not like this, O Prophet of Allah! [Dawud] said, How then? [Sulayman] said: Give the grapes to the owner of the sheep and let him tend them until they grow back as they were, and give the sheep to the owner of the grapes and let him benefit from them until the grapes have grown back as they were. Then the grapes should be given back to their owner, and the sheep should be given back to their owner. This is what Allah said: 4And We made Sulayman to understand (the case) .^ also reported by Al- Awfi from Ibn Abbas. [2) itl; Q\ This was 4And We made Sulayman to understand (the case); and to each of them I've gave wisdom and knowledge Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that when Iyas bin Mu'awiyah was appointed as a judge, Al-Hasan came to him and found Iyas weeping. [Al-Hasan] said, Why are you weeping? [Iyas] said, O Abu Said, What I heard about judges among them a judge is he, who studies a case and his judgment is wrong, so he will go to Hell; another judge is he who is biased because of his own whims and desires, so he will go to Hell; and the other judge he who studies a case and gives the right judgement, so he will go to Paradise. Al-Hasan Al-Basari said: But what Allah tells us about Dawud and Sulayman (peace be upon them both) and the Prophets and whatever judgements they made proves that what these people said is wrong. Allah says: \ && 4And (remember) Dawud and Sulayman, when they gave judgement in the case of the field in which the sheep of certain people had pastured at night; and We were witness to their judgement. Jabari 18:475. Tabari 18:475.

474 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Allah praised Sulayman but He did not condemn Dawud. Then he - Al-Hasan - said, Allah enjoins three things upon the judges: not to sell thereby for some miserable price; not to follow their own whims and desires; and not to fear anyone concerning their judgements. Then he recited: 4,0 Dawud! Verily, We have placed you as a successor on the earth; so judge you between men

in truth and follow not your desire -for it will mislead you from the path of Allah. [38:26] iTherejbrefear not men butfear Me} [5:44] 62 #tL i 4and sell notMy Aydtfor a miserable price.} [5:44] (1 ' I say: with regard to the Prophets (peace be upon them all), all of them were infallible and supported by Allah. With regard to others, it is recorded in Sahth.

The younger woman said, May Allah have mercy on you! He is her child, do not cut him up!

476 Tafslr Ibn Kathir meaning, the manufacture of chain-armor. Qatadah said that before that, they used to wear plated armor; he was the first one to make rings of chain-armor.' ' This is like the Ayah: j 0 JS 4\$ iJi 'J \$And We made the iron soft for him. Saying: "Make you perfect coats of mail, and balance well the rings of chain armor) [34:10-11], meaning, do not make the pegs so loose that the rings (of chain mail) will shake, or make it so tight that they will not be able to move at all. Allah says: ipLX & fc s) 4to protect you in yourfighting.) meaning, in your battles. p&) 4Are you then grateful?) means, Allah blessed you when He inspired His servant Dawud and taught him that for your sake. The Power ofSulayman is unparalleled 4And to Sulayman (We subjected) the wind strongly raging,) means, We subjugated the strong wind to Sulayman. 4running by his command towards the land which We had blessed.) meaning, the land ofAsh-Sham (Greater Syria). 4And ofeverything We are the All-Knower.) He had a mat made of wood on which he would place all the equipment of his kingship; horses, camels, tents and troops, then he would command the wind to carry it, and he would go underneath it and it would carry him aloft, shading him and protecting him from the heat, until it reached wherever he IM At-Tabari 18:480.

Al-Anbiva' (83-84) (Part-17) wanted to go in the land. Then it would come down and deposit his equipment and entourage. Allah says: it. 4So, We subjected to him the wind; it blew gently by his order whithersoever he willed.} [38:36] iits morning was a month's (journey), and its afternoon was a montit's} [34:12] 4 v 0}L*.J' cZfso} \$And of the ShaydtTn were some who divedfor him,} means, they dived into the water to retrieve pearls, jewels, etc., for him. iand did other work besides that;} This is like the Ayah 4 ov*- iAnd also the ShaydtTn, every kind of builder and diver. And also others bound in fetters.} [38:37-38]. iand it was We Who guarded them.} means, Allah protected him lest any of these ShaydtTn did him any harm. All of them were subject to his control and domination, and none of them would have dared to approach him. He was in charge of them and if he wanted, he could set free or detain whomever among them he wished. Allah says: iAnd also others bound in fetters.} [38:38] '<& ^ \$& ttse i} c%} " i" * ' >"* >< " *t ^ f 483. And (retnember) Ayyiib, when he cried to his Lord: "Verily, distress has seized me, and You are the Most Merciful

of all those who show mercy. 484. So We ansioered his call, and We removed the distress that was on him, and We restored his family to him, and the like thereof along with them as a mercy from Ourselves and a Reminderfor all those who ivorship Us.y The ProphetAyyub Allah tells us about Ayyub (Job), and the trials that struck him, affecting his wealth, children and physical health. He had plenty of livestock, cattle and crops, many children and beautiful houses, and he was tested in these things, losing every thing he had. Then he was tested with regard to his body, and he was left alone on the edge of the city and there was no one who treated him with compassion apart from his wife, who took care of him. It was said that it reached the stage where she was in need, so she started to serve people (to earn money) for his sake. The Prophet jg said: jiiVi p ij^iijj p iiu "The people who are tested the most severely are

the Prophets, then the righteous, then the next best and the next best*} According to another Hadith: A man will be tested according to his level of religious commitment; t)he stronger his religious commitment, the more severe will be his test.*^ The Prophet of Allah, Ayyub, upon him be peace, had the utmost patience, and he is the best example of that. Yazid bin Maysarah said: When Allah tested Ayyub, upon him be peace, with the loss of his family, wealth and children, and he had nothing left, he started to focus upon the remembrance of Allah, and he said: I praise You, the Lord of lords. Who bestowed His kindness upon me and gave me wealth and children, and there was no comer of my heart that was not filled with attachment to these worldly things, then You took At-Tabarani 24:245, 246. Ahmad 1 :180.

Al-Anbiyd' (83-84) (Part-17 all of that away from me and You emptied my heart, and there is nothing to stand between me and You. If my enemy Iblis knew of this, he would be jealous of me. When Iblis heard of this, he became upset. And Ayyub, upon him be peace, said: O Lord, You gave me wealth and children, and there was no one standing at my door complaining of some wrong I had done to him. You know that. I used to have a bed prepared for me, but I forsook it and said to myself: You were not created to lie on a comfortable bed. I only forsook that for Your sake. I 1 * This was recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded from Abu Hurayrah that the Prophet Sg said: \\\' V" " ^ o-X*t 4J"*" \j ^pu i fjA 1^: u i Jii ? > "iLc- 'jii! Cj i"i Ui y} U : "J jJ-ij : Jli iWhen Allah healed Ayyub, He sent upon him a shower of golden locusts, and he started to pick them up and gather them in his garment. It was said to him, "O Ayyub, have you not had enough? He said, "O Lord, who can ever have enough of Your mercy?v The basis of this Hadith is recorded in the Two Sahihs, as we shall see below. jui 4and We restored his family to him (that he had lost) and the like thereofalong zoith them\$ It was reported that Ibn Abbas said: They themselves were restored to him. ^ This was also narrated by Al- Awfi from Ibn Abbas . Something similar was also narrated from Ibn MasTid and Mujahid, and this was the view of Al-Hasan and Qatadah . 151 Mujahid said: It was said to him, O Ayyub, your family will be with you in Paradise; if you want, We will bring Hilyat Al-Awliya 5 :239 Ibn Abi Hatim 8 :2461 , similar with Al-Bukhari no. 3391Tabari 18:506, 507. At-Tabari 18:506, 507. At-Tabari 18:506, 507.

them back to you, or if you want, We will leave them for you in Paradise and will compensate you with others like them. He said, No, leave them for me in Paradise. So they were left for him in Paradise, and he was compensated with others like them in this world. '&v} 4as a mercy from Ourselves} means, *We did that to him as a mercy from Allah towards him. iand a Reminder for all those who worship Us.} means, We made him an example lest those who are beset by trials think that We do that to them because We do not care for them, so that they may take him as an example of patience in accepting the decrees of Allah and bearing the trials with which He tests His servants as He wills. And Allah has the utmost wisdom with regard to that. X *V- * > 4 " w ij* cfl r?\ y i yfS' L" j .L^SsS t a! 1^O^Lt^li AycAA fijj "ht " y* \yitt /- >-.7- . .> ' .'A' %. |*p s'y y *i i *? 5 ^ y'J. yy s' "J A * s'y 4S5. And (remember) Isma il, Idris and Dhul-Kifl: All were from among the patient.} 486. And We admitted them to Our mercy. Verily, they were of the righteous.}

Al-Anbiud' (87-88) (Part-17) Isma 11, Idris and Dhul-Kifl Ismatl was the son of Ibrahim Al-Khalll, peace be upon them both. He has already been mentioned in Surah Maryam, where mention was also made of Idris. From the context and the fact that Dhul-Kifl is mentioned alongside Prophets, it appears

that he was also a Prophet. Others say that he was a righteous man, a just king and a fair judge. Ibn Jarir refrained from making any decisive comment. 1 11 And Allah knows best. vi iji v j oiui)i 4 tS ^ ojji 487. A (remember) Dhun-Niin, when he went off in anger, and imagined that We shall not punish him! But he cried through the darknesses (Zulumdt) (saying): "There is no Cod but You, Glorified be You! Tndy, I have been of the Zalimin ivrongdoers 488. So We answered his call, and delivered him from the distress. And thus We do deliver the believers. Yunus This story is mentioned here, and in Surat As-Saffat and Surah Nun. Yunus bin Matta, upon him be peace, was sent by Allah to the people of Nineveh, which was a town in the area of Mawsil [in northern Iraq]. He called them to Allah, but they rejected him and persisted in their disbelief. So he left them in anger, threatening them with punishment after three [days]. When they realized that he was telling the truth and that a Prophet never lies, they went out to the desert with their children and cattle and flocks. They separated the mothers from their children, then they beseeched Allah and pleaded to Him, with the camels and their young groaning, the cows and their calves mooing, and the sheep and their lambs bleating, so Allah spared them from the punishment. Allah says: HI At-Tabari 18:507.

482 Tafslr Ibn Kathir ^ yV 'toiLj Gjlf ej 4W"s f/iere any town that believed (after seeing the punishment), and its faith saved it? Except the people of Yunus; when they believed, We removed from them the torment of disgrace in the life of the ivorld, and permitted them to enjoy for a while [10:98]. Yunus, meanwhile, went and traveled with some people on a ship, which was tossed about on the sea. The people were afraid that they would drown, so they cast lots to choose a man whom they would throw overboard. The lot fell to YQnus, but they refused to throw him overboard. This happened a second and a third time. Allah says: jt &^d} 4Then he (agreed to) cast lots, and he was among the losers.} [37:141] meaning, the draw went against him, so Yunus stood up, removed his garment and cast himself into the sea. Then Allah sent from the Green Sea - according to what Ibn MasTld said - a large fish which cleaved the oceans until it came and swallowed Yunus when he threw himself into the sea. Allah inspired that large fish not to devour his flesh or break his bones, (as if He said) Yunus is not food for you, rather your belly is a prison for him. iAnd (remember) Dhun-Niin,} Here Nun refers to the fish; it is correct for it to be attributed to him here. i_"&i iwhen he went off in anger,} Ad-Dahhak said: Anger towards his people. 11 4and imagined that We shall not punish him!} meaning, constrict him in the belly of the fish. Something m At-Tabari 18:511.

Al-Anbiua (87-88) (Part-17) similar to this was reported from Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Ad- Dahhak and others . This was the view favored by Ibn Jarir, and he quoted as evidence for that the Ayah JjLi L" La i iand the man zohose resources are restricted, let him spend according to what Allah has given him. Allah puts no burden on any person beyond what He has given him. Allah will grant after hardship , ease4 (65 :7). 1\ Y" iiJi Y j ciUisf j UxTty 4But he cried through the depths of darkness (saying): There is no God but You, Glorified be You! Truly, I have been of the wrongdoers Ibn Mas fid said regarding the depths of darkness : The darkness of the belly of the fish, the darkness of the sea and the darkness of the night. 121 This was also narrated from Ibn Abbas, Amr bin MaymQn, Said bin Jubayr, Muhammad bin Ka b, Ad-Dahhak, Al-Hasan and Qatadah . 131 Salim bin Abu Al- Ja d said: The darkness of the fish in the belly of another fish in the darkness of the sea. 141 Ibn MasUd, Ibn Abbas and others said: This was because the fish took him through the sea, cleaving it until it reached the bottom of the sea. Yunus heard the rocks at the bottom of the sea uttering glorification of Allah, at which point he said:

Y-4 Y> 4There is no God but You, Glorified be You! Truly, I have been of the wrongdoers Awf Al-A rabi said: When YUnus found himself in the belly of the fish, he thought that he had died. Then he moved his legs. When he moved his legs, he prostrated where he was, then heTabari 18:514, 515. 121 Al-Qurtubi 1 1 :333Tabari 18:516, 517. At-Tabari 18:517. 151 Ibn Abi Shaybah 1 1 :541 ; 13 :578.

484 Tafsfr Ibn KathTr called out: O Lord, I have taken a place of worship to You in a place which no other person has reached. if iSo We answered his call, and delivered him from the distress.} means, We brought him forth from the belly of the fish and from that darkness. 4And thus We do deliver the believers .} means, when they are in difficulty and they call upon Us and repent to Us, especially if they call upon Us with these words at the time of distress. The leader of the Prophets sg encouraged us to call upon Allah with these words. Imam

I said, Nothing, by Allah, except that you told us the first part of the supplication, then this bedouin came and kept you busy. He said, Yes, the supplicaion of Dhun-Nun when he was in the belly of thefish 3 % ill iThere is no Cod but You, Glorified be You! Truly, I have been of the wrongdoers

486 TafsTr Ibn Kathir A ^ - *" dj i^Ai V Cjj %j Oiib l[~^C J^=ff}} 4 iji^=" |i^i ?J &lSvj 4J iLJijJ U \$ -S L^;j aj 489. And (remember) Zakariyyd, when he cried to his Lord: "0 My Lord! Leave me not single (childless), though You are the Best of the inheritors."} 490. So We answered his call, and We bestowed upon him Yahya, and cured his wife for him. Verily, they used to hasten on to do good deeds, and they used to call on Us with hope and fear, and tlwy were Khashi m before Us.} Zakariyya andYahya Allah tells us of His servant Zakariyya, who asked Allah to grant him a son who would be a Prophet after him. The story has already been given in detail at the beginning of Surah Maryam and also in Surah Imran. Here an abbreviated version is given. 4 Aj 4when he cried to his Lord means, in secret, hiding it from his people. V CJJ} 40 My Lord! Leave me not single,} means, with no child and no heir to stand among the people after me. jy df} 4though You are the Best of the inheritors.} This is a supplication and form of praise befitting the topic. Allah says: 4**^*-jj A ? }) LZLJi} 4So We answered his call, and We bestowed upon him Yahya, and cured his wifefor him.} Ibn Abbas, Mujahid and Said bin Jubayr said: She was barren and never had a child, then she gave birth. ,11 m At-Tabari 18:520.

4 \y^=> iVerily, they used to hasten on to do good deeds, means, acts of worship and acts of obedience towards Allah. iand they used to call on Us with hope andfear,} Ath-Thawri said, Hoping for that (reward) which is with Us and fearing that (punishment) which is with Us. iand they were Khashi'in before Us.} Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn Abbas that this means, sincerely believing in that

which was revealed by Allah. 121 Mujahid said: "Truly

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3652–3653]

believing. 131 Abu Al- Aliyah said: Fearing. 141 Abu Sinan said: Khushu means the fear which should never leave our hearts. It was also reported from Mujahid that the KhashVin are those who are humble. Al-Hasan, Qatadah and Ad-Dahhak said, The KhashVin are those who humble themselves before Allah. 151 All of these suggestions are close in meaning. Ajlt i 4 \CsScd ^j^ Vt C^JliaSI 491. And she who guarded her chastity, We breathed into her through Our Ruh, and We made her and her son a sign for nations .} Isa and Maryam the True Believer Here Allah mentions the story of Maryam and her son Isa,

just after mentioning Zakariyya and his son Yahya, may peace be upon them all. He mentions the story of Zakariyya first, followed by the story of Maryam because the one is connected to the other. The former is the story of a child being born to TafsirAth-Thawri204 At-Tabari 16:2.Tabari 16:2. At-Tabari 16:2. 151 Al-Kashshaf3 :133 , Al-Baghawi 3 :267 , Ibn Abi Shaybah 13 :580

488 Tafstr Ibn Kathir an old man of advanced years, from an old woman who had been barren and had never given birth when she was younger. Then Allah mentions the story of Maryam which is even more wondrous, for in this case a child was born from a female without (the involvement of) a male. These stories also appear in Surah Al Imran and in Surah Maryam. Here Allah mentions

the story of Zakariyya and follows it with the story of Maryam,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3653–3654]

where He says: 4And she who guarded her chastity,} means, Maryam (peace be upon her). This is like the Ayah in Surah At-Tahrim: at & 4And Maryam, the daughter of Imran who guarded her chastity. And We breathed into it [her garment] through Our Ruh [66:12]. ihi4& & } 4and We made her and her son a sign for the nations .} means, evidence that Allah is able to do all things and that He creates whatever He wills; verily, His command, when He intends a thing, is only that He says to it, Be - and it is! This is like the Ayah: 4And (We wish) to appoint him as a sign to mankind [19:21] S-sf i 'Jirt== ' .'''I'l l ' .1 " i U! . 492. Truly, this, your Ummah is one, and I am your Lord, therefore worship Me.} 493. But they have broken up and differed in their religion among themselves. (And) they all shall return to Us.} 494. So whoever does righteous good deeds while he is a believer, his efforts will not be rejected. Verily, We record itfor him (in his Book ofdeeds).}

Mankind is One Ummah & p iTruhj, this, your Ummah is one,} Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Qatadah and Abdur- Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, Your religion is one religion. 1 11 Al-Hasan Al-Basri said: In this Ayah, Allah explains to them what they should avoid and what they should do. Then He said: & p\ iTruly, this, your Ummah is one religion,} Meaning, your path is one path. Certainly this is your Sharfah (Divine Law) which I have clearly explained you. So Allah says: p=uj \$>} iand I am your Lord, therefore worship Me.} This is like the Ayah i&C clp U& j & } 40 (you) Messettgers! Eat of the Tayyibdt (good things) and do righteous deeds.} Until His saying, 4And I am your Lord, so have Taqioa ofMe.} [23 :51 -52 The Messenger of Allah said: Wji jLiS/l 34^ j*- ^We Prophets are brothers from different mothers and our religion is one . '''21

What is meant here is that they all worshipped Allah Alone

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3654–3663]

with no partner or associate, although the Laws of each Messenger may have differed, as Allah says: **iri & 4To each among you, We have prescribed a Law and a clear way} [5 :48] At-Tabari 18:523. ,2) Fath Al-Bari 6 :550

> ! \jL juj) ^Bttt they have broken up and differed in their religion among themselves.) meaning, the nations were divided over their Messengers; some of them believed in them and some rejected them. Allah says: i(And) they all shall return to Us.) meaning, on the Day of Resurrection, when We will

requite each person according to his deeds. If they are good, then he will be rewarded and if they are evil then he will be punished. Allah says: *ljlju* whoever does righteous good deeds while he is a believer,) meaning, his heart believes and his deeds are righteous. *yS*) his efforts will not be rejected.) This is like the Ayah *o ^ if4 j^ " V* certainly We shall not make the reward of anyone who does his deeds in the most perfect manner to be lost.) [18:30] which means, his efforts will not be wasted; they will be appreciated and not even a speck of dust's weight of injustice will be done. Allah says: *i* Verily, We record it for him.) means, all his deeds are recorded and nothing of them at all is lost. *> j , < {Sr'i IjI* is . *4 L =" aHit irk \" \" 'At* . And a ban is laid on every town which We have destroyed that they shall not return.) . Until, when *Yajuj and Ma'jij* (Gog and Magog people)

Al-Anbiyd' (95-97) (Part-17) are let loose, and they swoop down from every *Hadab* 497. And the true promise shall draw near. Then you shall see the eyes of the disbelievers fixedly staring in horror. (They will say:) "Woe to us! We were indeed heedless of this - nay, but we were *xorongdoers* Those who have been destroyed, will never return to this World 4 And a ban is laid on every town> Ibn Abbas said, it is enforced , i.e., it has been decreed that the people of each township that has been destroyed will never return to this world before the Day of Resurrection, as is reported clearly [through other narrations] from Ibn Abbas, Abu Ja'far Al-Baqir, Qatadah and others. *Ya juj and Ma juj i*Until, when *Ya'uj and Ma'uj* are let loose> We have already mentioned that they are from the progeny of Adam, upon him be peace; they are also descents of Nuh through his son Yafith (Japheth), who was the father of the Turks, Turk referring to the group of them who were left behind the barrier which was built by Dhul-Qarnayn. Allah says: *jj Jiy ofj /W jj Jej bji 4, O' 4^:4 477ns* is a mercy from my Lord, but *xohen* the promise of my Lord comes, He shall level it down to the ground. And the promise of my Lord is ever true. And on that Day, We shall leave them to surge like waves on one another..[^][18:98-99]. And in this Ayah, Allah says: 111 *Al-Baghawi 3 :268 , At-Tabari 18 :525 , Ar-RSzi 22 : 19 1*

{Until, when *Ya'uj and Ma'uj* are let loose, and they swoop down from every *Hadab*. \$ meaning, they will come forth quickly to spread corruption. A *Hadab* is a raised portion of land. This was the view of Ibn Abbas, Ikrimah, Abu Salih, Ath-Thawri and others. ' This is how their emergence is described, as if the listener can see it. {And none can inform you like Him *Wlw* is the AU-Knower.) [35:14]. This is information given by the One Who knows what has happened and what is yet to come, the One Who knows the unseen in the heavens and on earth. There is no god except Him. Ibn Jarir narrated that Ubaydullah bin Abi Yazid said, Ibn Abbas saw some young boys playing and pouncing on one another, and said, this is how *Ya'uj and Ma'jaj* will emerge. '2 ' Their emergence has been described in numerous Hadiths of the Prophet *jgg*. The First Hadith Imam

Al-Anbiua' (95-97) (Part-17 ^ *jJrj :JU lii u Li; 0 J4-3 ^ ' , , > ,y - . , , # > ' * , l/ y . > ^ ' , *C * ' t J AjI* *tj^jJLp -Vi 3^^^ ^ ^ ^ ! (4J ^ i f4r--'3i In "U oLii oil)) Jj*- Ir*' -'j^' t j f-f-* A* "*Ya'jij and Ma'uj* will be let loose and will emerge upon mankind, as Allah says: *i*and they swoop do on from every *Hadab*> They will overwhelm the people, and the

494 *Tafsxr Ibn KathTr* The Second *Hadxth* Imam

Al-Anbiud' (95-97) (Part-17) *u*No, but you will have to compute it according to its due proportion (and pray accordingly)." We said, O Messenger of Allah, how fast will he move across the land? He said,

"Like a cloud driven by the wind." He said, sum pte) pi * >' > 1 1 ^ * | * * 'T h i * " &>- * J # ' ii I ' > ^}\y\ <*-ZJ tAJy aJU- 4uJ-r ^ P^*>*' In Cr? vX'-ll JLS - J>"Jl -l"l kajyJ <*- pi uiiii t i44-3 jl tdj jJli p*i; p ^y4\ ^ jir Jjoh "UiuJl ojJL"Jl -Up J t ^ ^ M * * >*/ , *s*r' I |- i " * . i * " # * ' ' ' t ' . UliLs OjJLi 4_ *_p-J fc^jXJU ^yp 4rf-U U-^lj k ^-Uo JH-- Jl J^3 p. Jill il 4dUiS pi U i - :J15 - "p*JI jJ p Jil OlJb i^aUp p; lSC& J" pi f^LJl 4pi- pp pi p Jli l"S 4^_j^~Uj {ryrh 3* ^ *::* jpdI p| jp yU pL=> P uM He iai// co/we to a people and call them [to his way] and they will respond to him . He will issue a command to the sky and it will rain, and to the earth and it will bring forth vegetation, then their livestock will come to them in the evening with their humps very high and their udders full of milk and their flanks wide and fat. Thai he will come to another people and call them [to his way] and they will refuse, and their wealth will leave with him, and they will be faced with drought, with none of their wealth left. Then he will walk through the wasteland and will say to it, "Bring forth your treasure," and its treasure will come forth like a swarm of bees . Then he will issue commands that a man be killed, and he will strike him with a sword and ait him into two pieces, and (put these pieces as far apart) as

Tafsir Ibn Kathir the distance betxoeeen an archer and his target. Then he will call him, and the man will come to him with his face shining. At that point Allah will send the Messiah Isa bin Maryam, who will come doivn to the white minaret in the eastern side of Damascus, wearing tivo garments lightly dyed with saffron and with his hands resting on the wings of tiuo angels. He will search for him (the Dajjal) until he catches up with him at the eastern gate of Ludd, ivhere he will kill him. Then Allah will reveal to Isa ibn Maryam the words: "I have brought forth from amongst My creatures people against whom none will be able to fight. Take My servants safely to the Mount (Tftr)." Tlten Allah will send Ya'juj and Ma jijj, as Allah says : iand they swoop doivnfrom every Hadab ' &J y- <*' Jl J jjS*; yi j ._* L& ^ J*'} j^Lij j* ?"* Ai yj & ^Vl "Jii ju^ juls Jii ' "Isa and his companions will beseech Allah, and Allah will send against them insects which will attack their necks, and in the morning they will all perish as one. Then Isa and his companions will come doivn and they will notfind a single spot on earth that is free from their putrefaction and stench. Then fsd and his companions will again beseech Allah, and He will send birds with necks like those of Bactrian camels, and they will carry them and throw them wherever Allah wills . Ibn Jabir said: Ata bin Yazld As-Saksaki told me, from Ka*b or someone else: They will throw them into Al-Mahbal. Ibn Jabir said: I said, O Abu Yazid, and where is Al-Mahbal? He said, In the east (where the sun rises). He said: jl} Yj fx" cJ,o Y I^L" J liUjJlS j* jl^ ; jjlh: . (4 jr? oLIJlJ t jJbi\ s? y, ^lUl (_#"SvX] Uoj y.j y ill il iilJi JU jJL Ul3 :Jli todI jA?

{' Jj>- U5~ yt y j* j' _ (4^* J # # Then Allah zwill send rain which no house of clay or (tent of) camel's hair xoill be able to keep out, for forty days, and the earth ivill be washed until it looks like a mirror. Then it will be said to the earth: bring forth your fruit and restore your blessing. On that day a group ofpeople ivill be able to eatfrom one pomegranate and seek shade under its skin, and everything ivill be blessed. A milch-camel will give so much milk that it will be sufficient for a whole group of people, and a milch-cow will give so much milk that it ivill be sufficient for a whole clan, and a sheep will be sufficient for an entire household. At thaf time Allah will send a pleasant wind which will reach beneath their armpits and will take the soul of every

faces, small eyes and reddish hair, pouring down from every mound with theirfaces looking like burnished shields Ibn Abi Hatim recorded a Hadith ofMuhammad bin Amr from Khalid bin Abdullah

bin Harmalah Al-Mudlaji, from his paternal aunt, from the Prophet jg, and he mentioned something similar.¹² It was confirmed by Hadiths that Isa bin Maryam will perform Hajj to the Al-Bayt Al-'Atiq (i.e., the Ka'bah). Imam

the Day of Resurrection, when these terrors and earthquakes

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3663–3679]

and this chaos will come to pass. The Hour has drawn nigh and when it comes to pass, the disbelievers will say: This is a difficult Day. Allah says: Of-d' jZZ Zt 'iji^ iThen, you shall see the eyes of the disbelievers fixedly staring in horror.} because of the horror of the tremendous events that they are witnessing. iWoe to us!} means, they will say, *Woe to us! ^ jbJu. j ls=s> ji} 4jWe were indeed heedless of this} means, in the world. ** Ahmad 5:271. There is a deficiency in its chain. It may be supported by other narrations 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 8 :2468. Ahmad 3:27, Al-Bukhari 1593.

Al-Anbim' (98-103) (Part-17 a! *zjy(>-ft ' >. " >/> > > > C|P ^>-Lj^>-L ^==4\$ 5jJi-^-1jft= U 4_ft)J ft / .If' . (BS4 / >^ ".<./ . >" . 's' , ">< < > />*, '- < '\$ ' > Jf,c. >< . , 11^=. jl)> 4nay, but we were wrongdoers. they will admit their wrong- doing at the time when that will not help them at all. oi 1^=0^ ^ ^ > s>' >-4^ i -y.^jy & >/// / >./ y / Lajjjj U {\$ {\$ \$ & ft fe> v ft.j i4; Jlft ftj> !"i ft jftji ftiii ft ftj ftft4 V :f -yifti c: ^ ftj tftft y tfjftift *> \u >"-u >>>>.'j\ ="yi jftii (^ "" : , v >/ ^ > * >\s% - / x j/ /" . " v-" 4 "^ > L^JJ' pSOjj 'ift* A^st^JJ > j S l. .lj 498. Certainly you and that which you are worshipping now besides Allah, are (but) fuel (Hasab) for Hell! (Surely) you will enter it.} 499. Had these been gods, they would not have entered there (Hell), and all ofthem will abide therein forever.} 4100. Therein they will be breathing out with deep sighs and roaring and therein they will hear not.} 4101. Verily, those for whom the good has preceded from Us, they will be removedfar therefrom (Hell).} 4102. They shall not hear the slightest sound of it (Hell), while they abide in that which their own selves desire.}

Al-Anbiyd' (98-103) (Part-17) 4vj^~ IJj iand all of them will abide therein forever. means, the worshippers and the objects of their worship will all abide therein forever. 4Therein they will be breathing out ivith deep sighs and roaring^ This is like the Ayah Q fit 4they will have (in the Fire), Zafir and Shahiq} [11:106]. Zafir refers to their exhalation, and Shahiq refers to their inhalation. 4and therein they will hear not.} The State ofthe Blessed 4&2X \% (4J 4Verily, thosefor whom the good has precededfrom Us,} Ikrimah said, Mercy. Others said it means being blessed. 4\$A2 tyfo 4they will be removedfar therefrom .^' 1| When Allah mentions the people of Hell and their punishment for their associating others in worship with Allah, He follows that with a description of the blessed who believed in Allah and His Messengers. These are the ones for whom the blessing has preceded from Allah, and they did righteous deeds in the world, as Allah says: ! d <\$> 4For those who have done good is the best reward and even more} [10:26] IM Af-Tabari 18:451.

ils there any rewardfor good other than good?} [55:60] Just as they did good in this world, Allah will make their final destiny and their reward good; He will save them from punishment and give them a great reward. v iiji ithey will be removed far therefrom. They shall not hear the slightest sound of it,} means, they will not feel its heat in their bodies. c j ^Xs} iwhile they abide in that which their own selves desire.} means, they will be safe from that which they fear, and they will have all that they love

and desire. It was said that this was revealed to point out an exception in the case of those who are worshipped instead of Allah, and to exclude Tjzayr and the Messiah from their number. Hajjaj bin Muhammad Al-A*war reported from Ibn Jurayj, and Uthman bin Ata reported from Ibn Abbas: fj* iJJU jo Li iCertainly you (disbelievers) and that which you are worshipping now besides Allah, are (but) Hasab for Hell! (Surely) you will enter it.} Then He made an exception and said: (J o-llC. iVerily, those for whom the good has preceded from Us.) It was said that this referred to the angels and Isa, and others who are worshipped instead of Allah. This was the view of Ikrimah, Al-Hasan and Ibn Jurayj. Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar said in his book of Sirah: According to what I have heard, the Messenger of Allah jg sat down one day with Al-Walid bin Al-Mughlrah in the Masjid, and An-Nadr bin Al-Harith came and sat down with them. There were also other men of Quraysh in the Masjid. The Messenger of Allah sg spoke, then An-Nadr bin Al-Harith

came up to him and the Messenger of Allah spoke to him until he defeated him in argument. Then he recited to him and to them, < ("&&& > ' // .A, -5, v 4Certainly you and that which you are worshipping now besides Allah, are (but) Hasab for Hell! (Surely) you will enter it.\$ Until His Statement, iand therein they will hear not> Then the Messenger of Allah jg got up and went to sit with Abdullah bin Al-Zab ari As-Sahmi. Al-Walid bin Al-Mughlrah said to Abdullah bin Al-Zab ari, By Allah, An-Nadr bin Al-Harith could not match the son of Abd Al-Muttalib in argument. Muhammad claims that we and these gods that we worship are fuel for Hell. Abdullah bin Az-Zab ari said: By Allah, if I meet with him I will defeat him in argument. Ask Muhammad whether everyone that is worshipped instead of Allah will be in Hell with those who worshipped him, for we worship the angels, and the Jews worship Uzayr, and the Christians worship Al-Maslh, Isa bin Mayyam. Al-Walid and those who were sitting with him were amazed at what Abdullah bin Az-Zab ari said, and they thought that he had come up with a good point. He said this to the Messenger of Allah jg, who said: Everyone who likes to be worshipped instead of Allah will be with the ones who worshipped him, for indeed they are worshipping the Shaytan and whoever told them to worship him ." Then Allah revealed the words: 14 v ff&fcS (4J 4Verily, those for whom the good has preceded from Us, they will be removed far therefrom (Hell). They shall not hear the

&} iTherefore have no doubt concerning it. And follow Me (Allah)! It is the straight path} [43:63]. ' What Ibn Az-Zab ari said was a serious mistake, because the Ayah was addressed to the people of Makkah concerning their worship of idols which were inanimate and could not think. It was a rebuke for their worship of them, so Allah said: . * . : y % i'- CK U_ {Certainly you (disbelievers) and that which you are worshipping besides Allah, are (but) Hasab for Hell!} How could this be applied to Al-Maslh, OJzayr and others who did righteous deeds and did not accept the worship of those who worshipped them? 'r&Z v} iThe greatest terror will not grieve them,} It was said that this means death, as was narrated by Abdur-Razzaq from Yahya bin Rabl'ah from Ata. Or it was said that the greatest terror refers to the blast of the Trumpet, as Al-Awfi said narrating from Ibn Abbas¹²¹ and Abu Sinan, Said bin Sinan Ash-Shaybani. This was the view favored by Ibn Jarir in his Tafsir. oji m &>} iand the angels will meet them, (with the greeting:) "This is your Day which you were promised .} meaning, the angels will greet them on the Day of Resurrection when they emerge from their graves with the words: 4 This is your Day which you were promised .} meaning, hope for the best. llllc Lij /X-y jj' Uji> isjz, ff/) 111 Ibn Hisham 1 :384. At-Tabari 18:542.

506 Tafsir Ibn Kathir 4104. And (remember) the Day when We shall roll up the heaven like a Sijill for books. As We began the first creation, We shall repeat it. (It is) a promise binding upon Us. Truly, We shall do it. TheHeavenswillbe rolledupontheDayofResurrection Allah says: this will happen on the Day of Resurrection: 4And (remember) the Day when We shall roll up the heaven like a Sijillfor books.} This is like the Ayah -ill*If *> iilt UjjS Cm iThey made not a just estimate ofAllah such as is due to Him. And on the Day of Resurrection the whole of the earth will be grasped by His Hand and the heavens will be rolled up in His Right Hand. Glorified be He, and High be He above all that they associate as partners with Him!} [39:67]

away until the Day of Resurrection. But the correct view as narrated from Ibn Abbas is that As-Sijill refers to the record (of deeds).¹¹¹ This was also reported from him by Ali bin Abi Talhah and Al- Awfi. ¹²¹ This was also stated by Mujahid, Qatadah and others. * This was the view favored by Ibn Jarir, because this usage is well-known in the (Arabic) language. Based on the above, the meaning is: the Day when the heaven will be rolled up like a scroll. This is like the Ayah: iThen, when theij had both submitted themselves (to the will of Allah), and he had laid him prostrate on his forehead .fc [37:103] There are many more linguistic examples in this respect. Allah knows best. & in iis }ij 3 \32 tf) 4As We began the first creation, We shall repeat it. (It is) a promise binding upon Us. Truly, We shall do it.) means, this will inevitably come to pass on the Day when Allah creates His creation anew. As He created them in the first place, He is surely able to re-create them. This must inevitably come to pass because it is one of the things that Allah has promised, and He does not break His promise. He is able to do that. Because He says: (S' iTruly, We shall do it.) Imam

As We began the first creation, We shall repeat it. (It is) a promise binding upon Us. Truly, We shall do it.¹¹¹ And he mentioned the entire Hadith. It was also recorded in the Two Sahih, and Al- Bukhari mentioned it in his Tafsir of this Ayah. j\$ i & \$\$. \ oj, J i And indeed We have written in Az-Za- biir after Adh-Dhikr that My righteous servants shall inherit the land.fr 4106. Verily, in this there is a plain Message for people who worship Allah.fr 4107. And We have sent you (O Muhammad ah) not but as a mercy for the 'Alamln.fr The Earth willbe inheritedby the Righteous Allah tells us of His decree for His righteous servants who are the blessed in this world and in the Hereafter, those who will inherit the earth in this world and in the Hereafter. As Allah says: 1:235. Fath Al-B&ri 8 :292 , Muslim 4 :2194

Z.t-S-81 i-reqBjL-iv (e| =81 VreqBi-iv {z} 'Zt:8I UBqBj,-iv (l) 9ip osp? sbm siqx |E | (-qBnv MJJM si qoiqM (qvp^j-jy lump) qoog aqj jo Jsjojq aqj si jytya-ypy pue jyiya-ypy jojjb aureo qoiq/w sqoog aqj sireau jrtqr-zy :pres piqBfnj^ ./qgjMBX sqj - ^OMQ-yPV pus priMBQ 01 pajB3A3j sbm qoiqM jBqj si mqvz-zy ptBS sjaqjo Pub qBpi?JB& ubsbh-iv tq,Bqg-qsv SBqqy, lelX 5!00^ aMJ stream Jnqvz-zy pres piqBfnj^ ltI(< /UB.jnf) " pire jifuj aqj qtjJMBX aqj stream jtnqvz-zy, :pres ag i- l)ltQ-ypV J9lfv - ujqvz-zy ui udpum dewy a/^ pddpui puy T f \0f fo jf :yvfuy aqj jnoqB J^Bqnp uiq pt.Bg paqsB :pres qsBui,yiV i*ma-HPV J3}fo JtJqvz~zy uf U9jjuai dewy pddpui puy^ f *? iifj> :s/{bs q?ltv ssBd oj amoo X]qB;iAaui qtMq qjqj pus saajoag puBSMBq 3UIAIQ jo sqoog aqj tn papjooaj st siqj jsq; sn s[pi qBqy iS9 : ^S] 4m3l{i uafudsoip svy a/j ipiym uoiSipu uunp dsyovud oj ryuoypw dip uidyi }uvu8 pm dji } vi{ } puv utdip duqfdq dsoip o) p pdjuvu8 dji sv 'puvj dip ui uoissdootis tudyt }uvj8 fyuwpdd pm dpi jvy) 'spddp poo8 snodjySu op puv dodipq oym nof\ 8uouw dsoip pdsiuoud svy yvpy\$ f-p tr*i g g#r fr, \p- y?\ r^ e==rn' "" 'S' " , ILS : Ot] 4 ' y)-tofpuv}s pim sdssdiyim dy) udyf fivQ dip uo puv d/p s

tppom sup ui deidipq oym dsoip puv sud8udssdi/y unO snouopia dyviu pddpui pirn d/y[R\ud^ ih rrr x?\n * rffi %t&u& , \2ZVL\ i UOibvp dewyoym dsoip jo/ si puo (pdssdiq) dyi puv .sfuvcuds spy fo spim duuioym ot d8v)udy v sv p sdat8 a/j 's yvpy si ipuvd dyi 'ftpud/[\$ (Zl-VVd) UULSOI) ,Vtiituy-iy 'll H^US60S

view of Zayd bin Aslam: It is the First Book. Ath-Thawri said: It is Al-Lawh Al-Mahfuz. && ithatMy righteous servants shall inherit the land.} Mujahid said, narrating from Ibn Abbas, This means, the land of Paradise. ' This was also the view of Abu Aliyah, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Ash-Shalai, Qatadah, As-Sud 1, Abu Salih, Ar-RabT bin Anas and Ath-Thawri (may Allah have mercy on them).2' ^ lijj 'ji* . i {Verily, in this (the Qur'an) there is a plain Messagefor people who toorship Allah.} means, in this Qur an which We have revealed to Our servant Muhammad jg, there is a plain Message which is beneficial and is sufficient for a people who worship Allah. This refers to those who worship Allah in the manner which He has prescribed and which He loves and is pleased with, and they would rather obey Allah than foUow the Shayfan or their own desires. Muhammad^ is a Mercy to the Worlds {And We have sent you not but as a mercy for the *AlamTn .} Here Allah tells us that He has made Muhammad si a mercy to the Alamin, i.e., He sent him as a mercy for all of them (peoples], so whoever accepts this mercy and gives thanks for this blessing, will be happy in this world and m the Hereaf er But whoever rejects it and denies it, will lose out in this world and in the Hereafter, as Allah says: '&S\$ & ^ ^ if {Have you not seen those who have changed the blessings of ITabari 18:549.Tabari 18:549, 550.

Al-Anbiua' (105-107) (Part-17) Allah into disbelief, and caused their people to dwell in the house of destruction? Hell, in which they will bum, - and what an evil place to settle in!) [14:28-29] And Allah says, describing the Qur an: oi JLC- iSay: "It is for those who believe, a guide and a healing. And as for those who disbelieve, there is heaviness in their ears, and it is blindness for them . They are those who are called from a placefar away [41:44]

blessings for him on the Day ofResurrection ."h 1 This was also recorded by

Al-Anbiya (108-112) (Part-17) The main Objective of Revelation is that Allah be worshipped Allah commands His Messenger to say to the idoators: t3 sf i"It is revealed to me that your God is only one God. Will you then be Muslims?"} meaning, will you then follow that and submit to it? i'\jy iBut if they turn away} means, if they ignore that to which you call them. J-i"r i\$ay : "I give you a notice to be biown to us all alike..."} meaning, I declare that I am in a state ofwar with you as you are in a state of war with me. I have nothing to do with you just as you have nothing to do with me. This is like the Ayah: QjUai U4 " V-3 V.. Ml .. i % iAnd if they belie you, say : "For me are my deeds andfor you are your deeds! You are innocent of what 1 do, and I am innocent ofwhat you do!"} (10:41) 4tV*& 3~0\ jJb iCir fj ilf you fear treachenj from any people, throw back (their covenant) to than (so as to be) on equal terms (that there will be no more covenant betweai you and than)} [8:58] which means: so that both you and they will know that the treaty is null and void. Similarly, Allah says here: T}!>- j-ii iBut if they turn away say : "1 give you a notice to be biown to us all alike..."} meaning, I have already informed you that I have nothing to do with you and you have nothing to do with me.

No one knowswhen the Hour will come J Lfi} iAnd I know not whether that which you are promised (i.e.,

the Day of Resurrection) is near or far

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3679–3680]

meaning: it will inevitably come to pass, but I have no knowledge of whether it is near or far. iVerily, He (Allah) knows that which is spoken aloud (openly) and He knows that which you conceal.} Allah knows the Unseen in its entirety; He knows what His creatures do openly and what they do secretly. He knows what is visible and what is concealed; He knows what is secret and hidden. He knows what His creatures do openly and in secret, and He will requite them for that, for both minor and major actions. J of)} iAnd I know not, perhaps it may be a trial for you, and an enjoymentfor a while.} meaning, do not know, perhaps it is a trial for you, and an enjoyment for a while. Ibn Jarir said: perhaps that is being delayed for you as a test for you, and enjoyment for an allotted time. 111 This was narrated by Awn from Ibn Abbas. And Allah knows best. 1 o j \$} iHe said: "My Lord! Judge You in truth!} means, judge between us and our people who disbelieve in the truth. Qatadah said: The Prophets (peace be upon them) used to say: Jr dj c j y & j} i"Our Lord! Judge between us and our people in truth, for You are the Best of those who give judgment."} (7:89), Ml At-Tabari 18:554.

Al-Anbiud' (108-112) (Part-17) and the Messenger of Allah jg was commanded to say this too. It was reported from Malik from Zayd bin Aslam that when the Messenger of Allah jg witnessed any fighting, he would say: && 4 My Lord! Judge You in truth! } 40ur Lord is the Most Gracious, Whose help is to be sought against that which you attribute!} means, against the various lies and fabrications that you utter, some of which are worse than others; Allah is the One Whose Help we seek against that.

Surah 22: Al-Hajj

PDF pages 3681–3792

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3681–3706]

In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. J-fcJC L |> ffijL-lj* \> iljj p ~~=,A> Lfjlj^ i-" . -.i.r r , "& -('s Uj op/j L \$-*** J "- v J==* t>== / , r.v /" / /> </<*'. > ^ j Att^ t-J p-h 41. O mankind! Have Taqia of your Lord! Verily, the earthquake of the Hour is a terrible thing.} 42. The Day you shall see it, every nursing mother will forget her nursling, and every pregnant one will drop her load, and you shall see mankind as in a drunken state, yet they will not be drunk, but Allah's torment is severe. } The Hour Allah commands His servants to have Taqwa of Him, He informs them of the terrors of the Day of Resurrection which will come to them with its earthquakes and other horrors, as He says: 4t^Quii joVi 'j , 'U'Sij 4Wlien the earth is shaken with its (final) earthquake. And when the earth throws out its burdens.} 199:1-2] 4l 3i"i'j)* oojj if'. t&Ji JUh> Pfji iAnd the earth and the mountains shall be removed from their places, and crushed with a single crushing. Then on that Day shall the (Great) Event befall.} [69:14-15] And;

517Siirah 22. Al-Haii (1-2) (Part-17) iWhen the earth will be shaken with a terrible shake. And the mountains will be powdered to dust.} [56 :4-5] It was said that this earthquake will come at the end of the ife span of this world, at the outset of the Hour. Ibn Jarir recorded that Alqamah commented on Allah s saying, '-ca &&& Vj iVerily, the earthquake of the Hour (ofJudgement) is a terrible thing.} Before the Hour. Others said that this refers to the terror, fear, earthquakes and chaos that will happen on the Day of Resurrection, in the arena (of Judgement), after the resurrection from the graves. This was the view favored by Ibn Jarir, who took the following Hadiths as evidence: Imam

Do you know what Day that is? That is the Day when Adam will be called. His Lord will call him and will say: "O Adam, said forth (those of your progeny) who are to be salt to the Fire. He will say, "O Lord, how many are to be sent to the Fire? He will say, From every thousand, nine hundred and ninety-nine will be in the Fire and one will be in Paradise. His Companions were filled with despair and stopped smiling. When he saw that, he said: iJe.J\$ J* J*. If) VI Li 4Be of good cheer and strive hard, for by the One in Whose Hand is the soul ofMuhammad, you will be counted with two creations who are of immense numbers, Ya'jii and Ma jii, and those who have already died of the progeny of Adam and the progeny of Iblis ." Then they felt happier, and he said: i'jiJ j\ Strive hard and be of good cheer, for by the One in Whose Hand is the soul ofMuhammad, in comparison to mankind you are like a mole on the flank of a camel or a mark on the foreleg ofa beast. "|1 This was also recorded by

Al-Haii (1-2) (Part-17) ibut Allah's torment is severe.} were revealed, the Prophet jg was on a journey, and he said: ill JX }y. .j&f iiyX/j Jill f>; j; ' Ulij jsUJL^J : JVJ Xi: li) 4^S U : Jti ijllJl IX iJlJl :fSV ^' iJi j! *Do you know what Day that is?* They said, Allah and His Messenger know best. said: That is the Day on which Allah will say to Adam, "Send forth (those of your progeny) who are to be sent to the

Fire." He will say, "O Lord, how many are to be salt to the Fire?" He will say, "From every thousand, nine hundred and ninety-nine will be in the Fire and one will be in Paradise." The Muslims started to weep, then the Messenger of Allah jg said: Jij U_> ijJidiJl oils' 'Vp aoJj jji lilUUJl ja liijl jrf? vU-J y&tiM (jjij iX j\ ^ *Be close in your rank and be straight forward, for there was never any Prophet but there was a time of ignorance just before his advent, so the number will be taken from that time of ignorance, and if that is not enough, it will be made up from the hypocrites. A parable of yours in comparison to the other nations is that, you are like a mark on theforeleg ofan animal, or a mole on theflank ofa camel . Then he said, "/ hope that you will be a quarter of the people of Paradise. They said, Allahu Akbari Then he said, aL"Jl vi-U I yyX L)f jXjS/ "/ hope that you will be a third of the people of Paradise . They said, AUahu Akbar!" Then he said,

"/ hope that you will be halfof the people ofParadise ." They said, uAlla.hu Akbart Then he [the narrator] said, I do not know if he said two- thirds or not. This was also recorded by Imam

Al-Haii (1-2) (Part-17) side ofa white bull, or a white hair on the side of a black bull . I hope that you will be one quarter of the people of Paradise.* We said AUahu Akbar! Then he said, "A third of the people of Paradise ." We said, AUahu Akbar!" Then he said, "One halfof the people ofParadise ." We said: Allahu Afcbari 1

xJj rrt emtsw \n f \ :f > r.m "Aw'i)Jjj LfAij O^Uf/L) ji====" _U"j >* > " "" ^ >* // / V/#S*i ^ ./" '-J-Cl"? ;>. ,i ^ " "A-i :c',-^i^ .*- . A^r: ^ -"tT irA-i"/> " them, will think, that they are drunk, Fakir Ibn Kathir i Z# iher nursling> means, her nursing infant that has not yet been weaned. sK *& J*- % i^S- iand every pregnant one will drop her load,} means, before the pre- gnancy has reached fullterm,becauseofthe intensityofthehorror. i*&. s& iand you shall see mankind as in a drunken state,} means, because of the severity of their situa- tion, when they will lose their minds, so that whoever sees i^jjs 4jH ^r>\ c. > |Jk l} iyet they will not be drunken, but Allah's torment is severe.} \$&&|W^ J Jk \$ aU&* J* Sv> fi-irJ 'kfi 'ij> 0 . And among mankind is he who disputes about Allah, without knowledge, andfallows every rebellious Shaytan.} i4. For him (the devil) it is decreed that whosoeverfallows him, he will mislead him, and will drive him to the torment of the Fire.}

Al-Haii (3-4) (Part-17) Condemnation ofthe Followers ofthe Shaytan Allah condemns those who deny the Resurrection and who deny that Allah is able to restore life to the dead, those who turn away from that which Allah has revealed to His Prophets and, in their views - denial and disbelief - follow every rebellious Shaytan among men and Jinn. This is the state of the followers of innovation and misguidance, who turn away from the truth and follow falsehood, following the words of the leaders of misguidance who call people to follow innovation and their own desires and opinions. Allah says concerning them and their like, iAnd among mankind is he who disputes about Allah, without knowledge,} meaning, without sound knowledge. iandfollows every rebellious Staytan . For him it is decreed.} Mujahid said, This refers to that Shayfan . 1 11 meaning that is a matter written in the decree. i'V ithat whosoeverfollows him,} and imitates him, j) Hjfi Ji-jo fc&} tyie will mislead him, and will drive him to the torment of the Fire.} means, he will mislead him in this world, and in the Hereafter he will drive him to the torment of the Fire, which is unbearably hot, painful and agonizing. As-Suddi reported that Abu Malik said, This Ayah was revealed about An-Nadr bin Al-HarithJ21 This was also the view of Ibn JurayjJ3' ' Al-MuharrarAl-Wajtz 4 : 107 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 6 :8 Af-Tabari 18:566.

U jf yl/ oi 4 b\ L di t* cj Jjj jXj ijPi /-ibtf JJdl2 P ^S y J 4=J^ '{ ^^ * bp 5%4 lit; fJ-"i 4^=4 4*" Jjj } 4 ,ju 4 iii ul jU'j tg4 gp 4^ jj 4i-" iS ">* ^~*k\$ -4Lj !,-" 4> 4* ol> ii> Pyj cf !> jp ./? 45. O mankind! If you are in doubt about the Resurrection, then verily, We have created you from dust, then from a Nutfah, then from a clot then from a little lump offlesh - some formed and some unformed - that We may make (it) clear to you. And We cause whom We will to remain in the wombs for an appointed term, then We bring you out as infants, then (give you growth) that you may reach your age offill strength. And among you there is he who dies (young), and among you there is he who is brought back to the miserable old age, so that he knows nothing after having knoion. And you see the earth Hamidatan, but when We send down water on it, it is stirred (to life), and it swells and puts forth every lovely kind (of growth).} 46. That is because Allah: He is the Truth, and it is He Who gives life to the dead, and it is He Who is able to do all things.} 47. And surely, the Hour is coming, there is no doubt about it; and certainly, Allah will resurrect those wlw are in the graves.} Evidence oftheResurrection inthe creation ofManand ofPlants When Allah speaks of disbelief in the Resurrection, He also mentions the evidence of His power and ability to resurrect that is evident from the way He initiates creation. Allah says: oj. 4^

Al-Hajj (5-7) (Part-17) 40 mankind! Ifyou are in doubt about the Resurrection,} which means the time when souls and bodies will be raised up on the Day of Resurrection, %} 4then verily. We have created youfrom dust,} meaning, you were originally created from dust , which is what Adam, peace be upon him, was created from. 4f&> Ji 4then from a Nutfah,} [32:8] meaning, then He made his offspring from semen of despised water. The Development of the Nutfah and Embryo in the Womb T/-*-* & *- 4then from a clot then from a little lump offlesh} if the Nutfah establishes itself in the woman s womb, it stays like that for forty days, then more material is added to it and it changes into a red clot, by the leave of Allah, and it remains like that for forty days. Then it changes and becomes a lump of flesh, like a piece of meat with no form or shape. Then it starts to take on a form and shape, developing a head, arms, chest, stomach, thighs, legs, feet and all its members. Sometimes a woman miscarries before the fetus is formed and sometimes she miscarries after it has formed. As Allah says: / _ "sy> *? /"i , / > 4tlien from a little lump of flesh - some fanned and some unfonned} meaning, as you see. 4J^p di 2 C jUjP 4that We may make (it) clear to you. And We cause whom We will to remain in the wombs for an appointed tenn,} meaning that sometimes the fetus remains in the womb and is not miscarried.

fj&tf isomeformed and some unformed,} Mujahid said, This means the miscarried fetus, formed or unformed. When forty days have passed of it being a lump of flesh, then Allah sends an angel to it who breathes the soul into it and forms it as Allah wills, handsome or ugly, male or female. He then writes its provision, its allotted length of life and whether it is to be one of the blessed or the wretched. It was recorded in the Two Sahihs that Ibn Mas*ud said, The Messenger of Allah j&, who is the true and truly inspired one, told us: (j liiij jL i , pj Ju, j> jli jj" **jj : s'# vlliiJl vij lil dJw jU iJLji jL iiJxl bjSZ j'" *Every one ofyou is collected in the womb ofhis motherfor the first forty days, and then he becomes a clot for another forty days, and then a lump of flesh for another forty days. Then Allah sends an angel to write four words: He writes his provision, his deeds, his life span, and whether he will be blessed or wretched. Then he blows the soul into him .* *' Man s Development from Infancy to Old Age His saying; mpj ithen We bring you out as infants,} means, weak in his body, hearing, sight, senses, stamina and mind. Then Allah gives him strength, gradually and causes his parents to treat him with tender

kindness night and day. Allah says: \&k& ithen (give you growth) that you may reach your age offull strength.} (i) Path Al-Bari 6:418, MusUm 4 :2036.

Al-Haii (5-7) (Part-17 meaning, his strength increases until he reaches the vitality and handsomeness of youth. 4And among you there is he who dies,} means, when he is young and strong. 4and among you there is he who is brought back to the miserable old age,} meaning advanced old age with its weakness in mind and body, in steady decline in comprehension, and disability to grasp. As Allah says: ifcl jpp =*i} 4so that he knows nothing after having known ~ t 1" J* iuu. isM &} JLP' yo b jiit iAllah is He Who created you in (a state of) weakness, then gave you strength after weakness, then after strength gave (you) weakness and grey hair. He creates what He wills. And it is He Who is the All-Knowing, the All-Powerful .} (30:54) Another Parable ofthe Resurrection from Plants 4;i*~i Ja>} iAnd you see the earth Hdmidatan,} This is another sign of the power of Allah to bring the dead back to life, just as He brings the dead, barren earth back to life, the lifeless earth in which nothing grows. Qatadah said, (This means) the eroded, dusty earth. As-Suddi said, Dead. 4+? fjj 4^=* ui ^A> CifjA ibut when We send down water on it, it is stirred (to life), and it swells and putsforth every lovely kind (ofgrowth) .} When Allah sends the rain upon it, it is stirred to life, that is,

528 Tafstr Ibn Kathir vegetation begins to grow and it comes alive after it was dead. Then it rises after the soil had settled, then it puts forth its different kinds of fruit and crops with all their varied colours, tastes, fragrances, shapes and benefits. Allah says: 4g0 Ji ^ Aand puts forth every lovely kind (ofgrowth).) meaning, beautiful in appearance and with delightful fragrances. 45b AThat is because Allah : He is the Truth,) means, the Creator, the Controller, the One Who does as He wills. & J.&) iand it is He Who gives life to the dead,) means, just as He gives life to the dead earth and brings forth from it all these kinds of vegetation. .Jr\$ 'tl30 lI) AVerily, He Who gives it life, surely is able to give life to the dead. Indeed He is able to do all things.) [41:39] AVerily, His command, when He intends a thing, is only that He says to it, Be!" - and it is!) [36:82]. A^ri vjj '* ielill >) AAnd surely, the Hour is coming, there is no doubt about it;) meaning, it will inevitably come to pass. A/y& 4 10\$ dJj) Aand certainly, Allah will resurrect those who are in the graves.) means, He will bring them back to life after they have become dust; He will create them anew after they have become nothing.

Al-Haii (8-10) (Part-17) tJ) Bdv rrr .ZZ&ZS'SS tij* \$,4] 4iJ 4, alafr^li i-ii'j 3ul;i!yj},>-(j Jii' * ^ -,4^ __,*' i/ s'S * y ss " x)*. s"l . ".*?*> >^ " "4jW" 0p jjj^ iy->-j jjLj JUbI 4jJ^ "sJi" \ > f > > 'V '* .fi < , . - s / Z/" " / Z" *>> "> ' > ^>^r-';-f5 c> '.< "z *- -c J*iu 'Ju'ojz-4-1^ 'cSz*f <. ^ >*^rr.'. >?{>> ' \ V.\ ' \$j^g Sfct-sgffipi < * // ' / />* Z{ / y/ * \ Jli /lili- ,^j) yjL* Ui Vi^y? 1A) r^j" <> sj-' laLiii csji' 1^ < J" ^j| f & j i\ il ii fi f .. r >- i t;vArvujJ3y 4Afit/ he puts forth for Us a parable, and forgets his own creation. He says: Who ivill give life to these bones after they are rotten and have be- come dust?" Say: "He will give life to them Who created them for the first time! And He is the All-Knower of every creation! He Who pro- duces for you fire out of the green tree, when be- hold you kindle there- with.) [36:78-80]. And there are many similar Ayat. 4. ij." ^ -, ^ t jj fiy j*j CS o;IJ' i^ ": , ' ,< .- 7*.. 'u '>' -" if ' ' V ":. "; - IaJ iJj^J * "Jar A" 1 .4) A AiJjj ~ l3 ;W Ai) 4'l'v5^sj J4i J_> 4'jj . And among men is he who disputes about Allah, without knoiuledge or guidance, or a Book giving light (from Allah).) 49. Bending his neck in pride, and leading (others) too (far) astray from the path of Alldlt . For him tltere is disgrace in

this worldly life, and on the Day of Resurrection We shall make him taste the torment of burning.) 410. That is because of what your hands have sent forth, and verily, Allah is not unjust to servants.)

530 Tafslr Ibn Kathir Clarifying the State of the Leaders of the Innovators and Those Who lead People astray Allah has already told us about the ignorant imitators who are led astray: -h 4 cy 0\$m} iAnd among mankind is he who disputes about Allah, without knowledge, and follows every rebellious Shaytan.} And here He tells us about those who call others to misguidance, the leaders of disbelief and innovation: iAnd among men is he who disputes about Allah, without knowledge or guidance, or a Book giving light (from Allah).} meaning, with no correct rational thought, and no clear transmitted text; what they say is based only on their opinions and whims. Allah's saying, iBending his neck in pride,} Ibn 'Abbas and others said, Too proud to follow the truth when he is called to it. 1 ! Mujahid, Qatadah and Malik said, narrating from Zayd bin Aslam: 4*O&e iBending his neck in pride,} means, twisting his neck, i.e., turning away from the truth to which he is called, bending his neck out of pride and arrogance. This is like the Ayat. iAnd in Musa, when We sent him to Fir'aun with a manifest authority. But (Fir'aun) turned away along with his hosts} 151:38-39], UjA.^al Jvji ;J1 cJj Jj-il U d] IjLal fX i p'.oii II] At-Tabari 18:573.

4And when it is said to them: "Come to what Allah has sent down and to the Messenger," you see the hypocrites turn away from you with aversion [4:611, oXju ,v4^ly & ly/en if it is said to them : "Come, so that the Messenger of Allah may ask forgiveness from Allah for you," they twist their heads, and you would see them turning away their faces in pride.) [63:5], And Luqman said to his son: iv&i &L %) 4And turn not your face away from men with pride) [31:18] meaning, do not turn away from them in an arrogant manner. And Allah says: ^ \>\$) 4And when Our verses are recited to him, he turns away in pride) [31:7], j-j?*(d) 4atid leading (others) too (far) astray from the path of Allah.) This either refers to those who are stubborn, or it means that the person who does this has been created like this so that he will be one of those who lead others astray from the path of Allah. Then Allah says: 4For him there is disgrace in this worldly life,) meaning, humiliation and shame, such as when he is too arrogant to heed the signs of Allah, so Allah will send humiliation upon him in this world and will punish him in this world, before he reaches the Hereafter, because this world is all he cares about and all he knows. c~" \li Jjvie f-'ef fj> fj*iA)) iand on the Day of Resurrection We shall make him taste the

torment of burning. That is because of what your hands have sent forth,> means, this will be said to him by way of rebuke. \$J~.fi Jll) ill \$j} iand verily, Allah is not unjust to the servants .} This is like the Ayat: ,ji 4-fj jy f 'tv' ^ tjj^} 1 > A***** / / / j ^ * s } ^ X -4^ U IJCft uj. ^isSStJl 4(7t wi// be said:) "Seize him and drag him into the midst of blazing Fire, Then pour over his head the torment of boiling water. Taste you (this)! Verily, you were (pretending to be) the mighty, the generous! Verily, this is that whereof you used to doubt!" [44:47-50] V \ * ' v **. ' >> ' ' ' -vs-^ *-*}**' jU''' jy- y/> ^ -oi* .Xju jj-U' sJ > ; > r v''*fr i'.&t' , ' { , { - ' t :r >- .t >>.' " , :-> . -:f > r * , r -> * >'.? s , " , >- J*/^ <.v . _yb Ci-U'j fOuu* j Uj fj ~ Jly, 4^ 412 And among mankind is he who worships Allah as it were upon the edge: if good befalls him, he is content therewith; but if a Fitnah strikes him, he turns back on his face. He loses both this world and the Hereafter. That is the evident loss.} ill. He calls besides Allah unto that which can neither harm him nor profit him. That is a straying far away.} il3. He calls unto him whose harm is nearer than his profit; certainly an evil Mawla and certainly an evil Ashir!} The meaning of worshipping

Allah as it were upon the edge Mujahid, Qatadah and others said: upon the edge} means, in doubt.' ' Others said that it meant m At-Tabari 18:576.

Al-Haii (U-13) (Part-17 on the edge, such as on the edge or side of a mountain, i.e., (this person) enters Islam on the edge, and if he finds what he likes he will continue, otherwise he will leave.

4He loses both this world and the Hereafter means, he does not gain anything in this world. As for the Hereafter, he has disbelieved in Allah the Almighty, so he will be utterly doomed and humiliated. So Allah says: itxJSi 101 ji iThat is the evident loss.), i.e., the greatest loss and the losing deal. V L n J V L" Oi 4He calls besides Allah unto that which can neither harm him nor profit him .) means, the idols, rivals, and false gods which he calls upon for help, support and provision - they can neither benefit him nor harm him. iLfii i&t >^ iThat is a strayingfar away.) i t </.1 >>. Vi vi>" ' >" o 4He calls unto him whose harm is nearer than his profit;) means, he is more likely to harm him than benefit him in this world, and in the Hereafter he will most certainly cause him harm. dip" pJ" 4certainly an evil Mawla and certainly an evil Ashir!) Mujahid said, This means the idols. The meaning is: How evil a friend is this one upon whom he calls instead of Allah as a helper and supporter. 4and certainly an evil Ashir!) means the one with whom one mixes and spends one s time. m At-Tabari 18:579.

Al-Haij (14-16) (Part-17) & if 5! J&Sn o;^ ijLS&C #^ if k> ^ V424. Truly, Allah will admit those who believe and do righteous good deeds to Gardens underneath which rivers flow. Verily, Allah does what He wills.} The Reward ofthe Righteous The mention of the misguided who are doomed is followed by mention of the righteous who are blessed. They are those who believe firmly in their hearts and confirm their faith by then- actions, doing all kinds of righteous deeds and avoiding evil actions. Because of this, they will inherit dwellings in the lofty ranks of the gardens of Paradise. So Allah tells us that He sends those astray and guides these, and says: iVerily, Allah does what He wills.} 2 p *# S\^ }A:\$j c& u if & * if% c Y4 M 425. Whoever thinks that Allah will not help him in this world and in the Hereafter, let him stretch out a rope to the ceiling and let him strangle himself. Then let him see whether his plan will remove that whereat he rages!} 426. Thus have We sent it down as clear Ayat, and surely, Allah guides whom He wills.} Allah will definitely help His Messenger^ Ibn Abb^s said, Whoever thinks that Allah will not help Muhammad^ in this world and the Hereafter, let him stretch out a rope 4to the ceiling} to the ceiling in his house.

and let him strangle himself. let him hang himself with it. This was also the view of Mujahid, Ikrimah, Ata , Abu Al- Jawza , Qatadah and others. 12 The meaning is: whoever thinks that Allah will not support Muhammad and His Book and His Religion, let him go and kill himself if it annoys him so much. For Allah will most certainly help and support him. Allah says: clif J \pa iVerily, We will indeed make victorious Our Messengers and those who believe in this world's life and on the Day when the witnesses will standforth.} (40:51]. Allah says here: 4-b^i U j* pi}} iThen let him see whether his plan ivill remove that whereat he rages!} As-Suddi said, Meaning, in the case of Muhammad 3& 13 ' Ata Al-Khurasani said, Let him see whether that will cure the rage he feels in his heart. 477ms have We sent it down the Qur an. 4o J c \l} ias clear Aydt,} clear in its wording and its meaning, evidence from Allah to mankind. 44vji ce iSp \$>} iand surely, Allah guides whom He wills.} He sends astray whomsoever He wills and He guides whomsoever He wills, and He has complete wisdom and definitive proof in doing so.Tabari 18:581.Tabari 18:580-583. 131 Ar-Razi 13:15.

4He cannot be questioned about what He does, while they will be questioned.} [21:23]. Because of His wisdom, mercy, justice, knowledge, dominion and might, no one can overturn His ruling, and He is swift in bringing to account. Att' uu)j [y^ uyJ' o\$ -4ri tJT tk o] 17. Verily, those ivho believe, and those who are Jezvs, and the Sabians, and the Christians, and the Majus, and those who ivorship others besides Allah; truly, Allah will judge between them on the Day of Resurrection. Verily, Allah is over all things a Witness.} Allah will judge between the Sects on the Day of Resurrection Allah tells us about the followers of these various religions, the believers (Muslims) and others such as the Jews and Sabians. We have already seen a definition of them in Surat Al- Baqarah[11 and have noted how people differ over who they are. There are also the Christians, Majus and others who worship others alongside Allah. Allah will 4 -\$ (ji .^? J~"d^ ijudge between them on the Day ofResurrection} with justice; He will admit those who believed in Him to Paradise and will send those who disbelieved in Him to Hell, for He is a Witness over their deeds, and He knows all that they say and all that they do in secret, and conceal in their breast. 3Qr?J vS1* J j jt \$c%^ ^ ^ sM 4%mc&>\$ si m Surat Al-Baqarah 2 :62

Al-Hajj (17-18) (Part-17) prostrate yourselves to Allah Who created them} [41:37]. In the Two Sahths it was recorded that Abu Dharr said, The Messenger of Allah jg said to me, ail jai "Do you know where this sun goes?" I said, Allah and His Messenger know best. He said, of : l*J Jli M - i * - : C^U JL JL> "/ f goes (se/sj and prostrates beneath the Throne, then it awaits the command. Soon it will be told, Go back the way whence you came. ' Ibn Abbas said, A man came and said, O Messenger of Allah, I saw myself in a dream last night, as if I was praying behind a tree. I prostrated, and the tree prostrated when I did, and I heard it saying, O Allah, write down a reward for me for that, and remove a sin from me for that, store it with You for me and accept it from me as You accepted from Your servant Dawud. Ibn Abbas said, The Messenger of Allah jg recited an Ayah mentioning a prostration, then he prostrated, and I heard him saying the same words that the man had told him the tree said. This was recorded by

Al-Hajj (19-22) (Part-17) j^J i)\$j ^ Cut *? /" f> > **, .*/ \$ \$^LJj (-&i ^ %"i rrt &mm %, -" , ;>^;r . ,-. l ilia Ly^ ^iu/y >< x / <>/ j> y s < /iy **'1 ^ lSf*dJjCat^lio')_1? *OJjJ|_J 1"(jUj l Qp >>)1^*jlljt^sa iyjiiIt , v^tat^JIt iulojl_A2^Up -U-pi A^LjSjy_y c ,""T>-f -> "" "> i<"n .\"*- '*fc>* _Pn-^(-4JLj 4JU'o- ^Cr*j< , *Jj 'Ac*c>'-<!'~L> * l/^ " / "^ / / yV A "V/ / " j.>.-"-l^)" >^"*"-)jj^a^Up AiaU^Jtio^Ollo^ > .. - . . ^ ,r ("{->*j s?y oi v-^j oj J) l> A* ^ r ^L # (gijij J L)JL^ I ai *- "a ,.1), ^ ,--.(> 4 -< - -.. >>:' Vj y-*~?' ^ Vt 4'^o^i' v'-w 'AAj 429. These two opponents dispute with each other about their Lord; then as for those who disbelieved, gar- ments offire will be cut out for them, boiling water will be poured down over their heads.} 420. With it will melt (or vanish away) what is within their bellies, as well as (their) skins.} 421. Andfor thetn are hooked rods of iron.} 422. Every time they seek to get away therefrom, from anguish, they will be driven back therein, and (it will be) said to them "Taste the torment ofbunting!"}

The Reason for Revelation

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3706–3726]

It was recorded in the Two Sahihs that Abu Dharr swore that this Ayah - (*jO iThese two opponents dispute with each other about their Lord;} was revealed concerning Hamzah and his two companions, and Utbah and his two companions, on the day of Badr when

they came forward to engage in single combat. This is the wording of

j 1 * > 4(1 > > A AY ";^v ["- :; (Vf-Jv & ^r-^ir iboiling water will be poured down over their heads. With it will melt (or vanish away) what is within their bellies, as well as (their) skins.) meaning, when the boiling water -which is water that has been heated to the ultimate degree- is poured down over their heads. Ibn Jarir recorded from Abu Hurayrah that the Prophet jg| said: " / - >, t .iaCi ,j1p jj ajl5 L15" ilij l I j&J JL O La "77ie boiling water will be poured over their heads and will penetrate their skulls until it reaches what is inside, and what is inside will melt until it reaches their feet. This is the melting, then he will be restored to the state he was before . " 11 It was also recorded by

Al-Haii (23-24) (Part-17) The Reward of the Believers When Allah tells us about the state of the people of Hell - we seek refuge with Allah from that state of punishment, vengeance, burning and chains - and the garments of fire that have been prepared for them, He then tells us about the state of the people of Paradise - we ask Allah by His grace and kindness to admit us therein. He tells us: ,c.'A .-AL } Truly, Allah zoill admit those who believe and do righteous good deeds, to Cardens underneath which rivers flow,} means, these rivers flow throughout its regions, beneath its trees and palaces, and its inhabitants direct them to go wherever they want. 4^+^ . } i wherein they zoill be adorned - with jewelry - Jjllj yli CK iivith bracelets of gold and pearls} means, on their arms, as the Prophet said in the agreed-upon Hadlthlv. -UUJI ^Lj 8 The jezoelry of the believer [in Paradise] will reach as far as his Wudu' reached ."}1! iand their garments therein will be of silk.} in contrast to the garments of fire worn by the inhabitants of Hell, the people of Paradise will have garments of silk, Sundus and Istabracf2 * fine green silk and gold embroidery, as Allah says: *j*-\~* _-i og iT> if ui iTheir garments zoill be of green Sundus, and Istabraq. They ^ FathAl-Bari 10:398, Muslim 1 :219. See the Tafsir of Surat Al-Kahf 19:31, and Surat Al-Insan 76:21-22.

Al-Haii (23-24) (Part-17 But only the saying of, "Peace! Peace! (Salomon! Salomon!) ." } [56:25-26] They will be guided to a place in which they will hear good speech. iTherein they shall be met with greetings and the word of peace and respect.} [25:75], unlike the scorn which will be heaped upon the people of Hell by way of rebuke, when they are told: iTaste the torment of burning! } i+Ji d\b&} iand they are guided to the path of Him Who is Worthy of all praises.} to a place in which they will give praise to their Lord for all His kindness, blessings and favors towards them, as it says in the Sahih Hadith: " US j^JJ" "77iei/ will be inspired with words of glorification and praise, just as they are inspired with breath. n Some scholars of Tafsir said that the Ayah, iAnd they are guided unto goodly speech} refers to the Qur an; and it was said that it means La ilaha illalldh or words of remembrance prescribed in Islam. And the Ayah: 4^- ' dl b^j} iand they are guided to the path of Him Who is Worthy of all praises.} means, the straight path in this world. These interpretations do not contradict that mentioned above. And Allah knows best. m Muslim 4:2180, 2181.

Surah 22 it, although the believers have more right than anyone else to go there. The structure of this phrase is like that to be found in the Ayah: Sii ir*' iTftose who believed, and whose hearts find rest in the remembrance of Allah, verily, in the remembrance of Allah do hearts find rest.> [13 :28] Not only are they believers, but their hearts also find rest in the remembrance of Allah. The Issue of renting Houses in Makkah iwhich We have made (open) to (all) men, the dweller in it and the visitor from the country are equal there meaning that they prevent people from reaching Al-Masjid Al- Haram, which

Allah has made equally accessible to all in Sharfah, with no differentiation between those who live there and those who live far away from it. The dweller in it and the visitor from the country are equal there, Part of this equality is that everyone has equal access to all parts of the city and can live there, as Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn Abbas concerning the Ayah: *the dweller in it and the visitor from the country are equal there*, He [Ibn Abbas] said: Both the people of Makkah and others can stay in Al-Masjid Al-Haram, *' the dweller in it and the visitor from the country are equal there I 1 ' At-Tabari 18:596.*

Mujahid said, The people of Makkah and others are equally allowed to stay there. This was also the view of Abu Salih, Abdur-Rahman bin Sabit and Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam. Abdur-Razzaq narrated from Ma'mar, from Qatadah who said: Its own people and others are equal therein. This is the issue about which Ash-Shafil and Ishaq bin Rahwayh differed in the Masjid of Al-Khayf, when

Al-Haii (25) (Part-17) charge rent in the Haram, and he told me that Umar bin Al- Khattab did not allow people to put gates on the houses of Makkah because the pilgrims used to stay in their courtyards. The first person to put a gate on his house was Suhayl bin Amr. Tjmar bin Al-Khattab sent for him about that and he said, Listen to me, O Commander of the faithful, I am a man who engages in trade and I want to protect my back. He said, Then you may do that. Abdur-Razzaq recorded from Mujahid that Umar bin Al-Khattab said, O people of Makkah, do not put gates on your houses, and let the bedouins stay wherever they want. * He said: Ma'mar told us, narrating from someone who heard Ata say about the Ayah, *the dweller in it and the visitor from the country are equal there,* They may stay wherever they want. Ad-Daraqutni recorded a saying reported from Abdullah bin Amr: Whoever charges rent for the houses of Makkah, consumes fire. Imam Ahmad took a middle path, according to what his son Salih narrated from him, and he said, They may be owned and inherited, but they should not be rented, so as to reconcile between all the proofs. And Allah knows best. AWarningtoThoseWhowant tocommit EvilActions in the Haram and whoever inclines to evil actions therein or to do wrong, him We shall cause to taste from a painful torment.} *for to do wrong,* means, he aims deliberately to do wrong, and it is not the matter of misunderstanding. As Ibn Jurayj said narrating from Ibn Abbas, This means someone whose actions are intentional. *** Ad-DurrAl-Manthur4 :633 * Ad-Daraqutni 2 :300 ' At-Tabari 18:601

--- Tafsir Ibn Kathir Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, The evil action of Shirk. Al- Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said: The evil action is allowing in the Haram what Allah has forbidden, such as mistreating and killing, whereby you do wrong to those who have done you no wrong and you kill those who have not fought you. If a person does this, then he deserves to suffer a painful torment. *for to do wrong,* Mujahid said, To do some bad action therein. This is one of the unique features of Al-Haram, that the person who is about to do some evil action should be punished if this is his intention, even if he has not yet commenced the action. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded in his Tafsir that Abdullah (i.e., Ibn Mas'ud) commented about the Ayah, *and whoever inclines to evil actions therein or to do wrong,* If a man intends to do some evil action therein, Allah will make him taste a painful torment. * This was also recorded by Ahmad. * I say, [its] chain is Sahih according to the conditions of Al-Bukhari, and it is more likely Mawquf than Marfa'. And Allah knows best. Said bin Jubayr said, Insulting a servant and anything more than that is (counted as) wrongdoing. Habib bin Abi Thabit said:

and whoever inclines to evil actions therein or to do wrong,} Hoarding (goods) in Makkah. This was also the view of others. 4JjL jfcSjL 7 and whoever inclines to evil actions therein or to do wrong,} At-Tabari 18:600. At-Tabari 18:600. * At-Tabari 18:601 * Ahmad 1 :428

Al-Haii (26-27) (Part-17) Ibn Abbas said, This was revealed about Abdullah bin Unays. The Messenger of Allah jg sent him with two men, one ofwhom was a Muhajir and the other from among the Ansar. They began to boast about their lineages and Abdullah bin Unays got angry and killed the Ansari. Then he reverted from Islam (became an apostate) and fled to Makkah. Then these words were revealed concerning him: and whoever inclines to evil actions therein or to do wrong,} meaning, whoever flees to Al-Haram to do evil actions, i.e., by leaving Islam. These reports indicate some meanings of the phrase evil actions", but the meaning is more general than that and includes things which are more serious. Hence when the owners of the Elephant planned to destroy the House (the Ka'bah), Allah sent against them birds in flocks, iStriking them with stones of SijjilJ21 And He made them like (an empty field of) stalks (of which the corn has been eaten up by cattle).} [105:4-5], means He destroyed them and made them a lesson and a warning for everyone who intends to commit evil actions there. Hence it was reported in a Hadith that the Messenger of Allah 3S said: ^ j 'H "77iis House zwill be attacked by an army, then when they are in a wide open space, the first of them and the last of them ivill be sivalloved up by the earth ."3 V o' JS &) 4 .'y J* iljf. The report is recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim. Its chain has some deficiency in it ' See volume five, the explanation of Surah Hud (1 1 :82). Al-Bari 4 :397

426. And (remember) when We showed Ibrahim the site of the House (saying): Associate not anything with Me, and sanctify My House for those who circumambidate it, and those who stand up (for prayer), and those who bow and make prostration (in prayer);"} 427. And proclaim to mankind the Hajj (pilgrimage). They will come to you on foot and on every lean camel, they will come from every Fajj 'Amiq.} BuildingoftheKa'bahand the Proclamation ofthe Hajj This is a rebuke to those among Quraysh who worshipped others than Allah and joined partners with Him in the place which from the outset had been established on the basis of Tawhid. and the worship of Allah Alone, with no partner or associate. Allah tells us that He showed Ibrahim the site of the Atiq House, i.e., He guided him to it, entrusted it to him and granted him permission to build it. Many scholars take this as evidence to support their view that Ibrahim was the first one to build the House and that it was not built before his time. It was recorded in the Two Sahihs that Abu Dharr said, I said, O Messenger of Allah, which Masjid was the first to be built? He said, Al-Masjid Al-Haram ." I said, Then which? He said, Bayt Al-MaqdisJ I said, How long between them? He said, n -' , f Forty yearsJ 111 And Allah says: ijiii UjUU yJ. Jjt 4Verily, thefirst House (ofworship) appointedfor mankind was that at Bakkah (Makkah), full of blessing [3:96] until the end of following two Ayat. Allah says: ^ FathAl-Bari 6:469, Muslim 1 :370.

ijr?. J i', 4 We commanded Ibrahim and Ismd'il that they should purify My House for those who are circumambulating it, or staying (I'tikdf), or bowing or prostrating themselves.> [2:125] And Allah says here: . . *> : "\ iAssociate not anything with Me,} meaning, Build it in My Name Alone. i'S iand sanctify My House} Qatadah and Mujahid said, And purify it from Shirk ^=ihj juASti} ifor those who circumambulate it, and those who stand up, and those who bow, and make prostration (in prayer)} means, and make it purely for those who worship Allah Alone, with no partner or associate. What is meant by those who circumambulate it is obvious, since this is an act of worship that is done only at the

Ka'bah and not at any other spot on earth. iand those who stand up} means, in prayer. Allah says: iand those who bow, and make prostration .} Tawaf and prayer are mentioned together because they are not prescribed together anywhere except in relation to the House. Tawaf is done around the Ka'bah and prayer is offered facing its direction in the majority of cases, with a few exceptions, such as when one is uncertain of the direction of the Qiblah, during battle and when praying optional prayers while traveling. And Allah knows best. m At-Tabari 18 :604

iAnd proclaim to mankind the Hajj} meaning, announce the pilgrimage to mankind and call them to perform pilgrimage to this House which We have commanded you to build. It was said that Ibrahim said: O Lord, how can I convey this to people when my voice will not reach them? It was said: Call them and We will convey it. So Ibrahim stood up and said, O mankind! Your Lord has established a House so come on pilgrimage to it. It is said that the mountains lowered themselves so that his voice would reach all the regions of the earth, and those who were still in their mothers wombs and their fathers loins would hear the call. The response came from everyone in the cities, deserts and countryside, and those whom Allah has decreed will make the pilgrimage, until the Day of Resurrection: At Your service, O Allah, at Your service. This is a summary of the narrations from Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayl * and others among the Salaf. And Allah knows best. This was recorded by Ibn Jarir and by Ibn Abi Hatim at length. iThey will come to you on foot and on every lean camel,} This Ayah was used as evidence by those scholars whose view is that Hajj performed on foot by those who are able, is better than Hajj performed riding, because the phrase on foot is mentioned first, and because it is an indication of their keenness and resolve. Waki narrated from Abu Al-TJmays from Abu Halhalah from Muhammad bin Ka*b that Ibn Abbas said, I do not regret anything except for the fact that I wish I had performed Hajj on foot, because Allah says, 2}{iThey will come to you on foot}. But the majority are of the view that performing Hajj while riding is better, following the example of the Messenger of Allah jg, because he performed Hajj riding, although his physical ability was sound. m At-Tabari 18:605, 606, 607. Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :35

Al-Haij (28-29) (Part-17) 4g\$ o-, djii ithey will come from everyFajft means every route, as Allah says: Ijj iand We placed therein Fijdj for them to pass\$> [21:31]. 4^} i'Anriq} means dis- tant. This was the view of Mujahid, Ata , As-Suddi, Qatadah, Muqatil bin Hayan, Ath-Thawri and others. 1 11 This Ayah is like the Ayah in which Allah tells us how Ibrahim prayed for his family, ink rro^ SUJ&S JOxU\j ijC- ^_Ls <^pjd -Si Cp jyjtJlJl ^US^=> . "if '--tT a> (>*j (iJUb *O-i-JV at' 4So fill some hearts among men with love towards them [14:37], There is no one among the Muslims who does not long to see the Ka'bah and perform Tawaf, people come to this spot from every comer of the world. j p-4Xu d* Ti "i' ^ O-itjL jA>^: b . Tlmt they may witness things that are of benefit to them, |il At-Tabari 18:608.

and mention the Name of Allah on appointed days, over the beast of cattle that He has provided for them. Then eat thereof and feed therewith the poor having a hard time.'} i29. Then let them complete their prescribed duties and perform their vows, and circumambulate the Atiq House.} HajjBrings benefits in this World and in the Hereafter iff iThat they may witness things that are of benefit to them,} Ibn Abbas said, Benefits in this world and in the Hereafter. Benefits of the Hereafter includes Allah s pleasure. Material benefits in this world include sacrificial animals and trade. 1 11 This was also the view of Mujahid and others, that the benefits come in this world and in the Hereafter.'21 This is like the

Ayah: iThere is no sin on you if you seek the bounty of your Lord} [2 :198]. iand mention the Name of Allah on appointed days, over the beast of cattle that He has provided for them (for sacrifice).} Shubah and Hushaym narrated from Abu Bishr from Said from Ibn Abbas, The appointed days are the ten days (of Dhul-Hijjah).³ '

i* Jt J-4''' Jt t*' aNo deeds are more virtuous than deeds done on these days ." They said, Not even Jihad for the sake of Allah? He said, gr jt i ' Jcr- "Not even Jihad for the sake of Allah, unless a man goes out risking himself and his wealth for the sake of Allah, and does not come back with anything.[^] Imam

560 Tafsir Ibt Kathir 4over the beast of cattle that He has provided for them means, camels, cattle and sheep, as Allah explained in Surat Al-An'am: 4(fj ieight pairs} [6:143] JjjSlii)fLfIJ Lfi iThen eat thereof and feed tiereioith the poor having a hard time.} It was recorded that when the Messenger of Allah sg offered his sacrifice, he commanded that part of each animal should be taken and cooked, and he ate some of the meat and drank some of the broth. 4\$ \jk=*} iThen eat thereof} Hushaym narrated from Husayn, from Mujahid, This is like the Ayat. 4/>\lamA ^UL. y>\j} 4But when you finish the Ihram, you may hunt} [5:2] 4 ijLZ! iThen when the (Jumu'ah) Saldh (prayer) is ended, you may disperse through the land} [62: 10]. 12 ' This was the view favored by Ibn Jarir in his Tafsir. 4the poor having a hard time.} Ikrimah said, This means the one who is in desperate need whose poverty is apparent, and the poor person who is too proud to ask others for help. '3' Mujahid said, The one who does not stretch forth his hand Ahmad 1 :314. At-Tabari 18:611. At-Tabari 18:612.

Al-Haii (28-29) (Part-17 (to ask for help). iThen let them complete their prescribed duties)> 'Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, This means ending Ihram by shaving one s head, putting on one s ordinary clothes, trimming one s nails and so on. 121 This was also reported from him by Ata and Mujahid. ' This was also the view of Ikrimah and Muhammad bin KaTb Al-Qurazi . iand perform their vows,} Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, this means any vows made about sacrificing a camel . iand circumambulate the 'Atiq House.} Mujahid said, This means the Tawaf which is obligatoiy on the day of Sacrifice. |6, Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Hamzah said, Ibn Abbas said to me: Have you read in Surat Al-Hajjwhere Allah says: iand circumambulate the Atiq House.} The end of rituals is the Tawaf around the Atiq House. t71 I say, this is what the Messenger of Allah m did. When he came back from Mina on

the day of Sacrifice, he began with stoning the Jamrah,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3726–3754]

stoning it with seven pebbles, then he offered his sacrifice and shaved his head, then he departed and circumambulated the House. In the Two Sahths it was recorded that Ibn Abbas said, The people were commanded to end their visit to the Ka'bah by circumambulating the House, but menstruatingTabari 18:612. |2) At-Tabari 18:613. At-Tabari 18:610. At-Tabari 18:610. At-Tabari 18:614. Ad-DurrAl-Manthur4 :643 Ibn Abi Hatim 8 :2490

562 Tafsir Ibn Kathir women are exempt from this. ^ (3^ cv JLthe Atiq House) the area from behind Al-Hijr, [2] because this was originally part of the Ka'bah built by Ibrahim, but the Quraysh excuded it from the House (when they had to rebuild it) because they were short of funds. The Messenger of Allah

included it in his Tawaf and said that it is part of the House. He did not acknowledge the two Shami comers, because they were not built precisely upon the original foundations of Ibrahim. Qatadah narrated that Al-Hasan Al-Basri commented on the Ayah, and circumambulate the Atiq House.) Because it is the first House established for mankind. 13 ' This was also the view of Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam. 14 ' It was recorded that Ikrimah said, It was called Al-Bayt Al- Atiq because it survived (U tiqa) from the flood at the time of Nuh. Khusayf said, It was called Al-Bayt Al- Atiq because it was never conquered by any tyrant. 15' IS kzz #u ik&z & c 430. That and whoever honors the sacred things of Allah, then that is better for him with his Lord. The cattle are lawful to you, except those (that will be) mentioned to you. So shun the Fath Al-B&ri 3 :684 Muslim 2 :963 ' The area near the Ka'bah that is enclosed by a low semi-circular wall. Al-Qurtubi 12:52. ' At-Tabari 18:615. ' There are a few narrations reported from the Salaf saying that the meaning of Atiq is Ancient , and it is commonly translated that way. However, Ibn Kathir's view is the common and most popularly reported view.

Al-Haii (30-31) (Part-17) Rijs of the idols, and shun false speech 431. Hunafd' Lillah, not associating partners unto Him; and whoever assigns partners to Allah, it is as if he had fallen from the sky, and the birds caught him in midair, or the wind had thrown him to a far offplace.) The Reward for avoiding Sin Allah says: This is what We have commanded you to do in the rituals (of Hajj), and this is the great reward that the person who does that will gain. it i' 4^- 0. cfji iwhoever honors the sacred things of Allah, \$ means, whoever avoids disobeying Him and does not transgress that which is sacred, and regards committing sin as a very serious matter, i ?j 4then that is better for him with his Lord.} means, he will attain much good and a great reward for doing that. Just as the one who does acts of obedience will earn a great reward, so too, the one who avoids sin will earn a great reward. Cattle are Lawful i^x u vt Oi\ 4The cattle are lawful to you, except those (that will be) mentioned to you.} means, We have made permissible for you all the An'am (cattle etc.), and Allah has not instituted things like Bahirah or a Sa ibah or a WasUah or a Ham) 40,& c\$} iexcept those mentioned to you.} the prohibition of Al-Maytah} 2] blood, the flesh of swine, and that on which Allah's Name has I 1 * See the Tafsir of Surat Al-Ma idah [5 :3] ^ See the Tafsir of Surat Al-Ma idah [5 :3]

not been mentioned while slaughtering (that which has been slaughtered as a sacrifice for others than Allah, or has been slaughtered for idols) and that which has been killed by strangling, or by a violent blow, or by a headlong fall, or by the goring of horns - and that which has been (partly) eaten by a wild animal - unless you are able to slaughter it (before its death) - and that which is sacrificed (slaughtered) on An- NusubJ This was the view of Ibn Jarir, who recorded it from QatadahJ21 TheCommand to shun Shirkand Lying SjVr s. 4S0 shun the Rijs of the idols, and shun false speech> From this it is clear what Ar-Rijs means, i.e., avoid the abomination, which means idols. Shirk is mentioned in conjunction with false speech, as in the Ayah: y C ijSyu Sl> uili 4\$ay : "(But) the things that my Lord has indeed forbidden are Al-Fawahish (immoral sins) whether committed openly or secretly, sins (of all kinds), unrighteous oppression, joining partners with Allah for which He has given no authority, and saying things about Allah of which you have no knowledge" This includes bearing false witness. In the Two Sahths it was reported from Abu Bakrah that the Messenger of Allah sg said: fst r&l y'U "Shall I not tell you about the worst of major sins?" We said, Yes, O Messenger of Allah. He said: "Associating others with Allah, disobeying one's parents . ^ See the Tafsir of Surat Al-Ma idah [5 :3]Tabari 18:618.

Al-Haii (30-31) (Part-17 He was reclining, then he sat up and said: Ni i jjiJ nand indeed giving false statements, and indeed bearing false witness..." and he kept on repeating it until we wished that he would stop."111 Imam

4the birds caught him in midair, 4or the wind had thrown him to afar offplace. means, remote and desolate, dangerous for anyone who lands there. Hence it says in the Hadith of Al-Bara : J "fi tjUJl Ij-UjjJ Opl iSv" ii'y IjJ jl" illi* t>-p *>-jj JI *U-Ul uWheti the angels of death take the soul of the disbeliever in death, they take his soul up to the heaven, but the gates of heaven are not opened for him; on the contrary, his soul is thrown downfrom there, t Then he recited this Ayah. The Hadith has already been quoted in our explanation of Surah Ibrahim ^ Allah gives another parable of the idolators in Surat Al-An am, where He says: ipiS" ill UiJA -W LliCt jje jji lijaj (jjLLi "if ll jll ^yj IpJl di \$ utf ji Ciil /i Sfc ^Vf 4 c&di i li "i' ^Srti/: S/w// we invoke others besides Allah, that can do us neither good nor can harm us, and shall we turn back on our heels after Allah has guided us? - like one whom the Shayqtn have made to go astray in the land in confusion, his companions calling him to guidance (saying): Come to ms.'" Say: Verily, Allah s guidance is the only guidance."} [6:71] vp di *JyC & p!u "if ff) (\$ >} 4;," pJI cZf jl uU 432. Thus it is, and whosoever honors the Sha'd ir of Allah, then it is trulyfrom the Taqwa of the hearts.} 433. In them are benefits for you for an appointed term, and afterwards they are broughtfar sacrifice to the 'AtJq House.} Ahmad 4:287. See volume five, the Tafsirof Sdrah Ibrahim 14 :27.

Explanation ofthe Udhiyyah and the Sha'a irofAllah iattd whosoever honors the Sha'd'ir of Allah,) means, His commands. / ^** / / ^ " it is trulyfrom the Taqwa of the hearts.) This also includes obeying His commands in the best way when it comes to offering sacrifices, as Al-Hakam said narrating from Miqsam, from Ibn Abbas: Honoring them means choosing fat, healthy animals (for sacrifice). Abu Umamah bin Sahl said: We used to fatten the Udhiyyah in Al-Madinah, and the

568 Takir Ibtt Kathfr jyr^^ gj' Four are not permitted for sacrifice: those that are obviously one-eyed, those that are obviously sick, those that are obviously lante and those that have broken bones, which no one ivould choose ." This was recorded by

rn *> "i Ji "Ride it gently accor- ding to your needs. gati^ / \ v " z ' s i>'< * X" W r* Lfc-jbsj U Aj ^ A.iaL^Oi c.La l >> *- / "> ' '+s **> '> ^v ffS^j^Lxl*^ jqjQ_^AjsS s *' / , / > / . * ' %. s : > . - . -." Jj-j -JU,jus/ U.*.--fJ}^--*^ jaU j,".v. ^LSi' 5\$ J 4jr^ oIJ' 4 UV iand afterwards they are brought for sacrifice to the Atiq House.} meaning, they are eventually brought to the Atiq House - which is the Ka'bah - as Allah says: iif&\ g, ju\$> ian offering, brought to the Ka'bah [5:95] i%4 J uJCLi Csji1\)) iand detained the Hady, from reaching their place ofsacrifice} [48:25] '&r>^ Ji ^jj C Jc ajii i\$jd idU Ll4 f.\ jk=dj} & (Uijl* Sj~j ii' fii lit jfjf Jfj \Jf} ,-iii jJj ijl if", & f ijj \le-j yL4 ff-O L 134. And for every nation We have appointed religious ceremonies, that they may mention the Name of Allah over the beast of cattle that He has given them for food. And your God is One God, so you must submit to Him Alone. And give glad tidings to the Mukhbitin . 135. Whose hearts are filled with fear ivhen Allah is mentioned, and the patient zoho bear whatever may befall them, and who Muslim 2 :961

perform the Salah, and who spend out of what We have providedfor them.} Rites ofSacrifice have been prescribed for every Nation in the World Allah tells us that sacrifice and shedding blood in the Name of

Allah has been prescribed for all nations. Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, 4&K.&j^} iAnd for every nation We have appointed religious ceremonies,} Festivals. Ikrimah said, Sacrifices. 4^ i ; \ iAnd for every nation We have appointed religious ceremonies,} Zayd bin Aslam said, This means Makkah; Allah did not appoint religious ceremonies anywhere else for any nation. 111 ithat they may mention the Name of Allah over the beast of cattle that He has given them for food.} It was recorded in the Two Sahths that Anas said, The Messenger of Allah sg brought two fat, homed rams; he said Bismillah and Allahu Akbar, then he put his foot on their necks. 4jA-* iAnd your God is One God, so you must submit to Him Alone.} Your God is One, even though the Laws of the Prophets may vary and may abrogate one another. All of the Prophets called mankind to worship Allah Alone with no partner or associate. T , 0 YJ '4 Y 2i;' iAnd We did not send any Messenger before you but We * Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :48 * Fath Al-Bari 10:25, Muslim 3 : 1556

Al-Haii (34-35) -U) revealed to him (saying) : None has the right to be zvorshipped but I, so worship Me.\$ [21:25]. Allah says: iso you must submit to Him Alone.> meaning, submit to His commands and obey Him in all sincerity. iAnd give glad tidings to the Mukhbitfn.i Mujahid said about Mukhbitin, Those who find contentment in their faith. m Ath- Thawri said, Those who find contentment in their faith and who accept the decree of Allah and submit to Him. 121 It is better to interpret it by what comes next, which is: iWhose hearts are filled with fear when Allah is mentioned, meaning, their hearts fear Him. ^(*r^ C& dycjJbfr iand the patient who bear whatever may befall them> meaning, of afflictions. ii&i ; iand who perform the Salah,) they fulfill the duties which Allah has enjoined upon them, the duty of performing the obligatory prayers. // /* 'I" I* " y iand zwho spend out ofivhat We have providedfor them .i the good provision which Allah has given them. They spend on their families and servants, and on the poor and needy; they treat people kindly while remaining within the limits set by Allah. This is in contrast to the hypocrites, who are the opposite of all this, as we have discussed in the Tafsir of Surah Bara ah ; to Allah be praise and blessings. At-Tabari 18:628. TafsirAth-Thawri 213. See volume four, in the Tafsir of SdratAt-Tawbah 9 :67

% \$p &A&oiP&Z <\$ \$ 2ftspqp j0 %&j \ j& j& &x /// C~"rJ 436 . And the Budn, We have made them for you as among the symbols ofAllah, wherein you have much good. So mention the Name ofAllah over them when they are drawn up in lines (for sacrifice). Then, when they are down on their sides (after slaughter), eat thereof, and feed the Qdni and the Mu tarr. Thus haveWe made them subject to you that you may be grateful .} TheCommand to slaughter the Budn (SacrificialCamel) Here Allah reminds His servants of the blessing which He has bestowed on His servants, by creating the Budn*** for them and making them one of His symbols. For He has decreed that they should be brought to His Sacred House; indeed, they are the best ofthatwhichmaybe offered as a sacrifice to Allah, as He says: 4#I ^% 531% * Vj# Jgs& 4Violate not the sanctity of the Sha'd'ir of Allah, nor of the Sacred Month, nor of the animals brought for sacrifice, nor the garlanded people or animals, and others, nor the people coming to the Sacred House}[5:2\ iAnd the Budn, We have made them for you as among the symbols ofAllah,} Ibn Jurayj said: Ata commented on this Ayah, Cattle and camels. ' A similar view was also reported from Ibn Umar, Said bin Al-Musayyib and Al-Hasan Al-Basri. * Mujahid said: Al-Budn means camels . According to Muslim, Jabir bin Abdullah and others said, The Messenger of Allah jg commanded us to share in offering the sacrifice, a Budn (camel) for seven people, and one cow for seven people. 111 Its

explanation follows Tabari 18:630. Muslim 2 :882 * Ibn Abi Shaybah the unpublished section 367 * Muslim 2 :882

ixoherein you have much good.} means, reward in the Hereafter. 4So mention the Name of Allah over them when they are drawn up in lines (for sacrifice).} It was reported from Al-Muttalib bin Abdullah bin Hantab that Jabir bin Abdullah said, I prayed with the Messenger of Allah Sg on Id Al-Adha. When he finished, he brought a ram and slaughtered it, saying, "Bismillah, and Allahu Akbar. O Allah, this is on behalf of me and anyone of my Ummah who has not offered a sacrifice . This was recorded by

574 Tafslr Ibn Kathir when the Messenger of Allah jg wanted to offer a sacrifice, he would buy two fat, homed, fine rams. When he had prayed and addressed the people, he would bring one of them to where he was standing in the prayer place, and would sacrifice it himself with a knife, then he would say: ^ - Lf- If- '- "O Allah, this is on behalf of all of my Ummah, whoever bears witness of Tawhid of You and bears witness that I have conveyed." Then he would bring the other ram and sacrifice it himself, and say, Jlj xL^ iJLat "77iis is on behalf of Muhammad and the family of Muhammad." He would give them to the poor and he and his family would eat from it as well. This was recorded by

Al-Haii (36) (Part-17) Ibn Abi Najlh reported that Mujahid said, This means, when it has fallen to the ground. * This was narrated from Ibn Abbas, and a similar view was narrated from Muqatil bin Hayyan. Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, iTlen, when they are down on their sides,} Meaning, when they have died. 121 This is what was meant by the comment of Ibn Abbas and Mujahid, for it is not permitted to eat from the sacrifice when it has been slaughtered until it has died and its movements have ceased. It was reported in a Marfu Hadith : * * * , * ' Do not rush until you are sure that the animal is dead ."13' Ath-Thawri narrated in his Jami that Umar bin Al-Khattab said that, and he supported it with the Hadith of Shaddad bin Aws in Sahih

ieat thereof, and feed Qani' and the Mu'tarr...} This is a command which implies that this is permissible. Al- Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said, Qani is the one who is content with what he is given and he stays in his house, and the Mu'tarr is the one who comes to you and rubs shoulders with you so that you will give him some meat, but he does not ask for it. * This was also the view of Mujahid and Muhammad bin Ka*b Al-Qurazi . [21 Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, Qdm is the one who is too proud to ask, and Mu'tarr is the one who does ask. This was also the view of Qatadah, Ibrahim An-Nakha I and Mujahid, according to one report narrated from him . [41 And the opposite was also suggested. This Ayah has been quoted as evidence by those scholars who said that the sacrifice should be divided into three: a third for the one who offers the sacrifice to eat from, a third to be given as gifts to his friends, and a third to be given in charity to the poor, because Allah says: ieat thereof, and feed the poor who does not ask, and the beggar zwho asks.} But there is no evidence in this Ayah for this view. According to a Sahih Hadith, the Messenger of Allah said to the people: IjJ La 0-5 "/ used to forbid you to keep the meat of the sacrifice for more than three days, but now eat from it and keep it as you see fit.* According to another report: Jabari 18:636. At-Tabari 18 :636 Tabari 18:363, 367. Tabari 18:363, 367. An-Nasal 7 :234

"E(?f keep some and give some in charity ."11 According to another report: 1jj.X-AiJ \ytjb\j "Eat some, feed others, and give some in charity ." As for the animal skins, it was recorded in Musnad

578 Tafstr Ibn Kathir the following three days of Tashriq,]] because of the Hadith of Jubayr bin Mut'im who said that the Messenger of Allah sg said: "77ie days of Tashriq are all (for) sacrifice . " This was recorded by Ahmad and Ibn Hibban,121 iThus have We made them subject to you that you may be grateful.} means, for this reason. < iThus have We made them subject to you} means, We have subjugated them to you, i.e., We have made them submissive towards you, so that ifyou wish you can ride them, or if you wish you can milk them, or if you wish you can slaughter them, as Allah says: iDo they not see that We have created for them of what Our Hands have created, the cattle, so that they are their owners.>[36:71] until He said: iWill they not then be grateful?} [36:73] And Allah says in this Ayah: 4'of& S0} iThus have We made them subject to you that you may be grateful.} ppL :p, KM && % VP \$X j} i37. It is neither their meat nor their blood that reaches Allah, Referring to the process of hanging the meat to dry in the sun. For more details , see volume one , the Tafsir of SaratAl-Baqarah 2 : 203 Ahmad 4:82.

Allah does not look to your appearance or your colors, but He looks to your hearts and deeds. n' 11 And in the Hadith ;

in the hand of the one asking .x ipcpAp} iThus have We made them subject to you} meaning, Tor this purposeWe have subjugated the Budn for you, ipxh C iiT \fjpQ,} ithat you may proclaim Allah's greatness for His guidance to you .} means, that you may glorify Him for guiding you to His religion and His way which He loves and is pleased with, and has forbidden you to do all that He hates and rejects. ic\$- ' iAnd give glad tidings to the doers ofgood.} means, give good news, O Muhammad, to those who do good, i.e., whose deeds are good and who remain within the limits prescribed by Allah, who follow that which has been prescribed for them, who believe in the Messenger jg| and follow that which he has conveyed from his Lord. (Note) The Udhiyyah is SunnahMustahabbahP One animal is sufficient on behalf of all the members of one household. Ibn Umar said, The Messenger of Allah jg continued to offer sacrifice for ten years. This was recorded by

Al-Haii (38) (Part-17) boasting (by sacrificing more than one] and things reached the stage that you see now. This was recorded by

whereby a person does not do what he says, and ingratitude is to deny the blessings, whereby one does not acknowledge or appreciate them. Vi i*P jt ii' 'jlli pt juJJ i o4 < \$p vjiij ii> LJj ijji o Cf JSj> *. "Jj -*? J gj *>-" -c.Si PP 6 op ii' Li . Permission (to fight) is given to those (believers) who are fought against, because they have been wronged; and surely, Allah is able to give them victory . Those who have been expelled from their homes unjustly only because they said: Our Lord is Allah." For had it not been that Allah checks one set of people by means of another, Saiodmi' , Biya , Salawat, and Masjids, ivherein the Name of Allah is mentioned much, would surely have beat pulled down Verily, Allah will help those who help His (cause). Truly, Allah is All-Strong, All-Mighty, Permission to fight; this is the firstAyah ofJihad Al- Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said, This was revealed about Muhammad sg and his Companions, when they were expelled from Makkah. 111 Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak and others among the Salaf, such as Ibn Abbas, TJrwah bin Az-Zubayr, Zayd bin Aslam, Muqatil bin Hayan, Qatadah and others said, This is the first Ayah which was revealed about Jihad. |21 Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn Abbas said, When the Prophet jg was driven out of Makkah, Abu Bakr said, They have their Prophet. Truly, to Allah we belong and truly, to Him we shall return; surely they are doomed. Ibn Abbas said, Then Allah

revealed the words: < -J) . d ^ jij (Pi iPermission (to fight) is given to those (believers) fought against, because they have been wronged; and surely, Allah is At-Tabari 18:643. (21 At-Tabari 18:643, 644, Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6:87.

Al-Haii (39-40) (Part-27) able to give them victory.} Abu Bakr, may Allah be pleased with him, said, Then I knew that there would be fighting. Imam

584 Tafsir Jbn Kathlr ft is*- 4And surely, We shall try you till We test those who strive hard and the patient, and We shall test yourfacts> (47:31). And there are many similar Ayat. Ibn Abbas commented on the Ayah, iand surely, Allah is able to give them (believers) victory And this is what He did. [11 Allah prescribed Jihad at an appropriate time, because when they were in Makkah, the idolators outnumbered them by more than ten to one. Were they to engage in fighting at that time, the results would have been disastrous. When the idolators went to extremes to persecute Muslims, to expel the Prophet jg and resolving to kill him; when they sent his Companions into exile here and there, so that some went to Ethiopia and others went to Al-Madinah; when they settled in Al-Madinah and the Messenger of Allah jg joined them there, and they gathered around him and lent him their support, and they had a place where Islam prevailed, and a stronghold to which they could retreat; then Allah prescribed Jihad against the enemy, and this was the first Ayah to be revealed for it. Allah said: 4>>- <*tiAii (to fight) is given to those fought against, because they have been wronged; and surely, Allah is able to give them victory. Those who have been expelled from their homes unjustly Al-'Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said; They were driven out of Makkah to Al-Madinah unjustly, i.e., Muhammad jg and his Companions. At-Tabari 18:643. At-Tabari 18:643.

Al-Haii (39-40) (Part-17) 4o/i/y because they said: "Our Lord is Allah. } means, they had not done anything to their people or committed any wrongs against them, apart from the fact that they believed in the Oneness of Allah and they worshipped Him Alone, with no partner or associate. But for the idolators, this was the worst of sins, as Allah says: iattd have driven out the Messenger and yourselves because you believe in Allah, your Lord!} (60:1). Then Allah says: iFor had it tiot been that Allah checks one set of people by weans ofanother,} meaning, were it not for the fact that He repels one people by means of another, and restrains the evil of people towards others by means of whatever circumstances He creates and decrees, the earth would have been corrupted and the strong would have destroyed the weak. iy^ iSaioami' surely have been pulled doivn means the small temples used by monks. This was the view of Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Abu Al- Aliyah, Ikrimah, Ad-Dahhak and others.' Qatadah said, This refers to the places of worship of the Sabians; according to another report, he said, The Sawdmi of the Zoroastrians. Muqatil bin Hayyan said, These are houses along the roads." i&} iBiya' .} These are larger than the Sawami and accommodate more worshippers; the Christians also have these. This was the view of Abu Al- Aliyah, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak, Ibn Sakhr, " At-Tabari 18:647, Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :59 , 60, Ar-Razi 3:36.

Muqatil bin Hayyan, Khusayf and others . Ibn Jubayr reported from Mujahid and others that this referred to the synagogues of the Jews which are known to them as Salut. And Allah knows best. iSalawat} Al- Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said, Salawat means churches. 'Ikrimah, Ad-Dahhak and Qatadah said that it referred to the synagogues of the Jews. Abu Al-Aliyah and others said, Salawat refers to the places of worship of the Sabians. Ibn Abi Najlh reported that Mujahid said, Salawat refers

to places of worship of the People of the Book and of the people of Islam along the roads. Masjids belong to the Muslims. 4wherein the Name of Allah is mentioned much,} It was said that the pronoun refers to Masjids, because this is the closest of the words mentioned. Ad-Dahhak said, In all of them the Name of Allah is often mentioned. Ibn Jarir said, The correct view is that the monasteries of the monks, the churches of the Christians, the synagogues of the Jews and the Masjids of the Muslims, in which the Name of Allah is mentioned much, would have been destroyed - because this is the usual usage in Arabic. * Some of the scholars said, This is a sequence listing the smallest to the greatest, because the Masjids are more frequented by more worshippers who have the correct intention and way. u4 a111 iVerily, Allah will help those who help His (cause).} This is like the Ayah : At-Tabari 18:648. At-Tabari 18:649. At-Tabari 18:650. At-Tabari 18:650.

pjl 'jjZ Jfjfy [cJjjJ i' o[! '* Sr jJ' 4 ; a '. 40 you who believe! If you help (in the cause of) Allah, He will help you, and make your foothold firm. But those who disbelieve, for them is destruction, and (Allah) will make their deeds vain.} [47:7-8] iTruly, Allah is All-Strong, All-Mighty .} Allah describes Himself as being All-Strong and All-Mighty. By His strength He created everything and measured it exactly according to its due measurements; by His might nothing can overpower Him or overwhelm Him, rather everything is humbled before Him and is in need of Him. Whoever is supported by the All-Strong, the All-Mighty, is indeed supported and helped, and his enemy will be overpowered. Allah says: ft fa p\ QTdSztffr 4And, verily, Our Word has gone forth of old for Our servants, the Messengers, that they verily, would be made triumphant, and that Our soldiers! They verily, would be the victors .} [37:171-173] iAlldh has decreed: Verily, it is I and My Messengers who shall be the victorious." Verily, Allah is All-Powerful, All- Mighty.) [58:21] # \jg> oypx u^lj sjj&rt itfS0 402 0 441 . Tlwse who, if We give them power in the land, establish the Salah, enforce the Zakah, and they enjoin the good and forbid the evil. And with Allah rests the end of (all) matters .}

Al-Haii (42-46) (Part-17 iAllah has promised those among you who believe and do righteous good deeds, that He will certainly grant them succession to (the pre- sent rulers) in the land} [24 :55], iAnd ivith Allah rests

the end of (all) matters.}

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 3754]

This is like the Ayah: },And the good end is for those who have Taqiva} [28 :83], Zayd bin Aslam said: i""j} }And with Allah rests

the end of (all) matters.}

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3754–3762]

And with Allah will be the reward for what they did. J 13^ rrv s s J. ^ ^^ ^ ^ ^ y-y^ f '.xS'isyd-** sf* .A. 3 y^ -A' ys** Ad'i'. ' ' OA^==.) .XXjijf) y > *4~^rc'2itj f J fiaJ cpaj " i / X;;, X > * x > "V ..' v " \ V' v-x-"b , "r.. i"j) cjjj prS/j :A-> > > > -/ j>-o "*" > . > ' . j~j gy py r"+v C<-^==> oii jJjf J.& "> ol6=" " * ! :t c'. - .j':. > .1 -ir *- > - ->, > 'CmUw ~J* '-d-JA- ijAri . \$ *: ' * - < &v/ i_JU> OyA ob"" j' Ojtjw s-

i^" ujSoi j 4 ^*V Jjiii' 3 142. And if they deny you, so did deny before them the people of Nuh, Ad and Thamiid.} 143. And the people of Ibrahim and the people of Lut,} m Ibn Abi Hatim 8:2498.

444. And the dwellers of Madyan; and denied zvas Musa. But I granted respite to the disbelievers for a while, then I seized them, and how (terrible) was My punishment!) 445. And many a township did We destroy while they were given to wrongdoing, \$0 that it lie in ruins, and a deserted well and castle Mashld!) 446. Have they not traveled through the land, and have they hearts wherewith to understand and ears wherewith to hear? Verily, it is not the eyes that grow blind, but it is the hearts which are in the breasts that grow blind.) The Consequences for the Disbelievers Here Allah consoles His Prophet Muhammad jg for the disbelief of those among his people who opposed him. A, *. >*- iAnd if they deny you, so did deny before them the people of Nith) until His saying, iand denied was Musa.) means, despite all the clear signs and evidence that they brought. iBut I granted respite to the disbelievers for a while,) means, I delayed and postponed. 4then I seized them, and how (terrible) was My punishment!) means, how great was My vengeance against them and My punishment of them! In the Two Sahihis it is reported from Abu Mtisa that the Prophet \$g said: lil pjlku 2)1 j)8 Allah lets the wrongdoer carry on until, when He seizes him. He will never let him go.* Then he recited: J\ Si 53 46%) iSuch is the punishment of your Lord when He seizes the

Al-Haii (42-46) (Part-17 towns while they are doing wrong. Verily, His punishment is painful (and) severe.) [11:102] Then Allah says: iAnd many a township did We destroy} jfi} iwhile they were given wrongdoing,} meaning, they were rejecting their Messengers. iso that it lie in ruins,} Ad-Dahhak said, [Leveled to] their roofs, * i.e., their houses and cities were destroyed. ifLhi f-p} iand (many) a deserted well} means, they draw no water from it, and no one comes to it, after it had been frequented often by crowds of people. iand a castle Mashfd!) Ikrimah said, This means whitened with plaster. * Something similar was narrated from Ali bin Abi Talib, Mujahid, Ata , Said bin Jubayr, Abu Al-Mulayh and Ad-Dahhak. * Others said that it means high and impenetrable fortresses. All of these suggestions are close in meaning and do not contradict one another, for this sturdy construction and great height did not help their occupants or afford them any protection when the punishment of Allah came upon them, as He says: &&p&m &\$} i"Wheresoever you may be, death will overtake you even if you are in Buruj Mttshayyadah! } [4:78] m Fath Al-Bari 8 :205 , Muslim 4 :1997 At-Tabari 18 :653 At-Tabari 18:654, 655. At-Tabari 18 :655, Al-Baghawi 3 :291

4u?jVf i. si 4 iHave they not traveled through the land,} means, have they not traveled in the physical sense and also used their minds to ponder? That is sufficient, as Ibn Abi Ad- Dunya said in his book At-Tafakkur wal-Ttib&r, Some of the wise people said, Give life to your heart with lessons, illuminate it with thought, kill it with asceticism, strengthen it with certain faith, remind it of its mortality, make it aware of the calamities of this world, warn it of the disasters that life may bring, show it how things may suddenly change with the passing of days, tell it the stories of the people of the past, and remind it what happened to those who came before. Walk through their ruins, see what they did and what became of them, meaning, look at the punishments and divine wrath that struck the nations of the past who belied, ^ Zjs spj} iand have they hearts wherewith to understand and ears wherewith to hear?} meaning, let them learn a lesson from that. iVerily, it is not the eyes that grow blind, but it is the hearts which are in the breasts that grow blind.} means, the blind person is not the one whose eyes cannot see, but rather

the one who has no insight. Even if the physical eyes are sound, they still cannot learn the lesson. i k-iiV iICj Xi ly> fJ&j ijibe ^ / " // * . SS " / < V -* . . . And they ask you to hasten on the torment! And Allah fails not His promise. And verily a day with your Lord is as a thousand years of what you reckon.} 448. And many a township did I give respite while it was given to wrongdoing. Then I seized it (ivith punishment) . And to Me is the (final) return (ofall).}

Al-Haij (42-46) (Part-17 The Disbelievers Demand for the Punishment Allah tells His Prophet sg : iAnd they ask you to hasten on the torment!} meaning, these disbelievers who disbelieve in Allah and His Book and His Messenger and the Last Day. This is like the Ayat j"J' j* 'x* '^\Li x ' -Si*V 7" > > " -i ' iAnd (remember) when they said: "O Allah! If this is indeed the truth from You, then rain down stones on us from the sky or bring on us a painful torment."} (8:32] i ff j3 il j u Sk% iThey say: "Our Lord! Hasten to us Qittana (our punishment) before the Day ofReckoning!"} [38:16]. iZj %\ Jig Jj} iAnd Allah fails not His promise.} means, His promise to bring about the Hour and wreak vengeance upon His enemies, and to honor His close friends. (/ *->' X Xv' 's' ' \ ' * - <*JUD tioj J^ ; \aj> iAnd verily a day with your Lord is as a thousand years of what you reckon.} means, He does not hasten, for what is counted as a thousand years with His creation is as one day with Him, and He knows that He is able to exact revenge and that He will not miss a thing, even if He delays and waits and postpones. Hence He then says: i IS' J!j fciil illlli (1 cfX^ J) yf =-j} iAnd many a township did I give respite while it was given to wrotigdomg. Then I seized it (with punishment) . And to Me is the (final) return (ofall).} Ibn Abi Hatim recorded from Abu Hurayrah that the

Al-Haii (49-51) (Part-17 meaning, Allah has sent me to you to warn you ahead of the terrible punishment, but I have nothing to do with your reckoning. Your case rests with Allah: if He wills, He will hasten on the punishment for you; and if He wills, He will delay it for you. If He wills he will accept the repentance of those who repent to Him; and if He wills, He will send astray those who are decreed to be doomed. He is the One Who does whatsoever He wills and wants and chooses. iThere is none to put back His judgement and He is swift at reckoning. [13:41) 4/ am (sent) to you only as a plain Warner. So those who believe and do righteous good deeds,) means, whose hearts believe and whose actions confirm their faith. if-S VS*& ifor them isforgiveness and Rizq Karim.) means, forgiveness for their previous bad deeds, and a great reward in return for a few good deeds. Muhammad bin KaTj Al-Qurazi said, When you hear Allah s saying: lujj) iRizq Karim) this means Paradise. 4u^ iJjfp) iBut those who strive against Our Ayat tofrustrate them,) Mujahid said, To discourage people from following the Prophet . 12] jhjg was ajgQ the view Of Abdullah bin Az-Zubayr, to discourage. Ibn Abbas said, To frustrate them means to Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 6 :63 At-Jabari 18:662. Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :64

596 Tafslr Ibn Kathir resist the believers stubbornly. 4they will be dwellers of the Hellfire.) This refers to the agonizingly hot Fire with its severe punish- ment, may Allah save us from it. Allah says: o* i. ' f "" ^ Oj* Il'-AC- ^ > 4Ji' J-J = " L*J > > ^ / > > ^ OJVi 4Tfwse who disbelieved and hinder (men) from the path of Allah, for them I've will add tor- ment to the torment be- cause they used to spread corruption> [16:88] rr* t&mm oAS[j ^ .. Jg e ajil\ ,X"" ", *i . ^ ?,\S' " ->,' -*.'***** *^'^ -> l*_9|v-fl-3jl3 < > *>: oi> : . c t " 1i!->'i" .If >>>,' ' *> ,3>- *J^Xj^ ; ~ > .ZKjV v_JAc \$ ALJ14JJukc.Lll I ii .lA *' &*j 'H %^ X} J j*, bL-j* C> ^ C J*"3 .lA? i~ "Si* ^^a^4 ^-5 j-AalAl' JiL ii' -^Ab (Ue" (*r_ 4 ^ vv " a ji/& ^yjr 0^] ! ' * | iU1 Si* C | h4" 452. Never did We send a Messenger or a Prophet before you but when he did

recite (the revelation or narrated or spoke), Shaytan threw (some falsehood) in his recitation (of the revelation). But Yansakh Allah that which Shaytan throws in. m Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :64

Al-Haii (52-54) (Part-17) Then Allah establishes His revelations. And Allah is All-Knoioer, All-Wise 453. That He (Allah) may make what is thrown in by Shaytan a trial for those in whose hearts is a disease and whose hearts are hardened. And certainly, the wrongdoers are in an opposition far-off (from the truth).} 454. And that those who have been given knowledge may know that it (this Qur'an) is the truth from your Lord, so that they may believe therein, and their hearts may submit to it with humility. And verily, Allah is the Guide of those who believe, to the straight path.}

How the Shaytanthrowsome Falsehood into theWords

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3762–3763]

ofthe Messengers, and how Allah abolished that At this point many of the scholars of Tafsir mentioned the story of the Gharaniq and how many of those who had migrated to Ethiopia came back when they thought that the idolators of the Quraysh had become Muslims, but these reports all come through Mursat chains of narration and I do not think that any of them may be regarded as Sahih. And Allah knows best. Al-Bukhari said, Ibn Abbas said, 4in his recitation (of the revelation).} When he spoke, the Shaytan threw (some falsehood) into his speech, but Allah abolished that which the Shaytan threw in. 121 4Then Allah establishes His revelations.} Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, iwhen he did recite (the revelation), Shaytan threw (some falsehood) in it} Mursal : A chain of narration that stops before the Companion Al-Bari 8 :292

When he spoke, the Shaytan threw (some falsehood) into his speech. * Mujahid said: iwhen he did recite^ When he spoke. It was said that it refers to his recitation, whereas, ip ibut they trust upon Amani} means they speak but they do not write. Al-Baghawi and the majority of the scholars of Tafsir said: ip ihe did recite} Reciting the Book of Allah. iShaytan threw (somefalsehood) in it} In his recitation. Ad-Dahhak said: ip iwhen he did recite} When he recited. Ibn Jarir said, This comment is more akin to interpretation. i'pp J, % } iBut Yansakh Allah that which Shaytdn throws in.}

The meaning of the word Naskh in Arabic is to remove or lift

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3763–3766]

away. Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, This means, Allah cancels out that which the Shaytdn throws in. At-Tabari 18:667. * At-Tabari 18:667. * See volume one , the Tafsirof SuratAl-Baqarah (2 :78) ' Al-Baghawi 3 :293 At-Tabari 18:668. ' At-Tabari 18 :668 At-Tabari 18:668.

Al-Haii (52-54) (Part-17) 4And Allah is Atl-Knower means, He knows all matters and events that will happen, and nothing whatsoever is hidden from Him. 4All-Wise.\$ means, in His decree, creation and command, He has perfect wisdom and absolute proof, hence He says: 4That He (Allah) may make wliat is thrown in by Shaytan a trial for those in whose hearts is a disease> meaning, doubt, Shirk, disbelief and hypocrisy. Ibn Jurayj said: 4those in whose hearts is a disease The hypocrites, and 4and whose hearts are hardened means the idolators. 4And certainly, the wrongdoers are in an opposition far-off. means, far away in misguidance, resistance and stubbornness, i.e., far from the truth and the correct

way. 4.^, %\ 4And that those who have been given knowledge may know that it is the truth from your Lord, so that they may believe therein means, so that those who have been given beneficial knowledge with which they may differentiate between truth and falsehood, those who believe in Allah and His Messenger, may know that what We have revealed to you is the truth from your Lord, Who has revealed it by His knowledge and under His protection, and He will guard it from being mixed with anything else. Indeed, it is the Wise Book which, m At-Tabari 18:669.

S J) .*iuAji*- ^ Vj ajjJ ^ ^ iFalsehood cannot come to it from before it or behind it, (it is) sent down by the All-Wise, Worthy of all praise (Allah).} [41:42] 4so that they may believe therein,} means, that they may believe that it is true and act upon it. iand their hearts may submit to it with humility.} means, that their hearts may humble themselves and accept it. i>>? off} iAnd verily, Allah is the Guide of tlwse who believe, to tlie straight path.} means, in this world and in the Hereafter. In this world, He guides them to the truth and helps them to follow it and to resist and avoid falsehood; in the Hereafter, He will guide them to the straight path which leads to the degrees of Paradise, and He will save them from the painful torment and the dismal levels of Hell. " * > .. ^ -if .*-y s ac.lui f+*y . i li/j CLty' jj} tj iyi-fj offfcy p 4 jv^=w: Aii - 41 "l* ' s-Of- 455. And those who disbelieved, will not cease to be in doubt about it until the Hour comes suddenly upon them, or there comes to them the torment ofYawm Aqhn.} i56. The sovereignty on that Day will be that ofAllah. He will judge between them. So those 10/10 believed and did righteous good deeds will be in Gardens ofDelight.} 457. And those who disbelieved and denied Our Aydt, for them will be a humiliating torment (in Hell).}

The Disbelievers will remain in Doubt and Confusion Allah tells us that the disbelievers will remain in doubt concerning this Qur an. This was the view of Ibn Jurayj and was the view favored by Ibn Jarir. 111 it* iaS &} iuntil the Hour conies suddenly upon them,} Mujahid said: By surprise. 121 Qatadah said: isuddenly} means, the command of Allah will catch the people unaware. Allah never seizes a people except when they are intoxicated with pride, enjoying a life of luxury, and they think that the punishment will never come upon them, but Allah does not punish anyone except the evildoers. j} ior there comes to them the torment ofYaivm 'Aqim .} Mujahid said, Ubay bin Kah said: Yawm 'Aqim means the day of Badr. Ikrimah and Mujahid said: Yawm Aqim means

the Day of Resurrection, following which there will be no

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3766–3772]

night. 131 This was also the view of Ad-Dahhak and Al-Hasan Al-Basri. * Allah says: -?y. MUJif iThe sovereignty on that Day will be that of Allah. He will judge between them.} This is like the Ayat iThe Only Owner of the Day ofRecompense} [1:4] iThe sovereignty on that Day will be the true (sovereignty), belonging to the Most Gracious (Allah), and it will be a hard Dayfor the disbelievers.} [25:26] At-Tabari 18:670. At-Tabari 11 :360. 131 Al-Baghawi 3 :295. 141 Al-Baghawi 3 :295

Al-Haii (58-60) (Part-17) wronged, Allah will surely help him. Verily, Allah indeed is Oft-Pardoning, Oft-Forgiving The GreatReward forThoseWho migrate in theCause of Allah Allah tells us that those who migrate for the sake of Allah, seeking to earn His pleasure and that which is with Him, leaving behind their homelands, families and friends, leaving their countries for the sake of Allah and His

Messenger to support His religion, then they are killed, i.e., in Jihad, or they die, i.e., they pass away without being involved in fighting, they will have earned an immense reward. As Allah says: 4\$& r 5 Ay-j) Si &f) 4And whosoever leaves his home as an emigrant unto Allah and His Messenger, and death overtakes him, his reward is then surely incumbent upon Allah) {4:100} LjJj% surely, Allah will provide a good provision for them.) means, He will reward them from His bounty and provision Paradise with that which will bring them joy. JSJ# in 4And verily, it is Allah Who indeed is the Best of those who make provision. Truly, He will make them enter an entrance with which they shall be well-pleased.) This means Paradise, as Allah says elsewhere: JL * , j^ K > y * i"/ " ". y iThen, if he be of those brought near (to Allah), rest and provision, and a Garden of Delights .) [56:88-89], Allah tells us that He will grant him rest and provision and a Garden of Delights, as He tells us here: surely, Allah will provide a good provision for them.) Then He says:

iTruly, He will make them enter an entrance with which they shall be well-pleased, and verily, Allah indeed is All-Knowing, meaning, He is All-Knowing about those who migrate and strive in Jihad for His sake and who deserve that (reward). iMost Forbearing, means, He forgives and overlooks their sins, and He accepts as expiation for their sins, their migration (Hijrah) and their putting their trust in Him. Concerning those who are killed for the sake of Allah, whether they are Muhajirs (migrants) or otherwise, they are alive with their Lord and are being provided for, as Allah says: rtfS iThink not of those as dead iwho are killed in the way of Allah. Nay, they are alive, with their Lord, and they have provision [3:169]. There are many Hadiths on this topic, as stated previously. With regard to those who die for the sake of Allah, whether they are emigrants or not. This Ayah and the Sahih Hadiths guarantee that they will be well provided for and that Allah will show them kindness. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Shurahbil bin As-Simt said: We spent a long time besieging a stronghold in the land of the Romans. Salman Al-Farisi, may Allah be pleased with him, passed by me and said, I heard the Messenger of Allah say: in in^j ^ oU j (*~4 jj 4%J5 \$\$\$ } f jjj Hi \$ "Whoever dies guarding the borders of Islam, Allah will give him a reward like that reward (of martyr) and will provide for him and keep him safe from trials. Recite, if you wish: iThose who emigrated in the cause of Allah and after that were killed or died, surely, Allah will provide a good provision for them. And

Al-Haii (58-60) (Part-17) verily, it is Allah Who indeed is the Best of those who make provision. Truly, He will make them enter an entrance with which they shall be well-pleased, and verily, Allah indeed is All-Knowing, Most Forbearing}! 4^ He also recorded that Abdur-Rahman bin Jahdam Al-Khawlani was with Fadalah bin Ubayd when they accompanied with two funerals, at (an island of) sea one of whom had been struck by a catapult, and the other had passed away. Fadalah bin Ubayd sat by the grave of the man who had passed away and someone said to him, Are you neglecting the martyr and not sitting by his grave? He said, I would not mind which of these two graves Allah would resurrect me from, for Allah says: itez liy% i&s } 4 cZjSj} iThose who emigrated in the cause of Allah and after that were killed or died, surely, Allah will provide a good provision for them And he recited these two Ayat, then said, What should I seek, O you servant, if I were to enter an entrance to His pleasure, and be provided good provisions? By Allah, I would not mind which of these two graves Allah would resurrect me from. 121 C& O'J 4That is so. And whoever has retaliated with the like of that which he was made to suffer... Muqatil bin Hayan and Ibn Jurayj mentioned that this was revealed about a skirmish in which the Companions encountered some of the idolators. The Muslims urged them not to fight during

the Sacred Months, but the idolators insisted on fighting and initiated the aggression. So the Muslims fought them and Allah granted them victory. iVerily, Allah indeed is Oft-Pardoning, Oft-Forgiving.} Ibn Abi Hatim 8:2503. At-Tabari 9 :182

607Siirah 22. Al-Haii (61-62) (Part-17) and You make the day to enter into the night, You bring the living out of the dead, and You bring the dead out of the living. And You give wealth and sustenance to whom You will, without limit.} [3:26-27]

The meaning of “merging” the night into the day and the day

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3772–3792]

into the night is that the one encroaches upon the other, and vice versa. Sometimes the night is long and the day is short, as in winter, and sometimes the day is long and the night is short, as in summer. iAnd verily, Allah is All-Hearer, All-Seer.} He hears what His servants say, and He sees them, nothing about them or their movement is hidden from Him whatsoever. When Allah tells us that He is controlling the affairs of all that exists, and that He judges, and there is none to reverse His judgement. He says: / J/N - * /-./v 4iP-' _y> *"" it iThat is because Allah - He is the Truth,} meaning, the true God, besides Whom no one deserves worship. He is the Possessor of the greatest sovereignty; whatever He wills happens and whatever He does not will does not happen. Everything is in need of Him and submits to Him. Ot &\s} iand what they invoke besides Him, it is false.} meaning, the idols and false gods. Everything that is worshipped instead of Him - may He be exalted - is false, because it can neither bring benefit nor cause harm. < &} iAnd verily, Allah - He is the Most High, the Most Great.} This is like the Ayat. iand He is the Most High, the Most Great} [42:4]

ithe Most Great, the Most High} [13:9]. Everything is subject to His might and power; there is no God except Him and no Lord besides Him, because He is the Almighty and there is none mightier than He, the Most High and there is none higher than He, the Most Great and there is none greater than He. Exalted, sanctified, and glorified be He far above all that the evildoers say. cJuLi ^Ai o' dL~*-lJ oj*' Jw o-*w ^ ^ y ZjM jfj ,%lL-"y Jjj lj) iif ill] a*j% V] Jc '> . See i/oh not that Allah sends down water front the sky, and then the earth becomes green? Verily, Allah is the Most Kind and Courteous, Well-Acquainted with all things .} 464. To Him belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is on the earth. And verily, Allah - He is Rich, Worthy of all praise.} 465. See you not that Allah has subjected to you all that is on the earth, and the ships tlrnt sail through the sea by His command? He withholds the heaven from falling on the earth except by His leave. Verily, Allah is for mankind, fill of kindness, Most Merciful.} 466. It is He, Who gave you life, and then will cause you to die, and ivill again give you life. Verily, man is indeed Kafurun.} Signs ofthe Power ofAllah This is a further sign of His might and power; that he sends the winds to drive the clouds which deliver rain to the barren land where nothing grows, land which is dry, dusty and desiccated. izz&Z S3 lf>} ibut when We send down water on it, it is stirred (to life), and it swells} [22:5].

iattd that the earth becomes green?\$ This indicates the sequence of events and how everything follows on according to its nature. This is like the Ayah: \ i^JUL LiUvi iikll liL. iThen We made the Nutfah liJ into a clot , then We made the clot into a little lump offlesh} [23:14]. It was recorded in the Two Sahihs

that between each stage there are forty days.¹²¹ Allah's saying, and then the earth becomes green} means, it becomes green after being dry and lifeless. It was reported from some of the people of Al-Hijaz that the land turns green after rainfall. And Allah knows best. "P iVerihj, Allah is the Most Kind and Courteous, Well- Acquainted with all things.} He knows what seeds are in the various regions of the earth, no matter how small they are. Nothing whatsoever is hidden from Him. Each of those seeds receives its share of water and begins to grow, as Luqman said: j J j j' iA- 4 oi ju-i eju i 0 my son! If it be equal to the weight of a grain of mustard seed, and though it be in a rock, or in the heavens or in the earth, Allah will bring it forth. Verily, Allah is Subtle, Well- Aware.} [31:16] And Allah says: See the explanation of Surat Al-Hajj (22 :4) Fath Al-Bari 6 :350 , Muslim 4 :2036

ships sail gently with their passengers and carry them wherever they want to go for trading and other purposes from one land to another, so that they bring goods from here to there, or vice versa, whatever people want or need. 4He ivithholds the heaven from falling on the earth except by His leave.} If He willed, He could give the sky permission to fall on the earth, and whoever is in it would be killed, but by His kindness, mercy and power, He withholds the heaven from falling on the earth, except by His leave. He says: HtS ccdit -it iVerily, Allah is for mankind, full of kindness, Most Merciful .} meaning, even though they do wrong. As Allah says elsewhere: iBut verily, your Lord is fidl of forgiveness for mankind in spite of their wrongdoing. And verily, your Lord is severe in punishment} [13:6]. ilt is He, Who gave you life, and then will cause you to die, and ivill again give you life. Verily, man is indeed Kafurun.} This is like the Aycit Cl! r -4 r* by! pi :C-"j 4&t> JtlS} 4How can you disbelieve in Allah? Seeing that you were dead and He gave you life. Then He will give you death, then again ivill bring you to life and then unto Him you will return.} [2:28], 4c vt; If jy) dl &A y 'r 'S^rA. 4*Say : Allah gives you life, then causes you to die, then He will assemble you on the Day of Resurrection about which there is no doubt."} [45:26],

Al-Hajj (67-69) (Part-17) invite them to your Lord. Verily, you indeed are on the straight guidance.} 468. And if they argue with you, say: "Allah knows best of what you do."} 469. "Allah will judge between you on the Day of Resurrection about that wherein you used to differ."} Every Nation has its Religious Ceremonies Allah tells us that He has made Mansak for every nation. Ibn Jarir said, This means that there are Mansak for eveiy Prophet s nation. He said, The origin of the word Mansik in Arabic means the place to which a person returns repeatedly, for good or evil purposes. So the Manasik (rites) of Hajj are so called because the people return to them and adhere to them. If the phrase For every nation We have ordained religious ceremonies means that every Prophet s nation has its religious ceremonies as ordained by Allah, then the phrase So let them (the pagans) not dispute with you on the matter refers to the idolators. If the phrase For every nation We have ordained religious ceremonies means that it is the matter of Qadar (divine decree), as in the Ayah, 4For each nation there is a direction to which theyface}[2 :148 Allah says here: iwhich they Ndsikuh meaning, which they must act upon. The pronoun here refers back to those who have these religious ceremonies and ways, i.e., they do this by the will and decree of Allah, so do not let their dispute with you over that divert you from following the truth. Allah says: / ^ > /> /<" < "%> ibut invite them to your Lord. Verily, you indeed are on the straight guidance.} iu At-Tabari 18 :678 , 679 .

tiU'j u'j. 4 o}. 4 l* "il ^ |vuu 4:f 470. K/rozy you no/ that Allah knows all that is in the heaven and on the earth? Verily, it is (all) in the Book. Verily, that is easyfor Allah.} Allah tells us how perfect is His knowledge of His creation, and that He encompasses all that is in the heavens and on earth. Not even the weight of a speck of dust, or less than that or greater escapes His knowledge in the heavens or in the earth. He knows all things even before they happen, and He has written that in His Book, Al-Lawh Al-Mahfuz, as was reported in Sahih Muslim from Abdullah bin Arar, who said, The Messenger of Allah said: j jSl lj y_StL" jjj 4))1 jUJl 4-1^p jLSj ' Allah issued His decrees concerning the measurement and due proportion of the creatures fifty thousand years before He created the heavens and the earth, and His Throne ivas over the waterV In the Sunan, it was reported from a group of the Companions that the Messenger of Allah said: li : Jli ?4J-S\ U j : Jti tjij bpJLdJl)1 t aiiOJl ^ y> Uj jUill SjThe first thing that Allah created was the Pen. He said to it, "Write!" It said, "Wltat should I write?" He said, "Write what will happen," so the Pen wrote everything that ivill happen until the Day ofResurrection Allah says: 4 Verily, it is (all) in the Book. Verily, that is easyfor Allah.} Muslim 4 :2044 ' Abu Dawud 5 :76 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi9 :232

02 (lAjirMl j^S -*< l*j .4. jjij J L rllf 'J *LT\ \fj c jyi.j 4 J^s & (Ui >; -i' Iaj*j jdi> SO'j jj j" "#ju"# far i? l . And they worship besides Allah others for which He has setrt down no authority, and of lohich they have no knowledge; andfor the zorongdoers there is no helper.> 472. And when Our clear Ayat are recited to them, you will notice a denial on the faces of the disbelievers! They are nearly ready to attack with violence those who recite Our Ayat to than . Say : Shall I tell you ofsomething worse than that? The Fire which Allah has promised to those who disbelieved, and zoorst indeed is that destination!"} The Idolators worship ofothersbesidesAllahand Their vehement rejection ofthe AyatofAllah Allah tells us that the idolators, in their ignorance and disbelief, worship besides Allah others which He has sent down no authority for, i.e., no proof or evidence for such behavior. This is like the Ayah: **-> -* H* ** ^ V cyj? 4And zvhoever calls upon, besides Allah, any other god, of whom he has no proof; then his reckoning is only with his Lord. Surely, the disbelievers will not be successful.} [23:117] So Allah says here: 4ps *< kill. .* j> J 4for which He has sent down no authority, and of which they have no knozvledge;} meaning, they have no knowledge in the subject that they fabricate lies about; it is only something which was handed down to them from their fathers and ancestors, with no evidence or proof, and its origins lie in that which the Shaytan beautified for them and made attractive to them. Allah warned them:

Al-Hajj (71-72) (Part-17 iandfor the wrongdoers there is no helper.} meaning, no one to help them against Allah when He sends His punishment and torment upon them. Then Allah says: iAnd when Our clear Ayat are recited to them,} means, when the Ayat of the Qur an and clear evidence and proof for Tawhld of Allah are mentioned to them, and they are told that there is no god besides Allah and that the Messengers spoke the truth, &&& iThey are nearly ready to attack with violence those who recite Our Ayat to them.} then they nearly attack and do harm to those who bring proof to them from the Qur an, and cause them harm using their tongues and hands. iSay} O Muhammad to these people, i\fjj ' jGlt iShall I tell you of something worse than that? The Fire which Allah has promised to those who disbelieved,} The fire and wrath and torment of Allah are far worse than that with which you are trying to scare the believing close friends of Allah in this world. The punishment in the Hereafter for these deeds of yours is worse than that what you claim you want to do to the believers. 4-W 1 J iand worst

indeed is that destination!} how terrible is the Fire as a final destination and abode! iEvil indeed it is as an abode and as a place to rest in.} [25:66]

J& 9>\ uj # Si j ^ JLUJi i\$ > 44M&^U ^ IS oU \$1 l^Uf JJ fc 4\S jtj3j "i* oj 3"- ' Ltjddj & 'vr'/.f U.lij 473. O mankind! A parable has been made, so listen to it: Verily, those on whom you call besides Allah, cannot create a fly, even though they combine together for the purpose. And if the fly snatches away a thing from them, they will have no power to release it from the fly. So weak are the seeker and the sought.} 474. They have not regarded Allah with His rightful esteem. Verily, Allah is All-Strong, All-Mighty.} The insignificance of the Idols and the foolishness of their Worshipers Here Allah points out the insignificance of the idols and the foolishness of those who worship them. 43*; j.u i\$ > 40 mankind! A parable has been made,} meaning, a parable of that which is worshipped by those who are ignorant of Allah and who join others as partners with Him. (41 4so listen to it) pay attention and understand. J A\ 4Verily, those on whom you call besides Allah, cannot create a fly, even though they combine together for the purpose.} Even if all the idols and false gods whom you worship were to come together to create a single fly, they would not be able to do that. Imam

My creation!"* This was also recorded by the authors of the Two Sahihs via Umarah from Abu Zur'ah from Abu Hurayrah, who said that

the Prophet said: ^ jliy 4-*^ Cr-i iAllah says: Who does more wrong than one who tries to create (something) like My creation? Let them create an ant, let them create a grain of barley Then Allah says: 4And if the fly snatches away a thing from them, they will have no power to release it from the fly .} They are unable to create a single fly and, moreover, they are unable to resist it or take revenge against it if it were to take anything from the good and perfumed thing on which it lands. If they wanted to recover that, they would not be able to, even though the fly is the weakest and most insignificant of Allah's creatures. Allah says: 4So weak are the seeker and the sought.} Ibn Abbas said, The seeker is the idol and the sought is the fly. '31 This was the view favored by Ibn Jarir, and it is what is apparent from the context. As-Suddi and others said, The seeker is the worshipper, and the sought is the idol. 41 Then Allah says: 4They have not regarded Allah with His rightful esteem .} meaning, they have not recognized the might and power of Allah when they worship alongside Him those who cannot Ahmad 2:391. Fath Al-Bari 13:537, Muslim 3 :1671 At-Jabari 18:685. Al-Baghawi 3 :298 , from Ad-Dahhak

Al-Haii (75-76) (Part-17) 475. Allah chooses Messengers from angels and from men. Verily, Allah is All-Hearer, All-Seer.> 476. He blows what is before them, and what is behind them. And to Allah return all matters.4 Allah chooses Messengers from the Angels and Messengers from Mankind Allah tells us that He chooses Messengers from His angels as He wills by His law and decree, and He chooses Messengers from mankind to convey His Message. 4^^ iVerily, Allah is All-Hearer, All-Seer. means, He hears all that His servants say, and He sees them and knows who among them is deserving of that, as He says: 4a3^ Allah blows best with whom to place His Message [6:124] 4He blows what is before them, and what is behind them. And to Allah return all matters.> He knows what will happen to His Messengers and the Message He sent them with, for none of their affairs are hidden from Him. He says: 4'1 fijlj jS- The All-Knower of the Chayb (Unseen), and He reveals to none His Ghayb."^[72:26] until His saying; iand He keeps count of all things.} [72:28] So He, may He be glorified, is guarding them,

and is Witness to what is said about them. He is protecting them and supporting them. a 'Mj xiS a J oii
oj 4 z

40 Messenger! Proclaim which has been sent down to you from your Lord. And if you do not, then you have not conveyed His Message. Allah will protect you from mankind [5:67]. A3 IjLksaf \yS\, I'g'jr'.Aa o; uy!' ^ Cj ji- jJif ^ -*r4-i 3 '3* tj j l j; 3ii _y" auL iy'-j JJAil' u-llif jc '.Cyi |yj3j 4 xa , 4 jUj 477 . O 1/OK who believe! Boiv down, and prostrate yourselves, and worship your Lord and do good that you may be successful. 478. And strive hard in Allah s cause as you ought to strive. He has chosen you, and has not laid upon you in religion any hardship: it is the religion of your father Ibrahim. He has named you Muslims both before and in this (Qur'an), that the Messenger may be a ivitness over you and you be witnesses over mankind! So, perform the Saldh, give the Zakah and hold fast to Allah. He is your Mawla, what an Excellent Mawla and zwhat an Excellent Helper/> TheCommand to worship Allah and engage in Jihad It was reported from TJqbah bin Amir that the Prophet jg said: C-Lai aSurat Al-Hajj has been blessed with two Sajdahs, so whoever does twt prostrate them should not read them ."[li j*-\$ 4 4And strive hard in Allah s cause as you ought to strive. means, with your wealth and your tongues and your bodies. This is like the Ayah: I 1 * Al-Hakim 1 :221. The addition, so whoever does not prostrate at them should not read them is considered unauthentic. The source for the Hadith was mentioned and noted earlier. See Ayah no. 18.

4Have Taqwa of Allah as is His due.} [3:102] 4He has chosen you,} means, O Ummah [of Islam), Allah has selected you and chosen you over all other nations, and has favored you and blessed you and honored you with the noblest of Messengers and the noblest of Laws. 4g/*- Si J-**- iand has not laid upon you in religion any hardship} He has not given you more than you can bear and He has not obliged you to do anything that will cause you difficulty except that He has created for you a way out. So the Salah, which is the most important pillar of Islam after the two testimonies of faith, is obligatory, four Rak'ahs when one is settled, which are shortened to two Rak'ah when one is traveling. According to some Imams, only one Rak'ahs is obligatory at times of fear, as was recorded in the HadithJ ' A person may pray while walking or riding, facing the Qiblah or otherwise. When praying optional prayers while traveling, one may face the Qiblah or not. A person is not obliged to stand during the prayer if he is sick; the sick person may pray sitting down, and if he is not able to do that then he may pray lying on his side. And there are other exemptions and dispensations which may apply to the obligatory prayers and other duties. So the Prophet said: / have been sent with the easy HanTfi 121 way . And he said to Mu adh and Abu Musa, when he sent them as governors to Yemen: IjiL* Yj Abu Dawud 2:38. Meaning monothiest. See volume four, the Tafsir of Surat Al-A raf (7 :30) Ahmad 5 :266

Give good news and do not repel them. Make things easy for the people and do not make the things difficult for them . "m And there are many similar Hadiths. Ibn Abbas said concerning the Ayah, i; 4 Cj} iand has not laid upon you in religion any hardship}, This means difficulty. ' tit is the religion of your father Ibrahim .} Ibn Jarir said, This refers back to the Ayah, igs- bt 4 iand has not laid upon you in religion any hardship meaning, any difficulty. On the contrary, He has made it easy for you, like the religion of your father Ibrahim. He said, It may be that it means: adhere to the religion of your father Ibrahim. 131 I say: This interpretation of the Ayah is like the Ayah: Ci !>" JI n iSay: Trtdy, my Lord has guided me to a straight path , a right religion, the religion of Ibrahim, a Hanif } [6:161] ef) (5? Cr, iHe

has named you Muslims both before and in this (Qur'an),} Imam Abdullah bin Al-Mubarak said, narrating from Ibn Jurayj, from Ata , from Ibn Abbas: concerning Allah s saying, 4& " iHe has named you Muslims before Al-Bari 7 :657 At-Tabari 18:689. At-Tabari 18:691. 141 See earlier note

Al-Haii (77-78) (Part-17) This refers to Allah, may He be glorified. ' ' This was also the view of Mujahid, Ata , Ad-Dahhak, As-Suddi, Muqatil bin Hayyan and Qatadah.'2 ' Mujahid said, Allah named you

626 Tafsir Ibtisami Kathir SUP Lfj l I ijfi-ju I^Pili k^U*?j jjj jv-*^ " Yes, eoen i//ie /asfs and performs Salah. So adopt the call of Allah whereby He called you Muslims and believers and servants of Allah. "(1 i'JS js ;T & 1I4 46itff the Messenger may be a ivitness over you and you be witnesses over mankind!} means, thus We have made you a just and fair nation, the best of nations, and all other nations will testify to your justice. On the Day of Resurrection you will be, io0&&& 4witnesses over mankind}, because on that Day all the nations will acknowledge its leadership and its precedence over all others. Therefore, on the Day of Resurrection the testimony of the members of this community will be accepted as proof that the Messengers conveyed the Message of their Lord to them, and the Messenger will testify that he conveyed the Message to .them. IjCj ;j&i &ji} 4So perform tire Salah, give Zakah} means, respond to this great blessing with gratitude by fulfilling your duties towards Allah, doing that which He has enjoined upon you and avoiding that which He had forbidden. Among the most important duties are establishing regular prayer and giving Zakah. Zakah is a form of beneficence towards Allah s creatures, whereby He has enjoined upon the rich to give a little of their wealth to the poor each year, to help the weak and needy. We have already mentioned its explanation in the Ayah of Zakah in Syrat At-Tawbah (9:5). IjwCcl')} 4and hold fast to Allah.} means, seek the help and support of I 1 ' An-Nasal in Al-Kubrd no . 1:8866.

Al-Haii (77-78) (Part-17)) Allah and put your trust in Him, and get strength from Hiih. iHe is your Maiula,} meaning, He is your Protector and your Helper, He is the One Who will cause you to prevail against your enemies. iwhat an Excellent Mawla and zohat an Excellent Helper!} He is the best Mawla and the best Helper against your enemies.

Module 24

Surah 23: Al-Muminun

Surah 23: Al-Muminun

PDF pages 3793–3886

Which was Revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3793–3798]

P *- rtt % J50&W Pcjpj0ojjldl^Ld2Jjli iil! iQuijPcP 45^i3is#fi^liitj;c3 iSK0ji^f^ /n the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. "y* 'tp^AP'^ (U bpj ; !&*-" (*r^-" j> > ^ .1^^ s* > > :u r* #!> ^ ^ ijfc 'fy ^ c c i^ <-*T "i V ^ *>?"< &*) V** > (*ri "jJji)Jlj liil'j "pj * "'*' /Ip ' .If' "*"J+ v <%>!> ."'.'S' -If' -- ' > ' frp~ Cr js cyJ'j , jjc-ii Jtfj PpJPk oyj-t -& S.ojjfr 4>' t* r 41 . Successful indeed are the believers.) 42. Those who with their Salah are Khashi'un.) 43. And those who him away from Al-Laghw.) 44. And those who pay the Zakah.) 45. And those who guard their private parts.)

629Stirah 23. Al-Mu'minun (1-11) (Part-18) i6. Except from their wives or their right hand possessions, for then, they are free from blame.} 47. But whoever seeks beyond that, then those are the transgressors.} 48. Those who are faithfully true to their Amdnat and to their covenants are Rd'tin .} 49. And those who strictly guard their Salawdt.} 410. These are indeed the heirs.} 411. Wlw shall inherit Firdaws. They shall dwell therein forever.} The Success is for the believers whose qualities are described here ?& 4Successful indeed are the believers} means, they have attained victory and are blessed, for they have succeeded. These are the believers who have the following characteristics: 4Those who with their Salah are Khashi'un.} Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said: 4Khashi'tin means those with fear and with tranquillity. This was also narrated from Mujahid, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and Az-Zuhri. * It was reported from Ali bin Abi Talib, may Allah be pleased with him, that Khushu' means the Khushu' of the heart. 3 * This was also the view of Ibrahim An-Nakha i. * Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, Their Khushu was in their hearts. So they lowered their gaze and were humble towards others. Khushu' in prayer is only attained by the one who has emptied his heart totally, who does not pay attention to anything else At-Tabari 19:9. 2| At-Tabari 19:8, 9. ' At-Tabari 19:9. * At-Tabari 19 :9

Al-Mu'minun (1-11) (Part-18) the soul from Shirk and filth, as in the Ayah v O' k- i O' jJ? ilndeed he succeeds who purifies himself (Zakkdhd). And indeed he fails who corrupts himself.} [91:9-10] It could be that both meanings are intended, purification of the soul and of one s wealth, because that is part of the purification of the soul, and the true believer is one who pays attention to both matters. And Allah knows best. O* jf- j' ipOj* if- J V'Ojki-* - 4 . j/jU' ^ ditj 0^ iAnd those who guard their private parts. Except from their wives and their right hand possessions, for then, they are free from blame. But whoever seeks beyond that, then those are the transgressors.} means, those who protect their private parts from unlawful actions and do not do that which Allah has forbidden; fornication and homosexuality, and do not approach anyone except the wives whom Allah has made permissible for them or their right hand possessions from the captives. One who seeks what Allah has made permissible for him is not to be blamed and there is no sin on him. Allah says: ik) ji. ithey are free from blame. But

whoever seeks beyond that meaning, other than a wife or slave girl, then those are the transgressors.} meaning, aggressors. A.oy-'j iThose who are faithfully true to their Amdndt and to their covenants} When they are entrusted with something, they do not betray that trust, but they fulfill it, and when they make a promise or make a pledge, they are true to their word. This is not like the hypocrites about whom the Messenger of Allah jg said:

liij < 1 jJ-j lilj n^iJS lij : jilLJl Z~\: "The signs of the hypocrite are three: when he speaks he lies, when he makes a promise he breaks it, and when he is entrusted with something he betrays that trust. a /> . s // >"

Silrah 23. Al-Mu'minun (1-11) (Part-18) 633 JL0}> iThese are indeed the heirs. Wlw shall inherit Firdaios. They shall dwell therein forever.} It was recorded in the Two Sahihs that the Messenger of Allah gj said: "C-BJ t I * s ll 1 " ' *- * ? * " .j-y 5-wvn aIfyou ask Allah for Paradise, then ask him for Al-Firdaws, for it is the highest part of Paradise, in the middle of Paradise, and from it spring the rivers of Paradise, and above it is the (Mighty) Throne of the Most Merciful .# |I) Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Hurayrah said, The Messenger of Allah said: ^ . - j # - " * t oU jli vjOl Jyjj 3'j~* -o')! i .oy/f jU JIJii <! jii jtlll jiji There is not one among you who does not have two homes, a home in Paradise and a home in Hell. If he dies and enters Hell, the people of Paradise will inherit his home, and this is

what Allah said: iThese are indeed the heirs.

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3798–3824]

Ibn Jurayj narrated from Layth from Mujahid: iThese are indeed the heirs.} The believers will inherit the homes of the disbelievers because they were created to worship Allah Alone with no partner or associate. So when these believers did what was enjoined on them of worship, and the disbelievers neglected to do that which they were commanded to do and for which they had been created, the believers gained the share that they would have been given if they had obeyed their Lord. Indeed, they will be given more than that as well. This is what was reported in Sahth Muslim from Abu Burdah, from his father, Al-Bari 13:415. Ibn Majah 2:1453.

from the Prophet jg who said: ill iJlOjJl Jlili _'yX Or?4 iri Some of the Muslims will come on the Day of Resurrection with sins like mountains, but Allah will forgive them and put (their burden of sin) on the /eras and Christians According to another version: the Messenger of Allah jg said: lii : Jlij iiii^ j\ 4^ jkl j>\ aoi oil liu *When the Day of Resurrection comes, Allah zvill appoint for every Muslim a Jeio or Christian, and it will be said, "This is your ransom from the Fire."o Umar bin Abd Al- AzIz asked Abu Burdah to swear by Allah besides Whom there is no other God, three times, that his father told him that from the Prophet jg, and he swore that oath.12 ' I say: this Ayah is like Allah s saying: 4 Ar , & lijL* l/i Cjjj iSuch is the Paradise which We shall give as an inheritance to those ofOur servants who have had Tacpoa> [19:63] Uj liyliyl Qfx iUJ ait}} 4This is the Paradise which you have been made to inherit because ofyour deeds which you used to do. [43:72] ^ jdi " Cj* L .VU- Jljy 3 Hi dig UiiF t^KS uu uuS 122 Sil&i A > t|:oyp'MM i3i ? 3# 453 & & 412. And indeed We created man out ofan extract of Tin. 413. Thereafter We made him a Nutfah in a safe lodging. ^ Muslim 4 :2120 2| Muslim 4:2119.

414. Then We made the Nut/ah into a clot, then We made the dot into a little lump offlesh, then We made out of that little lump offlesh bones, then We clothed the bones with flesh, and then We brought it forth as another creation. So Blessed is Allah, the Best of creators.} 415. After that, surely you will die.} 416. Then (again), surely you will be resurrected on the Day of Resurrection .} The Sign of Allah in the progressive creation of Man from Clay then from Nutfah and thereafter Allah tells us how He initially created man from an extract of Tin. This was Adam, peace be upon him, whom Allah created from sounding clay of altered black smooth mud. Ibn Jarir said, Adam was called Tin because he was created from it. ^ Qatadah said, Adam was created from 7Tn. 121 This is the more apparent meaning and is closer to the context, for Adam, upon him be peace, was created from a sticky Tin, which is a sounding clay of altered black smooth mud, and that is created from dust, as Allah says: ,- Til JJ y Crt (3 4And among His signs is this that He created you (Adam) from dust, and then - behold you are human beings scattered!) [30:20] Imam

4then We made out of that little lump offlesh bones, meaning, *We gave it shape, with a head, two arms and two legs, with its bones, nerves and veins. \jy&} 4then We clothed the bones with flesh,} meaning, *We gave it something to cover it and strengthen it. 4%\: &&% iand then We brought it forth as another creation .} means, then We breathed the soul into it, and it moved and became a new creature, one that could hear, see, understand and move. 3a i\j3} 4So Blessed is Allah, the Best of creators.} iand then We brought it forth as another creation.} Al- Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said, We change it from one stage to another until it emerges as an infant, then it grows up through the stages of being a child, adolescent, youth, mature man, old man and senile man. Imam

breathes the soul into it, and four things are decreed: his provision, his life-span, his deeds, and whether he will be wretched or blessed. By the One besides Whoin there is no other god, one of you may do the deeds of the people of Paradise until there is no more than a forearm's length betxoeen him and it, then the decree will overtake him ajtd he will do the deeds of the people of Hell and thus enter Hell. And a man may do the deeds of the people of Hell until there is no more than a forearm s length between him and it, then the decree will overtake him and he will do finally the deeds of the people of Paradise and thus enter Paradise.^ (1 This was recorded by Al-Bukhari and Muslim.121 iSo Blessed is Allah, the Best of creators.} means, when Allah mentions His ability and subtlety in creating this Nutfah and taking it from stage to stage until it takes the shape of a perfectly formed human being, He says, 4UO \$ &&} 4So Blessed is Allah, the Best of creators.} iAfter that, surely you will die.} means, after first being created from nothing, you will eventually die. A% iThen (again), surely you will be resurrected on the Day of Resurrection.} means, you will be created anew. stiUtf iif Z} iand then Allah will bring forth the creation of the Hereafter} (29:20] means, the Day of Return, when the souls will be restored to their bodies and all of creation will be brought to account. Everyone will be rewarded or punished according to his deeds [1 > Ahmad 1 :382. At-Bari 6 :4 18 , Muslim 4 :2036

639Siirah 23. Al-Mn'minun (17) (Part-18) - if they are good then he will be rewarded, and if they are bad then he will be punished. \$3 Cj 1 imZ& i17 . And indeed We have created above you seven Tara'iq, and We are never unaware of the creation .} His Sign in the creation of the Heavens After mentioning the creation of man, Allah then mentions the creation of the seven heavens. Allah often mentions the creation of the heavens and earth alongside the creation of man, as He says elsewhere: yU- vc -sf== "

Jfjii j iThe creation of die heavens and the earth is indeed greater than the creation of mankind} [40:57]. A similar Ayah appears at the beginning of Surat As-Sajdah, which the Messenger of Allah jg used to recite on Friday mornings. At the beginning it mentions the creation of the heavens and earth, then it says how man was created from semen from clay, and it also discusses the resurrection and rewards and punishments, and other matters. iseven Tara'iq.} Mujahid said, This means the seven heavens. 1 11 This is like the Ayat iThe seven heavens and the earth and all that is therein, glorify Him}[17:44] iSee you not hoto Allah has created the seven heavens one above another?} [71:15] Or/y ofe j&h VV ySi" jt-cSjj' i:f;& id a si% *js> Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 6 :94 .

640 Tafsir Ibtî Kathir 411 is Allah Who has created seven heavens and of tlte earth the like thereof. His command descends between them (heavens and earth), that you may know that Allah has power over all things, and that Allah surrounds all things in (His) bmvledge} [65:12] Similarly, Allah says here: tf Qil ft c; 4And indeed We have created above you seven Tara'iq, and We are never unaware of the creation.} meaning, Allah knows what goes into the earth and what comes out of it, what comes down from heaven and what goes up into it. He is with you wherever you are, and Allah sees what you do. No heaven is hidden from Him by another and no earth is hidden from Him by another. There is no mountain but He knows its features, and no sea but He knows what is in its depths. He knows the numbers ofwhat is in the mountains, the hills, the sands, the seas, the landscapes and the trees. .u nr mmI , ?. - " > ", uLialiQ*}(iju *rr;v \xj\ yo/ - I:. .jU 4 1,7?^ cffi oiUt 4 "- Vj Cri !***- > Cj} 4And not a leaffalls, but He kttows it. There is not a grain in the darkness of the earth nor anything fresh or dry, but is written in a Clear Record.} [6:59]

bliili w'ojjXiii _jl'i j* bjj ufy^' j-ii 5 jy> bt tr^-J * ojl; l; l ti1j i&gj Jrif oi i4 tLj 4 ojyj vjO^Si ^jy o- &j3C oxj "Ul- 4:%Z\$^ <^> j*j i^cj ^ IjjiT j3j 428. And We sent dozen from the sky water in measure, and We gave it lodging in the earth, and verily, We are able to take it azvay 429. Then We brought forth for you therewith gardens of date palms and grapes, wherein is much fruit for you, and ivhereof you eat.} 420. And a tree that springs forth from Tur Sinai, tlrt grows oil, and relish for the eaters .} 422. And verily, in the cattle there is indeed a lesson for you. We give you to drink of that zohich is in their bellies . And there are, in them, numerous benefitsfor you, and of them you eat.} 422. And on them, and on ships you are carried.} Allah's Signs and Blessings in the Rain, Vegetation, Trees and Cattle Allah mentions His innumerable blessings to His servants, whereby He sends down rain in due measure, meaning, according to what is needed, not so much that it damages the lands and buildings, and not so little to be insufficient for crops and fruits, but whatever is needed for irrigation, drinking and other benefits. If there is a land that needs a lot of water for its irrigation but its fertile soil would be carried away if rain fell on it, then Allah sends water to it from another land, as in the case of Egypt, which is said to be a barren land. Allah sends the water of the Nile to it, which brings red soil from Ethiopia when it rains there. The water brings the red soil which is used to irrigate the land of Egypt, and whatever of it is deposited is used for agriculture, because the land of Egypt is infertile, and most of it is sand. Glory be to the Subtle One, the All-Knowing, the Most Merciful, the Forgiving. 4 < j&}

}and We gave it lodging in the earth,} means, when the water comes down from the clouds, We cause it to settle in the earth, and We cause the earth to absorb it and the seeds etc. in the earth to be nourished by it. -ii & ^\)} iand verily, We are able to take it away.} means, if We wanted to cause it not to rain, We

could do so; if We wanted to divert it towards the wilderness and wastelands, We could do so; if We wanted to make it salty so that you could not benefit from it for drinking or irrigation, We could do so; if We wanted to cause it not to be absorbed by the earth, but to remain on the surface, We could do so; if We wanted to make it go deep underground where you would not be able to reach it and you could not benefit from it, We could do so. But by His grace and mercy, He causes sweet, fresh water to fall on you from the clouds, then it settles in the earth and forms springs and rivers, and you use it to irrigate your crops and fruits, and you drink it and give it to your livestock and cattle, and you bathe and purify yourselves with it. To Him is due the praise and thanks. Then We brought forth for you there until gardens of date palms and grapes,} means, from that which We send down from the sky, We bring forth for you gardens and orchards which look beautiful. ^{Jr^y oi} 4 of date palms and grapes,} These were the kinds of gardens that were known to the people of the Hijaz, but there is no difference between a thing and its counterpart. The people of each region have fruits which are the blessing of Allah given to them, and for which they cannot properly thank Allah enough. ^{<g 41%} } iioherein is much fruit for you,} means, of all fruits. As Allah says elsewhere:

foP' jL* g)' * > ja LZ 4 With it [the rain] He causes to grow for you the crops, the olives, the date palms, the grapes, and even/ kind of fruit > [16 : 11], iand whereof you eat.} This implies that you look at its beauty, wait for it to ripen, then eat from it. 4 And a tree that springs forth from Tur Sinai,} means the olive tree. Tur means a mountain. Some of the scholars said, It is called Tur if there are trees on it, and if it is bare it is called Jabal, not Tur. And Allah knows best. Mount Sinai is the same as Tur Sinin, and it is the mountain on which Allah spoke to Musa bin Imran, peace be upon him, and in the surrounding mountains there are olive trees. i that groins oil,} Some scholars think it [linguistically] means that it brings forth oil. Others say it [linguistically] means comes forth with oil. Allah said, iand relish} meaning a condiment, according to Qatadah J' ifor the eaters.} means, it contains a beneficial oil and condiment. Abd bin Humayd recorded in his Musnad and Tafsir from Umar that the Messenger of Allah said: \ * " rtf (olive) oil as a condiment and apply it as oil, for it comes from a blessed tree . IM Ad-Durr Al-Manthur 6 :95 .

It was recorded by At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Majah. 1 1 Allah s saying; < & 4 iL; ju3 fei 4p10 jfy < & i Attd verily, in the cattle there is indeed a lesson for you. We give you to drink of that which is in their bellies. And there are, in them, numerous benefits for you, and of them you eat. And on them and on ships you are carried K Here Allah mentions the benefits He has given to His servants in cattle, for they drink their milk which comes out from between dung and blood, they eat their meat and clothe themselves with their wool and hair, they ride on their backs and carry heavy burdens on them to far away lands, as Allah says: . jjuVi "-: "v " till p&duS j^ i t i And they carry your loads to a land that you could not reach except with great trouble to yourselves. Truly, your Lord is full of kindness, Most Merciful (16:7) 4 Do they not see that We have created for them of what Our Hands have created, the cattle, so that they are their owners. And We have subdued them unto them so that some of them they have for riding and some they eat. And in them there are benefits for them, and drink. Will they not then be grateful [36:71-73] y? nyy JtP t* fy & > . Jh" -Au* j], C-y diSjl aS% ol ij. iK C U& SEP '4 35\$ OiC c -4 j# Al-Muntakhab by Abd bin Humayd 13, At-Tirmidhi 1815, Ibn MSjah 3319.

4 ? 423. And indeed We sent Nidi to his people, and he said: "O my people! Worship Allah! You have no other God but Him. Will you not then have Taqwa?" } 424. But the chiefs of his people who disbelieved said: "He is no more than a human being like you, he seeks to make himself superior to you. Had Allah willed, He surely could have salt down angels. Never did we hear such a thing among our fathers ofold." \$ 425. "He is only a man in whom is madness, so waitfor him a while." 4 The Story ofNuh, Peace be upon Him; and his people Allah tells us about Nuh, peace be upon him, whom He sent him to his people to warn them of the severe punishment of Allah and His severe vengeance on those who associated partners with Him, defied His commands and disbelieved His Messengers: IS 4and he said: "O my people! Worship Allah! You have no other God but Him. Will you not then have Taqwa? } Meaning, Do you not fear Allah when you associate others in worship with Him? The chiefs or leaders of his people said: 4 ^=& Jin; j ^S C} 4He is no more than a human being like you, he seeks to make himselfsuperior to you.} meaning, he is putting himself above you and trying to make himself great by claiming to be a Prophet, but he is a human being like you, so how can he receive revelation when you do not? 4c&p j/f %}

iHad Allah willed, He surely could have sent doivn angels. meaning, if Allah had wanted to send a Prophet, He would have sent an angel from Him, not a human being. We have never heard of such a thing - i.e., sending a man to our forefathers - their predecessors in times past. 4He is only a man in whom is tnadness,} means, he is crazy in his claim that Allah has sent him and chosen him from among you to receive revelation. iso waitfor him a while.} means, Wait until he dies, put up with him until you are rid of him. o4 XI juK jwjJ J^=> 'ti LU jtjj VjJ \$ w \$ && Sii a^ x;^\$ Jr dj KjC* Xa*^ yj J"j iS^ jii ^ijf 426. He said: "O my Lord! Help me because they deny me. } 427. So, We revealed to him: "Construct the ship under Our Eyes and under Our revelation. T1\en, what Our command comes, and (water) gushes forthfrom the oven, take on board of each kind tzvo, and your family, except those thereof against whom the Word has already gone forth. And address Me not in favor of those who have done wrong. Verily, they are to be drowned. } 428. "And when you have embarked on the ship, you and whoever is with you, then say : All the praise be to Allah, Wlw has saved usfrom the people zoho are wrongdoers." } 429. "And say: 'My Lord! Cause me to land at a blessed landing place, for You are the Best of those who bring to land.' } 430. Verily, in this, there are indeed Ayat, for sure We are ever putting (men) to the test.}

Al-Mu'minun (26-30) (Part-18) Allah tells us that Nuh, peace be upon him, invoked his Lord to help him against his people, as Allah mentions in another Ayah: 4Then he invoked his Lord (saying) : "I have been overcome, so help (me)!" } [54:10]. Here he says: \$dyjj==> C, Cjj} 40 my Lord! Help me because they deny me.} At that point, Allah commanded him to build a boat and to make it strong and firm, and to carry therein of every kind two, i.e., a male and a female of every species of animals, plants and fruits etc. He was also to carry his family, 4\$' iy iexcept those thereof against whom the Word has already gone forth.} meaning, those whom Allah had already decreed were to be destroyed. These were the members of his family who did not believe in him, such as his son and his wife. And Allah knows best. 4 / " (*f[ij ug'ki 4And address Me not in favor of those ivho have done wrong Verily, they are to be droivned.} means, when you witness the heavy rain falling, do not let yourself be overcome with compassion and pity for your people, or hope for more time for them so that they may believe, for I have decreed that they will be drowned and will die in their state of disbelief and wrongdoing. The

story has already been told in detail in Surah Hud, and there is no need to repeat it here. 4 02 115 ik Jii kjlii!" iu! vJ iSJyLl ty} 4And when you have embarked on the ship, you and whoever is with you, then say: All the praise be to Allah, Who has saved m See volume five , the Tafsir of Surah Hud (1 1 :25)

648 Tafsir Ibn Kathir us from the people who are wrongdoers."} This is like the Ayah: IjJ ilju v ^ # ii4=. cj ill u rfjff c^jl ijzj -jgj iand has appointed for you ships and cattle on which you ride In order that you may mount on their backs, and then may remember the favor of your Lord what you mount thereon, and say : "Glory to Him Who has subjected this to us, and we could never have it (by our efforts). And verily, to Our Lord we indeed are to return!" [43:12-14] So, certainly, Nuh adhered to what he was commanded, as Allah says elsewhere: " 4="jt 36j} iAnd he said: "Embark therein: in the Name of Allah will be its (moving) course and its (resting) anchorage..."[1 1:41] So Nuh mentioned Allah at the beginning of his journey and at the end, and Allah said: 4:f : % 4> } yj jt> 4And say: My Lord! Cause me to land at a blessed landing place, for You are the Best of those who bring to land."} ;i 4 L{ } 4 Verily in this, there are indeed Aydt,} means in this event, which is the saving of the believers and the destruction of the disbelievers there are signs, i.e., clear evidence and proof that the Prophets speak the truth in the Message they bring from Allah, may He be exalted, and that Allah does what He wills, and He is able to do all things and knows all things. ifor sure We are ever putting (men) to the test.} means, We try Our servants by means of sending the Messengers.

Al-Mu'minim (31-41) (Part-18) rtt mm1B4 V> bliiV) jdlIJ jul\$)_A*J' ^V ^ //^/ >"" //^V ik "s^ti ** -' *? &psa, (ij2%(kisirf\$ \$d\$ /> / ' t" u^J , rr,o^J T*..C^~ 'ij j i^ & tSi 0 %\ *. - ".** ' >/ i < ,// - .-v' 0 , -^s jj-A - _y U J 'c ft uij gft & . ^ j>, ft > 4 ^ c; // / / // // ' '*< '-' l*j L\$/i' Jfy " / 'J/ ". -./ ?> **Z s^ J i c7A.sJJ3iH^*> ^ i-*i- - . > U-t Jb Uj 'djjA]0Ac 0> -;> -r, , .:,c", '-f^ *- * .? Jla 0_ UjJyvoi' 'i? 4*:*" oi G\L' (4^ x4j (4^- Ei"jS -g.- 4j". aJJ _ j ll ilii 1' ^ i^i StJ' Jlij ,TT ,Cjy j ^Ai' "> *^"y JI/^' ^ "A .uL i^iSj ! i/"j cyN alii jgaj 4 ^jfc iL j^t jdk > u c . '-riAU 'oft Then, after them, We created another generation> 432 . We se/if to f/iw a Messenger from among themselves (saying) : "Worship Allah! You have no other God but Him. Will you not then have Taqiva?"} 433 . And the chiefs of his people who disbelieved and denied the meeting in the Hereafter, and whom We had given the luxuries and comforts of worldly life, said: "He is no more than a human being like you, he eats of that which you eat, and drinks of what you drink."> 434. If you were to obey a human being like yourselves, then verily, you indeed would be losers >

meaning, very unlikely. 4He is only a man who has invented a lie against Allah,} meaning, in the Message he has brought to you, and his warnings and promise of resurrection. r' o iand ive are not going to believe in him. He said "O my Lord! Help me because they deny me."} meaning, the Messenger prayed against his people and asked his Lord to help him against them. His Lord answered his prayer: 4 fJi iLc Jli^ i(Alldh) said: "In a little while, they are sure to be regretful."} meaning, for their opposition towards you and their stubborn rejection of the Message you brought to them. 4So, The Sayhah overtook them in truth,} meaning, they deserved that from Allah because of their disbelief and wrongdoing. The apparent meaning is that the Sayhah was combined with the furious cold wind, tjir 4Destroying everything by the command of its Lord! So they became such that nothing could be seen except their dwellings!} [46:25] iand We made them as rubbish of dead plants.} means, they are dead

and destroyed, like the scum and rubbish left by a flood, i.e., something insignificant and useless that is of no benefit to anyone. iSo, aivay with the people who are wrongdoers.} As Allah s statement:

<%}* & WSj&&6> 4We wronged them not, but they were the wrongdoers [43:76] means, who are wrongdoers because of their disbelief and stubborn opposition to the Messenger of Allah, so let those who hear this beware of disbelieving in their Messengers. ly l+U-1 ;J C ls^ liLii'^ v uXiLa ^ \$:j*f tdA-53 c#& Oij 442. 77ien, after them, We created other generations .} 443. No nation can advance their term, nor can they delay it.} 444. Then We sent Our Messengers in succession. Every time there came to a nation their Messenger, they denied him; so, We made them follow one another, and We made them as Ahadith. So, away with a people who believe not!} Mention ofOther Nations Allah says: u fc*& iThen, after them, We created other generations.} meaning, nations and peoples. 4No nation can advance their term, nor can they delay it.} means, they are taken at the appropriate time, as decreed by Allah in His Book that is preserved with Him, before they were created, nation after nation, century after century, generation after generation, successors after predecessors. 4% QLj G\$ y} iThen We sent Our Messengers in succession.} Ibn Abbas said, (This means) following one another in succession. ' This is like the Ayah [i] At-Tabari 19:34.

4Jii ,4Li ^ Vjiy iil J-^= 4 t-jl 4 iliLidl jJc oil > : < { l*+y *"" iAnd verily, We have sent among every Ummah a Messenger (proclaiming): "Worship Allah, and avoid Taghiit (all false deities)." Then of them were some whom Allah guided and of them were some upon whom the straying was justified (16:36). 4%T dfi3% u iEvery time there came to a nation their Messenger, they denied him;} meaning the greater majority of them. This is like the Ayah: 4 / .*of.y^ . j .a, VI Ij L jLoJI (Jc 4A/as /or mankind! There never came a Messenger to them but they used to mock at him.} [36:30] iso We made them follow one another,} means, We destroyed them, as Allah says: iAnd how many generations have We destroyed after Nuh!} [17:17] }and We made them as Ahadith} meaning, stories and lessons for mankind, as Allah says elsewhere: iso, We made them as tales (in the land), and We dispersed them all totally} [34:19]. ^r*. Cj U l^ij Vj)Ui // . Cj \y6j 445. Then We sent Musa and his brother Harun, with Our

654 TafsTr IbtI Katltir Aydt and manifest authority, 446. To Fir'awn and his chiefs, but they behaved insoletitly and they were people self-exalting (by disobeying their Lord).} 447. They said: Shall we believe in two men like ourselves, and their people are obedient to us zoith humility!"} 448. So, they denied them both and became of those who were destroyed.} 449. And indeed We gave Musa the Scripture, that they may be guided.} The Story ofMusa, Peace be upon Him; and Fir'awn Allah tells us that He sent Musa, peace be upon him, and his brother Harun to Fir'awn and his chiefs with decisive evidence and definitive proof, but Fir'awn and his people were too arrogant to follow them and obey their commands because they were human beings, just as previous nations had denied the Message of the human Messengers. They were of a similar mentality, so Allah destroyed Fir'awn and his chiefs, drowning them all in one day. He revealed the Book to Musa, i.e., the Tawrah, in which were rulings, commands and prohibitions, after He had destroyed Fir'awn and the Egyptians and seized them with a punishment of the All-Mighty, All-Capable to carry out what He wills. After Allah revealed the Tawrah, Allah did not destroy any nation with an overwhelming calamity; instead, He commanded the believers to fight the disbelievers, as He says: iJXJtj i s 4And indeed We gave Musa - after We had destroyed the

generations of old - the Scripture as an enlightenment for mankind, and a guidance and a mercy, that they might remember.} [28:43] j\? v'-> JJ*J +-A+ J-O'j u*' And We made the son of Maryam and his mother as a sign, and We gave them refuge on a Rabwah, Dhat Qadr, and Ma'Tn.}

Al-Mu'minun (50) (Part-18) Isa and Maryam Allah tells us about His servant and Messenger Isa bin Maryam, peace be upon them both, and that He made them as a sign for mankind, i.e., definitive proof of His ability to do what He wills. For He created Adam without a father or a mother. He created Hawwa from a male without a female, and He created Isa from a female without a male, but He created the rest of mankind from both male and female. yir* V 1-1 }ji> J, ^ iand We gave them refuge on high ground, a place of rest, security and flowing streams.} Ad-Dahhak reported that Ibn Abbas said: Ar-Rabwah is a raised portion of land, which is the best place for vegetation to grow. ' This was also the view of Mujahid, Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr and Qatadah.¹² ' Ibn Abbas said, iDhdt Qadr} A fertile place. iand Ma'fn} means water running on the surface. ¹³¹ This was also the view of Mujahid, Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr and Qatadah.¹⁴ ' Mujahid said: A level hill. ¹⁵ ' Said bin Jubayr said that JLA iDhdt Qadr and Ma'in} means that water was flowing gently through it. Mujahid and Qatadah said: iand Ma'in } Running water. ¹⁶ ¹¹¹ Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 6:100. Tabari 5:536, 537. Tabari 19:38. At-Tabari 19:39. At-Tabari 19:38. At-Tabari 19:39.

Ibn Abi Hatim recorded from Satd bin Al-Musayyib: JJ* fj jt ^ iand We gave them refuge on a Rabwah, Dhat Qadr and Ma'in .} It is Damascus. ¹ ¹¹ He said; Something similar was also narrated from Abdullah bin Salam, Al-Hasan, Zayd bin Aslam and Khalid bin Ma'dan. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded from Ikrimah from Ibn Abbas that this Ayah referred to the rivers of Damascus. Layth bin Abi Sulaym narrated from Mujahid that the words; iand We gave them refuge on a Rabwah,} referred to Isa bin Maryam and his mother when they sought refuge in Damascus and the flatlands around it.' Abdur-Razzaq recorded that Abu Hurayrah said: ion a Rabwah, Dhat Qadr and Ma'in.}, It is Ramlah in Palestine. The most correct opinion on this matter is that which was reported by Al- Awfi from Ibn Abbas, who said; \y**?0 JJ* v'i dl &}*>^ iand We gave them refuge on a Rabwah, Dhat Qadr and Ma'in.} "Ma'in refers to running water, and is the river of which Allah mentioned: iyour Lord has provided a ivater stream under you.> [19:24] Ad-Dahhak and Qatadah said; ion a high ground, a place of rest, security and flowing streams.} Tabari 19:37. Al-Qurtubi 12:126. '3| Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 6 : 100

lr^ h TiO jL4ii^S iliju ;cijs' aUJjs^istr* -' ^t^o^^-x"~*< *jO ^e^O jli^IL0xA& diL !\$!: lj' cj)Jif-y^jLd - liij " ,"? r-"" r.r-'w'^i' *'A"" .: r^JyV 4-2* i4_*ij*>*<>. p^=tyti'j3-U.^ ij|p^JeqjLju 'A'7 *-"" r -**?- (^- U^Vri^J* Lr j(vrf'.^V,'i>"Ja43i i"-?^ > ^'. i frTh .: " > " 1 !^ { S "*" / " /t /vf-* */ i /> 'VSVL '*'J 1 l*A < v7.' *> ,<? ^ ^ ' >> > ci|V*^L-" cA^jJ taj ju> ^/VT^* / -*" ^ ,/ /.<' refers to Jerusalem. This -and Allah knows best - is the most apparent meaning, because it is mentioned in the other Ayah, and parts of the Qur'an explain other parts, so it is more appropriate to interpret it by another Ayah, then the Sahih. Hadiths, then other reports. v~W' oi \$ J-y" oJH ti, 41 \ptj 3 m 2;j olj : }~ ,_*} , p=Ly U'j tj^ y ifi frif. J\$ \j zi > .: ' ^ ' /f ,y 3T-, p-f%JU W ^ A^ t , - -* ^y " ^ .- JvCfir Ci*" > /* J // V ,CA^J ^ "A Ljl v i 4 If 4^ ^i 451 . O Messengers! Eat of the Tayyibat and do righteous deeds. Verily, I am Well-Acquainted with what you do. 452. And verily, this your religion is one religion, and I am your Lord, so have Taqwa."} 453. But they have broken their religion among them into sects, each group rejoicing in what is with it.

454. So, leave them in their error for a time.} 455. Do they think that in wealth and children with which We prolong them} 456. We hasten unto them with good things. Nay, but they perceive not.}

There is no Prophet who was not a shepherd.

Al-Mu'minim (51-56) (Part-18) commanded the Messengers by saying >& ll, ji \piij cSp S- % gfi 40 Messengers! Eat of the Tayyibdt and do righteous deeds. Verily, 1 am Well-Acquainted with what you do. [23:51] and 40 you who believe! Eat of the Tayyibdt that We have provided you with}[2:172]j Then he mentioned how a man may travel on a long journey, dusty and unkempt, j! (Sr^S (S'>*- ij U ^ U : wnd his food, drink and clothing are unlawful, and he has nourished himself with what is utilazofid, and he extends his hands towards the sky, saying, 'O Lord, O Lord!' - how can his prayer be answered .''II! At-Tirmidhi said that it is Hasan Gharib." The Religion of all the Prophets is Tawhid; and the

Warning against splitting into different Groups

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3824-3846]

4And verily, this your religion is one religion, means, your religion, O Prophets, is one religion and one group, which is the call to worship Allah Alone with no partner or associate. Allah said: u ; 4and I am your Lord, so have Taqwa.4 We have already discussed this in Surat Al-Anbiya .W The phrase 4one nation^ is descriptive. Muslim 1 :703 , Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8 :335, Ahmad 2 :328 ^ See volume six, the Tafsir of Surat Al-Anbiya" (2 1 :92).

iBut they have broken their religion among them into sects,} the nations to whom Prophets were sent. ieach group rejoicing in what is with it.} means, they rejoice in their misguidance because they think that they are rightly-guided. Allah says, threatening and warning: %^} <\$So, leave them in their error meaning their misguidance, ifor a time.} means, until the appointed time of their destruction comes. This is like the Ayah: & of&} 4So give a respite to the disbelievers; deal gently with them for a while.} [86:17] And Allah saysa.yo Jp ^s>} iLeave them to eat and enjoy, and let them be preoccupied with (false) hope. They will come to bwv!} [15:3] / -.' 'w. >*" * / E 'Vj> . /. > // > /' if >/< i 4Do they think that in wealth and children with which We prolong them, We hasten unto them with good things. Nay, but they perceive not.} means, do these deceived people think that what We give them of wealth and children is because they are honored and precious in Our sight? No, the matter is not as they claim when they say, iWe are more in wealth and in children, and we are not going to be punished.} [34:35]

But this thinking is wrong, and their hopes will be dashed. We only give those things to them in order to make them go further (in sin) and to give them more time. Allah says: itiZ v ibut they perceive not.} as He says elsewhere: ii jl 4 i3 Cl %\$\$ iSo, let not their wealth nor their children amaze you; in reality Allah's plan is to punish them with these things in the life of this world...} [9:55] 'fd C\} \$We postpone the punishment only so that they may increase in sinfulness} [3:178]. ip>\$ v iz j; j-j iThen leave Me Alone with such as belie this Qur'an . We shall punish them gradually from directions they perceive not. And 1 will grant them a respite.} [68:44-45] iLeave Me Alone (to deal) with whom I created lonely.} until His saying: VjS} iopposing^ [74:11-16] JJIJ C vi \$5 fiie JiM% i.And it is not your wealth, nor your children that bring you nearer to Us, but only he who believes, and does righteous deeds...} [34:37] And there are many other Ayat which say similar things. Imam

662 Tafstr Ibn Kathir IJ>- jfffi Vj 'Jj aAs jj-Lj Xp j^LIj ^ ;X; OjUj" "A//fl/! /ws distributed your behavior to you just as He has distributed your provision . Allah gives the things of this world to those whom He loves aid those whom He does not love, but He only gives religious commitment to those whom He loves. Whoever is given religious commitment by Allah is loved by Him. By the One in Whose Hand is my soul, no servant truly submits until his heart and his tongue submit, and he does not truly believe until his neighbor is safe from his harm ." They said, What is his harm, O Messenger of Allah? He said, J IJcJ O JXJ ('jy y> "JU Xt 'Jj N Jill jj tjllll jj! ojlj jLS Y tfpa aS'x 40 jJj *J Jxi ^ jj h His wrongdoing and misbehavior. No person ivho earns unlawful wealth and spends it will be blessed in that; if he gives it in charity, it will not be accepted from him and if he leaves it behind (when he dies), it will be his provision in the Fire. Allah does not wash away an evil deed with another, but he washes away evil deeds with good deeds, for impurity cannot wash away with another impurityJ} j*rj > ' * >- " ti ' >> *.' ; Ci- ' i:* '.If' S- s' 's\\ m / (*rJ j) |*r prA> !A ^ "" K / n >" . 7 457. Verily, those ivho live in awefor fear of their Lord;} 458. And those who believe in the Ayat of their Lord;} 459. And those who join not anyone as partners with their Lord;} 460. And those who give that which they give with their hearts hi Ahmad 1:387. The authentic narration of this text is from Ibn Mas*ud not the Prophet

full offear, because they are sure to return to their Lord.} 461. It is these who luisten in tlte good deeds, and they are foremost in them.} Description of the People of Good Deeds iVerily, those ivho live in awefor fear of their Lord;} means, even though they have reached the level of Ihsan and have faith and do righteous deeds, they are still in awe of Allah and fear Him and His hidden plans for them, as Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, The believer combines Ihsan with awe, while the disbelievers combine evil deeds with a sense of security. 11 4And those wlv believe in the Ayat of their Lord;} means, they believe in His universal and legislative signs, as Allah says about Maryam, peace be upon her: iand she testified to the truth of the Words of her Lord, and His Scriptures} [66: 12j, meaning that she believed that whatever existed was by the will and decree of Allah, and that whatever Allah decreed, if it was a command, it would be something that He liked and accepted; if it was a prohibition, it would be something that He disliked and rejected; and if it was good, it would be true. This is like the Ayah 4And those who join not anyone (in worship) as partners with their Lord;} meaning, they do not worship anyone or anything else besides Him, but they worship Him Alone and know that there is no god except Allah Alone, the One, the Self-Sufficient Master, Who does not take a wife or have any offspring, and there is m At-Tabari 19:45.

\$ki*?-) ("ty 1P* oj&ouJ[\$ > // " . 'z*s': '<- ' i / , ^ . , / > ^ | ^ \$ Q^l"" JjJtoilS cl > , ?&* ' > 390 ^ -i*t-T' , > is". ' ' fv !S]jV'(tlttiC "" "" * " * < #/*^ > -> *t*C s > *m'+\ ir^%j^TUA/^sMyj*"u, "J"*U-i)i 4i"- jj^yL " * < * > > r ^t Vv "" > !;? ' Tafefr Ibn Kathir none comparable or equal unto Him. 4And those who give that which they give with their hearts fall of fear, because they are sure to return to their Lord . means, they give in charity, fearing that it may not be accepted from them because of some shortcoming or failure to meet the required conditions of giving. This has to do with fear and taking precautions, as Imam

665Siirah 23. Al-Mu'minun (62-67) (Part-18) This was recorded by

account for their deeds, which He has recorded in a written Book from which nothing is omitted. He says: ipi&&m> iand with Us is a Record which speaks the truth,} meaning, the Book of deeds 4& iand they will not be wronged.} means, nothing will be omitted from their record of good deeds. As for evil

deeds, He will forgive and overlook many of them in the case of His believing servants. Then Allah says, denouncing the disbelievers and idolators of the Quraysh: i)> 4 Jfr iNay, but their hearts are covered}, meaning because of negligence and misguidance, ifrom this.} means, the Qur an which Allah revealed to His Messenger sg. iand they have other deeds, besides which they are doing.} Al-Hakam bin Aban narrated from Ikrimah, from Ibn Abbas that iand they have other deeds,} means, evil deeds apart from that, i.e., Shirk, } iivhich they are doing.} means, which they will inevitably do. This was also narrated from Mujahid, Al-Hasan and others. Others said that this phrase means: Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 6 : 107 .Jabari 19:49, Al-Qurtubi 12:134.

He said, They boasted about the Ka'bah and said, We are its people who stay up talking at night. They used to boast and stay up and talk at night around the Ka'bah. They did not use it for the proper purpose, and so in effect they had abandoned it. 111 2& \ ifIgs \$ \$ u \ Z iBI> gr ,s>; ;; o* (^ j? J-J JyV!> Jh j*j J* 'i 0 (*+ * % 0 ^ V S|f \$ AvOH . (*^d" 4 1>* "U Oi (+ t. Liis, 468 . Have they not pondered over the Word, or has there come to them wlmt had not come to theirfathers ofold?} 469. Or is it that they did not recognize their Messenger so they deny him? 470. Or they say: There is madness in him? Nay, but he brought them the truth, but most of them are averse to the truth .} 471 . And if Al-Haqq had followed their desires, verily, the heavens and the earth, and whosoever is therein would have been corrupted! Nay, We have brought them their reminder, but they turn awayfrom their reminder. 472. Or is it that you ask them for some Kharj? But the recompense of your Lord is better, and He is the Best of those who give sustenance . 473. And certainly, you call them to the straight path.} 474. And verily, those who believe not in the Hereafter are indeed deviatingfar astrayfrom the path.} 475. And though We had mercy on them and removed the distress which is on them, still they would obstinately persist in their transgression, wandering blindly.} m An-Nasat in Al-Kubrd 6 :412

Jahiliyyah. What these people, upon whom the blessing had been bestowed, should have done, was to accept it and give thanks for it, and try to understand it and act in accordance with it night and day, as was done by the wise ones among them who became Muslim and followed the Messenger jfe, may Allah be pleased with them. iHave they not pondered over the Word,} Qatadah said, Because, by Allah, if the people had pondered the meaning and understood it properly, they would have found in the Qur'an a deterrent to disobeying Allah. But they only paid attention to the Ayat which are not entirely clear, and so they were destroyed because of that. ^ Then Allah says, denouncing the disbelievers of the Quraysh: 3& p > iOr is it that they did rtot recognize their Messenger so they deny him?} means, do they not recognize Muhammad and the honesty, trustworthiness and good character with which he grew up among them? Can they deny that or argue against it? JaTar bin Abi Talib said to An-Najashi, the king of Ethiopia: O King, Allah has sent to us a Messenger whose lineage, honesty and trustworthiness are known to us. Al-Mughlrah bin Shu bah said something similar to the deputy of Kisra when he wanted to challenge him. When the Byzantine ruler Heraclius asked Abu Sufyan Sakhr bin Harb and his companions - who were Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6:110. 121 Ibn Hisham 1 :357

Al-Mu'minin (68-75) (Part-18) still disbelievers and had not yet become Muslim - about the characteristics, lineage, honesty and trustworthiness of the Prophet sg, they could only tell the truth and admit that he was indeed noble and truthful.111 i% ft iOr they say: There is madness in him?} This is a narration of what the Quraysh said about the Prophet jg. They said that he was making up the Qur'an by himself, or that he was crazy and did not know what he was saying. Allah tells us that their hearts did not believe that, they knew that what they were saying about the Qur'an was falsehood, for it had come to them from the Words of Allah and could not be resisted or rejected. So Allah challenged them and all the people of the world to produce something like it if they could - but they could not and would never be able to do so. So Allah says: 4**^s ft 4Nay, but he brought them Al-Haqq, but most of them are averse to the truth.} Truth does not followWhims and Desires Allah says; & J&b fix# M 4And ifAl-Haqq had followed their desires, verily, the heavens and the earth, and ivhosoever is therein would have been corrupted!} Mujahid, Abu Salih and As-Suddi said, Al-Haqq is Allah, may He be glorified. 121 What is meant by the Ayah is that if Allah had responded to the desires in their hearts and prescribed things accordingly, the heavens and the earth and whosoever is therein, would have been corrupted, i.e., because oftheir corrupt and inconsistent desires. As Allah says ofthem elsewhere: Fath Al-Bari 1 :42. At-Tabari 19 :57, Al-Qurtubi 12:140.

i:k^ U SOW 3\$V} 4 Why is not this Qur'an sent down to some great man of the two towns?"} [43:31] Then He says: 4%j jfLg \$} 41s it they who would portion out the mercy of your Lord?} [43:32] And Allah says: . / / ** /**/ 1 / , / " / / A/ #/ >{ " >\ < . l>~ 'j] ZiJ **-*y ij;!)-*" Ji^> 4Say: "If you possessed the treasure of the mercy ofmy Lord, then you would surely hold back for fear of spending it."} [17:100], 4 l"S iPw* Syit i U| 40r Jun?e they a share in the dominion? Then in that case they would not give mankind even a NaqTrP j> [4:53] All of this goes to show how incapable mankind is and how divergent and inconsistent their ideas and desires are. Only Allah, may He be glorified, is Perfect in all His attributes, words, actions, laws, power and control of His creation, may He be exalted and sanctified. There is no God but He and no Lord besides Him. Then He says: 4Nay, We have brought them their reminder,} meaning the Qur'an, 7^} ibut they turn awayfrom their reminder.} The speck on the back of a date stone. See the commentary of this Ayah in volume two

Al-Mu'minim (68-75) (Part-18) The Prophet sg does not ask for any payment, and he calls to the straight path. iOr is it that you ask than for some Kharj?) Al-Hasan said, A reward. Qatadah said, Some payment. '21 4Bid the recompense ofyour Lord is better,\$ means, you are not asking for any wages or payment or anything for calling them to right guidance, rather you are hoping for a great reward from Allah, as He says: iSay : Whatever wage I might have asked ofyou is yours. My wage isfrom Allah only.") iSay : No wage do 1 ask ofyou for this, nor am I one of the pretenders.") [38 :86 iiyii vi y 4Say : "No reward do I ask ofyou for this except to be kind to mefor my kinship with you.") [42 :23 y*-' V \$2 Jii &&& CJ 4And there came a man naming from the farthest part of the town. He said: "O my people! Obey the Messengers. Obey those who ask no ivages ofyou, and who are rightly guided.") [35 :20-21] 4 V di' # fire atyjf At-Jabari 19:58. ' Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6:110.

)And certainly, you call than to the straight path. And verily, those ivho believe not in the Hereafter are indeed deviating far astrayfrom the path.) The Situation ofthe Disbelievers 4: 'i cSk iAtid verily, those ivho believe not in the Hereafter are indeed deviatingfar astrayfrom the path.) meaning, they have gone astray and deviated. OJ. j Jt rH 6 r&v Jo) iAnd though We had mercy on them and removed the distress which is on than, still they would obstinately persist in their transgression, wandering blindly.) Here Allah tells of their stubbornness in their disbelief, in that even if He had removed the calamity from them and made them understand the Qur an, they still would not follow it; they would still persist in their disbelief and stubborn transgression. This is like the Ayat. Jt&Li s' > >' jrj j re* ^ 'S-&))Had Allah known ofany good in them, He would indeed have made them listen; and even if He had made them listen, they ivould but have turned away with aversion.) [8:23] j; Cli iii Jc 1jiJ> ISj fj) \yf- Q IjjU ijij j Jj jj CiyCc U pli '1. 4And if (Lauw) you could but see when they will be held over the (Hell) Fire! They will say: "Would that we ivere but sent back (to the ivorld)! Then we would not da\y the Aydt of our Lord, and we would be of the believers!" Nay, it has become manifest to than what they had been concealing before. But if they were returned (to the world), they would certainly revert to that which they wereforbidden.) [6:27-29] Until His statement:

675Surah 23, Al-Mu'mitiun (76-83) (Part-18) rJl mm* rtv x xx / // // x#xx x i/ x x/ JyJ icjUc ljUUj"1llcli3Cili|tsa ^ tfeVi, o; 3i3CjyjlS\$,< ,^r///>*-i/ > "ItA ">*A "s, " ,>=< x > ^ *. -' >*, Hf (Lauw)} is something that will never happen. i*i h^lAiJU Ji)j^ Cj j^p, // / // // / / i/ li Cl# fipClJLC *j ty jkiAi *tf p til aii < / ' '> , / / ,< V/ U yji -#J^b ii; ^ u\$ xi 4; ^ " ji; ^\$ 2 fg m.g tffi id C Ji* ijiii j; -SSI jCffi \$ \ <% \$\$ k4W mz ti'a& ' \$'. *.ic* ^\>-" &\'. *! ' * *S 4be resurrected} This has to do with the knowledge of Allah. He knows about some- thing that will not happen, but if it were to happen, He knows how it would be. Ad- Dahhak reported from Ibn Abbas: Every- thing that is implied in theword: 476. And indeed We seized them with punishment, but they humbled not themselves to their Lord, nor did they invoke with submission to Him.} 477. Until, when We open for them the gate of severe punishment, then lo! they will be plunged in despair.} 478. It is He Who has created for you hearing, eyes, and hearts. Little thanks you give.} 479. And it is He Who has created you on the earth, and to

When we are dead and have become dust and bones, shall we be resurrected indeed?

iAnd indeed We seized them ivith punishment, but they humbled not themselves.> This was also recorded by An-Nasal. 1 11 The basis of this Hadith is in the Two Sahihs, where it says that the Messenger of Allah sg prayed against the Quraysh when he could not make any headway with them,

and he said, O Allah, help me against them sending on them seven years (offamine) like the seven (years of drought) of YtIsuf. ",2) iUntil, when We open for them the gate of severe punishment, then lo! they will be plunged in despair . When the command of Allah reaches them and the Hour comes to them suddenly, and they are overtaken by the punishment of Allah which they were not expecting, then they will despair of any ease and goodness, and all their hopes will disappear. A reminder of the Blessings of Allah and His immense Power Then Allah mentions His blessings to His servants, in that He has given them hearing, sight and understanding through which they come to know things and draw lessons from them, the signs which attest to the Oneness of Allah and indicate that He is the One Who does what He wills and chooses what He wants. iLittle thanks you give means, how little you thank Allah for the blessings He has given you. This is like the Ayuh: iAnd most of mankind will not believe even if you desire it eagerly> [12:103] An-Nasa"! in Al-Kubra 6:413. Al-Bari 8 :435 , Muslim 4 :2156

679Siirah 23. Al-Mu'minin (84-90) (Part-18 shall we be resurrected indeed?") They thought it very unlikely that this would happen after they had disintegrated into nothing. 4"Verily, this we have been promised - we and our fathers before (us)! Tins is only the tales of the ancients! } This means, It is impossible that we could be brought back. This was said by those who learned it from the books and disputes of the ancients. This denial and rejection on their part is like the Ayah where Allah tells us about them: lili j--j srj-j j> v- tlie dT 4"Even after we are crumbled bones?" They say: "It would in that case, be a rehim with loss!" But it zoill be only a single ZajrahJ 71 Wheti behold, they find themselves on the surface of the earth alive after their death.} [79:11-14] i-j yT. lj cjff) ji ijji ill2 j- ilid. lS' cd-iy' fy} j*j }j \$ ULiil Zs\$ Ji 'vA, jL-jj ifd J* i3li /id. v 0 4Does nof /non see that We have created him from Nutfah. Yet behold he (stands forth) as an open opponent. And he puts forth for Us a parable, and forgets his own creation. He says: "Who will give life to these bones after they are rotten and have become dust?" Say: "He will give life to them Who created them for the first time! And He is the All-Knoiver of every creation!"} [36:77-79] Ji aU Ji ^ See the comments on Surat An-Nazi'at (79:13) and Surat As-Saffat * This was explained earlier. See Surat Al-Hajj (22 :4), and Surat Al- Mu minun (23 : 13)

680 TafsJr Ibn Kathir . .. - ^ vj jX-f. J(y ^L=. iJCu o i>\$ jl j* ifTfoyJCZ Say: "Whose is the earth and whosoever is therein? Ifyou know!"} 485. They will say: "It is Allah's!" Say: "Will you not then remember?"} 486. Say: "Who is (the) Lord of the seven heavens, and (the) Lord of the Great Throne?"} 487 . They will say: "Allah." Say: "Will you not then have Taqwa?"} 488. Say: "In Wlwse Hand is the sovereignty of everything? And He protects, while against Whom there is no protector, if you know?"} 489. They will say: "(All that belongs) to Allah. Say: "Hoiv then are you deceived and him awayfrom the truth?"} 490. Nay, but We have brought them the truth, and verily, they are liars.} The Idolators believe in Tawhid Ar-Rububiyyah which requires them to believe in TawhidAl-Uluhiyyah Allah states that the fact that He is One and that He is independent in His creation, control, dominion and guides one to realize that there is no God except Him and that none should be worshipped except Him Alone, with no partner or associate. He tells His Messenger Muhammad jg to say to the idolators who worship others besides Him, even though they admit His Lordship, that He has no partner in Lordship. But despite this they still attributed partners in divinity to Him, and worshipped others besides Him even though they recognized the fact that those whom they worshipped could not create anything, did not own anything, nor do they have any control over anything. However, they still believed that these

creatures could bring them closer to Allah, 4&J lit ^} 4We worship them only that they may bring us near to Allah} [39 :3],

Al-Mu minun (84-90) (Part-18) So Allah says: iK.i JoVr p; fo iSay: Whose is the earth and whosoever is therein?"} meaning, Who is the OwnerWho has created it and whatever is in it ofanimals, plants, fruits and all other kinds ofcreation?" i"If you knoio!" They will say: "It is Allah's!"} means, they will admit that this belongs to Allah Alone with no partner or associate. If that is the case, iSay: "Will you not then remember?"} that none should be worshipped except the Creator and Provider. 4# iSay: "Wlw is Lord of the seven heavens, and Lord of the Great Throne?"} means, Who is the Creator of the higher realm with its planets, lights and angels who submit to Him in all regions and in all directions? Who is the Lord of the Great Throne, which is the highest of all created things? Allah says here: <(& iand Lord of the Great Throne}, meaning the Mighty Throne. At

the end of the Surah, Allah says:

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3846–3857]

u *S' v} 4the Lord of the Supreme Throne!} [23:116], meaning splendid and magnificent. The Throne combines the features of height and vastness with splendor and magnificence. This is why it was said that it is made of red rubies. Ibn Mas'ud said, There is no night or day with your Lord, and the light of the Throne is from the Light of His Face. I 1 * Al-'Azamah no. 147, by Abu Ash-Shaykh. This narration is not authentic, however

XJ' J" *u oyj*~*f 4They will say: Allah." Say: "Will you not then have Taqwd?"} meaning, since you admit that He is the Lord of the heavens and the Lord of the Mighty Throne, will you not fear His punishment for worshipping others besides Him and associating others with Him? 4far J^=* ."Ju Cr4 ^Say: In Whose Hand is the sovereignty of everything?"} i.e., sovereignty is in His Hands. V. y VI o; iThere is not a moving creature but He has grasp of its forelock [11:56]. meaning, He has control over it. The Messenger of Allah used to say, 5JU{ 'jJa j&j v" By the One in Whose hand is my soul.* When he swore an oath, he would say, "By the One Who turns over (controls) the hearts ." He, may He be glorified, is the Creator, the Sovereign, the Controller, ^ a.% - iAnd He protects (all), while against Whom there is no protector, ifyou know?} Among the Arabs, if a leader announced his protection to a person, no one could go against him in that, yet no one could offer protection against that leader. Allah says: 4 ia.% 4And He protects (all), while against Whom tliere is no protector,} meaning, He is the greatest Master, and there is none greater

than Him. His is the power to create and to command, and none can overturn or oppose His ruling. What He wills happens, and what He does not, will not happen. Allah says: 4He cannot be questioned about what He does, while they will be questioned.} [21:23] He cannot be asked about what He does because of His greatness, Pride, overwhelming power, wisdom and justice, but all of His creation will be asked about what they did, as Allah says: 4So, by your Lord, We shall certainly call all of them to account. For all that they used to do.} [15:92-93] 4They will say: "(All that belongs) to Allah."} means, they will admit that the Almighty Master Who protects all while against Him there is no protector is Allah Alone, with no partner or associate. 4Say: "How then are you deceived and turn away from the

truth?"} means, how can your minds accept the idea of worshipping others besides Him when you recognize and acknowledge that? Then Allah says: 4Nay, but I've have brought them the truth,} which is the declaration that there is no god worthy of worship besides Allah, and the establishment of clear, definitive and sound proof to that effect, iand verily, they are liars.} means, in their worship of others alongside Allah when they have no evidence for doing so, as Allah says at the end of this Surah:

rd -mUShi riA JStBfJU //// /' < ^ c / ^ J^i-Lj J^ljsjj I j]aJ .A. ^ > ' ' ' < " "> > - ' To/sir Ibn Kathir iv_j; Jp 'UU ' " 1l- - ""ir>> ""\-\\" rH >>*" *.- < .-t,-r,< ^ > "-> s '.*'s -" (^ - *-s ^ ^ < iA^fi4^i s"" . * > x /. V JiJ. L-J-iJj 4i\ * Jj xa Lli a) dA^/f v ;*J whoever invokes, besides Allah, any other god, of whom he has no proof; then his reckoning is only with his Lord. Surely, the disbelievers will not be successful . [23:1 17J The idolators have no evidence for what they are doing, which has led them into lies and misguidance. Rather they are following their forefathers and predecessors who were confused and ignorant, as Allah describes them: 4 if dlj iil j|t fcfr; l Jwj A We found our fathers folloxvng a certain way and religion, and we will indeedfolloxv their footsteps "\$ [43:23] S^~ jf 4-"jj i&l & fM ^J^s=> Cj Jbj ii> Jk_jef . No son (or offspring) did Allah beget, nor is there any god along with Him . (If there had been many gods), then each god would have taken away what he had created, and some would have tried to overcome others! Glorified be Allah above all that they attribute to Him!\$

Al-Mu'minun (91-92) (Part-18) i92. All-Knmver of the unseen and the seen! Exalted be He over all that they associate as partners to Him/\$> Allah has no Partner or Associate Allah declares Himself to be above having any child or partner in dominion, control and worship. He says: yj, jii. \1j^X -U 'ij Cj & iNo son did Allah beget, nor is there any god along ivith Him (If there had been many gods), then each god would have taken aivay what he had created, and some would have tried to overcome others. meaning, if it were decreed that there should be a plurality of deities, each of them would have exclusive control over whatever he had created, so there would never be any order in the universe. But what we see is that the universe is ordered and cohesive, with the upper and lower realms connected to one another in the most perfect fashion. oj 4^ o, ts) fy iyou can see no fault in the creation of the Most Gracious [65:3]. Moreover, if there were a number of gods, each of them would try to subdue the other with enmity, and one would prevail over the other. This has been mentioned by the scholars of Rm-ul-KalamJ ' who discussed it using the evidence of mutual resistance or counteraction. This idea states that if there were two or more creators, one would want to make a body move while the other would want to keep it immobile, and if neither of them could achieve what they wanted, then both would be incapable, but the One Whose existence is essential [i.e., Allah] cannot be incapable. It is impossible for the will of both to be fulfilled because of the conflict. This dilemma only arises when a plurality of gods is suggested, so it is impossible for there to be such a plurality, because if the will of one is fulfilled and I 1 * A term used to denote the discipline of the Muslim scholars who utilized philosophy in their teachings

TheCommand to callonAllahwhenCalamity strikes, to repel Evil with that which is better, and to seek refuge with Allah Allah commands His Prophet Muhammad % to call on Him with this supplication when calamity strikes: iMy Lord! If You would show me that with which they are threatened. meaning, if You punish them while I am witnessing that, then do not cause me to be one of them. As was said in the Haclth recorded by Imam Ahmad and At-Tirmidhi, who graded it Sahth: yJu 'fj. JllJ] yi If You loant

to test people, then take me to You [cause me to die] without having to undergo the test." ['] iAnd indeed We are able to show you that with which We have threatened them> means, if We willed, We could show you the punishment and test that We will send upon them. Then Allah shows him the best way to behave when mixing with people, which is to treat kindly the one who treats him badly, so as to soften his heart and turn his enmity to friendship, and to turn his hatred to love. Allah says: iRepel evil with that which is better.\$ This is like the Ayah: dj r /cajj ijAjj isji (> Si\ iRepel (the evil) with one which is better, then verily he, between whom and you there was enmity, (will become) as though he was a close friend. But none is granted it except Ahmad 5 :243 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi9 : 108

those who are patient> [41:34-35). meaning, nobody will be helped or inspired to follow this advice or attain this quality, 4except those ivho are patient meaning, those who patiently bear people s insults and bad treatment and deal with them in a good manner when they are on the receiving end of bad treatment from them. 4^-J?*>> &>} iand none is granted it except the oivner of the great portion} means, in this world and the Hereafter. And Allah says: ^ Oi 4> \\$ Jj} iAnd say: My Lord! I seek refuge with You from the tohisperings of the Shayatin."} Allah commanded him to seek refuge with Him from the Shayatin, because no trick could help you against them and you cannot protect yourself by being kind to them. We have already stated, when discussing Isti'adhah (seeking refuge),111 that the Messenger of Allah jfe used to say, I seek refuge with Allah, the All-Hearing, All-Seeing, from the accursed Shayatin, from his ivhisperings, evil suggestions and insinuations His saying: / .. >> ' < . - < > 4"And I seek refuge with You, My Lord! lest they should come near me."} means, in any issue of my life. So we are commanded to mention Allah at the beginning of any undertaking, in order to ward off the Shayatin at the time of eating, intercourse, See volume one, prior to the Tafsir of Surat Al-Fatihah. |2) Abu Dawud 1 :490.

689Siirah 23. Al-Mu'miniin (99-100) (Part-18) slaughtering animals for food, etc.

690 Tafsir IbtI Kathir 4 " .JjIju 11) 'j* - i} 4And Allah is All-Aware ofwhat you do} [63:10-1 1] 4And warn mankind of the Day when the torment will come unto them} Jt p^=*1 } upto His saying; 4that you would not leave (the world far the Hereafter).} [14:44] And His saying: 22S oju ^ in oft 2 jj " ijl jftb S' jjSt^&2 f u 4On the Day the event is finally fulfilled, those who neglected it before will say: "Verily , the Messengers of our Lord did come with the truth, now are there any intercessors far us that they might intercede on our behalf? Or could we be sent back so that we might do deeds other than those deeds which we used to do?"} [7:53] And: % ilfjy >> 4And ifyou only could see when the criminals shall hang their heads before their Lord (saying) : "Our Lord! We have now seen and heard, so send us back, that we will do righteous good deeds. Verily, we now believe with certainty."} [32:12] And; Cf&> Vj iji Lift ijllii it} Jj} 4If you could but see when they will be held over the (Hell) Fire! They will say : "Would that we were but sent back! Then we would not deny the Aydt ofour Lord..."} until His saying;

iAnd indeed they are liars. [6:27-28] " Ar iAnd yon will see the wrongdoers, when they behold the torment, they will say: "Is there any way ofreturn?"} [42:44] & "*" Ji iThey will say: "Our Lord! You l\ave made us to die twice, and You have given us life twice! Now we confess our sins, then is there any way to get out? } [40:11] and the Ayah after it: u 12; S>^ ,} a \j.jz pr ii%&. they will cry : "Our Lord! Bring us out, we shall do righteous good deeds, not what we used to do." (Allah will reply:) "Did We not give you lives long enough, so -that whosoever would receive admonition could receive it? And the

wamer came to you . So taste you (the evil of your deeds) . For the wrongdoers there is no helper. } [35:37] Allah says that they will ask to go back, when death approaches, on the Day of Resurrection, when they are gathered for judgment before the Compeller (Allah) and when they are in the agonies of the punishment of Hell, but their prayer will not be answered. Here Allah says: 4%U jühr \ 4No/ It is but a word that he speaks;} The word Kalla (No!) is a word that is used to rebuke, and the meaning is: No, We will not respond to what he asks for and We will not accept it from him. jühr ilt is but a word that he speaks refers to his asking to go back so that he can do righteous deeds; this is just talk on his part, it would not be accompanied

692 Tafstr Ibn Katliir by any action. If he were to go back, he would not do righteous good deeds, he is merely lying, as Allah says: rrU Q IjjU V jj) any iBut if they iver returned, they zuould certainly revert to that which they wereforbidden. And indeed they are liars [6:28], Qatadah said: By Allah he will not wish to go back to his family and tribe, or to accumulate more of the things of this world or satisfy his desires, but he will wish that he could go back to do acts of obedience to Allah. May Allah have mercy on a man who does that which the disbeliever will wish he had done when he sees the punishment of Hell. Barzakh and Punishment therein iy-*n til opr iand in front of them is Barzakh until the Day when they will be resurrected.) Abu Salih and others said that: Lo oyft iand in front of them) means before them. Mujahid said, Al- Barzakh is a barrier between this world and the Hereafter. Muhammad bin Ka*b said, uAl-Barzakh is what is between this world and the Hereafter, neither they are the people of this world, eating and drinking, nor are they with the people of the Hereafter, being rewarded or punished for their deeds. Abu Sakhr said, Al-Barzakh refers to the graves. They are neither in this world nor the Hereafter, and they will stay there until

the Day of Resurrection.”11 '

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3857–3875]

r+frj iand in front of them is Barzakh). In these words is a threat to those wrongdoers at the time of death, of the punishment of Barzakh. This is similar to the Ayat iln front of them there is Hell) [45:10]. m Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6:116.

t/Se. .*S\3j iand in front of hint will be a great torment [14:17]. 4 > 3 iuntil the Daij when they will be resurrected}. means, he will be punished continually until the Day of Resurrection, as it says in the Hadith: He will continue to be punished in itJ meaning, in the earth. \~tV ** " // ' . /- s \ * / > / y . kiuJJU /C-jy* Vj ^ wjL j lipy -'i"-'. > ^,r ; " /"i S*Y >% " w t" . // ' :.*#" > > J *' 'Xrf* <%?' t^JSy O-ti. p-a . V* -^j pAj Jo\ <(701. 77ie/i, the Trumpet is blown, there will be no kinship among them that Day, nor will they ask of one another.} 4102. Then, those whose Scales (of good deeds) are heavy, these! they are the successful.} 4103. And those to those Scales (of good deeds) are light, they are those ivho lose themselves, in Hell will they abide 4104. The Fire will bum their faces, and therein they xvill grin, xvith displaced lips (disfigured) .} The soundingoftheTrumpet and the weighing ofDeeds in the Scales. Allah says that when the Trumpet is blown for the Resurrection, and the people rise from their graves, // i V"" ^ _ ay"/ v v Vj ithere will be no kinship among them that Day, nor will they ask ofone another.} meaning that lineage will be of no avail on that Day, and a father will not ask about his son or care about him. Allah says: [il Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 4 :183

and been saved from an evil from which there is no escape. \$And those whose Scales are light,} means, their evil deeds outweigh their good deeds. 4 *' i L_i Cri' ithey are those who lose themselves,} means, they are doomed and have ended up with the worst deal. Allah says: *- j,} 4in Hell will they abide.} meaning, they will stay there forever and will never leave. 4'M PJJ, &} 4The Fire will bum theirfaces,} This is like the Ayah: 4tt*&& 4andfire zoill cover tltheirfaces} [14:50]. and: 0* -A3 f+^yri u* y * -?- i O& pLu \$} 4If only those who disbelieved knew (the time) rohen they will not be able to ward off the Fire from their faces, norfrom their backs} [21:39]. 4and therein they will grin, zvith displaced lips.} *Ali bin Abi Talhah narrated from Ibn Abbas, Frowning. y V p r liji ijxx. jli LfU (fyt 4105. "Were not My Ayat recited to you, and then you used to deny them?"} 4106. They will say : Our Lord! Our wretchedness overcame us, and we were (an) erring people."} At-Tabari 19:74.

4109. Verily, there was a party ofMy servants ivho used to say: "Our Lord! We believe, so forgive us and have mercy on us, for You are the Best of all who show mercy!"} 4110. But you took them for a laughing stock, so much so that they made you forget My remembrance while you used to laugh at them!} 4111. Verily, I have rewarded them this Dayfor their patience; they are indeed the ones that are successful.} Allah s Response and Rejection ofthe Disbelievers This is the response of Allah to the disbelievers when they ask Him to bring them out of the Fire and send them back to this world. He will say: iRemain you in it with ignominy!} meaning, abide therein, humiliated, despised and scorned. 4And speak you not to Me!} means, do not ask for this again, for I will not respond to you. Al- Awfi reported from Ibn Abbas concerning this Ayah, 4oJ&& i ii> iRemain you in it zuith ignominy! And speak you not to Me!} These are the words of Ar-Rahman when silencing them. [11 Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abdullah bin Amr said, The people of Hell will call on Malik for forty years, and he will not answer them. Then he will respond and tell them that they are to abide therein. By Allah, their cries will mean nothing to Malik or to the Lord of Malik. Then they will call on their Lord and will say, % a jj Q. aji % SJ4 & %} 4 iVVi' iOur Lord! Our wretchedness overcame us, and we were (an) erring people. Our Lord! Bring us out of this. Ifever we returnTabari 19:79.

(to evil), theii indeed we shall be wrongdoers.} [23:106-107] Allah will not answer them for a time span equivalent to twice the duration of this world. Then He will reply: iRemain you in it with ignominy! And speak you not to Me!} By Allah, the people will not utter a single word after that, and they will merely be in the Fire of Hell, sighing in a high and low tone. Their voices are likened to those of donkeys, which start in a high tone and end in a low tone. 111 Then Allah will remind them of their sins in this world and how they used to make fun of His believing servants and close friends: 4s js h & *&: oi [} i >> iVerily, there was a party ofMy servants who used to say: "Our Lord! We believe, so forgive us and have mercy on us, for You are the Best of all who show mercy! But you took them for a laughing stock,} meaning, you made fun of them for calling on Me and praying to Me, iso much so that they made you forgetMy remetrnbrance} means, your hatred for them made you forget what I would do to you. ^J%} iwhile you used to laugh at them!} means, at their deeds and worship. This is like the Ayah: (*-p ll/-* (^yjl \j% b\} iVerily, those who committed crimes used to laugh at those who believed. And, whenever they passed by them, used to wink one to another.} [83:29-30] m Az-Zuhd by HannSd bin Al-Sirri 1:158.

meaning, they used to slander them in mockery. Then Allah tells us how He will reward His friends and righteous servants, and says: 4 JA-' Lj fJf 4 Verily, I have rewarded them this Day for their patience meaning, for the harm and mockery that you inflicted on them, 1' > it * it they are indeed the ones that are successful.} I have caused them to attain the victory of joy, safety, Paradise and salvation from the Fire. tJfaLaN .j f O' (j f (JlS px, & p&. ^ p> i *j* i & 4 u'j-*)' 4y j* csl*)* "" Jic* *} Ii4i 4222. He rei// say: "What number of years did you stay on earth?"} 4223. They will say: "We stayed a day or part of a day. Ask of those who keep account."} 4224. He toill say: "You stayed not but a little, if you Iwd only blown!"} 4225. "Did you think that We had created you in play, and that you would not be brought back to Us?"} 4226. So Exalted be Allah, the True King: None has the right to be worshipped but He, the Lord of Al- Arsh Al-Karhn!} Allah tells them how much they wasted in their short lives in this world by failing to obey Allah and worship Him Alone. If they had been patient during their short stay in this world, they would have attained victory just like His pious close friends. 4 'S^_; JXA Jfjii j X} S^} 4He will say: "What number of years did you stay on earth?"} means, how long did you stay in this world? . J r y Uj) LtJ

iThey loill say: "We stayed a day or part of a day. Ask of those who keep account." meaning, those who keep the records. &He will say: "You stayed not but a little..."} meaning, it was only a short time, no matter how you look at it. p)} 4*/ you had only known!} means, you would not have preferred the transient to the eternal, and treated yourself in this bad way, and earned the wrath of Allah in this short period. If you had patiently obeyed Allah and worshipped Him as the believers did, you would have attained victory just as they did. Allah did not create His Servants in vain iDid you think that We had created you in play,} means, did you think that you were created in vain, with no purpose, with nothing required of you and no wisdom on Our part? Or it was said that in play meant to play and amuse yourselves, like the animals were created, who have no reward or punishment. But you were created to worship Allah and carry out His commands. V U1 pj} iand that you would not be brought back to Us?} means, that you would not be brought back to the Hereafter. This is like the Ayah: 4Does man think that he will be left neglected?} [75:36] iSo Exalted be Allah, the True King.} means, s. : tified be He above the idea that he should create anything in vain, for He is the True King Who is far above doing such a thing. o;2 V}4 V>

meaning, they will not be successful with Him on the Day of Resurrection; they will not prosper or be saved. iAtid say : My Lord! Forgive and have mercy, for You are the best of those who shoiv mercy/"\$> Here Allah is teaching us to recite this supplication, for forgiveness, in a general sense, means wiping away sins and concealing them from people, and mercy means guiding a person and helping him to say and do good things. This is the end of Volume Six. Volume Seven begins with Surat An-Nur.

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TAFSIR (ABRIDGED) (Surat An-Nur to Surat Al-Ahzab, Verse 50)

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Important Guidelines About the Authenticity of the Reports and Quotations in the Tafsir of Ibn Kathir
Reports from the Companions of the Messenger of Allah[^] Reports that are attributed to the companions of Allah's Messenger 3g are commonly used for additional explanation of the meanings of the Qur'an. As for those quotes that Ibn Kathir mentions in passing, these quotes may, or may not be authentically attributed to them. Wherever it is mentioned that one of them said something, and that statement contradicts other clearly authentic texts, then such statements can not be held as an evidence against what is known to be authentic. Additional information in this regard is found in the Introduction of Ibn Kathir. Incomplete Chains of Narration The following is a list of common incomplete chains of narrations that Al-Hafiz Ibn Kathir often quotes. - Ali bin Abi Talhah (Al-Walibi) reported that Ibn Abbas said... - (Atiyah) Al-Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said... - Ad-Dahhak from Ibn Abbas. - As-Suddi reported from Abu Malik and Abu Salih from Ibn Abbas, Ibn Mas'ud and [or] some men among the companions. - Al-Hasan Al-Basri reporting from or about the Prophet sg;. - Qatadah reporting from or about the Prophet All narrations coming from these chains are unauthentic according to the Sciences of Hadith. Their meanings, however, may be correct as understood by authentic texts, and for this reason they are commonly referenced. Reports from the Followers of the Companions and those who Follow them The following is a list of those who did not see the Prophet

2S. but they report from companions of the Prophet while often they themselves are quoted for Tafsir. Reports that are attributed to them are used as additional support in understanding certain issues by Ibn Kathir. Such quotes may, or may not be authentically attributed to them. Wherever it is mentioned that one of them said something, and that statement contradicts other clearly authentic texts, then such statements can not be held as evidence against the authentic evidence. Abu Al-Aliyah, Said bin Jubayr, Said bin Al-Musayib, Ata (bin Abi Rabah), Ata Al-Khurasani, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Ar-Rabi' bin Anas, Ash-Shahbi, Qatadah, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Ad-Dahhak, Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam (Ibn Zayd), Ibn Jurayj. Other Scholars After the Companions The following are some scholars that Ibn Kathir often quotes from. Since these scholars are not well known to the average English reader, one should beware that their own statements about the Prophet jg, his companions, or circumstances surrounding the Qur'an's revelation, are not to be considered as important as authentically narrated texts. Waki, Sufyan Ath-Thawri, Muhammad bin Ishaq, Ibn Atiyyah, Ibn Abi Hatim, Ibn Jarir (At-Tabari).

Module 25

Surah 24: An-Nur, Surah 25: Al-Furqan

Surah 24: An-Nur

PDF pages 3887–4004

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3887–3937]

The Tafsir of Surat An-Nur (Chapter - 24) Which was Revealed in Al-Madinah In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. ^{^ \ -) l j j J > \$ f " jft) < \$ 'ix / // < "/ jy-i* **!} j j ^ j. } * i " i iijli Ufj'-i* - V^i> ro)V- i_yi. "by juujlj^L^l ^vi.A^aj^o) 1oyi/i/jlj^ y y ^ V"iV -" ..< >< ' * " y y ' lAJ " Alj-ijbjyC d.)Vjd-Jd-OCI^J^Pjj\ajb jy&'<&\ viB'iA"0^ ^)J^J //M/ / ^ -V / / JiO / /V Jbj)1 4_1 41. A Surah which We have sent down and which We have enjoined (Faradnahd), and in it We have revealed manifest Ayat, that you may remember.) 42. The Zaniyah and the Zdni, flog each of them with a hundred stripes. Let not pity withhold you in their case, in a punishment prescribed by Allah, if you believe in Allah and the Last Day. And let a party of the believers witness their punishment.)}

18 Tafsir Ibn Kathir The Importance of Surat An-Nur ^A Surah which We have sent down} Here Allah is pointing out the high esteem in which He holds this Surah, which is not to say that other Surahs are not important. iand which We have enjoined,} Mujahid and Qatadah said, This means: We have explained what is lawful and unlawful, commands and prohibitions, and the prescribed punishments. Al-Bukhari said, Those who read it: Faradnaha, say that it means: We have enjoined them upon you and those who come after you. iand in it We have revealed manifest Ayat,} means, clearly explained, #a> ithat you may remember. The Explanation of the Prescribed Punishment for Zina (Illicit Sex) Then Allah says: ijji~ Jij C& (< f } } iThe Zdnyah and the Zdni, flog each of them with a hundred stripes.} This honorable Ayah contains the ruling on the law of retaliation for the person who commits illegal sex, and details of the punishment. Such a person will either be unmarried, meaning that he has never been married, or he will be married, meaning that he has had intercourse within the bounds of a lawful marriage, and he is free, adult and of sound mind. As for the virgin who is unwedded, the prescribed *** At-Tabari 19 :89, Ad-Durr Al-Manthur 6 :124 Fath Al-Bari 8 :301

punishment is one hundred stripes, as stated in this Ayah. In addition to this he is to be banished from his homeland for one year, as was recorded in the Two Sahih from Abu Hurayrah and Zayd bin Khalid Al-Juhani in the Hadith about the two bedouins who came to the Messenger of Allah jg. One of them said, O Messenger of Allah, this son of mine was employed by this man, and committed Zina with his wife. I paid a ransom with him on behalf of my son one hundred sheep and a slave-girl, but when I asked the people of knowledge, they said that my son should be given one hundred stripes and banished for a year, and that this man's wife should be stoned to death. The Messenger of Allah jg said: iwJlIp j siJjJl 4)1 L L> ! o-Uj a l'y\ ^J\ - jiXit ja ^ jU jU t lJla "Bi/ the One in Whose Hand is my soul, I will judge between you both according to the Book of Allah. Take back the slave-girl and sheep, and your son is to be given one hundred stripes and banished for one year. O Unays - he said to a man from the tribe of Aslam - go to this man's wife, and if she confesses, then stone her to death. Unays went to her

and she confessed, so he stoned her to death. This indicates that if the person who is guilty of illegal sex is a virgin and unmarried, he should be banished in addition to being given one hundred stripes. But if married, meaning he has had intercourse within the bounds of lawful marriage, and he is free, adult and of sound mind, then he should be stoned to death. Imam Malik recorded that Umar, may Allah be pleased with him, stood up and praised and glorified Allah, then he said; O people! Allah sent Muhammad with the truth, and revealed to him the Book. One of the things that was revealed to him was the Ayah of stoning to death, which we have recited and Al-Bari 5 :355 , Muslim 3 :1324

20 Tafslr Ibn Kathir understood. The Messenger of Allah ^ carried out the punishment of stoning and after him we did so, but I am afraid that as time goes by, some will say that they did not find the Ayah of stoning in the Book of Allah, and they will go astray because they abandoned one of the obligations revealed by Allah. Stoning is something that is prescribed in the Book of Allah for the person - man or woman - who commits illegal sex, if he or she is married, if decisive evidence is produced, or if pregnancy results from that, or if they confess to it. 111 It was also recorded in the Two Sahlhs in the lengthy Hadxth of Malik, from which we have quoted briefly only the portion that is relevant to the current discussion. Do not feel pity for Them when carrying out the Prescribed Punishment 4? m j w &> 4Let not pity withhold you in their case, in a punishment prescribed by Allah,} Meaning, with a ruling prescribed by Allah. So the meaning of the Ayah is: Do not feel too sorry for them where the laws of Allah are established. This does not mean that we should not naturally feel pity when carrying out the punishment. What is prohibited here is the kind of pity that may make the judge ignore the punishment altogether. This is what is not permitted for the judge. Mujahid said, 4^ Hi j ii'jw ij} iLet not pity withhold you in their case, in a punishment prescribed by Allah,} If the matter is taken to the ruling authority, the punishment has to be carried out and cannot be stopped. This was also narrated from Said bin Jubayr and Ata bin Abi Rabah.'3 * It was recorded in a Hadith: 111 Muuiatta 2 :823 ' Path Al-B&ri 13:148, Muslim 3:1317. 131 Al-Baghawi 3:321.

"Compromise with the matter of prescribed punishment mutually sorting it out among yourselves, for once a matter where the prescribed punishment is required reaches me, I am obliged to carry it out. Allah s saying: ifyou believe in Allah and the Last Day.} means, then do that, carry out the punishments on those who commit illegal sex, and strike them hard without causing any wound, so that he and others like him will be deterred by the terror of that. In Al-Musnad, it was recorded that one of the Companions said, O Messenger of Allah, when I slaughter a sheep I feel pity for it. He said, l iuiJ ilJj' "Yom be rewardedfor that.^ Cany out the Prescribed Punishment in Public iAnd let a party of the believers witness their punishment.} This is more humiliating for the people who are guilty of illegal sex, if they are flogged in front of the people. This is because it is more effective as a deterrent and it conveys the sense of scandal and rebuke. Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, iAnd let a party of the believers witness their punishment.} Publicly. S& ^ } oi v 3 j i# -V) gc v Jf} i3 . The Zani marries not but a Zaniyah or a Mushrikah ; and the Zaniyah, none marries her except a Zani or a Mushrik. Abu D&wud 4 :540. Ahmad 5 :34. The wording varies slightly.

Such a thing is forbidden to the believers . Here Allah tells us that the Zani (male who is guilty of illegal sex) does not have intercourse except with a Zaniyah (female who is guilty of illegal sex) or a Mushrikah (female idolator), meaning that no one would go along with him in this action except a

sinful woman who is also guilty of Zina, or a Mushrikah who does not think it is unlawful. By the same token, a Zaniyah, none marries her except a Zani or a sinful man who is guilty of fornication, or a Mushrik (a man) who does not think it is unlawful. Je Jij'i ff-j} {Such a thing is forbidden to the believers.} meaning, indulging in this, or marrying prostitutes, or marrying chaste women to immoral men. Qatadah and Muqatil bin Hayyan said: Allah forbade the believers from marrying prostitutes. 11 * This Ayah is like the Ayah (about marrying slave-girls): {they should be chaste, not committing illegal sex, nor taking boyfriends.} [4:25) And His saying: Vj ji. {desiring chastity not committing illegal sexual intercourse, nor taking them as girlfriends [5:5]. Imam

So he asked the Messenger of Allah jgig for permission, or he mentioned the matter to him. The Messenger of Allah recited to him: M v XM 35 'C& vj& v 477te Zani marries not but a Zaniyah or a Mushrikah; and the Zaniyah, none marries her except Zani or a Mushrik. Such a thing is forbidden to the believers.} [24:3] Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Hurayrah ag said, "A Zani who has been flogged should not marry anyone except someone who is like him. A similar report was recorded by Abu Dawud in his Sunan. * A A A Jjuji-Llj pjl . And those who accuse chaste women, and produce not four witnesses, flog them with eighty stripes, and reject their testimony forever. They indeed are the rebellious.} 45. Except those who repent thereafter and do righteous deeds; (for such) verily, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} The Prescribed Punishment for Slandering Chaste Women This Ayah states the prescribed punishment for making false accusations against chaste women, i.e., those who are free, adult and chaste. If the person who is falsely accused is a woman, the same punishment of flogging also applies. If the accuser produces evidence that what he is saying is true, then the punishment does not apply. Allah said: // i t I "" ' ty //*/ <" * Jp-'A ^ i" 4and produce not four witnesses, flog them with eighty stripes, 1 Abu Dawud 2 :543.

and reject their testimony forever. They indeed are the rebellious. If the accuser cannot prove that what he is saying is true, then three rulings apply to him: (firstly) that he should be flogged with eighty stripes, (secondly) that his testimony should be rejected forever, and (thirdly) that he should be labelled as a rebellious who is not of good character, whether in the sight of Allah or of mankind. Explaining the Repentance of the One Who makes a False Accusation Then Allah says: 1 JJ** - Jli'i Jou [jt jj&\ "jl^ i Except those who repent thereafter and do righteous deeds; (for such) verily, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful. This exception refers to the second and third rulings mentioned above. The flogging has been carried out regardless of whether he repents or persists, and after that there is no further punishment, as is agreed among the scholars. If he repents, then his testimony may be accepted, and he is no longer to be regarded as a rebellious. This was the view of Said bin Al-Musayyib - the leader of the Tabi'in^ - and also a group among the Salaf.,2) Ash-Shalsi and Ad-Dahhak said, His testimony cannot be accepted even if he does repent, unless he himself admits that he said something false, in which case his testimony may be accepted. ' And Allah knows best. /ij ijj pf'fr' V) Jz fj fff) OyjM offfr J ijilj ^ iff o) ff jA iSlj 3 A.C/iL\j f se 4 if& f !\$y if /C^y if Ji 46. And for those who accuse their wives, but have no (1 * Referring to the generation after the Companions. [21 At-Jabari 19:105. At-Tabari 19:103, 108.

witnesses except themselves, let the testimony of one of them be four testimonies by Allah that he is one of those who speak the truth.> 47. And the fifth (testimony); invoking of the curse of Allah on him if he

be of those who tell a lie.} 48. But she shall avert the punishment from her, if she bears witness four times by Allah, that he is telling a lie.} 49. And the fifth; should be that the wrath of Allah be upon her if he speaks the truth.} 410. And had it not been for the grace of Allah and His mercy on you! And that Allah is the One Who forgives and accepts repentance, the All-Wise.} Details of Al-L'van This Ayah offers a way out for husbands. If a husband has accused his wife but cannot come up with proof, he can swear the Li'an (the oath of condemnation) as Allah commanded. This means that he brings her before the Imam and states what he is accusing her of. The ruler then asks him to swear four times by Allah in front of four witnesses that he is one of those who speak the truth} in his accusation of her adultery. & 3 3LAy} 4And the fifth ; the invoking of the curse of Allah on him if he be of those who tell a lie.} If he says that, then she is divorced from him by the very act of this Li'an; she is forever forbidden for him and he must give her Mahr to her. The punishment for Zina should be carried out on her, and nothing can prevent the punishment except if she also swears the oath of condemnation [Li'an) and swears by Allah four times that he is one of those who lied, i.e., in what he is accusing her of; 4And the fifth; should be that the wrath of Allah be upon her if he speaks the truth.}

Allah says: i&X 4But she shall avert the punishment} meaning, the prescribed punishment. * s', rs-'JV ^ "z* 'Tfs ^ ^ / vj' ' f.' ~i' / *, ' jo 4ii\ v..ag- j> i auL ^ Xpi -ysS jly iif she bears witness four times by Allah, that he is telling a lie. And the fifth; should be that the wrath of Allah be upon her if he speaks the truth.} The wrath of Allah is mentioned specially in the case of the woman, because usually a man would not go to the extent of exposing his wife and accusing her of Zina unless he is telling the truth and has good reason to do this, and she knows that what he is accusing her of is true. So in her case the fifth testimony calls for the wrath of Allah to be upon her, for the one upon whom is the wrath of Allah, is the one who knows the truth yet deviates from it. Then Allah mentions His grace and kindness to His creation in that He has prescribed for them a way out of their difficulties. Allah says: {33* jit iAtid had it not been for the grace of Allah and His mercy on you!} meaning, many of your affairs would have been too difficult for you, 4& &} iAtid that Allah is the One Who forgives and accepts repentance,} means, from His servants, even if that comes after they have sworn a confirmed oath. 4i^} ithe AU-Wise.} in what He prescribes and commands and forbids There are Hadiths which explain how we are to put this Ayah into effect, why it was revealed and concerning whom among the Companions it was revealed.

The Reason why the Ayah of L'van was revealed Imam

An-Nilr (6 - 10) (Part-18 to be flogged for it. So he testified for the fifth time that the curse of Allah would be upon him if he was telling a lie. Then it was said to his wife, Testify four times by Allah that he is telling a lie. And when his wife reached the fifth testimony, she was told, Have Taqwa of Allah, for the punishment of this world is easier than the punishment of the Hereafter, and this will mean that the punishment will be inevitable for you. She hesitated for a while, and was about to admit her guilt, then she said: By Allah, I will not expose my people to shame, and she swore the fifth oath that the wrath of Allah would be upon her if he was telling the truth. Then the Messenger of Allah separated them, and decreed that her child should not be attributed to any father, nor should the child be accused, and whoever accused her or her child, they would be subject to punishment. He also decreed that [Hilal] was not obliged to house her or feed her, because they had not been separated by divorce, nor had he

died and left her a widow. He said, *caj olij ^jjj ytj iJLif* "she gives birth to a red-haired child (with skinny thighs) and thin legs, then he is Hilal's child, but if she gives birth to a curly-haired child with thick legs and plump buttocks, then this is what she is accused of." She subsequently gave birth to a child who was curly-haired with thick legs and plump buttocks, and the Messenger of Allah said, *"5tiwj jis3 iujS/i o* Were it not for the oath that she swore, I would deal with her." Ikrimah said, The child grew up to become the governor of Egypt, and he was given his mother's name and was not attributed to any father.

nWait until she gives birth, and if she gives birth to a child whose eyes look as if they are ringed with kohl and who has plump buttocks and thick legs, then he is the child of Shank bin Sahmd. She gave birth to a child who matched this description, and the Prophet *5g* said, *jj iiid ^ u* "Were it not for the Book of Allah, I would deal with her. This version was recorded only by

32 Tafsir Ibtisama Kathirani started with the man, who swore four times by Allah that he was one of those who speak the truth, and swore the fifth oath that the curse of Allah would be upon him if he were lying. Then he turned to the woman, who swore four times by Allah that he was lying, and swore the fifth oath that the wrath of Allah would be upon her if he was telling the truth. Then he separated them. 111 It was also recorded by An-Nasa'i in his Tafsir, and by Al-Bukhari and Muslim in the Two Sahihahs. *P I 1 * Ahmad 2:19. An-Nasa'i in Al-Kubra 6 :414 Al-Bari 9 :367 , Muslim 2 : 1 130 , from Ibn Umar.*

*4 ju /J (*p; -jj_y v ^ ill.* Verily, those who brought forth the slander are a group among you. Consider it not a bad thing for you. Nay, it is good for you. Unto every man among them will be paid that which he had earned of the sin, and as for him among them who had the greater share therein, his will be a great torment.) Al-Ifk (the Slander) The next ten Ayat were all revealed concerning A'ishah, the mother of the believers, may Allah be pleased with her, when the people of slander and falsehood among the hypocrites made their accusations against her and spread lies about her. Allah became jealous on her behalf and on behalf of His Prophet *sg*, and revealed her innocence to protect the honor of the Messenger of Allah *fg*. He said: *j'.C- i* Verily, those who brought forth the slander are a group among you.) meaning they were not one or two, but a group. Foremost among this group was Abdullah bin Ubayy bin Salul, the leader of the hypocrites, who fabricated the lie and whispered it to others, until some of the

wanted to go on a journey, he would cast lots among his wives, and the one whose lot was drawn would go with him. A'ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, said, So he drew lots among us with regard to a campaign he was going out on, and mine was drawn, so I went out with the Messenger of Allah *j*. This was after the commandment of Hijab had been revealed, so I traveled in my howdah and stayed in it when we camped. We traveled until the Messenger of Allah *fg* completed his campaign, then we returned. As we were approaching Al-Madinah, we paused for a while, then they announced that the journey was to be resumed. When I heard this, I walked quickly away from the army to answer the call of nature, then I came back to my howdah. Then I put my hand to my chest and noticed that a necklace of mine that was made of onyx and cornelian had broken, so I went back and looked for it, and was delayed because of that. In the meantime, the people who used to lift my howdah onto my camel came along and put it on the camel, thinking that I was inside. In those times women were more slender and not so heavy, they only ate mouthfuls of food. So the people did not think anything of the howdah being

so light when they lifted it up, as I was a young woman. They set off, and I found my necklace after the army had moved on. Then I came back to the place where we had stopped, and I saw no one to call or answer. So I went to the place where I had been, thinking that the people would miss me and come back for me. While I was sitting there, I fell asleep. Safwan bin Al-Mu'attal As-Sulami Adh-Dhakwani had rested during the night behind the army. Then he set out just before daybreak and reached the place where I was in the morning, where he saw the outline of a person sleeping. He came to me and recognized me when he saw me, as he had seen me before Hijab was made obligatory for me. When he saw me and said Truly, to Allah we belong, and truly, to Him we shall return, I woke up, and covered my face with my Jilbab (outer garment). By Allah, he did not speak a word to me and I did not hear him say anything except Truly, to Allah we belong, and truly, to Him we shall return, until he brought his camel and made it kneel so that I could ride upon it, then he set out leading the camel until we caught up with the army at Zuhra time.

There are people who are doomed because of what happened to me, and the one who had the greater share therein was Abdullah bin Ubayy bin Salul. When we came back to Al-Madinah, I was ill for a month, and the people were talking about what the people of the slander were saying, and I knew nothing about it. What upset me when I was ill was that I did not see the kindness I used to see on the part of the Messenger of Allah When I was ill; he would just come in and say, aHoiv is tlmt (lady)? That is what upset me. I did not feel that there was anything wrong until I went out after I felt better, and Umm Mistah went out with me, walking towards Al-Manasi , which is where we used to go to relieve ourselves, and we would not go out for that purpose except at night. This was before we had lavatories close to our houses; our habit was similar to that of the early Arabs in that we went out into the deserts to relieve ourselves, because we considered it troublesome and harmful to have lavatories in our houses. So I went out with Umm Mistah, who was the daughter of Abu Ruhm bin Al-Muttalib bin Abd Manaf, and her mother was the daughter of Sakhr bin Amir, the paternal aunt of Abu Bakr As-Siddiq. Her son was Mistah bin Uthathah bin Abbad bin Al-Muttalib. When we finished what we had to do, the daughter of Abu Ruhm Umm Mistah and I came back towards my house. Umm Mistah stumbled over her apron and said, May Mistah be ruined! I said to her, What a bad thing you have said! Are you abusing a man who was present at Badr? She said, Good grief, have you not heard what he said? I said, What did he say? So she told me what the people of the slander were saying, which made me even more ill. When I returned home, the Messenger of Allah came in to me and greeted me, then he said, iHow is that (lady)? I said to him, Will you give me permission to go to my parents? At that time I wanted to confirm the news by hearing

"Be glad O A'ishah, Allah has declared your innocence ." My mother said to me, Get up and go to him. I said, *By Allah, I will not go to him and I will not give praise to anyone except Allah, may He be glorified, for He is the One Who has proven my innocence. So Allah revealed: iVerily, those who brought forth the slander are a group among you.}, until the ten Ayat. Allah revealed these Ayat concerning my innocence. Abu Bakr, may Allah be pleased with him, who used to spend on Mistah bin Uthathah because he was a close relative and because he was poor, said, By Allah, I will never spend anything on him again after what he has said about A'ishah. Then Allah revealed, 'fit \J\$ jit iAnd let not those among you who are blessed with graces and wealth swear not to give to their kinsmen .} until His saying: %% ft j 3U \$Do you not love that Allah should forgive you? And Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most

Merciful [24:22]. So Abu Bakr said, By Allah, certainly I love that Allah should forgive me. So he resumed spending on Mistah as he had spent on him before, and he said, By Allah, I shall never stop spending on him. The Messenger of Allah jfe asked Zaynab bint Jahsh about my situation, and said, jioJp lit* . w "O Zaynab, what do you know and xvhat have you seen?" She said, O Messenger of Allah, may Allah protect my hearing and my sight. By Allah, I know nothing but good. She is the one who used to compete with me among the wives of the Prophet 2S, but Allah protected her (from telling lies) because of her piety. But her sister Hamnah bint Jahsh kept on

fighting on her behalf, so she was doomed along with those who were doomed. Ibn Shihab said, This is as much as we know about this group of people. '11 It was also by Al-Bukhari and Muslim in their Sahihs from the Hadith of Az-Zuhri,¹²¹ and by Ibn Ishaq also from Az-Zuhri. ¹³¹ He also said: Yahya bin Abbad bin Abdullah bin Az-Zubayr told me from his father, from A ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, and Abdullah bin Abi Bakr bin Muhammad bin Amr bin Hazm Al- Ansari told me from Amrah, from A ishah, (a report) similar to that quoted above. And Allah knows best. Allah s saying: 4"ss\$ ifM \} 4Verily, those who brought forth the slander} means, the lies, falsehood and fabrications. iare a group} means, a gang among you. V" 4Consider it not a bad thingfor you.} O family ofAbu Bakr, 4 1& 4Nay, it is good for you.} means, in this world and the Hereafter, honorable mention in this world and raised status in the Hereafter. Allah demonstrated the esteem with which He regarded the family ofAbu Bakr when He defended A ishah the Mother of the believers, may Allah be pleased with her, by revealing her innocence in the Qur an, iFalsehood cannot come to it from before it or behind it...} [41:42). Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, entered upon her when she was dying, he said to her, Rejoice, for you are the wife of the Messenger of Allah jg and he used to love you; 1 :194. ¹²¹ Path Al-Bari 8 :306 , Muslim 4 :2 ¹²⁹ ¹³¹ Ibn Hisham 3 :309

he did not marry any virgin other than you, and your innocence was revealed from heaven. ot ^ (44 && 4Unto every man among them will be paid that which he had earned of the sin,} means, each of those who spoke about this matter and accused the Mother of the believers A ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, of any immoral action, will have a great share of punishment. i'fft Jj 4ft iand as for him among them who had the greater share therein,} It was said that this referred to the one who initiated the rumors, or that it was the one who collected rumors and spread them among the people. ft ihis will be a great torment.} means, for that. He was Abdullah bin Ubayy bin Salul, may Allah disfigure him and curse him. vj :f:*J u \$6 ' p> x.g L& P *-V1 412. Why then, did not the believers, men and women, when you heard it, think good of their own people and say: "This is an obvious lie?"} 413. Why did they not produce four witnesses against him? Since they have not produced witnesses! Then with Allah, they are the liars.} Disciplining the Believers for spreading the Slander Here Allah disciplines the believers with regard to the matter of A ishah, because some of them spread this evil talk and the slander that had been mentioned. So Allah says:Al-Bari 8:340.

4& iWhy then, when you heard it,} meaning, the talk which accused the Mother of the believers, may Allah be pleased with her, 4the believers, men and women, think good of their own people means, why did they not compare what was said to themselves - if it was not befitting for them then it was even less appropriate for the Mother of the believers, and she was more likely to be innocent. Or it was said that this was revealed about Abu Ayyub Khalid bin Zayd Al-Ansari and his wife, may Allah be pleased with

them. Imam Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar narrated, The wife of Abu Ayyub Khalid bin Zayd Al-Ansari, Umm AyyQb, said to him, O Abu AyyQb, have you heard what the people are saying about A ishah? He said, Tes, and it is all lies. Would you do that, O Umm AyyUb? She said, No, by Allah, I would not do that. He said, And by Allah, A ishah is better than you. When the Qur an was revealed, Allah mentioned those who spoke about the evil deed among the people of the slander, iVerily, those who broughtforth the slander are a group among you.} [24:1] This refers to Hassan and his companions who said what they said. Then Allah said. iWhy then, did not the believers, men, when you heard it, think...} means, as Abu Ayyub and his wife did. 111 Allah s saying: Si ' } ithe believers, men think...} meaning, *why did they not think good, because the Mother of HI At-Tabari 19:129.

An-Nur (13 - 15) (Part-18) the believers is his wife and is closer to him. This is concerned with innermost feelings; iand say :} means, with their tongues, verbally, i"This (charge) is an obvious lie? } means, a clear untruth told about the Mother of the believers, may Allah be pleased with her. What happened should not have been the cause of suspicion. The fact that the Mother of the believers came openly, riding on the camel of Salwan bin Al-Mu attal at midday, with the entire army watching and the Messenger of Allah jg among them, should have made it clear that there was no cause for suspicion. If there had been anything suspicious about the matter, they would not have come openly in this manner in front of so many witnesses; they would have come secretly. On this basis, what the people of the slander said accusing the Mother of the believers was an utter lie, false speech and evil foolish talk, by which people who indulged in it lost out. Allah said: 4Why did they not produce four witnesses against him?} meaning, to prove that what they were sayingwas true. iyL p i\$} 4Since they have not produced witnesses! Then with Allah they are the liars.} Allah has ruled that they are indeed wicked liars. ih% Cif if X2 S?ji> "iif i* ') ill ^ oJ&J 414. Had it not been for the grace ofAllah and His mercy unto you in this world and in the Hereafter, a great torment would have touched you for that whereofyou had spoken.} 425. When you were propagating it with your tongues, and uttering with your mouths that whereofyou had no knowledge,

44 TafsJr Ibn Kathir you counted it a little thing, while with Allah it was very great.} The Grace ofAllah towards the People ofthe Slanderby givingThem the Opportunity to repent Allah says, UjI' (j *uf jJj iHad it not been for the grace ofAllah and His mercy unto you in this world and in the Hereafter,} This is addressed to those who were indulging in discussing the matter of A ishah, informing them that Allah has accepted their repentance in this world, and forgiven them because of their faith in the Hereafter. iwould have touched youfor that whereofyou had spoken .} with regard to the slander. Aa great torment This refers to those who had faith in Allah because of their repentance, such as Mistah, Hassan andHamnah bint Jahsh the sister ofZaynab bint Jahsh. As for the hypocrites who indulged in the slander, such as Abdullah bin Ubayy bin Salti and his like, they are not the ones who are referred to in this Ayah , because they did not have sufficient faith and righteous deeds to balance or cancel out what they had done. By the same token, the threats that were narrated for a specific deed are bound to be carried out, if there is no repentance or sufficient righteous deeds to balance or outweigh it. Then Allah says: AWhen you were propagating it with your tongues,} Mujahid and Said bin Jubayr said, Some ofyou were relating it to others, 111 where one says, 1 heard this from so-and-so, and so-and-so said such and such, and some of them m At-Jabari 19:132

mentioned such and such. Others recited the Ayah: (When you were inventing a lie with your tongues...) In Sahih Al-Bukhari, it is recorded that A'ishah recited it like that.¹¹¹ According to her, the meaning refers to lies which a person persists in telling. The first recitation is preferred and more popular, and the majority recite it that way, but the second is reported from A'ishah, the Mother of the believers. uttering with your mouths that whereof you had no knowledge,} means, you were speaking about something which you knew nothing about. Then Allah says: dlla' X Jbji Li* *(if~i counted it a little thing, while with Allah it was very great. means, you said what you said about the Mother of the believers and you thought that it was a trifling and insignificant matter, but even if she was not the wife of the Prophet jg, it still would not be an insignificant matter - so how about when she is the wife of the Unlettered Prophet, the Seal of the Prophets and Leader of the Messengers 3g? It is a very serious matter with Allah that such a thing should be said about the wife of His Messenger! For Allah, may He be glorified and exalted, feels great fury and anger over such matters, and He would never decree such a thing for the wife of any of His Prophets. If that is the case, then how about the best of the wives of any Prophet, the wife of the best of the sons of Adam in this world and the next? Allah says: 411' X jbjj Lla ^ iyou counted it a little thing, while with Allah it was very great.} Al-Bari 8 :340

In the Two Sahihis it is reported that: (js ^ tSyii '(p 1* fr J 0!" frLULJI ^*, La iili "A man may say a word that angers Allah without realizing how far it will go, and because of that he will be thrown into Hell a distance greater than that between heaven and earths According to another report: Wc I4J jk, And he may not pay any attention to ^P J LJ op. u \ p ft p 4 Q \j& J a 416. And why did you not, when you heard it, say: "It is not rightfor us to speak of this. Glory be to You (O Allah)! This is a great lie."\$ il7. Allah forbids you from it and warns you not to repeat the like of itforever, ifyou are believers> 418. And Allah makes the Ayat plain to you, and Allah is All- Knowing, All-Wise Further Discipline This is further discipline, in addition to the command to think well of people, i.e., if something unbefitting is mentioned about good people, then one should think well of them, and not feel towards them anything but good. Then if a person has any unsuitable thoughts about them, insinuated into his mind and imagination by Shaytan, he should not speak about that, for

the Prophet jg said: 3 ' (d U 141 cJIU- lit jpi jjUi 3 bp Allah will excuse my Ummah for anything that occurs to their minds, so long as they do not speak about it or act upon it . m Fath Al-Bari 11 :3 14 , Muslim 4 :2290

This was reported in the Two SahihisJ Allah s saying: i\%P j U& u i&S. \ 4And why did you not, when you heard it, say: It is not rightfor us to speak of this .} meaning, we should not talk about it or mention it to anyone. l r }Clory be to You (O Allah)! This is a great lie.} means, gloiy be to Allah that such a thing should be said about the wife of His Prophet and close Friend Then Allah says, 4Q ULJ jt&s J 'itpL} iAlldh forbids you from it and warns you not to repeat the like of itforever,} meaning, Allah is forbidding you and warning you from doing anything like this again in the future. Allah says, pr ^} 4if you are believers.} meaning, if you believe in Allah and His Laws, and you respect His Messenger As for those who are described as disbelievers, a different ruling applies in their case. Then Allah says, p at > 4And Allah makes the Ayat plain to you,} meaning, He makes clear to you the rulings of Shari'ah and His divine decrees. 4l4fo fjz.% 4and Allah is All-Knowing, AU-Wise.} means, He knows what is right

for His servants and He is Wise in His Laws and decrees. y-% Git 4 f&ip. /it 4 IU. <\$ 40&& iM %Al-Bari 11:557, Muslim 1:116, 117.

4.19. Verily, those who like that Fahishah should be circulated among those who believe, they will have a painful torment in this world and in the Hereafter. And Allah knows and you know not.} Disciplining Those Who like that Illegal Sexual Intercourse should be circulated among the Believers This is a third instance of discipline directed at those who hear evil talk, believe it to some extent, and start to spread it; they should not spread such talk or pass it on to others. Allah says: 4Verily, those who like that Faltshah should be circulated among those who believe, they will have a painfitl torment meaning, those who like to see evil talk about them (the believers) appear, 4Q% 4 jj p.} ithey will have a painfitl torment in this world} means, because of the prescribed punishment, and in the Hereafter because of the torment in Hell. 4&J& *&& pi 4And Allah knows and you know not.} means, return the matter to Him and you will be guided. Imam

50 Tafsfr Ibn Kathlr kindness towards His servants and Merciful towards them. He accepts the repentance of those who repent to Him from this sin, and purifies those among them who are purified by the prescribed punishment carried out on them. Then Allah says: v iA* you who believe! Follow not the Khutuwat ofShaytan.} meaning, his ways and paths and what he commands. iAnd whosoever follows the footsteps of Shaytan, then, verily, he commands immorality and the evil deeds.} This is a warning given in the most concise and eloquent manner. Ali bin Abi Talhah recorded from Ibn Abbas that ithe Khutuwat of Shaytan} means his deeds.111 akrimah said that it means his evil whispers. Qatadah said: Every sin is one of the footsteps of Shaytan. 121 Abu Mijlaz said: Vowing to commit sin is one of the footsteps of Shaytan. Then Allah says: iAnd had it not been for the grace ofAllah and His mercy on you, not one ofyou would ever have been purefrom sins.} meaning, if He did not help whomever He wills to repent and come back to Him and be purified from Shirk, evil and sin, and whatever bad characteristics each person has according to his nature, no one would ever attain purity and goodness. il&i & | iu' < []} iBut Allah purifies whom He wills} means, among His creation, and He sends astray whomever He wills, leaving him to be doomed in his misguidance and sin. && At-Tabari 3 :301 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 1 :404. AMabari 3:301.

iand Allah is All-Hearer, means, He hears what His servants say, iAll-Knower of who deserves to be guided and who deserves to be misguided. 4ji' 4 [y]i 4',n'^oy jyi- ill! _/iij o 1 VI [ynjuaJj iyjtJj . And / ef nof f/iöse among you who are blessed with graces and wealth swear not to give to their kinsmen, the poor, and tlwse who left their homes for Allah's cause. Let them pardon and forgive. Do you not love that Allah should forgive you? And Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful. UrgingThoseWhohavebeenblessedwithWealth to give and to be tolerant Allah says, v> iAnd let not swear> meaning, make an oath, jjat ithose among you who are blessed with graces } means, those who have the means to give charity and do good, iand wealth} means, good fortune. J-v Ojt)l ly}> ito give to their kinsmen, the poor, and those who left tlieir homesfor Allah's cause.} means, do not swear that you will not uphold the ties of kinship with your relatives who are needy or who migrated for the sake of Allah, which is the ultimate act of kindness in the area ofupholding kinship ties. Allah says, 4'b^j iLet them pardon and forgive.} past insults and bad treatment. This is part of the patience, generosity and kindness of Allah

towards His creation, despite the fact that they wrong themselves. This Ayah was revealed concerning As-Siddiq, may Allah be pleased with him, when he swore that he would not help Mistah bin Uthathah after he said what he said about A'ishah, as we have already seen in the Hadith. When Allah revealed the innocence of the Mother of the believers, A'ishah, and the believers were happy and content with the outcome of this incident, and those believers who had talked about the matter repented, and the prescribed punishment had been carried out upon those on whom it was carried out, then Allah started to soften the heart of As-Siddiq towards his relative Mistah bin Uthathah. Mistah was the cousin of As-Siddiq, the son of his maternal aunt, and he was a poor man with no wealth except whatever Abu Bakr spent on him. He was one of those who had migrated for the sake of Allah. He had invented the lies and the slander, but then Allah accepted his repentance from that and the prescribed punishment was carried out on him. As-Siddiq was known for his generosity and he did favors to his relatives and strangers alike. When this Ayah was revealed: *Slit 'jfa j 0 \$Do you not love that Allah should forgive you?*}, which shows that the reward fits the action, and that if you forgive others, you will be forgiven, then As-Siddiq said, Of course, by Allah, we love - O our Lord - that You should forgive us. Then he resumed his spending on Mistah and said, By Allah I will never stop spending on him. This was to counteract what he had said previously, By Allah I will never spend on him. This proves that he deserved to be called As-Siddiq, may Allah be pleased with him and his daughter. & bh% Q% 4 \f4 sit ^ rri* % (+0J V* (k i23. Verily, those who accuse chaste believing women, who never even think of anything touching their chastity and are good believers - are cursed in this life and in the Hereafter, and

Ati-Nur (23 - 25) (Part-18) for them will be a great torment.) 424. On the Day when their tongues, their hands, and their legs will bear witness against them as to what they used to do. 425. On that Day Allah will pay them the recompense of their deeds in full, and they will know that Allah, He is the Manifest Truth.) A Threat to Those who accuse Chaste Women, Who never even think of anything touching their Chastity and are Good Believers This is a warning and threat from Allah to those who accuse chaste women, who never even think of anything effecting their chastity since they are good believers. The Mothers of the believers are more entitled to be included in this category than any other chaste woman, especially the one who was the reason for this Ayah being revealed: A'ishah bint As-Siddiq, may Allah be pleased with them both. All of the scholars agree that whoever slanders her or makes accusations against her after what has been said in this Ayah, is a disbeliever, because of his being obstinate with the Qur'an. The same ruling applies to all of the Mothers of the believers. 4bb%Q* a 4are cursed in this life and in the Hereafter,) This is like the Ayah: 4&--U Sf AH 0\$ 4Verily, those who annoy Allah and His Messenger,) [33:57] Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, This is about A'ishah, and whoever does anything similar nowadays to

jlala J^dj 5^ c-dJ j L*i U IjJu : Jjjj f ^Jl jLj cL ^Because of the way a person will dispute with his Lord. He will say, O Lord, did you not protect me from doing wrong?" Allah will say, "Of course," The person will say, "I will not accept for anyone to give testimony concerning me except myself." Allah will say, "You are sufficient as a witness against yourself." Then a seal will be put upon his mouth and it will be said to his faculties, "Speak." So they will speak about his deeds. Then he will be permitted to speak, and he will say, "Away with you! I was only speaking in your defence/" This was recorded by Muslim and An-Nasab 111 >>' i , v) iOn that Day Allah will pay Dinahum,} Ibn Abbas said, iDinahum} Meaning their account. Every time Dinahum appears in the Qur'an it means *their account. This was

also the view of other scholars.¹²¹ i'jdi &2& 3a&fr iand they will know that Allah, He is the Manifest Truth.} means, His promise, His threat and His reckoning are all just and there is no unfairness in them. dX \$ o'i.LU jfy. cJ+JbiJ) } j. v ' t'.i ? ?*-' I- / ' p** - ^i>*- 426. Bad statements are for bad people and bad people for bad statements. Good statements are for good people and good people for good statements: such are innocent of (every) bad statement which they say; for them is forgiveness, and honored provision.} 2969Jabari 19:141.

The Goodness of A ishahbecause She is married to the best ofMankind Ibn Abbas said, Evil words are for evil men, and evil men are for evil words; good words are for good men and good men are for good words. This was revealed concerning A ishah and the people of the slander. This was also narrated from Mujahid, Ata , Said bin Jubayr, Ash-ShaTai, Al-Hasan bin Abu Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Habib bin Abi Thabit and Ad-Dahhak, and it was also the view favored by Ibn Jarir. * He interpreted it to mean that evil speech is more suited to evil people, and good speech is more suited to good people. What the hypocrites attributed to Aishah was more suited to them, and she wasmost suited to innocence and having nothing to do with them. Allah said: 44>*AA tUyJ isuch (good people) are innocent of (every) bad statement which they say;} Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, Evil women are for evil men and evil men are for evil women, and good women are for good men and good men are for good women. This also necessarily refers back to what they said, i.e., Allah would not have made A ishah the wife of His Messenger jg unless she had been good, because he is the best of the best of mankind. If she had been evil, she would not have been a suitable partner either according to His Laws or His decree. Allah said: 4)jZA a isuch are innocent of (every) bad statement which they say;} meaning, they are remote from what the people of slander and enmity say. iW& ifor them is forgiveness,} means, because of the lies that were told about them, At-Tabari 19 :142 , Ad-DurrAl-ManthOr6:167. At-Tabari 19:143, 144. At-Tabari 19:144.

- 29) (Part-18) 57 j& ror mm" b* s - / ztz <* *> ^V'-Jz x f*. >'-* "" J * I*' Ajys f~Lx>- \$ ^ If-3 Jij ^r*j i)yC^aA*f/^~ii'o)^cSS^ lilJ'i / > .'?'-" * y- ' \:'. y '- ,*V ' : *r ^)04^ . ^ S^A)'Ss^P-'l^j >-^ J-3^!JJ<^zJft \$<< \$ &&#^kSlzJ^Ui 4andhonoredprovision. ^ meaning, with Allah in the Gardens of Delight. This implies a promise that she will be the wife of the Messenger of Allah % in Paradise. "jU.JL5 V !*.l# ^ V&? j i' *V ->*, *> > v _^o"- ,i wj-i t/ // " J */< . Ill/ "z L+i"i jjt b-i-b b-jU_3 j&fr 5 J&> i>-*^f J oj A/ z _//"/> i .Z *> ' Zi / . ^ lj^-1 j* !>"*y' j-j i^> s C 56 p & J & S\$ ">" ... --s.' . *' : tf *; " _/ Uj-i 4^" llj b jizu 4ib 427. O t/OH 10/10 believe! Enter not houses other than your own, until you have asked permission and greeted those in them; that is betterfor you, in order that you may remember> 428. And if you find no one therein, still enter not until permission has been given . And ifyou are asked to go back, go back, for it is purer far you . And Allah is All-Knoiver ofwhat you do.} 429. There is no sin on you that you enter houses uninhabited, you have any interest in them. And Allah has knowledge of what you reveal and what you conceal.}

If any one ofyou asks for permission three times and it is not given, then lethim go awayj

given the greeting three times and Sa d had returned the greeting three times, but he did not let him hear him [i.e., Sa d responded in a low voice]. So the Prophet jg went back, and Sa d followed him and said, O Messenger of Allah, may my father and mother be ransomed for you! You did not give any greeting but 1 responded to you, but I did not let you hear me. I wanted to get more of your Salams and

blessings. Then he admitted him to his house and offered him some raisins. The Prophet ﷺ ate, and when he finished, he said, *Yūhu Laka* May the righteous eat your food, may the angels send blessings upon you and may those who are fasting break their fast with you.^d It should also be known that the one who is seeking permission to enter should not stand directly in front of the door; he should have the door on his right or left, because of the Hadith recorded by

The Group recorded that Jabir said, I came to the Prophet ﷺ with something that was owed by my father and knocked at the door. He said, *"Ya Jibri"* Who is that? I said, I am! He said, *til ui* *"? I?o as ifhe disliked it. 111* He did not like it because this word tells you nothing about who is saying it, unless he clearly states his name or the name by which he is known, (nickname) otherwise everyone could call himself Me , and it does not fulfill the purpose of asking permission to enter, which is to put people at their ease, as commanded in the Ayah. Al- Awfi narrated from Ibn Abbas, Putting people at ease means seeking permission to enter. This was also the view of others.¹²¹ Imam

& i* oi iVerily, the most honorable of you with Allah is the one who has the most Taqwa (49:13], But (now) they say that the most honorable of them with Allah is the one who has the biggest house. As for seeking permission, the people have forgotten all about it. I said, Should I seek permission to enter upon my orphan sisters who are living with me in one house? He said, Yes. I asked him to make allowances for me but he refused and said, Do you want to see them naked? I said, No. He said, Then ask for permission to enter. I asked him again and he said, Do you want to obey Allah? I said, Yes. He said, Then ask for permission. Ibn Jurayj said, Ibn Tawus told me that his father said, There are no women whom I hate to see naked more than those who are my Mahrams. He was very strict on this point. Ibn Jurayj narrated that Az-Zuhri said, I heard Huzayl bin Shurahbll Al-Awdi Al-A ma (say that) he heard Ibn Mas*ud say, You have to seek permission to enter upon your mothers. Ibn Jurayj said, I said to Ata : Does a man have to seek permission to enter upon his wife? He said, No, it can be understood that this is not obligatory, but it is better for him to let her know that he is coming in so as not to startle her, because she may be in a state where she does not want him to see her. Abu JaTar bin Jarir narrated from the nephew of Zaynab - the wife of Abdullah bin Mas*Qd - that Zaynab, may Allah be pleased with her, said, When Abdullah came back from some errand and reached the door, he would clear his throat and spit, because he did not want to come suddenly and find us in a state he disliked. Its chain of narration is Sahdi. & iApj ^ i5 V ! C # > 40 you who believe! Enter not houses other than your own, until you have asked permission and greeted those in them Muqatil bin Hayyan said: During the Jahiliyyah, when a man (i) At-Tabari 19:148. This reference applies to the previous four narrations , as well

met his friend, he would not greet him with Salam; rather he would say Huyyita Sabahan or Huyyita Masa an" [equivalent to Good morning or Good evening]. This was the greeting among the people at that time. They did not seek permission to enter one another s houses; a man might walk straight in and say, I have come in, and so on. This was difficult for a man to bear, as he might be with his wife. So Allah changed all that by enjoining covering and chastity, making it pure and free of any sin or impropriety. So Allah said: *ipp& iAAj iA^ v p: jS ife}* 40 you who believe! Enter not houses other than your own, until you have asked permission and greeted those in them...* What Muqatil said is good. Allah said: *ip pi}* ithat is better for you,} meaning, seeking permission to enter in is better for you

because it is better for both parties, the one who is seeking permission to enter and the people inside the house. pi} iin order that you may remember.} iAnd ifyou find no one therein, still enter not until permission has been given .} This has to do with the way in which one deals with other people s property without their permission. If he wants to, he can give permission, and if he wants to he can refrain from giving permission. 10A 'P Jj if)} iAnd if you are asked to go back, go back, for it is purer for you.} m Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6:176.

An-Niir (27 - 29) (Part-18) means, if you are turned away at the door, before or after permission has been given, ip&\$ igo back, for it is purerfor you.} means, going back is purer and better for you. i%4&ZC iAnd Allah is All-Knower ofwhat you do.} Qatadah said that one of the emigrants said: All my life I tried to follow this Ayah, but if I asked for permission to enter upon one ofmy brothers and he asked me to go back, I could not do so happily, although Allah says, iAnd if you are asked to go back, go back, for it is purer for you. And Allah is All-Knower ofwhat you do.} [1] \p\$ Si# iAnd ifyou are asked to go back, go back....} Said bin Jubayr said, This means, do not stand at people s doors. ijipS pZ JpZ -'PP P} iThere is no sin on you that you enter houses uninhabited,} This Ayah is more specific than the one that comes before it, because it states that it is permissible to enter houses where there is nobody, if one has a reason for doing so, such as houses that are prepared for guests - if he has been given permission once, then this is sufficient. Ibn Jurayj said, Ibn Abbas said: iEnter not houses other than your own,} then this was abrogated and an exception was made, and Allah said: i%j 2 gpZ [3 jjLZ 01pZ PpJ# m At-Tabari 19:150.

iThere is no sin on you that you enter houses uninhabited, (when) you have any interest in them . \$ This was also narrated from Ikrimah¹¹¹ and Al-Hasan Al- Basri. C \$.fif*^ >' *" 430. Tell the believing men to lower their gaze, and protect their private parts . That is purerfor them . Verily, Allah is All- Aware ofwhat they do.\$> TheCommand to lower the Gaze This is a command from Allah to His believing servants, to lower their gaze from looking at things that have been prohibited for them. They should look only at what is permissible for them to look at, and lower their gaze from forbidden things. If it so happens that a person s gaze unintentionally falls upon something forbidden, he should quickly look away.

" Jc- ik-ij JUL ^Wlj Sjj .LiSj i j-ijl slower your gaze, return the greeting of Saldm, enjoin what is good andforbid what is evilV 1 Abu Al-Qasim Al-Baghawi recorded that Abu Umamah said, I heard the Messenger of Allah jg say: lip "fi Zjli- lij I^JUSI" \ \yB&} Ij. jjf j i v- -APj li[j k ' Guarantee me six things and I will guarantee you Paradise: when any one of you speaks, he should not lie; if he is entrusted with something, he should not betray that trust; ifhe makes a promise, he slwuld not break it; loiuer your gaze; restrain your hands; and protect your private parts .") Since looking provokes the heart to evil, Allah commanded (the believers) to protect their private parts just as he commanded them to protect their gaze which can lead to that. So he said: iTell the believing men to lower their gaze, and protect their private parts.} Sometimes protecting the private parts may involve keeping them from committing Zina, as Allah says: iAnd those wlto guard their chastity} [23:5]. Sometimes it may involve not looking at certain things, as in the Hadith in Musnad Ahmad and the Sunan: ajJL-yj t* j\ Si Ay "Guard your private parts except from your wife and those whom your right hands possess . Al-Bari 5 : 134 [2) Tarikh Al-Khatlb 7:392, At-Tabarani in Al-Mu jam Al-Kabir 8:314, Ibn Hibban in Al-Majruhm

2 :204. Ahmad 5:3, Abu Dawud 4:304, At-Tirmidhi 8:53, An-Nasal in Al- Kubra 5 :313, Ibn Majah 1 : 618

iiU'i iThat is purer for them .} means, it is purer for their hearts and better for their commitment to religion, as it was said: Whoever protects his gaze, Allah will illuminate his understanding, or his heart. ill iVerily, Allah is All-Aware of ivhat they do.} This is like the Ayah : 4 Cj yz} iAllah knows the fraud of the eyes and all that the breasts conceal.} [40 :19] In the Sahih it is recorded that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said that the Messenger of Allah said: uj jBtji jyzit i Jus byJ ty\ k \$ Jj. _J" J k jSiVl tijj iJLiJl uU-Ul & j j k y-&' JJji The son of Adam has his share of Zina decreed for him, and it will commit that which has been decreed. The Zina of the eyes is looking; the Zina of the tongue is speaking; the Zina of the ears is listening; the Zina of the hands is striking; and the Zina of the feet is walking. The soul wishes and desires, and the private parts confirm or deny that ." It was recorded by

* isg c pi ^ v; 5^" & ! i djJHri\$ LI!Ljr ji' Ijjyj lrgi> 431. And tell the believing women to lower their gaze, and protect their private parts and not to show off their adornment except that which is apparent, and to draw their veils all over their Juyiib and not to reveal their adornment except to their husbands, or their fathers, or their husband s fathers, or their sons, or their husband's sons, or their brothers or their brother's sons, or their sister's sons, or their women, or their right hand possessions, or the Tdbi"tn among men who do not have desire, or children who are not aware of the nakedness of women. And let them not stamp their feet so as to reveal what they hide of their adornment. And all of you beg Allah to forgive you all, O believers, that you may be successful.> The Rulings ofHijab This is a command from Allah to the believing women, and jealousy on His part over the wives of His believing servants. It is also to distinguish the believing women from the women of the Jdhiliyyah and the deeds of the pagan women. The reason for the revelation of this Ayah was mentioned by Muqatil bin Hayyan, when he said: We heard - and Allah knows best - that Jabir bin Abdullah Al-Ansari narrated that Asma bint Murshidah was in a house of hers in Bani Harithah, and the women started coming in to her without lower garments so that the anklets on their feet could be seen, along with their chests and forelocks. Asma said: *How ugly this is! Then Allah revealed: 4f jA It 4And tell the believing women to lower their gaze ...y^ And Allah says: 4And tell the believing women to lower their gaze} I 1 * This is a Mursal narration recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim , no. 14389.

68 Tafstr Ibn Kathlr meaning, from that which Allah has forbidden them to look at, apart from their husbands. [Some] scholars said that it is permissible for women to look at non-Mahram men without desire, as it was recorded in the SahXh that the Messenger of Allah was watching the Ethiopians playing with spears in the Masjid on the day of Id, and A ishah the Mother of the believers was watching them from behind him and he was concealing her from them, until she got bored and went away. iand protect their private parts}. Said bin Jubayr said: From immoral actions. Abu Al- Aliyah said: Every Ayah of the Qur an in which protecting the private parts is mentioned means protecting them from Zina, except for this Ayah- cMAj? iand protect their private parts}, which means protecting them from being seen by anybody." iand not to show off their adornment except that which is apparent,} means, they should not show anything of their adornment to non-Mahram men except for whatever it is impossible to hide. Ibn Maslid said: Such as clothes and outer garments, Meaning what the Arab women used to wear of the veil which covered their clothes and whatever showed from

underneath the outer garment. There is no blame on her for this, because this is something that she cannot conceal. Similar to that is what appears of her lower garment and what she cannot conceal. Al-Hasan, Ibn Sirin, Abu Al-Jawza, Ibrahim An-Nakhal and others also had the same view as Ibn MasHd.l4 * * Al-Bukhari no. 454, etc. Al-Tabari 19:154. Al-Tabari 19:156. [41 Al-Tabari 19:156.

and to draw their veils all over their Juyub} means that they should wear the outer garment in such a way as to cover their chests and ribs, so that they will be different from the women of the JahiUyyah, who did not do that but would pass in front of men with their chests completely uncovered, and with their necks, forelocks, hair and earrings uncovered. So Allah commanded the believing women to cover themselves, as He says: 40 Prophet! Tell your wives and your daughters and the women of the believers to draw their cloaks all over their bodies. That will be better, that they should be known, so as not to be annoyed [33 :59] And in this noble Ayah He said: tlr^r" UP and to draw their (Khumur) veils all over their JuyQb> Khumur (veils) is the plural of Khimar, which means something that covers, and is what is used to cover the head. This is

what is known among the people as a veil.

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3937–3948]

Said bin Jubayr said: and to draw} means to pull it around and tie it securely. &up*y itheir veils all aver their Juyub} means, over their necks and chests so that nothing can be seen of them.

70 Tafstr Ibn Kathir aprons and Akhtamar*'* themselves with them. 121 He also narrated from Safiyyah bint Shaybah that A ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, used to say: When this Ayah: and to draw their veils all over their Juyub was revealed, they took their Izars (waistsheets) and tore them at the edges, and Akhtamarthemselves with them . and not to reveal their adornment except to their husbands, or their fathers, or their husband's fathers, or their sons, or their husband's sons, or their brothers or their brother's sons, or their sister's sons,} All of these are a woman s close relatives whom she can never marry (Mahram) and it is permissible for her to show her adornments to them, but without making a wanton display of herself. Ibn Al-Mundhir recorded that Ikrimah commented on this Ayah, icLpP \$ <<*>& iPA v] y id and not to reveal their adornment except to their husbands, or theirfathers, or their husband's fathers...}, The paternal uncle and maternal uncle are not mentioned here, because they may describe a woman to their sons, so a woman should not remove her Khimar in front of her paternal or maternal uncle. With regard to the husband, all of this is for his sake, so she should try her best when adorning herself for him, unlike thewayshe should appear in front of others. Ill (2J HI However , it is obvious that others do not agree with this interpretation . It is not the place of the translators of this Tafstr to present their own views, especially when they may contradict the author s Fath Al-Bari 8 :347 Path Al-Bari 8 :347 At-Tabari 19:160.

ijf&& ^or their women, this means that she may also wear her adornment in front of other

hermaphrodite, used to enter upon the family of the Messenger of Allah sg and they used to consider him as one of those who do not have desire, but then the Messenger of Allah 2 came in when he was describing a woman with four rolls of fat in front and eight behind. The Messenger of Allah sg said, 'i U |JLii IJU Vb eLo! I think this person knoius what is they are; he should never enter upon you . He

expelled him, and he stayed in Al-Bayda and only came on Fridays to get food. 11 ! ior children who are not aware of the nakedness of women.> Because they are so young they do not understand anything about women or their Awrah or their soft speech or their enticing ways of walking and moving. If a child is small and does not understand that, there is nothing wrong with him entering upon women, but if he is an adolescent or approaching adolescence, so that he knows and understands these things, and can make a distinction between who is beautiful and who is not, then he should not enter upon women. It was recorded in the Two Sahihs that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: aAvoid entering upon women. It was said, O Messenger of Allah, what do you think about the male in-laws? He said: The male in-law is death. Muslim 4:1715, 1716, Ahmad 6:152, Abu Dawud 5:224, An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 5 :395 Fath Al-Bari 5 :242, Muslim 4:1171. Al-Hamu refers to the male in-laws that the woman may marry if she was divorced from her husband

Ati-Nur (31) (Part-18) The Etiquette of Women walking in the Street Allah ﷻ saying: iAtid let them not stamp their feet...} During Jahiliyyah, when women walked in the street wearing anklets and no one could hear them, they would stamp their feet so that men could hear their anklets ringing. Allah forbade the believing women to do this. By the same token, if there is any other kind of adornment that is hidden, women are forbidden to make any movements that would reveal what is hidden, because Allah says: iAnd let them not stamp their feet. . .} to the end of it. From that, women are also prohibited from wearing scent and perfume when they are going outside the home, lest men should smell their perfume. Abu Isa

>> 4l c8j^t ' 4* Ot '\$ in 432. And marry those among you who are single (Al-Ayama) and the pious of your servants and maidservants. If they be poor, Allah will enrich them out of His bounty. And Allah is All-Sufficient, All-Knowing.} 433. And let those who find not the financial means for marriage keep themselves chaste, until Allah enriches them of His bounty. And such of your servants as seek a writing (of emancipation), give them such writing, if you find that there is good and honesty in them. And give them something (yourselves) out of the wealth of Allah which He has bestowed upon you. And force not your slave-girls to prostitution, if they desire chastity, in order that you may make a gain in the goods of this worldly life. But if anyone compels them, then after such compulsion, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} 434. And indeed We have sent down for you Ayat that make things plain, and the example of those who passed away before you, and an admonition for those who have Taqwa.} The Command to marry These clear Ayat include a group of unambiguous rulings and firm commands. iAnd marry those among you wlu> are single (Al-Ayama)....} This is a command to many. The Prophet ﷺ said: j j.W.1] lli S;Gl {jA < > QJ j. ^jU ^j 'st\L \ "0 young men, whoever among you can afford to get married, let him marry, for it is more effective in lowering the gaze and protecting the private parts. Whoever cannot do that, then let him fast, for it is a protection for him. This was recorded in the Two Sahihs from the Hadith of Ibn Mas^d. * In the Sunan, it was recorded from more than one m Path Al-Bari 9:14, Muslim 2:1019.

An-Nur (32 - 34) (Part-18): "There are three whom it is a right upon Allah to help: one who gets married seeking chastity; a slave who makes a contract with his master with the aim of buying his freedom ; and one who fights for the sake of Allah. This was recorded by Imam Ahmad, At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasal and Ibn MajahJ The Prophet ﷺ performed the marriage of a man who owned nothing but his

waist wrap, and could not even buy a ring made of iron, but he still married him to that woman, making the Mahr his promise to teach her whatever he knew of the Qur'an. And it is known from the generosity and kindness of Allah that He provided him with whatever was sufficient for her and for him. The Command to keep Oneself Chaste if One is not able to get married Allah's saying: / r .if"

78 Tafcir Ibn Kathir J f^L j\$ Jif) AAnd whoever of you have not the means wherewith to wed free believing women) until His statement; iP% 142&) Abut it is better for you that you practise self-restraint) [4 :25 meaning, it is better for you to be patient and refrain from marrying slave-girl, because any child that is bom will also be a slave. jj*- "aL Aand Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful) [4 :25]. AO& OJ V i "jjf AAnd let those who find not the financial means for marriage keep themselves chaste,) Iknmah said, This refers to a man who sees a woman and it is as if he feels desire; if he has a wife then let him go to her and fulfill his desire with her, and if he does not have a wife, then let him ponder the kingdom of heaven and earth until Allah grants him means of livelihood. The Command to grant Slaves a Contract of Emancipation 4* jj pjzppp J L . iffo) AAnd such of your servants as seek a writing (of emancipation) give them such writing, if you find that there is good and honesty in them.) This is a command from Allah to slave-owners: if their servants ask them for a contract of emancipation, they should write it for them, provided that the servant has some skill and means of earning so that he can pay his master the money that is stipulated in the contract. Al-Bukhari said: Rawh narrated from Ibn Jurayj: 1 said to Ata , If I know that my servant has money, is it obligatory for me to write him a contract of emancipation? He said, I do

N, not think it can be anything but obligatory. Amr bin Dinar said: I said to Ata , Are you narrating this from anybody? He said, No, then he told me that MQsa bin Anas told him that Sirin, who had a lot of money, asked Anas for a contract of emancipation and he refused. So he went to Umar (bin Al-Khattab), may Allah be pleased with him, and he said, Write it for him. He refused, so Umar hit him with his whip and recited, igive them such writing, if you find that there is good and honesty in them Then he wrote the contract. This was mentioned by Al- Bukhari with a disconnected chain of narration. 11 It was also narrated by Abdur-Razzaq who said Ibn Jurayj told them: I said to Ata , If I know that my servant has some money, is it obligatory for me to write him a contract of emancipation? He said, do not think it can be anything but obligatory. 12 [It was also said by Amr bin Dinar who said, I said to Ata , Are you narrating this from anybody? He said, No.) Ibn Jarir recorded that Sirin wanted Anas bin Malik to write a contract of emancipation and he delayed, then Umar said to him, You should certainly write him a contract of emancipation. Its chain of narrators is Sahih, 3 Allah's saying: (i\} itfyou find that there is good and honesty in them.) Some of them said (this means) trustworthiness. Some said: Honesty, and others said: A skill and ability to earn. 4And give them something out of the wealth of Allah which He has bestowed upon you.) This is the share of the wealth of Zakdh that Allah stated to be their right. This is the opinion of Al-Hasan, Abdur-Rahman Al-B&ri 5:219. Abdur-Razz&q 8 : 371 Tabari 19:167.

bin Zayd bin Aslam and his father and Muqatil bin Hayyan. It was also the opinion favored by Ibn Jarir. Ofif "j(JU ji gioe them something out of the wealth of Allah which He has bestowed upon you Ibrahim An-Nakhal said, This is urging the people, their masters and others. This was also the view of Buraydah

bin Al-Husayb Al-Aslami and Qatadah. Ibn Abbas said: Allah commanded the believers to help in freeing slaves.

The Prohibition of forcing One's Slave-Girls to commit

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3948–3957]

Zina. Allah's saying: if 1A/3 iAnd force not your slave-girls to prostitution Among the people of the Jahiliyyah, there were some who, if he had a slave-girl, he would send her out to commit Zina and would charge money for that, which he would take from her every time. When Islam came, Allah forbade the believers to do that. The reason why this Ayah was revealed, according to the reports of a number of earlier and later scholars of Tafsir, had to do with Abdullah bin Ubayy bin Salul. He had slave-girls whom he used to force into prostitution so that he could take their earnings and because he wanted them to have children which would enhance his status, or so he claimed. Reports narrated on this Topic In his Musnad, Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr

An-Nur (32 - 34) (Part-18 revealed. Al-A mash narrated from Abu Sufyan that Jabir said concerning this Ayah, This was revealed about a slave-girl belonging to Abdullah bin Ubayy bin Salul whose name was Musaykah. He used to force her to commit immoral actions, but there was nothing wrong with her and she refused. Then Allah revealed this Ayah: 4And force not your saying; ' ">.' slave-girls to prostitution,} until His Crf^l 'ey \$ 1 yj} 4But if anyone compels them, then after such compulsion, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful

meaning, from the money they earn and their children. The Messenger of Allah forbade the money earned by the cupper, the prostitute and the fortune-teller. According to another report: V-JKJI The earnings of a prostitute are evil, the earnings of a cupper are evil, and the price of a dog is eviljW Oft'JI Cri'-ti\$ o iBut if anyone compels them, then after such compulsion, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful meaning, towards them, as has already been stated in the Hadith narrated from Jabir . 131 Ibn Abi Talhah narrated that Ibn Abbas said, If you do that, then Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful, and their sin will be on the one who forced them to do that. 141 This was also the view of Mujahid, Ata Al-Khurasani, Al-A mash and Qatadah . After explaining these rulings in detail, Allah says: iAnd indeed We have sent down for you Ayat that make things plain,} meaning, in the Qur'an there are Ayat which are clear and explain matters in detail. oi *!&- ^' Si iand the example of those who passed away before you,} means, reports about the nations of the past and what happened to them when they went against the commandments of Allah, as Allah says: 3:1198 Muslim 3:1199 131 An-Nasal in Al-Kubrd 6 :419 At-Tabari 19:175 At-Tabari 19:175, 176, Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6:195

iAnd We made them a precedent, and an example to later generations.} [43:56]; We made them a lesson, i.e., a rebuke for committing sin and forbidden deeds. ifor those who have Taqwa.} meaning, for those who remember and fear Allah. fa fafa ~far-> 4 {fat Q. 'fjPfa -jy> JS i fal fa. ' / % V 'f-y-j 'fafa-T - Jd au'j j;lil J^pV' *u' "liJ jp "#' cfJ^? d6 -U* J'-i - 435. A//fl/i is the Light of the heavens and the earth. The parable of His Light is as a niche and within it a lamp : the lamp is in a glass, the glass as it were a star Durriyyun, lit from a blessed tree, an olive, neither of the east nor of the west, whose oil would almost glow forth, though no fire touched it. Light upon Light! Allah guides to His Light whom He

wills. And Allah sets forth parables for mankind, and Allah is All-Knower of everything.} The Parable of the Light of Allah Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said: iAllah is the Light of the heavens and the earth.} means, the Guide of the inhabitants of the heavens and the earth. Ibn Jurayj said: Mujahid and Ibn Abbas said concerning the Ayah. iAllah is the Light of the heavens and the earth.} He is controlling their affairs and their stars and sun and moon. Jabari 19:177. 2| At-Tabari 19:177.

As-Suddi said concerning the Ayah: jy i\$} 4Allah is the Light of the heavens and the earth.} by His Light the heavens and earth are illuminated. In the Two Sahihs, it is recorded that Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said: When the Messenger of Allah ^ got up to pray at night, he would say: jy ^ - W cslfLLil siu 'Crte iyj oiyLiii O Allah, to You be praise, You are the Sustainer of heaven and earth and whoever is in them. To You be praise, You are the Light of the heavens and the earth and whoever is in them, a' 11 It was narrated that Ibn Mas'ad said, There is no night or day with your Lord; the Light of the Throne comes from the Light of His Face. 121 4The parable of His Light} There are two views concerning the meaning of the pronoun (His). The first is that it refers to Allah, may He be glorified and exalted, meaning that the parable of His guidance in the heart of the believer is as a niche} This was the view of Ibn Abbas.131 The second view is that the pronoun refers to the believer, which is indicated by the context of the words and implies that the parable of the light in the heart of the believer is as a niche. So the heart of the believer and what he is naturally inclined to of guidance and what he learns of the Qur'an which is in accordance with his natural inclinations are, as Allah says: j\$} Fath Al-B&ri 5 : 3 , Muslim 1 :532. See the discussion of Ayah no. 86 of Surat Al-Mu'minun. At-Jabari 19:179.

iCan they who rely on a clear proof from their Lord, and whom a witness from Him recites it (can they be equal with the disbelievers)} [11:17]. The heart of the believer in its purity and clarity is likened to a lamp in transparent and jewel-like glass, and the Qur'an and Shar'ah by which it is guided are likened to good, pure, shining oil in which there is no impurity or deviation. ias (if there were) a niche} Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Muhammad bin Kab and others said, This refers to the position of the wick in the lamp 111 This is well-known, and hence Allah then says: ife*& iand within it a lamp.} This is the flame that burns brightly. Or it was said that the niche is a niche in the house. This is the parable given by Allah of obedience towards Him. Allah calls obedience to Him as light, then He calls it by other numerous names as well. Ubayy bin Kab said, The lamp is the light, and this refers to the Qur'an and the faith that is in his heart. 121 As-Suddi said, It is the lamp. 4the lamp is in a glass,} means, this light is shining in a clear glass. Ubayy bin Kab and others said, This is the likeness of the heart of the believer. 131 4the glass as it were a star Durriyyun,} Some authorities recite the word Durriyyun with a Dammah on the Dal and without a Hamzah, which means pearls, i.e., as if it were a star made of pearls (Dun). Others recite it as Dirri'un or Durri'un, with a Kasrah on the Dal, or Dammah on the Dal, and with a Hamzah at the end, which means reflection [Dir], because if something is shone on the star it becomes brighter than at any other time. The Arabs call the stars they do not know DararL Ubayy bin At-Tabari 19:180, 183. At-Tabari 19:181 Tabari 19:178

so the sun reaches it morning and evening, so it is not counted as being in the east or in the west. i whose oil would almost glow forth (of itself), though no fire touched it.} Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said (this means) because the oil itself is shining. 4jy\$ 4Light upon Light!} Al-'Awfi narrated from Ibn Abbas that this meant the faith and deeds of a person.12 ' As-Suddi said: 4Light upon Light!}

Light of the fire and the light of the oil: when they are combined they give light, and neither of them can give light without the other. Similarly the light of the Qur'an and the light of faith give light when they are combined, and neither can do so without the other. 13 ' 4&J o* -jyyi *** 4Allah guides to His Light whom He wills.} means, Allah shows the way to the ones whom He chooses, as it says in the Hadith recorded by Imam Ahmad from Abdullah bin Amr, who said, I heard the Messenger of Allah say: JA ojj JA (j*J* ^ -fi. Ji\ p idtj iaii jiu- JiS 2)1 :Jji\ Jlj.il> ILu>- i ijy *Allah created His creation in darkness, then on the same day He sent His Light upon them. Whoever was touched by His Light on that day will be guided and whoever was missed will be led astray. Hence I say: the pens have dried in accordance with the knowledge of Allah, may He be glorifiedJ 14' At-Tabari 19:183. 121 Al-Tabari 19:182. ' Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :202 2 :176.

j&'f& -rrir-HJ) 4And Allah sets forth parables for mankind, and Allah is All-Knower of everything.} Having mentioned this parable of the Light of His guidance in the heart of the believer, Allah ends this Ayah with the words: 4^-Af \Zy iJity. "#-rlr*K> 4And Allah sets forth parables for mankind, and Allah is All-Knower of everything meaning, He knows best who deserves to be guided and who deserves to be led astray. Imam

Ati-Niir (36 - 38) (Part-18) Too e Igjf jlljj pAJj_> "*" / / y, *V** .// ^ t-jySp.^iaP'i lj^p t_"L-^rtjO"lil,j^ L~i 0JL^jJ.s 2Upli I lai'A ^ f J 4j_sjj ,0 "*" '.*< * /> > o' "*" # - 4 ' . ^-} iaJy 4^^:IT*r, . "-*" \> *'t> f\ rf >> -/v \$J^U5^f5 . . Ao" ^ /," !^ -//*' '/^^ < ^ ij^gap Its chain of narrators is good (Jayyid) although they (Al-Bukhari and Muslim) did not record it. J ft jil o ! gs. j .f ^=4j v jc, ;n:^'ij jijJC ?*' i5 o* J* X> tp" ^l>\$\ 0 d& c Pi & i'i : 4^Pa " ^ y>- (J, T^AyyL-^ -A" ^ a->_ . /" /louses wliidi Allah has ordered to be raised, in them His Name is remembered. Therein glorify Him in the mornings and in the evenings,) . Men whom neither trade nor business diverts from the remembrance of Allah nor from performing the Salah nor from giving the Zakat . They fear a Day when hearts and eyes will be overturned.) . That Allah may reward them according to the best of their deeds, and add even more for them out of His grace. And Allah provides without measure to whom He wills.)

The Virtues of the Masjids, the Correct Etiquette, and

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3957–3976]

the Virtues of Those who take care of them Having likened the heart of the believer and what it contains of guidance and knowledge to a lamp lit with good oil shining in a clear glass, Allah then states where it belongs, which is in the Masjids, the places on earth that are most beloved to

remembered, Allah will build for him a house in Paradise .s' 1

O Allah, send blessings on him, O Allah, have mercy on him.

A iM x 1/om should face (Him only) in each and every Masjid, and invoke Him only making your religion sincere to Him [7:29]. 4* iAnd the Masjids are for Allah> [72:18]. in them His Name is remembered.} Ibn Abbas said, This means that His Book is recited therein. 1 4iJU>'5ib jiiL /! 4Therein glorify Him in the mornings and in the evenings.} li & H ^ v 4Men whom neither trade nor business diverts from the remembrance of Allah} This is like the Ayat OM>* Si* <\$ } 40 you who believe! Let not your properties or your children divert you from the remembrance of Allah.} [63:9J l)jij jJi! JS IjilS

fiiijl Aj! sjM. 'iSiy 'H !>*' Cti! 40 i/oh who believe! When the call is proclaimed for the Salah on Friday, hasten earnestly to the remembrance of Allah and leave offbusiness [62:9] Allah says that this world and its adornments, attractions and marketplaces should not distract them from remembering their Lord Who created them and sustains them, those who know that what is with Him is better for them than what they themselves possess, because what they have is transient but that which is with Allah is eternal. Allah says: "#! Jb& Vj '(M, [11 At-Tabari 19:191.

iMen whom neither trade nor business diverts from the remembrance of Allah nor from performing the Salah nor from giving the Zakahi. meaning, they give priority to obeying Allah and doing what He wants and what pleases Him over doing what they want and what pleases them. It was reported from Salim from Abdullah bin Umar that he was in the marketplace when the Iqamah for prayer was called, so they closed their stores and entered the Masjid. Ibn Umar said: Concerning them the Ayah was revealed: * c? " , . > " > v iMen whom neither trade nor business diverts from the remembrance ofAllah4 . This was recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim and Ibn Jarir. iMen xvhom neither trade nor business diverts from the remembrance ofAlldhi. Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, This meant from the prescribed prayers. This was also the view of Muqatil bin Hayyan and Ar-Rabi bin Anas. As-Suddi said: From prayer in congregation. Muqatil bin Hayyan said, That does not distract them from attending the prayer and establishing it as Allah commanded them, and from doing the prayers at the prescribed times and doing all that Allah has enjoined upon them in the prayer. '4-1\$* m Cjt iTheyfear a Day when hearts and eyes will be overturned. means, the Day of Resurrection when people s hearts and eyes will be overturned, because of the intensity of the fear and terror of that Day. This is like the Ayah: ifify" (4J4j\$ iAnd warn them of the Day that is drawing near...> [40:18), *** Ibn Abi Hatim 8 :2607 * At-Tabari 19:193.

Surat 24. An-Nur (36 - 38) (Part-18) 97 ibut He gives them respite up to a Day when the eyes will stare in horror 14 :42]. f) 'Afr fci -K/ ^ \$ #wi 1 // ' 'ff if Aft jU> piA) oJI j j-. *"' CJj 'fCM & j} a & C t) c* G] ^jUh *** **} fi'srJ iAnd they givefood, inspite of their love for it, to the poor, the orphan, and the captive, (saying:) Wefeed you seeking Allah's Face only. We zoish for no reward, nor thanks from you. Verily, Wefearfrom our Lord a Day, hard and distressful, that will make thefaces look horrible." So Allah saved themfrom the evil of that Day, and gave them a light ofbeauty and joy. And their recompense shall be Paradise, and silken garments, because they were patient} [76 :8-12]. And Allah says here: i\u \$T)iat Allah may reward them according to the best of their deeds,} meaning, They are those from whom We shall accept the best of their deeds and overlook their evil deeds. i-Ar^ ui (**-) yy^ iand add even morefor than out ofHis grace.} means, He will accept their good deeds and multiply them for them, as Allah says: ;jS Olii* v iii iSurely , Allah wrongs not even of the weight of a speck of dust.} [4 :40] ^Whoever brings a good deed shall have ten times the like thereof to his credit.} 6 :160]

iWlw is he that will lend to Allah a goodly loan.} (2:245] JJ %) iAllah gives manifold increase to whom He wills.} (2:261) And Allah says here: i!u. }And Allah provides without measure to whom He wills.} hr f 'ij "L ohililf c /Li CJ^j} -"j ^ j c .J laT Jjj iilj fX ' LLjj i".'" ^ m "l 7', . " ')> /' - .-r - Hiii Jr c." -Ll> ^ .oy ^ & \$& !>> \$ "i>' /"?- 3 . As /or f/iouse io/io disbelieved, their deeds are like a mirage in a QVah. The thirsty one thinks it to be water until he comes up to it, hefinds it to be nothing; but hefinds Allah with him, Who will pay him his due. And Allah is swift in takinv account.} }40. Or like the

darkness in a vast deep sea, overwhelmed with waves topped by waves, topped by dark clouds, (layers of) darkness upon darkness : if a man stretches out his hand, he can hardly see it! And he for whom Allah has not appointed light, for him there is no light.} Two Examples of two kinds of Disbelievers These are two examples which Allah sets forth of two kinds of disbelievers. Similarly He sets forth two parables of the hypocrites at the beginning of Surat Al-Baqarah: one involving fire and the other involving water. 11 Similarly, in Surat Ar-Ra'd He gives two parables of the guidance and knowledge that are instilled in the heart, again involving fire and water; 121 we have discussed each of them in the appropriate place and there is no need to repeat it here, praise be to Allah. The first of these two examples is that of the disbelievers who call See Surat Al-Baqarah [2:17-19]. 121 See Surat Ar-Ra'd [13 : 17]

others to their disbelief, thinking that they have good actions and beliefs, when this is not in fact the case. Their likeness is that of a mirage which is seen in a desert plain, looking from a distance as if it is a deep sea. The word QVah refers to a vast, flat, level area of land in which the mirage may appear. There are different kinds of mirage, one which appears after midday, and another which appears in the morning and looks like water between heaven and earth. If a person who is in need of water sees the mirage, he thinks that it is water so he heads towards it in order to drink from it, but when he reaches it, i\kl '.J4)} he finds it to be nothing.}; Similarly the disbeliever thinks that he is doing something good and that he has achieved something, but when Allah judges him on the Day of Resurrection, and brings him to account and examines his deeds, he will find that nothing has been accepted at all, either because of a lack of sincere belief or because he did not follow the proper ways of the Shari'ah. As Allah says: 4 jit & u \$And We shall turn to whatever deeds they did, and We shall make such deeds as scattered floating particles of dust.} [25:23]. And He says here: iilfj *ijj" iXi iii J~jj} i but he finds Allah with him, who will pay him his due. And Allah is swift in taking account.} A similar view was also narrated from Ubayy bin Kab, Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Qatadah and others. 11 In the Two Sahls, it is reported that on the Day of Resurrection it will be said to the Jews, What did you used to worship? They will say, We used to worship TJzayr the son of Allah. It will be said to them, You have lied. Allah has not begotten a son. What do you want? They will say, O Lord, we are thirsty, give us something to drink. It will be said to them, Do you not see? Then Hell will be shown to them as if PI At-Tabari 19:196.

4Whomsoever Allah sends astray, none can guide him [7:186] This is in contrast to what Allah says about the believers: 4Q o' -AU-l ii' s -) iAllah guides to His Light whom He wills. [24:35] We ask Allah the Almighty to put light in our hearts and give us light on our right and on our left, and to increase us in light. jje Ji y 4 O* % j j-5 'U m , (* ' rtf' All' UJ rfUp All'j 441 . See you not that Allah, He it is Whom glorify whosoever is in the heavens and the earth, and the birds with wings outspread? Of each one He knows indeed his Salah and his glorification; and Allah is All-Aware of ivhat they do. 442. And to Allah belongs the sovereignty of the heavens and the earth, and to Allah is the return. Everything glorifies Allah, may He be exalted, and to Him belongs the Sovereignty Allah tells us that whosoever is in the heavens and on the earth, i.e., the angels, mankind, Jinn, animals and even inanimate objects, all glorify Him. This is like the Ayah: tit* > 'i 4The seven heavens and the earth and all that is therein, glorify Him) [17:44], 4and the birds with ivings outspread) means, while they are flying they glorify their Lord and worship Him with the glorification with which they are inspired and to which they are guided.

Allah knows what they are doing, and so He says: 40feach one He knows indeed his Salah and his glorification ;) meaning, He has guided every creature to its own way of

them together, then makes them into a heap of layers, and you see the rain come forthfrom between them ; and He sends down from the sky, from mountains in it of ice, and strikes therewith whom He wills, and averts it from whom He wills. The vivid flash of its (clouds) lightning nearly blinds the sight.) 444. Allah causes the night and the day to succeed each other. Tndy, in this is indeed a lesson for those who have insight.) The Power ofAllah to create the Clouds and thatwhich comes fromThem Allah tells us that He drives the clouds from the beginning, when they are formed and are still weak. This is the Gentle driving. 4then joins them together,) means, He brings them together after they have been scattered. Wfckp 4then makes them into a heap of layers,) means. He piles them up on top ofone another. 4and you see the Wadq) meaning the rain, 4come forth from between them;) means, from the gaps between them. This is how it was understood by Ibn Abbas and Ad-Dahhak. Ubayd bin Tlmayr Al-Laythi said: Allah sends the scatterer [wind], which stirs up that which is on the surface of the earth. Then he sends the generator [wind], which forms the clouds. Then He sends the joiner [wind] which brings them together. Then He sends the fertilizer [wind] which fertilizes or seeds the clouds. This was recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim and Ibn Jarir. 2 U Jt hi ITabari 19:202. ,2' At-Jabari 19:201

and He sends down from [Min] the sky, from [Min] mountains in it of[Min] ice,} Some of the grammarians said that the first Min describes the place from which it is coming, the second specifies from which part of the sky it comes, and the third means some kind of mountains. This is based on the view of those scholars of Tafsirwho say that, if* U& yfr ifrom [Min] mountains in it of[Min] ice means that there are mountains of hail in the sky from which Allah sends down ice. As for those who say that mountains here is used as a metaphor for clouds, they think that the second Min is also used to describe the place from which the ice is coming, and is thus interchangeable with the first. And Allah knows best. iand strikes therewith whom He wills, and averts itfrom whom He wills.} It may be that the phrase i ii iand strikes therewith} means, with what He sends down from the sky ofdifferent kinds of rain and hail. So then the phrase iand strikes therewith whom He wills} means, by His mercy towards them, and iand averts it from whom He wills.} means, He withholds rain from them. Or it may be that iand strikes therewith} means, with hail, as a punishment towards whomever He wills, striking their fruits and destroying their crops and trees. And He averts it from whomever He wills as a mercy towards them.

iThe vividflash of its lightning nearly blinds the sight.) the brightness of its lightning almost takes away their sight if the eyes follow it and try to look at it. j3f&4S> iAllah causes the night and the day to succeed each other.) He is controlling them, so that He takes something from the length of one and adds it to the other, which is short, until they become equal, then He does the opposite so that the one which was short becomes long and vice versa. Allah is the One Who is controlling that by His command, power, might and knowledge. ifSZtif tsjd# 4 d5[]) iTruly, in this is indeed a lesson for those who have insight.) means, this is an indication of His greatness, may He be exalted. This is like the Ayah: 4^ oy*-- *' 4 iVerily, in the creation of the heavens and the earth, and in tlle alternation of night and day, there are indeed signs for men of understanding.) [3:190] and thereafter. cy (*rV i & L'r*i J* (*r* Jt ' 4^ li\ "XZ U ill ji* if jfX 445. Allah has created every moving creature from water. Of them there are some that creep on their bellies, and some that walk on two legs, and some that walk on four. Allah creates

what He wills. Verily, Allah is able to do all things.) Allah's Power in His creation of the Animals Allah mentions His complete and almighty power to create all the different kinds of animals with their various forms, colors and ways of moving and stopping, from one kind of water. & t& i cy (>&) Of them there are some that creep on their bellies,) like snakes and so on;

and some that walk on two legs,) like humans and birds; i{3 && and some that walk on four,) like cattle and all kinds of animals. Allah says: i*Qj ill ij&z} iAllah creates what He wills.} meaning by His power, because what He wills happens and what He does not will does not happen. So he says: i j* } S& iVerily, Allah is able to do all things.} 4^ iti: c4i; Uj\2} i46. VJe have indeed sent down manifest Ayat. And Allah guides whom He wills to the straight path.} Allah states that in this Qur'an He has revealed many clear and unambiguous rulings, words of wisdom and parables, and that He guides people of understanding, insight and intellect to ponder and understand them. He says: iAnd Allah guides whom He wills to the Straight Path.} Uj tilli *jii til ijjJyuj} fd (4^ H fr*. \$ J} G i47. They say: We have believed in Allah and in the Messenger, and we obey," then a party of them turn away thereafter, such are not believers.} 448. And when they are called to Allah and His Messenger, to

An-Nur (46 - 52) (Part-18) judge between them, to! a party of them refuses and turns away.} 449. But if the truth is on their side, they come to him wittingly with submission. 450. Is there a disease in their hearts? Or do they doubt or fear lest Allah and His Messenger should wrong them in judgement. Nay, it is they themselves who are the wrongdoers.} 451. The only saying of the faithful believers, when they are called to Allah and His Messenger, to judge between them, is that they say: We hear and we obey." And such are the successful.} 452. And whosoever obeys Allah and His Messenger, fears Allah, and has Taqwa of Him, such are the successful.} The Treachery of the Hypocrites and the Attitude of the Believers Allah tells us about the characteristics of the hypocrites who show one thing while hiding another, and who say with their tongues, 4^> J ? oj (* ; 4 "We have believed in Allah and in the Messenger, and we obey," then a party of them turn away thereafter,) meaning, their actions contradict their deeds, and they say that which they do not do. Allah says: ^j>} 4such are not believers.} fQ, p j) v > fy} 4And when they are called to Allah and His Messenger, to judge between them...} means, when they are asked to follow the guidance which Allah has revealed to His Messenger s g j, they turn away and are too arrogantly proud of themselves to follow him. This is like the Ayah

108 Tafstr Ibt Kathlr iHave you not seen those who claim that they believe in that which has been sent down to you, and that which was sent down before you,) until His saying: OjJLdJ -K \$j} iyou see the hypocrites turn away from you with aversion [4 :60-61]. iBut if the truth is on their side, they come to him willingly with submission .} means, if the ruling will be in their favor and not against them, then they will come and will listen and obey, which is

what is meant by the phrase

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3976–3993]

iwillingly with submission .} But if the ruling will go against him, he turns away and demands something that goes against the truth, and he prefers to refer for judgement to someone other than the Prophet jg; so that his false claims may prevail. His acceptance in the beginning was not because he

believed that it was the truth, but because it happened to be in accordance with his desires. So when the truth went against what he was hoping for, he turned away from it. Allah said: iStr (*rJi ils tltere a disease in their hearts?...} meaning, their situation cannot be anything else, they must necessarily have a disease in their hearts, or else they have some doubts about the religion, or they are afraid that Allah and His Messenger will be unjust in their ruling against them. Whichever it is, it is pure disbelief, and Allah knows which of these characteristics each one of them has. (U iij ji} iNay, it is they themselves who are the wrongdoers.} means, they are the evildoers who commit immoral actions, and Allah and His Messenger jgj are innocent of the injustice and unfairness that they imagine; exalted be Allah and His Messenger above such a thing.

An-Nur (47 - 52) (Part-18) Then Allah tells us about the attributes of the believers who respond to Allah and His Messenger jg and who seek no other way apart from the Book of Allah and the Sunnah of His Messenger jg. Allah says: 477ie o"/y sai/mg o/ the faithful believers, when they are called to Allah and His Messenger, to judge between them, is tluit they say : We hear and we obey" meaning, to hear to obey. Allah describes them as having attained success, which is achieving what one wants and being saved from what one fears. So Allah says: 4And such are the successful. Concerning the Ayah: hl: \ j& 4they say : We hear and we obey Qatadah said: We were told that when Tjbadah bin As- Samit, who had been present at Al- Aqabah and at Badr, and was one of the leaders of the Ansar, was dying, he said to his nephew Junadah bin Abi Umayyah: Shall I not tell you what you must do and what is your due? He said, Yes. He said: You have to listen and obey when times are easy and when they are hard, when you feel energetic and when you do not want to, and when you feel selfish. You have to train your tongue to speak the truth. Do not go against those who are in authority, unless they openly command you to commit acts of disobedience to Allah. Whenever you are commanded to do something that goes against the Book of Allah, then follow the Book of Allah. 111 Qatadah said: We were told that Abu Ad-Darda said, There is no Islam except through obedience to Allah, and no goodness except in Jama'ah. Sincerity is to Allah and His Messenger jg, and to the Khalfah and all the believers. He said: And we were told that Umar bin Al-Khattab, may Allah m Ibn Abi Hatim 8 :2623

no Tafsir Ibn Kathir be pleased with him, used to say; The bonds of Islam are La ilah a illallah , establishing prayer, paying Zakah and obeying those whom Allah has given authority over the affairs of the

4such are the successful.} means, those who will attain sill goodness and be saved from all evil in this world and the Hereafter. 0^ .OJ/o Acll, j^ " m . "i V Ji ("TV' ^ r. *J !>* !) t* U L3ji \j)y ^ !>"r^ ji , rj" L- J 4 ^*i' ^ jA!)> 4, L . They swear by Allah their strongest oaths that ifonly you would order them, they would leave. Say: "Swear you not; obedience is known. Verily, Allah knows well what you do."} 454. Say: "Obey Allah and obey the Messenger, but if you turn away, he is only responsible for the duty placed on him and you for that placed on you. If you obey him, you shall be on the right guidance. The Messenger's duty is only to convey (the Message) in a clear way."} Allah says about the hypocrites who had promised the Messenger jg and sworn that if he were to command them to go out for battle, they would go: }Say : "Swear you not..."} meaning, do not swear this oath. 4cU"^ iobedience is known.} It was said that the meaning is, your obedience is known, i.e., it is known that your obedience is merely verbal and is not accompanied by action. Every time you swear an oath you lie. This is like the Ayah 4^

\ jl fesA Sf&} 4They swear to you that you may be pleased with them...} [9:96] And Allah says: 4They have made their oaths a screen (for their evil actions).} [58:16]

112 Tafslr Ibn Kathtr It is part of their nature to tell lies, even in the issues they choose, as Allah says: ujiyb \yjfc ^sfk\ jl j pi&% 'M& i && ^ ^DA r^-ir* Aj pjAt y Vjy 4-> r*~ ^sv*. ^ A iHave you not observed the hypocrites who say to their friends among the people of the Scripture who disbelieve: "If you are expelled, we indeed will go out with you, and we shall never obey any one against you; and if you are attacked, we shall indeed help you." But Allah is Witness that they verily are liars. Surely, if they are expelled, never will they go out with them ; and if they are attacked, they will never help them . And if they do help them, they will turn their backs, and they will not be victorious .} [59:1 1-12] Then Allah says: 44 2>' iSay: "Obey Allah and obey the Messenger...} meaning, follow the Book of Allah and the Sunnah of His Messenger \$ig. ibut if you turn aivay,} if you ignore what he has brought to you, <\$ c <%} ihe is only responsible for the duty placed on him), conveying the Message and fulfilling the trust. iand you for that placed on you accepting that, and venerating it and doing as it commanded. dj} ilf you obey him, you shall be on the right guidance.} because he calls to the straight path,

477ie path of Allah to Whom belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earth...} [42:53] 477ie Messenger's duty is only to convey in a clear way.} This is like the Ayat. iSj ^i/our duty is only to convey and on Us is the reckoning.} 13:4] UUJ " <*< J lij U.] 4So remind them - you are only one who reminds. You are not a dictator over them.} [88:21-22] *->*" j"rti o4^J (*+ti jj 4l"3oA- jt* vitpljti -*X _> ==> <> > till ,_j V 455. Allah has promised those among you who believe and do righteous good deeds, that He will certainly grant them succession in the land, as He granted it to those before them, and that He will grant them the authority to practise their religion which He has chosen for them . And He will surely give them in exchange a safe security after theirfear if they worship Me and do not associate anything with Me. But whoever disbelieved after this, they are the rebellious.} Allah s Promise to the Believers that He would grant them Succession This is a promise from Allah to His Messenger that He would cause his Ummah to become successors on earth, i.e., they would become the leaders and rulers of mankind, through whom He would reform the world and to whom people would submit, so that they would have in exchange a safe security after their fear. This is what Allah did indeed do, may He be glorified and exalted, and to Him be praise and blessings. For He did not cause His Messenger jfe to die until

114 Tafstr IbtI Kathir He had given him victoiy over Makkah, Khaybar, Bahrayn, all of the Arabian Peninsula and Yemen; and he took Jizyah from the Zoroastrians of Hajar and from some of the border lands of Syria; and he exchanged gifts with Heraclius the ruler of Byzantium, the ruler of Egypt and Alexandria, the Muqawqis, the kings of Oman and An-Najashi of Abyssinia, who had become king after Ashamah, may Allah have mercy on him and grant him honor. Then when the Messenger died, his successor (Khalifah) Abu Bakr As-Siddlq took over the reins of power and united the Ummah, preventing its disintegration. He took control of the entire Arabian Peninsula, and he sent the Islamic armies to the land of Persia, under the leadership of Khalid bin Al- Walid, may Allah be pleased with him, who conquered a part of it and killed some of its people. He sent another army under the leadership of Abu TJbaydah, may Allah be pleased with him, and the other commanders who came after

him in the lands of Syria. He sent a third army under the leadership of Amr bin Al- As, may Allah be pleased with him, to Egypt. Allah enabled the army sent to Syria to conquer Busra and Damascus and their provinces the land of Hawran and its environs. Then Allah chose for Abu Bakr to honor him with Him and he died. The people of Islam were blessed that A?-Siddiq was inspired to appoint Umar Al-FarQq as his successor, so he took the reins of power after him and did a perfect job. After the Prophets, the world never saw anyone like Umar in excellence of conduct and perfect justice. During his time, the rest of Syria and Egypt, and most of Persia, was conquered. Kisra was defeated and utterly humiliated, and he retreated to the furthest point of his kingdom. Mighty Caesar was brought low, his rule over Syria was overthrown, and he retreated to Constantinople. Their wealth was spent for the sake of Allah, as the Messenger of Allah had foretold and promised. May Allah s perfect peace and purest blessing be upon him. During the rule of Uthman, the Islamic domains spread to the furthest points ofthe earth, east and west. The lands ofthe west were conquered as far as Cyprus and Andalusia, Kairouan 1 I 1 * During the author s time, this citywas the capital ofTunisia.

and Sebta which adjoins the Atlantic Ocean. Towards the east, the conquests extended as far as China. Kisra was killed, his kingdom was utterly destroyed and the cities of Iraq, Khurasan and Al-Ahwaz were conquered. The

116 Tafslr Ibn Kathir to Al-Madinah. When they came to Al-Madinah, then Allah instructed them to fight. In Al-Madinah they were afraid and they carried their weapons morning and evening. This is how they remained for as long as Allah willed... Then Allah revealed this Ayah. He caused His Prophet to prevail over the Arabian Peninsula, and then they felt safe and put down their weapons. Then Allah took His Prophet jg and they remained safe throughout the time of Abu Bakr, Umar and Uthman, until what happened happened, and fear again prevailed over them, so they instituted a police force and guards. They changed, so their situation changed. One of the Salaf said, The Khilafah of Abu Bakr and Umar was true and adhered to the Book of Allah. Then he recited this Ayah." Al-Bara bin Azib said, This Ayah was revealed when we were in a state of extreme fear. 121 This Ayah is like the Ayah: r> ' .>< . v Jr* H } iAttd remember when you werew few and were reckoned weak in the land} Until His statement: iso that you might be gratefulj* [8:26]. 4^u 1 1Ck=^} ias He granted succession to those before them,} This is like the Ayah where Allah tells us that Musa said to his people: ^ J j\$2j Cr*} i It may be that your Lord will destroy your enetny and make you successors on the earth ..."} [7:129] And Allah says: / ." 4d;Si\

Do you know Al-Hirah? He said, I do not know it, but I have heard of it. The Messenger ofAllah jg said: jtj* cr. j'

punish them This was also recorded in the Two Sahihs. jU lijijti iX _=> iBut whoever disbelieved after this, they are the rebellious means, whoever then stops obeying Me after that, has stopped obeying the command of his Lord, and that is a great sin. The Companions - may Allah be pleased with them - were the most committed of people after the Prophet jg to the commands of Allah and the most obedient to Allah. Their victories were in accordance with their level of commitment. They caused the Word of Allah to prevail in the east and the west, and Allah supported them so much that they governed all the people and all the lands. When the people subsequently fell short in their commitment to some of the commandments, their strength and victory fell short accordingly, but it is confirmed through more than

one route in the Two Sahihs that the Messenger of Allah[^] said: Wfje iThere will remain a group of my Ummah adhering to the truth, and those whoforsake them or oppose them will not harm them until the Day ofResurrection . b|3) According to another report: jU} jit J>-" until the command of Allah comes to pass and they are like that , "4 ' According to another report: "... until they fight the DajjSLM51 5:242. Fath Al-B&ri 10:412, Muslim 1 :58. 1 :137. '4| Muslim 3:1523. 437.

120 Tafstr IbtI Kathtr According to another report: " ^S. J "J J^1.1 "... until Isa bin Maryam comes down and they are prevailing .s All of these reports are Sahih, and there is no contradiction between them. V && \J4j \$(ijCj \jj; } Jjjj %\ j&fc UyVf 4 156. And perform the Salah, and give the Zakah and obey the Messenger that you may receive mercy.} 157. Consider not that the disbelievers can escape in the land. Their abode shall be the Fire - and worst indeed is that destination.} The Command to pray, give the Zakah and obey the Messengersi; the inabilityofthe Disbelieversto escape, and the ultimate Destiny Allah commands His believing servants to establish prayer, which means worshipping Allah Alone with no partner or associate; to pay the Zakah, which is an act of kindness towards His poor and weak creatures; and by doing so to obey the Messenger of Allah jg, i.e., to do as he commands them and to avoid what he forbids them-, so that Allah will have mercy on them for that. No doubt, whoever does that, Allah will have mercy on him, as Allah says in another Ayah: iAlldh will have His mercy on them} [9:71] iU^'i} iConsider not} means, do not think, O Muhammad', that: ^U\$} ithe disbelievers} meaning, those who opposed and denied you, Fath Al-Bari 13:306.

An-Niir (56 - 60) (Part-18) icon escape in the land.} means, that they can flee from Al- lah. No, Allah is able to deal with them and He will punish them most severely for that. Allah says: iTheir abode} meaning, in the Hereafter, IU} ishall be the Fire - and worst indeed is that destination.} means, how terrible the consequences will be for the disbelievers, how evil a place to stay in and how awful a place to job jAi. jp ^jLX -V *-V '.*i ~y < /- ^ /> ^ ", / / ^ rest! *&^& fis i&; j jztf szz4pjQ p: P&^} P 9&>^*^ +*>. oj> sjy\$ o; ^Q. o^j j&\ yu ^s %&Jt l2- AiX "f, jiiVi ? ur, % * & p * #5^i 46 * g&r ig M & PjPQ, \$ * ^J6i v tk^r j(Vy^i* ^ i* ^ > >'f-' *, ' " * < ,, ^ t -* CH-j ! o'j y/t i58. O you who believe! Let your slaves and slave-girls, and those among you who have not come to the age ofpuberty ask your pertnission on three occasions : before the Fajr prayer, and

while you put off your clothes during the afternoon, and after the 'lshd' prayer. (These) three (times) are of privacy for you; other than these times there is no sin on you or on them to move about, attending to each other. Thus Allah makes clear the Ayat to you. And Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise.} 459. And when the children among you come to puberty, then let them (also) ask for permission, as those senior to them (in age) ask permission. Thus Allah makes clear His Ayat for you. And Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise.} 460. And the Qawa'id among women who do not hope for marriage, it is no sin on them if they discard their (outer) clothing in such a way as not to show their adornment. But to refrain is better for thetn. And Allah is All-Hearer, All- Knoioer.} The Times when Servants and Young Children should seek Permission to enter These Ayat include a discussion ofhow people who are closely related should seek permission to enterupon one another. What was mentioned earlier in the Surah had to do with how unrelated people should seek permission to enter upon one another. Allah commanded the believers to ensure that their servants and their children who have not yet reached puberty should seek permission at three times: the first is before the Fajr prayer, because people are asleep in their beds at that time. 4and

while you put off your clothes during the afternoon,} means, at the time of rest, because a man may be in a state of undress with his wife at that time. 4and after the Ishd ' prayer.} because this is the time for sleep. Servants and children are commanded not to enter upon household members at these times, because it is feared that a man may be in an intimate situation with his wife and so on. Allah says:

i(These) three (times) are of privacy for you ; other than these times there is no sin on you or on them If they enter at a time other than these, there is no sin on you if you let them enter, and no sin on them if they see something at a time other than these times. They have been given permission to enter suddenly, because they are those who go around in the house, i.e., to serve you etc., and as such they may be forgiven for things that others will not be forgiven. Although this Ayah is quite clear and has not been abrogated, people hardly follow it, and Abdullah bin Abbas denounced the people for that.

4And the Qawa'id among women. Said bin Jubayr, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Ad-Dahhak and Qatadah said that these are the women who no longer think that they can bear children, 4who do not hope for marriage, meaning, they no longer have any desire for marriage, lSi- 4it is no sin on them if they discard their (outer) clothing in such a way as not to show their adornment. meaning, they do not have to cover themselves in the same way that other women have to.

ii in such a way as not to show their adornment. SaTd bin Jubayr said, They should not make a wanton display of themselves by removing their outer garment so that their adornment may be seen. 5 S4But to refrain is better for them.} means, not removing their outer garment, even though that is permissible for them, is better for them. iAnd Allah is All-Hearer, All-Knmver.} o' if y- if % y- yff f%^ yif f j' ') j' op j' f j' ffy j' j vy 1 j* j" y=Qz .-^Ui j? jZJt- *ju jl Ld f^ ;jci! ^ pp p iO 4; j;&5yM ft dsfe*> i61 . There is no restriction on the blind, nor any restriction on the lame, nor any restriction on the sick, nor on yourselves, if you eat from your houses, or the houses of your fathers, or the houses of your mothers, or the Iwuses of your brothers, or the houses of your sisters, or the houses of your father's brothers, or the houses of your father's sisters, or the houses of your mother's brothers, or the houses of your mother's sisters, or (from that) ivhereof you hold keys, or (from the house) of a friend. No sin on you whether you eat together or apart. But when you enter the houses, greet one another with a greetmg from Allah, blessed and good. Thus Allah makes clear the Ayat to you that you may understand.} Eating from One s Relatives Houses

What is referred to here is the fact that they used to feel too

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3993–4001]

embarrassed to eat with the blind, because they could not see the food or where the best morsels were, so others might take the best pieces before they could. They felt too embarrassed to

eat with the lame because they could not sit comfortably, and their companions might take advantage of them, and they felt embarrassed to eat with the sick because they might not eat as much as others. So they were afraid to eat with them lest they were unfair to them in some way. Then Allah revealed this Ayah, granting them a dispensation in this matter. This was the view of Said bin Jubayr and Miqsam. 111 Ad-Dahhak said: Before the Prophet s Mission, they used to feel too embarrassed and too proud to eat with these people, lest they might have to help them. So Allah revealed this Ayah." inor any

restriction on the lame,} Abdur-Razzaq recorded that Mujahid said: A man would take a blind, lame or sick person to the house of his brother or sister or aunt, and those disabled people would feel ashamed of that and say, they are taking us to other people's houses. So this Ayah was revealed granting permission for that. 13 As-Suddi said: A man would enter the house of his father or brother or son, and the lady of the house would bring him some food, but he would refrain from eating because the master of the house was not there, so Allah revealed: iThere is no restriction on the blind...} It 3 && inor on yourselves, ifyou eatfrom your houses,} This is stated here although it is obvious, so that from this starting point the houses of others may be mentioned, and to make it clear that the ruling applies equally to what comes after. Sons houses are included in this even though they are not mentioned by name, and this is used as evidence by those who regard the son's wealth as being like the father's wealth. In the Musnad and the Sunan, it is reported through several *** Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :223 , At-Tabari 19 :221 * At-Tabari 19:219. Abdur-Razzaq 3 :64

You and your wealth belong to yourfather.^ * j ior the houses ofyourfathers, or the houses ofyour mothers,} until His statement; t f} ior (from that) whereofyou hold keys,} This is obvious, and this is used as evidence by those who think that it is obligatory for relatives to spend on one another. ior (from that) whereof you hold keys,} Said bin Jubayr and As- Suddi said, This refers to a people's servants, whether a slave or otherwise. There is nothing wrong with them eating from the food that is stored with them, within reason. Az-Zuhri narrated from TJrwah that A isha, may Allah be pleased with her, said, The Muslims used to go out on military campaigns with the Messenger of Allah jg and they would give their keys to people they trusted and say, We permit you to eat whatever you need. But they would say, It is not permissible for us to eat, they have given us permission reluctantly and we are only trustees. Then Allah revealed: iHi-^JiS JUrsqii \$i} ior (from that) whereofyou hold keys}.

iNo sin on you whether you eat together or apart.} Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn Abbas concerning this Ayah, When Allah revealed the Ayah: IikJa V \ & 40 you who believe! Eat not up your property among yourselves unjustly [4:29], the Muslims said, Allah has forbidden us to eat up our property among ourselves unjustly, and food is the best of property, so it is not permissible for anyone among us to eat at the house of anyone else. So the people stopped doing that. Then Allah revealed: iThere is no restriction on the blind,} until His statement; j} ior (from the house) ofafriend.} A man would also feel embarrassed and would refrain from eating alone until someone else came along, but Allah made the matter easier for them and said: i CL J &=&} iNo sin on you whether you eat together or apart.}^ Qatadah said, This was a clan of Banu Kinanah who during the Jahiliyyah thought that it was a source of shame for one of them to eat alone, to such an extent that a man might keep on driving his laden camel even though he was hungry, until he could find someone to eat and drink with him. Then Allah revealed: iNo sin on you whether you eat together or apart.}^ So this was a dispensation from Allah, allowing people to eat either alone or with others, even though eating with others is more blessed and is better. m At-Tabari 19:224.Tabari 19:224.

J i&Jliiw ro\ commanded to do, and it has been narrated to us that the angels will return his greeting. 111 ill dJl;IL=> pissezAjS s.*> ' 'w'.S* t' 5. A.' (iiijJel-JuU)(j|"> ji^i dji v.'^'^.v ij*ji ' J ^Op\$CguO ^ > ** ,j"iv " f tv t i ^ " ix ^ "" ^ 'pJfJLS^ / / *" Z y /Sy yr w}** , & S _ iTIius Allah makes clear the Ayat to you that you may understand.} When Allah mentioned what wise rulings and reasonable, well-

constructed laws are contained in this Surah, He points out to His servants that He explains the Ayat to them clearly so that they may ponder them and understand their meanings. / > ,/ ' i, ' "> ,y I y-" " y ^ / ^ ^ a jj "yJ L-A < * > J* ^ tli^ ** \y\ =* **iyy*jj "" ' i * jIJ ojli p 4^ - 4)*^ " 44 -~yHid itj' y . " : " ; -if iif "T -> jy-* *"" -d_4 *a' p-i 1> (4^i . The believers are only those who believe in Allah and His Messenger; and what they are with him on some common matter, they go not away until they have asked his permission. Verily, those who ask your permission, those are they who (really) believe in Allah and His Messenger. So if they ask your permission for some affairs of theirs, give permission to whom you will of them, and ask Allah for their forgiveness. Truly, m Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :228

Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful . Asking Permission to leave when They are doing something together This is another matter of etiquette to which Allah has guided His believing servants. Just as He commanded them to seek permission when entering, He also commanded them to seek permission when leaving, especially when they are doing something together with the Messenger 2g, such as the Friday, Id, or congregational prayers, or a meeting for the purpose of consultation and so on. Allah commanded them not to leave him in these situations until they had asked his permission. If they did this, then they were of the true believers. Then Allah commanded His Messenger jg to give permission when someone asked for it, if he wanted to. He said: 0 ^ J4 igive permission to whom you will of them, and ask Allah for theirforgiveness

commandment, lest some Fitnah should befall them or a painful torment be inflicted on them.} The Etiquette ofaddressing the Prophetg Ad-Dahhak said, reporting from Ibn Abbas: They used to say, O Muhammad, or O Abu Al-Qasim, but Allah forbade them to do that, as a sign of respect towards His Prophet jg, and told them to say, O Prophet of Allah, O Messenger of Allah. This was also the view of Mujahid and Said bin Jubayr. ' Qatadah said: Allah commanded that His Prophet 2 5 should be treated with respect and honor, and that he should be a leader. * Muqatil said concerning the Ayah: iyUif 1} iMake not the calling of the Messenger among you as your calling one ofanother.} When you address him, do not say, O Muhammad, or O son of Abdullah ; rather honor him and say, O Prophet of Allah, or, O Messenger of Allah. 4* J ["***" pr-=^h i} iMake not the calling of the Messenger among you as your calling one ofanother.} A second view concerning the meaning of the Ayah is that it means do not think that if he prays against you it is like when anyone else prays against you, because his prayers will be answered; so beware lest he prays against you and you will be doomed. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded this from Ibn Abbas, Al- Hasan Al-Basri and Atiyyah Al- Awfi. And Allah knows best. p* & pu; *} iAllah knows those ofyou who slip away under shelter.} Muqatil bin Hayyan said, This refers to the hypocrites who used to find it too difficult to listen to the Khutbah on Fridays, so they would hide behind some of the Companions of *** Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :230 [2) At-Jabari 19:230. Al-Tabari 19:230.Tabari 19:230.

An-Nur (63) (Part-18) Muhammad \$g and sneak out of the Masjid. It was not proper for a man to leave on Fridays once the Khutbah began, unless he had permission from the Prophet 3g. If one of them wanted to leave, he would make a gesture to the Prophet sg with his linger, and the Prophet ig would give permission without the man speaking. This is because if the Prophet jg was giving the Khutbah and a man spoke, it would invalidate his Friday prayer. As-Suddi said, If they were with him for a congregational prayer, they would hide behind one another so that he could not see them.

The Prohibition of going against the Messenger's

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4001–4003]

Commandment iAnd let those beware who oppose the Messenger's commandment^ This means going against the commandment of the Prophet jg, which is his way, methodology and Sunnah. All words and deeds will be measured against his words and deeds; those that are in accordance with his words and deeds will be accepted, and whatever does not match up will be rejected, no matter who the person is who said and did them. It was recorded in the Two Sahihs and elsewhere that the Messenger of Allah jg said: A* lA y** Jt* j "Whoever does a deed that is not in accordance with this matter of ours will have it rejected ." 2 meaning, let those beware who go against the Shan'ah of the Messenger sg, in secret and in the open, jLi' >' > tv trM> o'r ilest some Fitnah should befall them}, i.e., lest some disbelief or hypocrisy or innovation enter their hearts. Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :23 1 Al-Bari4 :416 , Muslim 3 :1343

iAnd put your trust until His saying; in the All-Mighty, the Most Merciful,} 4Verily, He, only He, is the All-Hearer, the AU-Knoiver [26:217-220]. IjjJi 'll Vj yL.Ji Oi *it 4 ,>* Vj 4 Vj u ^_j)ji -> *ri 4;|:oJw# 4 ^ 'J3% 4Neither you do any deed nor recite any portion of the Qur'an, nor you do any deed but We are Witness thereofwhen you are doing it. And nothing is hidden from your Lord; (even) the weight of a speck of dust on the earth or in the heaven . Not

what is less than that or what is greater than that but is in a

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4003–4004]

Clear Record .} [10:61] 4o3" ^ -A} 41s then He Who takes charge of every person and knows all that he has earned?} [13:33] He sees all that His servants do, good and evil alike. And Allah says. /S , *t a , Uj U JUj >-\$jU > j 4Surely, even when they cover themselves with their garments, He knows what they conceal and what they reveal>] 1 1:5). jjij' "A A A? 4It is the same (to Him) ivhether any ofyou conceals his speech or declares it openly [13:10]. 4 jf ^V-Ay A} % l*i)j Jc- V' . (ijU 4And no moving creature is there on earth but its provision is due from Allah. And He knows its dwelling place and its deposit. All is in a Clear Book.} [11:6] 4 i*? yA 4 crff-% A J A 4And with Him are the keys of the Unseen, none knows them

Surah 25: Al-Furqan

PDF pages 4005–4077

The Tafsirof SuratAl-Furqan

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4005–4021]

(Chapter - 25) Which was revealed in Makkah In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. Blessed be He Who sent down (Nazzala) the criterion to His servant that he may be a warner to all nations.} 42. He to Whom belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth, and Who has begotten no son and for Whom there is no partner in the dominion. He has created everything, and has measured it exactly according to its due measurements.} Blessed be Allah Here Allah praises Himself for the Noble Qur'an He has revealed to His noble Messenger s.j. This is like the Ayat liaS d; Jx3 \$ &. % :M &\$4 ' k y lMj AjKj iAll the praises and thanks be to Allah, Who has sent down to His servant the Book, and has not placed therein any crookedness. (He has made it) straight to give warning of a severe punishment from Him, and to give glad tidings to the believers, who do righteous deeds...} [18:1-2] Here Allah says: , , v Am} 4Blessed be He.} The verbal form used here implies an ongoing, permanent, eternal blessing. 4^

iWho sent down the criterion The verb Nazzala is a form which implies something done a great deal and often. This is like the Ayah: the Book which He (Nazzala) sent down to His Messenger, and the Scripture which He (Anzala) sent down to those before (him)} (4:136). Each of the previous Books was sent down at one time, but the Qur'an was revealed gradually, in stages, Ayat after Ayat, rulings after rulings, Surahs after Surahs. This is more eloquent and indicative of greater care for the one to whom it is revealed, as Allah says later in this Surah: seat&\$y \&r yr iAnd those who disbelieve say: "Why is not the Qur'an revealed to him all at once?" Thus, that We may strengthen your heart thereby. And We have revealed it to you gradually, in stages. And no example or similihide do they bring, but We reveal to you the truth, and the better explanation thereof.} (25:32-33) This Surah was named Al-Furqan, because it is the criterion that decides between truth and falsehood, guidance and misguidance, right and wrong, lawful and unlawful. \$} 4to His servant} This description is one of praise and commendation, because here Allah is connecting him to Him- self, describing him as His servant. Allah also described him in this manner when referring to the noblest of events, the Night of the Isra , as He said: 4% i .1 8\$^} 4Glorified be He Who took His servant for a journey by night} Allah also described him in this way when He described how he stood and called to Him: yi* ju l \$j}

Al-Furqan (1 - 2) (Part-18 iAnd when the servant of Allah stood up invoking Him in prayer they (the Jinn) just made round him a dense crowd as if sticking one over the other (in order to listen to the Prophet's recitation).} (72:19) This description is also used here when Allah describes how the Book is revealed to him and how the angel comes down to him: > ,, ii i Jj iBlessed be He Who sent down the criterion to His servant that he may be a warner to all nations.} CyjJLuU ofi).} ithat he may be a

warmer to all nations.} means, he alone has been blessed with this great, detailed, clear Book which, 4> f&r It dtj? . 3' tJf. y} 4Falsehood cannot come to it from before it or behind it, (it is) sent down by tire All-Wise, Worthy of all praise (Allah).} (41:42) The One Who made it the mighty criterion, singled him out to convey it to those who seek the shade of trees and to those who live on the land (i.e., to all of mankind, nomad and settled alike), as the Prophet sg said: "/ have been sent to the red and the black .u111 And he said: 1 JL"-t C ..1at-i "I have been given five things which no Prophet before me was given. Among them he mentioned: J\ ILlj liu- JI J-ii; *[Before me] a Prophet was sent only to his own people, but I have been sent to all ofmankind . 5:145. Al-Bari 1 :634.

140 Tafstr Ibn Kathir And Allah says: iSay: "O mankind! Verily, I am sent to you all as the Messenger of Allah..."} (7:158), meaning, the One Who has sent me is the Sovereign of the heaven and the earth, who merely says to a thing Be! and it is. He is the one who gives life and causes death. Allah says here: \$He to Whom belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth, and Who has begotten no son andfor Whom there is no partner in the dominion.} Allah states that He is above having any offspring or partner. Then He tells us: r tMimz i*v ^ villi' 4 (j' lityLUi jLLg ili/j' Cp oli==a \) bxx-tjScLEJLiyl^" iAJii A)J-i" J = vjii-y has created everything, and has measured it exactly according to its due measurements.} meaning, everything apart from Him is created and subject to Him. He is the Creator, Lord, Master and God of all things, and everything is subject to His dominion, control and power. i'& IJIC^ a; !42>

Al-Furqdn (3) (Part-18 43. Yet they have taken besides Him other gods who created nothing but are themselves created, and possess neither harm nor benefit for themselves, and possess no power (of causing) death, nor (ofgiving) life, nor of raising the dead.) The Foolishness ofthe Idolators Allah tells us of the ignorance of the idolators in taking other gods instead of Allah, the Creator of all things, the One Who controls the affairs of all things; whatever He wills happens and whatever He does not will does not happen. In spite of that, they still worshipped others besides Him, idols who could not even create the wing of a gnat, but were themselves created. They could neither do harm nor bring benefit to themselves, so how could they do anything for their worshippers? iand possess no poiver (of causing) death, nor (of giving) life, nor of raising the dead.) means, they could not do any of that at all; that power belongs only to Allah, Who is the One Who gives life and death, and is the One Who will bring all people, the first and the last, back to life on the Day of Resurrection. 4The creation ofyou all and the resurrection ofyou all are only as (the creation and resurrection of) a single person) (31:28). This is like the Ayat, \$ SU-S 4And Our commandment is but one as the twinkling of an eye.) (54:50) 4But it will be only a single ZajrahP When behold, theyfind themselves on the surface of the earth alive after their death.) (79:13-14) m See the TafSrof Surat As-Saffat (37 : 19]

ilt will be a single Zajrah, and behold, they will be staring!} (37:19) Vi j; 4 4/f will be but a single Sayhah, so behold they will all be brought up before Us!} (36:53). He is Allah besides Whom there is no other God and besides Whom there is no other Lord. No one should be worshipped except Him because whatever He wills happens and whatever he does not will does not happen. He has no offspring nor progenitor, nor equal nor likeness nor rival nor peer. He is the One, the Self-Sufficient Master, Whom all creatures need, He begets not, nor was He begotten, and there is none co-equal or comparable unto Him. l*U" oii pif-T - i. ur-w' 4 ol^=" ojiVb ^' (*Lj 44. Those who disbelieve say: This

is nothing but a lie that he has invented, and others have helped him in it." In fact, they have produced an unjust wrong and a lie.} 45. And they say: Tales of the ancients which he has written down, and they are dictated to him morning and afternoon."} 46. Say: It has been sent down by Him Who knows the secret of the heavens and the earth. Truly, He is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful."} What the Disbelievers said about the Qur'an Allah tells us about the foolishness of the disbelievers ignorant minds, when they said about the Qur'an: % Til 11} 4This is nothing but a lie}, meaning an untruth. 4that he has invented,} meaning the Prophet jg.

Al-Furqdn (4 - 6) (Part-18) pj" iand others have helped him in it.} means, he asked other people to help him compile it. So Allah said: i&& j%&} iln fact, they have produced an unjust wrong and a lie.} meaning, they are the ones who are telling a lie, and they know that it is false, for their own souls know that what they are claiming is not true. "V.yi J Vf \$%} iAnd they say: Tales of the ancients which he has written down..."} meaning, the ancients wrote them down, and he has copied it. 4*& iand they are dictated to him} means, they are read or recited to him. imorning and afternoon.} at the beginning and end of the day. Because this idea is so foolish and is so patently false, everyone knows that it is not true. It is known through Mutawatir reports and is a common fact that Muhammad the Messenger of Allah jg never learned to read or write, either at the beginning or the end of his life. He grew up among them for approximately forty years, from the time he was born until the time when his mission began. They knew all about him, and about his honest and sound character and how he would never lie or do anything immoral or bad. They even used to call him Al-Amin (the Trustworthy One) from a young age, until his mission began, because they saw how truthful and honest he was. When Allah honored him with that which He honored him, they declared their enmity towards him and came up with all these accusations which any reasonable person would know he was innocent of. They were not sure what to accuse him of. Sometimes they said that he was a sorcerer, at other times they would say he was a poet, or crazy, or a liar. So Allah said:

"S Su ijiV jfcViJ \ iSee what examples they have put forward for you. So they have gone astray, and never can they find a way.} (17 :48) In response to their stubbornness, Allah says here: j yp pCZ isji\ iijit 4Say : "It has been sent down by Him Who knows the secret of the heavens and the earth".} meaning, He has revealed the Qur'an which includes true information about the earlier and later generations, information which concurs with the realities of the past and future. i'ypZ jM} AWho blows the secret means, Allah is the One Who knows the unseen in the heavens and on the earth; He knows their secrets just as He knows what is visible therein. jyii ul^=" ATruly, He is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} This is an invitation to them to repent and turn back to Allah, telling them that His mercy is vast and His patience is immense. Whoever repents to Him, He accepts his repentance. Despite all their lies, immorality, falsehood, disbelief and stubbornness, and saying what they said about the Messenger SH and the Qur'an, He still invites them to repent and give up their sin, and to come to Islam and true guidance. This is like the Ayat \$ VS U kV 'jiu yj\ 13> sJl \$3 \ T < ,Jf VVjOX iV iSurely, disbelievers are those who said: "Allah is the third of the three." But there is no god but One God. And if they cease not from what they say, verily, a painful torment will befall on the disbelievers among them. Will they not turn with repentance to Allah and ask His forgiveness? For Allah is Oft-

Al-Furqdn (7 - 14) (Part-18 Forgiving, Most Merciful.> (5:73- 74) SssSB ^ ii ?^ v'j*\$ 'fvr iVerily, those who put into trial the believing men and believing women, and then do not him in repentance, then they will have the torment of Hell, and they will have the punishment of the burning Fire.) (85:10) Al-Hasan Al-Basri said: Look at this kindness and generosity! They killed His friends and He is calling them to repentance and mercy. \ZLjr \jX\ Uijo Ci cy, lyii ^ iy-j C(o-iZ 47. And they say: Why does this Messenger eat food, and walk about in the markets. Why is not an angel sent down to him to be a wamer with him?"\$

146 Tafstr Ibn Kathir 48. "Or (why) has not a treasure been granted to him, or why has he not a garden whereofhe may eat? And the wrongdoers say: "You follow none but a man bewitched."} 49. See how they coin similitudes for you, so they have gone astray, and they cannotfind a path.} 410. Blessed be He Who, if He wills, will assign you better than (all) that - Gardens under which rivers flow and will assign you palaces.} 411. Nay, they deny the Hour, and for those who deny the Hour, We have prepared aflaming Fire.} 412. When it sees them from a far place, they will hear its raging and its roaring.} 413. And when they shall be thrown into a narrow place thereof, chained together, they will exclaim therein for destruction .} 414. Exclaim not today for one destruction, but exclaim for many destructions.} What the Disbelievers said about the Messenger refutation ofTheir Words, and Their ultimate Destiny Allah tells us about the disbelievers stubborn resistance to and rejection of the truth, with no proof or evidence for doing so. Their excuse was, as they said: 4.X-*k)t J\fJJS Oc* At} 4Why does this Messenger eatfood,} meaning, as we eat, andwhy does he need food as we need it? 4and walk about in the markets.} means, he walks around and goes there often seeking to trade and earn a living. 4Why is not an angel sent down to him to be a wamer with him?} They were saying: why doesn t an angel come down to him from Allah, to be a witness that what he is claiming is true? This is like when FiraVn said:

^ mJL* t_-4i % then are not golden bracelets bestowed on him, or angels sent along with him?"} (43:53). These people had a similar mentality and said the same kind of thing. They said: 4i& -\} 40r (why) has not a treasure beeti granted to him?} meaning, treasure that he could spend on his needs and wants. V-A uVj^(-)} ior why 1ms he not a garden whereofhe may eat?} meaning, a garden that would go with him wherever he went. All of this is easy for Allah, but He had a reason for not doing any of these things, and with Him is the perfect proof and argument. ji j\j} iAnd the wrongdoers say: "You follow none but a man bewitched."} Allah said: // /.{ "" I iy/ ^ .> ^ 4jLoi JWV1 jjj Jtif iSee how they coin similitudes for you, so they have gone astray,} meaning, they accused you and belied you when they said that you were a sorcerer or bewitched or crazy or a liar or a poet, but all of these are false ideas. Eveiyone who has the slightest understanding will recognize that they are lying. Allah says: iso they have gone astray} from the path of guidance. iand they cannotfind a path.} Everyone who steps outside of the way of truth and guidance has gone astray, no matter what direction he takes, because the truth is one and its methodol- ogy is unified, parts of it confirming other parts. Then Allah tells His Prophet that if He willed, He could

bestow on him in this world something far better than what they were saying. He said: (y (jy- ill! ^ oj. XSJ& iBlessed be He Who, if He wills, will assign you better than (all) that...} Mujahid said, This means in this world. And he said: The Quraysh used to call every house that was made of stone a palace , whether it was large or small. 111 \y'& j.'^ iNay, they deny the Hour,} means, they say this in

stubborn disbelief, not because they are seeking insight and guidance, but because their disbelief in the Day of Resurrection makes them say what they say. 4And We have prepared} means, We have made ready, MdC v-i6*" J4} ifor those who deny the Hour, aflaming Fire.} means, an unbearably hot and painful torment in the fire of Hell. iWhen it sees them} means, when Hell sees them, ifrom a far place,} means from the place of gathering (on the Day of Resurrection), U [y^} ithey will hear its raging and its roaring.} means, (it will make those sounds) out of hatred towards them. This is like the Ayah, }When they are cast therein, they will hear the (terrible) m At-Tabari 19:243.

Al-Furqan (7 - 14) (Part-18) drawing in of its breath as it blazes forth. It almost bursts up withfury" (67:7-8), which means that parts of it almost separate from other parts because of its intense hatred towards those who disbelieved in Allah. Imam Abu Ja far bin Jarir narrated that Ibn Abbas said: A man will be dragged towards Hell, which will be expanding and contracting, and Ar-Rahman will say to it: What is the matter with you? It will say: He is seeking refuge from me. So Allah will say, *Let My servant go. Another man will be dragged towards Hell and he will say, O Lord, I never expected this from You. Allah will say, What did you expect? The man will say, 1 expected that Your mercy would be great enough to include me. So Allah will say, Let My servant go. Another man will be dragged towards Hell, and Hell will bray at him like a donkey braying at barley. Then it will give a moan that will instill fear in everyone. 11 ' Its chain of narrators is Sahth. 4U& U 4they will hear its raging and its roaring> Abdur-Razzaq recorded that TJbayd bin TJmayr said: Hell will utter a moan such that there will be no angel who is close to Allah and no Prophet sent to mankind, but he will fall on his face, shaking all over. Even Ibrahim, peace be upon him, will fall to his knees and say: O Lord, I do not ask You for salvation this Day except for myself. ' ULi Ijl& lyjl 4And when they shall be thrown into a narrow place thereof, chained together, Qatadah narrated from Abu Ayyub that Abdullah bin Amr said: Like the point of a spear, i.e., in its narrowness.Tabari 9:370. Abdur-Razzaq 3 :67 I3 Ad-Durr Al-Manthur 6:240, Az-Zuhd by Ibn Al-Mubarak in Az- Zawa id 86.

whom He has shown His favor. He says: \$It is a upon your Lord a Wa'dan Mas'fda) meaning, it must inevitably come to pass. Abu Jafar bin Jarir reported from some of the scholars of the Arabic language that the words iWa'dan Mas'iila) mean: a binding pledge. In this Surah Allah mentions Hell, then refers to the situation of the people of Paradise. This is similar to the passage in Surat As-Saffat where Allah mentions the status of the people of Paradise, with its beauty and joy, then He says: SJifS JjX'y P\$ oj ^ ^ :;ojs3f 4/s that better entertainment or the tree ofZaqqim? Tndy, We have made it a trial for the wrongdoers. Verily, it is a tree that springs out of the bottom of Hellfire, The shoots of its fruit stalks are like the heads ofShaydtin. Tndy, they will eat thereof and fill their bellies therewith . Then on the top of tluit they will be given boiling water to drink so that it becomes a mixture. Then thereafter, verily, their return is to the flaming fire of Hell. Verily, they found their fathers on the wrong path. So they hastened in theirfootsteps!) (37:62-70) > .,/ W' . > >* * ,// >>>. /t/v " 4W U>> \AJ n C\$J JA jicj ^ u U ijJli lIS \1j xii 1 ^^= iii pUL' Sfj lip 427. And on the Day when He will gather them togetlier and that which they worship besides Allah. He will say: 'Was it you who tnisled these My servants or did they stray from the At-Tabari 19:247.

152 Tafstr Ibn Kathir path?"} 418. They will say: "Glorified be You! It was notfor us to take any Awliya' besides You, but You gave them and their fathers comfort till they forgot the warning, and

became a lost people. } 419. Thus they will deny you in what you say; then you can neither avert nor find help. And whoever among you does wrong, We shall make him taste a great torment.} The godsofthe IdolatorswilldisownThem ontheDayof Resurrection Allah tells us about what will happen on the Day of Resurrection, when those whom the idolators used to worship instead of Allah, angels and others, will rebuke them. Allah says: / AA " OJJ ot AAA / < **V fjfj 4And on the Day when He will gather them together and that which they worship besides Allah.} Mujahid said, This means Isa, TJzayr and the angels. 43j& jaw Jjit 4He will say: "Was it you who misled these My servants...?"} Allah will say to those who were worshipped: T)id you call these people to worship you instead of Me, or was it their own idea to worship you, without any call to that on your part? This is like the Ayah, JB jif ojilil Sis 'if ts-ilr-l *f)} 4 2 4 S4 \$ 3 4 c & 4,h jS3% 4And when Allah will say : "O Isa, son ofMaryam! Did you say unto men : Worship me and my mother as two gods besides Allah? " He will say: "Glory be to You! It was not far me to say what I had no right (to say). Had I said such a thing, You m At-Tabari 19:247.

Al-Furqan (15 - 19) (Part-18) would surely have known it. You know what is in my innerself though I do not know what is in Yours ; truly, You, only You, are the All-Knower of all that is hidden. Never did I say to them aught except what You did command me to say."} (5:116-117) Describing how those who were worshipped will respond on

the Day of Resurrection, Allah says:

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4021–4043]

Si os 5 o' ft C 4They will say : "Glorified be You! It was not for us to take (Nattakhidh) any Awliyid besides You..." } Most of the scholars recite a Fathah on the Nun of the word Nattakhidh in His saying: 4'Qi it ot '& } 4" ...for us to take (Nattakhidh) any Awliyid' besides You,"} meaning, it is not right for any created being, neither us nor them, to worship anyone except You; we did not call them to do that, but they did it of their own accord, without us telling them to do it or accepting what they did. We are innocent of them and their worship. This is like the Ayah, 4And (remember) the Day when He will gather them all together, then He will say to the angels : "Was it you that these people used to worship?" They (the angels) will say: "Glorified be You!"} (34:40-41) Other scholars understand this phrase to mean: it is not proper for us to take anyone except You as protectors or helpers (Awliyid), meaning, it is not proper for anyone to worship us, for we are Your servants and in need of You. This meaning is close to the first. 4but You gave them and theirfathers comfort} means, You made such a long period of time pass that they forgot the Reminder, i.e., they forgot what had been sent down to them through the Messengers, calling them to worship You alone with no partner or associate.

%WS> iand became a lost people.} Ibn Abbas said, This means, they were destroyed. *^ Al-Hasan Al-Basri and Malik narrated from Az-Zuhri: There was no good in them. ! And Allah says: iThus they will deny you because ofwhat you say;} meaning, those whom you used to worship besides Allah will show you to be liars in your claims that they were your helpers and protectors bringing you closer to Allah. This is like the Ayah jc- |Uj sy Ji yi V iy ji> Ly } J** j-J yj} 4And who is more astray than one who calls on besides Allah, such as will not answer him till the Day of Resurrection, and who are unaware of their calls to them . And when mankind are gathered, they will become their enemies and will deny

their worshipping.} (46:5-6) 4then you can neither avert nor find help.} means: they will not be able to avert the punishment from themselves, nor will they be able to help themselves. i.^== 4And iwhoever among you does wrong,} means by associating others in worship with Allah, li'-if- *jx} }We shall make him taste a great torment.} 4 iJs'Li^ S; iXi ~ j} At-T*bari 19:248.Ti.bari 19:248.

Al-Furqdn (20) (Part-18 420. And We never sent before you any of the Messengers but verily, they ate food and walked in the markets. And We have made some of you as a trial for others; will you have patience? And your Lord is Ever All-Seer.} All of the Previous Messengers were Human Allah tells us about the previous Messengers He sent: they all used to eat food needing the nourishment in it. They used to go around in the marketplaces seeking to engage in trade and earn a livelihood. This should not, however, affect their status as Messengers, for Allah gave them good characteristics and caused them to speak fine words and do noble deeds, and gave them miracles and clear proofs, from which any person with sound insight may see the confirmation that what they brought from Allah was true. This Ayah is similar to the Ayat, oj zj4^ [oft %} iAnd We sent not before you any but men unto wlmw We revealed, from among the people of townships} (12:109). 4fU l" oj 'jui p (>" Uj} iAnd We did not create them bodies that ate not food} (21:8). iAnd We have made some of you as a trial for others; will you have patience?} means, *We test some of you by means of others, so that We may see who will be obedient and who will be disobedient. Allah says: iwill you have patience? And your Lord is Ever All-Seer.} meaning. He knows who deserves to receive revelation, as Allah says elsewhere: iAllah knows best with whom to place His Message} (6:124). And He knows who deserves to be guided to the Message with which He sent them, and who does not deserve to be guided.

156 Tafair Von Kathir iAnd We have made some of you as a trial for others. Will you have patience Muhammad bin Ishaq said: Allah is saying, If I had willed that the world be such that no one would oppose My Messengers, I could have made it so, but I wanted to test My servants by means of them. 111 In Sahih

are not the angels sent down to us, or why do we not see our Lord?" Indeed they think too highly of themselves, and are scornful with great pride. 422 . On the Day they will see the angels - no good news will there be for the criminals that day. And they will say: "Hijran Mahjura."} 423. And We shall turn to whatever deeds they did, and We shall make such deeds as scattered floating particles of dust.} 424. The dwellers of Paradise will, on that Day, have the best abode, and have the fairest of places for repose. The Stubbornness of the Disbelievers Allah describes how stubborn the disbelievers were in their disbelief when they said: iWhy are not the angels sent down to us,} meaning, so that we may see them with our own eyes and they may tell us that Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah. This is like when they said: 4 A\$ 4or you bring Allah and the angels before (us) face to face} (17:92). Hence they also said: t 4&>& ior why do we not see our Lord?} Allah said: 4(4& xjt fH} iIndeed they think too highly of themselves, and are scornful with great pride.} And Allah says: }And even if We had sent down unto them angels, and the dead had spoken unto them ...} (6: 1 1 1)

iVerily, those who say: "Our Lord is Allah," and then they stand firm, on them the angels will descend (saying) : "Fear not, nor grieve! But receive the good news of Paradise which you have been promised! We have been your friends in the life of this world and are (so) in the Hereafter. Therein you shall have what your souls desire, and therein you shall have what you ask for. Entertainment from, the Oft-

Forgiving, Most Merciful. } (41:30-32) According to an authentic Hadith narrated from Al-Bara bin Azib, the angels say to the believer's soul (at the time of death): Come out, O good soul in a good body, as you were dwelling in it. Come out to rest and pleasant fragrances and a Lord Who is not angry. 111 Other scholars said that the Ayah: iOn the Day they will see the angels - no good neios} refers to the Day of Resurrection. This was the view of Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak and others. But there is no contradiction between these two views, because on both of these days - the day of death and the Day of Resurrection - the angels will appear to the believers and disbelievers, and they will give glad tidings of divine mercy and pleasure to the believers, while they will give the disbelievers news that will bring regret and sorrow, so there will be no glad tidings for the evildoers and criminals on that Day. iAnd they (angels) will say: "Hijran Malijura."} The angels will say to the disbelievers: success is forbidden to you this day. The basic meaning of Al-Hijr is preventing or prohibition, hence the word is used in the phrase Hajara Al- m Muslim 4 :2202

260 TafsTr Ibn Kathir Qadi Ala Fulan (or, The judge prohibited so and so.) when he forbids him to dispose of his wealth in cases of bankruptcy, folly, being underage, etc. The name of Al-Hijr (the low semicircular wall near the Ka'bah) is also derived from this root, because it prevents people from Tawaf inside it, since they have to go behind it. The mind is also called Al-Hijr, because it prevents a person from indulging in things that do not benefit him. In conclusion, the pronoun in the phrase. 4And they will say} refers to the angels. This was the view of Mujahid, Ikrimah, Al-Hasan, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah, Atiyyah Al- Awfi, Ata Al- Khurasani, Khusayf and others; it was also the view favored by Ibn Jarir.111 Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn Jurayj said that this referred to the words of the idolaters. 121 40n the Day they will see the angels} means, they will seek refuge from the angels. This is because when disaster and hardship struck, the Arabs would say: 4"Hijran Malijura."} Although there is a point to what Ibn Jurayj said, from the context it is unlikely that this is what was meant, and the majority of scholars said something different. it |As* J', 4And We shall him to whatever deeds they did,} This refers to the Day of Resurrection, when Allah will bring mankind to account for their deeds, good and bad alike. Allah tells us that the deeds which these idolaters thought would bring them salvation will be of no avail to them, because they were not in accordance with the Sharpah or Laws of Allah, whether in terms of sincere intention or in terms of following the Laws set out by Allah. Every deed that is neither sincere nor in accordance with the Laws of Allah is futile, and theTabari 19 :256, Al-MuharrarAl-Wajtz 4 : 206.Tabari 19:254.

Al-Furqan (21 - 24) (Part-19 deeds of the disbelievers are either one or the other, or they may include both, in which case they are even less likely to be accepted. Allah says: iAnd We shall him to xuhatever deeds they did, and We shall make such deeds as scatteredfloating particles of dust.) Sufyan Ath-Thawri, narrated from Abu Ishaq, from Al-Harith that Ali, may Allah be pleased with him, commented on Allah's saying: iand We shall make such deeds as scattered floating particles of dust (Habit').} The rays of the sun when they pass through a small aperture. A similar view was also narrated through a different chain of narrators from Ali, and something similar was also narrated from Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, As-Suddi, Ad-Dahhak and others. Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, This refers to the rays coming through a small window, and if anyone tries to grasp them, he cannot. Abu Al-Ahwas narrated from Abu Ishaq from Al- Harith that Ali said: Haba refers to the dust raised by animals. A similar view was also narrated from Ibn Abbas and Ad-Dahhak, and this was also said by Abdur-

Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam. is scattered floating particles of dust (Haba').} Qatadah said: Have you not seen dry trees when they are blown by the wind? This refers to those leaves. It was narrated that Ya'la bin Ubayd said: Ashes or dust when it is stirred up by the wind. In conclusion, all of these views are pointing out that the deeds of the disbelievers will be like some worthless scattered thing, and will be of no avail to them whatsoever. As Allah says: At-Jabari 19:257 258. * At-Tabari 19:257. * At-Tabari 19:258.

162 Tafstr Ibn KathTr 4& * & Z0 Ig. ! 2T & } 4The parable of those who disbelieved in their Lord is that their works are as ashes, on which the wind blows furiously (14:18). 4is>% V \pa bM 40 you who believe! Do not render in vain your charity by reminders of your generosity or by injury,} until His saying: iThey are not able to do anything with what they Ixvve earned> (2:264). 4ki iJ4 ji ;:ts; & \$ & 4X^ i;^=. 4As for those who disbelieved, their deeds are like a mirage in a desert. The thirsty one thinks it to be water, until he comes up to it, he finds it to be nothing (24:39). The Abode of the People of Paradise Allah says: / ' . / ' i C' i f t \ } The dwellers of Paradise will, on that Day, have the best abode, and have the fairest of places for repose.} meaning, on the Day of Resurrection. <\$5#* jU jisif 4^-1 fen 4PlsNot equal are the dwellers of the Fire and the dwellers of the Paradise. It is the dwellers of Paradise that will be successful} (59:20). That is because the people of Paradise will ascend to lofty degrees and secure dwellings, so they will be in a place of safety, beauty and goodness, fcjj 4Abiding therein - excellent it is as an abode, and as a place to rest in.} (25:76) The people of Hell will go down to the lowest levels and

continual regret, with all kinds of punishments and torments. ^ ,yi liLLij iEvil indeed it (Hell) is as an abode and as a place to rest in.>(25:66) means, how evil a dwelling place to look at, and how evil an abode in which to stay. Allah says: li3* tSLi% iXX iThe dwellers of Paradise will, on that Day, have the best abode, and have the fairest of places for repose meaning, in return for what they have done of acceptable deeds, they will attain what they will attain and reach the status they will reach, in contrast to the people of Hell, who will not have even one deed to their credit that would qualify them to enter Paradise and be saved from the Fire. Allah points out the situation of the blessed in contrast to that of the doomed, who will not enjoy any goodness at all. Said bin Jubayr said: Allah will finish the Judgement halfway through the Day, and the people of Paradise will take their mid day rest in Paradise and the people of Hell in Hell. Allah says: 5 / iThe dwellers of Paradise will, on that Day, have the best abode, and have the fairest of places for repose. Ikrimah said, I know the time when the people of Paradise will enter Paradise and the people of Hell will enter Hell. It is the time which in this world is the time when the late forenoon starts and people go back to their families to take a siesta. The people of Hell will go to Hell, but the people of Paradise will be taken to Paradise and will have their siesta in Paradise, and they will be fed the liver of a whale and they will all eat their fill. This is what Allah says: itfi&y Hrs. iThe dwellers of Paradise will, on that Day, have the best abode, and have the fairest of places for repose.^

164 Tafslr Ibn Kathir CiXjet gfoj Sy*^ j* ,j- i f_W tiiCL 31 i =>% J3 13 ti# i*i ^ ^iMM 4&~" 425. And (remember) the Day when the heaven shall be rent asunder with clouds, and the angels will be sent down, with a grand descending .) 426. The sovereignty on that Day will be the true (sovereignty) of the Most Gracious, and it will be a hard Day for the disbelievers .) 427. And (remember) the Day when the

wrongdoer will bite at his hands, he will say: "Oh! Would that I had taken a path with the Messenger.) 428. "Ah! Woe to me! Would that I had never taken so-and-so as an intimate friend!") 429. "He indeed led me astray from the Reminder after it had come to me. And Shaytan is to man ever a deserter.") The Terrors of the Day of Resurrection, and how the Wrongdoers will wish that They had taken a Path with the Messenger. Here Allah tells us about the terror of the Day of Resurrection and the tremendous events that will happen, including the splitting of heavens when they are pierced by the clouds, that is the shadow of the magnificent light which dazzles all sight. The angels of heaven will come down on that Day and surround all creatures at the place of gathering, then the Lord, may He be blessed and exalted, will come to pass judgement. Mujahid said, This is as Allah says: 4i^ij j>& 4*& 4Do they then wait for anything other than that Allah should come to them in the shadows of the clouds and the angels?) (2:210)m IM At-Tabari 19:260.

Al-Furqan (25 - 29) {Part-19} iThe sovereignty on that Day will be the true (sovereignty) of the Most Gracious,} This is like the Ayah, iWhose is the kingdom this Day? : It is Allah's, the One, the Irresistable!} (40:16) In the Sahih it says: 'J fj/j#ji 'JV3 1 41)1 O Vi hjs 'jS ocin iji iio lm "Allah, may He be exalted, will fold up the heavens in His Right Hand, and will take the earths in His other Hand, then He will say: I am the Sovereign, I am the Judge. Where are the kings of the earth? Where are the tyrants? Where are the arrogants <> ^^=6} iand it will be a hard Day for the disbelievers .} means it will be very difficult, because it will be the Day of justice and the decisive judgement, as Allah says: iTruly, that Day will be a hard Day - Far from easy for the disbelievers (74:9-10). This is how the disbelievers will be on the Day of Resurrection. As for the believers, Allah says: i'fkJti pi *> 4The greatest terror will not grieve them.} ^ olkf jjSTj *Ji' jc Jj; fj} iAnd (remember) the Day when the wrongdoer will bite at his hands, he will say : O! Would that I had taken a path with the Messenger. } Here Allah tells us of the regret felt by the wrongdoer who |i| FathAl-B&ri 1 1 :379 , Muslim 4 :2148

Al-Furqan (30 - 31) (Part-19 430. And the Messenger will say: "O my Lord! Verily, my people deserted this Qur'an.") 431 . Thus have We made for every Prophet an enemy among the criminals. But sufficient is your Lord as a Guide and Helper.} The Messenger^ will complain against His Opponents Allah tells how His Messenger and Prophet Muhammad will say: O my Lord! Verily, my people deserted this Qur'an. The idolaters would not listen to the Qur'an, as Allah says: 4#j, Uil V cjiS' iAnd those who disbelieve say: "Listen not to this Qur'an, and make noise in the midst of it."} (41:26). When he would recite Qur'an to them, they would talk nonsense or speak about something else, so that they would not hear it. This is a form of forsaking it and rejecting it, and not believing in it is the same as forsaking it, and not pondering its meanings and trying to understand it is the same as forsaking it, and not acting upon it and following its commandments and heeding its prohibitions is the same as forsaking it, and turning away from it in favor of poetry or other words or songs or idle talk or some other way is the same as forsaking it. We ask Allah, the Most Generous, the Bestower of bounty, the One Who is able to do what He wills, to keep us safe from doing that which earns His wrath and to use us to do that which will earn His pleasure of preserving and understanding His Book, following its commandments night and day in the manner which He loves and which pleases Him, for He is Generous and Kind. {Thus have We made for every Prophet an enemy among the criminals.} means, just as there is for you, O Muhammad, those people who scorned the Qur'an, so in all the previous

nations did Allah make for every Prophet an enemy among the criminals, who called people to their misguidance and disbelief, as Allah says:

g p, OZ && } oii} c&Q- iAttd so We have appointed for every Pro- phet enemies - Shaydtfn among mankind and Jinn as stated in these two Ayat. (6:112) Allah says here: ^ Ljjla y iBut sufficient is your Lord as a Guide and Helper.} meaning, for the one who follows His Messenger jfe and believes in His Book, Allah will be his Guide and Helper in this world and the Hereafter. Allah says \$a Guide and Helper.} because the idolators used to try to prevent people from following the Qur an lest anyone be guided by it. They wanted their way to prevail over the way of the Qur an. Allah says: iThus have We made for every Prophet an enemy among the criminals.} jlJJI .Jj oil idS' Ai==> \1~J si*. gc J_ Vp Jij} \$ ^ 'A&

Al-Furqan (32 - 34) (Part-19) <\$32. And those who disbelieve say: "Why is not the Qur'an revealed to him all at once? Thus, that We may strengthen your heart thereby. And We have revealed it to you gradually, in stages. <\$33. And no example or parable do they bring, but We reveal to you the truth, and the better explanation thereof.} <\$34. Those who will be gathered to Hell on their faces, such will be in an evil state, and most astray from the path.} The Reason why the Qur an was revealed in Stages, the Refutation of the Disbelievers, and their Evil End Allah tells us about the many objections raised by the disbelievers, their stubbornness, and how they spoke of things which were none of their concern. They said: i Why is not the Qur'an revealed to him all at once?"} meaning, why was this Qur an, which was revealed to him, not sent down all at one time, as the previous Books, the Tawrah, Injil, Zabur and other Divine Books? Allah answered them, telling them that it was revealed in stages over twenty-three years, according to events and circumstances, and whatever rulings were needed, in order to strengthen the hearts of the believers, as He says: 4And (it is) a Qur an which We have divided (into parts)...} (17:106). Allah says: iiiia3\$ sSi} ithat We may strengthen your heart thereby. And We have revealed it to you gradually, in stages.} Qatadah said it means: We have explained it. Abdur- Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said it means: We have given its interpretation. |i| At-Tabari 19:266.

Al-Furqan (35 - 40) (Part-19) make him walk on his face on the Day of Resurrection .n ' tail L'.Ui . lLU- j v^=j' isyQ l* T j} . > " : * : < < > ! , ; ; ' : > ' : * / * ; . pi?" .tr L* - ^ = U gy j*j' j' '\$, 'J' '\$J' (HV- ** ! * " { \$; 0 cz% zps ; | : q > cstf; p & z fev? a fe < ^ s % 4 , i'] , - CZlftV. y \j & = a j ; \yjf -- = * i jrtj' fjj' jJ' 435. And indeed We gave Musa the Scripture, and placed his brother Hariin with him as a helper;} 436. And We said: Go you both to the people wlio have denied Our Aydt." Then We destroyed them with utter destruction .} 437. And Niih s people, when they denied the Messengers, We drowned them, and We made them as a sign for mankind. And We have prepared a painful torment for the wrongdoers.} 438. And (also) "Ad and Thamiid, and the Dwellers of Ar- Rass, and many generations in between.} 439. And for each We put forward examples, and each We brought to utter ruin.} 440. And indeed they have passed by the town on which was rained the evil rain. Did they not then see it? Nay! But they used not to expect any resurrection .} Frightening the Idolaters of Quraysh Allah threatens the idolators who denied and opposed His Messenger Muhammad ^ and He warns them of the punishment and painful torment He sent upon the previous nations who rejected their Messengers. Allah begins by mentioning Musa, upon him be peace, whom He sent along with his brother HarQn as a helper - i.e., as another Prophet who

helped and supported him - but Fir'awn and his chiefs denied them both: iAlldh destroyed them completely, and similar (awaits) the 3:229.

disbelievers> (47:10). And when the people ofNuh denied him, Allah destroyed them likewise, for whoever denies one Messenger denies all the Messengers, because there is no difference between one Messenger and another. If it had so happened that Allah had sent all His Messengers to them, they would have denied them all. Allah says: iAnd Nuh's people, when they denied the Messengers although Allah sent only NOh to them, and he stayed among them for 950 years, calling them to Allah and warning them of His punishment, m^ sa; 'Uj> iAnd none believed with him, except afew (11:40). For this reason Allah drowned them all and left no one among the sons ofAdam alive on earth apart from those who boarded the boat. iand We made them a sign for mankind.> meaning a lesson to be learned. This is like the Ayah, iVerily, when the water rose beyond its limits, We carried you in the boat. That We might make it a remembrance for you, and the keen ear may understand it> (69:1 1-12), which means: We left for you ships that you ride upon to travel across the depths of the seas, so that you may remember the blessing of Allah towards you when He saved you from drowning, and made you the descendants of those who believed in Allah and followed His commandments. iAnd (also) 'Ad and Thamud, and the Dwellers ofAr-Rass We have already discussed their story, which is referred to in more than one Surah, such as Surat Al-A raf [I] and there is m See volume four, the Tafsirof Surat Al-A raf.

Al-Furqan (35 - 40) (Part-19) no need to repeat it here. As for the Dwellers of Ar-Rass, Ibn Jurayj narrated from Ibn Abbas about the Dwellers of Ar-Rass that they were the people of one of the villages of Thamud.' Ath-Thawri narrated from Abu Bukayr from Ikrimah that Ar- Rass was a well where they buried (Rassu) their Prophet.12' iand many generations in between.} means nations, many more than have been mentioned here, whom We destroyed. Allah said: iAndfor each We putforward examples,} meaning, *We showed them the proof and gave them clear evidence, as Qatadah said, They had no excuse. '3 ' iand each (ofthem) We brought to utter ruin.} means, *We destroyed them completely. This is like the Ayah, iAnd how many generations (Quriin) have We destroyed after Null!} (17:17). Generations (Qurun) here refers to nations among mankind. This is like the Ayah, iThen, after them, We created other generations (Quriin).} (23:42) Some defined a generation as being 120 years, or it was said that a generation was one hundred years, or eighty, or forty, etc. The most correct view is that a generation refers to nations who are one another s contemporaries, living at the same time. When they go and others succeed them, this is another generation, as it was recorded in the Two Sahihs: '* At-Tabari 19:269. 21 Al-Baghawi 3 :369 , Al-Qurtubi 13 :32 At-Tabari 19:272.

"77ie best of generations is my generation, then the one that follows it, then the one thatfollows thatJ ll] 'jSk* OpJ jf ijii indeed they have passed by the town on which was rained the evil rain.} refers to the town of the people of Lut, which was called Sodom, and the way in which Allah dealt with it, when He destroyed it by turning it upside down and by sending upon it the rain of stones of baked clay, as Allah says: ;n \$ 4And We rained on them a rain . And how evil was the rain of those who had been warned!} (26:176), \$3 ;'g: A# 4Verily, you pass by than in the morning. And at night; will you not then reflect?} (37:137-138), 4\$d iAnd verily, they were right on the highroad.} (15:76), iThey are both on an open highway, plain to see (15:79). Allah says: 4Did they not then see it?} meaning, so that they might learn

a lesson from what happened to its inhabitants of punishment for denying the Messenger and going against the commands of Allah. Nay! But they used not to expect any resurrection.} means, the disbelievers who passed by it did not learn any lesson, because they did not expect any resurrection, i.e., on Fath Al-Bari 5 :306 , Muslim 4 :1963

the Day of Judgement. 0^ A iSf' l i 0* bLiJ jI = it} lIj3XA> 14& eSJi 4' vi 4j.c -"<" ><*/-' v-L^W c# 5*^ i3 * " >' <, T""Sf - OJUl " MVl l> r' * oj^ f >' ' "I ! > "-5 _ O V *ff " * C " #y" j) pluVIf V) |"A iAi" And when they see you, they treat you only in mockery (saying): Is this the one whom Allah has sent as a Messenger?"} 442. "He would have nearly misled us from our gods, had it not been that we were patient and constant in their worship! And they will know, when they see the torment, who it is that is most astray from the path!"} 443 . Have you seen him who has taken as his god his own vain desire? Would you then be a guardian over him?"} 444. Or do you think that most of them hear or understand? They are only like cattle - nay, they are even farther astray from the path.}

How the Disbelievers mocked the Messenger

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4043–4067]

Allah tells us how the disbelievers mocked the Messenger, when they saw him. This is like the Ayah, &mm Hi tmmm ^ * ^ss, ./ s * ?,-' ? . >' ;4-^" r.-i -r^^^ ^ r Jftykj^

Tii>* -tJ'iy w/ien the disbelievers see you, they take you not except for mockery}' (21:36), which means that they tried to find faults and shortcomings in him. Here Allah says: 4'i sM '55 -* o) Mj ^And when they see you, they treat you only in mockery (saying): "Is this the one whom Allah has sent as a Messenger?"} i.e., they said this by way of belittling and trying to undermine him, so Allah put them in their place, and said: 445*& iAnd indeed Messengers before you were mocked at} (6:10) i'L&f bUj tt. iHe would have nearly misled us from our gods,} They meant: He nearly turned us away from worshipping idols, and he would have done so, had we not been patient and persevered in our ways. So Allah said, warning and threatening them: iAnd they will know, when they see the torment...} They took Their Desires as their gods and were more astray than Cattle Then Allah tells His Prophet jg that if Allah decrees that someone will be misguided and wretched, then no one can guide him except Allah, gloiy be to Him: Xj\ ilyfy iHave you seen him who has taken as his god his own vain desire?} meaning, whatever he admires and sees as good in his own desires becomes his religion and his way. As Allah says:

41s he then, to whom the evil of his deeds is made fair seeming. So that he consider it as good. Verily, Allah sends astray whom he wills.} [35:8] 4U=j& ^} iWould you then be a guardian over him?} Ibn Abbas said: During the Jahiliyyah, a man would worship a white rock for a while, then if he saw another that looked better, he would worship that and leave the first. Then Allah said: ikfe i pUJ 34^ ft iOr do you think that most of them hear or understand?} meaning, they are worse than grazing cattle. Cattle only do what they were created to do, but these people were created to worship Allah Alone without associating partners with Him, but they worship others with Him, even though evidence has been established against them and Messengers have been sent to them. & oZbi uZ 2 gc 2 jg jiii 3 \$} fPS 'p& 4^% 5U5 2 445. Have you not seen how your Lord spread the shadow. If He willed, He could

have made it still - but We have made the sun its guide.} 446. Then We withdraw it towards Ourselves - a gradual withdrawal.} 447. And it is He Who makes the night a covering for you, and the sleep (as) a repose, and makes the day Nushiir.} Evidence of the existence of the Creator and the extent of His Power Here Allah begins explaining the evidence for His existence l 1 * Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :260

and His perfect power to create various things and pairs of opposites. Allah says: iHave you not seen how your Lord spread the shadow. Ibn Abbas, Ibn Umar, Abu Al-'Aliyah, Abu Malik, Masruq, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, An-Nakhal, Ad-Dahhak, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, As-Suddi and others said, This refers to the period from the beginning of the dawn until the sun rises. i&C iw to ilfHe willed, He could have made it still meaning, immobile, never changing. This is like the Ayat. iSay : Tell me! If Allah made the night continuous for you... >(28:71) ui& uu. 'to iBut We have made the sun its guide.} means, were it not for the sun rising, it would not be there, for a thing can only be known in contrast to its opposite. Qatadah and As-Suddi said, The sun is a guide which follows the shade until the shade disappears. ' Ci tji^ to iThen We withdraw it towards Ourselves - a gradual withdrawal.} This refers to the shade. .} i gradual} meaning slowly. As-Suddi said: A gentle, concealed, withdrawal until there is no shade left on earth except under a roof or a tree, and the sun is shining on whatever is above it. 4a gradual withdrawal.} Ayyub bin MQsa said: Little by At-Tabari 19 :275, Al-Qurtubi 13:37. ' Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :262

Al-Furqan (47 - 50) (Part-19) little. icq p S 4And it is He Who makes the night a covering for you,} It covers and conceals all things. This is like the Ayah: 4By the night as it envelops> (92:1). 4and the sleep a repose, means, a halt to movement so that bodies may rest. For the faculties and limbs get tired from their constant movement during the day when one goes out to earn a living. When night comes, and it becomes quiet, they stop moving, and rest; so sleep provides a rejuvenation for both the body and the soul. 4and makes the day Nushur meaning, people get up and go out to earn a living and attend to their business. This is like the Ayah: % i* a s&b 4It is out of His mercy that He has made for you the night and the day that you may rest therein and that you may seek of His bounty...} (28:73) CfcQ In ^ Juj of j*f} jji \jp4 (4%. jil) Lili- iLj J j; ajjj 448. And it is He Who sends the winds as heralds of glad tidings, going before His mercy; and We send down pure Water from the sky,} 449. That We may give life thereby to a dead land, and We give to drink thereof many of the cattle and men that We have created.} I" Ad-DurrAl-Manthiir 6 :262

i50. And indeed We have distributed it among them in order that they may remember the grace of Allah, but most men refuse (out of) gratitude. This is also part of His complete power and supreme authority: Allah sends the winds as heralds of glad tidings, i.e., they bring the clouds behind them. The winds are of many different types, depending on the purpose for which they are sent. Some of them form the clouds, others carry the clouds or drive them, and others come ahead of the clouds as heralds announcing their coming. Some of them come before that to stir up the earth, and some of them fertilize or seed the clouds to make it rain. Allah says: iand We send down pure water from the sky}, meaning, as a means of purifying it. Abu Sa^d said, It was said: O Messenger of Allah, can we perform Wudu with the water of the well of Buda'ah? For it is a well in which rubbish and the flesh of dogs are thrown. He said: zxx v^ iui aWater is pure and nothing makes it impure ." This was recorded by Ash-Shafil and Ahmad, who graded it Sahih, and also by Abu Dawud and At-Tirmidhi, who graded it Hasan, and by

An-Nasal. His saying: i'iz ij jJii} iThat We may give life thereby to a dead land,} means, a land that waited a long time for rain. It is devoid of vegetation or anything at all. When the rain comes to it, it becomes alive and its hills are covered with all kinds of colorful flowers, as Allah says: izz as uj i >} ibut when We send down water to it, it is stirred to life and (1 ' Musnad Ash-Sh&fi'i 1 :21 , Ahmad 3 : 31 ; Abu Dawud 1 :53, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 1 :203, An-Nasal 1 :174

Al-Furqan (48 - 50) (Part-19) growth...} (41:39). His saying: tL* (CxXj} iand We give to drink thereofmany of the cattle and men that We had created.} means, so that animals such as cattle can drink from it, and people who are in desperate need of water can drink from it and water their crops and fruits. This is like the Ayah: jJu Cfi ' dj? csjl' j*j} iAnd He it is Who sends down the rain after they have despaired,} (42:28) j&ff J. SC 31 iLook then at the effects of Allah's mercy, how He revives the earth after its death.} (30:50) His saying: < !# \$And indeed We have distributed it among them in order that they may remember} means, We cause rain to fall on this land and not on that, and We cause the clouds to pass over one land and go to another, where We cause sufficient rain to fall so that its people have plenty, but not one drop falls on the first land. There is a reason and great wisdom behind this. Ibn Abbas and Ibn Mas'ud, may Allah be pleased with them said: One year does not have more rain than another, but Allah distributes the rain as He wills. Then he recited this Ayah: iAnd indeed We have distributed it (rain or water) amongst them in order that they may remember the grace of Allah, but most men refuse (out of) ingratitude.} 1^ meaning, so that they may be reminded, when Allah bringsTabari 19:280.

Al-Furqdn (51 - 54) (Part-19) 453. And it is He Who has let free the two seas, this is palatable and sweet, and that is salty and bitter; and He has set a barrier and a complete partition between them.} 454. And it is He Who has created man from water, and has appointed for him kindred by blood, and kindred by marriage. And your Lord is Ever All-Powerful to do what He wills.} The universality of the Prophet s Message, how He was supported in His Mission and Allah's Blessings to Mankind Allah says: 0 4 %} }And had We willed, We would have raised a wamer in every town.} Calling them to Allah, but We have singled you out, O Muhammad, to be sent to all the people of earth, and We have commanded you to convey the Qur an, i' ou -it&&} ithat I may therewith warn you and whomsoever it may reach} (6 : 19). ibut those of the sects that reject it, the Fire will be their promised meeting place} (11 :17). 4Qj . '(1 jX^} }that you may warn the Mother of the Towns and all around it} (42 :7). 4Say: "O mankind! Verily, I am sent to you all as the Messenger ofAllah.. ." } (7 :158). In the Two Sahihs (it is reported that the Prophet said:) J\ "I have been sent to the red and the black . " And:

184 Tafslr Ibn Kathlr -A Prophet would be sent to his own people, but I have been sent to all ofmankind."(11 Allah says: 4*a Ug&K %) obey not the disbelievers, but strive hard against them with it> meaning, with the Qur an. This was the view of Ibn Abbas.! 4 i^=> ^ iwith the utmost endeavour.) This is like the Ayah, 'fe=*JJ 40 Prophet! Strive hard against the disbelievers and the hypocrites,) (9:73) 4.And it is He Who has let free the two seas, this is palatable and sweet, and that is salty and bitter;} means. He has created the two kinds of water, sweet and salty. The sweet water is like that in rivers, springs and wells, which is fresh, sweet, palatable water. This was the view of Ibn Jurayj and of Ibn Jarir, and this is the meaning without a doubt, for nowhere in creation is there a sea which is fresh and sweet. Allah has told us about reality so that His servants may realize His blessings to them and give

thanks to Him. The sweet water is that which flows amidst people. Allah has portioned it out among His creatures according to their needs; rivers and springs in every land, according to what they need for themselves and their lands. ip m Muslim 1 :370, FathAl-Bari 1 :634. At-Tabari 19:281.

185Surah 25, Al-Furqan (51 - 54) (Part-19) 4and that is salty and bitter;} meaning that it is salty, bitter and not easy to swallow. This is like the seas that are known in the east and the west, the Atlantic Ocean and the Straits that lead to it, the Red Sea, the Arabian Sea, the Persian Gulf, the China Sea, the Indian Ocean, the Mediterranean Sea, the Black Sea and so on, all the seas that are stable and do not flow, but they swell and surge in the winter and when the winds are strong, and they have tides that ebb and flow. At the beginning of each month the tides ebb and flood, and when the month starts to wane they retreat until they go back to where they started. When the crescent of the following month appears, the tide begins to ebb again until the fourteenth of the month, then it decreases. Allah, may He be glorified, the One Whose power is absolute, has set these laws in motion, so all of these seas are stationary, and He has made their water salty lest the air turn putrid because of them and the whole earth turn rotten as a result, and lest the earth spoil because of the animals dying on it. Because its water is salty, its air is healthy and its dead are good (to eat), hence when the Messenger of Allah j|| was asked whether sea water can be used for Wudu , he said: "/ts water is pure and its dead are lawful ." This was recorded by Malik, Ash-Shafil and Ahmad, and by the scholars of Sunan with a good [Jayyid] chain of narration. iand He has set a barrier and a complete partition between them.} meaning, between the sweet water and the saltwater. 4a barrier} means a partition, which is dry land. *** Al-Muwattd 1:22, Musnad Ash-Shafi i 1:23, Ahmad 2:361, Abu Dawud 1 :64, TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 1 :224, An-Nasat 1 :50, Ibn Majah

187Siirah 25. Al-Furqan (55 - 60) (Part-19) ibJ,o iand has appointed for him kindred by blood, and kindred by marriage.} in the beginning, he is someone s child, then he gets married and becomes a son-in-law, then he himself has sons-in-law and other relatives through marriage. All of this comes from a despised liquid, Allah says: 4& &} 4And your Lord is Ever All-Powerful to do what He wills.} ip & 'io V t* j* jjamj} A-Zig pf==tLi-*i L js mj! , . ***">>' *?* " if <' Vs. 't' *ti </=*> -JsL ctri ^ S' aL- ^ Li Uj jjJb o^ . jnP J^S *>/>*/ 455. And they worship besides Allah, that which can neither profit them nor harm them ; and the disbeliever is ever a helper against his Lord.} 456. And Vie have sent you only as a bearer of good news and a wamer.} 457. Say: "No reward do I ask of you for this, save that whosoever wills may take a path to his Lord."} 458. And put your trust in the Ever Living One Wfw dies not, and glorify His praises, and sufficient is He as the All-Knower of the sins ofHis servants,} 459. Wlw created the heavens and the earth and all that is between them in six Days. Then He rose over (Istawa) the Throne. The Most Gracious! Ask Him, as He is the All- Knower.} 460. And when it is said to them: "Prostrate yourselves to Ar- Rahmdn!" They say: "And what is Ar-Rahman? Shall we fall down in prostration to that which you command us?" And it increases in them only aversion.}

The Ignorance of the Idolaters Allah tells us how ignorant the idolaters are; instead of worshipping Allah, they worship idols which do not possess the power either to harm or benefit. They do this with no evidence or proof; the only thing that led them to do this was their own whims and desires. So they take these idols as protectors and fight for their sake, and they oppose Allah and His Messenger jg and the believers for their sake. Similarly Allah says: iand the disbeliever is ever a helper against his Lord.} meaning, he is a supporter of Shaytan against the party of Allah, but the party of Allah are the ones who

will prevail, as Allah says: (* (*-*J (V** V SI? vfhi m).** *Ul* OjJ \ij -\)) iAnd they have taken besides Allah gods , hoping that they might be helped. They cannot help them, but they will be brought forward as a troop against those who worshipped them.) (36:74-75) meaning, the gods which they worshipped instead of Allah cannot help them. These ignorant people are troops for the idols and are ready to fight for their sake and protect their sanctuaries, but in the end the victory will be for Allah and His Messenger sg and the believers, in this world and the Hereafter. iand the disbeliever is ever a helper against his Lord.) Mujahid said: He supports and helps the Shayt&n in disobedience towards Allah. The Messenger^ brings Glad Tidings and Warnings Then Allah tells His Messenger jg: Vj&j 1^** VI vibQ Lj} iAnd We have sent you only as a bearer of good news and a

Al-Furqdn (55 - 60) (Part-19) wamer. meaning, a bringer of good news to the believers, a wamer to the disbelievers; bringing good news of Paradise to those who obey Allah, and bringing warnings of a dreadful punishment for those who go against the commandments of Allah. St fS t 4Say : No reward do I ask of you for this..." for conveying this message and this warning, I do not ask for any reward from your wealth; I am only doing this for the sake of Allah, may He be exalted. iTo whomsoever among you who wills to walk straight) (81:28). isave that whosoever wills, may take a path to his Lord.) means, a way and a methodology to be followed. The Command to the Messenger0 to put his Trust in Allah, and some of His Qualities Then Allah says: 4And put your trust in the Ever Living One Who dies not,) meaning, in all your affairs, put your trust in Allah, the Ever- Living Who never dies, the One Who 4^&&%m \$*) 4is the First and the Last, the Most High and tlxe Most Near. And He is tire All-Knower of everything) (57:3). The Eternal, Ever-Lasting, Ever-Living, Self-Sufficient One, the Lord and Sovereign of all things, the One to Whom you should always turn. Allah is the One in Whom you should put your trust and to Whom you should turn for refuge, He will be sufficient for you and will be your helper and supporter, and will cause you to prevail. As Allah says:

Al-Furqan (55 - 60) (Part-19) means. He is the Ever-Living Who never dies, He is the Creator, Sustainer and Sovereign of all things, Who by His might and power created the seven heavens with their vast height and width, and the seven earths with their great depths and density. f& 4in six Days. Then He rose over the Throne.) means, He is running all affairs and He decrees according to the truth, and He is the best of those who decide. 4\$ 4Then He rose over (Istawd) the Throne. The Most Gracious! Ask Him, as He is the All-Knoiver> meaning, find out about Him from one who knows most about Him, and follow him and take him as your example. It is known that there is no one who knows more about Allah than His servant and Messenger Muhammad si, the absolute leader of the sons of Adam in this world and the Hereafter, who does not speak of his own desire, but conveys revelation revealed to him. What he says is true, and he is the leader whose decision counts; when there is a dispute, people are obliged to refer to him, and whatever is in accordance with his words and deeds is right, and whatever goes against them should be rejected no matter who says or does it. Allah says: 4(And) if you differ in anything among yourselves...} (4:59). 4And in whatsoever you differ, the decision thereof is with Allah} (42:10). 4^j fo-% siz;} }And the Word of your Lord has been fulfilled in truth and in justice} (6:115). meaning, He has spoken the truth and is fair and just in His commands and prohibitions. Allah says here:

192 Tafstr Ibn Kathir iAsk Him, as He is Al-Knower.} Condemnation of the Idolators Then Allah rebukes the idolators who prostrate to idols and rivals instead of Allah: iji'j i Jj 4And when it is said to them: "Prostrate yourselves to Ar- Rahman! They say: "And what is Ar-Rahman?"} meaning: we do not know Ar-Rahman. They did not like to call Allah by His Name Ar-Rahman (the Most Gracious), as they objected on the day of (the treaty of) Al-Hudaybiyyah, when the Prophet jg told the scribe: a^^JIO ji' 4' Write: "In the Name of Allah, Ar-Rahman (the Most Gracious), Ar-Ralim (the Most Merciful)." They said, We do not know Ar-Rahman or Ar-Rahlm. Write what you used to write: Bismika Allahumma (in Your Name, O Allah). So Allah revealed the words: i&n CClVi \$ u i\ \$if\ \p } if \pi ft iSay: "Invoke Allah or invoke Ar-Rahman, by whatever name you invoke Him (it is the same), for to Him belong the Best Names} (17:110). meaning, He is Allah and He is the Most Gracious. And in this Ayah, Allah said: iAnd when it is said to them: "Prostrate yourselves to Ar- Rahman! They say: "And wltat is the Ar- Rahman?"} meaning: we do not know or approve of this Name. fe U 3} iShall we fall down in prostration to that which you command us?} means, Just because you tell us to? Ahmad 3:268, similar with Muslim no. 1784.

Al-Furqan (61 - 62) (Part-19) "And it increases in them only aversion . As for the believers, they worship Allah Who is the Most Gracious, Most Merciful, and they attribute divinity to Him Alone and prostrate to Him. The scholars, agree that it is allowed and approved for the reader and the listener to prostrate when he reaches this mention of prostration in Surat Al-Furqan, and Allah knows best. 4% 4 4 y >=j, J jljl JULi- JJ' 461 . Blessed be He Who has placed in the heaven Al-Buruj, and has placed therein a great lamp, and a moon giving light.} }62. And He it is Who has put the night and the day in succession (Khilfatan), for such who desires to remember or desires to show his gratitude.} Mentioning the Might and Power of Allah Here Allah glorifies Himself and praises the beauty He created in the heavens of Al-Buruj, the giant stars, according to the view of Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Abu Salih, Al-Hasan and QatadahJ ' This is like the Ayah, 4^~m CTjif xAj} 4And indeed We have adorned the nearest heaven with lamps} (67:5). Allah says: 4Blessed be He Who has placed in the heaven Al-Buruj, and has placed therein a great lamp,} which is the sun which shines like a lamp, as Allah says: 4And We have made (therein) a shining lamp} (78:13). At-Tabari 19:289, Al-Baghawi 3 :374.

and a moon giving light.} means, shining and illuminated by the light of something else, different from the light of the sun, as Allah says: lllli ifjl f} ilt is He Who made the sun a shining thing and the moon as a light (10:5). And Allah tells us that Nuh, peace be upon him, said to his people: ' by yj^ & j . i j iSee you not how Allah has created the seven heavens one above another? And has made the moon a light therein, and made the sun a lamp?} (71:15-16). Then Allah says: ///" / < ' < / // i* /> / \ 4^~4- 4And He it is Who has put the night and the day in succession (Khil/atan),} meaning, each one comes after the other, in a never-ending alternation. When one goes the other comes, and vice versa, as Allah says: 'Jj% julJtp^j} 4And He has made the sun and the moon, both constantly pursuing their courses} (14:33). J3C 'j&& 4He brings the night as a cover over the day, seeking it rapidly} (7:54). ilt is notfor the sun to overtake the moon} (36:40).

ifor such who desires to remember or desires to show his gratitude.} means, He has caused them both to follow one another to show the times when His servants should worship Him. So whoever misses an act of worship during the night can make it up during the day, and whoever misses an act of worship

(faring the day can make it up during the night. It was recorded in a Sahih Hadith: k~L> 1 'Sy L JIIJj oJj " "JP^ Allah spreads forth His Hand at night for the one who has done evil during the day to repent, and He spreads forth His Hand during the day for the one who has done evil during the night to repent. Mujahid and Qatadah said: Khilfatan means different, i.e., because one is dark and the other is light. 121 fa & 4rit c; 'oj&&& tx* Ufx gs jtJ % (Li, Jjtl \+>\ i)a 4ff <^aj IaZ-Sj . And the servants of the Most Gracious are those who walk on the earth Hawna, and when the foolish address them they say; "Saldma.") 464. And those who spend the night in worship of their Lord, prostrate and standing.} 465. And those who say : "Our Lord! Avert from us the torment of Hell. Verily, its torment is ever an inseparable, permanent punishment. } 466. Evil indeed it is as an abode and as a place to rest in.} 467. And those who, when they spend, are neither extravagant nor stingy, but are in a just balance between them.} I1 * Muslim 4 :21 13. At-Tabari 19:290, 291.

Attributes of the Servants of the Most Gracious These are the attributes of the believing servants of Allah, if it those who walk on the earth Hawna,} meaning that they walk with dignity and humility, not with arrogance and pride. This is like the Ayah iAnd walk not on the earth with conceit and arrogance... (17:37). So these people do not walk with conceit or arrogance or pride. This does not mean that they should walk like sick people, making a show of their humility, for the leader of the sons of Adam (the Prophet) jg used to walk as if he v^ts coming downhill, and as if the earth were folded up beneath him. What is meant here by Hawna is serenity and dignity, as the Messenger of Allah jgj said: Ui LSwJl lay\j K pit I J lap yyii ^li laj 1 jLSai l^la uWhen you come to the prayer, do not come rushing in haste. Come calmly and with tranquility, and whatever you catch up with, pray, and whatever you miss, make it up. M iand when the foolish address them they say: "Saldma.") If the ignorant people insult them with bad words, they do not respond in kind, but they forgive and overlook, and say nothing but good words. This is what the Messenger of Allah jgg did: the more ignorant the people, the more patient he would be. This is as Allah says: iAnd when they hear Al-Laghwa (evil or vain talk), they withdraw from it} (28:55). Al-BQri2 :453 .

Al-Furqan (63 - 67) (Part-19) Then Allah says that their nights are the best of nights, as He says: iAnd those who spend the night in worship of their Lord, prostrate and standing.} meaning, worshipping and obeying Him. This is like the Ayat iThey used to sleep but little by night. And in the hours before dawn, they were asking for forgiveness (51:17-18). >> 0* i!S iTheir sides forsake their beds...} (32:16). i-ifj [fr/j { \$1 ji lf\} ils one who is obedient to Allah, prostrating himself or standing during the hours of the night, fearing the Hereafter and hoping for the mercy of his Lord...} (39:9). Allah says: iAnd those who say: Our Lord! Avert from us the torment of Hell. Verily, its torment is ever an inseparable punishment."} meaning, ever-present and never ending. Al-Hasan said concerning the Ayah, \} iVerily, its torment is ever an inseparable, permanent punishment.} Everything that strikes the son of Adam, then disappears, does not constitute an inseparable, permanent punishment. The inseparable, permanent punishment is that which lasts as long as heaven and earth. 111 This was also the view of Sulayman At-Taymi. 121 Qf} AMabari 19:297. 121 Abdur-Razzaq 3 :72

Al-Furqan (68 - 71) (Part-19) 468. And those who invoke not any other god along with Allah, nor kill such person as Allah has forbidden, except for just cause, nor commit illegal sexual intercourse - and whoever does this shall receive Athdma.} 469. The torment will be doubled for him on the Day of

Resurrection, and he will abide therein in disgrace 470. Except those who repent and believe, and do righteous deeds; for those, Allah will change their sins into good deeds, and Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.> 471. And whosoever repents and does righteous good deeds; then indeed he has repented to Allah Mataba

The Attributes of the Servants of the Most Gracious

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4067–4076]

include avoiding Shirk, Murder and Zina Imam

200 Tafstr Ibn Kathir and

Al-Furcjdñ (68 - 72) (Part-19) 4Except those who repent and believe, and do righteous deeds;) means, those who do these evil deeds will be punished in the manner described, 406 & 4Except those who repent), that is; those who repent in this world to Allah from all of those deeds, for then Allah will accept their repentance. This is evidence that the repentance of the murderer is acceptable, and there is no contradiction between this and the Ayah in Surat An-Nisa 4And whoever kills a believer intentionally) (4:93), because even though this was revealed in Al-Madlnah, the meaning is general, and it could be interpreted to refer to one who does not repent, because this Ayah states that forgiveness is only for those who repent. Moreover Allah says: OJJ 4r4 J ^ " ' iVerily, Allah forgives not that partners should be set up with Him, but Heforgives except that to whom He wills) (4:48). And in the authentic Sunnah, it is reported from the Messenger of Allah Hg that the repentance of a murderer is acceptable, as was stated in the story of the person who killed one hundred men and then repented, and Allah accepted his repentance, and other Hadiths . [1 3 ^Zu&) 4for those, Allah will change their sins into good deeds, and Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Mercifiil.) Imam

*r ^ J& JiJ j)i ilili kljj^ j{ U13! V suil: "He will say, Yes, and he will not be able to deny anything."

tEven your betrayals and immoral actions ." The man went away saying La ilaha iUollah and AUahu Akbar Allah tells us how His mercy extends to all His creatruess, and that whoever among them repents to Him, He will accept his repentance for any sin, great or small. Allah says: 4And whosoever repents and does righteous good deeds; then indeed he has repented to Allah Mataba.} meaning, Allah will accept his repentance. This is like the Ayat YSZi ,"/ ^ Jit . ' 4ji\ v"J /C-JU jtiJaJ jl '*> 0*Jr iAnd whoever does evil or wrongs himself but afterwards seeks Allah's forgiveness, he will find Allah Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful^ (4:110). z y 3 iKnow they not that Allah accepts repentance from His servants?...} (9:104). 4Say: "O My servants who have transgressed against themselves! Despair not of the mercy ofAllah."} (39:53) - for those who repent to Him. 'i) dz&j iv iv' 'ijj - \$' V Cj C-i cL>\$yi oji'j .i" > 472. And those who do not bear witness to falsehood, and if they pass by some evil play or evil talk, they pass by it with Ibn Abi Hatim and Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 6 :281 . This narration is not authentic. There is a similar, but shorter narration from Anas, recorded byAbu Yala, Al-Bazzar, and At-Tabarani.

204 Tafslr Ibn Kathtr dignity.. And those who, when they are reminded of the Ayat of their Lord, fall not deafand blind thereat.> 174. And those who say: Our Lord! Bestow on us from our wives and our offspring the comfort of our eyes, and make us leaders of those who have Taqwa More Attributes ofthe

Servants of the Most Gracious These are further attributes of the servants of the Most Gracious. They do not bear witness to falsehood, including lies, immorality, disbelief, foul speech and false words. Amr bin Qays said, this refers to gatherings of sexual immorality. It was said that the Ayah, *And those who do not bear witness to falsehood* refers to giving false testimony, which means lying deliberately to someone else. It was recorded in the Two Sahih's that Abu Bakrah said, The Messenger of Allah[^] said three times: Shall I not tell you of the greatest of major sins?" We said, Of course, O Messenger of Allah. The Messenger of Allah said: "Associating others in worship with Allah and disobeying one's parents . He was lying down, then he sat up and added: < t}jjj Vi Beware false speech, and bearing witness to falsehoodj and he kept repeating it until we thought, would that he would stop. From the context it seems that what is meant by those who do not bear witness to falsehood is those who do not attend it or Fath Al-Bari 5 :309 , Muslim 1 :91 .

are not present when it happens. Allah says: !vP !v<& iand if they pass by some evil play or evil talk, they pass by it with dignity.)> They do not attend where falsehood occurs, and if it so happens that they pass by it, they do not let it contaminate them in the slightest. Allah says: ip) ithey pass by it with dignity.) 'ij. (i) \$And those who, when they are reminded of the Ayat of their Lord, fall not deaf and blind thereat.) This is also a characteristic of the believers, fa a: sg fijs & X lit p) iThose who, when Allah is mentioned, feel a fear in their hearts and when His Ayat are recited unto them, they increase their faith; and they put their trust in their Lord.) (8:2) Unlike the disbelievers. When they hear the Words of Allah, they are not affected by them or moved to change their ways. They persist in their disbelief, wrongdoing, ignorance and misguidance, as Allah says: \pc ki 28jW 4As &^ t \$L 4 'S 4And whenever there comes down a Surah, some of them say Which of you has had his faith increased by it?" As for those who believe, it has increased their faith, and they rejoice. But as for those in whose hearts is a disease, it will add doubt to their doubt) (9:124-125). [.js \$) 4fall not deaf and blind thereat.) means, unlike the disbelievers

who, when they hear the Ayat of Allah, are not moved by them, but continue as they are, as if they did not hear them but are deaf and blind. His saying: U - iAnd those who say: "Our Lord! Bestow on us from our wives and our ofspring the comfort of our eyes . means those who ask Allah to bring forth from their loins offspring who will obey Him and worship Him and not associate anything in worship with Him. Ibn Abbas said, This means (offspring) who will strive to obey Allah and bring them joy in this world and the Hereafter. Imam

Our Lord! Bestow on us from our wives and our offspring the comfort of our eyes . Its chain of narrators is Sahih, although they did not report it.' 1 iand make us leaders of those who have Taqwa.} Ibn Abbas, Al-Hasan, As-Suddi, Qatadah and Rabl bin Anas said: Leaders who would be taken as examples in good. Others said: Guides who would call others to goodness. They wanted their worship to be connected to the worship of their children and offspring, and their guidance to go beyond themselves and benefit others. This would be more rewarding and a better end, as it was recorded in Sahih Muslim from Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, that the Messenger of Allah sg said: *& jJj ji ft oi 1^ 'H mm | * mm* m 43JL^ j I i oJju fjA riNhen a son of Adam dies, his deeds cease apart from three: a righteous child who will pray for him, knowledge from which others may benefit after him, or ongoing charity .

208 Tafsir Ibn Kathir 4.77 . Say : My lord pays attention to you only because of your invocation to Him. But now you have indeed denied. So the torment will be yours forever.'> The Reward of the Servants of the Most Gracious, and a

Warning to the People of Mafwah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4076–4077]

After mentioning the beautiful attributes of His believing servants, and their fine words and deeds, Allah then says: 4Those\$> meaning, the people who are described in this manner, 4will be rewarded on the Day of Resurrection, iwith the highest placeK which is Paradise. Abu Ja'far Al-Baqir, Said bin Jubayr, Ad-Dahhak and As-Suddi said, It was so called because of its elevation. ibecause of their patience. means, their patience in doing what they did. 4Therein they shall be mefy means, in Paradise. iwith greetings and the word of peace and respect. This means that they will be greeted first with words of welcome and honor. Peace will be theirs and they will be wished peace. And angels shall enter unto them from every gate, saying, Peace be upon you for that you persevered in patience! Excellent indeed is the final home! iAbiding therein means, they will settle there and never leave or move or die, they will never exit or wish to move to somewhere else. This is like the Ayah,

Al-Furqan (75 - 77) (Part-19) oij C ciyji- i [f jp IjlfL \$j} 4A"d f/iouse who are blessed, they will be in Paradise, abiding therein for all the time that the heavens and the earth endure^ (11 :108). 4excellent it is as an abode, and as a place to rest in.} Its appearance is beautiful and it is a good place in which to rest and to dwell. Then Allah says: iSay: My Lord pays attention to you only because of your invocation to Him..."} meaning, He would not care to pay attention to you if you did not worship Him, for He only created mankind to worship Him Alone and to glorify Him morning and evening. His saying: iZZ&} iBut now you have indeed denied.} O you disbelievers. 4*~*y }So the torment will be yours forever.} So your denial will remain with you forever, i.e., it will lead to your punishment, doom and destruction in this world and the Hereafter. This also refers to the day of Badr, as it was interpreted by Abdullah bin Mas'ud, Ubayy bin Ka b, Muhammad bin Ka b Al-Qurazi, Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah, As-Suddi and others. ^jy~>} iSo the torment will be yours forever.} Al-Hasan Al-Basri said: The Day of Resurrection. * And there is no conflict between the two interpretations.

Module 26

Surah 26: Ash-Shuara, Surah 27: An-Naml

Surah 26: Ash-Shuara

PDF pages 4078–4164

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 4078]

Opening The Tafsir of Surat Ash-Shu'ara. (Chapter - 26)

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4078–4090]

(In the Tafsir that was narrated from Malik it was said that this Surah is also known as Surat Al-Jami'ah) In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. These are Ayat of the Book, which We reveal to you in Arabic, that you may understand. These are signs for the people who are going to be judged, that they may become believers. We will send down to them from the heaven a sign, to which they would bend their necks in humility.

Perhaps, you would deny yourself, over their footsteps, because they believe not in this narration} (18 :6). Mujahid, Ikrimah, Qatadah, Atiyyah, Ad-Dahhak, Al-Hasan and others said that: 411 may be that you are going to deny yourself} means, Tail yourself. Then Allah says: We will, We could send down to them from the heaven a sign, to which they would bend their necks in humility.} meaning, if We so willed, We could send down a sign that would force them to believe, but We will not do that because We do not want anyone to believe except by choice. Allah says: WS? is it not so? 4 And had your Lord willed, those on earth would have believed, all of them together. So, will you then compel mankind, until they become believers.} (10 :99) 4 And if your Lord had so willed, He could surely, have made mankind one Ummah...} (11 :118) But Allah's will has acted, His decree has come to pass, and His proof has been conveyed to mankind by mission of Messengers and the revelation of Books to them. Then Allah says: ** If it were not for the revelation of the Book, they would have denied it. 4 And never comes there unto them a Reminder as a recent revelation from the Most Gracious, but they turn away therefrom.} m At-Tabari 19:330, Ad-Durr Al-Manthur 6:360.

214 Tafsir Ibn Kathir meaning, every time a Scripture comes from heaven to them, most of the people turn away from it. As Allah says: } And most of mankind will not believe even if you desire it eagerly.} (12 :103) 4 J it is a sign for mankind! There never came a Messenger to them but they used to mock at him.} (36 :30) 4 Then We sent Our Messengers in succession. Every time there came to a nation their Messenger, they denied him...} (23 :44). Allah says here: } So, they have indeed denied, then the news of what they mocked at will come to them.} meaning, they denied the truth that came to them, so they will come to know the news of the consequences of this denial after a while. 4, J Li ii '4 4 And those who do wrong will come to know by what overturning they will be overturned} (26 :227). Then Allah tells those who dared to oppose His Messenger and disbelieve in His Book, that

He is the Subduer, the Almighty, the All-Powerful, Who created the earth and caused every good kind of crop, fruit and animal to grow therein. Sufyan Ath-Thawri narrated from a man from Ash-ShaTsi that people are a product of the earth. So whoever enters Paradise is good and noble, and whoever enters Hell is base and vile.111 iVerily, in this is an Ayah,} meaning an evidence of the power of * Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 6 :289 .

Ash-Shu'ard' (10 - 22) (Part-19) Sit'*- - 'i'''/yy ' ' | fcWtSj&iO&P* \$ I?A\ j pzM&%j_ ^ oA^ Cp? * \$ \$& , ^the Creator of all things. He spread out the earth and raised the canopy of the heavens, yet despite that the majority of people do not believe, rather they deny Him, His Messengers, and His Books, and they go against His commands doing the things He had prohibited. His saying: 4And verily your Lord, He is truly the All- Mighty,} means, the One Who has power over all things, to subdue and control them, 4the Most Merciful.} means, towards His creation, for He does not hasten to punish the one who sins, but He gives him time to repent, and if he does not, then He seizes him with a mighty punishment. Abu Al- Aliyah, Qatadah, Ar-Rabl bin Anas and Ibn Ishaq said: He is Almighty in His punishment of those who went against His commands and worshipped others besides Him. Said bin Jubayr said: He is Most Merciful towards those who repent to Him and turn to Him. ijU-1 Cp 36 'IjpOyii1 Sft ijti (j* sjlc&jrktf s3 ^ && C!S& <& Hi sji c& jjK% JblZ *& J yji C& GillV 36 JTabari 33 :304, 3 :260 , 5 :51 1

oi \$ JB ~{jt. -y 6; tl> lij Ifiili 3tt cijj oi*" ^ _iH*j ollij ili o? 4^> 4 s**>* (- 12 j^" iyjjj 4;'Vj l/l rC Ijcl *-5 -K dS 410. And (remember) when your Lord called Musa (saying) "Go to the people who are wrongdoers."} 111. "The people ofFira'wn. Will they not have Taqwd?"} 112. He said: "My Lord! Verily, I fear that they will deny me, } 113. "And my breast straitens, and my tongue expresses not well. So sendfor Harun."} 114. "And they have a charge of crime against me, and I fear they will kill me."} 115. (Allah) said: "Nay! Go you both with Our signs. Verily, We shall be with you, listening."} 116. "And go both of you to Fira'wn, and say: We are the Messengers of the Lord ofAl-'Alamin,}" 117. 'So allow the Children of Israel to go with us. " } 118. (Fir'awn) said (to Milsa): Did we not bring you up among us as a child? And you did dwell many years of your life with us."} 419. "And you did your deed, which you did. While you were one of the ingrates."} 420. Musa said: "I did it then, when I was in error."} 421. "So, Ifledfrom you when Ifeared you. But my Lord has granted me HukmJ and made me one ofthe Messengers."} 422 . "And this is the past favor with which you reproach me, - that you have enslaved the Children ofIsrael."} BetweenMusa and Fir*awn Allah tells us what He commanded His servant, son of Imran and Messenger Musa, peace be upon him, who spoke with m SeeAyah no. 83 as follows later.

Him, to do, when He called him from the right side of the mountain, and conversed with him, and chose him, sent him and commanded him to go to Fir'awn and his people. Allah says: t:J <-&* xj\ #{C Vs Vs >/ i3riH) iAnd when your Lord called Musa: "Go to the people who are wrongdoers. Tlte people of Fir'awn. Will they not have Taqwa?" He said: "My Lord! Verily, I fear that they will deny me. And my breast straitens, and my tongue expresses not well. So send for Hariin. And they have a charge of crime against me, and Ifear they will kill me."} So, Musa asked Allah to remove these difficulties for him, as he said in Surah Ta Ha iMusa said: "O my Lord! Open for me my chest. And ease my taskfor me."} (20:25-26) until: 4You are granted your request, O MiisdI} (20:36) &&&&m iAnd they have a charge

of crime against me, and I fear they will kill me.} because he had killed that Egyptian, which was the reason that he left the land of Egypt. i(Allah) said: "Nay!..."} Allah told him: do not be afraid of anything like that. This is like the Ayah, Jul &:} iAllah said: "We will strengthen your arm through your brother, and give you both power} meaning, proof;

Ash-Shu ard' (22 - 28) (Part-19 manner: you killed one of our men and denied our favors to you. So he said to him: iWhile you were one of the ingrates.) meaning, one of those who deny favors. This was the view of Ibn Abbas and Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam, and was the view favored by Ibn Jarir. i\>[i(Miisa) said: I did it then..." meaning, at that time, iwhen I was in error.) meaning, before revelation was sent to me and before Allah made me a Prophet and sent me with this Message. iSo, I fled from you when I feared you. But my Lord has granted me Hukm, and made me one of the Messengers.) means, the first situation came to an end and another took its place. Now Allah has sent me to you, and if you obey Him, you will be safe, but if you oppose Him, you will be destroyed. Then Musa said: Js5 l I OX* o* Je tJL} iO iAnd this is the past favor with which you reproach me, - that you have enslaved the Children of Israel.) meaning, whatever favors you did in bringing me up are offset by^ the evil you did by enslaving the Children of Israel and using them to do your hard labor. Is there any comparison between your favors to one man among them and the evil you have done to all of them? What you have mentioned about me is nothing compared to what you have done to them. \ ju t pp & -PS ju vt p jii |g m At-Tabari 19:340.

noH Jo pj(rj dip si 'vsnyj q -imp oiffr :pws (u,jij)) iw V?&D v fn >!f* iff jf f i(vfiy aq} aiRI si ifvfiy siqx pres ippng-sy suoqBJ3ua3 jajBj jo sureuq aqj pire jBjBg aq} jo sxBjoqos aq} Xq pajajdiajut sbm } i Moq si siqx <(ireq} jaqjo uimv}y,-jy jo pjoq aqj si Suiuirep bjb noX oqM siqj si oq/yv unq o} pres umb,jij ,/sppoM aq} jo pjoq aq} jo jaSuassaj^ aq} ure j :maqj o} pres ?SDW uaq/v\ -umb,ju ireqj pjoj jaqjo ou psq Xaq} }Bq} paAaaq Xaqj puB paguois aq an Xbui joiBajQ aq} Xuap oj pasn Xaqx (t-S :e^) i'uttii pafhqo Imp puv '3\do3d sit/ pdjooJ 31/ sni/x> (SZ'SZ) i'3iu ump J3ipo poS v aamj nod ivip jou aiouy 4 ? r? ip' :a(doad siq oj Xbs o} pasn aq asnBoaq si siqx i.uumviy, 3tp/o puo-j dip si mi puy,, (:pws umv/ij)) 4fn r? :sXbs an sb umb,jij jo jBiuap pus uoissajddo uoinaqaj jaqaqsip aq} jnoqs sn sjpj qBjiv i ipuv}SJ3pun ptq pip nodJi 'utdq} uddapdq si W{ } \v puv is3 dip puv }svd dip Jo puoqn :pws (vsnyq) 'szi 4"juvuipvui v si noli 0} }Uds uddq svq oqm joSudssdyj jnod H\U3A PfOS (uoiv,jij) /)" ijsudipvJ iudpuv mod Jo puoj dip puv puoq mo^, :pws (vsny\ f) -9^ < i(sfos 3q fvaqi) uvdi(}ou tiofi oq :punouv dsoip 0} pws (umv,Jij) - z i,;tkuwwdo qim pdouiauoo dq oj ydds noH Ji 'uidip uddapdq si ivip pv puv ipuvd dip puv sudavdif dip Jo puoq din :pivs (vsnyj) fzt i iumoiy,-ivJo pjoq dip si ivqtn puy :pws uow^ij - z> jp2 fT crfs# ?r rt* && rc^* m %% & %- unpyv uqi uisfvi OZZ

two?" He said: "Our Lord is He Who gave to each thing its form and nature, then guided it aright."} (20:49-50) Those among the philosophers and others who claimed that this was a question about the nature or substance (of Allah) are mistaken. Fir awn did not believe in the Creator in the first place, so he was in no position to ask about the nature of the Creator; he denied that the Creator existed at all, as is apparent from the meaning, even though proof and evidence had been established against him. When Fir awn asked him about the Lord of Al-'Alamm, Musa said: 4 &' Cj oyHii 4J ti} i(Musa) said: The Lord of the heavens and the earth, and all that is between them..."} meaning, the Creator, Sovereign and Controller of all that, their God Who has no partner or associate. He is the One Who has created all

things. He knows the higher realms and the heavenly bodies that are in them, both those that are stationary and those that move and shine brightly. He knows the lower realms and what is in them; the oceans, continents, mountains, trees, animals, plants and fruits. He knows what is in between the two realms; the winds, birds, and whatever is in the air. All of them are servants to Him, submitting and humbling themselves before Him. *Ubis ft 4^ iifyou seek to be convinced with certainty.*} means, if you have believing hearts and clear insight. At this, Fir'awn turned to the chiefs and leaders of his state around him, and said to them - mockingly expressing his disbelief in Musa: *4S, \$} i"Do you not hear?"*} meaning, are you not amazed by what this man is claiming - that you have another god other than me? Mass said to them: *4Your Lord and the Lord ofyour ancient fath rs!*}

meaning, the One Who created you and your forefathers, those who came before Fir'awn and his time. } Hc said} that is, Fir'awn said: *4Verily, your Messenger who has been sent to you is a madman!*} meaning, there is no sense in his claim that there is any god other than me! i(Musa) said} - to those in whose hearts Fir'awn had planted doubts: *4&jlii 0) ly jj} iLord of the east and the west, and all that is between them, if you did but understand!}* He is the One Who made the east the place where the heavenly bodies rise, and made the west the place where they set; this is the system to which He has subjugated all the heavenly bodies, stationary and moving. Ifwhat Fir'awn claims is true, that he is your lord and your god, then let him turn things around so that the heavenly bodies set in the east and rise in the west. This is similar to the Ayah, if *ijj h d\$S\ iii iii; J 4 iji O/Jj' O?* Jfi J ",^l lit Jfi *-+ J iwho* disputed with Ibrahim about his Lord, because Allah had given him the kingdom? When Ibrahim said: "My Lord is He Who gives life and causes death." He said, "I give life and cause death." Ibrahim said, "Verily, Allah brings the sun from the east. So cause it to risefrom the west."} (2:258) So when Fir'awn was defeated in debate, he resorted to the use of his force and power, believing that this would be effective in dealing with Musa, peace be upon him, so he said, as Allah tells us:

*jtt . j# J6 o&t oO J6^ i"iT * ?<*** -5 (^iC >. 'iff ^ ,f > ^ *&*&? \$ Wafr *^=" \$ p-^ssuiyJ tJ -bj* ^, jp _/ *l 1 UlfC oj dj>- JU J^=o C^jJJ j *U3j 4*-J i_pLi jip^LiXj^* ^L ^ flC, 429.* He said: "If you choose a god other than me, 1 will certainly put you among the prisoners. 430. He said: Even if I bring you something manifest?"} 431. He said: "Bring itforth then, ifyou are of the truthful!"} 432. So he threw his stick, and behold, it was a serpent, manifest.} 433 . And he drew out his hand, and behold, it was white to all beholders!} 434. He said to the chiefs around him: "Verily, this is indeed a well-versed sorcerer."} 435. "He wants to drive you out of your land by his sorcery:

what is it then that you command?"}

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4090–4103]

436. They said: "Put him offand his brother (for a while), and send callers to the cities; } 437. "To bring up to you every well-versed sorcerer."} After the Rational Proof, Fir*awn resorts to Force When proof had been established against Fir awn, clearly and rationally, he resorted to using force against MQsa, thinking that after this there would no further room for discussion. So he said: *4iT'1-~ ^ Ot * j& ojiicl iff you choose a god other than me, 1 will certainly put you among the prisoners.*} To this, Musa responded: *ic*? t&i ')\$} iEven if l bring you something manifest?}* meaning, clear and definitive proof.

sJpCCs? 6U5 Ct 4Fir'awn said: Bring it forth then i/yoH are of the truthful!" So he threw his stick, and behold, it was a serpent, manifest.} meaning, it was very clear and obvious, with a huge body and a big mouth, terrifying in appearance. 4And he drew out his hand,} meaning, from his sleeve, iand behold, it was white to all beholders!} It was shining like a piece of the moon. Since Fir'awn was already doomed, he hastened to stubborn denial, and said to the chiefs around him: iVerily, this is indeed a well-versed sorcerer.} One who knows a great deal of magic or witchcraft. Fir'awn was trying to convince them that this was sorcery, not a miracle. Then he provoked them against Musa, trying to make them oppose him and disbelieve in him, and said: 4He wants to drive you out of your land by his sorcery. . .} meaning, *he wants to capture the people's hearts and win them over by doing this, so that they will support him, and help him and follow him, and he will defeat you in your own land and take the land from you. So advise me, what should I do with him? j tZSy 4They said "Put him off and his brother, and send callers to the cities; to bring up to you every well-versed sorcerer."} meaning, delay him and his brother until you gather together all the sorcerers from every city and region of your kingdom so that they may confront him and produce something like he produces, then you will defeat him and have the victory. So Fir'awn did as they suggested, which is what Allah decreed

Ash-Shu'ard' (38 - 48) (Part-19) rn l U3 jls\$ u'y \$c&&\ 0^\ p# 0U^i&"Jfo0 0 tfflVSi) J1 ^\jSf^y^J ^\^jl? ^^ pfj&Sjj&0pJfJ9-^a?(4^ D^^ Cp ^oi all :t3V would happen to them, so that all the people would gather in one place and the signs and proof of Allah would be made manifest before them all in one day. jOi '~ ' ^ ^>%) } j* o;t5 jj" oi ^tou LUJ ^p^OyyjZ . llii ,ti i^f u y s ys (*-** oj : ;S ; H\$^ i/%. ^ ;< ojii!' uj*>" t Jot ^ fry \z& 'jk f'oj^i: ^ ..V 1 Isrj* *ji> -iy. L jj)li . 'J^y 438. So, the sorcerers were assembled at a fixed time on a day appointed.} 439. And it was said to the people: "Are you (too) going to assemble?"} 440. "That we may follow the sorcerers if they are the winners."} 441 . So, when the sorcerers arrived, they said to Fir'awn "Will there surely be a reward for us if we are the winners?"} 442. He said: "Yes, and you shall then verily be of those brought near (to myself)." } 443. Musa said to them: "Throw what you are going to

throw! } 444. So, they threw their ropes and their sticks, and said: "By the might of Fir'awn, it is we who will certainly win! } 445. Then Musa threw his stick, and behold, it swallowed up all that they falsely showed!} 446. And the sorcerers fell down prostrate.} 447. Saying: "We believe in the Lord of Al- Alamin ." } 448. "The Lord of Musa and Hariin." } Between Musa, peace be upon him, and the Sorcerers Allah describes the actual encounter between Musa, peace be upon him, and the Egyptians in Surat Al-A raf, Surah Ta Ha, 11 and in this Surah. The Egyptians wanted to extinguish the Light of Allah with their words, but Allah insisted that His Light should prevail even though the disbelievers disliked that. This is the issue of disbelief and faith; they never confront one another but faith always prevails: tL Jiji' '4 4Nay, We fling the truth against the falsehood, so it destroys it, and behold, it disappears. And woe to you for that which you ascribe.} (21:18) /Ct A SSSf - m 4And say: "Truth has come and falsehood has vanished." } (17:81) The sorcerers of Egypt were the most skilled in the art of illusion, but when a huge group of them gathered from all corners of the land, and the people came together on that day whose exact numbers are kn<^j^n to Allah Alone, one of them said: jt* \yjfc a) / * .ii 4That we may follow the sorcerers if they are the winners.} See volume four, Surat Al-A raf (7 : 79-82), and volume six, Surah TaHa{20:59-76).

Sarah 26. Ash-Shu'ara' (38 - 48) (Part-19) 227 They did not say: \ve will follow the truth, whether it rests with the sorcerers or with Musa; the people were followers of the religion of their king. &} ^So, when the sorcerers arrived, means, when they reached the court of Fir awn, and a pavilion had been erected for him. There he gathered his servants, followers, administrators, and provin- cial leaders, and the soldiers of his kingdom. The sorcerers stood before Fir awn, asking him to treat them well and bring them closer to him if they prevailed in this matter which he had brought them together for. They said: i Will there surely be a reward for us ifwe are the winners?" He said: "Yes, and you shall then verily be of those brought near."} meaning, and you will be given more than what you are asking for; I will make you among those who are close to me, those who sit with me. So they went back to their places: 4jyll St JtS <>* O' ty }They said : O Musa! Either you throw first or we be the first to throw?" (Musa) said: "Nay, throw you (first)! } (20:65- 66). Here the incident is described more briefly. Musa said to them: i"Throw what you are going to throw!" So, they threw their ropes and their sticks, and said: "By the might of Fir'awn, it is we who will certainly win!"} This is what the ignorant masses say when they do something: This is by the virtue of So-and-so! In Surat Al-A'raf Allah mentioned that they: iThey bewitched the eyes of the people, and struck terror into them, and they displayed a great magic} (7:116). And in Surah TaHa He said:

\$ 'fijv (a Sh piCs iThen behold! their ropes and their sticks, by their magic, appeared to him as though they movedfast until Allah saying: i3 g%} iand the magician will never be successful, whatever the amount (ofskill) he may attain} {20:69). And here Allah says: i l* < iih ^ liji iThen Musa threw his stick, and behold, it swallowed up all that they falsely showed!} by snatching up and catching them from every comer and swallowing them up, and it did not leave any of them untouched. Allah says: i&sfz u &&} iThus truth was confirmed, and all that they did was made of no effect.} until ^ ^j} iThe Lord ofMiisd and Harun.} (7:118-122) This was a very serious matter, furnishing decisive proof leaving no room for any excuse. Fir awn s supporters, who sought and hoped that they would prevail over Mtisa, were themselves defeated. At that moment they believed in Musa and prostrated to Allah, the Lord of Al- Alamin Who sent Musa and H&rGn with the truth and an obvious miracle. Fir awn was defeated in a manner the likes of which the world had never seen, but he remained arrogant and stubborn despite the clear evidence, may the curse of Allah and the angels and all of mankind be upon him. He resorted to arrogance and stubbornness and propagating falsehood. He began to issue threats against them, saying: pi '\$p& iVerily, he is your chiefwho has taught you magic} (20:71).

j, JZ& l\} iSurely, this is a plot which you have plotted in the city^ (7:123). Spi 3^' ^ ssc g 35 jlit; Gjj dj J** ^ fgg jjt if gtga (2; e j gg 449. He said: "You have believed in him before I give you leave. Surely, he indeed is your chief, wlv has taught you magic! So verily, you shall come to know. Verily, I will cut off your hands and your feet on opposite sides, and I will crucify you all."} 450 . They said: "No harm! Surely, to our Lord we are to return."} 452. "Verily, we really hope that our Lord will forgive us our sins, as we are thefirst of the believers."} Between Fir awn and the Sorcerers His threats against them resulted only in an increase in their faith and submission to Allah, for the veil of disbelief had been lifted from their hearts and the truth became clear to them because they knew something that their people did not: that what Musa had done could not have been done by any human being unless Allah helped him, making it proof and an evidence of the truth of what he had brought from his Lord. Then Fir'awn said to them: ip 3 \$p:} iYou have believed in him before I give you leave.} meaning, *you

should have asked my permission for what you did, and you did not consult with me; if I had given you permission you could have done it, and if I did not allow you, you should not have done it, for I am the ruler and the one to be obeyed. ipfi 'p& iSurely, he indeed is your chief, who has taught you magic!}

458. Treasures, and every kind of honorable place.} 459. Thus and We caused the Children of Israel to inherit them.} The Exodus of the Children of Israel from Egypt After Musa stayed in Egypt for a long time, and the proof of Allah was established against Fir'awn and his chiefs, yet they were still arrogant and stubborn, then there was nothing left for them but punishment and vengeance. So Allah commanded Musa, peace be upon him, to take the Children of Israel out of Egypt by night, and take them wherever he would be commanded. So Musa, peace be upon him, did as he was commanded by his Lord, may He be glorified, and he led them forth after they had borrowed an abundance of jewelry from the people of Fir'awn. As more than one of the scholars of Tafsir have said, they left when the moon was rising, and Mujahid, may Allah have mercy on him, said that the moon was eclipsed that night. 1 11 And Allah knows best. Mh'sa asked about the grave of Yusuf (Prophet Joseph), peace be upon him, and an old woman from among the Children of Israel showed him where it was, so he took the remains with them, and it was said that they were among the things that were carried by Musa himself, may peace be upon them both. It was also said that Yusuf, peace be upon him, had left instructions in his will that if the Children of Israel ever left Egypt, they should take his remains with them.12 The following morning, when there was nobody to be found in the Israelite quarters, Fir'awn became angry and his anger intensified since Allah had decreed that he was to be destroyed. So he quickly sent his callers to all his cities, i.e., to mobilize his troops and bring them together, and he called out to them: 4Verily, these} meaning, the Children of Israel, 4i>)4 Z&fr At-Tabari 19:354.Tabari 19:354.

^indeed are but a small band.} meaning, a small group. 4And verily, they have done what has enraged us.} means, every time we have heard anything about them, it has upset us and made us angry. 4But we are a host all assembled, amply forewarned.} means, *we are constantly taking precautions lest they betray us. Some of the Salaf read this with the meaning, we are constantly forewarned and forearmed. And I want to destroy them to the last man, and destroy all their lands and property. So he and his troops were punished with the very things he sought to inflict upon the Children of Israel. Allah says: 'l'? > 4So, We expelled them from gardens and springs, treasures, and every kind of honorable place.} meaning, they were thrown out of those blessings and into Hell, and they left behind the honorable places, gardens and rivers, wealth, provision, position and power in this world: iThus and We caused the Children of Israel to inherit them.} This is like the Ayat jfXT4^ \ C'Jj} 4And We made the people who were considered weak to inherit the eastern parts of the land and the western parts thereof which We have blessed} (7:137). 4And We wished to do a favor to those who were weak in the land, and to make them rulers and to make them the inheritors} The two Ayat thereafter: [28:5-6].

4'infioxspy 1S0W ai/; 3lti fyt4 si 3H 'P*o7 xnoR R\i3a puy 89\$ 4'sx303ipq JOU 3XV U13Iff fo fSOLU }dR 'u8ts V p33pUl SI Stiff III 'RU3/{ 9\$ 4'sx3iffo 3iff psumoup 3/vi U3ILL '99\$ 4'uitq iffim 3sotff ffv puv vstjpy pscws 3/vj puy 59'3ov\ d)viff 0} SJ3iffO 31/; JV3U iqEnoxq 3/w usqi pg} 4 uw)unoui sZnq 3j/i/ 3iuv33q pvd sfvuvdss tpvd puv 'pdfxvd 11 puy ,,'^pffS xnoR tffiai vss 3i/; 3J/u;s : (SuiRvs) ysnny 0; p3\v3cm 3/vi ioi/j, ' 9^ i/;m Rjusa 'Rvpi,, :pws (ysnw) Z9\$ 4,,U3^V}J3aO sq 0;

sxtis 3xv 3/V4 :pi"s "s"^\o suotuvdutoj 3tff xsiffo ipvs ows sfsoq omi 3i/; U3i/m puy jg 3SIXUHS IV Ul3lff pdnsxnd Rsiff 'os 09\$ js ^ a It 'r 5- ' ' - 'i, M r*r\ r* ifOr\ rjss s! <&f & ^ it* hntr j js i?T #T3. If? f-fi f ?C rC# jr^ \$r irrr^ b <\$fr* !P -?j 4,,3ut spin8 Him 3f/ -pxoq Rui si 3iu m 6l-V"d) {89 - 09)WmSW '93W

to strike the sea with his staff, so he struck it, and it parted, by the will of Allah. Allah says: 4And it parted, and each separate part became like huge mountain.} meaning, like mighty mountains. This was the view of Ibn Mas'ud, Ibn Abbas, Muhammad bin Ka b, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah and others. 11 Ata Al-Khurasani said, It refers to a pass between two mountains. Ibn Abbas said, The sea divided into twelve paths, one for each of the tribes. 2 As- Suddi added, And in it there were windows through which they could see one another, and the water was erected like walls. 3 Allah sent the wind to the sea bed to make it solid like the land. Allah says: iand strike a dry pathfor them in the sea, fearing neither to be overtaken nor being afraid (20:77). And here He says: iThen We brought near the others to that place.} Ibn Abbas, Ata Al-Khurasani, Qatadah and As-Suddi said: iThen We brought near} means, We brought Fir awn and his troops near to the sea. 4 yj fry i^j,} }And We saved Musa and all those with him. Then We drowned the others.} meaning: *We saved Musa and the Children of Israel and whoever followed their religion, and none of them wereJabari 19:358. 2| Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :299Tabari 19:357. |4 At-Jabari 19:359.

destroyed, but Fir'awn and his troops were drowned and not one of them remained alive, but was destroyed. Then Allah says: 4&S j >[} iVerily, in this is indeed a sign,} meaning, this story with its wonders and tales of aid to the believing servants of Allah is definitive proofand evidence ofAllah s wisdom. 2%&@^ J3SI of iyet most of them are not believers. And verily your Lord, He is truly the All-Mighty, the Most Merciful.}

The explanation of this phrase has already been discussed

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4103–4104]

above.' 1 U Ulil x2 {yltt C H ^ kiy j* yii 3Jy&ll Ji Jli & @53 & il^ jti jujT 4@os- 5' vj 4 . And recite to than the story ofIbrahim. 470. When he said to his father and his people: "What do you worship?"} 471. They said: "We worship idols, and to them we are ever devoted."} 472. He said: "Do they hear you when you call?"} 473. "Or do they benefit you or do they cause harm?"} 474. They said: "(Nay) but wefound ourfathers doing so."} 475. He said: "Do you observe that which you have been worshipping -"} 476. "You and your ancientfathers? } 477. "Verily, they are enemies to me, save the Lord of Al-Alamin,"} [i] SeeAyah no. 9 ofthis Surah.

How the Close Friend of Allah, Ibrahim spoke out

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4104–4111]

against Shirk Here Allah tells us about His servant, Messenger and Close Friend, Ibrahim, upon him be peace, the leader of the pure monotheists. Allah commanded His Messenger Muhammad jg to recite this story to his Ummah so that they could follow this example of sincerity towards Allah, putting one s trust in Him, worshipping Him Alone with no partner or associate, and renouncing Shirk and its people.

Allah granted guidance to Ibrahim before, i.e., from a very early age he had denounced his people's practice of worshipping idols with Allah, may He be exalted. iWheti he said to his father and his people: "What do you worship? } meaning: what are these statues to which you are so devoted? 4 Li jit* liuJ jlu iThey said: "We worship idols, and to them we are ever devoted. } meaning: we are devoted to worshipping them and praying to them. fa: yti iHe said: "Do they hear you when you call? Or do they benefit you or do they cause harm?" They said: "(Nay) but we found our fathers doing so." } They knew that their idols could not do anything, but they had seen their fathers doing this, so they made haste to follow in their footsteps. So Ibrahim said to them: "j d J-* U ^tO'r 4Do you observe that which you have been worshipping -you and your ancient fathers? Verily, they are enemies to me, save the Lord of Al- Alamm. }

made it a Word lasting among his offspring, that they may turn back (43:26-28). meaning: La. tiaha lUalldh." 'ip .>" J! 1 v 478. Who has created me, and it is He Who guides me . 479. And it is He Who feeds me and gives me to drink. 4 480. And when I am ill, it is He Who cures me. 481 . And Who will cause me to die, and then will bring me to life. 482. And Wlw, 1 hope, will forgive me my faults on the Day of Recompense. Ibrahim mentions Allah's Kindness towards Him Ibrahim said, I will not worship any but the One Who does these things: 4Who has created me, and it is He Who guides me. He is the Creator Who has decreed certain things to which He guides His creation, so each person follows the path which is decreed for him. Allah is the One Who guides whomsoever He wills and leaves astray whomsoever He wills. 4And it is He Who feeds me and gives me to drink. 4 He is my Creator Who provides for me from that which He has made available in the heavens and on earth. He drives the clouds and causes water to fall with which He revives the earth and brings forth its fruits as provision for mankind. He sends down the water fresh and sweet so that many of those whom He has created, animals and men alike, may drink from it. 4And when I am ill, it is He Who cures me. Here he attributed sickness to himself, even though it is Allah

^ iKSffig rv ' mtSSP ^ i^"> -"tf ">" <* ' '>:.*"Xi ':\&> .- 0 03 o^%V^oj3Ssit3sjSSjVi^i^ Tafctr Ibn Kathir MX ^saWho decrees it, out of respect towards Allah. By the same token, Allah commands us to say in the prayer, "(| \$ iGuide us to the straight way} (1:6) to the end of the Surah. Grace and guidance are attributed to Allah, may He be exalted, but the subject of the verb with reference to anger is omitted, and going astray is attributed to the people. This is like when the Jinn said: t| t>*j -*y* jr*" V f& n 4 jj"jVf 4A"d u know not whether evil is intended for those on earth, or whether their Lord intends for them a right path (72:10) Similarly, Ibrahim said: {And when I am ill, it is He Who cures me.} meaning, when I fall sick, no one is able to heal me but Him, Who heals me with the means that may lead to recovery . r"^> < y Who will cause me to die, and then will bring me to life.} He is the One Who gives life and causes death, and no one besides Him is able to do that, for He is the One Who originates and repeats.

j_ J Afi And Who, I hope, will forgive me my faults on the Day of Recompense.} means, no one is able to forgive sins in this world or the Hereafter except Him. Who can forgive sins except Allah? For He is the One Who does whatever He wills. pt "if 0}& Pi tfl &> if ^ ^ j* if . My Lord! Bestow Hukm on me, and join me with the righteous.} 484. And grant me an honorable mention in later generations.} 485. And make me one of the inheritors of the Paradise of Delight.} 486. And forgive my father, verily, he is

of the erring.} 487. And disgrace me not on the Day when they will be resurrected.} 488. The Day whereon neither wealth nor sons will avail,} 489. Except him who brings to Allah a clean heart.} The Prayer of Ibrahim for Himself and for His Father Here Ibrahim, upon him be peace, asks his Lord to give him Hukm. Ibn Abbas said, This is knowledge. 4cr~^iA. ,ji*Aj} 4and join me with the righteous.} means, make me one of the righteous in this world and the Hereafter. This is like the words

the Prophet said three times when he was dying: 'J& * J=#'J "0 Allah, with the Exalted Companion (of Paradise)*j2 4 4 oO j *** Al-Baghawi 3 :390 121 Path Al-Bdri 7 :743

iAnd grant me an honorable mention in later generations.} meaning, cause me to be remembered in a good manner after my death, so that I will be spoken of and taken as a good example. This is like the Ayah, iAnd We left for him (a goodly remembrance) among the later generations: "Saldm (peace) be upon Ibrahim. Thus indeed do we reward the good doers.} (37:108-110) iAnd make me one of the inheritors of the Paradise of Delight.} meaning, *bless me in this world with honorable mention after I am gone, and in the Hereafter by making me one of the inheritors of the Paradise of Delight. 4And forgive my father,} This is like the Ayah, i&j&j J 'jp'&j} \$My Lord! Forgive me, and my parents} (71:28). But this is something which Ibrahim, peace be upon him, later stopped doing, as Allah says: fSy if Cj} iAnd Ibrahim's supplication for his father's forgiveness was only because of a promise he had made to him} (9:1 14) until: i^L l{ iVerily, Ibrahim was Awwdh111 and was forbearing} (9:1 14). Allah stopped Ibrahim from asking for forgiveness for his father, as He says: 'So 1+fA '4 p& 15} iIndeed there has been an excellent example for you in Ibrahim and those with him}, until His saying: m See volume four , the Tafsir of Surat At-Tawbah (9:114).

&\$&& ibnt I have no power to do anything for you before Allah.} (60:4), . ft. iAnd disgrace me not on the Day when they will be resurrected.} means, protect me from shame on the Day of Resurrection and the Day when all creatures, the first and the last, will be raised.

244 Tafsir Ibn Kathir and there will be dust and darkness on Azar's face. Ibrahim will say to him, "Did I not tell you not to disobey me?" His father will say to him: Today I will not disobey you." Ibrahim will say: "O Lord, You promised me that You would not disgrace me on the Day when they are resurrected, but what disgrace can be greater than seeing my father in this state?" Allah will say to him: "I have forbidden Paradise to the disbelievers." Then it will be said: "O Ibrahim! Look beneath your feet." So he will look and there he will see (that his father was changed into) a male hyena covered in dung, which will be caught by the legs and thrown in the Fire.i111 This was also recorded by Abu Abdur-Rahman An-Nasa i in

the Tafsir of his Sunan Al-Kubra.

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 4111]

|2) 4103* The Day whereon neither wealth nor sons will avail,} means, a man's wealth will not protect him from the punishment of Allah, even if he were to pay a ransom equivalent to an earthful of gold. <&& in or sons} means, or if you were to pay a ransom of all the people on earth. On that Day nothing will be of any avail except faith in Allah and sincere devotion to Him, and renunciation of Shirk and its people. Allah says: 410;*^*** yli jf^{} iExcept him who brings to Allah a clean heart.} meaning, free

from any impurity or Shirk. Ibn Sirin said, The clean heart knows that Allah is true, that the Hour will undoubtedly come and that Allah will resurrect those who are in the graves. 131 Said bin Al-Musayyib said, The clean heart is the sound heart. 141 This is the heart of the believer, for the heart of the disbeliever and the hypocrite is sick. Allah says: Fath Al-Bari 6:445. This was previously explained in volume three,

the Tafsir of Surat Al-Ana'm (6 :79)

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4111–4161]

jou auv tuaqi fo }sout iaR 'uSts v paapui si stip ui 'Rjua/) f.jsuaaa,ipq aqi 8uouiv aq R\tui \vqs am. 'uuttjau o) aoutnp v pvq Rjuo am f\ Qstqy) ZOI i pw v jon ioi 4,/sjossaauijui ou aovq am mopq,, 00l) 4,/ S\VUllUU3 aip jdaaxa uouua 0}ui sn iq2nouq svq auou puy gg) i,/s)stxa imp ip fo puoq aip ipim spnba sv noR pjaq am uaq/zilt -ggp 4'uouua isafiuvtu v ui R\rui axam am qvpy Rq zg) 4'utajaifl Suipuaiuoo apqm Rvs pirn Ram ggp i uaqiaSoi sijqjfo sisoq aqi/o pv puy 4'Rvuisv aip puv Raqi '(autj aqi) ji o;ui saavf utaqi uo umoiqi aq pirn Ratp uaqi fgp i'^saaiasuiaqi d{aq jo noR dpq Raqi uvj iqppy fo pvaisuj,, - g\$ i'/diqsuom o) pasti noR imp asoqi auv auaq/w,, : tuaqi o) ptvs aq ptm p puy Z6) 4'Rvuisv aqi fo mam ptif ui paov{d aq pirn auij (pan) aqi puy ig\$ 4 vmbv pvq oqm asoqi 1 wau iqSnoj aq pim asipvuvj puy 06) .. IfBUUnS 3ip iptM 1U3JU00 SI PUB UOpBAOUUl UIOJJ aajj si iBip vreaq aip si pres unqBsyj-uv u?tuipfL nqy '(Ol S) iasvasip v si sfuvaq upqi uft SPZ {6l~1Jvd) (POl - 06) ,m,nqs-qsy gz qvjtJS

f JldJl)&)) 4And all of the hosts of blis together.) they will all be thrown into it. 4They will say while contending therein, "By Allah, we were truly in a manifest error, when we held you as equals with the Lord of all that exists.") The weak ones among them will say to their arrogant leaders: Verily, we were following you; can you avail us anything from the Fire? Then they will realize that themselves are to blame and will say: i) & 4 \$s) 4By Allah, we were truly in a manifest error, when we held you as equals with the Lord of all that exists.) meaning, we obeyed your commands as we should have obeyed the commands of the Lord of the all that exists, and we worshipped you along with the Lord of all that exists. uti Zj) 4And none has brought us into error except the criminals.) meaning, nobody called us to do that except the evildoers. 4Now we have no intercessors.) This is like the Ayah which tells us that they will say: La i Jp Ji U Ijn.4^U *LtJut ij* U 4-..now are there any intercessors for us that they might intercede on our behalf? Or could we be sent back so that we might do deeds other than those deeds which we used to do?) (7:53). Similarly, in this Surah, Allah tells us that they will say: 4Now we have no intercessors, nor a close friend.)

248 Tafsir Ibtī Kathir 4(Alas!) If we only had a chance to return, we shall truly be among the believers!} They will wish that they could come back to this world so that they could do deeds of obedience to their Lord - as they claim - but Allah knows that if they were to come back to this world, they would only go back to doing forbidden things, and He knows that they are liars. Allah tells us in Surah Sad about how the people of Hell will argue with one another, as He says: >' \} iVerily, that is the very truth - the mutual dispute of the people of the Fire!} (38:64) Then He says: iVerily, in this is indeed a sign, yet most of them are not believers.} meaning, in the dispute of Ibrahim with his people and his proof of Tawhid there is a sign, i.e., clear evidence that there is no God but Allah. iyet most of them are not believers. And verily, your Lord, He is truly the All-Mighty, the Most Merciful.} 04&P 4l

\$\$\$ \$&& ?X h iil \J& Je V) Lb4 Oi Ey 4105. The people of Nilh denied the Messengers.} 4106. When their brother Nuh said to them: "Will you not have Taqwa? } 4107. "I am a trustworthy Messenger to you."} 4108. "So have Taqwa of Allah, and obey me."} 4109. No reward do I ask of you for it; my reward is only

from the Lord of all that exists. } 4110. "So have Taqwd of Allah, and obey me. } Null's preaching to His People, and Their Response Here Allah tells us about His servant and Messenger Null, peace be upon him, who was the first Messenger sent by Allah to the people of earth after they started to worship idols. Allah sent him to forbid that and to warn people of the consequences of idol worship. But his people belied him and continued their evil practice of worshipping idols besides Allah. Allah revealed that their disbelieving in him was akin to disbelieving in all the Messengers, So Allah said: iThe people of Niih belied the Messengers. When their brother Niih said to them: Will you not have Taqwd?"} meaning, do you not fear Allah when you worship others instead of Him? 4: t-U&&p 4/ am a trustworthy Messenger to you.} means, I am the Messenger of Allah to you, faithfully fulfilling the mission with which Allah has sent me. I convey the Messages of my Lord to you, and I do not add anything to them or take anything away from them., Lt& jgfd % 'it \$&} 4So have Taqwd of Allah, and obey me. No reward do I ask of you for it;} means, I do not want any payment for the advice I give you; I will save my reward for it with Allah. it \y&} 4So have Taqwd of Allah, and obey me.} It is clear to you that I am telling the truth and that I am faithfully fulfilling the mission with which Allah has entrusted me.

SI op O} 3ABq I JJB :pUnOJ jpip 3UIUIBX3 pUB UI3ip UO qoaqo oi 3ABq iou op i sjojsq op oi pssn Asqi isqM jshbui on (3UI MOIIOJ Xsqi JI 3UX qitM op 01 3ABq 11 S30p IBqM, 3UJUB3UI < iop 01 pssn Rstp ivqtnfo j savq 3%p3\aioid{ imftn puy :pws spj „inoR cnopcf uousfui sni U3i{(ti noli ut dosipq 3m. pvifs,, :pws fain) 49f1 ffi ?? ?C9T ^ Jfi Suoure is3moi aqi sjb Asqi pUB noA ui 3A3ipq puB noA Moqoj oqm ajdoad sqi jo issuBsui sqi oi psnbs stuoosq puB noA avoiipj iou niM puB noA ui 3A3ipq iou op 3/w :pres Asqj, asuodsaxam P" quN jo aidoad ajjjo puBuiaa sqx ^ usuuvon uwid v R\uo rnv / -silt 4,/sudastpq sip Rvcnv saup oj SuioS IOU uw I puy fil> 4,/motq (piq) pinoo noli ft puo'j Rui ipica R\uo si lunooov Apia,, IZ> i i P o) pssn Imp ivqm fo l 3am{ 3%pd\ (noun ivqoi puy :p}"s 3H 'Zll> i..t" R cnonof uousfui dip usqcn noR ut sasipq sm ims V vs fan III> a^ tK # % f. ra a \ 1? ff- ffi "r Star umivyi uqi uis/vx OSZ

Ash-Shu'ard' (111 - 122) (Part-19) accept it if they believe in me; whatever is in their hearts is for Allah to know. iTheir account is only with my Lord, if you could (but) know. And I am not going to drive away the believers.} It seems that they asked him to drive these people away, then they would follow him, but he refused to do that, and said: 4 %a jdk \$o iAnd I am not going to drive away the believers. I am only a plain wamer.} meaning, have been sent as a wamer, and whoever obeys me and follows me and believes in me, then he belongs to me and I to him, whether he is noble or common, upper-class or lower-class. 4* C*U ' l VJ Jt Ot =J {fk *ku y J2&& & (3 4^ "4j oJS Cites* Cj 4 M tip 4116. They said: "If you cease not, O Nuh you will surely be among those stoned."} 4117. He said: "My Lord! Verily, my people have denied me."} 4118. "Therefore judge You between me and them, and save me and those of the believers who are with me. } 4119. And We saved him and those with him in the laden ship.} 4120.

Then We drowned the rest thereafter.} 4121. Verily, in this is indeed a sign, yet most of them are not believers.} 4122 . And verily your Lord, He is indeed the All-Mighty, the Most Merciful.}

Ash-Shu'ard' (123 - 135) (Part-19) believers. And verily your Lord, He is indeed the All-Mighty, the Most Merciful.} 4123. Ad denied the Messengers.} 4124. When their brother Hud said to them: Will you not have Taqwa?"} 4125. "Verily , I am a trustworthy Messenger to you. } 4126. "So, have Taqwa ofAllah, and obey me."} 4127. "No reward do I ask of you for it; my reward is only from the Lord of all that exists."} 4128. "Do you build on every Rt an Ayah for your amusement?"} 4129. "And do you get for yourselves Masdni' as if you will live therein forever?"} 4130. "And when you seize (somebody), seize you Qxim) as tyrants?"} 4131. "So have Taqwa ofAllah, and obey me."} 4132. "And have Taqwa ofHim, fear Him Who has aided you with all (good things) that you know."} 4133. "He has aided you with cattle and children."} 4134. "And gardens and springs."} 4135. "Verily, Ifearfor you the torment ofa Great Day."} Hud s preaching to His People Ad Here Allah tells us about His servant and Messenger Hud, when he called his people Ad. His people used to live in the Ahqaf curved sand-hills near Hadramawt, on the borders of Yemen. They lived after the time of Nuh, as Allah says in Surat Al-A'r&f.

Ash-Shu ara' (135 - 140) (Part-19) rvr X />" j*SV> 1 1 >"" < :. ^ > * Up Up " **'<&> *>' . \i4as if you will live therein forever^ means, so that you may stay there forever, but that is not going to hap- pen, because they will eventually cease to be, just as happened in the case of those who came before you. AiU^a-XIA ^Antf when you seize (somebody), seize you (him) as tyrants?} They are described as being strong, violent and tyrannical. i*fSy \ %} iSo, have Tacfwa of Allah, and obey me.> Worship your Lord and obey your Messenger. Then Hud began reminding them of the blessings that Allah had bestowed upon them. He said: xj>\ oy^f /J L, ifjJi ^ & iAnd have Taqiva ofHim, Who has aided you with all that you know. He has aided you with cattle and children, and gardens and springs. Verily, I fear for you the tontient of a Great Day.} meaning, *if you disbelieve and oppose (your Prophet). So he called them to Allah with words of encouragement and words of warning, but it was to no avail. o* ty yu. <\$1 2 \$ %\$ SP

'iLL L.J *J"Sf (4 0] 4P~ . They said: "It is the same to us whether you preach or be not of those who preach."} 4137. "This is no other than Khuluq of the ancients,"} 4138. "And we are not going to be punished."} 4139. So they denied him, and We destroyed them. Verily, in this is indeed a sign, yet most ofthem are not believers.} 4140. And verily your Lord, He is indeed the Almighty, the Most Merciful.} The Response of the People of Hud, and Their Punishment Allah tells us how the people of Hud responded to him after he had warned them, encouraged them, and clearly explained the truth to them. 4They said: "It is the same to us whether you preach or be not of those who preach."} meaning, we will not give up our ways. 4And we shall not leave our gods far your (mere) saying! And we are not believers in you} (1 :53). This is how it was, as Allah says: 4Verily, those who disbelieve, it is the same to them whether you warn them or do not warn them, they will not believe} (2 :6). 4Truly, those, against whom the Word of your Lord has been justified, will not believe} (10 :96-97). And they said:

is no other than Khuluq of the ancients.) Some scholars read this: Khalq . According to Ibn Mas ud and according to Abdullah bin Abbas - as reported from Al- Awfi - and Alqamah and Mujahid, they meant, What you have brought to us is nothing but the tales (Akhlqa) of the ancients. 111 This is like what the

idolaters of Quraysh said: iAnd they say : "Tales of the ancients, which he has written down, and they are dictated to him morning and afternoon.") (25:5) And Allah said: jA*- -Ail pi ije Aj/it t li[^ Til* u) f jlij^ Jjkd ijiiij :h< > iThose who disbelieve say: "This is nothing but a lie that he has invented, and others have helped him in it. In fact, they have produced an injustice and a lie." And they say: "Tales of the ancients..." (25:4-5) i^\$R pk jj iAnd when it is said to them : "What is it that your Lord has sent down?" They say: "Tales of the ancient!") (16:24). Some other scholars recited it. 'Ji Ui iThis is no other than Khuluq of the ancients,) as Khuluq, meaning their religion. What they were following was the religion of the ancients, their fathers and grandfathers, as if they were saying: We are following them, we will live as they lived and die as they died, and there will be no resurrection and no judgement. Hence they said: m At-Tabari 19:378.

258 Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr 4And we are not going to be punished . Allah s saying; 4So they denied him, and We destroyed them.} meaning, they continued to disbelieve and stubbornly oppose Allah s Prophet Hud, so Allah destroyed them. The means of their destruction has been described in more than one place in the Qur an: Allah sent against them a strong and furious wind, i.e., a fiercely blowing wind that was intensely cold. Thus the means of their destruction was suited to their nature, for they were the strongest and fiercest of people, so Allah overpowered them with something that was even stronger and fiercer than them, as Allah says: 4Have you not seen how your Lord dealt with Ad of Iram? Possessors of the pillars} (89:6-7). This refers to the former Ad, as Allah says: 4 JjVi 'jU \$3} 4And that it is He Who destroyed thefarmer Ad (53:50). They were descendents of Iram bin Sam bin Nuh, 4\^} 4Possessors of the pillars} They used to live among pillars. Those who claim that Iram was a city take this idea from Isra ttiyyat 1 narrations, from the words of KaT> and Wahb, but there is no real basis for that. Allah says: 4The like ofwhich were not created in the land} (89:8). meaning, nothing like this tribe was created in terms of might, power and tyranny. If what was meant was a city, it would have said, The like of which was not built in the land. And Allah says: 28 dA ! M% U &\ z \)ij \$. \ Jfa %&} ' l| See the author s introduction to volume one.

4As for Ad, they were arrogant in the land without right, and they said: "Who is mightier than us in strength? See they not that Allah Who created them was mightier in strength than them. And they used to deny Our Ayat!} (41:15) And Allah says: 4And as for 'Ad, they were destroyed by a furious violent wind!} until His saying: 4tji~} 4in succession (69:6-7) meaning, consecutively (i.e., seven nights and eight days). cj\$ is*} iso that you could see men lying overthrown (destroyed), as if they were hollow trunks ofdate palms!} (69:7) means, they were left as headless bodies, because the wind would come and carry one of them, then drop him on his head, so that his brains were spilled out, his head was broken and he was thrown aside, as if they were uprooted stems of date-palms. They used to build fortresses in the mountains and caves, and they dug ditches half as deep as a man is tall, but that did not help them against the command of Allah at all. * %U iVerily, the term given by Allah, when it comes, cannot be delayed (71:4). Allah says here: 4So they denied him, and We destroyed them.} 4141. Thamud denied the Messengers.}

A Reminder to Them of their Circumstances and the Blessings They enjoyed Salih preached to them, warning them that the punishment of Allah could overtake them and reminding them of the blessings that Allah had bestowed upon them, by giving them ample provision and making them safe from all

kinds of dangers, giving them gardens and flowing springs, and bringing forth for them crops and fruits. it iand date palms with soft clusters .} Al- Awfi narrated from Ibn Abbas, Ripe and rich. 111 Ali bin Abi Talhah narrated from Ibn Abbas that this meant growing luxuriantly. Ismail bin Abi Khalid narrated from Amr bin Abi Amr - who met the Companions - from Ibn Abbas that this means, When it becomes ripe and soft. This was narrated by Ibn Abi Hatim, then he said: And something similar was narrated from Abu Salih. iAtid you hew out in the mountains, houses with great skill.} Ibn Abbas and others said, With great skill. * According to another report from him: They were greedy and extravagant. This was the view of Mujahid and another group. * There is no contradiction between the two views, because they built the houses which they carved in the mountains as a form of extravagant play, with no need for them as dwelling places. They were highly skilled in the arts of masonry and stone- carving, as is well known to anyone who has seen their structures. So, Salih said to them: iSo, have Taqwd ofAllBi\, and obey me.} Pay attention to that which could benefit you in this world and the Hereafter; worshipping your Lord Who created you, who Fath Al-Bdri 7 :731 . See the Tafstrof Surat Al-A r if[7 - 79) ' At-Tabari 19:380. ' At-Tabari 19:382. At-Tabari 19:383.

Ash-Shu'ara' (153 - 159) (Part-19) witchcraft. * Then they said: iYou are but a human being like us.} meaning, how can you receive Revelation when we do not? This is like the Ayah where they are described as saying: 'VI 4"Is it that the Reminder is sent to him alonefrom among us? Nay, he is an insolent liar! Tomorrow they will come to know who is the liar, the insolent one!} (54:26-27) Then they asked him for a sign to prove that what he brought to them from their Lord was the truth. A crowd of them gathered and demanded that he immediately bring forth from the rock a she-camel that was ten months pregnant, and they pointed to a certain rock in their midst. Allah s Prophet Salih made them promise that if he responded to their request, they would believe in him and follow him. So they agreed to that. The Prophet of Allah Salih, peace be upon him, stood and prayed, then he prayed to Allah to grant them their request. Then the rock to which they had pointed split open, revealing a she-camel that was ten months pregnant, exactly as they had requested. So some of them believed, but most of them disbelieved. O - . virs " #(X a *iii 4He said: "Here is a site-camel: it has a right to drink (water), and you have a right to drink (water) (each) on a day, known.} meaning, she will drink from your water one day, and on the next day you will drink from it. Hi 4And toitch her not with harm, lest the torment of a Great Day should seize you.} He warned them of the punishment of Allah if they should do her any harm. The she-camel stayed among them for a while, drinking the water, eating leaves and grazing, and theyTabari 19:384, 385.

i,,iP(nbD 3aml }ou noR ///Ad,, umg o/ pws pjq isipoiq imp ioijm igft 4 SJ3\$U3SS31A/ 3lff psiusp PJ1 fo 3\do3cl 31U 091\$ ft'3WI sa 17 & 1*f 5 ff J!^#\ ?r rfr n 15- K* c\$1 2^ ft# i'lnfpusw isow 3il} 'Rl l { ! Vi-llV 3tii p33put si 3j-j 'pjo'j inoR Rjusa puy sianoiq fou 3iv lusty fo ;soiu pR 'iiSts v psspui si snp ui 'R\U3^ <% p& h%>x? rrtf % rar&x% sauioq Jiaqi ui aiBJjsojd 3tnXj (peap) yaj ajaM os Sutpadxa iou 3J3M Aaqi qorq/A SJU3A3 Aq uajfejjaAO 3J3M Aaqx 'saoBjd .iraqi uiojj sjJBaq Jiaqi jjoo; qorqAA (jnoqs) ifvqfivs SutuqaqAuaAO ub uiaqi oj auiba ajaqi pire ajjBtibqjjBa Suojjs b Xq U33{Bqs sbm puB| Jtaqx i'uaifi yoopdao }U3tu -10} 3if) 'os 'pifpiSou 3UIV33q R.31}} U3l{ } pUV 'I3if P3JJPI Rsip pig), ssrfnc} f\ uaq npi oj pajrdsuoo Aaqj xEAU Avaap uorpruisap jraqi joj auip aqi pur? auqi 3uoj b joj uo auoS psq siqj jayy nU srq jjuup oj auo XJ3A3 joj saytiuBnb juaprgns ui jjooi Xaqi qotqM jqrux jaq uiojj pauraauq ^mmmm"i ferric? Vi?*i \$\$df 0 JAJ f^IttSf: f9Z

Ash-Shu'ard' (160 - 164) (Part-19) 4162. "Verily , I am a trustworthy Messenger to you."} 4163. "So, have Taqwa of Allah, and obey me."} 4164. "No reward do I ask of you for it; my reward is only from the Lord of all that exists."} Lut and His Call Here Allah tells us about His servant and Messenger Lut, peace be upon him. He was Lut bin Haran bin Azar, the nephew of Ibrahim Al-Khalil, upon him be peace. Allah sent him to a mighty nation during the lifetime of Ibrahim, peace be upon them both. They lived in Sadum (Sodom) and its environs, where Allah destroyed them and turned the area into a putrid, stinking lake, which is well-known in the land of Al- Ghur (the Jordan Valley], bordering the mountains of Jerusalem, between the mountains and the land of Al-Karak and Ash-Shawbak. He called them to Allah, to worship Him alone with no partner or associate, and to obey the Messenger whom Allah sent to them. He forbade from disobeying Allah and committing the sin that they had invented which was unknown on earth before their time; intercourse with males instead of with females. Allah said: it p, 41 36 Si\$3 & j4 gfi ^ // /ft' * /ay 4 X. ./ < . K.yyy y I y.y y > .y Sty Qj 4165. "Come you in unto the males of Al-Alamin (people),"} 4166. "And leave those whom Allah has created for you to be your wives? Nay, you are a trespassing people!"} 4167. They said: "If you cease not, O Lut, verily, you will be one of those who are driven out!"} 4168. He said: "I am indeed of those who disapprove with severe anger and fury your belmavior."} 4169. "My Lord! Save me and my family from what they do."}

4170. So, We saved him and his family, all,} 4171. Except an old woman among those who remained behind.} 4172. Then afterward We destroyed the others.} 4173. And We rained on them a rain, and how evil was the rain of those who had been warned!} 4174. Verily, in this is indeed a sign, yet most of them are not believers.} 4175. And verily your Lord, He is indeed the All-Mighty, the Most Merciful.} Lut's Denunciation of His People's Deeds, Their Response and Their Punishment The Prophet of Allah forbade them from committing evil deeds and intercourse with males, and he taught them that they should have intercourse with their wives whom Allah had created for them. Their response was only to say: 4If you cease not, O hut,} meaning, if you do not give up what you have brought, 4U%^ U 4verily, you will be one of those who are driven out!} meaning, *we will expel you from among us. This is like the Ayah, o*'-^ p-fij oi -Jyl J** [f%A o' VI CIA =" 4There was no other answer given by his people except that they said: "Drive out the family of Lut from your city. Verily, these are men who want to be clean and pure!"} (27:56). When he saw that they would not give up their ways, and that they were persisting in their misguidance, he declared his innocence of them, saying: 4I am, indeed, of those who disapprove with severe anger and

fury) Of those who are outraged, I do not like it and I do not accept it, and I have nothing to do with you. Then he prayed to Allah against them and said: 4My Lord! Save me and my family from what they do.) Allah says: 4So, We saved him and his family, all. Except an old woman among those who remained behind.) This was his wife, who was a bad old woman. She stayed behind and was destroyed with whoever else was left. This is similar to what Allah says about them in Surat Al-A'raf and Surah Hud, and in Surat Al-Hijr} 1] where Allah commanded him to take his family at night, except for his wife, and not to turn around when they heard the Sayhah as it came upon his people. So they patiently obeyed the command of Allah and persevered, and Allah sent upon the people a punishment which struck them all, and rained upon them stones of baked clay, piled up. Allah says: 4Then afterward We destroyed the others. And We rained on them a rain> |21 until Allah s saying; 48-*^' kf) 4And verily, your Lord, He is indeed the All-Mighty, the Most Merciful.) 4#*Pv ^& oi2*& psi tj it \j& 4176. The

companions of Al-Aykah denied the Messengers.) 111 See 7:80-81, 11:77, 15:58-76. ,21 That was a storm of stones. See the previous references for its explanation

268 Tafslr Ibn Kathir i!77. When Shu'ayb said to them: "Will you not have Taqwa?" } 4178. I am a trustworthy Messenger to you." } 4179. "So, have Taqwa of Allah, and obey me." } 4180. "No reward do I ask of you for it; my reward is only from the Lord of Al- Alamin." } Shu'ayb and His Preaching to the Dwellers of Al-Aykah The companions of Al-Aykah were the people of Madyan, according to the most correct view. The Prophet of Allah Shu'ayb was one of them, but it does not say here, their brother Shu'ayb, because they called themselves by a name denoting their deification of Al-Aykah, which was a tree which they used to worship; it was said that it was a group of trees which were tangled, like trees in a thicket. For this reason, when Allah said that the companions of Al-Aykah denied the Messengers, He did not say, When their brother Shu'ayb said to them. Rather, He said: fix iWhen Shu ayb said to them} He is not described as belonging to them because of the meaning that was inherent in the name given to them even though he was their brother by blood. Some people did not notice this point, so they thought that the dwellers of Al-Aykah were different from the people of Madyan, and claimed that Shu'ayb was sent to two nations; some said that he was sent to three. 1 ^} 4The companions of Al-Aykah} were the people of Shu'ayb. This was the view of Ishaq bin Bishr.^ Someone besides Juwaybir said, The dwellers of Al-Aykah and the people of Madyan are one and the same. And Allah knows best. Although there is another opinion that they were different nations with two identities, the correct view is that they were one nation, but they are described differently in different *** Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :318 At-Jabari 19:390.

places. Shu'ayb preached to them and commanded them to be fair in their weights and measures, the same as is mentioned in

the story of Madyan, which also indicates that they were the same nation. Si pxili- cfil' ^T,uUJu . Give full measure, and cause no loss (to others)."} "And weigh with the true and straight 4183. "And defraud not people by reducing their things, nor do evil, making corruption and mischief in the land." } 4184. "And have Taqwa of Him Who created you and the generations of the men ofold." } TheCommand to give Full Measure Allah commanded them to give full measure, and forbade them to give short measure. He said: " Si !#3% SP" 4Givefull measure, and cause no loss.} meaning, Svhen you give to people, give them full measure, and do not cause loss to them by giving them short measure, J V.m rvo msesm 'j0S^S: ^ a3]^JiJ^"A3i-1i ,dSCoo' ^SjJjV ^ yVr 0 f|pJj > /V// ^ / *> "> / . // y"uii . >' . "A ' -> . balance." }

270 Tafstr Ibn Kathir while taking full measure when you are the ones who are taking. Give as you take, and take as you give. 4And weigh with the true and straight balance. The balance is the scales. 4^X- J*Sli \jL 3 4And defraud not people by reducing their things, means, do not shortchange them. u&Vi \ l&O Vj} 4nor do evil, making corruption and mischief in the land.} means, by engaging in banditry. This is like the Ayah, ~jj} 4And sit not on every road, threatening (7:86). piAnd have Taqwa ofHim Who created you and the generations of the men ofold.} Here he is frightening them with the punishment of Allah Who created them and created their forefathers. This is like when Musa, peace be upon him, said: 4tdji' ffQ* viy '&} 4Your Lord and the Lord ofyour ancientfathers!} (26:26). Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, As-Suddl, Sufyan bin TJaynah and Abdur-Rahm&n bin Zayd bin Aslam said: 41& 4the

generations of the men of old.} means, He created the early generations. And Ibn Zayd recited: j-i' &j} 4And indeed he (Shaytdn) did lead astray a great multitude of you} (36:62).' m Af-Tabari 19:392.

4185. They said: "You are only one of those bewitched!"} 4186. "You are but a human being like us and verily, we think that you are one of the liars! } 4187. "So, cause a piece of the heaven to fall on us, ifyou are of the truthful!"} 4188. He said: "My Lord is the Best Knower of what you do. } 4189. But they denied him, so the torment of the Day of Shadow (a gloomy cloud) seized them. Indeed that was the torment ofa Great Day.} 4190. Verily, in this is indeed a sign, yet most of them are not believers.} 4191 . And verily your Lord, He is indeed the All-Mighty, the Most Merciful.} The Response of Shu ayb 8 People, Their Disbelief in Him and the coming ofthe Punishment uponThem Allah tells us how his people responded, and how it was like the response ofThamud to their Messenger - for they were of like mind - when they said: 4ctf \$ SiYou are only one of those bewitched!} meaning, you are one of those who are affected by witchcraft. y & 4SOH% tj} 4You are but a human being like us and verily, we think that you are one of the liars!} means, we think you are deliberately lying to us in what you say, and Allah has not sent you to us.

i\$2& Si ^So cause a piece of the heaven to fall on us,} Ad-Dahhak said: One side of the heavens. ' Qatadah said: A piece of the heaven. As-Suddi said: A punishment from heaven. This is like what the Quraysh said, as Allah tells us: tjffs .-Xu ' ' * > J }And they say: We shall not believe in you, until you cause a spring to gushforthfrom the earthfor us} until: \$Or you cause the heaven to fall upon us in pieces, as you have pretended, or you bring Allah and the angels before (us) face to face."} (17:90-92) Si IS Jdgft " JI iii 4 jLtfl i li'j} iAnd (remember) when they said: O Allah! If this is indeed the truth from You, then rain down stones on us from the sky...."} (8:32). Similarly, these ignorant disbelievers said: Si Serf*} iSo, cause a piece of the heaven to fall on us, ifyou are of the truthful!} 4He said: "My Lord is the Best Knower ofwhat you do."} means, Allah knows best about you, and if you deserve that, He will punish you therewith, and He will not treat you unjustly. So this is what happened to them - as they asked for - an exact recompense. Allah says: /J- vOe jSi) otic At-Tabari 19:393. ' At-Tabari 22:485.

4&ut they denied him, so the torment of the Day of Shadow seized them. Indeed that was the torment ofa Great Day This is what they asked for, when they asked for a part of the heaven to fall upon them. Allah made their punishment in the form of intense heat which overwhelmed them for seven days, and nothing could protect them from it. Then He sent a cloud to shade them, so they ran towards it to seek its shade from the heat. When all of them had gathered underneath it, Allah sent sparks of fire and flames and intense heat upon them, and caused the earth to convulse beneath them, and He sent against them a mighty Sayhah which destroyed their souls. Allah says: 4-^A /j" ty} 4Indeed that was the torment ofa Great Day.} Allah has mentioned how they were destroyed in three places in the Qur an, in each of which it is described in a manner which fits the context. In Surat Al-A'raf He says that the earthquake seized them, and they lay (dead), prostrate in their homes. This was because they said: 4 i/ iyCi \$ pj& tLU \p'. jJtj 4"We shall certainly drive you out, O Shu'ayb, and those who have believed with you from our town, or else you (all) shall return to our religion."} (7:88). They had sought to scare the Prophet of Allah and those who followed him, so they were seized by the earthquake. In Surah Hud, Allah says: 4And As-Sayhah seized the wrongdoers} (11:94). This was because they mocked the Allah

s Prophet when they said: X P.\ ijB -4 3 iJ j\ Sjb; C 33 ol I jb&&} 4"Does your Saldlt command that we give up what our fathers used to worship, or that we give up doing what we like xoith

our property? Verily, you are the forbearer, right-minded!") (11:87). They had said this in a mocking, sarcastic tone, so it was befitting that the Sayhah should come and silence them, as Allah says: iSo As-Saihah overtook them) (15:73). iAnd As-Saihah seized the wrongdoers) (11:94). And here, they said: \li Svũ&) 4So, cause a piece of the heaven to fall on us,) in a stubborn and obstinate manner. So, it was fitting that something theyneverthoughtwould happen should befall them: It% &(4,iji p&fr iso the torment of the Day ofShadow seized them. Indeed that was the torment of ofa Great Day.) Muhammad bin Jarir narrated from Yazid Al-Bahili: I asked Ibn Abbas about this Ayah: ff 4*u 4so the torment of the Day ofShadow seized them.) He said: Allah sent upon them thunder and intense heat, and it terrified them [so they entered their houses and it pursued them to the innermost parts of their houses and terrified them further|, and they ran fleeing from their houses into the fields. Then Allah sent upon them clouds which shaded them from the sun, and they found it cool and pleasant, so they called out to one another until they had all gathered beneath the cloud, then Allah sent fire upon them. Ibn Abbas said, That was the torment of the Day of Shadow, indeed that was the torment of a Great Day. m At-Tabari 19:394.

4Verily, in this is an Ayah, yet most of them are not believers. And verily, your Lord, He is truly, the All-Mighty, the Most Merciful.} (26:8-9) meaning, He is All-Mighty in His punishment of the disbelievers, and Most Merciful towards His believing servants. 4192. And truly, this is a revelation from the Lord of all that exists,> 4193. Which the trustworthy Ruh (Jibril) has brought down.} 4194. Upon your heart that you may be (one) of the wamers,} 4195. In the plain Arabic language.} The Qur an was revealedby Allah Here Allah tells us about the Book which He revealed to His servant and Messenger Muhammad s&. 4And truly, this} refers to the Qur an, which at the beginning of the Surah was described as >< s Jtand never comes there unto them a Reminder as a recent revelation from the Most Gracious...} (26:5). 4is a revelationfrom the Lord ofAl-'Alamin.} means, Allah has sent it down to you and revealed it to you. & a 4Which the trustworthy Ruh has brought down.} This refers to Jibril, peace be upon him. This was the view of more than one of the Salaf: Ibn Abbas, Muhammad bin Ka*b, Qatadah, Atiyyah Al- Awfi, As-SuddI, Ad-Dahhak, Az-Zuhri and Ibn Jurayj. ' This is an issue concerning which there is At-Tabari 19:396.

no dispute. Az-Zuhri said, This is like the Ayah: 4 4' oiũ JU\$ } iSay: "Whoever is an enemy to fibril - for indeed he has brought it down to your heart by Allah's permission, confirming what came before it..."} (2:97). 4 &} iUpon your heart} O Muhammad, free from any contamination, with nothing added or taken away. Si 4that you may be of the wamers,} means, so that you may warn people with it of the punishment of Allah for those who go against it and disbelieve in it, and so that you may give glad tidings with it to the believers who follow it. iln the plain Arabic language.} meaning, this Qur an which We have revealed to you, We have revealed in perfect and eloquent Arabic, so that it may be quite clear, leaving no room for excuses and establishing clear proof, showing the straight path. 4196. And verily, it is in the Zubur of theformer people.} 4197. Is it not a sign to them that the learned scholars of the Children of Israel knew it?} 4198. And ifWe had revealed it unto any of the non-Arabs,} 4199. And he had recited it unto them, they would not have believed in it.} The Qur an was mentioned in the Previous

Scriptures Allah says: this Qur'an was mentioned and referred to in the previous Scriptures that were left behind by their Prophets who foretold it in ancient times and more recently. Allah took a covenant from them that they would follow it, and the last of them stood and addressed his people with the good news of

Ash-Shu'ard' (196 - 199) (Part-19)

278 Tafslr Ibn Kathir ' agom rv-' mmm ^ (t-pS' CA^ ^^nLIw.jU_) *J\ * "/ - " Jy /// / -J^, ^ tsj\$ 0Zj^&"zJ. > 'rf. <}/"/< ** >*C' " (1)U5\ o^IaAji J l> eSglSligu ^ all its eloquence had been revealed to a non-Arab who did not know one word of Arabic, they still would not have believed in him. Allah says: O?" (& / 1* jt^ 'Us 4!^ mss" !>^= ^And i/We had revealed it unto any of the non- Arabs, And he had recited it unto them, they would not have believed in it.) And Allah says: is ft rf &3 J> & ij& tf i&4 z l (\$ [iAnd even if We opened to them a gate from the heaven and they were to keep on ascending thereto. They would surely say: "Our eyes have been dazzled... } (15:14-15) i^Cit 'f4l Vij St %} iAnd even if We had sent down unto them angels, and the dead had spoken unto them...} (6: 1 1 1) 4f|py~i3: 't oJ^=" jijlc oi"- |t 51^ iTruly, those, against whom the Word of your Lord has been justified, will not believe.} (10:96) (M %> & .* &P& v @ X 4^ ulj1 J* (t4<^

\yb l* U iy& V* p-hiU y "" "" 0"/ *' 4 lij isji @CuJxi Q 0 Oi gtf EJ 4200. Thus have We caused it to enter the hearts of the criminals.} They will not believe in it until they see the painful torment.} 4202. It shall come to them of a sudden, while they perceive it not.} 4203. Then they will say: "Can we be respited?"} 4204. Would they then wish for Our torment to be hastened on?} 4205. Think, if We do let them enjoy for years,} 4206. And afterwards comes to them that which they had been promised.} 4207. All that with which they used to enjoy shall not avail them.} 4208. And never did We destroy a township but it had its warners} 4209. By way of reminder, and We have never been unjust.} The Deniers will never believe until They see the Torment Allah says: thus We caused denial, disbelief, rejection and stubbornness to enter the hearts of the sinners. 4They will not believe in it}, i.e., the truth, 4jyVf w&Si &} 4until they see the painful torment.} means, when their excuses will be of no avail, and the curse will be upon them, and theirs will be an evil abode. 4/f shall come to them of a sudden,} means, the punishment of Allah will come upon them suddenly,

280 Tafclr Ibn Kathlr r*-" iwhile they perceive it not. Then they will say: Can we be respited?"} means, when they see the punishment, then they will wish they had a little more time so that they can obey Allah - or so they claim. This is like the Ayah: iAnd warn mankind of the Day when the torment will come unto them} until: ithat you would not leave (14:44). When every sinner and evildoer sees his punishment, he will feel intense regret. Such was the case of Fir'awn, when Musa prayed against him: iOur Lord! "You have indeed bestowed on Fir'awn and his chiefs splendor and wealth in the life of this world^ until: j o'J j i JB^ i(Allah) said: "Verily, the invocation of you both is accepted."} (10:88-89). This supplication had an effect on Fir'awn: he did not believe until he saw the painful torment: itill when drowning overtook him, he said: "I believe that none has the right to be worshipped but He in Whom the Children of Israel believe. } until: iand you were one of the mischief-makers} (10:90-91). And Allah says: ZL SC \% t&} iso when they saw Our punishment, they said: We believe in

Ash-Shu'ard' (200 - 209) (Part-19) Allah Atone...) (40:84-85). uLl) Would they then wish for Our torment to be hastened on?) This is a denunciation and a threat, because they used to say to the Messenger, by way of denial, thinking it unlikely ever to happen: iBring Allah's torment upon us) (29:29). This is as Allah said: iAnd they ask you to hasten on the torment...) (29:53-55). Then Allah says: s >' > 'A iThink, if VVe do let them enjoy for years, and afterwards comes to them that which they had been promised, all that with which they used to enjoy shall not avail them.) meaning, even if We delay the matter and give them respite for a short while or for a long time, then the punishment of Allah comes upon them, what good will their life of luxury do them then? iThe Day they see it, (it will be) as if they had not tarried (in this world) except an afternoon or a morning) (79:46). And Allah says: i J Si , "<> V 'Itf "> iEveryone of them wishes that he could be given a life of a thousand years. But the grant of such life will not save him even a little from punishment) (2:96). X&Ar*" i 'll' > " *> ,~V iAnd what will his wealth avail him when he goes down?) (92:11)

4 people thereof are wrongdoers (28:59). L-j 4m&2 4220. And it is not the Shayatin (devils) who have brought it down.) 4211. Neither would it suit them nor are they able.) 4212. Verily, they have been removed far from hearing it.) The Qur'an was brought down by Jibril, not Shaytan Allah tells us about His Book, which falsehood cannot approach from before or behind it, sent down by the All-Wise, Worthy of all praise. He states that it has been brought down by the trustworthy Ruh (i.e., Jibril) who is helped by Allah, * fsji Cj) 4And it is not the Shayatin who have brought it down.) Then He tells us that it could not be the case for three reasons that the Shayatin brought it down. One is that it would not suit them, i.e., they have no desire to do so and they do not want to, because their nature is to corrupt and misguide people, but this contains words enjoining what is right and forbidding what is evil, and light, guidance and mighty proofs. There is a big difference between this and the Shayatin, Allah says: ip JP. 4Neither would it suit them) 4&^.%) 4nor are they able.) meaning, even if they wanted to, they could not do it. Allah says: 4% Si 4-^ & SC^Ii& 0 J) 4Had We sent down this Qur'an on a mountain, you would surely have seen it humbling itself and rent asunder by the fear

you do."} 4227. And put your trust in the All-Mighty, the Most Merciful,} 4215. Who sees you when you stand up.} 4219. And your movements among those who fall prostrate.} 4220. Verily, He, only He, is the All-Hearer, the All-Knower.} The Command to warn His Tribe of near Kindred Here Allah commands (His Prophet jg) to worship Him alone, with no partner or associate, and tells him that whoever associates others in worship with Him, He will punish them. Then Allah commands His Messenger % to warn his tribe of near kindred, i.e., those who were most closely related to him, and to tell them that nothing could save any of them except for faith in Allah. Allah also commanded him to be kind and gentle with the believing servants of Allah who followed him, and to disown those who disobeyed him, no matter who they were. Allah said: . LiyU-xj W* gj iThen if they disobey you, say : 1 am innocent of what you do."} This specific warning does not contradict the general warning; indeed it is a part of it, as Allah says elsewhere: 4 u4 jX) B Cj Ji_jJ^ iln order that you may warn a people whose forefathers were not warned, so they are heedless .} (36:6), 4G>^- Irj CfJ-afi 4that you may warn the Mother of the Towns and all around it} (42:7), iAnd warn therewith those who fear that they will be gathered before their Lord} (6:51),

286 Tafslr Ibn Kathir ithat you may give glad tidings to those who have Taqwd, and warn with it the most quarrelsome people.} (19:97), ithat I may therewith warn you and whomsoever it may reach (6:19), and j* -if 'j&> *j} ibut those of the sects that reject it, the Fire will be their promised meeting place} (11:17). According to Sahlh.

Ash-Shu'ara' (213 - 220) (Part-19) "0 Batti 'Abd Al-Muttalib, O Bani Fihir, O Bani Lu'ayyl What do you think, if I told you that there was a cavalry at the foot of this mountain coming to attack you - would you believe me? They said, Yes. He said: "77ien I warn you ofa great punishment that is close at handJ Abu Lahab said, May you perish for the rest of the day! You only called us to tell us this? Then Allah revealed: ,j\ Tju iPerish the two hands ofAbu Lahab and perish hel)> [111: 1] [1 This was also recorded by

iWho sees you when you stand up.} When you pray alone. Ad-Dahhak said: iWho sees you when you stand up.} When you are lying in bed and when you are sitting. 111 Qatadah said: iWho sees you} When you are standing, when you are sitting, and in all other situations. / \ iAnd your movements among those ivho fall prostrate.} Qatadah said: / / / / 4"/ >' , / ,, sees you w/ien you stand up. And your movements among those who fall prostrate.} When you pray, He sees you when you pray alone and when you pray in congregation. 131 This was also the view of Ikrimah, Ata Al-Khurasani and Al-Hasan Al-Basri.141 4f& \$ %} iVerily, He, only He, is the All-Hearer, the All-Knower.} He hears all that His servants say and He knows all their movements, as He says: H " S*-* - Ji Ojlllu ijti dj 4 j} ' * .i #5-" oj'- rJ' iNeither you do any deed nor recite any portion of the Qur'an, nor you do any deed, but I've are Witness thereof, when you are doing it} (10:61). Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6:330. Abdur-Razzaq 3 :77 131 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :33Tabari 19:413.

pkJi, gx \$ \$ && fl) ^s" j S"uif jt+* i "i ^ ^ it &j %)f& \ju \pc Si" 4i l ^'tj/(jjxic. AS-j l * l_yUJ" -J U AaJ . Shall I inform you upon whom the Shayatin descend?) 4222. They descend on every lying, sinful person (AthTm).) 4223. W/10 giues ear, and most ofthem are liars.) 4224. Asfor the poets, the astray follow them,) 4225. See you not that they speak about every subject in their poetry?) 4226. And that they say what they do not do.) 4227. Except tlwse who believe and do righteous deeds, and remember Allah much and vindicate themselves after they have been wronged. And tlwse wlw do wrong will come to know by what overturning they will be overturned.) Refutation ofthe Fabrications ofthe Idolaters Here Allah addresses those idolators who claimed that what was brought by the Messenger jg was not the truth but was merely something that he had made up by himself, or that it came to him in visions from the Jinn. Allah stated that His Messenger was above their claims and fabrications, and that what he had brought did indeed come from Allah, and that it was a revelation and inspiration, brought down by a noble, trustworthy and mighty angel. It did not come from the Shayatin, because they have no desire for anything like this Noble Qur an - they descend upon those who are like them, the lying fortune-tellers. Allah says: 4Shall I inform you) meaning, shall 1 tell you, 4upon whom the Shayatin descend? They descend on every lying, sinful person (AthTm))

Ash-Shu'ard' (221 - 227) (Part-19) meaning, one whose speech is lies and fabrication. iAthim} means, whose deeds are immoral. This is the person upon whom the Shayatin descend, fortune-tellers and other sinful liars. The Shayatin are also sinful liars. 4Who gives ear,} means, they try to overhear what is said in the heavens, and they try to hear something of the Unseen, then they add to it a hundred lies and tell

it to their human comrades, who then tell it to others. Then the people believe everything they say because they were right about the one thing which was heard from the heavens. This was stated in an authentic Hadith recorded by

Allah decrees a matter in heaven, the angels beat their wings in submission to His decree, a drum beating on a rock. And when the fear in their hearts subsides, they say :

4As for the poets, the astray ones follow them .} Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn Abbas that this means: The disbelievers follow the misguided among mankind and the Jinn. 11 This was also the view of Mujahid, Abdur- Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam, and others. Ikrimah said, Two poets would ridicule one another in verse, with one group of people supporting one and another group supporting the other. Hence Allah revealed the Ayah, 4As for the poets, the erring ones follow them.} fj Sr= 4 J 4See you not that they speak about every subject in their poetry?} Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn Abbas that this means: They indulge in every kind of nonsense. * Ad-Dahhak reported that Ibn Abbas said, They engage in every kind of verbal art. This was also the view of Mujahid and others. 4And that they say what they do not do.} Al- Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said that at the time of the Messenger of Allah 5g|, two men, one from among the Ansar and one from another tribe, were ridiculing one another in verse, and each one of them was supported by a group of his own people, who were the foolish ones, and Allah said: 4 m 4i4s for the poets, the erring ones follow them . See you not that they speak about every subject in their poetry? And that they At-Tabari 19:416. At-Tabari 19:415 416. * Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :323 At-Jabari 19:418. *S * Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :334 At-Tabari 19:417.

294 Tafslr Ibn Kathir say what they do not do.^

What is meant here is that the Messenger jg, to whom this

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4161–4162]

Qur an was revealed, was not a soothsayer or a poet, because his situation was quite obviously different to theirs, as Allah says: %2k 6 \$And We have not taught him poetry, nor is it suitable for him. This is only a Reminder and a plain Qur'an .) (36:69), l* Pf Jyj Jy; j* -Pit? jJj-v 4 y5 oj JkA jV, 477wf f/iis is verily, the word of an honored Messenger. It is not the word of a poet, little is that you believe! Nor is it the word of a soothsayer, little is that you remember! This is the Revelation sent down from the Lord of all that exists.) (69:40-43) The Exception of the Poets of Islam i> P* c/i' 4Except those who believe and do righteous deeds,) Muhammad bin Ishaq narrated from Yazid bin Abdullah bin Qusayt, that Abu Al-Hasan Salim Al-Barrad, the freed servant of Tarnim Ad-Dari said: When the Ayah - 4As for the poets, the erring ones follow them.) was revealed, Hassan bin Thabit, Abdullah bin Rawahah and Ka*b bin Malik came to the Messenger of Allah jgg, weeping, and said: Allah knew when He revealed this Ayah that we are poets. The Prophet g recited to them the Ayah, ipp i \p: c/j\ y\ iExcept those who believe and do righteous deeds,) and said: iM At-Tabari 19:416.

Ash-Shu ard' (221 - 227) (Part-19) (This means) you. it {and remember Allah much}. He said: (This means) you. iand vindicate themselves after they have been wronged.} He said: (This means) you. This was recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim and Ibn Jarir from the narration of Ibn Ishaq. But this Surah was revealed in Makkah, so how could the

reason for its revelation be the poets of the Ansar? This is

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4162–4164]

something worth thinking about. The reports that have been narrated about this are all Mursal and cannot be relied on. And Allah knows best. But this exception could include the poets of the Ansar and others. It even includes those poets of the Ja.hiU.yyah who indulged in condemning Islam and its followers, then repented and turned to Allah, and gave up what they used to do and started to do righteous deeds and remember Allah much, to make up for the bad things that they had previously said, for good deeds wipe out bad deeds. So they praised Islam and its followers in order to make up for their insults, as [the poet] Abdullah bin Az-Zab ari said when he became

Ash-Shu'ard' (221 - 227) (Part-19) iThe Day when their excuses will be of no profit to wrongdoers} (40:52). According to the Sahih, the Messenger of Allah jg said: faodk jjlkJl ijJliJlj fafy Beware of wrongdoing, for wrongdoing will be darkness on the Day of Resurrection .",Tl Qatadah bin Di'amah said concerning the Ayah - 4JjAa- 1_.A j ^ l_ rUi ^ f/iouse who do wrong will come to know by what overturning they will be overturned.} this refers to the poets and others.

Surah 27: An-Naml

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Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4165–4180]

Opening The Tafsir of Surat An-Naml (Chapter - 27) Which was revealed in Makkah In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. ¹ ² ³ ⁴ ⁵ ⁶ ⁷ ⁸ ⁹ ¹⁰ ¹¹ ¹² ¹³ ¹⁴ ¹⁵ ¹⁶ ¹⁷ ¹⁸ ¹⁹ ²⁰ ²¹ ²² ²³ ²⁴ ²⁵ ²⁶ ²⁷ ²⁸ ²⁹ ³⁰ ³¹ ³² ³³ ³⁴ ³⁵ ³⁶ ³⁷ ³⁸ ³⁹ ⁴⁰ ⁴¹ ⁴² ⁴³ ⁴⁴ ⁴⁵ ⁴⁶ ⁴⁷ ⁴⁸ ⁴⁹ ⁵⁰ ⁵¹ ⁵² ⁵³ ⁵⁴ ⁵⁵ ⁵⁶ ⁵⁷ ⁵⁸ ⁵⁹ ⁶⁰ ⁶¹ ⁶² ⁶³ ⁶⁴ ⁶⁵ ⁶⁶ ⁶⁷ ⁶⁸ ⁶⁹ ⁷⁰ ⁷¹ ⁷² ⁷³ ⁷⁴ ⁷⁵ ⁷⁶ ⁷⁷ ⁷⁸ ⁷⁹ ⁸⁰ ⁸¹ ⁸² ⁸³ ⁸⁴ ⁸⁵ ⁸⁶ ⁸⁷ ⁸⁸ ⁸⁹ ⁹⁰ ⁹¹ ⁹² ⁹³ ⁹⁴ ⁹⁵ ⁹⁶ ⁹⁷ ⁹⁸ ⁹⁹ ¹⁰⁰ ¹⁰¹ ¹⁰² ¹⁰³ ¹⁰⁴ ¹⁰⁵ ¹⁰⁶ ¹⁰⁷ ¹⁰⁸ ¹⁰⁹ ¹¹⁰ ¹¹¹ ¹¹² ¹¹³ ¹¹⁴ ¹¹⁵ ¹¹⁶ ¹¹⁷ ¹¹⁸ ¹¹⁹ ¹²⁰ ¹²¹ ¹²² ¹²³ ¹²⁴ ¹²⁵ ¹²⁶ ¹²⁷ ¹²⁸ ¹²⁹ ¹³⁰ ¹³¹ ¹³² ¹³³ ¹³⁴ ¹³⁵ ¹³⁶ ¹³⁷ ¹³⁸ ¹³⁹ ¹⁴⁰ ¹⁴¹ ¹⁴² ¹⁴³ ¹⁴⁴ ¹⁴⁵ ¹⁴⁶ ¹⁴⁷ ¹⁴⁸ ¹⁴⁹ ¹⁵⁰ ¹⁵¹ ¹⁵² ¹⁵³ ¹⁵⁴ ¹⁵⁵ ¹⁵⁶ ¹⁵⁷ ¹⁵⁸ ¹⁵⁹ ¹⁶⁰ ¹⁶¹ ¹⁶² ¹⁶³ ¹⁶⁴ ¹⁶⁵ ¹⁶⁶ ¹⁶⁷ ¹⁶⁸ ¹⁶⁹ ¹⁷⁰ ¹⁷¹ ¹⁷² ¹⁷³ ¹⁷⁴ ¹⁷⁵ ¹⁷⁶ ¹⁷⁷ ¹⁷⁸ ¹⁷⁹ ¹⁸⁰ ¹⁸¹ ¹⁸² ¹⁸³ ¹⁸⁴ ¹⁸⁵ ¹⁸⁶ ¹⁸⁷ ¹⁸⁸ ¹⁸⁹ ¹⁹⁰ ¹⁹¹ ¹⁹² ¹⁹³ ¹⁹⁴ ¹⁹⁵ ¹⁹⁶ ¹⁹⁷ ¹⁹⁸ ¹⁹⁹ ²⁰⁰ ²⁰¹ ²⁰² ²⁰³ ²⁰⁴ ²⁰⁵ ²⁰⁶ ²⁰⁷ ²⁰⁸ ²⁰⁹ ²¹⁰ ²¹¹ ²¹² ²¹³ ²¹⁴ ²¹⁵ ²¹⁶ ²¹⁷ ²¹⁸ ²¹⁹ ²²⁰ ²²¹ ²²² ²²³ ²²⁴ ²²⁵ ²²⁶ ²²⁷ ²²⁸ ²²⁹ ²³⁰ ²³¹ ²³² ²³³ ²³⁴ ²³⁵ ²³⁶ ²³⁷ ²³⁸ ²³⁹ ²⁴⁰ ²⁴¹ ²⁴² 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S iliaijfa- tva V, Uj^ i*Lj c~J 7 Ljjj ^--aii 1 fv,j'.j.,\) 1^ . Pt - '.<>.' > >;>- S^v3iS!CiiiiSi^oj%1; \$ 'o^>"1 "cA^i UlfiJ 4Awd the Word of your Lord has been fulfilled in truth and in justice} (6:115). cliC i4"V jfi l^i" J -jyr * iiji- j> .y,PjfLU, jj y " . . * -> ,5^ JI j4 -^y o* <-\$*? "*u- Ui *" if "/>/ .ijf VL> 4tt" (^J t>*J .jUJl 'it ct 4 : * > a & :S^t #" dj%&% lil" l^ -3" vl? 3 ii" *) ' SjL^it 23 *>? t,r '*' j' . * '{ ' yy* W %y* -* *? J-V <^ft 4 j?4S l!4"" (*r*t"- Cto pfdsiJi \Jfi \j6 t ijj ojp jl yjt, gli j jyi> ji. JLi- j " J-tili ijlcj LJLt j^lii l 4:U-"-b ^ 'j-^iS 'i^ . ?wJ UC* ipli 'CPf> itjtsUiJfi& 47. (Remember) when Musa said to his household: "Verily, I have seen a fire; I will bring you from there some information, or I will bring you a burning ember, that you may warm yourselves."} 48. But when he came to it, he was called: "Blessed is whosoever is in the fire, and whosoever is round about it! And glorified be Allah, the Lord of all that exists."} 49. "O Musa! Verily, it is I, Allah, the All-Mighty, the All- Wise."}

An-Naml (7 - 14) (Part-19) 410. ",And throw down your stick!" But when he saw it moving as if it were a snake, he turned in flight, and did not look back. (It was said:) "O Musa! Fear not: verily, the Messengers fear not in front of Me."} ill. "Except him who has done wrong and afterwards has changed evil for good ; then surely, I am Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful."} 412. "And put your hand into opening of your garment, it will come forth white without hurt. (These are) among the nine signs (you will take) to Fir'awn and his people. Verily, they are a people who are rebellious. } 413. But when Our Ayat came to them, clear to see, they said: "This is a manifest magic. } 414. And they belied them wrongfully and arrogantly, though they themselves were convinced thereof. So, see what was the end of the mischief-makers.} The Story of Musa and the End of Fir'awn Here Allah tells His Messenger Muhammad 3g| about what happened to Musa, peace be upon him, how Allah chose him, spoke with him and gave him mighty, dazzling signs and overwhelming proof, and sent him to Fir'awn and his people, but they denied the proof, disbelieved in him and arrogantly refused to follow him. Allah says: 4) 3 -> 1 when Musa said to his household}, meaning, remember when Musa was traveling with his family and lost his way. This was at night, in the dark. Musa had seen a fire beside the mountain, i.e., he had noticed a fire burning brightly, and said, 4^i \$ c-j 4 to his household: Verily, I have seen a fire; I will bring you from there some information... } meaning, about the way we should take. 4^ Jffi yifi* f^y

ior I will bring you a burning ember, that you may warm yourselves.) meaning, so that they could keep warm. And it was as he said: He came back with great news, and a great light. Allah says: 4 or 4a* ^ &) <\$But when he came to it, he was called: Blessed is whosoever is in the fire, and whosoever is round about it!") meaning, when he came to it, he saw a great and terrifying sight: the fire was burning in a green bush, and the fire was burning ever brighter while the bush was growing ever more green and beautiful. Then he raised his head, and saw that its light was connected to the clouds of the sky. Ibn Abbas and others said, It was not a fire, rather it was shining light. According to one report narrated from Ibn Abbas, it was the Light of the Lord of the worlds.' ! Musa stood amazed by what he was seeing, and 4 or J ihe was called: "Blessed is whosoever is in the fire..." Ibn Abbas said, This means. Holy is (whosoever is in the fire). !2' iand whosoever is round about it) means, of the angels. This was the view of Ibn Abbas, Ikrimah, Sa*Td bin Jubayr, Al-Hasan and Qatadah.'3 ' 4And glorified be Allah, the Lord of all that exists), Who does whatever He wills and there is nothing like Him among His creation. Nothing He has made can encompass Him, and He is the Exalted, the Almighty, Who is utterly At-Tabari 19:428. Af-Tabari 19:428. ' At-Tabari 19:429, Al-Muharrar Al-Wajiz 4 :250, Ad-Durr Al-Manthur

unlike all that He has created. Heaven and earth cannot contain Him, but He is the One, the Self-Sufficient Master, Who is far above any comparison with His creation. fork) iO Musa! Verily, it is I, Allah, the All-Mighty, the All- Wise.} Allah told him that the One Who was addressing him was his Lord Allah, the All-Mighty, Who has subjugated and subdued all things, the One Who is Wise in all His words and deeds. Then He commanded him to throw down the stick that was in his hand, so that He might show him clear proof that He is the One Who is able to do all things, whatever He wills. When Musa threw that stick down, it changed into the form of a huge and terrifying snake, moving quickly despite its size. Allah says: i%\$% (1) iBut when he saw it moving as if it were a Jann (snake).} Jann refers to a type of snake that is the fastest-moving and most agile. When Musa saw that with his own eyes, ihe turned in flight, and did not look back.} meaning, he did not turn around, because he was so afraid. Allah s saying: \ S3 SZ & .} iO Musa! Fear not : verily, the Messengers fear not in front of Me.} means, do not be afraid of what you see, for I want to choose you as a Messenger and make you a great Prophet. * -a4 4Except him who has done wrong and afterwards has changed evil for good; then surely, I am Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} This is an exception of the exclusionary type. This is good news for mankind, for whoever does an evil deed then gives it

up and repents and turns to Allah, Allah will accept his repentance, as He says: MV j^J <^: Jlj jU3 jl } 4And verily, Iam indeedforgiving to him who repents, believes and does righteous good deeds, and then AhtadaP] } (20:82) 4P~ 4And whoever does evil or wrongs himself. . .> (4: 1 10). And there are many other Ayat which say the same. tr o* ~ } -ift &\$>} 4And put your hand into the opening ofyour garment, it will come forth white without hurt.} This is another sign, further brilliant proof of the ability of Allah to do whatever He wills. It is also confirmation of the truth of the one to whom the miracle was given. Allah commanded him to put his hand into the opening of his garment, and when he put his hand in and took it out again, it came out white and shining as if it were a piece of the moon or a flash of dazzling lightning. gfi } 4among the nine signs} means, these are two of the nine signs which you will be supported with and which will serve as proof for you. 4to Fir'awn and his people. Verily, they are a people who are rebellious.} These were the nine signs of which Allah said: \$ yi& Gfr JSSj} 4And indeed We gave Musa nine clear signs} (17:101) - as we have stated thereJ2 4Z esc &} 111 Meaning, he is guided. See the Tafsir of Surah TaHa (20 :82) I2 ' See volume nine, the Tafsirof Surat Al-Isra (17:101)

{But when Our Aydt came to them, clear to see,}, i.e., clear and obvious, * { "A- ui ithey said: This is a manifest magic" .} They wanted to oppose it with their own magic, but they were defeated and were returned disgraced. 4 V^f} iAnd they belied them means, verbally, ithough they themselves were convinced thereof.} means, they knew deep down that this was truth from Allah, but they denied it and were stubborn and arrogant. iwrongfully and arrogantly} means, wronging themselves because this was the despicable manner to which they were accustomed, and they were arrogant because they were too proud to follow the truth. Allah said: iSo, see what was the end of the mischief-makers.} meaning, see, O Muhammad, what were the consequences of their actions when Allah destroyed them and drowned every last one of them in a single morning. The point of this story is: beware, O you who disbelieve in Muhammad and deny the Message that he has brought from his Lord, lest the same thing that befell them befall you also. But what is worse, is that Muhammad jg is nobler and greater than Musa, and his proof is stronger than that of Musa, for the signs that Allah has given him are combined with his

presence and his character, in addition to the fact that previous Prophets foretold his coming and took a covenant from the people that they would follow him if they should see him, may the best of blessings and peace from his Lord be upon him. oCc If jff Jp liLi ttll 4\AlX' "jlij dip julLij llcl. &j}

308 Tafstr Ibn Kathir l jU q? j.u Ql jig *)' ".*." H& % J&j 0aft ">>' .^'1 ; tU*& ~L. * - 4*^* i j & !?' : i Jti) l+b* j* > Cm A * + 4 Joy \$& & do % ZZ& 415. And indeed We gave knowledge to Dawud and Sulaxjmdn, and they both said: "All praise be to Allah, Who has preferred us above many of His believing servants!" } 416. And Sulayman inherited from Dawud. He said: "O mankind! We have been taught the language of birds, and we have been given from everything. This, verily, is an evident grace." } 417. And there were gathered before Sulayman his hosts of Jinn and men, and birds, and they all were set in battle order (marching forward). } 418. Till, when they came to the valley of the ants, one of the ants said "O ants! Enter your dwellings, lest Sulayman and his armies should crush you, while they perceive not." } 419. So he (Sulayman) smiled, amused at her speech and said: "My Lord! Grant me the power and ability that I may be grateful for Your favors which You have bestowed on me and on my parents, and that I may do righteous good deeds that will please You, and admit me by Your mercy among Your righteous servants." } Dawud and Sulayman (peace be upon them), the organization of Sulayman's Troops and His passage through the Valley of the Ants Here Allah tells us about the great blessings and favors which He bestowed upon two of His servants and Prophets, Dawud (David) and his son Sulayman (Solomon), peace be upon them both, and how they enjoyed happiness in this world and the Hereafter, power and authority in this world, and the position of being Prophets and Messengers. Allah says:

fe uli tfjf m. Jui> 'jiiij iLL ijij uC indeed We gave knowledge to Dawud and Sulaymdn, and they both said: All the praises and thanks be to Allah, Who has preferred us above many of His believing servants!") 4And Sulaymdn inherited from Dawud.) means, in kingship and prophethood. What is meant here is not wealth, because if that were the case, Sulayman would not have been singled out from among the sons of Dawud, as Dawud had one hundred wives. Rather what is meant is the inheritance of kingship and prophethood, for the wealth of the Prophets cannot be inherited, as the Messenger of Allah ggjj said: oiisj> u ".dVi viUJ I'Ve Prophets cannot be inherited from; whatever we leave behind is charity And Sulayman said: \$ & djJM jki dipJM &) 40 mankind! We have been taught the language of birds, and we have been given from everything.) Here Sulayman was speaking of the blessings that Allah bestowed upon him, by giving him complete authority and power, whereby mankind, the Jinn and the birds were subjugated to him. He also knew the language of the birds and animals, which is something that had never been given to any other human being - as far as we know from what Allah and His Messenger told us. Allah enabled Sulayman to understand what the birds said to one another as they flew through the air, and what the different kinds of animals said. Sulayman said:

4We have been taught the language of birds, and we have been given from everything. i.e., all things that a king needs. &&\$ % iThis, verily, is an evident grace.} means, this is clearly the blessings of Allah upon us. (iAnd there were gathered before Sulayman his hosts of Jinn and men, and birds, and they all were set in battle order.) means, all of Sulayman's troops of Jinn, men and birds were gathered together, and he rode with them in a display of might and glory, with people marching behind him, followed by the Jinn, and the birds flying above his head. When it was hot, they would shade him with their wings.

ft*? iand they all were set in battle order.} The first and the last of them were brought together, so that none of them would step out of place. Mujahid said: Officials were appointed to keep each group in order, and to keep the first and the last together so that no one would step out of line - just as kings do nowadays. 11 iplf h \$h iTill, when they came to the valley of the ants,} meaning, when Sulayman, the soldiers and the army with him crossed the valley of the ants, i/ w*/ >>>>' | 'fs* |V*i V'5 .ii ione of the ants said: "O ants! Enter your dwellings, lest Sulayman and his armies should crush you, while they perceive not. } Sulayman, peace be upon him, understood what the ant said,Tabari 19 :500, 501

\$&& iSo he smiled, amused at her speech and said: My Lord! Grant me the power and ability that 1 may be grateful for Your favors which You have bestowed on me and on my parents, and that I may do righteous good deeds that will please You,) meaning: inspire me to give thanks for the blessings that You have bestowed upon me by teaching me to understand what the birds and animals say, and the blessings that You have bestowed upon my parents by making them Muslims who believe in You. L\$ iand that / may do righteous good deeds that will please You,) means, deeds that You love which will earn Your pleasure. 4and admit me by Your mercy among Your righteous servants.) means, when You cause me to die, then join me with the righteous among Your servants, and the Higher Companion among Your close friends. 420. He inspected the birds, and said: What is the matter that 1 see not the hoopoe? Or is he among the absentees?") 421. I will surely punish him with a severe torment or slaughter him, unless he brings me a clear reason.") The Absence ofthe Hoopoe Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr and others narrated from Ibn Abbas and others that the hoopoe was an expert who used to show Sulaymdn where water was if he was out in open land and needed water. The hoopoe would look for water for him in the various strata of the earth, just as a man looks at things on the surface of the earth, and he would know just how far below the surface the water was. When the hoopoe showed

him where the water was, Sulayman would command the Jinn to dig in that place until they brought water from the depths of the earth. One day Sulayman went to some open land and checked on the birds, but he could not see the hoopoe. ifji 'i iand (Sulayman) said: What is the matter that I see not the hoopoe? Or is he among the absentees?"} One day Abdullah bin Abbas told a similar story, and among the people was a man from the Khaw&rij whose name was Nafi bin Al-Azraq, who often used to raise objections to Ibn Abbas. He said to him, Stop, O Ibn Abbas; you will be defeated (in argument) today! Ibn Abbas said: Why? Nafi said: You are telling us that the hoopoe can see water beneath the ground, but any boy can put seed in a trap and cover the trap with dirt, and the hoopoe will come and take the seed, so the boy can catch him in the trap. Ibn Abbas said, If it was not for the fact that this man would go and tell others that he had defeated Ibn Abbas in argument, I would not even answer. Then he said to Nafi : Woe to you! When the decree strikes a person, his eyes become blind and he loses all caution. Nafi said: By Allah I will never dispute with you concerning anything in the Qur an. 41 will surely punish him with a severe torment Al-A*mash said, narrating from Al-Minhal bin Amr from Said that Ibn Abbas said: He meant, by plucking his feathers. I Abdullah bin Shaddad said: By plucking his feathers and exposing him to the sun. This was also the view of more than one of the Salaf, that it means plucking his feathers and leaving him exposed to be eaten by ants. 4S&.sfi 4or slaughter him,} means, killing him. Al-Qurtubi 13:177 178. At-Tabari 19:443. At-Tabari 19:443.

An-Naml (22 - 26) (Part-19 J mm (+4^==*-p**> _-ij jC- VIf|p oil O^LLoUj j S^SS&C fyJi#K -. [ills \$S/bbC)jt S^l ijli^UbjiLsI unless he brings me a clear reason. The hoopoe said, Then I am saved. 4.^? 4 \$ 4unless he brings me a clear reason.} i.e., a valid excuse. Sufyan bin Uyaynah and Ab- dullah bin Shaddad said: When the hoo- poe came back, the other birds said .to him: What kept you? Sulayman has vowed to shed your blood. The hoopoe said: Did he make any excep- tion [did he say un- less]? They said, Yes, he said: jt \1^ . li& 41 will surely punish him with a severe tor- ment or slaughter him, 41 ps p* * -W p P. Jtii jJuJi ji, U-*jb Wi-uy vi? '-4i ji1 ji c "l> ipl ojI4 V (^ f jH-1 oii> ' j (> ^-llu Ly ojt*- U %uj Jfjiij v^ll 4 ifjl j5j Ltii-i VI S^jpiyjLJj c^-*" 4u _>* V't V *il 422 . But (the hoopoe) stayed not long, he said: "I have grasped which you have not grasped and I have come to you from Saba with true news."} 423. Ifound a woman ruling over them, she has been given

324 Tafslr Ibn Kathir all things, and she has a great throne."} 424. "Ifound her and her people worshipping the sun instead of Allah, and Shaytan has made their deeds fair seeming to them to prevent them from the way, so they have no guidance."} 425. So they do not prostrate themselves before fillah, Who brings to light what is hidden in the heavens and the earth, and knows what you conceal and what you reveal.} 426. Allah, La ilaha ilia Huwa, the Lord of the Supreme Throne! }

How the Hoopoe came before Sulayman and told Him

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4180–4189]

about Saba Allah says: 4^-fi jf. l^Jt} 4But (the hoopoe) stayed not long,} meaning, he was absent for only a short time. Then he came and said to Sulayman: 4 41 have grasped which you have not grasped} meaning, I have come to know something that you and your troops do not know. 4.\$?. pj pr 4and I have come to youfrom Saba' with true news.} meaning, with true and certain news. Saba (Sheba) refers to Himyar, they were a dynasty in Yemen. Then the hoopoe said: 4ih^="K * ' o[] 41found a woman ruling over them,} Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, This is Bilqls bint Sharahl, the queen of Saba . Allah s saying: 4she has been given all things,} means, all the conveniences of Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :351

this world that a powerful monarch could need. iand she has a great throne.} meaning, a tremendous chair adorned with gold and different kinds ofjewels and pearls. The historians said, This throne was in a great, strong palace which was high and firmly constructed. In it there were three hundred and sixty windows on the east side, and a similar number on the west, and it was constructed in such a way that each day when the sun rose it would shine through one window, and when it set it would shine through the opposite window. And the people used to prostrate to the sun morning and evening. This is why the hoopoe said: - ' >> ' 41 found her and her people worshipping the sun instead of Allah, and Shaytan has made their deeds fair seeming to them, and has prevented themfrom the way,} meaning, from the way of truth. iso they have no guidance.} Allah s saying: V* V if L?JJT iand Shaytdn has made their deeds fair seeming to them, and has prevented them from the way, so they have no guidance, so they do not prostrate themselves before Allah.} They do not know the way of truth, prostrating only before Allah alone and not before anything that He has created, whether heavenly bodies or anything else. This is like the Ayah: H plij jLLlfj X&J #^} 4Andfrom among His signs are the night and the day, and the sun and the moon. Prostrate yourselves not to the sun nor to the moon, but prostrate yourselves to Allah Who created them, ifyou indeed worship Him.} (41:37)

Who brings to light what is hidden in the heavens and the earth,} Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said: He knows everything that is hidden in the heavens and on earth. 111 This was also the view of Ikrimah, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Qatadah and others.121 His saying: Cj ofoi and knows what you conceal and what you reveal.} means, He knows what His servants say and do in secret, and what they say and do openly. This is like the Ayah J>*J it j-ft- i)*J 4 ,y ^} 4It is the same whether any of you conceals his speech or declares it openly, whether he be hid by night or goes forth freely by day} (13:10). His saying: ti^ *, V ^} 4Allah, La ildha ilia Huwa, the Lord of the Supreme Throne!} means, He is the One to be called upon, Allah, He is the One other than Whom there is no god, the Lord of the Supreme Throne, and there is none greater than Him in all of creation. Since the hoopoe was calling to what is good, and for people to worship and prostrate to Allah alone, it would have been forbidden to kill him. Imam

ty P 'Ji \$^jS3t Sj SX ft 3SZi js Cr*-j~* v^T dj ij\$ ti[It-fe)U bt* Jls6 / s,x _ 4 >{, /<> " > '* ij ^ ,x' ^ ^y _ . 427 . (Sulayman) said: We shall see whether you speak the truth or you are (one) of the liars."4 428. Go you with this letter of mine and deliver it to them, then draw backfrom than and see what they return."4 429. She said: "O chiefs! Verily, here is delivered to me a noble letter,"4 430. Verily , it is from Sulayman, and it (reads): In the Name ofAllah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful;'4 431 . Be you not exalted against me, but come to me submitting (as Muslims).' "4 Sulayman s Letter to Bilqis Allah tells us what Sulayman said to the hoopoe when he told him about the people of Saba and their queen: Oj ft oSju3 jJliuS. jtt*> 4(Sulayman) said: We shall see whether you speak the truth or you are (one) of the liars."4 meaning, are you telling the truth? iUgSi U ft" 4or you are (one) of the liars. meaning, or are you telling a lie in order to save yourselffrom the threat I made against you? 4 b JliiS ffJ- 3j5 lili 4Go you with this letter of mine and deliver it to than then draw backfrom them and see what they return. Sulayman wrote a letter to Bilqis and her people and gave it to the hoopoe to deliver. It was said that he carried it on his wings, as is the way with birds, or that he carried it in his beak. He went to their land and found the palace of Bilqis, then he went to her private chambers and threw the letter through a small window, then he stepped to one side out of

&\$&W &-&^^ C 6,^ ijO # . c" "ii ijfca & jse ^ ^^ ^ j* %!&fa r#% \$ 4\$^ tful &t t? S 1 . S/ie said: "O chichi/ Advise me in case of mine. I decide no case till you are present with me."} 433 . They said : "We have great strength, and great ability for war, but it is for you to command; so think over what you will command."} 434. She said: "Verily, kings, when they enter a town, they destroy it and make the most honorable among its people the lowest. And thus they do."} 435. "But verily, I am going to send him a present, and see with what (answer) the messengers return."} Bilqis consults with Her Chiefs When she read Sulayman s letter to them and consulted with them about this news, she said: 4jU-V-i <! #*"\$ sfo 4 djr*\ ijili' 4"0 chiefs! Advise me in (this) case of mine. I decide no case till you are present with me. } meaning, until you come together and offer me your advice. (They said: We have great strength, and great ability for war..."} They reminded her of their great numbers, preparedness and strength, then they referred the matter to her and said: ibut it is for you to command; so think over what you will command.} meaning, we have the power and strength, if you want to go to him and fight him. The matter is yours to decide, so instruct us as you see fit and we will obey. Ibn Abbas said:

An-Naml (36 - 37) (Part-19 Prophet, so follow him. ' jiA 21> * "- ii? Hi JLiJ CpjjJ Jtt ;Il Cji^ (4H^J ^ jii < * y A&i (if?i jrj' 436. So, when (the messengers with the gift) came to Sulayman, he said: "Will you help me in wealth? What Allah has given me is better than that which He has given you! Nay, you rejoice in your gift!"} 437. "Go back to them. We verily, shall come to them with armies that they cannot resist, and we shall drive them out from there in disgrace, and they will be abased."} The Gift and the Response of Sulayman More than one of the scholars of Tafsir among the Salaf and others stated that she sent him a huge gift of gold, jewels, pearls and other things. It is apparent that Sulayman, peace be upon him, did not even look at what they brought at all and did not pay any attention to it, but he turned away and said, rebuking them: i Will you help me in wealth?"} meaning, are you trying to flatter me with wealth so that I will leave you alone with your Shirk and your kingdom? ~lii jO- Hi^ iWhat Allah has given me is better than that which He has given you!} means, *what Allah has given to me of power, wealth and troops, is better than that which you have. 4j^ii ,; jiA Ji} }Nay, you rejoice in your gift!} means, tyou are the ones who are influenced by gifts and presents; we will accept nothing from you except Islam or the sword. m At-Tabari 19 :455

}Go back to them^ means, with their gift, & * j&e gp 4We verily, shall come to them with armies that they cannot resist, they have no power to match them or resist them. Vi iand we shall drive them out from there in disgrace,} *we shall drive them out in disgrace from their land. iand they will be abased means, humiliated and expelled. When her messengers came back to her with her undelivered gift, and told her what Sulayman said, she and her people paid heed and obeyed him. She came to him with her troops in submission and humility, honoring Sulayman and intending to follow him in Islam. When Sulayman, peace be upon him, realized that they were coming to him, he rejoiced greatly. 138. He said: "O chiefs! Which of you can bring me her throne before they come to me surrendering themselves in obedience (as Muslims)?"} 139. An Ifrit from the Jinn said: "I will bring it to you before you rise from your place. And verily, I am indeed strong and trustworthy for such work. } 140. One with whom was knowledge of the Scripture, said : "I will bring it to you within the twinkling of an eye! Then when he saw it placed before him, he said: This is by the grace of my Lord - to test me whether I am grateful or ungrateful! And whoever is grateful, tndy, his gratitude is for himself; and whoever is ungrateful, certainly my Lord is Rich, Bountiful."}

How the Throne of Bilqis was brought in an Instant

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4189–4195]

Muhammad bin Ishaq reported from Yazid bin Ruman: When the messengers returned with word of what Sulayman said, she said: *By Allah, I knew he was more than a king, and that we have no power to match him, and that we can gain nothing by being stubborn with him. So, she sent word to him saying: I am coming to you with the leaders of my people to see what you will instruct us to do and what you are calling us to of your religion. Then she issued commands that her throne, which was made of gold and inlaid with rubies, chrysolite and pearls, should be placed in the innermost of seven rooms, one within the other, and all the doors should be locked. Then she told her deputy whom she was leaving in charge, Take care of my people and my throne, and do not let anyone approach it or see it until I come back to you. Then she set off to meet Sulayman with twelve thousand of her commanders

from the leaders of Yemen, under each of whose command were many thousands of men. Sulayman sent the Jinn to bring him news of her progress and route every day and night, then when she drew near, he gathered together the Jinns and humans who were under his control and said: s\$ j j3 IK?^p i&it 40 chiefs! Which of you can bring me her throne before they come to me surrendering themselves in obedience (as Muslims)?}. |11 4An Ifntfrom the jinn said :} Mujahid said, A giant Jinn." Abu Salih said, It was as if he was a mountain. 4/ will bring it to you before you rise from your place.} Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, Before you get up from where you are sitting. At-Tabari 9:520. Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :359 131 Al-Baghawi 3:420.

As-SuddI and others said: He used to sit to pass judgements and rulings over the people, and to eat, from the beginning of the day until noon. ilS)&&\$} iAnd verily, I am indeed strong and trustworthy far such work.} Ibn Abbas said: Strong enough to carry it and trustworthy with the jewels it contains. Sulayman, upon him be peace, said, I want it faster than that. 111 From this it seems that Sulayman wanted to bring this throne as a demonstration of the greatness of the power and authority that Allah had bestowed upon him and the troops that He had subjugated to him. Power such as had never been given to anyone else, before or since, so that this would furnish proof of his prophethood before Bilqxs and her people, because this would be a great and wondrous thing, if he brought her throne as if he were in her country, before they could come to it, although it was hidden and protected by so many locked doors. When Sulayman said, I want it faster than that, iJ f % fe ji\$ iOne with whom was knowledge of the Scripture said:} Ibn Abbas said, This was Asif, the scribe of Sulayman. It was also narrated by Muhammad bin Ishaq from Yazid bin Raman that he was Asif bin Barkhiya' and he was a truthful believer who knew the Greatest Name of Allah . Qatadah said: He was a believer among the humans, and his name was Asif. iui% 35 , Ax il will bring it to you within the twinkling of an eye!} Meaning, lift your gaze and look as far as you can, and before you get tired and blink, you will find it before you. Then he got up, performed ablution and prayed to Allah, may He be exalted. Mujahid said: He said, O Owner of majesty and honor. *** Al-Baghawi 3 :420. * Al-Baghawi 3 :420 [3] At-Tabari 19:466.

325 Surah 27, An-Naml (38 - 40) (Part-19) When Sulayman and his chiefs saw it before them, ihe said: "This is by the grace of my Lord..." meaning, this is one of the blessings which Allah has bestowed upon me. 4P& j&. r' -spy 4to test whether I am grateful or ungrateful! And whoever is grateful, truly, his gratitude is for himself;} This is like the Ayat .1 5P& P*} iWhosoever does righteous good deed, it is for himself; and whosoever does evil, it is against himself.} (41:46) iand whosoever does righteous good deed, then such will prepare a good place for themselves.} (30:44). iand whoever is ungrateful, certainly my Lord is Rich, Bountiful.} He has no need of His servants or their worship. 4%y=y iBountiful} He is Bountiful in and of Himself, even if no one were to worship Him. His greatness does not depend on anyone. This is like what MQsa said: imLir&& J# jPf o\} ilf you disbelieve, you and all on earth together, then verily, Allah is Rich, Owner of all praise.} (14:8). It is recorded in Sahih Muslim: PPyUj 'ppsyj jJSjf \$ & * G :juc Jj> ypj of \$&irf u . pi j, Ju> so u jjs p: JS c && ji iUi> U -p.pjp p \Spro 'ppo

326 Tafisir Ibn Kathir Cj** UJJ ^jII J< ^ ^! dr*^ 'f* x>-j j j ". , may He be exalted, says: O My servants, if the first of you and the last of you, mankind and Jinn alike, were all to be as pious as the most pious among you, that would not add to My dominion in the slightest. O My servants, if the first of you and

the last of you, mankind and Jinn alike, were all to be as evil as the most evil one among you, that would not detract from My dominion in the slightest. O My servants, these are deeds which I am recording for you, and I will judge you according to them, so whoever finds something good, let him praise Allah, and whoever finds otherwise, let him blame no one but himself." "m Ufcj Ji a .vfoi^r V v OjSo A XSJ& Ja l > U l JSy ji' UJLy Ji %fi /OK^ cJU idijp W u Si " ZX Qi - ' , *?S\> " **\Ar :r >*n. t. - ' vvt> **i O- * . ki I ij 4^c' He said: Disguise her throne for her that we may see whether she will be guided, or she will be one of those not guided."} 442. So when she came, it was said, Is your throne like this?" She said: "As though it were the very same." And he said, "Knowledge was bestowed on us before her, and we had submitted to Allah (as Muslims)." } 443. And Saddaha that which she used to worship besides Allah has prevented her (from Islam), for site was of a disbelieving people.} 444. It was said to her: "Enter As-Sarh," but when she saw it, she thought it was a pool, and she (tucked up her clothes) uncovering her legs. Sulayman said: "Verily, it is a Sarh Mumarrad of Qawartr. She said: "My Lord! Verily, I have Muslim 4 :1994.

wronged myself, and I submit, together with Sulayman to Allah, the Lord of all that exists." } The Test of Bilqis When Sulayman brought the throne of Bilqis before she and her people arrived, he issued orders that some of its features should be altered, so that he could test her and see whether she recognized it and how composed she would be when she saw it. Would she hasten to say either that it was her throne or that it was not? So he said: v juK oj 4^ s' (1 i iDisguise her throne for her that we may see whether she will be guided, or she will be one of those not guided.) Ibn Abbas said: Remove some of its adornments and parts. * Mujahid said: He issued orders that it should be changed, so whatever was red should be made yellow and vice versa, and whatever was green should be made red, so everything was altered. Ikrimah said, They added some things and took some things away. Qatadah said, It was turned upside down and back to front, and some things were added and some things were taken away. jj o't & } iSo when she came, it was said: "Is your throne like this?" } Her throne, which had been altered and disguised, with some things added and others taken away, was shown to her. She was wise and steadfast, intelligent and strong-willed. She did not hasten to say that this was her throne, because it was far away from her. Neither did she hasten to say that it was not her throne, when she saw that some things had been altered and changed. She said. i(It is) as though it were the very same.} This is the ultimate in intelligence and strong resolve. At-Tabari 19:469. At-Tabari 19:469.

oi _ "U" iKnowledge was bestowed on us before her, and we had submitted to Allah.} Mujahid said, This was spoken by Sulayman. /j* jl <>; 4And Saddaha that which she used to worship besides Allah has prevented her, for she was of a disbelieving people.} This is a continuation of the words of Sulayman according to the opinion of Mujahid and Said bin Jubayr, may Allah be pleased with them both - i.e., Sulayman said: y. iKnowledge was bestowed on us before her, and we had submitted to Allah .} and what stopped her from worshipping Allah alone was jO* Oi "*" i?, ithat which she used to worship besides Allah, for she was of a disbelieving people.} What Mujahid and Said said is good) it was also the view of Ibn Jarir.121 Then Ibn Jarir said, It could be that the subject of the verb. iAnd Saddaha refers to Sulayman or to Allah, so that the phrase now means: Jt iShe would not worship anything over than Allah.} fi o*& %l} ifor she was of a disbelieving people.} I say: the opinion of Mujahid is supported by the fact that she declared her Islam after she entered the Sarh, as we shall see below. Af-Tabari 19:471 Af-Tabari 19 :472

Uii ji-j' U 4/f was said to her: Enter As-Sarh but when she saw it, she thought it was a pool, and she (tucked up her clothes) uncovering her legs .) Sulayman had commanded the Shayatin to build for her a huge palace of glass beneath which water was flowing. Anyone who did not know the nature of the building would think that it was water, but in fact there was a layer of glass between a person walking and the water. Verily, it is a SarhMumarrad ofQawdrxr Sarh means a palace or any lofty construction. Allah says of Fir'awn - may Allah curse him - that he said to his minister Haman: iC J\$) iBuild me a Sarh that I may arrive at the ways.) (40:36-37) Syr is also used to refer to the high constructed palaces in Yemen. Mumarrad means sturdily constructed and smooth. itS iof Qawarir) means, made of glass, i.e., it was built with smooth surfaces. Marid is a fortress in Dawmat Al-Jandal.

What is meant here is that Sulayman built a huge, lofty palace

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 4195]

of glass for this queen, in order to show her the greatness of his authority and power. When she saw for herself what Allah had given him and how majestic his position was, she submitted to

the command of Allah and acknowledged that he was a noble

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4195–4197]

Prophet, so she submitted to Allah and said: iv> 4My Lord! Verily, I have wronged myself,) meaning, by her previous disbelief and Shirk and by the fact that she and her people had worshipped the sun instead of Allah. 4U&' llllj) 4and I submit, together with Sulayman to Allah, the Lord of all that exists.)

{Then look! They became two parties quarreling with each other.} Mujahid said, These were believers and disbelievers. 1 11 This is like the Ayah, & ^ Si; S-i CiyJ C/J' Jli 4@^i/ ** Xu'^ tfji di iThe leaders of those who were arrogant among his people said to those who were counted weak - to such of them as believed Know you that Salih is one sent from his Lord." They said: "We indeed believe in that with which he has been sent." Those who were arrogant said: "Verily, we disbelieve in that which you believe in."} (7:75-76) - .*.U JJi j - >*- J 4He said: "O my people! Why do you seek to hasten the evil before the good?"} meaning, why are you praying for the punishment to come, and not asking Allah for His mercy? Then he said: 4"Why seek you not the forgiveness of Allah, that you may receive mercy? They said: "We augur an omen from you and those with you."} This means: We do not see any good in your face and the faces of those who are following you. Since they were doomed, whenever anything bad happened to any of them they would say, This is because of Salih and his companions. Mujahid said, They regarded them as bad omens. 121 This is similar to

what Allah said about the people of Fir'awn:

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4197–4216]

C / s o*J ilLi Jfy .;xi Q \) _i#C.Tabari 19:475. 121 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :369

iBut whenever good came to them, they said: Ours is this. And if evil afflicted them, they saw it as an omen about Musa and those with him (7:131). And Allah says: J* Cit (Hr j f-9 bt -if ^ i; 4And i/ some

good reaches them, they say, This is from Allah," but if some evil befalls them, they say, This is from you." Say: All things are from Allah."} (4:78) i.e., by virtue of His will and decree. And Allah tells us about the dwellers of the town, when the Messengers came to them: m t s J4 q \$t} iThey (people) said: For us, we see an omen from you; if you cease not, we will surely stone you, and a painful torment will touch you from us." They (Messengers) said: Your omens are with yourselves!} (36:18) And these people [Thamud] said: JLe jti liLJ i 'We augur an omen from you and those with you." He said: Your omen is of Allah;} meaning, Allah will punish you for that. JL* *% rv inay, but you are a people that are being tested.} Qatadah said: You are being tested to see whether you will obey or disobey. The apparent meaning of the phrase iare being tested is: you will be left to get carried away in your state of misguidance. m Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :369

t yU 4 < yi-i Ju"j L"Li j-.ulM % &&& C4* a^S 2 ^ Lit j"-* - i-ii == " J-LiL ^ i==au i-tf "il j ^ tj-jji Lj iijjL- ^UL* X j r {4*jj f&s 4i 2'^^i "y^== -> *.& L-Ltflj I^OjilLo ^i) 448. And there were in the city nine Rahtin, who made mischief in the land, and would not reform. 449. They said: Swear one to another by Allah that we shall make a secret night attack on him and his household, and thereafter we will surely say to his near relatives: 'We witnessed not the destruction of his household, and verily, we are telling the truth.'" 450. So, they plotted a plot, and We planned a plan, while they perceived not.} 451. Then see how was the end of their plot! Verily, We destroyed them and their nation all together.} 452. These are their houses in utter ruin, for they did wrong. Verily, in this is indeed an Ayah for people who know.} 453. And We saved those who believed, and had Taqwa of Allah.} The Plot of the Mischief-Makers and the End of the People of Thamud Allah tells us about the evildoers of Thamud and their leaders who used to call their people to misguidance and disbelief, and to deny Salih. Eventually they killed the she-camel and were about to kill Salih too. They plotted to let him sleep with his family at night, then they would assassinate him and tell his relatives that they knew nothing about what happened to him, and that they were telling the truth because none of them had seen anything. Allah says: 4 .P" 4 4And there were in the city} meaning, in the city of ThamQd, 4-kiJ il^}

334 Tafstr Ibn Kathtr 4nine Raht,4 meaning, nine people, iwho made mischief in the land, and would not reform. They forced their opinions on the people of Thamud, because they were the leaders and chiefs. Al- Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said: These were the people who killed the she- camel, [11 Meaning, that happened upon their instigation, may Allah curse them. Allah says: c>&pZ 63S> iBut they called their comrade and he took (a sword) and killed (the she-camel).} (54:29) iWhen the most wicked man among them went forth (to kill the she-camel). (91:12) Abdur-Razzaq said that Yahya bin Rabl ah As-San ani told them, I heard Ata - i.e. Ibn Abi Rabah - say: 4And there were in the city nine Raht, who made mischief in the land, and would not reform. They used to break silver coins. They would break off pieces from them, as if they used to trade with them in terms of numbers [as opposed to weight], as the Arabs used to do. Imam Malik narrated from Yahya bin Said that Said bin Al- Musayyib said: Cutting gold and silver (coins) is part of spreading corruption on earth. What is meant is that the nature of these evil disbelievers was to spread corruption on earth by every means possible, one of which was that mentioned by these Imams. 4p\j iThey said: "Swear one to another by Allah that we shall make a secret night attack on him and his household . m At-Tabari 19:477. Abdur-Razzaq 3 :83

An-Naml (48 - 53) (Part-19) They took a mutual oath, pledging that during the night, whoever met the Allah's Prophet Salih, peace be upon him, he would assassinate him. But Allah planned against them and caused their plot to backfire. Mujahid said, They took a mutual oath pledging to kill him, but before they could reach him, they and their people were still destroyed. Abdur-Rahman bin Abi Hatim¹²¹ said: When they killed the she-camel, Salih said to them: *jjS lej iidl \yClj* 4 Enjoy yourselves in your homes for three days. *Tftis* is a promise (i.e., a threat) that will not be belied." (11:65). They said: Salih claims that he will finish with us in three days, but we will finish him and his family before the three days are over. Salih had a place of worship in a rocky tract in a valley, where he used to pray. So they set out to go to a cave there one night, and said, When he comes to pray, we will kill him, then we will return. When we have finished him off, we will go to his family and finish them off too. Then Allah sent down a rock upon them from the mountains round about; they feared that it would crush them, so they ran into the cave and the rock covered the mouth of the cave while they were inside. Their people did not know where they were or what had happened to them. So Allah punished some of them here, and some of them there, and He saved Salih and the people who were with him. Then he recited: *jjj 4 f-tr J?*. ^ (*igPoi l-1'* 4So, they plotted a plot, and We planned a plan, while they perceived not. Then see how was the end of their plot! Verily, We destroyed them and their nation, all together. These are their houses in utter ruin,} i.e., deserted. Tabari 19:478. ¹²¹ That is Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd . This narration is recorded by Ibn Abi H&tim no. 16485, and At-Tabari no. 27054.

upon him, and how he warned his people of Allah's punishment for committing an act of immorality which no human ever committed before them - intercourse with males instead of females. This is a major sin, whereby men are satisfied with men and women are with women (i.e. homosexuality). Lut said: 4Do you commit immoral sins iwhile you see?} meaning, while you see one another, and you practice every kind of evil in your meetings. *pf & fe)" *&X#^ pfr i*Do you practice your lusts on men instead of women? Nay, but you are a people who behave senselessly.} means, you do not know anything of what is natural or what is prescribed by Allah. This is like the Ayah: *P P 3? u& ^*Go you in unto the males of mankind, and leave those whom Allah has created far you to be your wives? Nay, you are a trespassing people!} (26:165-166) iThere was no other answer given by his people except that they said: "Drive out the family of Lut from your city. Verily, these are men who want to be clean and pure!"} means, they feel embarrassed because of the deeds you are doing, and because you approve of your actions, so expel them from among yourselves, for they are not fit to live among you in your city. So, the people resolved to do that, and Allah destroyed them, and a similar end awaits the disbelievers. Allah says: 4So, We saved him and his family, except his wife. We

^Praise and thanks be to Allah,} meaning, for His innumerable blessings upon His servants and for His exalted Attributes and most beautiful Names. And He commands him to send peace upon the servants of Allah whom He chose and selected, i.e., His noble Messengers and Prophets, may the best of peace and blessings from Allah be upon them. This was the view of Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam and others; the meaning of the servants He has chose is the Prophets. He said, This like He said in the Ayah; *C,j & & {*Glorified be your Lord, the Lor\$ of honor and power! (He is free) from what they attribute unto Him! And peace be on the Messengers! And all the praises and thanks be to Allah, Lord of all that exists.} (37:180-182). Ath-Thawri and As-Suddi said, This refers to the Companions of Muhammad may Allah be pleased with them all. Something similar was also narrated from Ibn Abbas, and there is

no contradiction between the two views, because they were also among the servants of Allah whom He had chosen, although the description is more befitting of the Prophets. Is Allah better, or what they ascribe as partners (to Him)? This is a question aimed at denouncing the idolators for their worship of other gods besides Allah. Some more Proofs of Tawhld Then Allah begins to explain that He is the Only One Who creates, provides and controls, as He says: {Is not He Who created the heavens} meaning. He created those heavens which are so high and serene, with their shining stars and revolving planets. And He created the earth, with its varying heights and densities, and He created everything in it, mountains, hills, plains, rugged terrain, wildernesses, crops, trees, fruits, seas and animals of

4\$- i Nay, but they are a people who ascribe equals (to Him)!} meaning, they describe others as being equal and comparable to Allah. J"- City jj ^ aJJ \yX~ 461 . Is not He Who has made the earth as a fixed abode, and has placed rivers in its midst, and has placed firm mountains therein, and has set a barrier between the two seas (of salt and sweet water)? Is there any ilah (god) with Allah? Nay, but most of them know not!} Allah says: o&t j^ - } 4Is not He Who has made the earth as a fixed abode,} meaning, stable and stationary, so that it does not move or convulse, because if it were to do so, it would not be a good place for people to live on. But by His grace and mercy. He has made it smooth and calm, and it is not shaken or moved. This is like the Ayah, iAlldh, Who has made for you the earth as a dwelling place and the sky as a canopy} (40:64). 4and has placed rivers in its midst,} means, He has placed rivers which are fresh and sweet, cutting through the earth, and He has made them of different types, large rivers, small rivers and some in between. He has caused them to flow in all directions, east, west, south, north, according to the needs of mankind in different areas and regions, as He has created them throughout the world and sends them their provision according to their needs. iand has placed firm mountains therein,}

342 Tafslr Ibn Kathir means, high mountains which stabilize the earth and make it steadfast, so that it does not shake. iand has set a barrier between the two seas} means, He has placed a barrier between the fresh water and the salt water, to prevent them from mixing lest they corrupt one another. Divine wisdom dictates that each of them should stay as it is meant to be. The sweet water is that which flows in rivers among mankind, and it is meant to be fresh and palatable so that it may be used to water animals and plants and fruits. The salt water is that which surrounds the continents on all sides, and its water is meant to be salty and undrinkable lest the air be corrupted by its smell, as Allah says: \$ & > 4And it is He Who has let free the two seas, this is palatable and sweet, and that is salty and bitter; and He has set a barrier and a complete partition between them.} (25:53) Allah says: 4\$ & } 41\$ there any god with Allah?} meaning, any god who could do this, or who deserves to be worshipped? Both meanings are indicated by the context. tips 1pu & } 4Nay, but most of them know not!} means, in that they worship others than Allah. P g ZJj JcSp \ j iitf dJ p } 462. Is not He Who responds to the distressed one, when he calls on Him, and Who removes the evil, and makes you inheritors of the earth, generations after generations? Is there any god with Allah? Little is that you remember!} Allah points out that He is the One upon Whom people call in times of difficulty, and He is the One to Whom they turn when

An-Naml (62) (Part-20) calamity strikes, as He says elsewhere $\text{V}_i, \text{v L. ti}^\wedge$ And when harm touches you upon the sea, those that you call upon vanish from you except Him[^] (17:67), iThen, when harm touches you, unto Him you cry aloud for help (16:53). Similarly, Allah says here: iiz SUX 4.4} ils not He Who responds to the distressed one, when he calls on Him,} meaning. Who is the only One to Whom the person in desperate need turns, and the only One Who can relieve those who are stricken by harm? Imam Ahmad reported that a man of Balhajlm said: O Messenger of Allah, what are you calling for? He said: o,i,Ui jl ^jjlj nillp kJCS tijeJi ~jJ> villi jj IjJ~j &\ *ll) vLwl 3* .IliLxt jl jA * ' ' ' ' 0 0 "/ am calling people to Allah Alone, the One Who, if you call on Him when harm befalls you, will relieve you; and when you are lost in the wilderness, you call on Him and He brings you back: and when drought (famine) strikes, you call on Him and He makes your crops grow. He said: Advise me. He \$g| said:)1 Ljll C-j\j iitif jt jij yji OXAJi 'Ij 'l/ 8 4 JI^JI 4[jj jUJ ^ ji fij Ajipr} n an jp iL j, /y{\ jpi j^ jO'ji Jpp Istfp " ujl iiDo not slander anyone and do not think of any good deed as insignificant, even if it is only meeting your brother with a cheerful face or emptying your vessel into the vessel of one who is asking for water. Wear your lower garment at mid-calf

344 TafsirRm Kathir length, or - ifyou insist - let it reach your ankles, and beware of lowering the garment below the ankles along the ground,111 for it is aform ofshowing-off, and Allah does not like showing- off. b'21 The Story ofaMujahidwho fought forthe sake ofAllah In his biography of Fatimah bint Al-Hasan Umm Ahmad Al- Ajaliyyah, Al-Hafiz bin Asakir reported that she said: One day the disbelievers defeated the Muslims in a battle. There was a good horse which belonged to a rich man who was also righteous. The horse just stood there, so its owner said, What is the matter with you? Woe to you! I was only preparing you for a day such as this. The horse said to him: *How can you expect me not to perform badly, when you delegated my feeding to the grooms, and they mistreated me and only fed me a little? The man said, 1 make you a promise before Allah that from this day on, only I will feed you from my own lap. So the horse began to run, and his owner was saved, and after that he only ever fed the horse from his own lap. This story became well known among the people, and they started to come to him to hear the story from his own lips. News of this reached the king of Byzantium, and he said: A city where this man is, will be kept safe from harm. He wanted to bring the man to his own city, so he sent an apostate (a man who had left Islam) who was living in his city to go to him, and when he reached him, he pretended that his intentions towards Islam and its followers were good, so the Mujahid trusted him. One day they went out walking along the shore, but the apostate made a pact with another person, a follower of the Byzantine king, to come and help him take the Mujahid prisoner. When they made their move, he lifted his gaze to the sky and said, O Allah! He has deceived me by swearing in Your Name, so protect me in whatever way You will. Then two wild animals came out and seized them, and the Mujahid came back safe and sound. ' To let one s lower garment trail along the ground. Ahmad 5 :64. This narration is not authentic. Most parts ofthe text are found in other authentic Hadiths. ' TOrtkh Dimashq 19 :489 MS

The Inheritance ofthe Earth iand makes you inheritors of the earth,\$ means, each generation inherits from the generation that came before them, one after the other, as Allah says: fy oi 4U2I t3T itS u b He a)i7/s. He am destroy you, and in your place make whom He wills as your swccessors, as He raised you from the seed ofother people (6:133), jy" jijj " ijfe i j|{ iAnd it is He Who has made you generations coming after generations, replacing each other on the earth. And He has raised you in ranks, some

above others (6:165), j*H\ 4 jeC - i) -TSjjJ J6 ilj> iAnd (remember) when your Lord said to the angels: "Verily, I am going to place generations after generations on earth." (2:30) meaning, people who will come after one another, as we have already stated. Allah's saying: iand makes you inheritors of the earth,} means, nation after nation, generation after generation, people after people. If He had willed, He could have created them all at one time, and not made some of them the offspring of others. If He had willed. He could have created them all together, as He created Adam from dust. If He had willed. He could have made some of them the offspring of others, but not caused any of them to die until they all died at one time; in this case the earth would have become constricted for them and it would be too difficult for them to live and earn a living, and they would have caused inconvenience and harm to one

An-Naml (63 - 64) (Part-20 P ^ rAr And landmarks and by the stars, they guide ^ J ; ' 5- . . - V/; i'f\$ i -*' ": i-1 J^^OI 1 3 , , "V-Jjj C^J)Jrl^vi' i^&QOjhdLSj ^-viaoi^y&ot (jM^il! 'a-ajc-ooii-a-^ss) "<_ ; a 't|IGy- J "J>, //i^r - ' " OJ. M" cj 4"/fJf is He lA4io has set the stars for you, so that you may guide your course with their help through the darkness of the land and the sea...} (6:97) 3 ^ b j 4 '*<" * /" tJfJj iand Who sends the winds as heralds of glad tidings, going before His mercy?} meaning, ahead of the clouds which bring rain, by means of which Allah shows His mercy to His servants who are suffering drought and despair. 4f =*fii '& iSS jjJ ' 4J.ty ils there any god with Allah? Exalted be Allah above all that they associate as partners!} pZ &s ji w M&* " i3 ** ;jui " 5ai ijr (xv ^ * & 4 Wga 464. Is not He Who originates creation, and shall thereafter repeat it, and Who provides for you from heaven and earth? Is there any god with Allah? Say: "Bring forth your proofs, if you are truthful."} He is the One Who, by His might and power, originates

4Say "Bring forth your proofs, if you are truthful."} Produce the evidence of that. But it is known that they have no proof or evidence, as Allah says: cU * & ** te tf 0% * & g 4And whoever invokes besides Allah, any other god, of whom he has no proof; then his reckoning is only with his Lord. Surely, the disbelievers will not be successful.} (23:117) (** * j4 4 . Say: None in the heavens and the earth knows the Unseen except Allah, nor can they perceive when they shall be resurrected. } 466. Nay, their knowledge will perceive that in the Hereafter. Nay, they are in doubt about it. Nay, they are in complete blindness about it.} The OneWho knows the Unseen is Allah Allah commands His Messenger ig to inform all of creation that no one among the dwellers of heaven and earth knows the Unseen, except Allah. i'Ji 4except Allah This is an absolute exception, meaning that no one knows this besides Allah, He is alone in that regard, having no partner in that knowledge. This is like the Ayat 4% 4And with Him are the keys of the Unseen, none knows them but He} (6:59). 4Z3\ Jffc jaaf 2f l[] 4Verily, Allah, with Him is the knowledge of the Hour, He sends down the rain} (31:34). until the end of the Surah. And there are many Ayat which mention similar things.

\$ Cf} inor can they perceive when they shall be resurrected.} That is, the created beings who dwell in the heavens and on earth do not know when the Hour will occur, as Allah says: iHeavy is its burden through the heavens and the earth. It shall not come upon you except all of a sudden (7:187). meaning, it is a grave matter for the dwellers of heaven and earth. 4& iNay, their knowledge will perceive that in the Hereafter. Nay, they are in doubt about it.} means their knowledge and amazement stops short of knowing its time. Other scholars read this with the meaning their knowledge is all the same with regard to that, which reflects

the meaning of the Hadith in Sahih Muslim which states that

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4216–4217]

the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said to Jibril, when the latter asked him when the Hour would come: $\text{ijnu} \text{ } \text{ja} \text{ } \text{'}$ u " iThe one who is being asked about it does not know any more than the one who is asking. n In other words, they were both equal in the fact that their knowledge did not extend that far. 4 iNay, they are in doubt about it.} This refers to the disbelievers in general as Allah says elsewhere: 3 S4 J^ j; \$ US' 52 4; \^} iAnd they will be set before your Lord in rows, (and Allah will say:) Now indeed, you have come to Us as We created you the first time. Nay, but you thought that We had appointed no m Muslim 1 :36.

An-Naml (67 - 70) (Part-20 meeting for you (with Us).") (18:48) i.e., the disbelievers among you. By the same token, Allah says here: iNay, they are in doubt about it.} meaning, they doubt that it will come to pass. , " iNay, they are in complete blindness about it.} They are blind and completely ignorant about it. js i 4wz &4& Jfjii j lt J* V) Ui j; 4 -v (*+^ ii/J* Vj 467. And those who disbelieve say: "When we have become dust - we and our fathers - shall we really be brought forth?"} 168. "Indeed we were promised this - we and our forefathers before, verily, these are nothing but tales of ancients."} 169. Say to them: "Travel in the land and see how has been

the end of the criminals."}

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4217–4240]

170. And grieve you not over them, nor be straitened (in distress) because of what they plot.} Scepticism about the Resurrection and Its Refutation Allah tells us about the idolators who deny the Resurrection, considering it extremely unlikely that bodies will be re-created after they have become bones and dust. Then He says: 4Jr* tj&y yi- UC" IjJej Xd} indeed we were promised this - we and our forefathers before,} meaning, *we and our forefathers have been hearing this for a long time, but in reality, we have never seen it happen. iup % Qi& verily, these are nothing but tales of ancients.} the promises that bodies will be restored are

i'4p 4nothing but tales of ancients.} meaning that they were taken by the people who came before us from books which were handed down from one to the other, but they have no basis in reality. Responding to their thoughts of disbelief and their belief that there would be no Resurrection, Allah said, 43Sm/^ O Muhammad, to these people, iTravel in the land and see how has been the end of the criminals.} meaning, those who denied the Messengers and their message of the Resurrection and other matters. See how the punishment and vengeance of Allah struck them and how Allah saved from among them the noble Messengers and the believers who followed them. This will be an indication of the truth of the Message brought by the Messengers. Then, to comfort the Prophet ﷺ , Allah says: l-Z%} 4And grieve you not over them,} meaning, but do not feel sorry for them or kill yourself with regret for them, 4nor be straitened because of what they plot.} means, because they plot against you and reject what you have brought, for Allah will help and support you, and cause your religion to prevail over those who oppose you and stubbornly resist you in the east and in the west. 471. And they say: "When this promise, if you are truthful? } 472. Say: "Perhaps that which you wish to hasten on, may be

close behind you.") 473. Verily, your Lord is full of grace for mankind, yet most of them do not give thanks. 474. And verily, your Lord knows what their breasts conceal and what they reveal.} 475. And there is nothing hidden in the heaven and the earth but it is in a Clear Book.} Allah tells us about how the idolaters asked about the Day of Resurrection, but thought it unlikely that it would ever come to pass. / c s . / V // // / > \ * - V,- ifl-i O) '-C* JJyjj} iAnd they say "When (will) this promise (be fulfilled), if you are truthful?"} Allah said, responding to them: 43ft 4Say} O Muhammad, Jjj bfoi J 4Perhaps that which you wish to hasten on, may be close behind you.} Ibn Abbas said, That which you wish to hasten on has come close to you, or some of it has come close. 111 This was also the view of Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak, Ata Al-Khurasani, Qatadah and As-Suddi. 121 This is also what is meant in the Ayat && ol^ ji % 4And they say: When will that be?" Say: "Perhaps it is near!"} (17:51) 4They ask you to hasten on the torment. And verily, Hell, of a surety, will encompass the disbelievers} (29:54). ip J At-Jabari 19:492. At-Tabari 19 :492 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :375

An-Naml (76 - 81) (Part-20) J XM \$oip'i^T uj 1 Laj * ' -V-I-'ilj^ -j oU ^ W>-^j4r^djii'^Sj (j^L-iu jla! Liel^). (3^iIsjj*^ :A^= IS j3'&P lixdt ; ^_43_j^J 'j^cij^)_^ ^ii!^u ^ the heaven and the earth but it is in a Clear Book.} This is like the Ayah, 4 p ait ru i"> 4 oi JfeSf ail < 4-i 51, iKnow you not that Allah knows all that is in the heaven and on the earth? Verily, it is (all) in the Book. Verily, that is easy for Allah.} (22:70) J*k itfyfi & a-i ji" jM _A^=>! diCr'l fa "a" /< , Tf7^ - >/" ' ^y o| vv.u^f >\$>!' J*" ** "*" (4^ i" <> j& iSA^). Ca^ ty ^ 'jb "iejjj ^ } f ^ ^ ^ V viCJ <>") jc pi* Se*j (>* '!) oj JLg&S jt yilil' 476. Verily, this Qur'an narrates to the Children of Israel most of that in which they differ.} 477. And truly, it is a guide and a mercy for the believers.} } 78. Verily, your Lord will decide between them by His judgement. And He is the All-Mighty, the All-Knowing.} 479. So, put your trust in Allah; surely, you are on manifest truth.} 480. Verily, you cannot make the dead to hear nor can you make the deaf to hear the call, when they flee, turning their

backs. 481 . Nor can you lead the blind out of their error. You can only make to hear those who believe in Our Ayat, so they submit (became Muslims).} The Qur'an tells the Story of the Differences among the Children of Israel, and Allah judges between them Allah tells us about His Book and the guidance, proof and criterion between right and wrong that it contains. He tells us about the Children of Israel, who were the bearers of the Tawrah and Injil. 4most of that in which they differ.} such as their different opinions about Isa. The Jews lied about him while the Christians exaggerated in praise for him, so the Qur'an came with the moderate word of truth and justice: that he was one of the servants of Allah, and one of His noble Prophets and Messengers, may the best of peace and blessings be upon him, as the Qur'an says: '(-j* J-' u-k 4Such is Isa, son of Maryam. (It is) a statement of truth, about which they doubt} (19:34). tS-jj 'A fy} 4And truly, it is a guide and a mercy for the believers.} meaning, it is guidance for the hearts of those who believe in it, and a mercy to them. Then Allah says: isik iVerily, your Lord will decide between them} meaning, on the Day of Resurrection, jij 4by His judgement. And He is the All-Mighty,} means, in His vengeance,

the All-Knowing.} Who knows all that His servants do and say. The Command to put One's Trust in Allah and to convey the Message iSo, put your trust in Allah;} in all your affairs, and convey the Message of your Lord. 4\$ &\} isurely, you are on manifest truth.} meaning, you are following manifest truth, even though you are opposed by those who oppose you because they are doomed. The Word of

your Lord has been justified against them, so that they will not believe even if all the signs are brought to them. Allah says: 44P V iVerily, you cannot make the dead to hear} meaning, you cannot cause them to hear anything that will benefit them. The same applies to those over whose hearts is a veil and in whose ears is deafness of disbelief. Allah says: **! > .1 x / t:y ItfZ \js ty sit p>y -ij} p-f S. or inor can you make the deaf to hear the call, when they flee, turning their backs. Nor can you lead the blind out of their error. You can only make to hear those who believe in Our Ayat, so they submit (became Muslims).} meaning, those who have hearing and insight will respond to you, those whose hearing and sight are of benefit to their hearts and who are humble towards Allah and to the Message that comes to them through the mouths of the Messengers, may peace be upon them. *m ix u 4x2 s Xu p y^ > . > 482. And when the Word is fulfilled against them, We shall bring out from the earth a beast for them, to speak to them because mankind believed not with certainty in OurAyat.}

Hasan Sahth. ' ' It was also recorded by

will make the face of the believer bright with the staff, until when people gather far a meal, they will say to one another, O believer, orO disbeliever It was also recorded by Ibn MajahJ Ibn Jurayj reported that Ibn Az-Zubayr described the beast and said, Its head is like the head of a bull, its eyes are like the eyes of a pig, its ears are like the ears of an elephant, its horns are like the horns of a stag, its neck is like the neck of an ostrich, its chest is like the chest of a lion, its color is like the colour of a tiger, its haunches are like the haunches of a cat, its tail is like the tail of a ram, and its legs are like the legs of a camel. Between each pair of its joints is a distance of twelve cubits. It will bring out with it the staff of Musa and the ring of Sulayman. There will be no believer left without it making a white spot on his face, which will spread until all his face is shining white as a result; and there will be no disbeliever left without it making a black spot on his face, which will spread until all his face is black as a result, then when the people trade with one another in the marketplace, they will say, How much is this, O believer? How much is this, O disbeliever? And when the members of one household sit down together to eat, they will know who is a believer and who is a disbeliever. Then the beast will say: O so-and-so, enjoy yourself, for you are among the people of Paradise. And it will say: O so-and-so, you are among the people of Hell, This is what Allah says: V \jlt p ^ g 0 f S > . y 4And when the Word is fulfilled against them, We shall bring out from the earth a beast for them, to speak to than because mankind believed not with certainty in Our Ayat.^ [3] Jt* jX*. IjJ yr** & ^-4-* ^ (***. 1,1 Ahmad 2:295. 121 Ibn Majah 2:1351. ,31 AlBaghwi 3:429.

4 dji 1 -^b aJ jjf Lilil Q _jii ^ jl * y ;; 4&3. And (remember) the Day when We shall gather out of every nation a Fawj of those who denied Our Ayat, and they shall be driven,} 484. Till, when they come. He will say: Did you deny My Ayat whereas you comprehended them not by knowledge, or what was it that you used to do?""} 485. And the Word will be fulfilled against them, because they have done wrong, and they will be unable to speak.} 486. See they not that We have made the nightfor them to rest therein, and the day sight-giving? Verily, in this are Ayat for the people who believe.} Gathering the Wrongdoers on the Day ofResurrection Allah tells us about the Day of Resurrection when the wrongdoers who disbelieved in the signs and Messengers of Allah will be gathered before Allah, so that He will ask them about what they did in this world, rebuking, scolding and belittling them. pi ' }} 4And the Day when We shall gather out of every nation, a Fawj} means, from every people and generation a

group of those who denied Our Ayat}. This is like the Ayat "Assemble those who did wrong, together with their companions (from the devils)." (37:22) And when the souls are joined with their bodies (81:7). And

and they shall be driven, Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said: They will be pushed. 11 Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said: They will be driven. 12 Till, when they come, and stand before Allah, may He glorified and exalted, in the place of reckoning, He will say: "Did you deny My Ayat whereas you comprehended them not by knowledge, or what was it that you used to do?" meaning they will be asked about their beliefs and their deeds. Since they are among the doomed and, as Allah says: He neither believed nor performed Salah! But on the contrary, he denied and turned away! (75:31-32) Then the proof will be established against them and they will have no excuse whatsoever, as Allah says: That will be a Day when they shall not speak. And they will not be permitted to put forth any excuse (77:35-36). Similarly, Allah says here: And the Word will be fulfilled against them, because they have done wrong, and they will be unable to speak. They will be stunned and speechless, unable to give any answer. This is because they wronged themselves in the world, and now they have returned to the One Who sees the unseen and the seen, from Whom nothing can be hidden. Then Allah points out His complete power, immense authority and greatness, all dictating that He is to be obeyed Tabari 19:501. Tabari 19:438.

and that His commands must be followed, and that the message of inescapable truth brought by His Prophets must be believed in. Allah says: We have made the night for them to rest therein, Due to the darkness of the night they halt their activities and calm themselves down, to recover from the exhausting efforts of the day. And the day sight- meaning filled with light, so that they can work and earn a living, and travel and engage in business, and do other things that they need to do. Verily, in this are Ayat for the people who believe.) And the Day on which the Trumpet (Sur) will

An-Naml (87 - 90) (Part-20) be blown - and all who are in the heavens and all who are on the earth, will be terrified except him whom Allah wills. And all shall come to Him, humbled. 488. And you will see the mountains and think them solid, but they shall pass away as the passing away of the clouds. The work of Allah, Who perfected all things, verily, He is well-acquainted with what you do. 489. Whoever brings a good deed, will have better than its worth; and they will be safe from the terror on that Day. 490. And whoever brings an evil deed, they will be cast down on their faces in the Fire. (And it will be said to them) "Are you being recompensed anything except what you used to do?" The Terrors of the Day of Resurrection, the Rewards for Good Deeds and the Punishments for Evil Deeds Allah tells us about the terrors of the Day when the Sur will be blown. The Sur, as described in the Hadith, is, (the angel) Israfil who will blow into it by the command of Allah, may He be exalted. He will blow into it for the first time, for a long time. This will signal the end of the life of this world, and the Hour will come upon the most evil of people ever to live. Everyone who is in the heavens and on earth will be terrified, except him whom Allah wills. these are the martyrs, for they are alive, with their Lord, and being provided for. Imam

nimble as birds and will be more temperamental than wild beasts. They will not recognize anything good or denounce anything evil. The Shaytan will appear to them and will say, Will you do as I tell you?" They will say, What do you command us to do?" He will command them to worship idols but in spite of this their provision will be plentiful and they will lead comfortable lives. Then the Sur (Trumpet) will be blown, and no one will hear it but he will tilt his head to hear the sound. The first person to hear it will be a man who is setting up the tank for watering his camels. He will fall down, and all the other people will also fall down. Then Allah will send - or send down - rain like dew - or he said, like shade (Nu'mdn was the one who was not sure) - from which will grow the bodies of the people. Then the Trumpet will be blown again, and they will get up and look around. Then it will be said: "O mankind! Go to your Lord!" And they will be stopped, for they are to be questioned. Then it will be said: Bring forth the people who are to be sent to the Fire." It will be asked: "How many are they?" It will be said, Out of every thousand, nine hundred and ninety-nine." That will be the Day which will make the children grey-headed, and that will be the Day when the Shin shall be uncovered.* His saying; bJ j bJ ^| - ^ Then the Sur (Trumpet) will be blown, and no one will hear it but he will tilt his head to hear the sound. means that they will tilt their heads so that they can better hear the sound coming from the heavens. That is the blast of the Sur which will terrify everyone, then after that will come the blast which will cause them to die, then the blast which will resurrect them to meet the Lord of the worlds - this is when all of the creation will be brought forth from their graves. Allah says: yd iAnd all shall come to Him, humbled. meaning, humbling 4:2258.

themselves and obeying Him, and no one will go against His command. This is like the Ayat. iOn the Day when He will call you, and you will answer with His praise and obedience> (17:52). a Mlj) dfjJl ^ ijtJ Ij) f) iThen afterwards when He will call you by a single call, behold, you will come out from the earth) (30:25). According to the Hadith about the Stir, when it is blown for the third time, Allah will command the souls to be put into the hole of the Sur (Trumpet), then Israfil will blow into it, after the bodies have grown in their graves and resting places, and when he blows into the Sur (Trumpet), the souls will fly, the believers souls glowing with light, and the disbelievers souls looking like darkness. And Allah will say: By My might and majesty, every soul will go back to its body. And the souls will come back to their bodies and go through them like poison going through a person who is bitten or stung by a poisonous creature. Then they will get up, brushing off the dirt of their graves. Allah says: J] &r} * ... \ iThe Day when they will come out of the graves quickly as racing to a goal.) (70:43) tyUdi s jell dljj))And you will see the mountains and think them solid, but they shall pass away as the passing away of the clouds.) (27:88) meaning, you will see them as if they are fixed and as if they will remain as they are, but they will pass away as the passing away of the clouds, i.e., they will move away from their places. * I At-Tabarfini in At-Tiwal 36. The author is referring to an unauthentic Hadith. Most of the scholars say that the Sur will be blown two times, based upon the authentic Hadiths, including those seen in this discussion

This is like the Ayat. 4On the Day when the heaven will shake with a dreadful shaking. And the mountains will move away with a (horrible) movement.)) (52:9-10) (cl5 lijJLj jf) Jii t)JA if JkJ&j) imX% e iAnd they ask you concerning the mountains : say, My Lord will blast them and scatter them as particles of dust. Then He shall leave them as a level smooth plain. You will see therein nothing crooked or curved.") (20:105-107), isn't* ijJj Jui1 jf pjJJjf iAnd (remember) the Day We shall cause the

mountains to pass away, and you will see the earth as a leveled plain.) (18:47). , i\ \$\$ && 4The work of Allah, Who perfected all things,) means, He does that by His great power. ^Who perfected all things,) means, He has perfected all that He has created, and has fashioned it according to His wisdom. iverily, He is well-acquainted with what you do) means, He knows all that His servants do, good or evil, and He will reward or punish them accordingly. Then Allah describes the state of the blessed and the doomed on that Day, and says: 4& %- % *& 4Whoever brings a good deed, will have better than its worth.) Qatadah said, That is sincerely for Allah alone. 111 Allah has Tabarani 19:508.

\$93. And say: "All the praises and thanks be to Allah. He will show you His Ayat, and you shall recognize them. And your Lord is not unaware of what you do." 4 The Command to worship Allah and to call People with the Qur'an Allah commands His Messenger jfe to say: i;-j.%=% 4' ^&& 3 m 41 have been commanded only to worship the Lord of this city, Who has sanctified it and to Whom belongs everything.} This is like the Ayah, xfi jjj ce, -4 tj11 oi 4 4 '4 kt 4'7&r. lij1' 4Sai/ : "O i/oh mankind! If you are in doubt as to my religion, then (know that) I will never worship those whom you worship besides Allah. But I worship Allah Who causes you to die.} (10:104) The fact that the word Robb (Lord) is connected to the word city (in the phrase the Lord of this city) is a sign of honor and divine care for that city. This is like the Ayah, 4So let them worship the Lord of this House (the Ka'bah), Who has fed them against hunger, and has made them safe from fear.} (106:3-4) 4Who has sanctified it} means, the One Who made it a sanctuary by His Law and by His decree, making it sanctified. It was recorded in the Two Sahih's that Ibn Abbas said: On the day of the conquest of Makkah, the Messenger of Allah jg said: J1 4)1 II 4)1 JLH l-i* j1 Tj -fi Nj "LaS L4 i) % i) /J4 1X1 .uaii "Verily, this city was made sacred by Allah the day He

created the heavens and the earth, so it is sacred by the sanctity of Allah until the Day of Resurrection. Its thorny bushes should not be cut, its game should not be chased, and its lost property should not be picked up except by one who would announce it publicly and none is allowed to uproot its thorny shrubs... This was reported in Sahih, Hasan, Musnad narrations, through various routes, by such a large group that it is absolutely unquestionable, 121 as has been explained in the appropriate place in the book Al-Ahkam, to Allah is the praise and thanks. iand to Wlwm belongs everything.} This is a statement of general application following a specific statement, i.e., He is the Lord of this city, and the Lord and Sovereign of all things, there is no god worthy of worship besides Him. & sjrf iJ Lpy} AAnd I am commanded to be from among the Muslims.} means, those who believe in Allah alone, who are sincere towards Him and who obediently follow His commands. AAnd that I should recite the Qur'an,} means, to people, so as to convey it to them. This is like the Ayah, AThis is what We recite to you of the Ayat and the Wise Rejoinder.} (3:58) AWe recite to you some of the news of Musa and Fir'aun in truth.} (28:3) meaning, I am a conveyer and a Warner.' FathAl-Ban 4:56. 2:986, Abu Dawud 2:517, An-Nasal 5:203, Ibn Majah 2:1038, Ahmad 1 :253.

j* b* Lit Jit .iJuJ liXf. &Jklkt ^i} 4then whosoever receives guidance, receives it for the good of himself; and whosoever goes astray, say (to him): "I am only one of the warners."} meaning, have an example to follow in the Messengers who warned their people, and did what they had to do in order to convey the Message to them and fulfil the covenant they had made. Allah will judge their nations to whom they were sent, as He says: & gjf <%} iyour duty is only to convey and on Us is the reckoning>

(13 :40). f i'J-\$ % ii 4But you are only a wamer. And Allah is a Protector over all thing (11:12). i&JZ k& 4And say: "All the praises and thanks be to Allah. He will show you His Ayat (signs), and you shall recognize them.} means, praise be to Allah, Who does not punish anyone except after establishing plea against him, warning him [and leaving him with no excuse]. Allah says: 4He will show you His Ayat (signs), and you shall recognize them.} This is like the Ayah, ^ .bl jvJJ OO, tfp. Cp.iit X^} ' (4, bbi.'* T-HS *} 4We will show them Our signs in the universe, and in themselves, until it becomes manifest to them that this is the truth} (41 :53). lit bb) Cj} 4And your Lord is not unaware of what you do.} means, on the contrary, He witnesses and sees all things. It

374 Tafslr Ibt Kathlr was recorded that Imam Ahmad, may Allah have mercy upon him, used to recite the following two lines of verse, whether they were written by him or someone else: If you are alone one day, do not say, I am alone. Rather say, Someone is watching me. Do not think that Allah will let His attention wander for even an instant, or that anything is hidden from Him.

Module 27

Surah 28: Al-Qasas, Surah 29: Al-Ankabut, Surah 30: Ar-Rum

Surah 28: Al-Qasas

PDF pages 4241–4322

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4241–4253]

376 Tgi In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. (fry p OJ <&, |U"l4 gJi lift " L-i t+U.1 oj'Wf i| Cf>> ^Vfo < if o' ijs &Z&M U& k '?'&> S** '4> ^Vf %*UJ\$ ill 4i ,4L 41 . Ta Sin Mim} 42 . These are the Ayat of the manifest Book.} . We recite to you some of the news of Musa and Fir'awn in truth, for a people who believe.} 44. Verily, Fir'awn exalted himself in the land and made its people Shtya'a, weakening a group among them: killing their sons, and letting their females live. Verily, he was of the mischief-makers \$> 45 . And We wished to do a favor to tlwse who were weak in the land, and to make them rulers and to make them the inheritors,} 46. And to establish them in the land, and We let Fir'awn and Hdmdn and their armies receive from than that which they feared.} The Story of Musa and Fir'awn, and what Allah intended for Their Peoples We have already discussed the significance of the separate letters. 4uO' " 4' 4These are the Ayat of the manifest Book.} means the Book which is clear and makes plain the true reality of things, and tells us about what happened and what will happen. fry P fr 4We recite to you some of the news of MU\$ and Fir'awn in truth,}

Al-Qasas Cl - 6) (Part-20) This is like the Ayah, }V\!e relate unto you the best of stories} (12:3). which means, *We tell you about things as they really were, as if you are there and are seeing them yourself. Then Allah says: 4yjiVf j% iZ&Jl iVerily, Fir'awn exalted himself in the land^ means, he was an arrogant oppressor and tyrant. iattd made its people Shiya'} means, he made them into different classes, each of which he used to do whatever he wanted of the affairs of his state. ifc ijfL iweakening a group among them .} This refers to the Children of Israel, who at that time were the best of people, even though this tyrant king overpowered them, using them to do the most menial work and forcing them to hard labor night and day for him and his people. At the same time, he was killing their sons and letting their daughters live, to humiliate them and because he feared that there might appear among them the boy who would be the cause of his destruction and the downfall of his kingdom. So Fir'awn took precautions against that happening, by ordering that all boys bom to the Children of Israel should be killed, but this precaution did not protect him against the divine decree, because when the term of Allah comes, it cannot be delayed, and for each and every matter there is a decree from Allah. Allah says: iofti >' o &&& IJj} 4And \Nc wished to do a favor to those who were weak in the land,} until His saying; iwhich they feared.} And Allah did indeed do this to them, as He says:

t' K' *' > (JjuJwJ \y iAnd We made the people who were considered weak} until His saying; ithey erected} (7:137). And Allah said: &j \$> iThus and We caused the Children of Israel to inherit them} (26:59). Fir'awn hoped that by his strength and power he would be saved from Musa, but that did not help him in the slightest. Despite his great power as a king he could not oppose the decree of Allah, which can never be overcome. On the contrary, Allah's ruling was carried out, for it had been written

and decreed from past eternity that Fir'awn would meet his doom at the hands of Musa. Vj j),['i> \ *de ouj- liji j Zsey \$ 2l) C^y{f} oJlij [IjiifUj !}-" 1Su.^ " - .1 >' .< f." ' (/-(>; .1 t ' jl ujuu (jl isr*" V -yJj <_ * y} 47. And We inspired the mother of Musa: "Suckle him (Musa), but when you fear for him, then cast him into the river and fear not, nor grieve. Verily, We shall bring him back to you, and shall make him one of the Messengers."} i8. Then the household of Fir'awn picked him up, that he might become for them an enemy and a (cause of) grief. Verily, Fir'awn, Haman and their armies were sinners.} 49. And the wife of Fir'awn said: "A comfort of the eye for me and for you . Kill him not, perhaps he may be of benefit to us, or we may adopt him as a son ." And they perceived not.} How Musa's Mother was inspired and shown what to do It was mentioned that when Fir'awn killed so many of the

males of the Children of Israel, the Copts were scared that the Children of Israel would die out, and they themselves would have to do the heavy labor that the Children of Israel used to do. So they said to Fir'awn, If this continues, and their old men die and the young men are killed, their women will not be able to do the work that the men are doing, and we will end up having to do it. So Fir'awn issued orders that the boys should be killed one year, and left alone the following year. Harun, peace be upon him, was born in a year when the boys were not killed, and Musa was born in a year when the boys were being killed. Fir'awn had people who were entrusted with this task. There were midwives who would go around and check on the women, and if they noticed that any woman was pregnant, they would write her name down. When the time came for her to give birth, no one was allowed to attend her except for Coptic women. If the woman gave birth to a girl, they would leave her alone and go away, but if she gave birth to a boy, the killers would come in with their sharp knives and kill the child, then they would go away; may Allah curse them. When the mother of Musa became pregnant with him, she did not show any signs of pregnancy as other women did, and none of the midwives noticed. But when she gave birth to a boy, she became very distressed and did not know what to do with him. She was extremely scared for him, because she loved him very much. No one ever saw Musa, peace be upon him, but they loved him, and the blessed ones were those who loved him both as a natural feeling and because he was a Prophet. Allah says: 4 And I endued you with love from Me \$ (20:39). Musa, peace be upon him, in the House of Fir'awn When Musa's mother became so worried and confused, it was inspired into her heart and mind what she should do, as Allah says: *Vj . i 4\$ c.j Ji Zsty 3* cl) j^

Fir'awn said: For you he may be, but not for me. And this was indeed the case: Allah guided her because of him, and destroyed him at his hands. -\ 4 perhaps he may be of benefit to us,} This is indeed what happened in her case, for Allah guided her through him and caused her to dwell in Paradise because of him. 4 or we may adopt him as a son.} She wanted to take him and adopt him as a son, because she had no children from Fir'awn. V. 4 And they perceived not.} means, they did not know what Allah planned for them when they picked him up, by His great wisdom and definitive proof. je tjJLj oi VJJ . fjlJ 1 Jlj ^fy} V \$ ^ <* ^ 'T-a\$ & j* at % \- .6 ju '\$,*;1 llj, iijji J) pkj ,U==*J V U Zj 410. And the heart of the mother of Musa became empty. She was very near to disclose his (case), had We not strengthened her heart, so that she might remain as one of the believers.} 411 And she said to his sister: "Follow him. So she watched him from afar place (secretly), while they perceived not.} 412. And We had already forbidden foster suckling mothers for him, until she said : "Shall I direct you to a household who will rear him for you, and look after him in a good manner?"} 413. So We restored him

to his mother, that her eye might be comforted, and that she might not grieve, and that she might know that the promise of Allah is true. But most of them know not. }

found in their household, and he did not accept any of them, refusing to take milk from them. So they took him out to the marketplace, hoping to find a woman who would be suitable to nurse him. When (his sister) saw him in their arms, she recognized him, but she did not give any indication nor did they suspect her. Allah says: } And We had already forbidden foster suckling mothers for him, } Because of his honored status with Allah, it was forbidden by divine decree. It was decreed that no one should nurse him except his own mother, and Allah caused this to be the means reuniting him with his mother so that she could nurse him and feel safe after having) felt such fear. When [his sister] saw that they were confused over who should nurse the child, ^j *) cj; jit jjc ishe said: "Shall I direct you to a household who will rear him for you, and look after him in a good manner?" } Ibn Abbas said: When she said that, they had some doubts about her, so they seized her and asked her, How do you know these people will be sincere and will care for him? She said to them, They will be sincere and will care for him because they want the king to be happy and because they hope for some reward. So they let her go. After what she said, being safe from their harm, they took her to their house and brought the baby to his mother. She gave him her breast and he accepted it, so they rejoiced and sent the glad tidings to the wife of Fir'awn. She called for Musa's mother, treating her kindly and rewarding her generously. She did not realize that she was his real mother, but she saw that the baby accepted her breast. Then Asiyah asked her to stay with her and nurse the baby, but she refused, saying, I have a husband and children, and I cannot stay with you, but if you would like me to nurse him in my own home, I will do that. The wife of Fir'awn agreed to that, and paid her a regular salary and gave her extra gifts and clothing and treated her kindly. The mother of Musa came back with her child, happy that after a time of fear Allah granted her security, prestige, and ongoing provision. There was only a short time between the distress and the

way out, a day and night, or thereabouts - and Allah knows best. Glory be to the One in Whose hands are all things; what He wills happens and what He does not will does not happen. He is the One Who grants those who fear Him, a way out from every worry and distress, Allah said: '\$ S 4^ i So We restored him to his mother, that her eye might be comforted, means, by him, %} i and that she might not grieve, means, for if 'X%>} i and that she might know that the promise of Allah is true.} meaning, We had promised her to return him to her and to make him one of the Messengers. When he was returned to her, she realized that he was one of the Messengers, so as she brought him up, she treated him both as a child (with kindness) and as a Messenger (with respect). i But most of them know not.} means, they do not know the wisdom of Allah in His actions and their good consequences, for which He is to be praised in this world and the Hereafter. For a thing may happen that people do not like, but its consequences ISssT vav V, * ** // "z' s' S* *" " " >-9 . , , , fo\ju\i- itx3\ jo //' ^ ^y / x , "x ." x.x JLiJJj^ybc jji o5M llli X . ?> >./' _ Iff lA*" Kj(lA^ O*-k}L"JJ0)2 \ bWoj him.

are good, as Allah says: ip J^} i and it may be that you dislike a thing which is good for you and that you like a thing which is bad for you (2:216). Li- ***" inf j^j tijjSS iit may be that you dislike a thing and Allah brings through it a great deal of good > (4:19). & iip*> JuM fry^ ;lii q,> tijl' a11"uLmiU ^ Uj^ \jjjk u y* -Wy I4U1 aLac Jji /it oiuijl J>- Ijc* JU wdie ^aii -JJj* iSj tijj' -*i^r5' o; 0V _yi' lij J Jiilj ilib cii *ly Jli . , Cij* J-if 4 . ii+k "d? '-> -i 414. And when he reached maturity, and was complete, We bestowed

on him Hubn and knowledge. And thus do We reward the doers of good.} 415. And he entered the city when its people were unaware: and he found there two men fighting, - one of his party, and the other of his foes. The man of his (own) party asked him for help against his foe, so Musa struck him with his fist and he died. He said: This is of Shaytan's doing, verily, he is a plain misleading enemy."} 416. He said: My Lord! Verily, I have wronged myself, so forgive me." Then He forgave him. Verily, He is the Oft-Forgiving, the Most Merciful.} 417. He said: "My Lord! For that with which You have favored me, I will nevermore be a helper of the criminals!"} How Musa killed a Coptic Man Having described Musa's beginnings, Allah then tells us that when he reached maturity, and was complete in stature, Allah gave him Hukm and religious knowledge. Mujahid said that this means prophethood . * Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 5 :23 1

386 Tafstr Ibn Kathir iAnd thus do We reward the doers of good.} Then Allah describes how Musa reached the status that was decreed for him, that of Prophethood and speaking to Allah, as a direct consequence of killing the Coptic, which was the reason why he left Egypt and went to Madyan. Allah says: Ik f-Lc. Jc ilojf &-*j} iAnd he entered the city when its people were unaware.} Ibn Jurayj narrated from Ata Al-Khurasani, from Ibn Abbas, That was between Maghrib and /sftd 11 ' Ibn Al-Munkadir narrated from Ata bin Yasar from Ibn Abbas, That was in the middle of the day."121 This was also the view of Said bin Jubayr, Ikrimah, As-Suddi and Qatadah. Ijj iand he found there two men fighting,} meaning, hitting one another and struggling with one another. i one of his party,} meaning, an Israelite, iand the other of his foes.} meaning, a Coptic . This was the view of Ibn Abbas, Qatadah, As-Suddi and Muhammad bin Ishaq . 141 The Israelite man asked Musa, peace be upon him, for help, and Musa took advantage of the fact that people were not paying attention, so he went to the Coptic man and i*\$ fui fry fj\$} so Musa struck him with his fist and he died.} Mujahid said, This means he punched him with his fist.Tabari 19:538. At-Tabari 19:538. At-Tabari 19:539. At-Tabari 19:539, 540. [5J At-Tabari 19:540.

And then he died. 4He said} refers to Musa. -tii J JiiU j>\ Cfj Jli^^ J> Jt 45* C*i v*J Jli S 4 This is of Shaytan's doing, verily, he is a plain misleading enemy." He said: My Lord! Verily, I have wronged myself, so forgive me." Then He forgave him. Verily, He is the Oft-Forgiving, the Most Merciful. He said: "My Lord! For that with which You have favored me,} meaning, *what You have given me of prestige, power and blessings - 41 will nevermore be a helper of the criminals!} those who disbelieve in You and go against Your commands. ** .1? til'. 1' ' vili] /U jw Qe* "? j! j JLi Lf) _>-Xc jh l\$JIt ji Uii uj L"J j I j oj_ ciui 418. So he became afraid, looking about in the city, when behold, the man who had sought his help the day before, called for his help (again). Musa said to him : Verily, you are a plain misleader!"} 419. Then when he decided to seize the man who was an enemy to both of them, the man said: O Musa! Is it your intention to kill me as you killed a man yesterday? Your aim is nothing but to become a tyrant in the land, and not to be one of those who do right."}

How the Secret of this Killing became known

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Allah tells us that when Musa killed that Coptic, 4^jE- 4^

he became afraid in the city meaning, of the consequences of his action, looking about means, turning around and watching out, waiting for the consequences of his action to befall him. He went out and about, and saw the man who sought his help the day before, fighting with another Coptic. When Musa passed by him, he called for his help again, against this other Coptic. Musa said to him: 4 iVerily, you are a plain misleader!} meaning, you obviously lead people astray and are very evil. Then Musa intended to attack that Coptic, but the Israelite because of his own cowardice and weakness - thought that Musa wanted to hit him because of what he had said, so he said, in self-defence - 4 Musa! Is it your intention to kill me as you killed a man yesterday?} Nobody except him and Musa, peace be upon him, knew about it, but when the other Coptic heard this, he took the news to Fir'awn's gate and told him about it. So Fir'awn came to know of it, and he became very angry and resolved to kill Musa, so he sent people after him to bring him to him. JiJIL JL ,\ 2^ ju > CSt 3w o; ctU 420. And there came a man running, from the farthest end of the city. He said: "O Miisa! Verily, the chiefs are taking counsel together about you, to kill you, so escape. Truly, I am one of the good advisers to you ." \$> 4And there came a man} He is described as being a man because he had the courage to take a different route, a shorter route than those who were sent after Musa, so he reached Musa first and said to him: O Musa, 4^i4^ Si'

si usqjvfuno puy (syootfump) xpr} spusqdaqs dip \pun (siporf uno) udfvoi ;ouum a/vi,, :pws Rdqi inofi ipim uopvtu sip si miM : P!VS dH '(po]fump) ypvq Euidodq 3U3 oqoi udiuooi oaij punof 3i{ tU3W sopisoq puv 'Sutuoijvm udui fo dnouE v 3U3ip puncf 3i{ 'uvRpyq fo U3)vai dip }v psauuo at/ uai/m puy Z\$ 4,, 'fivai p 8u dip o; diu sopinS puoq Riu }mp dq fvtu if,, :pws at/ uvfipvyq spuooow/ }U3oi di{ udqoi puy zib 4"jSJdop8uoum 3uv oqai ojdoos dip utojf diu daog jp-to7 Ryq,, :pivs af/ uvdffo 3}V} S v ui ptoqv Sup/00/ duoip tuoif podooso dq og izb & irq g?X if h *rC -\$ jr*T ii^v f]fp rf? #2* ?C n 752P fT-i^r a? cfrf-J "*" f^ / '// c ^ T' irt tC?"> p/ " 3? 5 a?^ ' ,f> ?f-f# J- > y ^tr :m; 10 ?r ^ P to 3 "r - 4'uo/i 07 sudsiapv poo8 dip fo duo uiv 1 Rpui\$ "r rtf rf? ST ^P itjf "nr/} //} <* / " # / pirej stip uiojj stream i'3dv3S3 OS nofl UPi 0/\$> nOiC jnoqB jaipoire auo qiiM Suiqnsuoo 3jb jCaqj, Suiubsm ,, ^noR jtioqv uoipoEo} idsunod EupjV) duv sfdiip dip R\udj\\$ fin* ?<*=4rfRH !! <*< 1* ^^ //// / //// r=^==r^gtln^ttrirr^Pif\irf ?r\p up^r\$frplTs!!'rr^fr:5p^^^ m^-Tn^ vva 6"e (oz-m) in - o?; svsvq-iv -szwvs

a very old man."} 424. So he watered (theirflocks) for them, then he turned back to shade, and said: "My Lord! Truly, I am in need of whatever good that You bestow on me!"} Musa, peace be upon him, in Madyan, and how He watered the Flocks of the Two Women When the man told Musa about how Fir'awn and his chiefs were conspiring against him, he left Egypt on his own. He was not used to being alone, because before that he had been living a life of luxury and ease, in a position of leadership. iSo he escaped from there, looking about in a state of fear.} meaning, turning around and watching. iMy Lord! Save me from the people who are wrongdoers!} means, from Fir'awn and his chiefs. It was mentioned that Allah sent to him an angel riding a horse, who showed him the way. And Allah knows best. "LiC &j} iAnd when he went towards (the land of) Madyan,} means, he took a smooth and easy route - and he rejoiced because of that. 'Ay isi-i-a u' ihe said: "It may be that my Lord guides me to the right way."} meaning, the most straight route. And Allah did indeed do that, for He guided him to the straight path in this world and the Hereafter, and caused him to be guided and to guide others. i&z & cjj} iAnd when he arrived at the water (a well) of Madyan,} means, when he reached Madyan and went to drink from its water, for it had a well where shepherds used to water their flocks.

yoir^ iit ot!0\ Ail '^j) ihefound there a group ofmen watering, and besides them he found two women who were keeping back.) means, they were stopping their sheep from drinking with the sheep of those shepherds, lest some harm come to them. When Musa, peace be upon him, saw them, he felt sorry for them and took pity on them. 4He said: "What is the matter with you?") meaning, why do you not water your flocks with these people? &) iThey said: "We cannot water until the shepherds take..." meaning, *we cannot water our flocks until they finish. 4And our father is a very old man.) means, this is what has driven us to what you see. iSo he watered (theirflocks) for them,) ii Ji*- ot l!|, LJ (jl. VJ J'-** lii iv ^>))then he turned back to shade, and said : "My Lord! Truly, I am in need ofwhatever good that You bestow on me!") 4j4>' "5l> ito shade,) Ibn Abbas, Ibn Mas*ud and As-Suddi said: He sat beneath a tree. 111 Ata bin As-Sa ib said: When MUsa said: yV- Ct Q.)"My Lord! Tndy, I am in need of whatever good that You bestow on me!") the women heard him. 121Tabari 19:556.Tabari 19:557.

392 Tafsir Von Kathlr t3 C j;i c"1 < . iJli ,>^ &3> iJU J#^ jl jXaji JJJ ll ^ -iy' 4l \ \$U\$ ^' _ . < . i i ->-u- c <\$ g*e- ijfo J Ol" tSj\l & x % 'te. 4 ci^: < t Jit ^ lyl t; 4\$)2U-j 4 G& 5&SS < & 5B jJiVf i3 Xi-rj 425. Thai there came to him one of them, walking shyly. She said : Verily, my father calls you that he may reward you for turning watered (our flocks) for us." So when he came to him and narrated the story, he said: "Fear ydu not. You have escapedfrom the people who are wrongdoers."} 426. And said one of them (the two women): "O my father! Hire him! Verily, the best ofmen for you to hire is the strong, the trustworthy."} He said : I intend to wed one of these two daughters of mine to you, on condition that you serve me for eight years but ifyou complete ten years, it will be (afavor)from you. But I intend not to place you under a difficulty. IfAllah wills, you willfind me one of the righteous."} 42S. He (Musa) said: "That (is settled) between me and you: whichever of the tivo terms I folfill, there will be no injustice to me, and Allah is Surety over wfuit we say. } Musa, the Father ofthe Two Women, and His Marriage to One ofThem When the two women came back quickly with the sheep, then- father was surprised that they returned so soon. He asked them what had happened, and they told him what Musa, peace be upon him, had done. So he sent one of them to nail him to meet her father. Allah says: iThen there came to him one of than, walking shyly.} meaning, she was walking like a free woman, as it was narrated from the Commander of the faithful, Umar, may

Al-Oasas (25 - 28) (Part-20) Allah be pleased with him: She was covering herself from them with the folds of her garment. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Amr bin Maymun said, 'Umar, may Allah be pleased with him, said: She came walking shyly, putting her garment over her face. She was not one of those audacious women who come and go as they please. 12 This chain of narrators is Sahih. iShe said: Verily, my father calls you that he may reward you for having watered (ourflocks) for us."} This is an example of good manners: she did not invite him directly lest he have some suspicious thoughts about her. Rather she said: My father is invitingyou so that hemay rewardyou for wateringour sheep, i.e., giveyousomepayment for that. ij&x a} iSo when he came to him and narrated the story,} means, he told him about his story and why he had to leave his country. ^Os-hlajt ihe said: "Fear you not. You have escapedfrom the people who are wrongdoers."} He was saying: calm down and relax, for you have left their kingdom and they have no authority in our land. So he said: }You have escapedfrom the people who are wrongdoers.} iAnd said one of them : "O my father! Hire him! Verily, the best ofmen for you to hire is the strong, the trustworthy."} One of the two daughters of the man said this, and it was said

that she was the one who had walked behind Musa, peace be upon him. She said to her father: Tabari 19:558. (2) AMabari 19:559.

any inconvenience or argue with you. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ali bin Rabah Al-Lakhmi said, I heard Tjbah bin An-Nadar As-Sulami, the Companion of the Messenger of Allah jg narrating that the Messenger of Allah jg said: uj ^Musa, peace be upon him, hired himself out for the purpose of keeping chaste and to feed himself. ",1) And Allah tells us o>> b about iviusa, peace > yj purti 4He said: "That (is settled) between me and you: whichever of the two terms I fulfill, there will be no injustice to me, and Allah is Surety over what we say."} Musa said to his father-in-law, The matter is as you say. You have hired me for eight years, and if I complete ten years, that is my choice, but if I do the lesser amount, I will still have fulfilled the covenant and met the conditions. So he said: ^ cJiVf0} 4whichever of the two terms I fulfill, there will be no injustice to me,} meaning, there will be no blame on me. The complete term is permissible but it is still regarded as something extra. This is like the Ayah, 4But whosoever hastens to leave in two days, there is no sin on him and whosoever stays on, there is no sin on him} (2:203). And the Messenger of Allah said to Hamzah bin Amr Al- Aslami, may Allah be pleased with him, who used to fast a great deal and who asked him about fasting while traveling: I1 ' Al-Bazz&r 1495. This Hadxth has two different chains of narration. That of Al-Bazz&r is very weak , that of Ibn Abi Hatim has a minor deficiency and is also technically weak. Some HadUh scholars would consider it a valid witness.

ogam mm If ip <.'feas jLi <, ^ "Mj(i juSbL^f w7 --^r-r . ".f / - f^.? - : alf y u wish > then fist. and if you wish, do not > '>'AC\ ">\r even though it is better to ^st, 0 according to the /{4.,/{ / ..j ^ / .> evidence of other reports. And there is "aSS"2JUjjjytt(S)< "-?(& f v denct which s ,s '* > ' indlcates that Musa, peace be upon him, the two terms. jti^<^A*yli y

jf. *Uj- gy* j i-li* Vj Jyljilj 429. Then, when Musa had fulfilled the term, and was traveling with his family, he saw a fire in the direction of At- Tur. He said to his family : "Wait, I have seen a fire; perhaps I may bring to you from there some information, or a burning firebrand that you may warm yourselves."} 430. So when he reached it, he was called from the right side of the valley, in the blessed place, from the tree: "O Musa! Verily, I am Allah, the Lord of all that exists!"} i31 . "And throw your stick!" But when he saw it moving as if it were a snake, he turned in flight, and looked not back. (It was said:) "O Musa! Draw near, and fear not. Verily, you are of those who are secure."} 432. "Put your hand into the opening of your garment, it will come forth white without a disease; and draw your hand close to your side to be free from the fear. These are two proofs from your Lord to Fir'awn and his chiefs. Verily, they are the people who are rebellious."} Musa s Return to Egypt and how he was honored with the Mission and Miracles on the Way In the explanation of the previous Ayah, we have already seen that MQsa completed the longer and better of the two terms, which may also be understood from the Ayah where Allah says: &} 4Then, when Musa had fulfilled the term,} meaning, the longer of the two; and Allah knows best. \ J^j} i and was traveling with his family,} They said: MQsa missed his country and his relatives, so he resolved to visit them in secret, without Fir'awn and his people knowing. So he gathered up his family and the flocks which his father-in-law had given to him, and set out on a cold, dark, rainy night. They stopped to camp,

meaning, the One Who is addressing you and speaking to you is the Lord of all that exists, the One Who does what He wills, the One apart from Whom there is no other god or lord, may He be exalted and sanctified, the One Who by His very nature, attributes, words and deeds is far above any resemblance to His creation, may He be glorified. } And throw your stick! } the stick that is in your hand - as was stated in the Ayah, 4 And what is that in your right hand, O Musa?" He said: "This is my stick, whereon I lean, and wherewith I beat down branches for my sheep, and wherein I find other uses." } (20:17-18). The meaning is: This stick, which you know so well; 4"Cast it down, O Musa! He cast it down, and behold! It was a snake, moving quickly.} (20:19-20). Musa knew that the One Who was speaking to him was the One Who merely says to a thing, Be! and it is, as we have already stated in (the explanation of) Surah Ta Ha. And here Allah says: 4 %&& } But when he saw it moving as if it were a snake, he turned in flight, } It moved so quickly, even though it was so big, and its mouth was so huge, with its jaws snapping. It swallowed every rock it passed, and every rock that fell into its mouth fell with a sound like a rock falling into a valley. When he saw that: } he turned in flight, and looked not back.} he did not turn around. Al-Bari 5 :342 .

4to Fir'awn and his chiefs .^ meaning his leaders and prominent followers. iVerily, they are the people who are rebellious .} means, who are disobedient towards Allah and who go against His commands and His religion. ^ c? "U i Oj JI5^ iiU.1 -iljulac JC." Jtt J uiU-i Cfedf C23 SJL-S :*&& i2j 433. He said: "My Lord! I have killed a man among them, and Ifear that they will kill me."4 434. "And my brother Hdrun - he is more eloquent in speech than me, so send him with me as a helper to confirm me. Verily, Ifear that they will deny me." } 435. Allah said: "We will strengthen your arm through your brother, and give you both power, so they shall not be able to harm you, with Our Aydt; you two as well as those whofollow you, will be the victors." } HowMusaasked for the Support ofHis Brotherandwas granted thatby Allah When Allah commanded him to go to Fir'awn, the one who he had run away from and whose vengeance he feared, tiii [4l> j& } 4 Musa said: My Lord! I have killed a man among them, } meaning, that Coptic, 4and Ifear that they will kill me. } i.e., when they see me. 4And my brother Harun - he is more eloquent in speech than me, } Musa, peace be upon him, had a speech defect, because when

iYou are granted your request, O Musa! } (20:36) iAnd We granted him his brother Harun, (also) a Prophet, out ofOur mercy } (19:53). One of the Salaf said, There is no one who has ever done a greater favor to his brother than Musa did for Harun, may peace be upon them both, for he interceded for him until Allah made him a Prophet and Messenger with him to Fir'awn and his chiefs. Allah said concerning Mdsa: \$ ig& } ihe was honorable before Allah } (33:69). l&J && } iand (We will) give you both power } means, overwhelming evidence. iso they shall not be able to harm you, with Our Aydt; } means, they will have no way or means of harming you because you are conveying the signs of Allah. This is like the Aydt ikl t j <& } iO Messenger! Proclaim (the Message) which has been sent down to youfrom your Lord.} until His saying: i'J* u iAllah will protect youfrom mankind } (5:67). * t iThose who convey the Message ofAllah } until His saying: \$> } iAnd sufficient is Allah as a Reckoner } (33:39). And sufficient is Allah as a Helper and Supporter. And Allah

404 TafsTr Ibn Kathir told them the consequences in this world and the next, for them and for those who followed them, HS0 <&\$& iyou two as well as those who follow you will be the victors.} This is like the Ayat. 0 i3 &=> } Si" iAllah has decreed "Verily, it is I and My Messengers who shall be the

victorious." Verily, Allah is All-Powerful, All-Mighty.} (58:21) igu 4 4Verily, We will indeed make victorious Our Messengers and those who believe in this world's life (40:51) to the end of the Ayah. rJ} HjSksm w gssngu ^)l-XllbU\fli .X) c.U.I "lift r y?<" '>\A- ' " A*' 4 04, C"C uj ui C i 4^* jO 6 ,j^ . "J-; c^i+H; , pit Isry-S' - JU> <(36. Then when Musa came to than with Our Clear Ayat, they said: "This is nothing but invented magic. Neva did we hear of this among ourfathers ofold."} 437. Musa said: "My Lord knows best him who came with guidance from Him, and whose will be the happy end in the Haeafter. Verily, the wrongdoers will not be successful."}

Al-Oasas (36 - 37) (Part-20) Musa before Fir'awn and His People Allah tells us how Musa and his brother HarQn came before Fir'awn and his chiefs, and showed them the clear miracles and overwhelming proof that Allah had given them to confirm the truth ofwhat they were saying about Allah being One and that His commandments were to be followed. Fir'awn and his chiefs saw that with their own eyes and realized that it was certainly from Allah, but because of their disbelief and sin they resorted to stubbornness and false arguments. This was because they were too evil and arrogant to follow the truth. They said: iThis is nothing but invented magic meaning, fabricated and made up. They wanted to oppose him by means of their own tricks and their position and power, but this did not work. e&c xi cj} iNever did we hear of this among ourfathers ofold.} They were referring worshipping Allah Alone, with no partner or associate. They said: We have never seen anyone among our forefathers following this religion; we have only ever seen people associating other gods in worship with Allah. MUsa said in response to them: 4:J- O' jjet 4My Lord knows best him who came with guidance from Him,} meaning, of me and you, and He will decide between me and you. So he said: ijti w IP&} iand whose will be the happy end in the Hereafter.} meaning, who will be supported and will prevail. 4Verily, the wrongdoers will not be successful.} refers to the idolaters who associate others in worship with Allah.

js sj > S/fi Al J* (Sul' S&j) j* A-A) -iSi (*liiV jjj ^_yy aJi d] Mi* J J;Mti Y4 J V Ml iJ 4^i>^ csiVf ? iijl jjU lil' M-6 Mi^=> >-i^ jLk" .iM ci jnftJM py A'^ji] UjII aJJ-" j | i";*^j ,av, ij_] ^"aj V iLiili jdll cil ^jyy^> 4l^C(ja5^" ,vi 433. Fir awn said: "O chiefs/ I /cnou> no/ that you have a god other than me. So kindle for me (a fire), O Human, to bake clay, and set up for me a Sarh in order that 1 may look at the God ofMusa; and verily, I think that he (Musa) is one of the liars.") . And he and his armies were arrogant in the land, without right, and they thought that they would never return to Us.) 440. So, We seized him and his artnies, and We threw them all into the sea. So, behold what was the end of the wrongdoers.) 441. And We made them leaders inviting to the Fire: and on the Day ofResurrection, they will not be helped.) 442. And We made a curse to follow them in this world, and on the Day ofResurrection, they will be among disgraced.) The Arrogance ofFir awn and His ultimate Destiny Allah tells us of Fir awn s disbeliefand wrongdoing, and how he falsely claimed divinity for his evil self, may Allah curse him. /tiji 4Thus hefooled his people, and they obeyed him.) [43:54] He called on his people to recognize his divinity, and they responded, because oftheirweak and foolish minds. So, he said: 4^sJ> SuK tffe) 40 chiefs! I know not that you have a god other than me.) Allah tells us about Fir awn:

4Then he gathered (his people) and cried aloud, saying : "I am your lord, most high." So Allah, seized him with punishment for his last and first transgression. Verily, in this is an instructive admonition for

whosoever fears Allah.} (79:23-26) meaning: he brought his people together and called to them in a loud voice, shouting that, and they responded to him obediently. So Allah took revenge on him, and made him a lesson to others in this world and the Hereafter. He even confronted Musa with that, and said: JI Lft till) 4If you choose a god other than me, I will certainly put you among the prisoners} (26:29). j}l crri "4 4So kindle for me (a fire), O Hdmdn, to bake (bricks out of) clay, and set up for me a Sarh in order that I may look at the God ofMusa;} He commanded his minister and adviser Haman to bake bricks for him, i.e., to make bricks in order to build a Sarh, a exalted towering palace. This is like the Ayah, j}l J Oj7j> JBj^ "jk oy-yA Cff ts J" 4 vi }And Fir'awn said: "O HSman! Build me a Sarh that I may arrive at the ways - the ways of the heavens, and I may look upon the God of Musa, but verily, I think him to be a liar." Thus it was made fair seeming, in Fir'awn's eyes, the evil of his deeds, and he was hindered from the path; and the plot of Fir'awn led to nothing but loss and destruction} (40:36-37). Fir'awn built this tower, which was the highest structure ever seen on earth, because he wanted to show his people that MOsA was lying when he claimed that there was a God other than Fir'awn. Fir'awn said: iUgs& "&} iand verily, I think that he (Musa) is one of the liars.}

meaning, when he says that there is a lord other than me. The issue was not whether Allah had sent Mtisa, because he did not acknowledge the existence of the Creator in the first place. On the contrary, he said: is >} 4And what is the Lord ofAl-'Alamin?} (26:23) and: 4'okfy^ Si ojilf g\$} 4tf you choose a god other than me, I will certainly put you among the prisoners.} (26:29) and he said: 4^ .4*^ssjxc yai \ \$k} 40 chiefs! I know not that you have a god other than me.} This was the view of Ibn Jarir. 11 v -4i jfjti ji 4And he and his armies were arrogant in the land, without right, and they thought that they would never return to Us.} means, they were arrogant oppressors who spread much mischief in the land, and they believed that there would be no Resurrection. 3f> \ ly ilifj Z~aji} 4So, your Lord poured on them different kinds of severe torment. Verily, your Lord is Ever Watchful (over them).} (89:13-14). Allah says here: 4i\$ 4 &&&} 4So, We seized him and his armies, and We threw them all into the sea.} meaning, *We drowned them in the sea in a single morning, and not one ofthem was left. 4^ \ J - -S =" 4So, behold what was the end of the wrongdoers. And We m At-Tabari 19 :580

Al-Oasas (42 - 43) (Part-20) made them leaders inviting to the Fire) for those who followed them and took the same path as they did, rejecting the Messengers and denying the Creator. idjjCa* V iand on the Day ofResurrection, they will not be helped. their humiliation in this world is combined with and connected to their humiliation in the Hereafter, as Allah says: 4We have destroyed them. And there was none to help them (47:13). iAnd We made a curse tofollow them in this world,) Allah decreed that they and their king Fir'awn should be cursed by the believers among His servants who follow His Messengers, just as in this world they were cursed by the Prophets and their followers. (*-* fyj) iand on the Day of Resurrection, they will be among disgraced.) Qatadah said, This Ayah is like the Ayah, ii-ii j iThey were pursued by a curse in this (life) and on the Day of Resurrection. Evil indeed is the gift given.) (ingg). 11 ! jkzZai 4/i l 443. And indeed We gave Musa - after We had destroyed the generations of old - the Scripture as an enlightenment far mankind, and a guidance and a mercy, that they might remember.) |i| At-Tabari 19:583.

The Blessingswhich AllahbestoweduponMusa Allah tells us about the blessings which He gave His servant and Messenger Musa, the speaker, may the best of peace and blessings from his Lord be upon

him, He revealed the Tawrah to him after He destroyed Fir'awn and his chiefs. *gadzmafiar* VJe had destroyed the generations of old. After the revelation of the Tawrah, no nation would again be punished with an overwhelming calamity; instead the believers were now commanded to fight the enemies of Allah among the idolators, as Allah says: *Isyagtmrwmm* ^="LSCj s } /// O } "*"r> ojj j >< \ ". 1"- "C*" \ s' * -Y4.i ^ vV:' | "fJ Jj V !> * izJZfjjJlj | i^" iAnd Fir'awn, and those before him, and the cities overthrown committed sin. And they disobeyed their Lord's Messenger, so He seized them with a strong punishment} (69:9-10). *tf-Uy j.^ u}* ias an enlightenment for mankind, and a guidance and a mercy,} guidance from blindness and error. A guidance to the truth and a mercymeans, to show the way towards doing righteous deeds.

\$*} i that they might remember.} means, that the people might be reminded and guided by it. *X / V ,// < O?jS di VrSjit ij i^jdl cX Cj} jjLU LCjII jl jj.Uli cX CJ ; J VJ (*+U Cj4 jXl j-& Z4{ ZZ.} V M . A .s v. t, A*J | W iCM> i44.* And you were not on the western side (of the Mount), when We made clear to Musa the commandment, and you were not among the witnesses.} 445. But We created generations, and long were the ages that passed over them. And you were not a dweller among the people of Madyan, reciting Our Ayat to them. But it is We Who kept sending (Messengers).} 446. And you were not at the side of At-Tur when We called. But (you are sent) as a mercy from your Lord, to give warning to a people to whom no warner had come before you, in order that they may remember or receive admonition.} 447. And if (We had) not (sent you to the people of Makkah) in case a calamity should seize them for what their hands have sent forth, they would have said: "Our Lord! Why did You not send us a Messenger? We would then have followed Your Ayat and would have been among the believers."} Proof of the Prophethood of Muhammad^ Allah points out the proof of the prophethood of Muhammad whereby he told others about matters of the past, and spoke about them as if he were hearing and seeing them for himself. But he was an illiterate man who could not read books, and he grew up among a people who knew nothing of such things. Similarly, Allah told him about Maryam and her story, as Allah said:

i) 63 4You were not with them, when they cast lots with their pens as to which of them should be charged with the care of Maryam; nor were you with them when they disputed (3:44), meaning, you were not present then, but Allah has revealed this to you. Similarly, Allah told him about Nuh and his people, and how He saved Nuh and drowned his people, then He said: *l\ iA ^ cS U JU) 'r^ tiJ Ji i* This is of the news of the Unseen which We reveal unto you ; neither you nor your people knew it before this. So, be patient. Surely, the (good) end is for those who have Taqwa (11:49). And at the end of the same Surah (Hud) Allah says: *i* That is some of the news of the towns which We relate unto you^ (11:100). And here, after telling the story of Musa from beginning to end and how Allah began His revelation to him and spoke with him, Allah says: *4jLS/ ' ts'f d) i) ^ <\$.* And you were not on the western side (of the Mount), when We made clear to Musa the commandment, meaning, you - O Muhammad - were not on the western side of the mountain where Allah spoke to Musa from the tree which was to the east of it, in the valley. *i* and you were not among the witnesses.} *to that event, but Allah has revealed this to you, so that it may be evidence and proof of events which happened centuries ago, for people have forgotten the evidence that Allah established against them and what was revealed to the earlier Prophets.

- I " ^j} you were not a dweller among the people of Madyan, reciting Our Ayat to them.} meaning, you were not living among the people of Madyan reciting Our Ayat to them, when you started to tell about Our Prophet Shu ayb and what he said to his people and how they responded. 4But it is We Wfio kept sending .} means, but We revealed that to you and sent you to mankind as a Messenger. 4&X it cX Cj} 4And you were not at the side ofAt-Tur when We called.} Qatadah said that: 4&X >! JjX cX Cj} 4And you were not at the side ofAt-Tfir when We did call.} refers to Musa, and this - and Allah knows best - is like the Ayah 4 \dXt ij L^jt ijiii cX Cj} 4And you were not on the western side (of the Mount), when We made clear to Musa the commandment,} Here Allah puts it in a different and more specific way by describing it as a call. This is like the Ayat i&S& iS& if)} 4And (remember) when your Lord called Musa} (26:10). ^ aljil fj j it i(^ iWheti his Lord called him in the sacred valley of Tuwa} (79:16). jjX '- X& 4And We called him from the right side of At-Tur, and made him draw near to Usfor a talk with him} (19:52). o* &ij}

Al-Oasas (48 - 51) (Part-20 rst ifi'fr J^Sl' I.i tgSHEii ^ Messengers^ (4:165). 4^ jJL(jji ^& ;db^ ' *' '< /// /""* V/- ^ ""^ ^ / >/ / jjylij^ L "Cj(> l5 Jjl iil(Isjlli *jj GjJ*t5^ j oy"j4l) fyfrj*o^V.^-s^Lfe!j^Sj ^ N^ij^LoV|tAj^=3\ fr'C 1 v-i?31 1 i-'V " -'" -t' *Vi <" 4-31 ' Oi /a* cf (-> <^ri yi ^ fit C ij5ys AjJ&j J^rt f&r & 40 People of the Scriphire! Now has come to you Our Messenger making (things) clear unto you, after a break in (the series of) Messen- gers, lest you say: There came unto us no bringer of glad tidings and no warner." But now has come unto you a bringer of glad tidings and a Warner^ (5:19). And there are many similar Ayat. * &t jtt&s- J4 1 tsrf |Ujt fyy ^jj\ H jZa Hf jlll Lx f* tfj.jS X* j*) 'JlSj Ir-fi jJ c^j j&ti j/. *; ,.' . jj A^ixX, J^ =" u) < uii; j53j it^ 'J at <<,) at^ ^ gt#^: ^ jj3t fi 448. Bid when the truth has come to than from Us, they say: Why is he not given the like ofwhat was given to Musa? Did they not disbelieve in that which was given to Musa of old? They say : "Two kinds of magic, each helping the other!" And they say: Verily, in both we are disbelievers." 449. Say: Then bring a Book from Allah, which is a better

guide tlwn these two, that I may follow it, if you are truthful."} 450. But if they answer you not, then know that they only fallow their own lusts. And who is more astray than one who fallows his own lusts, without guidance from Allah? Verily, Allah guides not the people who are wrongdoers. 451 . And indeed now We have conveyed the Word to them, in order that they may remember. The stubborn Response ofthe Disbelievers Allah tells us that if people were to be punished before proof was established against them, they would use the excuse that no Messenger came to them, but when the truth did come to them through Muhammad jfe, in their stubbornness, disbelief, ignorance and misguided thinking, they said: 4Why is he not given tire like ofwhat was given to Musa?} Meaning - and Allah knows best - many signs like the staff, the hand, the flood, the locusts, the lice, the frogs, the blood, the destruction of crops and fruits - which made things difficult for the enemies of Allah - and the parting of the sea, the clouds (following the Children of Israel in the wilderness and) shading them, the manna and quails, and other clear signs and definitive proof, miracles which Allah wrought at the hands of Musa as evidence and proof against Fir awn and his chiefs and the Children of Israel. But all of this had no effect on Fir'awn and his chiefs; on the contrary, they denied Musa and his brother HarUn, as Allah tells us: 45&& 4\$ 4 & ojs; im:& ZZ-j&&& 4Have you come to us to turn us away from what we found our fathers fallowing, and that you two may have greatness in the land? We are not

going to believe you two!) (10:78) 4So they denied them both and became of those who were destroyed.} (23:48)

Al-Oasas (48 - 51) (Part-20) The Rebellious do not believe in Miracles Allah says here: Oi i 4Did they not disbelieve in that which was given to Musa of old?) Did not mankind disbelieve in those mighty signs which were given to Musa? Ab-4^" o!r*-? AThey say: Two kinds of magic, each helping the other!") cooperating or working one with the other. 4And they say: "Verily, in both we are disbelievers.") meaning, we disbelieve in each of them. Because of the close relationship between Musa and Hariin, mention of one includes the other. False Accusation that Musa and Hariin (peace be upon them both) practiced Magic Mujahid bin Jabr said, The Jews told Quraysh to say this to Muhammad then Allah said: Did they not disbelieve in that which was given to Musa of old? They say: Two kinds of magic, each helping the other! This refers to MQsa and Hariin, may the peace and blessings of Allah be upon them both, i'S+ik) ieach helping the other) i.e., working together and supporting one another. 111 This was also the view of Said bin Jubayr and Abu Razm that the phrase two kinds of magic referred to Musa and Hariin. 121 This is a good suggestion. And Allah knows best. The Response to this False Accusation A'Si&t o!^) At-Tabari 19:588.Tabari. 19:598.

down to His Prophets, there is no Book more perfect, more eloquent or more noble than the Book which He revealed to Muhammad jg, which is the Qur an. Next to it in status and greatness is the Book which Allah revealed to Musa bin Imran, which is the Book concerning which Allah says: 'jjU uOJJ Ij. "jj jja LJj (3yl 4'Ajj & #Jf j. c iVerily, We did send down the Tawrdh, therein was guidance and light, by which the Prophets, who submitted themselves to Allah's will, judged for the Jews. And the rabbis and the priests, for to them was entrusted the protection of Allah's Book, and they were witnesses thereto (5:44). The Injll was revealed as a continuation and complement of the Tawrah and to permit some of the things that had been forbidden to the Children of Israel. Allah says: 4 Sia fix* UJC \$ iThen bring a Book from Allah, which is a better guide than these two, that 1 mayfollow it, ifyou are truthful. meaning, in your efforts to refute the truth with false arguments. 4But if they answer you not,} means, *if they do not respond to what you tell them, and do not follow the truth, 4then know that they onlyfollow their own lusts.} means, with no basis or evidence. Cj*J7 4And who is more astray than one who follows his own lusts, without guidancefrom Allah?} means, with no guidance taken from the Book of Allah. fjai y sif c} 4Verily, Allah guides not the people who are wrongdoers.}

4Jj*i' pi ilij jii} 4And indeed now We have conveyed the Word} Mujahid said: We have explained the Word to them. As- Suddi said something similar. 121 Qatadah said: Allah is saying, He has told them what He did in the past and what He will do in the future. i'o iin order that they may remember.}^ Mujahid and others said: 4We have conveyed the Word means, to Quraysh. j' lllC ijlli jfjc. lijj I|pd s3j pi pi^' ""if : ! >" v* i - * rf' r-iU uAl/4 j*-^***' 0>>>> yuL-* ^ w Ul Ujj pj t5 ye& ^ ^ . Those to whom We gave the Scripture before it, they believe in it.} 453. And when it is recited to them, they say: We believe in it. Verily, it is the truth from our Lord. Indeed even before it toe have been from Muslims."} 454. These will be given their reward twice over, because they are patient, and repel evil with good, and spend out ofivhat We have providedfor them.} 455. And when they hear evil vain talk, they withdrawfrom it and say: To us our deeds, and to you your deeds. Peace be to you. We seek not (the

way of) the ignorant."} The Believers among the People of the Book Allah tells us that the pious scholars among the People of the Tabari 19:593. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 9:2987. Tabari 19:593. At-Tabari 19:594.

Al-Oasas (52 - 55) (Part-20) Book believe in the Qur'an, as He says: j*- -y* C/ji'4 iThose to whom We gave the Book recite it as it should be recited, they are the ones who believe therein (2:121). &4 Vipi& e;A i-j; 4&U" 4And there are, certainly, among the People of the Scripture, those who believe in Allah and in that which has been revealed to you, and in that which has been revealed to them, humbling themselves before Allah (3:199). jyy' 4 Verily, those who were given knowledge before it, when it is recited to them, fall down on their faces in humble prostration. And they say: Glory be to our Lord! Truly, the promise of our Lord must be fulfilled."} (17:107-108) ll tjllS \yS\ oi\$S iiji 4And you will find the nearest in love to the believers those who say : "We are Christians."} until: 4so write us down among the witnesses} (5:82-83). Said bin Jubayr said, This was revealed concerning seventy priests who were sent by An-Najashi (ruler of Ethiopia). When they came to the Prophet he recited to them: 4Ya Sin. By the Qur'an, full of wisdom.} (36:1-2) until he completed the Surah. They began to weep, and they embraced Islam. These other Ayat were revealed concerning them: See volume one, the Tafsir of Surat Al-Baqarah (2:121) for comments on this Ayah. 2 Ibn Abi Hatim 9 :2988 . This is a Mursal narration

422 Tafsir Ibn Kathir ft &" (ji'i jit?6 dk dviy^" -* (J> -*C" ^ -jIj o; US* \1[fcj (jr iThose to whom We gave the Scripture before it, they believe in it. And when it is recited to them, they say: "We believe in it. Verily, it is the truth from our Lord. Indeed even before it we have been from

Messenger of Allah jg as he was riding, and he said some very beautiful words, including the following: jjLii y,j Qp U dlpj 0 U dj Jz'y di Ji (d-' j blip U dlpj 0 U dj di ^ "Whoever among the people of the two Books becomes Muslim, he will have his reward twice, and he has the same rights and duties as we do. Whoever among the idolators becomes Muslim will have one reward, and he has the same rights and duties as we do." Allah's saying: 4and repel evil with good,} means, they do not respond to evil in kind, rather they forgive and overlook. iand spend out of what We have provided for them.} meaning, from the lawful provision that We have given them, they spend on their families and relatives as they are required to do, and they pay Zakah and give voluntary charity. Ij%A 'Jj& \JAnd when they hear evil vain talk, they withdraw from it} meaning, they do not mix with the people who indulge in such talk, rather they do as Allah says: !v* iv iand if they pass by some evil vain talk, they pass by it with dignity} (25:72). 4and they say: To us our deeds, and to you your deeds. Peace be to you. We seek not (the way of) the ignorant."} means, if some foolish person speaks to them in a foolish manner and says something to which it does not befit them to Ahmad 5:259.

respond, they turn away from him and do not respond in kind with ugly speech. They never say anything but good words. Allah says of them that they say: && 1 13} \$To us our deeds, and to you your deeds. Peace be to you. We seek not (the way of) the ignorant.} meaning, we do not seek the way of the ignorant and we do not like it. ft% '& * * V \$ is - k"- | E' iSi gi; V ^"A/S,irgPl > SjJ fr, lijj 456. Wri/y, you guide not whom you like, but Allah guides whom He wills. And He knows best those who are the guided.} 457. And they say: "If we follow the guidance with you, we would be snatched away from our land." Have We not established for them a secure sanctuary, to which are brought fruits of all kinds, a provision from Ourselves, but most of them know not.} Allah guides Whom He wills Allah says to His

Messenger jg: O Muhammad: iVerily, you guide not whom you like} meaning, The matter does not rest with you; all that you have to do is convey the Message, and Allah will guide whom He wills, and His is the ultimate wisdom, as He says: "i*idt Jj 4Not upon you is their guidance, but Allah guides whom He wills.} (2:272) cJjTfr jjj \Zj} 4And most of mankind will not believe even if you desire it eagerly.} (12:103) This Ayah is even more specific than the following:

'< '1J 4Verily, you guide not whom you like, but Allah guides whom He wills. And He knows best those who are the guided> meaning: Allah knows best who deserves to be guided and who deserves to be misguided. It was recorded in the Two Sahihs that this Ayah was revealed concerning Abu Talib, the paternal uncle of the Messenger of Allah He used to protect the Prophet, support him and stand by him. He loved the Prophet jg dearly, but this love was a natural love, i.e., bom of kinship, not a love that was bom of the fact that he was the Messenger of Allah jgg. When he was on his deathbed, the Messenger of Allah jg called him to Faith and to enter Islam, but the decree overtook him and he remained a follower of disbelief, and Allah s is the complete wisdom. Az-Zuhri said: Said bin Al-Musayyib narrated to me that his father, Al-Musayyib bin Hazan Al-Makhzumi, may Allah be pleased with him, said: When Abu Talib was dying, the Messenger of Allah 5*g came to him and found Abu Jahl bin Hisham and Abdullah bin Abi Umayyah bin Al-Mughirah with him. The Messenger of Allah jg said: " j4 i* iu' las \ V :ji JU u" "0 my uncle, say La ilaha illalldh, a word which I may use as evidence in yourfavor before Allah [in the Hereafter] . Abu Jahl bin Hisham and Abdullah bin Abi Umayyah said: O Abu Talib, will you leave the religion of Abdul-Muttalib? The Messenger of Allah 4s, kept urging him to say La ilaha illalldh, and they kept saying, Will you leave the religion of Abdul-Muttalib? - until, at the very end, he said that he was on the religion of Abdul-Muttalib, and he refused to say La ilaha illalldh. The Messenger of Allah said: "aiip Sii U vlil 4)1 Allah, I shall certainly seekforgivenessfor you unless 1 am told not toj Then Allah revealed:

426 Tafsir Ibn Kathlr ilt is not (proper) for the Prophet and those who believe to ask Allah's forgiveness for the idolators, even though they be of kin (9:113). And there was revealed concerning Abu Talib the Ayah, if&s; \} 4Verily, you guide not whom you like, but Allah guides whom He wills.} This was recorded (by Al-Bukhari and Muslim) from the Hadith of Az-Zuhri. 11 The Excuses made by the People of Makkah for not believing, and the Refutation of Their Excuses 4And they say: "Ifwefollow the guidance with you, we would be snatched awayfrom our land."} Allah tells us that this is the excuse which was given by some of the disbelievers for not following true guidance. They said to the Messenger of Allah jg: w, *r isxI' 4If we follow the guidance with you, we would be snatched awayfrom our land.}, meaning, *we are afraid that if we follow the message of guidance that you have brought, and go against the pagan Arab tribes around us, they will seek to do us harm and wage war against us, and they may snatch us away from wherever we may be. Allah said in response to them: JZs, S p\$} 4Have We not establishedfor them a secure sanctuary,} meaning, the excuse they give is a lie and is false, because Allah has put them in a secure city and a venerated sanctuary which has been safe from the time it was built - how could this sanctuary be safe for them when they believed in disbelief and Shirk, and how could it not be safe for them when they Al-BOri8:365, Muslim 1:54. !*S"

Al-Oasas (58 - 59) (Part-20) become Muslims and follow the truth? 4to which are broughtfruits of all kinds,} means, all kinds of fruits from the surrounding regions, from At-Ta if and elsewhere. Similarly,

the people of Makkah engaged in trade and other goods also came to their city. & at 4a provision from Ourselves, but most of them know not.} - this is why they said what they said. o; tit \$>} 4fA" vl Jsii-U^=" ^ .tf. 458. And how many a town have We destroyed, which was thankless for its means of livelihood! And those are their dwellings, which have not been inhabited after them except a little. And verily, We have been the heirs.} 459. And never will your Lord destroy the towns until He sends to their mother town a Messenger reciting to them Our Ayat. And never would We destroy the towns unless the people thereof are wrongdoers The Destruction of Towns, which are not destroyed until Evidence is established against them Referring to the people of Makkah, Allah says: tii {&} 4And how many a town have We destroyed, which was thankless for its means of livelihood!} They were arrogant transgressors who denied Allah's blessing of giving them ample provision. This is like the Ayah, jS' J* \jjz, 45jj \+JC XL 4And Allah puts forward the example of a township, that dwelt secure and well-content: its provision coming to it in abundance from every place} until:

428 Tafsir Ibtī Kathir 4 > 4So the torment overtook them while they were wrongdoers> (16:112-113) Allah said: 4*i) iAnd those are their dwellings, which have not been inhabited after them except a little. Their land became empty and desolate, and you can see nothing but their dwellings. iAnd verily, We have been the heirs. Their towns became ruins, with none remaining. Then Allah tells us of His justice and that He does not destroy anyone unjustly; on the contrary. He destroys those whom He destroys after establishing proof against them. So, he says: ti '-V. (5"- ii > olf iAnd never will your Lord destroy the towns until He sends to their mother town i.e., Makkah - 4& ia Messenger reciting to them Our Ayat> This indicates that the Unlettered Prophet, Muhammad jg was sent from the Mother of Cities as a Messenger to all cities and towns, Arab and non-Arab alike. This is like the Ayat. 4Q jij&Si fi iso that you may warn the Mother of Towns and all those around ify (6:92). 4dJr fSs*& % <&, ji> iSay: "O mankind! Verily, I am sent to you all as the Messenger of Allah (7:158),

Al-Oasas (59 - 60) (Part-20) iThat I may therewith warn you and whomsoever it may reach.) (6:19) Si j&i iZ 4"XJ*y jdS ibut those of the sects that reject it, the Fire will be their promised meeting place.) (11:17). i-ej Cit sy Jj 4And there is not a town but We shall destroy it before the Day of Resurrection, or punish it with a severe torment.) (17:58). Allah tells us that He will destroy every town before the Day of Resurrection, as He says: wssm *p Site Jufyj &&&#{&\$k&32&& k Jj/ /\s. * . ^ - "J * a,,d&^ >*> j; r 4And We never punish until We have sent a Messenger.) (17:15). Allah has sent the Unlettered Prophet to all the towns (all of mankind), because he has been sent to the Mother of Cities, their source to which they all return. It was recorded in the Two Sahihis that the Prophet sfe said: fJ-^ J) Ji.: "I have been sent to the red and the blackM 1 :370.

Al-Oasas (60-61) (Part-20 is better and more lasting.) (87:16-17). The Messenger of Allah jgg said: ^ as 'i/j iy}\ cjJi suaji a "ui \y>: tiu "Bi/ Allah, the life of this world in comparison to the Hereafter is as if one of you were to dip his finger in the sea; let him see what comes back to Allah's saying: iHave you then no sense?} means, do those who prefer this world to the Hereafter have no sense? in ."At v '> A 'Y .1 /s" "#* 'ils he whom We /we promised an excellent promise - which he will find true - like him whom We have made to enjoy the luxuries of the life of the world, then on the Day of Resurrection, he will be among those brought up?} Is the one who believes in the reward which Allah has promised in return for righteous deeds, which he will undoubtedly attain, like one who disbelieves in the meeting

with Allah and in His promises and threats? He is only enjoying a few days in this life, in 4then on the Day of Resurrection, he will be among those brought up.} Mujahid and Qatadah said: He will be among those who are punished. It was said that this was revealed concerning the Messenger of Allah and Abu Jahl, or that it was revealed concerning Hamzah and Ali, and Abu Jahl.'2 * Both views were narrated from Mujahid. The apparent meaning is that it is 4:230.Tabari 19:604, 605.Tabari 19:604, 605.

more general than that. This is like the Ayah where Allah describes a believer in Paradise looking out at his companion who is in Hell, and saying: iSj ccSJ jjj '^J^ iHad it not been for the grace ofmy Lord, I would certainly have been among those broughtforth (to Hell).} (37:57) And Allah says: pri ibut the Jinn know well that they have indeed to appear (before Him)}(37:158). 462. And (remember) the Day when He will call to than and say: "Where are My (so-called) partners whom you used to assert?"} 463. Those about whom the Word will have been fulfilled will say: "Our Lord! These are they whom we led astray. We led them astray, as we were astray ourselves. We declare our innocence before You. It was not us they worshipped."} 464. And it will be said: "Call upon your partners," and they will call upon them, but they will give no answer to them, and they will see the torment. Ifonly they had been guided!} 465. And the Day He will call to them, and say: "What answer gave you to the Messengers?"} 466. Then the news ofa good answer will be obscured to them on that Day, and they will not be able to ask one another.} 467. But as for him who repented, believed, and did righteous deeds, then perhaps he will be among those who are successful.}

434 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir iAnd they have taken gods besides Allah, that they might give them honor, power and glory. Nay, but they will deny their worship ofthem, and become opponents to them.) (19:81-82) u* (*^J 4JJ 3!, jil ((T/% 5\$ iSjJ who is more astray than one who calls besides Allah, who will not answer him till the Day of Resurrection, and who are (even) unaware of their calls to them? And when mankind are gathered, they will become their enemies and will deny their worshipping.) (46:5-6). Ibrahim Al-Khalla, peace be upon him, said to his people: _ tj-di 4 (^h-> WjS jrf oj3 Jt JJu* \) 4you have taken idols instead ofAllah. The love between you is only in the life of this world, but on the Day of Resurrection, you shall disown each other, and curse each other.) (29:25) rti * \\r, \id\ sA\ iWhen those who were followed disown those who followed, and they see the torment, then all their relations will be cut off from them) until: iAnd they will never get out of the Fire.) (2:166-167). Allah says: . i0&W&) iAnd it will be said (to them): "Call upon your partners,) meaning, to save you from the predicament you are in, as you hoped that they would do in this world. ^ Ifc jfl&S5 i iand they will call upon them, but they will give no answer to them, and they will see the torment.) means, they will realize for sure that they are inevitably destined for the Fire. His saying: 3)

ilf only they had been guided!} means, when they see the punishment with their own eyes, they will wish that they had been among the guided in this world. This is like the Ayah, ^ Uuij > jUjwi tfj' lA Syi V* (*l> ijLk* jQ' ' M) f/ie Dai/ He u// say: "Ca// those partners ofMine whom you claimed. Then they will cry unto them, but they will not answer them, and We shall put a Mawbiq (a barrier) between them. And the criminals, shall see the Fire and apprehend that they have to fall in it. And they willfind no way ofescapefrom there.} (18:52-53) Their attitude towards the Messengers on the Day of Resurrection 4And the Day He will call to them, and say: "What answer gave you to the Messengers? } The first call will be concerning the issue of Tawhid, which includes evidences of the prophethood - *What was your

response to the Messengers who were sent to you? How did you deal with them? This is like the questions which will be asked of a person in his grave: who is your Lord? who is your Prophet? and what is your religion? The believer will testify that there is no God except Allah and that Muhammad is His servant and Messenger, but the disbelievers will say, Oh, oh, I do not know. So he will have no answer on the Day of Resurrection except to remain silent, because whoever is blind in this world (i.e., does not see Allah's signs and believes not in Him), will be blind in the Hereafter, and more astray. Allah says: 4Then the news of a good answer will be obscured to them on that Day, and they will not be able to ask one another.} Mujahid said: The proof will be obscured from them, 111 so they will not be able to ask one another for help by virtue of m At-Tabari 19:607.

their blood ties. Allah's saying: J ,y1y 4But as for him who repented, believed, and did righteous deeds,} means, in this world. 4then perhaps he will be among those who are successful.} means, on the Day of Resurrection. And the word; perhaps (Asa), when used in reference to Allah, may He be exalted, implies that the thing described will inevitably come to pass, and this will undoubtedly happen by the grace and mercy of Allah. % 'Ji v i\% Uj&& 4s \$ bb% &Vf 4 ii 468. And your Lord creates whatsoever He wills and chooses, no choice have they. Glorified is Allah, and exalted above all that they associate.} 469. And your Lord knows what their breasts conceal, and what they reveal.} 470. And He is Allah; La ildha ilia Huwa, His is the praise in the first and in the last, and His is the decision, and to Him shall you be returned.} Allah Alone is the One Who has the Power of Creation, Knowledge and Choice Allah tells us that He is the only One Who has the power to create and make decisions, and there is no one who can dispute with Him in that or reverse His judgement. His saying: 4X%3 4And your Lord creates whatsoeverHe wills and chooses,} means, whatever He wills, for what He wills, happens; and what He does not will, does not happen. All things, good and

Al-Oasas (68 - 70) (Part-20) bad alike, are in His Hands and will return to Him. ik,'&p& \< =" C} }no choice have they.} is a negation, according to the correct view. This is like the Ayah, ot WP us^ li i iyy % </&, j ilt is not for a believer, man or woman, when Allah and His Messenger have decreed a matter that they should have any option in their decision} (33:36). Then Allah says: 4 - i' pi)J-i> 'J*y & it-" 4 } And your Lord knows what their breasts conceal, and what they reveal.} He knows what is hidden in their hearts, just as He knows what they do openly. ^& / z-' 3^)' j-' 4/f is f/ie same whether any of you conceals his speech or declares it openly, whether he be hid by night or goes forth freely by day.} (13:10). }And He is Allah; Ld ilaha ilia Huwa,} meaning, He is unique in His divinity, for none is to be worshipped besides Him, and there is no lord who can create what he wills and chooses besides Him. } His is the praise, in thefirst and in the last,} in all that He does. He is to be praised for His justice and wisdom. 4j iJ' }His is the decision,} that none can put back, because of His might, power, wisdom and mercy.

438 TafsTr Ibn Kathir iatid to Him shall you be returned.} means, all of you on the Day of Resurrection, and everyone will be re-warded or punished according to his deeds, good and evil alike, and absolutely none of their deeds will be concealed from Him. & js? 4 23 \$} 2. 4 &2 \$ =4 = & j* aJ 2\$ \$ & kfi ill o] il S . "\$l n >> i- i * ' " JJ; ["-4r="- 4l)l jic Aj] (> \U b6 /Jhj,/ /*" {> / ,/ I !> / >> / /< < *ALi* at aj _A+Dij 471. Say: "TV// me! IfAllah made the night continuousfor you till the Day of Resurrection, which god besides Allah could bring you light? Will you not then hear?"} 472. Say: "Tell me! IfAllah made the

day continuous for you till the Day of Resurrection, which god besides Allah could bring you night wherein you rest? Will you not then see?"} 473. It is out of His mercy that He has made for you the night and the day that you may rest therein and that you may seek of His bounty - and in order that you may be grateful.}

Al-Oasas (71 - 73) (Part-20 Night and Day are among the Blessings of Allah and are Signs of Tawhid Allah reminds His servants of His favors towards them by subjugating for them the night and day, without which they could not survive. He explains that if He made the night continuous, lasting until the Day of Resurrection, that would be harmful for them and would cause boredom and stress. So He says: jfi ijj if} i which god besides Allah could bring you light?} meaning, with which you could see things and which would bring you relief? &} i Will you not then hear?} Then Allah tells us that if He had made the day continuous, lasting until the Day of Resurrection, that would also be harmful for them and their bodies would get tired from so much movement and activity. Allah says: i> | ii' j* j-} i which god besides Allah could bring you night wherein you rest?} meaning, to rest from your work and activity. rf; &} i Will you not then see? It is out of His mercy} towards you, i that He has made for you the night and the day} He created both, 'J&%} i that you may rest therein} during the night, i and that you may seek of His bounty} during the day, by traveling, moving about and working.

i and in order that you may be grateful.} So that you may give thanks to Allah by performing all kinds of acts of worship at night and during the day. Whoever misses something during the night can make it up during the day, and vice versa. This is like the Ayah, i ' } J==0b o' i'J dj j4' 4 yob i And He it is Who has put the night and the day in succession, for such who desires to remember or desires to show his gratitude.} (25:62). And there are many similar Ayat iil j^=> at ? (Jjfr (4* j- *ii j\ J [& (&*/. !>*- " d*" 474. And the Day when He will call to them, and will say: Where are My (so-called) partners, whom you used to assert?"} 475. And We shall take out from every nation a witness, and We shall say: "Bring your proof." Then they shall know that the truth is with Allah, and the lies which they invented will disappear from them.} Rebuking the Idolaters This is another call by way of rebuke for those who worshipped other gods besides Allah. The Lord, may He be exalted, will call to them before all the witnesses, and will say: 4&& '& 4Where are My (so-called) partners, whom you used to assert?} meaning, in this world. 4And We shall take out from every nation a witness,} Mujahid said, This means a Messenger. f&" s. 'Jd At-Tabari 19:614.

} and We shall say : "Bring your proof."} meaning, of the truth of your claim that Allah had partners. any ik 3 i Then they shall know that the truth is with Allah,} meaning, that there is no god besides Him. Then they will not speak and they will not be able to find any answer. ijii^ if j} 4 and the lies which they invented to ill disappear from them.} they will vanish and will be of no benefit to them. as St E S; i^t" os Si^ v sif l\ 2 v # ju it .1 E2-^ Ciif^ JLiG jQt iit ^uSt; 4 w.uiaGJ' 4-^; } tjiVl j jElllf yj -oil 476. Verily, Qariin was of Musa's people, but he behaved arrogantly towards them. And We gave him of the treasures, that of which the keys would have been a burden to a body of strong men. Remember when his people said to him: "Do not exult. Verily, Allah likes not those who exult."} 4J7 . But seek, with that which Allah has bestowed on you, the home of the Hereafter, and forget not your portion of lawful enjoyment in this world; and be generous as Allah has been generous to you, and seek not mischief in the land. Verily Allah likes not the mischief-makers."} Qarun and His People s exhortation It was

recorded that Ibn Abbas said: oi => iifu iVerily, Qarun was ofMusa's people,} He was the son of his paternal uncle. 111 This was also theview of Ibrahim An-Nakha I, Abdullah bin Al-Harith bin m Ibn Abi Hatim 9 :3005.

His saying: SS \Li i^if ifcill 4Bid seek, with that which Allah has be- stowed on you, the home of the Hereafter, andfor- get not your portion of lawful enjoyment in this world;} means, use this great wealth and immense blessing Allah has given you to worship your Lord and draw closer to Him by doing a variety of good deeds which will earn you reward in this world and the Hereafter. 40j)' iand forget not your portion of lawful enjoyment in this world;} That which Allah has permitted of food, drink, clothing, dwelling places and women. Your Lord has rights over you, your self has rights over you, your family has rights over you, and your visitors have rights over you. So give each of them their due. }and be generous as Allah has been generous to you,} Be generous to His creatures, as He has been generous to you. O 4 scarg%} iand seek not mischief in the land.} meaning: do not let your aim & tgsaga ^ (.Hi > -'A'*" -r L. Q 1 S. iV A. - t . ^ ^ . > , ' -tif ^ & sgssjk*{\$

* Li 4He said: "This has been given to me only because of the knowledge I possess."} He said: Were it not for the fact that Allah is pleased with me and knows my virtue, He would not have given me this wealth. And He said: 4fo; <i > - it aijil ji iii fo} 4Did he not know that Allah had destroyed before him generations, men who were stronger than him in might and greater in the amount they had collected?} 1^ This is what those who have little knowledge say when they see a person whom Allah has granted a lot of wealth; they say that if he did not deserve it, Allah would not have given it to him. z&a Gif i Si JU^ j^ & 'fpf &%\$ 4* p-% gj Jtfj & -ftA^ * '< V_> Lai 479. So, /jo went forth before his people in his finery. Those who were desirous of the life of the world, said: "Ah, would that we had the like ofwhat Qarun has been given! Verily, he is the owner ofa greatfortune."} 480. But those who had beat given knowledge said: "Woe to you! The reward of Allah is better for those who believe and do righteous deeds, and this none shall attain except the patient."} How Qarun went forth in His Finery, and His People s Comments Allah tells us how Qarun went forth one day before his people with his magnificent regalia; wearing his fine clothes, accompanied by. his fine horses, his servants and retinue. When those whose desires and inclinations were for the world saw his adornments and splendor, they wished that they could have the same as he had been given, and said: m Al-Tabari 19:626.

i yiA c& 13 4A/i, would f/wf we /iod die like ofwhat Qdriin has been given! Verily, he is the owner ofa greatfortune.} meaning, he is very lucky and has a great share in this world. When the people of beneficial knowledge heard this, they said to them: 4'A** lMj Q jif 4r 4Woe to you! The reward of Allah is better for those who believe and do righteous deeds,} Allah s reward to His believing, righteous servants in the Hereafter is better than what you see, as is reported in the authentic Hadith: 'Jj viJtw ll\ Nj of; N U oeJUJl ojfff :JU: lil owl of ^ : 'j s~i 3^ uAllah has preparedfor His righteous servants what no eye has seen, no ear has heard, and the heart of a human cannot comprehend. Recite, if you wish: 4N0 person knows what is kept hidden for them ofjoy as a reward for what they used to do.}* (32: 17).m 4\& \$} iand this none shall attain except the patient.} As-Suddi said: None shall reach Paradise except for the patient - as if this were the completion of the statement made by the people of knowledge. ' Ibn Jarir said, This applies only to those who patiently forsake the love of this world, seeking the Hereafter. It is as if this is part ofwhat the people of knowledge said, but it is made part of

the Words of Allah, stating this fact. ' < / , ' if . > v >> ^ ' tit / / \ Cj* Uj aui gy* # CK la i i ;i .. Xy FathAl-B&ri 8:375. ' Ibn Abi Hatim 9:3016.) FathAl-Bdri 10 :269

& J21 & 0jJ>; 42CMgk 4lt y /Ot&y ^ ii-wl tie iii ly* J Vj) jJkiy j; *Llj 4S2 . So, We caused the earth to swallow him and his dwelling place. Then he had no group to help him against Allah, nor was he one of those who could save themselves 482 . And those who desired his position the day before, began to say: "Know you not tltat it is Allah Who expands the provision or restricts it to whomsoever He pleases of His servants. Had it not been that Allah was Gracious to us, He could have caused the earth to swallow us up! Know you not that the disbelievers will never be successful."} HowQarunandHis DwellingPlacewereswallowedupby the Earth After telling us about Qartin s conceit and pride in his adornments, and how he was arrogant towards his people and transgressed against them, Allah then tells us how he and his dwelling place were swallowed up by the earth. This was also reported in the Sahih by

Resurrection This version was recorded only by Ahmad, and its chain of narration is Hasan (sound). i /I iA*" " Li^ iThen he had no group to help him against AIMi, nor was he one of those who could save themselves.} means, his wealth, group, servants and retinue were of no avail to him; they could not protect him from the wrath and vengeance of Allah. Nor could he help himself or save himself. There was no one to help him, neither himself nor anybody else. His People learned a Lesson from Him being swallowed up Allah s saying: iAnd those who had desired his position the day before,} means, those witnessed him with his finery and said: iThose who were desirous of the life of the world, said: "Ah, would that we luid the like of what Qariin has been given! Verily, he is the owner ofa greatfortune."} When he was swallowed up in the earth, they began to say: 4jAL> i-A ce A. A, Axif } 4Know you not that it is Allah Who expands the provision or restricts it to whomsoever He pleases ofHis servants.} Wealth does not indicate that Allah is pleased with its owner, for Allah gives and withholds, allows times of difficulty and times of ease, raises and lowers, His is the most complete wisdom and most convincing proof. According to a Hadlth narrated by Ibn MasMd, m Ahmad 3 :40

SjJ y. jdi jjs ai lj jui }Jzz jui a"i o>" w j; v'5 & lAllah has allotted character among you just as He has alioted your provision. Allah gives wealth to those whom He loves and those whom He does not love, but He gives Faith only to those whom He /oues." 1 clliJ (iit 3 V\$} 4Had it not been that Allah was Gracious to us, He could have caused the earth to szoallow us up!} meaning, were it not for the kindness and grace of Allah towards us, we could have been swallowed up by the earth just as he was swallowed up, because we wanted to be like him. i&p '& i iKnow you not that the disbelievers will never be successful.} He was a disbeliever, and the disbelievers will never be successful before Allah in this world or in the Hereafter. k:UPi. tdb a 4\$ * id,i &j} U "Jl Cjli-Sll iuult tfci |>*J Ifi* j*i- /(!" ii-it Kt-483 . That is the home of the Hereafter, We s/ia// assign to those who do not want to exalt themselves in the land nor cause corruption. And the good end isfor those who have Taqwa.} 484. Whosoever brings good, he shall have the better thereof; and whosoever brings evil, then those who do evil deeds will only be requitedfor what they used to do.} The Blessings ofthe Hereafter for the humble Believers Allah tells us that He has made the home of the Hereafter, and its eternal delights which will never change or fade away, for His believing, humble servants who do not rebel against the truth with pride and oppression in the land. They do not 1:387.

exalt themselves above the creatures of Allah, arrogantly oppressing them and spreading corruption among them. Ikrimah said that this phrase referred to haughtiness and arrogance. 1 ^ Ibn Jurayj said: 4those who do not want to exalt themselves in the land^ Arrogance and tyranny, 4'b v;> inor cause corruption committing sins. 121 Ibn Jarir recorded that Ali said, If a man wants the straps of his sandals to be better than the straps of his companion s sandals, then he is one ofthose referred to in the Ayah, \$3\$ ib Vj i;-jgtR jiS(iThat is the home of the Hereafter, We shall assign to those who do not want to exalt themselves in the land nor cause corruption. And the good end is far those who have Taqwdy3] This is understood to mean that if his intention is to show off and appear better than others, then that is to be condemned, as it was reported in the Sahih that the Prophet sgg said: J*^ ^ J* -b J*- oi Q\ ^rj\ It has been revealed to me that you should be humble to the extent that none ofyou boasts to others or mistreats others ."14 But if a person simply likes to look good, then there is nothing wrong with that. It was recorded that a man said: O Messenger of Allah, I like to have my garment looking good and my shoes looking good - is this a kind of arrogance? The Prophet |S said: At-Tabari 19:637. At-Tabari 19:637. At-Tabari 19:638. 4:2199.

Jr rw mm ^Oj^ Wus 0 ill o;oyJ'^ ^'oJ*. ojc;/^i0^joja i i/rr> 4 j-^- si oi ^ JUAJI oNo, /or AMaii is beautiful and loves beauty ...",1) And Allah says: it o# {Whosoever brings good,} meaning, on the Day of Resurrection, % Jfc {he shall have the better thereof;} meaning, the reward of Allah is bet- ter than the good deeds of His servant - how can it not be, when Allah has multi- plied it many times over? This is the posi- tion of generosity. Then Allah says: \y^ ^ {and whosoever brings evil, then those who do evil deeds will only be requitedfor what they used to do.} This is like the Ayah, {^ < &l jiJ '* > {And whoever brings an evil deed, they will be cast down on their faces in the Fire. (And it will be said to them) "Are you being recompensed anything except what you used to do?"} (27:90). This is the postition of generosity and justice. **' Muslim 1 :93.

452 Tafslr Ibn Kathir J* Irj iSxii ' o' Jj ji 2S) . <>< & aL& J,Jj cfit c,i^ v^**' - z ? o' lAy > <^iu> j 4 2 4 ijJ i> m i> y& Jii; Vj ^Jcs * \$ 4 v >': \$1 it g Sfj ^s^ vj dis 4s V) 4ii . Verify, He Who has given you the Qur'an, will surely bring you back to the return. Say: "My Lord is Aware ofhim who brings guidance, and ofhim who is in manifest error."} 486. And you were not expecting that the Book would be sent down to you, but it is a mercy from your Lord. So never be a supporter of the disbelievers .} 487 . And let them not turn you away from the Aydt of Allah after they have been sent down to you, and invite to your Lord and be not of idolaters.} 488. And invoke not any other god along with Allah, La ilaha ilia Huwa. Everything will perish save His Face. His is the decision, and to Him you shall be returned.} The Command to convey the Message ofTawhxd Here Allah commands His Messenger jg to convey the Message and recite the Qur an to people. He tells him that he will be brought back to the return, which is the Day of Resurrection, where he will be asked about the prophethood he was entrusted with. So Allah says: 4)C4 ^Xji\ Alxfc Jfft jJ l\} 4Verily, He Wlw has given you the Qur'an, will surely bring you back to the rehim.} meaning, the One Who has commanded you to put it into practice among mankind, 4}C41%} 4will surely bring you back to the return.} On the Day of Resurrection, where He will question you concerning that, as Allah said: K SJ '&}

Al-Oasas (85 - 88) (Part-20) iThen surely, We shall question those to whom it was sent and verily, We shall question the Messengers.} (7:6) Allah said: ISC # iSf 0 iOn the Day when Allah will gather the

Messengers together and say to them: "What was the response you received?"} (5:109). And He said: 4and the Prophets and the witnesses will be brought forward} (39:69) In his Tafsir of his Sahlh,

454 Tafstr Ibn Kathir after death, and to Paradise which will be his reward and his destiny for putting the Message of Allah into practice and conveying it to the humans and Jinns, and because he is the most perfect, most eloquent and most noble of all the creation of Allah. Allah s saying: 4 J* J j 'Z ij* pH frf iSay: "My Lord is Aware ofhim who brings guidance, and of him who is in manifest error. } means: Say, O Muhammad, to those among your people who oppose you and disbelieve you, among the idolators and those who follow them in their disbelief, My Lord knows best which of us, you or I, is rightly guided, and you will come to know for which of us will be the (happy) end in the Hereafter, and for which of us will be a good end and victoiy in this world and in the Hereafter . Then Allah reminds His Prophet the numerous blessings He granted to him and mankind by virtue of sending him to them: ^H) off J C,} iAnd you were not expecting that the Book would be sent down to you,} Before the revelation was sent down to you, you did not expect that revelation would be sent down to you. ibut it is a mercyfrom your Lord.} means, but revelation has been sent down to you from Allah as a mercy to you and to mankind because of you. Since Allah has granted you this great blessing, iSo never be a supporter} i.e., a helper, ipf the disbelievers.} rather, separate from them, hostility towards them and oppose them. Jju CZi)* (jP express your

iAnd let them not turn you away from the Ayat ofAllah after they have been sent down to you.} meaning, Do not let their opposition to you affect you or put people off from following your way; do not worry about that or pay any attention to it, for Allah will make your word supreme, will support your religion and will make the Message with which He has sent you prevail over all other religions. So He says: ms4 iand invite to your Lord} to worship your Lord Alone, with no partners or associates, 4S&X U&&W iand be not of idoiators.} ^And invoke not any other god along zuith Allah, there is no God but Him.} means, it is not appropriate to worship anything or anybody except Him, and divinity does not befit any except His glory. msifa& 4Everything will perish save His Face .} Here Allah is telling us that He is Eternal, Ever Lasting, Ever Living, Self-Sustaining, Who, although His creation dies, He will never die, as He says: ^Whatsoever is on it will perish. And the Face ofyour.Lordfull ofmajesty and Iwnor will remain forever.} (55:26-27). Allah used theword Face to refer to Himself, as He says here: ms'iifa.^!?) 4Everything will perish save His Face.} meaning, everything except Him. It was reported in the Sahth. via Abu Salamah that Abu Hurayrah said, The Messenger of Allah jg said: 3 JLU 'SS- t* -rJ ^ G

456 Tafsir Ibt Kathir "The truest word of a poet was the saying of Labid - indeed everything except Allah isfalse.s'11 ip5 i> iHis is the decision> means, dominion and control, and there is none who can reverse Hisjudgement or decision. i4& iand to Him you shall be returned.^ means, on the Day when you will be brought back, and He will reward or punish you according to your deeds: if they are good, then you will be rewarded, and if they are bad, then you will be punished.

Surah 29: Al-Ankabut

PDF pages 4323–4382

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4323–4340]

Opening The Tafsir of Surat Al-Ankabut (Chapter - 29) Which was revealed in Makkah In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. {Do people think that they will be left alone because they say: "We believe," and will not be tested.} 43. And We indeed tested those who were before them so that Allah will indeed know those who are true, and He will know those who are liars.} 44. Or think those who do evil deeds that they can outstrip Us? Evil is that which they judge!} The Believers are tested so that it may be known who is Sincere and who is Lying In the beginning of the Tafsir of Surat Al-Baqarah, we discussed the letters which appear at the beginning of some Surahs. {Do people think that they will be left alone because they say: "We believe," and will not be tested.} This is a rebuke in the form of a question, meaning that Allah will inevitably test His believing servants according to their level of faith, as it is recorded in the authentic Hadith. {Do people think that they will be left alone because they say: "We believe," and will not be tested.} This is a rebuke in the form of a question, meaning that Allah will inevitably test His believing servants according to their level of faith, as it is recorded in the authentic Hadith.

is the view of Ibn Abbas and others concerning phrases such as the Ayah, {Do people think that they will be left alone because they say: "We believe," and will not be tested.} (2:143).
111 Meaning, only to see - because seeing has to do with

what is there, but knowledge is broader than seeing, since it includes what is not present as well as what is. The Evil-doers cannot escape from Allah Allah said: {Or think those who do evil deeds that they can outstrip Us? Evil is that which they judge!} means, those who are not believers should not think that they will escape such trials and tests, for ahead of them lies a greater and more severe punishment. Allah says: {Or think those who do evil deeds that they can outstrip Us} meaning, escape from Us. Please note that these Ayat are usually translated with the meaning of Allah tests instead of will know. They are to be understood with that general meaning as well as the explanation above.

(5 - 8) Al-Ankabut (Part-20) Whoever does a righteous deed, the benefit of that deed will come back to him, for Allah has no need of the deeds of His servants, and even if all of them were to be as pious as the most pious man among them, that would not add to His dominion in the slightest. Allah says: {And whosoever strives, he strives only for himself. Verily, Allah stands not in need of any of the creatures.} Then Allah tells us that even though He has no need of His creatures, He is kind and generous to them. He will still give to those who believe and do righteous deeds the best of rewards, which is that He will expiate for them their bad deeds, and will reward them according to the best deeds that they did. He will accept the fewest good deeds and in return for one good deed will give anything between ten rewards and seven hundred, but for every bad deed, He will give only one evil merit, or even that He may overlook and forgive. This is like the Ayah, {Surely, Allah wrongs not even the

weight of a speck of dust, but if there is any good, He doubles it, and gives from Him a great reward. (4:40). And He says here: iThose who believe, and do righteous good deeds, surely, We shall expiate from them their evil deeds and We shall indeed reward them according to the best of that which they used to do.\$ cl Uj 48. And We have enjoined on man to be dutiful to his parents; but if they strive to make you associate with Me, which you

(10-11) Al- Ankabut (Part-20 gathered on the Day of Resurrection with those whom he loves, meaning, religious love. Allah says: 4 \jiSj \yX Sj# 4And for those who believe and do righteous good deeds, surely, We shall make them enter with the righteous.} In his Tafsir of this Ayah,

The Attitudes ofthe Hypocrites and theWays in which Allah tests People Allah mentions the descriptions of the liars who falsely claim faith with their lips, while faith is not firm in their hearts. When a test or trial comes in this world, they think that this is a punishment from Allah, so they leave Islam. Allah says: ojdtf alii jii-4 j liji iOfmankind are some who say: 'We believe in Allah.' Blit if they are made to suffer for Allah, they consider the trial of mankind as Allah's punishment;} Ibn Abbas said, Meaning that their trial is leaving Islam if they are made to suffer for Allah. This was also the view of others among the Salaf. This Ayah is like the Ayah, 4*< iAnd among mankind is he who worships Allah as it were upon the edge: ifgood befalls him, he is content therewith; but ifa trial befalls him, he turns back on hisface...} until: 4444 4d#} iThat is a strayingfar away} [22:1 1-121- Then Allah says: 4\$z 4&4 44} iand if victory comes from your Lord, they will say: Verily we were with you."} meaning, if victory comes from your Lord, O Muhammad, and there are spoils of war, these people will say to you, *We were with you,' i.e., we are your brothers in faith. This is like the Ayat U&bX& jfes J3 jff rj&4 4 <&4 - jM} 4kt& -A itm * iThose who wait and watch about you; if you gain a victory m At-Tabari 20 :13.

(10 - 11) Al-'Ankabut (Part-20) from Allah, they say: "Were we not with you? But if the disbelievers gain a success, they say (to them): "Did we not gain mastery over you and did we not protect you from the believers?) (4:141). ^Perhaps Allah may bring a victory or a decision according to His will. Then they will become regretful for what they have been keeping as a secret in themselves) (5:52). And Allah tells us about them here: iand if victory comes from your Lord, they will say: "Verily, we were with you) Then Allah says: jjii, ^ Lj jJeL ft j\} ils not Allah Best Aware of what is in the breasts of the creatures?) meaning, does Allah not know best what is in their hearts and what they store secretly within themselves, even though outwardly they may appear to be in agreement with you? ' 4\$ ft iAnd indeed Allah knows those who believe, and verily He knows the hypocrites.) Allah will test the people with calamities and with times of ease, so that He may distinguish the believers from the hypocrites, to see who will obey Allah both in times of hardship and of ease, and who will obey Him only when things are going in accordance with their desires. As Allah says: iAnd surely, We shall try you till We test those who strive hard and the patient, and We shall test yourfacts.) (47:31) After the battle of Uhud, with its trials and tribulations for the Muslims, Allah said: ii&i UUpU ^ U ft tit 6)

itf& ^And no friend will ask a friend (about his condition), though they shall be made to see one another) (70:10-11). iAnd verily, they shall bear their own loads, and other loads besides their own.) Here Allah tells us that those who call others to disbelief and misguidance will, on the Day of Resurrection, bear their own sins and the sins of others, because of the people they misguided. Yet that will not detract from the burden of those other people in the slightest, as Allah says: A. iThat they may

bear their own burdens in full on the Day of Resurrection, and also of the burdens of those whom they misled without knowledge) (16:25). In the Sahih, it says: jlp ja fj 4' J* J ~t j4-^' Ijl ^-*** ^ O' Ja fill 34 Jt S* jVS Iji b^~S J-frj'5 ' bi b^~^ jA bf ^ ^Whoever calls others to true guidance, will have a reward like that of those who follow him until the Day of Resurrection, without it detracting from their reward in the slightest. Whoever calls others to misguidance, will have a burden of sin like that of those who follow him until the Day of Resurrection, without it detracting from their burden in the slightest, s 11 In the Sahih, it also says: & -Ja Jjt a* ^ "jail person is killed unlawfully, but a share of the guilt will be upon the first son of Adam, because he was the first one to l1 ' Muslim 4 :2060

initiate the idea of killing another. "(1) verily, they shall be questioned on the Day of Resurrection about that which they used to fabricate means, the lies they used to tell and the falsehood they used to fabricate. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Umamah, may Allah be pleased with him, said that the Messenger of Allah jgg conveyed the Message with which he was sent, then he said: Jliii ja *i& ^ (li y jlli tjs lii p ijiik J4-j j* -*i If*. sjf \+5\ i-Ul * ^ o* XP uvt j\ U12 3 cJis if p ^ A > 1 / J << A , 9 t * t * t + > + ,, y) X Uj-ls-o jylji Vi ijjLls- cT^^ \j~a" ' .dy^ loU^Atll ^ ji_j t C^>- 14^* V i g - "4lip U^LjI-U ja Ijisi : J_jij <.ZjJ~ jj i^Ju* ft- ^Beware of injustice, for Allah will swear an oath of the Day of Resurrection and will say: By My glory and majesty, no injustice xoill be overlooked today." Then a voice will call out, "Where is so-and-so the son of so-and-so?" He will be brought forth, followed by his good deeds which appear like mountains while the people are gazing at them in wonder, until he is standing before the Most Merciful. Then the caller will be commanded to say: "Whoever is owed anything by so-and-so the son of so-and-so, or has been wronged by him, let him come forth." So they will come forth and gather before the Most Merciful, then the Most Merciful will say: "Settle the matter for My servant." They will say, "How can we settle the matter?" He will say, "Take from his good deeds and give it to them." They will keep taking from his good deeds until there is nothing left, and there will still be people with scores to be settled. Allah will say, "Settle the matter for My servant." They will [11 FathAl-BOri 6:419.

rw x" >*- 4^ \$0 (*"-V ^j vj* p * '4 aA^LJaJ^VIU " ",i *AAa2A.LiJL2lj1)^"J^ say, He does not have even one good deed left." Allah will say, "Take from their evil deeds and give them to him." Then the Prophet jgg quoted this Ayah: \$\$; j\$S & peg \$3; jAfiSf ^And verily, they shall bear their own loads, and other loads besides their own ; and verily, they shall be questioned on the Day of Resurre- tion about that which they used to fabricate.^ There is a corroborating report in the Sahih with a different chain of narration: ju iU} iili jjk jij ji^Ji j t oi^ uaii f>: ^tj j^ji !>|" IS^i iJLij ^ iJLi jb^ti itJLi o'* /: Iri ^ "A man wi// come on the Day of Resurrection with good deeds like mountains, but he had wronged this one, taken the wealth of that one and slandered the honor of another. So each of them will take from his good deeds . And if there is nothing left of his good deeds, it will be taken from their evil and placed on l 1 ' Ad-DurrAl-Manthur5 :272

(14 - 25) Al-'Ankabat (Part-20) mission when he was forty years old, and he stayed among his people for a thousand years less fifty; after the Flood he lived for sixty years until people had increased and spread. iThen We saved him and the Companions of the Boat,} means, those who believed in NClIj, peace be upon him. We have already discussed this in detail in Surah Hud, * and there is no need to repeat it here. iand made it (the ship) an Ayah for all people.} means. We caused that ship to remain,

whether in itself, as Qatadah said, that it remained until the beginning of Islam, on Mount Jttdi, or whether the concept of sailing in ships was left as a reminder to mankind of how Allah had saved them from the Flood. * This is like the Ayat iAnd an Ayah for them is that We bore their offspring in the laden ship. And We have createdfor them of the like thereunto, on which they ride until: iand as an enjoymentfor a while [36:41-44]. iVerily, when the water rose beyond its limits. We carried you in the ship. That We might make it an admonition for you and that it might be retained by the retaining ears.} (69:11-12) And Allah says here: SSK &} iThen We saved him and the Companions of the Boat, and made it an Ayahfor all people.} This is a shift from referring to one specific ship to speaking *** Ibn Abi H&tim no. 17186, Ad-DurrAl-ManthOr 5 :273 * Seevolume five , the TafsirofSURahHud (10 :25) > At-Tabari 20:18.

worship Allah alone, with no partner or associate, to fear Him alone, to seek provision from Him alone, with no partner or associate, to give thanks to Him alone, for He is the One to Whom thanks should be given for the blessings which none can bestow but He. Ibrahim said to his people: it 4Worship Allah, and have Tacfwd of Him,} meaning worship Him and fear Him Alone, with all sincerity. ithat is betterfor you ifyou know.} if you do that you will attain good in this world and the next, and you will prevent evil from yourselves in this world and the Hereafter. Then Allah states that the idols which they worshipped were not able to do any harm or any good, and tells them, You made up names for them and called them gods, but they are created beings just like you. This interpretation was reported by Al- Awfi from Ibn Abbas. 1 11 It was also the view of Mujahid and As-Suddl. Al-Walibi reported from Ibn Abbas: You invent falsehood, means, you carve idols, 121 which do not have the power to provide for you. 4-' \$ is 4so seekfrom Allah your provision,} This emphasizes the idea of asking Allah Alone. This is like the Ayat 4You (Alone) we worship, and You (Alone) we ask for help.} (1:5) And His saying: 4My Lord! Build for me, with You, a home in Paradise} (66:11). Allah says here: At-Jabari 20:19. Al-Tabari 20:19.

iso seek} meaning, ask for 44\$\$ x%} ifrom Allah your provision,} meaning, do not seek it from anyone or anything other than Him, for no one else possesses the power to do anything. iand worship Him, and be grateful to Him.} Eat from what He has provided and worship Him Alone, and give thanks to Him for the blessings He has given you. 4To Him you will be brought back.} means, on the Day of Resurrection, when He will reward or punish each person according to his deeds. His saying: ip&J oi X^ vjlk=a lii 0\$} iAnd ifyou deny, then nations before you have denied.} means, you have heard what happened to them by way of punishment for opposing the Messengers. cjEJt % <)' & iAnd the duty of the Messenger is only to convey plainly.} All the Messengers have to do is to convey the Message as Allah has commanded them. Allah guides whoever He wills and leaves astray whoever He wills, so strive to be among the blessed. Qatadah said concerning the Ayah: 4 (Oi X^ '->> =* Jii & of}} iAnd ifyou deny, then nations before you have denied.} These are words of consolation to His Prophet, peace be upon him. This suggestion by Qatadah implies that the narrative (about Ibrahim) is interrupted here, and resumes with the words And nothing was the answer of (Ibrahim s) people... in

Ayah 24. This was also stated by Ibn Jarir. From the context

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4340–4353]

it appears that Ibrahim, peace be upon him, said all of what is in this section. Here he establishes proof against them that the Resurrection will indeed come to pass, because at the end of this passage it says: 4
 {trij => &} 4 And nothing was the answer of his people...'(29:24) And Allah knows best. !&* \$ k 3
 & ! ? fit } 3 % 12 dEi ti; 1 ^Vi Ji BJ #< #2 fcS * j " U/-^" Xj lj iyj oj 4*tic jvi oj [y-fc-i . See they not
 how Allah originates the creation, then repeats it. Verily, that is easy for Allah.} 420. Say: "Travel in the
 land and see how He originated the creation, and then Allah will bring forth the creation of the
 Hereafter. Verily, Allah is able to do all things."} 421 . He punishes whom He wills, and shows mercy to
 whom He wills; and to Him you will be returned.} 422 . And you cannot escape in the earth or in the
 heaven . And besides Allah you have neither any protector nor any helper.} 423. And those who
 disbelieve in the Ayat of Allah and meeting with Him, such have no hope of My mercy: and for such
 there is a painful torment.} The Evidence for Life after Death Allah tells us that Ibrahim, peace be upon
 him, showed them the proof of life after death, which they denied, in their souls. For Allah created them
 after they had been nothing at all, then they came into existence and became people who could hear and
 see. The One Who originated this is able to repeat it, it is very easy for Him. Then he taught them to
 contemplate the visible signs on the horizons and the things that Allah has created: the heavens with
 their stars and planets, moving and stationary, the earth with its plains and mountains, its valleys,

J T\ mm% Jjj 'j pj a Uii^OJJ A-** l j^JUjQp 1/iem.B111 Allah says: &s * ,u ss ^s> 4He punishes
 whom He wills, and shows mercy to whom He wills; and to Him you will be returned You will return to
 Him on the Day of Resurrection. ojiSVf (4 OjyyL Cj^ i| Y" 4And you cannot escape on the earth or in
 the heaven.) No one in heaven or on earth can flee from Him, for He is the Subduer Who is above His
 servants, and everything fears Him and is in need of Him, while He is the One Who is Independent of
 all else. 4if L Lti-5^ l|p Xj) o; iyj o; ^==J Cy**And besides Allah you have neither any protector nor
 any helper. And those who disbelieve in the Ayat of Allah and the meeting with Him,) Those who
 disbelieved in the signs of Allah and denied the Resurrection, 4i^"y iti i ia! m Abu Dawud 5 :75 , Ibn
 Majah 1 :30

isuch have no hope of My mercy> they will have no share in it, i/j,*p dizifo} iandfor such there is a
 painful torment.} meaning, extremely painful, in this world and the next. Jilj 4 jUlf ia(lljili yij> _ ybji
 ijUl 4 tj ylij 4 ("?*-? taj ji' i,J 1> fjk liJ? paO. ufVj. tjj!" 424. So nothing was the answer of people
 except that they said : "Kill him or burn him." Then Allah saved him from the fire. Verily, in this are
 indeed signs for a people who believe.} 425. And (Ibrahim) said: "You have taken idols instead of Allah.
 The love between you is only in the life of this world, but on the Day of Resurrection, you shall deny
 each other, and curse each other, and your abode will be the Fire, and you shall have no helper."} The
 Response of Ibrahim s People - and how Allah controlled the Fire Allah tells us how Ibrahim s people
 stubbornly and arrogantly disbelieved, and how they resisted the truth with falsehood. After Ibrahim
 addressed them with his words of clear guidance, 4& j\ :j& tfu 4 H[} iexcept that they said: "Kill him
 or burn him."} This was because proof had clearly been established against them, so they resorted to
 using their power and strength. 4%'uOtt pO- GT^ i/4 4^^\$ iThey said : "Build for him a building and
 throw him into the blazing fire!" So they plotted a plot against him, but We made them the lowest.}
 (37:97-98). They spent a long time gathering a huge amount of firewood,

they built a fence around it, then they set it ablaze until its flames reached up to the sky. No greater fire had ever been lit. Then they went to Ibrahim, seized him and put him into a catapult, then they threw him into the fire. But Allah made it cool and safe for him, and after spending several days in it, he emerged unscathed. For this reason and others, Allah made him an Imam for mankind, for he offered himself to the Most Merciful, he offered his body to the flames, he offered his son as a sacrifice, and he gave his wealth to care for his guests. For all of these reasons he is beloved by the followers of all religions. ^Then Allah saved him from the fire.} means, He rescued him from it by making it cool and safe for him. fA 9\$ iVerily, in this are indeed signsfor a people who believe. Ibrahim, peace be upon him, explains to his people that idols are incapable of doing anything, Jl j Ojl tiyiA &J3 S&j} }And (Ibrahim) said: "You luroe taken idols instead of Allah. The love between you is only in the life ofthis world,} Here Ibrahim was rebuking his people for their evil deed of worshipping idols, and telling them: You have taken these as gods and you come together to worship them so that there is friendship and love among you in this world, ibut on the Day of Resurrection,} the situation will be the opposite, and this love and friendship will turn into hatred and enmity. Then iyou shall deny each other,} meaning, you will denounce one another and deny whatever was between you, }and curse each other,} means, the followers will curse their

relationship was to him, Ibrahim said, My sister. Then he went to her and said, I told him that you are my sister, so do not let him think I am lying, for there are no believers on earth except for you and I, and you are my sister in faith. It seems - and Allah knows best - that the meaning here is, there is no other Muslim couple on earth apart from you and I. Among his people, only Lut believed in him and migrated with him to Syria, then during Ibrahim s lifetime he was sent as a Messenger to the people of Sadum (Sodom) where he settled. 1 11 We have already discussed their stoiy and more is to come. iHe (Ibrahim) said: "I will emigratefor the sake ofmy Lord."} It may be that the pronoun in the verb he said refers to Lut, because he was the last person mentioned before this phrase; or it may refer to Ibrahim. Ibn Abbas and Ad-Dahhak said that Ibrahim is the one who is referred in the phrase. ilj JS' u" }So, Lut believed in him.} i.e., out of all his people. Then Allah tells us that he chose to leave them so that he might be able to follow his religion openly. So he said: iVerily, He is the All-Mighty, the All-Wise.} Power belongs to Him and to His Messenger and to those who believe in him, and He is Wise in all that He says and does, and in all His rulings and decrees, both universal and legislative. Qatadah said, They migrated together from Kutha, which is on the outskirts of Kufa, and went to Syria. 121 Allah gave Ibrahim, Ishaq and Ya'qub, and ordained Prophethood in His Offspring Al-Bari 6 :447Tabari 20:26.

}And We bestowed on him, Isliaq and Ya'qub,} This is like the Ayah, ' *? , Lijj i&r ytj J>"1[lil lLk> "jjt op CSI (A** ' 4So, when he had turned away from them and from those whom they worshipped besides Allah, We gave him Ishaq and Ya'qub, and each one ofthem We made a Prophet.} (19:49) That is, when he left his people, Allah gave him joy in a righteous son who was also a Prophet, to whom in turn was bom, in his grandfather s lifetime, a righteous son who was also a Prophet. Allah also says: 4And We bestowed upon him Ishaq, and Ya'qiib in addition (21:72) meaning, as an additional gift. This is like the Ayah, 4But We gave her glad tidings of Ishaq, and after Ishaq, of Ya'qub.} (11:71) meaning, to this son would be born a son during their lives, who would be a delight to them. 4) Xy~& irv* ti hiZ>-j} }and We ordained among his offspring prophethood and the Book,} This is a tremendous blessing. Not only did Allah take him as a close friend and make him an Imam for mankind, but He also ordained

prophethood and the Book among his offspring. After the time of Ibrahim there was no Prophet who was not from among his descendants. All of the Prophets of the Children of Israel were from among his descendants, from Ya'qub bin Ishaq bin Ibrahim to the last of them, Isa bin Maryam, who stood in the midst of his people and announced the good news of the Hashimi Qurashi Arab Prophet, the last of all the Messengers, the leader of the sons of Adam in this world and the next, whom Allah chose from the heart of the Arab nation, from the descendants of Ismail bin Ibrahim, may peace be upon them. There is no Prophet from the line of

483Siirah 29. (27 - 30) Al-'Ankabut (Part-20) Ismail besides him, may the best of blessings and peace be upon him. 4and We granted him his reward in this world; and verily i" the Hereafter he is indeed among the righteous .} Allah granted him happiness in this world that was connected to happiness in the Hereafter, for in this world he had plentiful provision, a splendid home, a beautiful and righteous wife, and he was and still is spoken of highly, for everyone loves him and regards him as a friend. Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Qatadah and others said: He obeyed Allah in all ways. This is like the Ayah, iAnd ofIbrahim who fulfilled all.} (53:37) He did all that he was commanded to do and obeyed his Lord to the utmost. Allah says: g & 4% KSif 4^ iand We granted him his reward in this world; and verily, in the Hereafter he is indeed among the righteous.} And He says: to iVerily, Ibrahim was an Ummah, Qdnit to Allah, a Hanif, and he was not one of the idolaters} until: tj \$ff} iand in the Hereafter he shall be ofthe righteous} (16:120-122). sft* Ju-1 Cfl 1; oytj j =c.Ilf *& j J.i/Jf jfUbjuj JI^f Sj 4 if Giif ijd J^^ aTabari 20:27 28. 121 See volume six, the Tafsirof Surat Al-Isrn (16-120).

(31 - 35) Al-'Ankabiit (Part-20) J 1 UU^JUisj i-J 1; .tf^UL.ijocU-Dj y " s* <*y lfc)j v^SUiyl|"f: '~y*U"j!LiiiyO jS r" ^_a-) aJJjS -p'j *;_/_j~a \. ^T*' ' fl - }~*~ JL-ai :*)j^ ^ ^==:-^ t^gjUga Allah s torment upon us if you are one of the truthful."} This is indicative of their disbelief, scornful attitude and stubbornness. So Allah s Prophet asked for help against them, and said: jjN\ Jf- 4-J-Ji-My Lord! Give me victory over the people who are corrupt.} X3L1J tij} jii dj tfii L iyl s> L+Lkl 6} ? dSi Jii C & 0^S >. vt juij a t/ ^ yu a; "il yU_> le |"4> |*j; ".~y (3yl Lvlt Ollj" c? 0i C*1*- =" ^JW ill ^ i 4 q a lii a i; t^=v jiJ iy^ tL ^ !>*v >' i -j ' >, <; 431 . And when Our messengers came to Ibrahim with the glad tidings they said: "Verily, we are going to destroy the people of this town; truly, its people have been wrongdoers."} 432. Ibrahim said: "But there is Lut in it." They said: "We know better who is there. We will verily, save him and his family - except his wife, she will be of those who remain behind."} 433. And when Our messengers came to Lut, he was grieved

(31 - 35) Al-'Ankabut (Part-20) ihe was grieved because of them , and felt straitened on their account. means, he was worried since if he had them as guests then he was afraid for them and what his people might do to them, but if he did not host them, he was still afraid of what might happen to them. At that point he did not know who they were. jye- Vj Oiic *i/ ySj) 4They said: "Have no fear, and do not grieve! Truly, we shall save you and your family except your wife: she will be of those who remain behind. Verily, we are about to bring down on the people of this town a great torment from the sky, because they have been rebellious."} Jibril, peace be upon him, uprooted their town from the depths of the earth, lifted it up to the sky, then threw it upside down upon them. Allah rained upon them: Ji *d 4stones of Sijjil, in a well-arranged manner one after another. Marked from your Lord; and they are not

ever far from the evil doers.} [1 1:82-83] Allah turned the place where they had lived into a putrid, stinking lake, which will remain as a lesson to mankind until

the Day of Resurrection, and they will be among those who are

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4353–4354]

most severely punished on the Day of Resurrection. Allah says: 4And indeed We have left thereof an evident Ayah i.e., a clear sign, 4for a folk who understand.} This is like the Ayah, ^Verily, you pass by them in the morning And at night; will m See volume five , the Tafsir of Surah Hud (1 1 :82)

you not then reflect?} (37:137-138) j (*J^* JyrJj iif bi4^ JUi tL^Li ^j"UJ rfe lj 4 {*&*-& *j"a su ^TSy&A-i* cj^Vl 436. And to Madyan, We sent their brother Shu'ayb. He said: "O my peop/e/ Worship Allah and hope for the last Day, and commit no mischief on the earth as mischief-makers."} 437. And they denied him; so the earthquake seized them, and they lay, prostrate in their dwellings .} Shu'ayb and His People Allah tells us that His servant and Messenger Shu'ayb, peace be upon him, warned his people, the people of Madyan, and commanded them to worship Allah Alone with no partner or associate, and to fear the wrath and punishment of Allah on

the Day of Resurrection. He said:

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r- my people! Worship Allah and hope for the last Day,} Ibn Jarir said: Some of them said that this meant: Fear the Last Day. 111 This is like the Ayah, !& ifoy ifor those who look forward to (meeting with) Allah and the Last Day} (60:6). 4S.-J Jfjii > \ Vj} 4and commit no mischief on the earth as mischief-makers.} This is forbidding them to make mischief on earth by spreading corruption, which means going around doing evil to people. They used to cheat in weights and measures, and ambush people on the road; this is in addition to their disbelief in Allah and His Messenger. So Allah destroyed them with a mighty earthquake that convulsed their land, and the Sayhah (shout) which tore their hearts from their bodies, and the torment of the Day of Shade, when their souls were taken. |il At-Tabari 20:34.

(36 - 40) Al-'Ankabut (Part-20) ' i > _ .7> * * " X' o-^L)^t| LLA^==alL^Ii L / y // "9y' { " ^ i " ^ U f -T / ' y'f' c/iljl* ^jSy4 ".i \$ _j A* |y /V ". /" -/.f< y^#/ " ^ ^V o~^-=z.'.i 'ii^L)Ov-J ' > ol sggaigu ^This was the torment of a great day. We have already examined their story in detail in Surat Al- A ra/, Surat Hud and Surat Ash-Shu'ard . 4"nd f/iey lay, prostrate in their dwellings.) Qatadah said, They were dead. Others said that they were thrown on top of one another. ^j6 aj fc Sj & J> O^*; -**' - iy^il iytij yC *V ' / " > ". 'CL>^> <!*>* > cxxjif sj^>* jlaIj [yiT uj 4 232 jS^ C .& CZ3 \$ rJi ui23^ i>^=. jGj ;&) ft Uj& XM -J "2i2. 4:f:^A . And Ad and Thamud! And indeed (their destruction) is clearly apparent to you from their (ruined) dwellings. Shaytan made their deeds fair seeming to them, and turned them away 'o IB! Ski Cj*yiij iifjU.^ r ^ y *** Volume four, the Tafsir of Surat Al-A'raf (7:85), volume five, the

Tafsir of Surah Hud (1 1 :84) , and volume seven , the Tafsir of Surat

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from the path, though they were intelligent.} 439. And Qariin, Fir'awn, and Haman. And indeed Musa came to them with clear Aydt, but they were arrogant in the land, yet they could not outstrip Us.} 440. So, We punished each for his sins, of them were some on whom We sent a Hdsib, and of them were some who were overtaken by As-Sayhah, and of them were some whom We caused the earth to swallow, and of them were some whom We drowned. It was not Allah Wlw wronged them, but they wronged themselves.} The Destruction of Nations Who rejected Their Messengers Allah tells us about these nations who disbelieved in their Messengers, and how He destroyed them and sent various kinds of punishments and vengeance upon them. Ad, the people of Hud, peace be upon him, used to live in the Ahqaf (curved sand-hills), near Hadramawt, in the Yemen. Thamtd, the people of Salih, lived in Al-Hijr, near Wadi Al-Qura. The Arabs used to know their dwelling place very well, and they often used to pass by it. Qariin was the owner of great wealth and had the keys to immense treasures. Fir'awn, the king of Egypt at the time of Mdsa, and his minister Haman were two Coptics who disbelieved in Allah and His Messenger, peace be upon him. 4* till y&} 4So, We punished each for his sins,} their punishments fit their crimes. & 1 ^} iof them were some on whom We sent a Hdsib,} This was the case with Ad, and this happened because they said: Who is stronger than us? So, there came upon them a violent, intensely cold wind, which was very strong and carried pebbles which it threw upon them. It carried them through the air, lifting a man up to the sky and then hurling him headlong to the ground, so that his head split and he was left as a body without a head, like uprooted stems of date palms.

492Siirah 29. (38 - 40) Al-'Ankabut (Part-20) iand ofthem were some who were overtaken by As-Sayhah,} This is what happened to Thamtid, against whom evidence was established because of the she-camel who came forth when the rock was split, exactly as they had asked for. Yet despite that they did not believe, rather they persisted in their evil behavior and disbelief, and threatening to expel Allah s Prophet Salih and the believers with him, or to stone them. So the Sayhah struck them, taking away their powers of speech and movement. 4^3 ^ iand of them were some whom We caused the earth to swallow,} This refers to Qarun who transgressed, he was evil and arrogant. He disobeyed his Lord, the Most High, and paraded through the land in a boastful manner, filled with self- admiration, thinking that he was better than others. He showed off as he walked, so Allah caused the earth to swallow him and his house, and he will continue sinking into it until

the Day of Resurrection. 40^ o iand ofthem were some whom I'Ve drowned.} This refers to Fir awn, his minister Haman and their troops, all ofwhom were drowned in a single morning, not one of them escaped. i& 3 C,} ilt was not Allah Who wronged than,} in what He did to them, 4oy41 ibut they wronged themselves.} that happened to them as a punishment for what they did with their own hands. Ojj OJUit lijOcf dsdl ' oi ot L p~l> ill' o\ o \jV => OjJ

492 Tafslr Ibn Kathir 441 . The parable of those who seek protectors from other than Allah is that of a spider who builds a house; but indeed, the weakest ofhouses is the spider's house - ifthey but knew. 442. Verily, Allah knows what things they invoke instead of Him. He is the All-Mighty, the All-Wise.) 443. And these are the examples We give for mankind; but none will understand them except those who have knowledge (of Allah).) Likening the gods of the Idolators to the House of a Spider This is how Allah described the idolators in their reverence of gods besides Him, hoping that they would help them

and provide for them, and turning to them in times of difficulties. In this regard, they were like the house of a spider, which is so weak and frail, because by clinging to these gods they were like a person who holds on to a spider's web, who does not gain any benefit from that. If they knew this, they would not take any protectors besides Allah. This is unlike the

(41- 45) Al-'Ankabut (Part-20) And these are the examples We give for mankind; but none will understand them except those who have knowledge.} 1^ ad) CrJ C 4 dl-1 & &-} & jTij ^ yk&t ^ ^jf. Allah created the heavens and the earth with truth. Verily, therein is surely a sign for those who believe.} 445. Recite what has been revealed to you of the Book, and perform the Salah. Verily, the Salah prevents from Al-Fahsha (immoral sins) and Al-Munkar (evil deeds) and the remembering (praising) of Allah is greater indeed. And Allah knows what you do.} Allah tells us of His immense power, that He created the heavens and the earth with truth, meaning for a higher purpose than mere play, 4cs^ Of it that every person may be rewarded for that which he strives} (20:15). it that He may requite those who do evil with that which they have done, and reward those who do good, with what is best} (53:31). vs 4 1\} iVerily, therein is surely a sign for those who believe.} meaning, there is clear evidence that Allah is alone in creating, controlling, and in His divinity. The Command to convey the Message, to recite the Qur'an and to pray Then Allah commands His Messenger and the believers to recite the Qur'an, which means both reciting it and conveying I 1 * Ibn Abi Hatim no. 17344 , Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :464

it to people. iZiJ& 35 C/cc, * - - - ykSJi perform the Salah. Verily, the Salah prevents from Al- Fahsha' and Al-Munkar and the remembrance of Allah is greater indeed.} Prayer includes two things: the first of which is giving up immoral behavior and evil deeds, i.e., praying regularly enables a person to give up these things. Imam

(46) Al-'Ankabut (Part-21) prohibitions. Ibn Awn Al-Ansari said: When you are praying, you are doing good, it is keeping you away from immoral sins and evil wicked deeds and what you are doing is part of the remembrance of Allah which is greater. ^^ Jt < [4 t4\ &C Mk A ifa -h-J 446. And argue not with the People of the Scripture, except with that which is better - except with such of them as do wrong; and say (to them) : We believe in that which has been revealed to us and revealed to you; our God and your God is One, and to Him we have submitted."} Arguing with the People of the Book

What is meant here is that anyone who wants to find out

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about religion from them should argue with them in a manner that is better, as this will be more effective. Allah says: invite to the way of your Lord with wisdom and fair preaching...} (16:125) Ja &s!3m t-r T>. >' c > ly*. V) * *. ' >-rg(rti U fa ;/ fes. / , Mil ^ ^ / - , Ibn Abi Hatim recorded this narration under this Ayah.

that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said, The People of the Book used to read the Tawrah in Hebrew and explain it in Arabic to the

498 Tafsir Ibn Kathir fJ V> o! A4 ui ! Cj y^o^i^all Vj ll^Ai Cy CJ 2y? &t < 4 Sir. > j: fjS^f 6i vi, till teZ 447. And thus We have sent down the Book to you, and those whom We gave the Scripture believe

therein as also do some of these and none but the disbelievers reject Our Ayat. 448. Neither did you read any book before it nor did you write any book with your right hand. In that case, indeed, the followers of falsehood might have doubted. 449. Nay, but it is clear Ayat, (preserved) in the breasts of those who have been given knowledge. And none but the wrongdoers deny Our Ayat Evidence for the Fact that the Qur'an was revealed from Allah Ibn Jarir said: Allah says, just as We revealed the Books to the Messengers who came before you, O Muhammad, so We have also revealed this Book to you.' What he said is good and fits the context. Allah's saying: 4and those whom We gave the Scripture believe therein) means, those knowledgeable rabbis and scholars among them who learned it and recited it properly, such as Abdullah bin Salam, Salman Al-Farisi and others like them. 4fi>, ofc off) 4as also believe therein some of these) meaning, the Quraysh Arabs and others. vj Cj) 4and none but the disbelievers reject Our Ayat.) No one disbelieves and rejects them except those who conceal the truth with falsehood, and those who try to hide the rays in At-Tabari 20 :50.

(47 - 49) Al-'Ankabūt (Part-21) and light of the sun by their covering an eye. Then Allah says: It 1)^ iNeither did you read any book before it (this Qur'an) nor did you write any book with your right hand.} meaning, you lived among your people for a long time before you brought this Qur'an. During this time you never read any book or wrote anything. Your people, as well as others all know that you are an unlettered man who does not read or write. This is how he was also described in the previous Scriptures, as Allah says: JL ' / 'it ' . ' "tf >>>?' (** * /Ojorf Jji' Jj-J' iThose who follow the Messenger, the Prophet, the unlettered about whom they find written with them in the Tawrah and the Injil, - he commands them with good; and forbids them from evil.} (7:157) This is how the Messenger of Allah will remain until the Day of Resurrection, unable to write even one line or one letter. He used to have scribes who would write down the revelation for him, or would write letters from him to be sent to different places. Allah's saying: iojh.In Cw 'H> }In that case, indeed, the followers of falsehood might have doubted.} means, *if you had been literate, some ignorant people would have doubted you. They would have said that you learned this from Books inherited from the Prophets which came before. Indeed, they did say that, even though they knew that he was unlettered and could not read or write. } And they say : "Tales of the ancients, which he has written down, and they are dictated to him morning and afternoon."} (25:5)

500 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Allah says: puu (JJil iSay : It has been sent down by Him Who knows the secret of the heavens and the earth} (25:6). And Allah says here: / w { 4'Ui tjj iNay, but it is (Quran), the clear Ayat, (preserved) in the breasts of those who have been given knowledge.} meaning, this Qur'an is clear Ayat which indicate the truth, commands, prohibitions and stories. It is memorized by the scholars for whom Allah makes it easy to memorize, recite and interpret. This is like the Ayah, c* J5 JM 2 ^j} iAnd We have indeed made the Qur'an easy to understand and remember; then is there any one who would remember?} (54:17). The Messenger of Allah jg said: &-j iLjjf ^jji of dtj dL j* u JJ.I jJj N)^ l "ULi5 bjS\M Sil *There has never been any Prophet who was not given that which would make people believe in him. What I have been given is revelation which Allah reveals to me, and I hope that I will have the most followers among them .b According to the Hadith of Iyad bin Himar, recorded in Sabah Muslim, Allah says: UiU Vyji iJUJi iLjj i cys JjQp Jji Jjl. iuij J> ""/ am testing you and testing others through you, revealing to you a Book which cannot be washed away by water, which you recite while

you are asleep and while you are awake. This means, if the manuscript where it is written were to be washed with water, there is no need for that manuscript. Al-Bari8:619. Muslim 4:2197.

This is because it is preserved in the hearts and is easy on the tongue (i.e., is easy to recite), and is controlling people's hearts and minds. It is miraculous in its wording and in its meanings. In the previous Scriptures this Ummah was described as carrying their holy Books in their hearts. 4And none but the wrongdoers deny Our Ayat} Nobody denies it or tries to undermine its status or rejects it except the wrongdoers, i.e., the arrogant transgressors who know the truth but turn away from it, as Allah says: ! # < = j& iTruly, those, against whom the Word (wrath) of your Lord has been justified, will not believe. Even if every sign should come to them, until they see the painful torment.} (10:96-97) S& if i* iLfs a.t ji % iS V 4 fO >' 450. And they say: "Why are not signs sent down to himfrom his Lord?" Say: "The signs are only with Allah, and I am only a plain wamer."} 451. Is it not sufficient for them that We have sent down to you the Book which is recited to them? Verily, herein is mercy and a reminderfor a people who believe.} 452. Say: Sufficient is Allah for a witness between me and you. He knows what is in the heavens and on the earth." And those who believe in falsehood, and disbelieve in Allah, it is they who are the losers.} The Idolaters demand for Signs, and the Response Allah tells us how the idolaters stubbornly demanded signs, meaning that they wanted signs to show them that Muhammad was indeed the Messenger of Allah, just as

^i! L#a^ tit ils it not sufficientfor them that We have sent down to you the Book which is recited to them?} means, is it not sufficient as a sign for them that We have sent down to you this great Book which tells them about what happened before their time, what will happen after they are gone, and passes judgement between them. Even though you are an unlettered man who can neither read nor write, and you have not mixed with any of the People of the Book. Yet you brought them news of what was said in the first Scriptures showing what is right in the matters that they dispute over, and bringing clear and obvious truth. As Allah says: j& (d& ft} 41\$ it not a sign to them that the learned scholars of the Children ofIsrael knew it (to be true)?} (26:197) wjuwJt 4 ii- p-cf (4i oi YjJ 4They say : Why does he not bring us a sign from his Lord?" Has there not come to them the proof of that which is in the former Scriptures?} (20:133) Imam

& =>}j -'i j 4Verily, herein is mercy and a reminder for a people who believe. In this Qur'an there is mercy, that is, explanation of the truth and removal of falsehood, and a reminder to the believers of the punishment that is to come to the disbelievers and sinners. Then Allah says: 4Say: Sufficient is Allah for a witness between me and you..."} He knows best the words of denial that you utter, and he knows what I am telling you about Him and that He has sent me. If I were telling lies about Him, He would have executed His vengeance upon me, as Allah says elsewhere: it " a s* c&i p 14 e 4And ifhe had forged a false saying concerning Us, We surely would have seized him by his right hand, and then We certainly would have cut off his aorta, and none of you could have withheld Usfrom (punishing) him.} (69:44-47). *But I am telling the truth in what I say to you about Him, so He has supported me with clear miracles and definitive evidence. 4He knows what is in the heavens and the earth.} means, nothing is hidden from Him at all. 4And those who believe in falsehood, and disbelieve in Allah, it is they who are the losers.} means, on the Day of Resurrection, they will be punished for what they did,

and will get what they justly deserve for rejecting the truth and following falsehood, for disbelieving in the Messengers of Allah even when there was proof that they

454. They ask you to hasten on the torment. And verily. Hell, of a surety, will encompass the disbelievers.} 455. On the Day when the torment shall cover them from above them and from beneath their feet, and it will be said: "Taste what you used to do."} How the Idolators asked for the Torment to be hastened on Allah tells us of the ignorance of the idolators and how they asked for the punishment of Allah to be hastened so that it would befall them quickly. This is like the Ayah, IL& JJ4 JU i 53 * ui 4 JUJSi

(56 - 60) Al-'Ankabūt (Part-21) if only those who disbelieved knew (the time) when they will not be able to ward off the Fire from their faces, nor from their backs (21:39). The Fire will cover them from all sides, which is more effective as a physical punishment. 1 Jj j} and it will be said: Taste what you used to do."} This is a threat and a rebuke, which is a form of psychological punishment, as in the Ayah, It* 'Jj *>#* > pi; iThe Day they will be dragged on their faces into the Fire (it will be said to them) : "Taste you the touch of Hell!" Verily, We have created all things with a measurement.} (54:48-49) .ii j J', &} **' ' Oi 45 V i V\$ f ; iThe Day when they will be pushed down by force to the fire of Hell, with a horrible, forceful pushing. This is the Fire which you used to deny. Is this magic or do you not see? Enter you therein (taste you therein its heat) and whether you are patient of it or impatient of it, it is all the same. You are only being requited for what you used to do.} (52:13-16) } f vP* ur" y ipj 61 ipC Zdi f * } iff Cb a* (4 [APj IP* jM) y >*' > o C/j^=U pt) ifj \isf> OjJ' Pi fu oyi- . O My servants who believe! Certainly, spacious is My earth. Therefore worship Me.} 457. Everyone shall taste death. Then unto Us you shall be returned.} 458. And those who believe and do righteous good deeds, to them We shall surely give lofty dwellings in Paradise, beneath

We shall surely give lofty dwellings in Paradise, underneath which rivers flow,} meaning, *We shall cause them to dwell in lofty homes in Paradise under which various kinds of rivers flow - water, wine, honey and milk - which they can direct and cause to flow wherever they wish. }to live therein forever.} means, they will remain there forever, never wanting to leave. ^ ^U.} 4Excellent is the reward for the workers.} these rooms will be a blessed reward for the good deeds of the believers, iThose who are patient,} in adhering to their religion, who migrated for the sake of Allah and fought the enemy, leaving behind their families and relatives to seek Allah's Face, and hoping for that which is with Him, believing His promise. Ibn Abi Hatim, may Allah have mercy on him, recorded from Abu Mu'aniq Al-Ash'ari that Abu Malik Al-Ash'ari told him that the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) told him: ^)l I UjAUJ {jA 1 kill ll Ij* o[B "fG "/" Paradise there are rooms whose outside can be seen from the inside, and their inside can be seen from the outside; Allah has prepared them for those who feed others, who speak well, who pray and fast continually, and who stand in prayer at night while people are asleep .i &j} and put their trust in their Lord.} W At-Tabarfini 17:372

They will surely reply: "Allah." How then are they deviating?} <\$62. Allah expands the provision for whom He wills of His servants, and straitens it for whom (He wills). Verily, Allah is the All-Knower of everything.} 463. And if you were to ask them : "Who sends down water from the sky, and gives life there- with to the earth after its death?" They will surely reply: "Allah." Say: "All the praises and thanks be to Allah!" Nay, most of them have no sense.} Evidences of Tawhīd Allah states that there is no God

but He. The idolators who worshipped others besides Him recognized that He was the sole creator of the heavens and earth, the sun and the moon, alternating the night and day. They acknowledged that He was the Creator Who provided for His servants and decreed how long they should live. He made them and their provision different, so that some were rich and some were poor, and He knew best what was suitable for each of them, who deserved to be rich and who deserved to be poor. So, Allah stated that He has alone created everything, and that He alone is controlling them - if this is how it is, then why worship anyone else? Why put one's trust in anyone else? Since dominion is His Alone, then let worship be for Him Alone. Allah often establishes His divinity by referring to their acknowledgement of His Unique Lordship, because the idolators used to acknowledge His t t mamw " A, it ' 'j1 Uli ililUl 1

This is like the Ayah, 2'f ji V) ojp-ji & Ji j fjll' 4And when harm touches you upon the sea, those that you call upon vanish from you except Him (Allah Alone). But when He brings you safely to land, you turn away^ (17:67). Allah says here: 4but when He brings them safely to land, behold, they give a share of their worship to others. Muhammad bin Ishaq reported from Ikrimah bin Abi Jahl that when the Messenger of Allah conquered Makkah, he (Ikrimah) ran away, fleeing from him. When he was on the sea, headed for Ethiopia, the ship started to rock and the crew said: O people, pray sincerely to your Lord alone, for no one can save us from this except Him. Ikrimah said: By Allah, if there is none who can save us on the sea except Him, then there is none who can save us on land except Him either, O Allah, I vow to You that if I come out of this, I will go and put my hand in the hand of Muhammad and I will find him kind and merciful. And this is what indeed did happen. iSo that they become ingrate for that which We have given them, and that they take their enjoyment,} f&f- q Q & c /*' if-t jUW ! Sil i}j U i Lj 467. Have they not seen that We have made a secure sanctuary, while men are being snatched away from all around than ? Then do they believe in falsehood, and deny the graces of Allah?} 468. And who does more wrong than he who invents a lie against Allah or denies the truth, when it comes to him? Is IM At-Tabarani 3 :301

there not a dwelling in Hell for the disbelievers?} i69. /Is for those who strive hard for Us, We will surely guide them to Our paths. And verily, Allah is with the doers of good.} The Blessing of the Sanctuary Here Allah reminds Quraysh how He blessed them by granting them access to His sanctuary which He has made (open) to (all) men, the dweller in it and the visitor from the country are equal there, and whoever enters it is safe, because he is in a place of great security, although the Arabs of the desert round about used to ambush and raid one another and kill one another. As Allah says: grj*- oi ojlf iFor the protection of the Quraysh. The caravans to set forth safe in winter and in summer. So let them worship the Lord of this House. Who has fed them against hunger, and has made them safe from fear.} (106:1-4) 4Then do they believe in falsehood, and deny the graces of Allah?} means, is the thanks that they give for this immense blessing to associate others with Him and worship others besides Him, idols and rivals? iHave you not seen those who have changed the blessings of Allah into disbelief, and caused their people to dwell in the house of destruction?} (14:28) They disbelieved in the Prophet, servant and Messenger of Allah 5^, when what they should have done was to worship Allah Alone and not associate anything with Him, and to believe in, honor and respect the Messenger, but they rejected him and fought him, and expelled him from their midst. So, Allah took His blessing away from them, and killed those of

them whom He killed at Badr, then His Messenger ^{2g} and the believers gained the upper hand, and Allah enabled His Messenger ^{2g} to conquer Makkah, and He disgraced them and humiliated them (the disbelievers). Then Allah says: ^{4t3}"L- CJ And who does more wrong than he who invents a lie against Allah or denies the truth, when it comes to him?"} There is no one who will be more severely punished than one who tells lies about Allah and says that Allah revealed something to him at the time when Allah did not reveal anything to him, or says, shall reveal something like that which Allah revealed. And there is no one who will be more severely punished than one who denies the truth when it comes to him, for the former is a fabricator and the latter is a disbeliever. Allah says: & '(4* j 41s there not a dwelling in Hell for the disbelievers?)} Then Allah says: \jx&. &\$} 4As for those who strive hard for Us,} meaning the Messenger jg and his Companions and those who follow him, until the Day of Resurrection, 4We will surely guide them to Our paths.} means, We will help them to follow Our path in this world and the Hereafter. Ibn Abi Hatim narrated that Abbas Al-Hamdani Abu Ahmad - one of the people of Akka (Palestine) - said, concerning the Ayah: 4As for those who strive hard for Us (in Our cause), We will surely guide them to Our paths. And verily, Allah is with the doers of good.}

Those who act upon what they know, Allah will guide them to that which they do not know.

Surah 30: Ar-Rum

PDF pages 4383–4434

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4383–4421]

Opening The Tafsir of Surat Ar-Rum (Chapter - 30) Which was revealed in Makkah P 3 In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. *ra y p#S ASK 4J'I YL'jy-j^ '-^fr A&s 3r ui(4Jo^-iplS0 gS0 AA * *f -J ISj0^^ Aj &3J YAj 2(4ft V Jf 0^j o;CJ> j* Gif)i & = A L*r3' 6 41 . AlifLam Mvm .)* 42. TTi Romans have been defeated. 43. In the nearest land, and they, after their de- feat, will be victorious.) 44. In Bid i years. The decision of the matter, before and after is only with Allah. And on that day, the believers will rejoice) With the help of Allah. He helps whom He wills, and He is the All-Mighty, the Most Merciful.) *jk o k. u 35 " j-ftf a > :>;f >" t' . v' &s*

46. A promise from Allah, and Allah fails not in His promise, but most men know not.} 47. They know only the outer appearance of the life of the world, and they are heedless of the Hereafter.} Foretelling the Victory of the Romans These Ayat were revealed about the victory of Sabdr, the king of Persia, over Ash-Sham (Greater Syria), the adjoining partisan states of the Arabian Peninsula, and the outlying regions of the land of the Romans. Heraclius, the emperor of the Romans, was forced to flee to Constantinople where he was besieged for a lengthy period. Then Heraclius regained the upper hand. Imam

were victorious, and he said, That is what Allah said: *40SJ&Z U&A oj piJjM ti dll' ojLjji!' Q-ii il Oi> Oi J-A''' ^ iAlifLam Mim.* The Romans have been defeated. In the nearest land, and they, after their defeat, will be victorious. In Bid'i years. The decision of the matter, before and after is only with Allah. And on that day, the believers will rejoice - with the help of Allah. He helps whom He wills, and He is the All- Mighty, the Most Merciful.} ll] This was also recorded by At-Tirxnidhi and

prevail, because neither of them were people who followed a Book and neither of them believed in the Resurrection. When Allah revealed these Ayat, Abu Bakr went out proclaiming throughout Makkah: - *oi (**j ofjVf J'J ti iAlifLam Mim.* The Romans have been defeated. In the nearest land, and they, after their defeat, will be victorious. In Bid' years Some of the Quraysh said to Abu Bakr: This is (a bet) between us and you. Your companion claims that the Romans will defeat the Persians within three to nine years, so why not have a bet on that between us and you? Abu Bakr said, *Yes. This was before betting had been forbidden. So, Abu Bakr and the idolators made a bet, and they said to Abu Bakr: What do you think, Bid' means something between three and nine years, so let us agree on the middle. So they agreed on six years. Then six years passed without the Romans being victorious, so the idolators took what they had bet with Abu Bakr. When the seventh year came and the Romans were finally victorious over the Persians, the Muslims rebuked Abu Bakr for agreeing on six years. He said: Because Allah said: In Bid years. At that time, many people became Muslim. This is how it was narrated by At-Tirmidhi, then he said, This is a Hasan Hadith . 11 Who were the Romans? iAlifLam

Mim. The Romans have been defeated.} We have already discussed the separate letters which appear at the beginning of some Surahs in the beginning of our Tafsir of Surat Al-Baqarah. With regard to the Romans (Ar-Rum), they are the descendents of Al-lys bin Ishaq bin Ibrahim. They are the cousins of the Children of Israll, and are also known as Bani m TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 9 :52.

Ar-Rum (1 - 7) (Part-21 Al-Asfar. They used to followed the religion of the Greeks, who were descendents of Yafith bin Nuh, the cousins of the Turks. They used to worship the seven planets, and they prayed facing the direction of the North Pole. It is they who founded Damascus and built its temple in which there is a prayer niche facing north. The Romans followed this religion until approximately three hundred years after the time of the Messiah. The king who ruled Greater Syria along with the Fertile Crescent (semicircle of fertile land from Syrian Desert to Persian Gulf) was called Caesar. The first of them to enter the Christian religion was Constantine the son of Costas, whose mother was Maryam Al-Hllaniyyah Ash-Shadqaniyyah, from the land of Haran. She had become Christian before him, and she invited him to her religion. Before that he had been a philosopher, then he followed her. It was said that this was merely an outward show of belief. Then the Christians met with him. During his time they debated with Abdullah bin Arius (Arius) and great differences arose which could not be reconciled. Then a gathering of three hundred and eighteen bishops reached an agreement, and presented their creed to Constantine. This is what they call the Great Trust, but in fact it is the Worst Betrayal. They presented to him their laws, i.e., books of rulings on what was lawful and prohibited, and other things that they needed. They changed the religion of the Messiah (peace be upon him), adding some things and taking some things away. They began praying towards the East, and changed the Sabbath (Saturday) rites to Sunday. They worshipped the cross, permitted eating of pigs, adopted innovated observances such as the festival of the cross, Mass, baptism, etc., Palm Sunday and other occasions. They appointed a pope, as their leader, and patriarchs, metropolitans, bishops, priests and deacons, and they invented monasticism. The king built churches and places of worship for them, and he founded the city which is named after him, Constantinople. It was said that during his time twelve thousand churches were built, three places of prayer in Bethlehem, and that his mother built the Church of the Holy Sepulchre. These are the ones who followed the religion of the kings. Then after them came the Jacobites, followers of Ya'qub Al-

522 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Askaf, then the Nestorians, the followers of Nestorius. There are many groups and sects among them, as the Messenger of Allah said: ***jt Or- f-fr'l *They split into seventy two sects. The point here is that they continued to follow Christianity. Every time one Caesar died, another succeeded him, until the last of them, Heraclius, came to power. He was a wise man, one of the most astute and intelligent of kings, who had deep insight and well-formed opinions. His was a great and glorious reign. He was opposed by Chosroes, the king of Persia and of regions such as Iraq, Khurasan, Ar-Riy and all the lands of the Persians. His name was SabQr Dhul-Aktaf, and his kingdom was greater than the kingdom of Caesar. He was the leader of the Persians and was as stubborn as the Persians who were Zoroastrian fire worshippers. How Caesar defeated Chosroes (Kisra) It was previously reported that Tkrimah said: Chosroes sent his deputy and his army against Caesar, and they fought. It is well-known that Chosroes himself fought in the army that invaded his land, and he defeated Caesar and overwhelmed him until he had nothing left except the city of Constantinople, where Chosroes besieged him for a long time, until things became very difficult for him. He was highly venerated among the

Christians, and Chosroes was not able to conquer the city because it was well fortified, and half of it faced the land while the other half faced the sea, from where supplies were able to reach them. After this had gone on for a long time, Caesar thought of a clever trick. He asked Chosroes to let him leave his city in return for money given as a peace-offering, on whatever terms he (Chosroes) wanted. Chosroes agreed to that and asked for a huge amount of wealth - gold, jewels, fabric, servant-women, servants, and much more - such that no king on earth could ever pay. Caesar went along with that and gave him the impression that he had all that he had asked for, although he thought he was crazy for asking for such a thing, because even if the two of them were to combine all of their wealth, it would not amount to even one-

Ar-Rum (1 - 7) (Part-21 tenth of that. He asked Chosroes to let him go out of the city to Ash-Sham and the other regions of his kingdom, so that he could gather that from his storehouses and places where his wealth was buried. Chosroes let him go, and when Caesar was about to leave Constantinople, he gathered his people together and told them: I am going out on a mission I have decided to do so with some soldiers I have selected from my army; if I come back to you before one year passes, I will still be your king but if I do not come back after that, you will have the choice. Then, if you wish, you may remain loyal to me, or if you wish you may appoint someone instead of me. They replied, You are our king for as long as you live, even if you are gone for ten years. When he left Constantinople, a cavalry detachment left with him, and Chosroes camped outside Constantinople to await his return. Caesar went straight away to the land of the Persians, where he started to kill all the men of fighting age, one by one, and he did not stop killing until he reached Al-Madain, which was the seat of power of the kingdom of Chosroes. He killed everyone in the city, and took all its treasures and wealth. He captured the women of Chosroes, shaved his son's head and made him ride on his donkey, sending with him the leaders of his people in a state of utmost humiliation. He wrote to Chosroes saying, This is what you asked for, so take it. When this reached Chosroes, he was extremely distressed, to an extent known only by Allah. His anger was directed against the city of Constantinople and he renewed his siege with increased vehemence, but he was not able to besiege it for long, nor was he able to go to the ford of the river Jayhan, which was the only route through which Caesar could reach Constantinople. When Caesar heard of this, he came up with an unprecedented strategy, whereby he left his troops and goods by the ford, and went off with some of his army. He commanded them to pick up some straw and animal droppings, and to travel approximately one day upstream. Then he told them to throw those things unto the water. When they passed by Chosroes, he and his soldiers thought that the Romans had gone that way, so they rode off in pursuit of them, and the ford was no longer occupied by the Persians. Then Caesar commanded his men to get up and

524 Tafsir Ibn Kathir jump into the river, which they did, thus escaping Chosroes and his troops, then they entered Constantinople. That was a great day for the Christians. Chosroes and his army remained in a state of confusion, not knowing what they were doing. They had not been able to conquer the land of Caesar, and their own land was devastated by the Romans, who seized their wealth, and captured their women and children. This was how the Romans defeated the Persians, and this happened nine years after the Persians defeated the Romans. This conflict between the Persians and the Romans continued until the Romans prevailed between Adhru'at (Ash-Sham) and Busrfi, according to what was stated by Ibn Abbas, Ikrimah and others. This is a place on the edge of Ash-Sham, along the border

with Al-Hijaz. Mujahid said, That was a place in the Arabian Peninsula which is closer to the land of the Romans than to Persia. And Allah knows best. The decision of the matter, before and after is only with Allah before that and after that. And on that day, the believers will rejoice - with the help of Allah> They will rejoice because the Romans, the companions of Caesar, the king of Ash-Sham, defeated the Persians, the companions of Chosroes, who were Zoroastrians. According to many of the scholars, such as Ibn Abbas, Ath-Thawri, As-Suddi and others, the victory of the Romans over the Persians happened on the same day as the battle of Badr. It was reported in the Hadith recorded by At-Tirmidhi, Ibn Jarir, Ibn Abi Hatim and Al-Bazzar that Abu Said said: On the day of Badr, the Romans defeated the Persians, and the believers were happy and rejoiced about that. And Allah revealed the words: />/ if is

4And on that day, the believers will rejoice - with the help of Allah. He helps whom He wills, and He is the All-Mighty, the Most Merciful. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Az-Zubayr Al-Kilabi said, I saw the victory of the Persians over the Romans, then I saw the victory of the Romans over the Persians, then I saw the victory of the Muslims over both the Persian and the Romans, and all of that happened within fifteen years. Allah's saying: {and He is the All-Mighty,} means, in His defeat of and vengeance upon His enemies. His saying: {the Most Merciful.} means, towards His believing servants. {It is} a promise of Allah, and Allah fails not in His promise.} means, *this that We have told you, O Muhammad, that the Romans will defeat the Persians, is a true promise from Allah, truth which cannot be changed and which will surely come to pass, because Allah has decreed that the one of the two parties that is closer to the truth will prevail and that victory will be theirs. 2& but most men know not.} means, they do not know the decree of Allah concerning His creation, but what He does is wise and is based on justice. His saying: {They know only the outer appearance of the life of the world, and they are heedless of the Hereafter.} means, most people know only about this world and how to make a living and so on. They are clever when it comes to Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9:50, At-Tabari 20:73

getting what they need and earning a living, but they are heedless of that which will benefit them in the Hereafter; they are unaware of it and have no idea about it. Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, It has reached the state that in this world one of them could put a Dirham on his finger and tell how much it weighs, but he does not know how to pray properly. / i/*\$? y ik oJ&} iThexj know only the outer appearance of the life of the world, and they are heedless of the Hereafter.} Ibn Abbas said, This means that the disbelievers know how to prosper in this world, but they are ignorant of matters of religion. l** J~t> Ji&b vS ? jji. l; jtj-jil i) jtT uftS"? 4 itij-j ij? oj_J u*M J#? 53 * " Si? a# 2 ,44^ Si? Q ,4iij _'S 'jj*~i ^ iySj ? c4i< o* j 4S. Do they not reflect on themselves? Allah has created not the heavens and the earth, and all that is between them, except with truth and for an appointed term. And indeed many of mankind deny meeting with their Lord.} \$9. Do they not travel in the land, and see what was the end of those before them? They were superior to them in strength, and they tilled the earth and populated it in greater numbers than these have done, and there came to them their Messengers with clear proofs. Surely, Allah wronged them not, but they used to wrong themselves.} 410. Then evil was the end of those who did evil, because they denied the Ayat of Allah and made a mockery of them.} Signs of Tawhid Allah tells us that pondering His creation will show that He m At-Tabari 20:76.

Ar-Rum (8 - 10) (Part-21) exists and that He is Unique in creating it, and that there is no god nor lord besides Him. So He says: tj)& fi} iDo they not reflect upon themselves?} Thinking and pondering how Allah created various things in the upper and lower realms and in the space between, realizing that this was not created in jest or in vain, but in truth, and that it will continue until an appointed time, the Day of Resurrection, as Allah says: 44 rfi! Si Uf} iAnd indeed many of mankind deny meeting with their Lord.} Then Allah tells us of the truth of the Message brought by the Messengers and how He supported them with miracles and clear signs, such as when He destroyed those who disbelieved in them and saved those who believed in them. j, iDo they not travel in the land?} means, do they not understand and think and see and hear about the people of the past? Allah says: B jr)f&} iand see what was the end of those before them? They were superior to them in strength,} meaning, the nations of the past who came before you were stronger than you to whom Muhammad^ has been sent; they had more wealth and more sons. You have not been given one-tenth of what they were given. They stayed longer in this world than you will stay. They were more civilized than you and were more prosperous in the land than you. Yet despite all that, when their Messengers came to them with clear signs, while they were enjoying their life of luxury, Allah punished them for their sins and they had no one who could protect them from Allah. Their wealth and sons could not protect them from the wrath of Allah in the slightest, and Allah was not at all unjust towards them when He sent His punishment upon them.

530 Tafslr Ibn Kathlr Allah said: 4'.LZ f jffi 4Allah originates the creation, then He will repeat it,\$ Just as He was able to create it in the first place, so He is also able to repeat it. t s' tow ithen to Him you will be returned on the Day of Resurrection, when each will be requited according to his deeds. Then Allah says: iAnd on the Day when the Hour will be established, the criminals will be plunged into destruction with despair. Ibn Abbas said, The sinners will be filled with despair. Mujahid said, The sinners will be exposed; according to another report he said, The sinners will grieve. 01 4No intercessors will they have from those whom they made equal with Allah, means, the gods whom they used to worship instead of Allah will not intercede for them; they will reject them and betray them despite their desperate need of them. Then Allah says: ^ >*C 4And on the Day when the Hour will be established - that Day shall (all men) be separated. Qatadah said: By Allah, this refers to the separation after which there will be no reunion. * In other words, if one person is taken up to the highest heights and another is sent down to the lowest depths of Hell, that is the last they will ever see of one another. Allah says: a li \pC tty iThen as for those who believed and did righteous good deeds, At-Tabari 20:80. At-Tabari 20:81.

Ar-Rum (17-19) (Part-21) such shall be honored and made to enjoy a luxurious life in a Garden of Delight .} Mujahid and Qatadah said, This means, they will enjoy a life of luxury. L *;gj aJj tj**) y " iff ^ *{' > >/ ./I' / Z"?? > '* #rvTi*-' > " * - > -Uu J*j? \ CwJ' ot if*' v, ioirfJ" JW> 417. So glorify Allah, when you enter the evening, and when you enter the morning. 418. And His is all the praise in the heavens and the earth; and in Ashiyya and when Tuzhiriin.} 419. He brings out the living from the dead, and brings out the dead from the living. And He revives the earth after its death. And thus shall you be brought out.} The Command to pray Five Times Daily Here Allah glorifies Himself and commands His servants to glorify and praise Him at these times which come one after the other and are indicative of His might and power in the heavens. This is when the night comes with its darkness, then in the morning the day comes with its light. This glorification is followed by befitting praise, as Allah says:

4And His is all the praise in the heavens and the earth;} meaning, He is the One who is to be praised for what He has created in the heavens and on earth. Then Allah says: Jifj &*>} 4and in Ashiyya and when Tuzhiriin.} - the Ashiyy is the time when the darkness is most intense, and Izhar is the brightest point of the day. Glory be to the OneWho created both ofthem, the Cleaver of the daybreak and the One Who makes night a time of rest. Allah says: m At-Tabari 20 :82

4And you see the earth barren, but when We send down water on it, it is stirred, and it swells and puts forth every lovely kind.} until: 4and certainly, Allah will resurrect those who are in the graves.} (22:5-7) 4M Jil% 3# ii: \Uj. <\$And if is He Who sends the winds as heralds ofglad tidings, going before His mercy. Till when they have carried a heavy- laden cloud} until: iso that you may remember or take heed.} (7:57) Allah says here: 4And thus shall you be brought out.} 3E. 3 2 ytf oj pSi 3 M j l\ ip^ j3 "0*^' 420. And among His signs is this that He created you from dust, and then - behold you are human beings scattered!} 421. And among His signs is this that He created Jbr you wives from among yourselves, that you may find repose in them, and He has put between you affection and mercy. Verily, in that are indeed signsfor a people who reflect.} Among the Signs ofAllah Allah says: 4And among His signs} - which speak of His might and power, is the fact that He created your fatherAdam out of dust. &%%}

Ar-Rum (22 - 23) (Part-21 Allah said: ^ jji. J 4And among His signs is this that He created for you wives from among yourselves,} meaning, *He created females ofyourown kind, tobe wives foryou. 4that you mayfind repose in them,} This is like the Ayah, --w j-VI> w?" oi 411 is He Who has created you from a single person, and He has createdfrom him his wife, in order that he might enjoy the pleasure ofliving with her} (7:189). This refers to Hawwa'. Allah created her from Adam, from the short rib on his left. If Allah had made all of Adam s progeny male, and created the females from another kind, such as from Jinn or animals, there would never have been harmony between them and their spouses. There would have been revulsion if the spouses had been from a different kind. Out of Allah s perfect mercy He made their wives from their own kind, and created love and kindness between them. For a man stays with a woman because he loves her, or because he feels compassion towards her if they have a child together, or because she needs him to take care of her, etc. 4& /\$, ail'i 4 d[} 4Verily, in that are indeed signsfor a people who reflect.} yJ i'h tj 5) <-*& {} Jti- -ij4 422 . And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the difference of your languages and colors. Verily, in that are indeed signsfor men ofsound knowledge.} 423 . And among His signs is your sleep by night and by day, and your seeking His bounty. Verily, in that are indeed signs for a people who listen.}

Allah said: Kf} AAnd. among His signs} indicating His magnificent power. iofM &*>} \$is the creation of the heavens and the earth,} The heavens with their vast height and brightness and beauty of the stars and planets, and the earth with its density and its mountains, valleys, seas, plains, animals and trees. iand the difference ofyour languages} So, we see that some speak Arabic, and the Tatars have their own language, as do the Georgians, Romans, Franks, Berbers, Tou Couleurs (of Sudan), Ethiopians, Indians, Persians, Slavs, Khazars, Armenians, Kurds and others. Only Allah knows the variety of languages spoken among the sons ofAdam. And the difference of their colors mentioned here refers to their appearance, for all the people of this world, from the time that Allah created Adam, and until the Hour begins, each of them has two eyes, two eyebrows, a nose, a forehead, a mouth and two cheeks, but none

of them looks like another; there is bound to be some difference in posture, appearance and speech, whether it is apparent or is hidden and can only be noticed with careful observation. Each face has its own characteristics and does not look like another; even if there was a group of people who looked alike, having a beautiful or ugly characteristic in common, there would still be a difference between one person and the next. 4Verily, in that are indeed signs far men of sound knowledge.} .f' wb J IfS} 4And among His signs is your sleep by night and by day, and your seeking of His bounty.} Among His signs is the cycle of sleep that He has created during the night and the day, when people are able to cease moving and rest, so that their tiredness and exhaustion will go

Ar-Rum (24 - 25) (Part-21 jn>. t"v iL-l! z4i^U ^"J ^\j-C>_c jj J^=c^jVij v > *y "" / *V> " **> / ^ - "< Up == r/ // i<* * > ^ J ""* *- >"1 ^ ^ >" *_ yJill jLUJ ^it ^ upLuV E^P^away. And He has enabled you to seek to earn a living and to travel about during the day, this is the opposite of sleep. -f.A J\$ O^ /- >' '\$Verily, in that are indeed signs far a people who listen.} meaning, understand. ^=*y. &*' jtj} & \$z& " a 6> i ? JjJ'i 4 < l jyjij j CAJ l"J -, "a\ J"ji\j "CJi ^ c ' >>:- 424. And among His signs is that He shows you the lightning, far fear and far hope, and He sends down water from the sky, and therewith revives the earth after its death. Verily, in that are indeed signs far a people who understand> 425. And among His signs is that the heaven and the earth stand by His command. Then afterwards when He will call you by a single call, behold, you will come out from the earth.} Allah says, &>} 4And among His signs} which speak of His greatness, 4^ ^ j tjji- !* ="->/_ 4He shows you the lightning, far fear and far hope,}

dead will come forth from their graves, brought back to life by His command and His call to them, 4* *- "" Jf " > /" v 477ien afterwards when He will call you by a single call, behold, you will come out from the earth.} This is like the Ayat. > "v> <- (j;> }On the Day when He will call you, and you will answer with His praise and obedience, and you will think that you have stayed but a little while!} (17:52) iBut it will be only a single ZajrahP1 When behold, they find themselves on the surface of the earth alive after their death.} (79:13-14), and 4 L-i-d 1JU.j .-z\ ilt will be but a single SayhahJ21 so behold they will all be brought up before Us!} (36:53). ^ J-V. jk) " Jd J^=> oylli' j ,y > /-'tf > ' .f <*- K' c . To Him belongs whatever is in the heavens and the earth. All are obedient to Him.} 427. And He it is Who originates the creation, then He will repeat it; and this is easier for Him. His is the highest description in the heavens and in the earth. And He is the All- Mighty, the All-Wise.} Allah says: * *%} 4To Him belongs whatever is in the heavens and the earth.} means, He owns it and it is enslaved to Him. See the Tafsir of Surat As-Saff&t (37 : 19) * See volume five , the Tafsir of Surah Hud (11 :94)

540 Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr i'n iAll are obedient to Him.} they are humble before Him and submit to Him, whether willingly or unwillingly. Repeating the Creation is easier for Allah Allah s saying: / * f* > /> / " > ^ .if f^zZl dW* J-V. Jr*J7 iAnd He it is Who originates the creation, then He will repeat it; and this is easier for Him.} Ibn Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, This means it is easier for Him. ' Mujahid said: Repeating it is easier for Him than originating it, and originating it is easy for Him. This was also the view of IkTimah and others. Al-Bukh&ri recorded that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said that the Prophet jgg said: tvilJi d pj ijjJi d p fjL ^ JI Jt tp- ^Aj ^ y ijC\ Al; p jp\ Ami A^S/i ulj jAJj i Aiii lila iSfj toSUj iJ AijI "Allah says; The son of Adam denied Me, and he had no right to do so. And he reviled Me, and he had no right to do so. As for his denying Me, it is his saying: He mil not remake me as He originated me' - while originating the creation is not easier for Me than re-creating

him . As for his reviling Me, it is his saying: Allah has taken to Himself a son,' while I am the One, the Self-Sufficient Master; I beget not, nor was I begotten, and there is none comparable to Me." This was recorded only by Al-Bukhari.** a0 3Tabari 20:92. * AMabari 20:92. * At-Tabari 20 :92 * Fath Al-Bari 8 :611 612.

Ar-Rum (28 - 29) (Part-21) {His is the highest description in the heavens and in the earth.} Ali bin Abi Talhah reported Ibn Abbas said, This is like the Ayah: iThere is nothing like Him} (42:11). Qatadah said: His description is La. ilaha tilalldh, and there is no Lord but He. jXLii! 'fjri.jf " IS j3l o? ,J3 ^ gi Jf . He sets forth for you a parable from yourselves : Do you have partners among those whom your right hands possess to share as equals in the wealth We have bestowed on you, whom you fear as you fear each other? Thus do We explain the signs in detail to a people who have sense.} 429. Nay, but those who do wrong follow their own lusts without knowledge. Then who will guide him whom Allah has sent astray? Andfor such there will be no helpers.} A Parable ofTawhtd This is the parable Allah makes of the idolators, those who worship others besides Him and attribute partners to Him, while at the same time admitting that these so-called partners - idols and false gods - are enslaved to and belong to Him. In their Talbiyah (during Hajj and Umrah they used to say, At Your service, You have no partner except the partner that You have, You own Him and whatever he owns. If ^} iHe setsforthfor you a parablefrom yourselves} something which you yourselves can see witness, and understand. 4Do you have partners among those whom your right hands

542 Tafsir Ibtî Kathir possess to share as equals in the wealth We have bestowed on you...?) None ofyou would like to have his servant as a partner in his wealth, each ofthem having an equal share. iwhom youfear as you fear each other.} *You fear that they will have a share in your wealth with you. Abu Mijlaz said, You do not fear that your servant will have a share in your wealth, because he has no such right; similarly, Allah has no partner. ' The point is, that since any one of you would abhor such a thing, how can you attribute rivals to Allah from among His creation? At-Tabarani recorded that Ibn Abbas said, The people of Shirk used to say in their Talbiyah, At Your service, You have no partner except the partner that You have, You own Him and whatever he owns. Then Allah revealed the words: Sip *_j J=s ij C ^ il == "r^ J* U iDo you have partners among tlwse whom your right hands possess to share as equals in the wealth We have bestowed on you, whom youfear as you fear each other?}" If humans have this characteristic, this parable shows that it is even less befitting for Allah to have a partner. jjjiJ f \$Thus do We explain the signs in detail to a people who have sense.} Then Allah points out that when the idolaters worship others instead of Him, doing so out of their own folly and ignorance: 4Nay, but those who do wrongfallow...}, meaning, the idolaters,Jabari 20:96. AJ-Tabarfini 12 :20 , with aweak chain ofnarration

4...their own lusts} means, in their worship of false gods without knowledge. ^JZ} iThen who will guide him whom Allah has sent astray?) means, no one can guide them if Allah has decreed that they will be misguided. 4Andfor such there will be no helpers .} means, there is no one who can save them from the power of Allah or grant them a way out, for what He wills, happens and what He does not will, does not happen. *?!. V Aiff Jji S' \j& A iyjs % 4ij^of^t (Vr_J tL 430. So, set you your face towards the religion as a Hanif. Allah's Fitrah with which He has created mankind. No change let there be in Allah's Khalq, that is the straight religion, but most men know not.} 431. (And remain always) turning in

repentance to Him and have Taqwa of Him; and perform the Salah and be not of idolators.} 432. Of those who split up their religion, and became sects, each sect rejoicing in that which is with it.} The Command to adhere to Tawhid Allah says: so set your face and persevere in the religion which Allah has prescribed for you, the worship of Allah Alone, the religion of Ibrahim, to which Allah has guided you and which He has perfected for you with the utmost perfection. In this manner, you will also adhere to the sound Fitrah with which He created His creation. Allah created His

tjiiJ JtJ4 4No change let there be in Allah's Khalq,} It means, the religion of Allah, and the religion, and the Fitrah is Islam. Then he reported that Abu Hurayrah said, The Messenger of Allah sg said: j\ j I oljli S^kiJl l_Jj V) JJj ijJ* Jj* li "No child is bom except in a state of Fitrah, then his parents make him a Jew or a Christian or a Zoroastrian, just as each animal produces a perfect animal like itself - do you see any among them that are bom mutilated?" then the narrator (Abu Hurayrah) said (recite this Ayah), 4^' il jyj V J,\3\ j& \$\$ ojJb iAllah s Fitrah with which He has created mankind. No change let there be in Allah s Khalq, that is the straight religion.} This was also recorded by Muslim.111 4 !:if 4that is the straight religion, means, adherence to the Shari'ah and the sound Fitrah is the true, straight religion. 4& v 4but most men know not.} means, most people do not know this and they deviate far astray from it, as Allah says: 4And most of mankind will not believe even if you desire it eagerly.} (12:103) u* Jljt-i" Jfji\ j a* ^ j } 4And ifyou obey most of those on the earth, they will mislead you far awayfrom Allah's path (6:1 16). Id FathAl-Bari 8 :372 11:512, Muslim 4 :2047 , 2048

ituming in repentance to Hint} Ibn Zayd and Ibn Jurayj said, This means, returning to Him. iand have Taqwa ofHim;} means, fear Him and remember that He is always watching. iand perform the Salah}, which is the greatest act of worship.^ iand be not of the idolators.} Be of those who single out Allah, devoting their worship sincerely for Him alone, not anyone or anything other them Him. Ibn Jarir recorded that Yazid bin Abi Maryam said: Umar, may Allah be pleased with him, passed by Mu'adh bin Jabal and asked, What is the foundation of this Ummah? Mu'adh seiid, Three things, and they eire the things that will bring salvation: Al-Ikhlās (doing a deed for Allah alone), which is the Fitrah with which Allah created mankind; Salah, which is the thing that tells a believer apart from a disbeliever; and obedience, which is protection. Umar said: Tou have spoken the truth. "I21 Splitting into Sects and the Saved Sect131 His saying: f*r.3 y p&i bu* yf iOf those who Farraqn Dtnahum (split up their religion), and became sects, each sect rejoicing in that which is with it.} means, do not be of the idolators who split up their religion, i.e., changed it by believing in parts of it and rejecting other parts. Some scholars read this as Faraqu Dinahum, meaning At-Tabari 20:100 AMabari 20 :98. * This is one of the headings added to the English version of this book.

J i A J^ f10iiA24PiAi3^i: ? * ""\ ft'* -> " > A 'Ss.s *fit1 l^>-^~c^ul "eLiJ^J 10 /j L j. *~^..l;l IU^ilUiOluij0 iiU'j IJy^tjjJjd c jll t'j"a",waJl|i8^l>(^i>^""^j3 '!'>-'.' .*e ' . V,' -"- ' iVt/> \$o^..i> 0>^("4^ c J)'y*jj""^jJp-Q I(JICI ^^^ neglected their religion and left it behind them. These are like the Jews, Christians, Zoroastrians, idol worshippers and all the followers of false religions, besides the followers of Islam, as Allah says: (Irii 'At* Ctift p*^/LS) {ij J (i{ij c-ll 4^Ji iVerily, those who divide their religion and break up into sects, you have no concern in them in the least. Their affair is only with Allahb (6:159). The followers of the religions before us had differences of opinions and split into false sects, each group claiming to be following the truth. This Ummah too has split into sects, all of which

are misguided apart from one, which is Ahlus-Sunnah Wal-Jama'ah, those who adhere to the Book of Allah and the Sunnah of the Messenger of Allah^ and what was followed by the first generations, the Companions, their followers, and the Imams of the

o^J t? \fzf ***--> cr*-- r-i ** i 9 **+* [**M "j o) jjip o_ jri 4i"" J it/ pi j*ppJ c-*jS 4 5 ^. And when harm touches men, they cry sincerely only to their Lord, turning to Him in repentance; but when He gives them a taste of His mercy, behold, a party of them associates partners in worship with their Lord.} 434. So as to be ungrateful for the graces which We have bestowed on them. Then enjoy; but you will come to know.} 435. Or have We revealed to them an authority, which speaks of that which they have been associating with Him?} 436. And when We cause mankind to taste of mercy, they rejoice therein; but when some evil afflicts them because of wltat their lumds have sentforth, behold, they are in despair!} 437. Do they not see that Allah expands the provision for whom He wills and straitens (itfor whom He wills). Verily, in that are indeed signs for a people who believe.} How man sways between Tawhid and Shirk, and between Joy and Despair, according to His Circumstances Allah tells us that when man is in dire straits, he calls upon Allah alone with no partner or associate, then when times of ease come and they have the choice, some people associate others with Allah and worship others alongside Him. 4So as to be ungrateful for the graces which We have bestowed on them.} Then Allah warns them by saying: ibut you will come to know.} One ofthem said: By Allah, if a law

enforcment officer were to say this to me, I would be afraid, so how about when the One Who is issuing the warning is the One Who merely says to a thing Be! and it is? Then Allah denounces the idolators for fabricating lies and worshipping others instead ofHim with no evidence or proof: ft 40r have We revealed to them an authority,} means, proof. ip iwhich speaks} means, tells iof that which they have been associating with Him?} This is a rhetorical question intended to denounce them, for they have no such thing. iAnd when We cause mankind to taste of mercy, they rejoice therein ; but when some evil afflicts them because ofwhat their hands have sent forth, behold, they are in despair!} This is a denunciation of man for the way he is, except for those whom Allah protects and helps, for when man is given blessings, he is proud, and says: it&Mf* M Xsf v*->? 4'7/Zs have departed from me. Surely, he is exultant, and boastful.} (11:10) He rejoices over himself and boasts to others, but when difficulties befall him, He despairs of ever having anything good again. Allah says: 4Except those who show patience and do righteous good deeds}. They are patient during times of difficulty and do good deeds at times of ease. It was reported in the Sahih: oU.1 o! 13 \js- b\s Vi ;uJ iJ iii

550 Tafslr Ibn Kathir 8 1 iljJ? ^f jlJ l <! I "How wonderful is the affair of the believer. Allah does not decree anything for him but it is good for him. Ifgood things happen to him, he gives thanks, and that is good for him; and if bad things happen to him, he bears that with patience, and that is goodfor him .s 4->-iffi iLS ii l' Jhu ' 3^ \fj iDo they not see that Allah expands the provision for whom He wills and straitens (itfor whom He wills).} He is the One Who is controlling and doing that, by His wisdom and justice, so He expands the provision for some people and restricts it for some. iVerily, in that are indeed signsfor a people who believe.} Jbljtj 4jif ' ty fti ju ^ U IjJ o# ty jti J-3 j^JLb is j^aU- ttJi ii' -j 438. So, give to the kindred his due, and to Al-Miskin and to the wayfarer. That is bestfor those who seek Allah's Face; and it is they who will be successful.} 439. And that which you give in Riba in order that it may increase from other people's property, has no increase with Allah; but that which you give in Zakah

seeking Allah's Face, then those they shall have manifold increase.} 440. Allah is He Who created you, then provided food for you, then will cause you to die, then He will give you life. Is there any of your partners that do anything of that? Glory be to Him! And Exalted be He above all that they associate.} Muslim 4 :2295

The Command to uphold the Ties of Kinship and the Prohibition of Riba Allah commands giving: 4to the kindred his due^ his due of respect and upholding the ties of kinship. iand to Al-Misktn} the one who has nothing to spend on his needs, or he has something but it is not enough. SS 4and to the wayfarer.} the traveler who is in need of money and other things during his journey. iThat is best for those who seek Allah's Face;} meaning; to look upon Him on the Day of Resurrection, which is the ultimate aim. 4^}^} iand it is they who will be successful.} means, in this world and the Hereafter. Then Allah says: jlc [gjt Mi M JyS -j gy iiJ }And that which you give in Riba, in order that it may increase from other people's property, has no increase with Allah;} This means, that which is given as a gift to others in the hope that they will give back more than they were given. There is no reward for this with Allah. This is how this Ayah was interpreted by Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah, Ikrimah, Muhammad bin Ka*b and Ash-Sha'bi. 11 * Allah says: 4but that which you give in Zakdh seeking Allah's Face, then IM AKTabari 20:104, 105.

\ ^ ' i . t . ^ U " / t ^ > A Cjll5y> Lr'^rjJt^Jo^Jo / ^ ^ ^). * s s * s //)*>*V" Kpo^O_ ^J^ yo >* S- ^ " ^ * V/ > / '+'} *S+Sy > * "'." * ^ y" _j dvpu^SCij 5A^C~AA ' %ajC^oi :'^tLA*vI~^^^ j-4^ o*J-^iy^oJ]\$ 4dial do anything of that?} meaning, none of them are able to do any of that. But Allah is the One Who is Independent in His powers of creation, provision, and giving life and death. Then He will resurrect His creation on the Day of Resurrection. This is why, after all this He says: 2; ^.} i^AA iGlory be to Him! And Exalted be He above all that they associate.} meaning, exalted and sanctified and glorified be He far above having any partner, peer, equal, son or father, for He is the One, the Unique, the Self-Sufficient Master, Who begets not nor was He begotten, and there is none comparable unto Him. i"fuJ \jif cJj)' jau jJ_ ojili *sf} c*" W fiibA q A-il' f-A} if- A &A 'A iiA^ fy-; J 4AAA 442 . Evil has appeared in Al-Barr and Al-Bahr because of what the hands of mm have earned, that He may make them taste a part of that which they have done, in order that they may return .} 442. Say: "Travel in the land and see what was the end of those before (you)! Most of them were idolaters."}

554 Tafstr Ibn Kathir The Effects of Sin in this World Ibn Abbas, Ikrimah, Ad-Dahhak, As-Sudd! and others said: What is meant by Al-Barr here is the empty land or wilderness, and by Al-Bahr is towns and cities. According to a report narrated from Ibn Abbas and Ikrimah, Al-Bahr refers to towns and cities which are on the banks of rivers . Others said that what was meant was the usual meaning of the words, i.e., land and sea. Zayd bin Rafi said: iEvil lias appeared> The rain is withheld from the land and this is followed by famine, and it is withheld from the sea, adversely affecting the animals which live in it. This was recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim, who said: Muhammad bin Abdullah bin Yazld Al- Muqri' told us, from Sufyan from Humayd bin Qays Al-A raj from Mujahid: iEvil has appeared on land and sea> Evil on land means the killing of the son of Adam, and evil on the sea means piracy. According to the first opinion, the phrase, iEvil has appeared on land and sea because of what the hands of men have earned,> means the shortfall in the crops and fruits is because of sins. Abu Al- Aliyah said: Whoever disobeys Allah in the earth has corrupted it, because the good condition of the earth and the heavens

depends on obedience to Allah. Hence it says in the Hadith which was recorded by Abu Dawud: J fuj Jill Any prescribed punishment which is carried out in the land is better for its people than if it were to rain for forty days, a131 At-Jabari 20:108. At-Tabari 20:108. [31 An-Nasab 8:75.

The reason for that is that if the prescribed punishments are

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 4421]

carried out, this will deter the people - most or many of them - from violating the prohibitions of Allah. If they give up sin, this will be a cause of blessings in the skies and on the earth. So, when Isa bin Maryam, peace be upon him, comes down at

the end of time, he will judge according to this Shari'ah at

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4421–4423]

that time, and will kill the pigs and break the cross and abolish the Jizyah. He will accept nothing except Islam or the sword. When Allah destroys the Dajjal and his followers, and Ya juj and Ma juj during his time, it will be said to the earth, bring forth your blessing. Then groups of people will eat from one pomegranate, and will seek shade beneath its skin, and the milk of one pregnant camel will be sufficient for a group of people. This will only be because of the blessings that will result from application of the Shar'ah of Muhammad ag. The more justice is established, the more the blessings and good things will increase. It was reported in the Sahih: yJiiVj ^ oii >;u3i !ii" *When the evildoer dies, it is a relief for the people, the land, the trees and the animals. n11 ' Imam

in order that they may return .} means, from disobedience. This is like the Ayah, '^>* (H" *s**s 4And We tried them with good and evil in order that might turn.) (7:168). Then Allah says: they iSay: "Travel in the land and see what was the end of those before (you)!"} meaning, those who came before you. 4^4J&J iMost of them were idolaters.} means, so see what happened to them when they rejected the Messengers and were ungrateful for the blessings. [>*- & * >* j& i- -a' > > ' t: t ' ' ' 443. So, set your face to the straight and right religion, before there comes from Allah a Day which none can avert. On that Day men shall be divided .} 444. Whosoever disbelieves will suffer from his disbelief, and whosoever does righteous good deeds, then such will prepare a good place for themselves .} 445. That He may reward those who believe and do righteous good deeds, out of His bounty. Verily, He likes not the disbelievers .} The Command to follow the Straight Path before the Day of Resurrection Here Allah commands His servants to hasten to obedience to Him and to hasten to do good deeds. 4^ li/i A if y uUiJ 4So, set your face to the straight and right religion, before

there comes from Allah a Day which none can avert

The Day of Resurrection, for when Allah wants it to happen,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4423–4434]

no one will be able to avert it. -U-y} iOti that Day men shall be divided. means, they will be separated, with one group in Paradise and another in Hell. Allah says: 4/jjl i +i ioJLL* r*y iWhosoever disbelieves

will suffer from his disbelief, and whoever does righteous good deeds, then such will prepare a good place for themselves. That He may reward those who believe, and do righteous good deeds, out of His bounty.> meaning that He may reward them from His bounty, in return for one good deed, he will get the reward for ten, up to seven hundred like it, as much as Allah wills. 4i -5 iVerily, He likes not the disbelievers.} yet He is still just with them and does not oppress them. ? / *" |' z- ,> 1 ZZ . y\ !> *% -is'o 0: fW Jfjj j our z Z* ZZ ^ # #Z Z Z^^ Z "z Z"z i zZZ^ Z ^iZfZ Azz Z^ #z lu okxJL -xiJj 4 ^ uib ik /z-ift Ti'j <(46. And among His signs is this that He sends the winds as glad tidings, giving you a taste of His mercy, and that the ships may sail at His command, and that you may seek of His bounty, in order that you may be thankful.) 447. And indeed We did send Messengers before you to their own peoples. They came to them with clear proofs, then, We took vengeance on those who committed crimes; and it was incumbent upon Us to help the believers.} Among the Signs of Allah are the Winds Here Allah mentions the favor He does for His creatures by sending winds to them, as harbingers of His mercy, meaning

that they will be followed by rain. Allah says: (giving you a taste of His mercy,) that is, the rain which will come down and revive people and the land. iand that the ships may sail at His command,) means, on the sea, for they are driven by the wind. \yll3j) iand that you may seek of His bounty,) means, by trading, earning a living and traveling from one country to another, one region to another. iin order that you may be thankful.) means, that you may give thanks to Allah for the innumerable favors He has done for you, both visible and hidden. Then Allah says: fl* di S j. Zij) iAnd indeed We did send Messengers before you to their own peoples. They came to them with clear proofs, then, We took vengeance on those who committed crimes;) These are words of consolation from Allah to His servant and Messenger Muhammad ig. They tell him that if many of his people and of mankind disbelieve in him, the previous Messengers were also rejected, despite the clear signs that they brought, but Allah punished those who rejected and opposed them, and saved those who believed in them. iand it was incumbent upon Us to help the believers.) This is a duty which Allah took upon Himself as a blessing and a favor to them. This is like the Ayah, iyour Lord has prescribed mercy for Himself) (6:54). Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Ad-Darda , may Allah be

ms& n- tmmm pleased with him, ' r ; \X"v . > -> 'J ;// ^ << - > > ^rf. .W/Jf'Y 'Z*' .<{ \ \".*V\ -i.T> *^s?' *-t> */ i i x ps . ^ * +** */ < i> // _ "> "J L^*J^>* Jifc(joz&l said: I heard Allah s Messenger jg saying: J* . (4^ JcS4' ot U>- jl5 Ml <> ! j fji (--<?' J^> * ^ji jil iiQjl "No

449. And verily, before that - just before it was sent down upon them - they were in despair!} 450. Look then at the effects of Allah's mercy, how He revives the earth after its death. Verily, that shall indeed raise the dead, and He is able to do all things.} 451 . And if We send a wind, and they see it him yellow - behold, they then would become unthankful (disbelievers) .} The Revival of the Barth is a Sign of the Resurrection Here Allah explains how He creates the clouds that rain the water. 4Allah is He Who sends the xinds, so that they raise clouds either from the sea, as was mentioned by more than one (of the scholars), or from whatever Allah wills. 4*&i j (Dalxj) 4and spread them along the sky as He wills,} means, He spreads them and causes them to increase and grow. From a little He makes a lot, and creates the clouds that look like shields. Then He spreads them out until they fill the horizon. Sometimes the clouds come from the sea, heavy and full, as Allah says: VliS Ijl 4And it is He Wlw sends the winds as heralds of glad tidings, going before His mercy. Till when they have carried a heavy-

laden cloud, We drive it to a land that is dead until: il* jp'f jg. 4Similarly, We shall raise up the dead, so that you may remember or take heed.} (7:57) Allah says here: ^ J 4Allah is He Wlw sends the winds, so that they raise clouds

567Siirah 30. Ar-Riim (48 - 57) (Part-21) and spread them along the sky as He wills, and then break them into fragments^ Mujahid, Abu Amr bin Al- Ala , Matar Al-Warraq and Qatadah said, This means pieces. Others said that it means piled up, as Ad-Dahhak said. Others said that it means black, because they contained so much water, and sometimes they are heavy and close to the earth. His saying: 4..4^r it iuntil you see rain drops come forth from their midst!} means, so you see the drops, i.e., the rain, which come from the midst of those clouds. 'ij isjL^ ibi ,y .Ai iThen when He has made them fall on whom of His servants as He wills, lo, they rejoice!} They rejoice at the rain when it comes to them because of their need for it. Jt o* crt j}? iAnd verily, before that - just before it was sent down upon them - they were in despair!} The people to whom this rain came were in despair, thinking that it rain would never fall, just before it came to them. When it came to them, it came at the time of greatest need, so it was a tremendous event for them What this means is that they were in need of it before it fell, and there had been no rainfall for a long time, so they were waiting for it at the time when it was due, but it did not come to them at that time. The rain was late, and a long time passed. Then the rain came to them suddenly, after they began to despair, and after their land became dry and barren, it was stirred to life, and it swelled and produced every lovely kind of growth. Allah says: ^ til -iLook then at the effects of Allah's mercy,} meaning, the rain, m At-Jabari 20:114.

Ar-Rum (52 - 53) (Part-21) can make to hear only those who believe in Our Ayat, and have submitted (to Allah in Islam).) The Disbelievers are like the Dead, Deaf and Blind Allah says, just as you are not able to make the dead hear in their graves, or to make your words reach the deaf who cannot hear and who still turn away from you, so too you cannot guide the blind to the truth and bring them back from their misguidance. That is a matter which rests with Allah, for by His power He can make the dead hear the voices of the living if He wills. He guides whom He wills and sends astray whom He wills, and no one but He has the power to do this. Allah says: (% v iyou can make to hear only those who believe in Our Ayat, and have submitted (to Allah in Islam).) means, those who are humble and who respond and obey. These are the ones who will listen to the truth and follow it; this is the state of the believers; the former (being deaf and blind) is the state of the disbelievers, as Allah says: Jr ii' t?" ^ J'j 1 I it is only those who listen will respond, but as for the dead, Allah will raise them up, then to Him they will be returned.) (6:36) A ishah, the Mother of the faithful, may Allah be pleased with her, used this Ayah - 44P *? At iSo verily, you cannot make the dead to hear) as evidence against Abdullah bin Umar when he reported that the Prophet sg had addressed the slain disbelievers who had been thrown into a dry well three days after the battle of Badr, rebuking and reprimanding them, until Umar said, O Messenger of Allah, are you addressing people who are dead bodies? He said: V jfoU jUif U ;J1 ^Jly "By the One in Whose Hand is my soul, you do not hear what

Ar-Rum (54 - 57) (Part-21 whatever way He wants. 4^ %) 4And He is the All-Knowing, the All-Powerful.} xV / V /"" "x"< r/ < X/ *> * ^ J, . *x/ x* "x i> { / ix pi ^-A2_43 cJLJI 4\$ (j -XjJ platf ju)t ^ i'^ ^ g v v 4r KS . And on f/je Day that the Hour will be established, the criminals will swear that they stayed not but an hour - thus were they ever deluded.} 456. And those who have been bestowed with

knowledge and Faith will say: Indeed you have stayed according to the decree of Allah, until the Day of Resurrection; so this is the Day of Resurrection, but you knew not."} 457. So, on that Day no excuse of theirs will avail those who did wrong, nor will they be allowed to return to seek (Allah's) pleasure.} The Ignorance of the Disbelievers in this World and in the Hereafter Here Allah tells us of the ignorance of the disbelievers in this world and in the Hereafter. In this world they worship idols, and in the Hereafter they will also display great ignorance. They will swear by Allah that they did not even stay for one hour in this world. They will mean that there was not enough time given to establish proof against them which would leave them with no excuse. Allah says: : dj >-tJ jjJ (*yi !A>' J'b \j < &)&'} 4thus were they ever deluded. And those who have been bestowed with knowledge and Faith will say: "Indeed you have stayed according to the decree of Allah, until the Day of Resurrection .. ."} The believers who have knowledge of the Hereafter will

respond to them, just as they established the proof of Allah against them in this world. When they swear that they did not stay even one hour in this world, they will say to them: ^Indeed you have stayed according to the decree ofAllah,} meaning, the Book of deeds, & iutilil the Day of Resurrection ;} means, from the day when you were created until the dayyou were resurrected. ibut you knew not.} Allah says: ^So, on that Day} meaning, the Day of Resurrection, ino excuse of theirs will avail those wlv did wrong,} means, their excuses for what they did. inor will they be allowed (then) to return to seek (Allah's) pleasure.} means, they will not be allowed to return to this world. This is like the Ayah, Sj (**& iand if they seek to please (Allah), yet they are not ofthose who will ever be allowed to please (Allah)} (41:24). (| v vjg \$> ki tiiSM i '\$ k i58. And indeed We have setforthfor mankind, in this Qur'an every kind of parable. But if you bring to them any sign or proof, the disbelievers are sure to say (to the believers): You

Ar-Riim (58 - 60) (Part-21 follow nothing butfalsehood and magic."} 459. Thus does Allah seal up the hearts of those who know not.} 460. So be patient. Verily, the promise ofAllah is true; and let not those who have no certainty offaith discourage you (from conveying Allah's Message).} Parables in the Qur an and bow the Disbelievers do not learn from them 4S^f ot 'jcj* x&j} 4And indeed We have set forth for mankind, in this Qur'an every kind ofparable.} means. We have explained the truth to them and have made it clear to them, and have set forth for them parables so that they may understand the truth and follow it.' ol c/j)\ i-kj jjSj} 4But ifyou bring to them any sign or proof, the disbelievers are sure to say (to the believers): "You follow nothing butfalsehood and magic."} If they were to see any kind of sign, whether it was at their own direction or otherwise, they would not believe in it and they would think that it was magic and falsehood, as they said when the moon was cleft asunder, etc., as Allah says: 4Truly, those, against whom the Word of your Lord has been justified, will not believe. Even if every sign should come to them, until they see the painful torment.} (10:96-97). Allah says here: V "-yli ii' 4Thus does Allah seal up the hearts of those who know not. So be patient. Verily, the promise ofAllSh is true;} meaning, bear their stubborn opposition with patience, for Allah will fulfill His promise to grant you victory over them

56S Tafsir Ibn Kathir and cause you and those who follow you to prevail in this world and in the Hereafter. let not those who have no certainty offaith discourage you (from conveying Allah s Message). Remain steadfast in the mission with which Allah has sent you, for it is truth in which there

is no doubt. Do not turn away from it, for nowhere else is there truth which is to be followed; the truth rests exclusively in the Message with which you have been sent. Reports concerning the Virtues of this Surah and that it is recommended to recite it during Fajr Imam

Module 28

Surah 31: Luqman, Surah 32: As-Sajdah, Surah 33: Al-Ahzab

Surah 31: Luqman

PDF pages 4435–4469

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 4435]

Opening The Tafsir of Surah Luqman (Chapter - 31)

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4435–4449]

In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. t\\ ("4pJ AjO 1 e^V^cy^J r > . lC < *> S ,/ / "*"> / / .jVK^ -Jyy. S'S okjliUiU oj^j^p j - jjo -oo o& />/^ > ^x? ' \\ty *->*Vsp oWljicfj^ t' > // , / . ^^ ^ /' * *> i" i& ii; ^ i:^if c/jJ^ . ^ . lift ' *?" ".5^.# *) > / / < / > 0-t tW-" i a .o*I' |*-" liUJlj ("*"j> il. AlifLam Mim .} 42. These are Aydt of the Wise Book 43 . A guide and a mercy for the Muhsinin .} 44. Those ivho perform the Saldh and give Za- kah and they have faith in the Hereafter with certainty 45 . Such are on guidance from their Lord, and such are the successful.} At the beginning of Surat Al-Baqarah we discussed the letters such as those that appear at the beginning of this Surah. Allah has made the Qur an a guidance and healing and a mercy for the Muhsinin, who are those who do good deeds in accordance with the

Luqman (6 - 7) (Part-21 fear their Lord shiverfrom it. Then their skin and their heart soften to the remembrance ofAllah} (39:23). He connect that with mention of the doomed, those who turn away from the Qur an and do not benefit from hearing the Words of Allah. Instead, they turn to listening to flutes and singing accompanied by musical instruments. As Ibn Mas*ad commented about the Ayah: Siff" if- J-jJ iSfLJ 4And of mankind is he who purchases Lahii Al-Hadith to mislead (men)from the path ofAllah}, he said, This - by Allah - refers to singing. 4f? if J-jJ if ifj} iAnd of mankind is he who purchases Lahw Al-Hadith to mislead (men)from the path ofAllah without knowledge,} Qatadah said: By Allah, he may not spend money on it, but his purchasing it means he likes it, and the more misguided he is, the more he likes it and the more he prefers falsehood to the truth and harmful things over beneficial things. It was said that what is meant by the words Si 4purchases idle talks} is buying singing servant girls. Ibn Jarir said that it means all speech that hinders people from seeing the signs ofAllah and following His path. His saying: 4\$ o* s 4to mislead (men)from the path ofAllah} means, he does this to oppose Islam and its followers. iand takes it by way of mockery.} Mujahid said, This means At-Tabari 20 :127 * At-Tabari 20:127. * At-Tabari 20:130.

mocking the path ofAllah and making fun of it. 111 iPP p }For such there will be a humiliating torment.} Just as they showed no respect to the signs and path of Allah, so they will be shown no respect on the Day of Resurrection, and they will be subjected to a painful, ongoing torment. Then Allah says: iAnd when Our Ayat are recited to such a one, he turns away in pride, as if he heard than not

- as if there were deafness in his ear.} means, when these Qur'anic verses are recited to one who is fond of idleness and play, he turns away from them and does not want to hear them. He turns a deaf ear to them as if he can hear nothing, because it annoys him to hear them since he gains no benefit from them and has no interest in them. ifJ} iSo announce to him a painful torment.} i.e., on the Day of Resurrection, which will hurt him just as much as listening to the Book of Allah and its verses hurt him. /> /." * // " / p i ip: u} jP }8. Verily, those who believe and do righteous good deeds, for them are Gardens of Delight.} 49. To abide therein. It is a promise of Allah in truth. And He is the All-Mighty, the All-Wise.} The Good Destiny of the Believers Here Allah mentions the destiny of the righteous in the Hereafter, those who believe in Allah and His Messenger m and do righteous deeds in accordance with the Laws of Allah. p m At-Tabari 20:131.

Luqmdn (10 - 37) (Part-21) 4for them are Gardens of Delight.} means, there they will enjoy all kinds of delights and pleasures, food, drink, clothing, dwelling- places, means of transportation, women, a light of beauty and delightful sounds, which have never crossed the mind of any human being. They will stay there forever, never leaving and never desiring change. ' ^c.j} ilt is a promise of Allah in truth.} meaning, this will undoubtedly come to pass, for it is a promise from Allah, and Allah never breaks His promise, because He is the Most Generous Bestower Who does what He wills and is able to do all things. }And He is the All-Mighty,> Who has subjugated all things and to Whom all things submit, ithe All-Wise.} in what He says and what He does, Who has made this Qur'an a guidance to the believers. 4Say : It is for those who believe, a guide and a healing. And as for those who disbelieve, there is heaviness (deafness) in their ears, and it is blindnessfor them (41:44). 4 .-A U L * " oybblt ieo oj 4And We send down of the Qur'an that which is a healing and a mercy to those who believe, and it increases the wrongdoers nothing but loss.} (17:82) ot q, *s*I" -v-? ^ (s^isj ufoVi j ff. 3& tY. "</ **. / " - A. 430. He has created the heavens without any pillars that you see, and has set on the earth firm mountains lest it should shake with you. And He has scattered therein moving creatures of all

kinds. And We send down water from the sky, and We cause (plants) of every goodly kind to grow therein in pairs,} i'll. This is the creation of Allah. So, shew Me that which those besides Him have created. Nay, the wrongdoers are in plain error.} Proofs of Tawhid Thus Allah explains His mighty power in creating the heavens and the earth, and everything that is within them and between them. He says: }He has created the heavens without any pillars} Al-Hasan and Qatadah said, It does not have any pillars, visible or invisible." iand has set on the earthfirm mountains} means, the mountains which stabilize and lend weight to the earth, lest it should shake with its water. Allah says: ilest it should shake with you.} 4 vt *> } }And He has scattered therein moving creatures of all kinds} means, He has placed throughout it all kinds of animals, the total number of whose kinds and colors is known to no one except the One Who created them. When Allah tells us that He is the Creator, He also reminds us that He is the Provider, as He says: 4*-^' Jt U_ iAnd We send down water from the sky, and We cause (plants) of every goodly kind to grow therein in pairs,} meaning, every kind of good produce in pairs, i.e., they are At-Tabari 20 :132

575Siirah 31. Luqmdn (12) (Part-21) beautiful to look at. Ash-Sha bi said: People are also produce of the earth, so whoever enters Paradise is goodly and whoever enters Hell is vile. 477ns is the creation of Allah.} means, all that Allah has mentioned here of the creation of the heavens and earth and everything

in between stems from His power of creation and control alone, and He has no partner or associate in that, Allah says: *Ot V& Cjk- *~uX** } Him have created.} those idols and rivals whom you worship and call upon. 4Nay, the wrongdoers} means the idolators who associate others in worship with Allah }/ 4in error} means, they are ignorant and blind. i \r ^ , // >, > / . > A- I y *AiOj JoyIt4 > / /V * isftj6^iLL4U jyljJkxJ'gft l 4So, s/iow Me Z/iaf zy/iic/i those besides i&} iplain} means, it is clear and obvious, and not at all hidden. 5 " "V // i" a/ /{ / > { "V * * ^V"j

ill. And indeed We bestowed upon Luqman At-Hibnah saying: Give thanks to Allah. And whoever gives thanks, he gives thanks for (the good of) himself. And whoever is unthankful, then verily, Allah is All-Rich, Worthy of all praise. Luqman The Salaf differed over the identity of Luqman; there are two opinions: was he a Prophet or just a righteous servant of Allah without the prophethood? The majority favored the latter view, that he was a righteous servant of Allah without being a Prophet. Sufyan Ath-Thawri said, narrating from Al-Ash ath, from Ikrimah, from Ibn Abbas, Luqman was an Ethiopian slave who was a carpenter. Abdullah bin Az-Zubayr said, I said to Jabir bin Abdullah: What did you hear about Luqman? He said: He was short with a flat nose, and came from Nubia. '2 ' Yahya bin Sa Id Al-Ansari narrated from Sa Id bin Al- Musayyib that Luqman was from the black peoples of (southern) Egypt, and had thick lips. Allah gave him wisdom but withheld prophethood from him. '3 Al- Awza i said, Abdur-Rahman bin Harmalah told me; A black man came to Said bin Al-Musayyib to ask him a question, and Said bin Al-Musayyib said to him: Do not be upset because you are black, for among the best of people were three who were black: Bilal, Mahja* the freed slave of Umar bin Al-Khattab, and Luqman the Wise, who was a black Nubian with thick lips. '4 Ibn Jarir recorded that Khalid Ar-Rabal said: Luqman was an Ethiopian slave who was a carpenter. His master said to him, Slaughter this sheep for us, so he slaughtered it. [His master] said: Bring the best two pieces from it, so he brought out the tongue and the heart. Then time passed, as much as Allah willed, and [his master] said: Slaughter this sheep for us, so he slaughtered it. [His master] said, Bring the worstTabari 10:135. ' Ibn Abi Hatim 9 : 3097 and Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 5 :310. 3| At-Tabari 20:135. 4 ' At-Tabari 20:135.

Luqman (13 - 15) (Part-21) two morsels from it, so he brought out the tongue and the heart. His master said to him, T told you to bring out the best two pieces, and you brought these, then I told you to bring out the worst two pieces, and you brought these! Luqman said, There is nothing better than these if they are good, and there is nothing worse than these if they are bad. Shuhah narrated from Al-Hakam, from Mujahid, Luqman was a righteous servant, but he was not a Prophet. 12 Allah s saying: 4And indeed We bestowed upon Luqman Al-Hikmahy means, understanding, knowledge and eloquence. i*P# isaying: "Give thanks to Allah."y means, *We commanded him to give thanks to Allah for the blessings and favors that Allah had given to him alone among his people and contemporaries. Then Allah says: iP4 % i j-yj 4And whoever gives thanks, he gives thanks for (the good of) himself. meaning, the benefit of that will come back to him, and Allah s reward is for those who give thanks, as He says: iand whosoever does righteous good deeds, then such ivill prepare a good placefor themselves. (30:44) 4And whoever is unthankful, then verily, Allah is Rich, Worthy of all praise. He has no need of His servants and He will not be harmed by that, even if all the people of the earth were to disbelieve, for He has no need of anything or anyone besides Himself. There At-Tabari 20:135. At-Tabari 20:134.

578 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir is no God but He, and we worship none but Him. -iiis -SJ4* < " %u 1 Zk&% .<& 2 Jii 4 J uylc ii js ij ^ jj bwjj llfik ia pc dll ^ J Cj_A- jl iU^ li *^=*j. - ai J3 Lr 4 4c . And when Luqman said to his son when he was advising him: "O my son! Join not in worship others with Allah. Verily, joining others in worship with Allah is a great Zulm (wrong) indeed."} 424. And We have enjoined on man (to be dutiful and good) to his parents. His mother bore him in weaktness and hardship upon weabiess and hardship, and his weaning is in two years - give thanks to Me and to your parents. Unto Me is the final destination .} 415. But if they strive ivith you to make you join in worship with Me others that ofwhich you have no knowledge, then obey them not; but behave with them in the world kindly, andfolloiv the path of him who turns to Me in repentance and in obedience. Then to Me will be your rehim, and I shall tell you what you used to do.} Luqman s Advice to His Son Allah tells us how Luqman advised his son. His full name was Luqman bin Anqa bin Sadun, and his son s name was Tharan, according to a saying quoted by As-Suhayli. Allah describes him in the best terms, and states that he granted him wisdom. Luqman advised his son, the closest and most beloved of all people to him, who deserved to be given the best of his knowledge. So, Luqman started by advising him to worship Allah Alone, and not to associate anything with Him. Then he warned him: 4X& !&s iVerily, joining others in worship with Allah is a great Zulm (wrong) indeed.}

Luqman (13 - 15) (Part-21) meaning, it is the greatest wrong.

580 Tafsir Ibn Kathir iand his weaning is in two years means, after he is bom, he is breastfed and weaned within two years. This is like the Ayah, iiz^ff jtjl Ifo gjjZ, , i'j&S'j^ iThe mothers shall give suck to their children for two wlvle years, for those who desire to complete the term of suckling} {2:233}. On this basis, Ibn Abbas and other Imams understood that the shortest possible period of pregnancy was six months, because Allah says elsewhere: ifeZ& iand the bearing of him, and the weaning of him is thirty months (46:15). Allah mentions how the mother brings the child up, and how she gets tired and suffers stress from staying up with the child night and day, to remind the son of her previous kind treatment of him. This is like the Ayah, iand say : My Lord! Bestow on them Your mercy as they did bring me up when I was young. } (17:24). Allah says here: ij^aS\ JI J j =C.\ J} igive thanks to Me and to your parents. Unto Me is the final destination .} means, 1 will reward you most generously for that.)? & (*% it ^ off} iBut if they strive with you to make you join in worship with Me others that of which you have no knowledge, then obey them not;} means, if they try hard to make you follow them in their religion, then do not accept that from them, but do not let that stop you from behaving with them in the world kindly, i.e. treating them with respect. iJ[o* }

Luqman (16 - 19) (Part-21) iandfollow the path ofhim who turns to Me in repentance and in obedience.} means, the believers. iThen to Me will be your return, and I shall tell you what you used to do.} At-Tabarani recorded in Al- Ishrah that Sa d bin Malik said, This Ayah, t)ip ^ At* J if .d'JLjjr Jlj} iBut if they strive with you to make you join in worship with Me others that of which you have no knowledge, then obey them not;} was revealed concerning me. I was a man who honored his mother, but when I became Muslim, she said: O Sa d! What is this new thing I see you doing? Leave this religion of yours, or I will not eat or drink until I die, and people will say: Shame on you, for what you have done to me, and they will say that you have killed your mother. I said, Do not do that, O mother, for I will not give up this religion of mine for anything. She stayed without eating for one day and one

night, and she became exhausted; then she stayed for another day and night without eating, and she became utterly exhausted. When I saw that, I said: O my mother, by Allah, even if you had one hundred souls and they were to depart one by one, I would not give up this religion of mine for anything, so if you want to, eat, and if you want to, do not eat. So she ate. 1 crpVl j _}i ^ cA f-e~ lit pi ^ % yfcstf J 33 # k& ij yi Vj ufA 'i) iK '-Zft-3 4 L Jc _"b 4 if !? * iX" "if in' 4 ' y Op OpV'P ll ' Mentioned by Ibn Al-Athir in Usd Al-Ghdbah 2 :216.

116. "O my son! If it be (anything) equal to the weight of a grain of mustard seed, and though it be in a rock, or in the heavens or on the earth, Allah will bring it forth. Verily, Allah is Subtle, Well-Aware."}

117. O my son! Perform the Salah, enjoin the good, and forbid the evil, and bear with patience whatever befalls you. Verily, these are some of the important commandments."} \$18. "And him not your face away from men with pride, nor walk in insolence through the earth. Verily, Allah likes not any arrogant boaster."} 419. And be moderate in your walking, and lower your voice. Verily, the harshest of all voices is the braying of the asses."} This is useful advice which Allah tells us Luqman gave, so that people may follow it and take it as a good example. He said: ir- Ot JLii* lit o), V' 40 my son! If it be (anything) equal to the weight of a grain of mustard seed,} means, if a wrong action or a sin be equal to the size of a grain of mustard seed. 4*j>\ 1 ^ cfc} 4Allah will bring it forth.} means, He will bring it forth on the Day of Resurrection, when it is placed in the Scales of justice and everyone is rewarded or punished for his actions - if they are good, he will be rewarded and if they are bad he will be punished. This is like the Ayat 4^y~ J-i* Vi -Llj)' y 4And We shall set up Balances of justice on the Day of Resurrection, then none will be dealt with unjustly in anything} (21:47).)j* X u jZj i jji SXu 4So, whosoever does good equal to the weight of a speck of dust shall see it. And whosoever does evil equal to the weight of a speck of dust shall see it.} (99:7-8)

Luqman (16 - 19) (Part-21) Even if this tiny thing were to be hidden inside a solid rock or anywhere in the heavens and the earth, Allah will bring it forth, because nothing is hidden from Him, not even the weight of a speck of dust in the heavens or on the earth. Allah says: 4 Verily, Allah is Subtle, Well-Aware.} meaning, His knowledge is subtle, for nothing is hidden from Him, no matter how small, subtle and minute. 4Well-Aware.} even of the footsteps of an ant in the darkest night. Then he (Luqman) said: <&5i 40 my son! Perform the Salah ,} meaning, offer the prayer properly at the appointed times. 4pi' 25 vbP'k ienjoin the good, and forbid the evil,} meaning, to the best of your ability and strength. iand bear with patience whatever befalls you.} Luqman knew that whoever enjoins what is good and forbids

what is evil, will inevitably encounter harm and annoyance

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4449–4469]

from people, so he told him to be patient. 4jP 6iP k) iVerily, these are some of the important commandments.} means, being patient when people cause harm or annoyance is one of the most important commandments. 4And turn not your face away from men with pride means, do not turn your face away from people when you speak to them or they speak to you, looking down on them in an arrogant fashion. Rather be gentle towards them and greet them with a cheerful face, as it says in the Hadith:

J^r-b ^'ib ?^JJ >^rjj iiU-f l_filj j! "Jii v iuJij "... ey"! (/ it is only by greeting your brother with a cheerful countenance. And beware of letting your lower garment trail below your ankles, for this is a kind ofboasting, and Allah does not like boasting " 1 inor walk in insolence through the earth.) means, do not be boastful, arrogant, proud and stubborn. Do not do that, for Allah will hate you. So he said: t/_>*" V Si> j[] 4 Verily, Allah likes not any arrogant boaster.) meaning, one who shows off and admires himself, feeling that he is better than others. And Allah says: ^ JQj v_Jj J Jfo j^ walk not on the earth ivith conceit and arrogance. Verily, you can neither rend nor penetrate the earth nor can you attain a stature like the mountains in height.) (17:37). We have already discussed this in detail in the appropriate place. 121 TheCommand to be Moderate in Walking 4And be moderate in your walking,) means, walk in a moderate manner, neither slow and lazy nor excessively fast, but be moderate, somewhere in between these two extremes. }and loiver your voice.) means, do not exaggerate in your speaking and do not raise your voice unnecessarily. Allah says: Abu D&wud 4:345. 121 See volume five , the Tafsirof Surat Al-Isra (17 :37)

^ cjyd iVerily, the harshest of all voices is the braying of the asses.) Mujahid and others said, The most ugly of voices is the voice of the donkey, i.e., when a person raises his voice, the resulting noise is like the voice of a donkey in its loudness. Moreover this is hateful to Allah. Likening a loud voice to that of a donkey implies that it is forbidden and extremely blameworthy, because the Messenger of Allah jg said: * iz* ij? f w "/f is not befitting ns to be an evil parable. The person who takes back his gift, he is like a dog that vomits and then goes back to his vomit. n The Advice ofLuqman This is very useful advice, which the Qur an tells us about Luqman. Many other proverbs and words of advice were also narrated from him, some examples of which we will quote below, as basic principles: Imam

U "i' o' \i/ \$} jr l> Of!jV' ly v>* j >. ^ .JjOf Vj ^ \$; > t* iyr 'jjj @y^ & c^ j; t# &\$ JiLLiJt 6l =" jljl li*Cl" 4llc 4d^ 4l 420. See you not that Allah has subjected for you whatsoever is in the heavens and whatsoever is on the earth, and has completed and perfected His graces upon you, apparent and hidden? Yet of mankind is he who disputes about Allah without knowledge or guidance or a Book giv- ing light!} ill . And when it is said to them "Follow that which Allah has sent J nr*seii!i S ' '.Ahr's > 'i: v\ U4J1IIJyl La lv2ui:&fa-x Jl.Zlzl\4JiO^J-1 ^ftiCSSO p&S0i^ia^tiuTco# down, they say: Nay, we shall follow that which we found our fathers (following). Even if Shaytan invites them to the torment of the Fire?) Reminder ofBlessings Here Allah reminds His creation of the blessings He bestows upon them in this world and the Hereafter. In the heavens He has subjugated for them the stars which give them light during the night and during the day, and He has created clouds, rain, snow and hail, and made the heavens a canopy which covers and protects them. On earth He has created for them stability and rivers, trees, crops and fruits; He has

Luqman (22 - 24) (Part-21) completed and perfected His graces upon them, apparent and hidden, by sending Messengers, revealing Books and removing doubts and excuses. Yet despite all this, not all the people believe, and indeed there are those who dispute concerning Allah, that is, His Tawhid, and His sending the Messengers. Their dispute is without knowledge and they have no sound evidence or valid inherited Book. Allah says: " Sij < U 'Jj jf jyu jit 4 JW: <> 4And among men is he who disputes about Allah, without knowledge or guidance, or a Book giving light (from Allah).} (22:8) meaning clear and unambiguous. 4,\$ Jj }And what it is said to them} means, to these people who dispute about the

Oneness of Allah. jyl 'C \jj,\} i"Folloio that which Allah has sent down,"} means, the pure Divine Laws that He has sent down to His Messengers, fSt. iTjLj C^ j; [j!15^ ithey say: "Nay, we shall follow that which we found our fathers (following)."} means, they have no other proof except the fact that they are following their forefathers. Allah says: iEven though their fathers did not understand anything nor were they guided?} (2:170) meaning, Svhat do you think, you who take the forefathers deeds as proof, that they were misguided and you are following in their footsteps? Allah says: "_) b\ =* j'\$} iEven ifShaytdn invites them to the torment of the Fire?}

Luqmdn (25 - 28) (Part-21) iWe let them enjoyfor a little while,} means, in this world, itthen in the end We shall oblige them} means, *We shall cause them, 4to (enter) a great torment.} means, a torment that is terrifying and difficult to bear. This is like the Ayah, c 2 i"Verily, those lulto invent a lie against Allah, will never be successful." Enjoyment in this world! and then unto Us will be their return, then We shall make them taste the severest torment because they used to disbelieve.} (10 :69-70) v |3SiJ s * as \$ is a# \$. a fic mptp** si ck bsa 125. And ifyou ask them: "Who has created the heavens and the earth," they will certainly say: "Allah. Say: "All the praises and thanks be to Allah!" But most ofthem know not.} 126. To Allah belongs whatsoever is in the heavens and the earth. Verily, Allah, He is Al-Ghani, Worthy of all praise.} The Idolators admitted that Allah is the Creator Allah tells us that these idolators who associated others with Him admitted that Allah Alone, with no partner or associate, is the Creator of heaven and earth yet they still worshipped others besides Him who they recognized were created by Him and subjugated to Him. Allah says: 4k S3! i ft && uj} iAnd if you ask them: "Who has created the heavens and the earth," they will certainly say: "Allah." Say: "All the praises and thanks be to Allah! } By their admitting that, proof is established against them.

iBut most of them know not Then Allah says: iTo Allah belongs whatsoever is in the heavens and the earth.} meaning, He created it and has dominion over it. 41a< tfx } Verily, Allah, He is Al-Gham, Worthy of all praise.} means, He has no need of anyone or anything besides Himself, and everything else is in need of Him. He is Worthy of praise for all that He has created, so praise be to Him in the heavens and on earth for all that He has created and decreed, and He is worthy of praise in all affairs. OAii Li ji* . y All' oj /-Uj Cjt jl} i pz. % piZ t :f u? af k . And if all the trees on the earth were pens and the sea, with seven seas behind it to add to it, yet the Words of Allah would not be exhausted. Verily, Allah is All-Mighty, All- Wise.} 428. The creation ofyou all and the resurrection ofyou all are only as a single person. Verily, Allah is All-Hearer, All-Seer.} The Words ofAllah cannot be counted or exhausted Allah tells us of His might, pride, majesty, beautiful Names and sublime attributes, and His perfect Words which no one can encompass. No human being knows their essence or nature, or how many they are. As the Leader of Mankind and Seal of the Messengers jg said: JU ui oil ini stl: "/ cannot praise You enough; You are as You have praised yourself Allah says: m Muslim 1 :352

Luqmdn (29 - 30) (Part-21) U ,iAa) ^ /-L*j >***' ^ Ot (3 P> 4And if all the trees on the earth were pens and the sea, with seven seas behind it to add to its, yet the Words ofAllah would not be exhausted . meaning, even if all the trees on earth were made into pens and the sea was made into ink, and topped up with seven more like it, and they were used to write the Words of Allah showing His might, attributes and majesty, the pens would break and the ink would run dry, even if more were brought. The number seven is used to indicate a large amount, it is not to be taken literally or to be understood as

referring to the seven oceans of the world, as was suggested by those who took this idea from Israelite stories, which we neither believe nor reject. As Allah says elsewhere: \L uv JJ JSs J 65, %it jl js" 4Say : "If the sea were ink for the Words of my Lord, surely, the sea would be exhausted before the Words of my Lord would be finished, even if We brought like it for its aid."} (18:109). The words 4like it\$ do not mean merely another one, but another like it and another and another and another, etc., because there is no limit to the signs and Words of Allah. &\$k> 4Verily, Allah is All-Mighty, All-Wise.> means, He is All-Mighty and has subjugated all things to His will, so nothing can prevent what He wills, and none can oppose or put back His decision. He is All-Wise in His creation, commands, Words, actions, Laws and all His affairs. 4The creation of you all and the resurrection of you all are only

r^ JjX&im i't \$AJj363d5fc33Jiy^ a. Tahir ton Kgtlr &og ? \$^ S' * u' * ."> 4 **V^ ^ W -X.PJ ":0_AjI ft^yg;j|i>"ftA J>^S J^ft 4JJ1 -- -' r <.'>"" ,i' .-' Mi '-' --* >-'.' . ^,i if^ > -"< rr T-^iui^J4tj5yVi4i?c; mmm as rt sing/e person .} means, His creation and resurrection of all of mankind on the Day of Resurrection is, in relation to His power, like the creation and resurrection of a single soul; all of this is easy for Him. J U*lt* jj3^ li| JO^I 4&JJZS jr % 3A 4Verily, His command, when He intends a thing, is only that He says to it, Be!" - and it is!} (36:82) ix^j vi ijil 4And Our commandment is but one as the twinkling of an eye.} (54:50). This means He only has to command a thing once, and it will happen. There is no need for Him to repeat it or confirm it. A% i':W>% jt %> 4But it will be only a single ZajrahP] When behold, they find themselves on the surface of the earth alive after their death.}{79:13) 4^-4 3 4Verily, Allah is All-Hearer, All-Seer.} means, just as He hears all that they say, so He also sees all that they do, as if He is til See the Tafsir of Surat As-Saffat (37 : 19)

Luqmati (29 - 30) (Part-21) hearing and seeing a single soul. His power over all of them is like His power over a single soul, Allah says: \$1 iThe creation of you all and the resurrection of you all are only as a single person .) y 4 ^ j jfo * ' 'Sy t'Xf '> s"\ 41 " < *Aft *" U 0"J < 1 o*"J . * ^ ji Mj 429. See i/ow not that Allah merges the night into the day, and merges the day into the night, and has subjected the sun and the moon, each naming its course for a term appointed; and that Allah is All-Aware of what you do.) 430. That is because Allah, He is the Tmth, and that which they invoke besides Him is falsehood; and that Allah, He is the Most High, the Most Great> The Might and Power of Allah Allah tells us that He imerges the night into the day,) meaning, He takes from the night and adds to the day, so that the day becomes longer and the night shorter, which is what happens in summer when the days are longest; then the day starts to become shorter and the night longer, which is what happens in winter. d[xsj*y jliJ'j cP-il' iand has subjected the sun and the moon, each running its course for a term appointed;) It was said that this means, each runs within its set limits, or it means until the Day of Resurrection; both meanings are correct. The first view is supported by the Hadith of Abu Dharr, may Allah be pleased with him, in the Two Sahihs, according to which the Messenger of Allah said: q oJl& j. ; . ijj uf 4

Luqman (31 - 32) (Part-21) Him, because everything in heaven and on earth is created by Him and is enslaved by Him; none of them could move even an atom's weight except with His permission. If all the people of heaven and earth were to come together to create a fly, they would not be able to do so. Allah says: 4CT.'.'ijkJssJt -pj! jj 4" fj jJlLl' 4jjJ U j* ii' ^That is because Allah, He is the Truth, and that which they invoke besides Him is falsehood; and that Allah, He is the Most High, the Most Great.} meaning, He is the Most High and there is none higher than Him, and He is the Most Great Who is

greater than everything. Everything is subjugated and insignificant in comparison to Him. Ji a -4 3 & ! p jls ^ jZjt. i>> JP' 431 . See you not that the ships sail through the sea by Allah's grace that He may show you of His signs? Verily, in this are signs for every patient, grateful (person).} 432 . And when waves cover them like shades, they invoke Allah, making their invocations for Him only. But when He brings them safe to land, there are among them those that stop in between. And Our Ayat are not denied except by every KhattSr Kafur.} Allah tells us that He is the One Who has subjugated the sea so that ships may sail on it by His command, i.e., by His grace and power. For if He did not give the water the strength to cany the ships, they would not sail. So he says: 44s4'* Sipyy {that He may show you of His signs} meaning, by His power. 4yjS. P, ? 4 dSy {Verily, in this are signsfor every patient, grateful.} means, every person who bears difficulty with patience and

Lucjman (33 - 34) (Part-21) iKafur means, one who denies blessings and does not give thanks for them, rather he forgets them and does not remem- ber them. o & i' -i; *& ^ it all* ^ it ^ . 0 mankind! Have Taqwa of your Lord, and fear a Day when no father can avail aught for his son, nor a son avail aughtfor his father. Verily, the promise ofAllah is true, let not then this present life deceive you, nor let the chief deceiver deceive you about Allah. The Command to fear Allah and remember the Day of Resurrection Here Allah warns people about the Day of Resurrection, and commands them to fear Him and remember the Day of Resurrection when 0* kb ino father can avail aught for his son,} which means, even if he wanted to offer himself as a sacrifice for his son, it would not be accepted from him. The same will apply in the case of a son who wants to sacrifice himself for his father - it will not be accepted from him. Then Allah reminds them once again with the words: iOiIt ilet not then this present life deceive you,} meaning, do not let your feelings of contentment with this life make you forget about the Hereafter. iSj&i it & itior let the chiefdeceiver deceive you about Allah.} refers to the Shaytan. This was the view of Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak and Qatadah. The Shaytan makes m At-Tabari 20 : 159

promises to them and arouses in them false desires, but there is no substance to them, as Allah says: 4:MJZ 4\ /jfcSrt 4He makes promises to them, and arouses in them false desires; and Shaytan's promises are nothing but deceptions.} (4 :120). Wahb bin Munabbih said: Uzayr, peace be upon him, said: When I saw the misfortune of my people, I felt very sad and distressed, and I could not sleep, so I prayed to my Lord and fasted, and I called upon Him weeping. There came to me an angel and I said to him: Tell me, will the souls of the righteous intercede for the wrongdoers, or the fathers for their sons? He said: On the Day of Resurrection all matters will be settled, and Allah s dominion will be made manifest and no exceptions will be made. No one will speak on that Day except with the permission of the Most Merciftd. No father will answer for his son, or any son for his father, or any man for his brother, or any servant for his master. No one will care about anybody except himself, or feel grief or compassion for anyone except himself. Everyone will be worried only about himself. No one will be asked about anybody else. Each person will be concerned only about himself, weeping for himself and carrying his own burden. No one will cany the burden of another. This was recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim. bl* JLj" eb-Lj Lj , / I b f-U)^ CjyCi \$ liti tSjJi be y 434. Verily, Allah, with Him is the hicrwledge of the Hour, He sends down the rain, and knows that which is in the wombs. No person knows what he will earn tonwrrrow, and no person knows in what land he will die. Verily, Allah is All-Knower, All-Aware.} The Knower ofthe Unseen is Allah These are the keys of the Unseen, whose knowledge Allah alone has

kept for Himself, and no one else knows them unless Allah tells him about them. The knowledge of when the Hour will occur is not known to any Prophet who was sent or any angel who is close to Allah.

iy. V) Tjfr 1} 4None can reveal its time but He} (7:187). Similarly, no one but Allah knows when rain will fall, but when He issues the commands, the angels who are entrusted with the task of bringing rain know about it, as do those among His creation whom He wills should know. No one but He knows what is in the wombs of what He wants to create, but when He decrees whether it is to be male or female, and whether it is to be blessed or doomed, the angels who are entrusted with that know about it, as do those among His creation whom He wills should know. No one knows what he will earn tomorrow with regard to this world or the Hereafter. dy-c 4and no person knows in what land he will die.} in his own land or elsewhere, in some other land. No one knows this. This Ayah is like the Ayah, 4And with Him are the keys of the Unseen, none knows them but He.} (6:59) It was reported in the Sunnah that the above five things are called the Keys of the Unseen. Imam

00 Tafsir Ibn Kathir The chain of narrators for this Hadith is Sahih, although they did not recorded it. The Hadith of Ibn Umar Imam

Luqman (34) (Part-21) man came to him and said, O Messenger of Allah, what is Iman? He said: 4-* lyty'j *^j >*&'& jit lyfiY O' oUjVh *iman is to believe in Allah, His Angels, His Books, His Messengers and in the meeting with Him, and to believe in the Resurrection in the Hereafter . He said: O Messenger of Allah, what is Islam? He said: Ji'yj 'pJCj ilili hjiz 'jj Z>\ Jui: jl p^iVlH fl OLA*j ^ Islam is to xvorship Allah Alone and not associate anything in worship with Him, to establish regular prayer, to pay the obligatory Zakah, and to fast in Ramadan ." He said, O Messenger of Allah, what is Ihsan? He said: illjJ jp JkIS Jui: jf jU4>-V"" Ihsan is to xvorship Allah as if you see Him, and if you do not see Him, then He sees you . He said, O Messenger of Allah, when will the Hour come? He said: oiJj lil :l*i;rii ji- j&j iJlIJl j* U Irf CrJJJ 015 lip i je Ill-ii l^Sj pis "> 6^ :Jii jYSi: V jJJ- ^ i^"i^M li iiju) The one who is asked about it does not know more than the one who is asking, but I will tell you of some of its signs: when the servant woman gives birth to her mistress, that is one of its signs; when the barefoot and naked become leaders of the people, that is one of its signs. The timing of the Hour is one of the five things which no one knows except Allah: iVerily, Allah, with Him is the knowledge of the Hour, He sends down the rain, and knows that which is in the wombs Then the man went away, and the Prophet jg said,

oBring him back to me." They went to bring him back, but they could not find him. He said: ' uThat was fibril who came to teach the people their religion .b 1 It was also recorded by

Luqman (34) (Part-21) be stricken by calamity tomorrow. 4CjyU Jfj o-i* ufjJi no person knows in what land he will die.} means, no person knows where his resting place will be, on the land or in the sea, on a plain or in the mountains. [1 * It says in the Hadith: J^>- JuP Jill a \ j\ lilt ""//Allah wants to take a person's soul in a particular land, He will give him a reason to go there.^ In Al-Mu'jam Al-Kabir, Al-Hafiz Abu Al-Qasim At-Tabarani recorded that Usamah bin Zayd said, The Messenger of Allah said: Ifci Ji"- JIp *i~; ill lit ^Allah does not will that a person should die in a certain land but He gives him a reason to go there

Surah 32: As-Sajdah

PDF pages 4470–4494

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4470–4483]

Opening The Tafsir of Surah Alif Lam Mim As-Sajdah (Chapter - 32) Which was revealed in Maklugh The Virtues of Surah Alif Lam Mim As-Sajdah In the Book of the Friday prayer, Al-Bukhari recorded that Abu Hurayrah said, The Prophet used to recite in Fajr on Fridays: iAlif Lam Mim. The revelation of...}, As-Sajdah, and jc- i, Has there not been over man . . .} Al-Insan (76). * This was also recorded by Muslim.'2' Imam

606 Tafsir Ibtisam Kathir iAlif Lam Mim. The revelation of...}, As-Sajdah, and "Ji^ tfjji iBlessed be He in Whose Hand is the dominion} Al-Mulk (67). ' 5g>" P In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. y j? A/i d 4 tA *rtU ^ Jv >%* oi Jp ^ by J^rA- u? i' 43. Alif Lam Mim.} 42 . The revelation of the Book in which there is no doubt, is from the Lord of all that exists.} 43. Or say they : "He has fabricated it?" Nay, it is the truth from your Lord, so that you may warn a people to whom no warner has come before you, in order that they may be guided.} The Qur'an is the Book of Allah in which there is no Doubt We discussed the individual letters at the beginning of Surat Al-Baqarah, and there is no need to repeat it here. 4The revelation of the Book in which there is no doubt,} means, there is no doubt whatsoever that it has been revealed from the Lord of all that exists.} Then Allah tells us about the idolaters: }Or say they: "He has fabricated it?": they say, he has fabricated it, i.e., he has made it up by himself. m Ahmad 3:340.

4-^o-X-r. p-a-lj d&J oi jfi" cit |*i^ ^ y" jxil. iNay, it is the truth from your Lord, so that you may warn a people to whom no warner has come before you, in order that they may be guided.} means, in order that they may follow the truth. U Jryli Je lsy~7\ > frji ii_-. ^ l. Uj oyH)' jU- 4af^> JI * >^ SgS 53^ vj# *J> it .)(j jth* UJ (Jijt nJliL fji j . Allah it is He Wlw has created the heavens and the earth, and all that is between them in six Days. Then He Istawa over the Throne. You have none, besides Him, as a protector or an intercessor. Will you not then remember?} 45. He directs the command from the heavens to the earth; then it will go up to Him, in one Day, the space whereof is a thousand years of your reckoning.} . That is He, the All-Knower of the unseen and the seen, the All-Mighty, the Most Merciful.} Allah is the Creator and Controller of the Universe Allah tells us that He is the Creator of all things. He created the heavens and earth and all that is between them in six days, then He rose over the Throne - we have already discussed this matter elsewhere. 'h > v, 0' f^C} 4You have none, besides Him, as a protector or an intercessor} means, only He is the Sovereign Who is in control of all affairs, the Creator of all things, the Controller of all things, the One Who is able to do all things. There is no Creator besides Him, no intercessor except the one to whom He gives permission. See volume four, the Tafsir of Surat Al-A'raf{7 :54)

As-Sajdah (7 - 9) (Part-21) 47. Who made everything He has created good and He began the creation of man from clay.} 48. Then He made his offspring from semen of despised water.} 49. Then He fashioned him in due proportion, and breathed into him the soul; and He gave you hearing, sight and the sense of deduction . Little is the thanks you give!} The Creation of Man in Stages Allah tells us that He has created everything well and formed everything in a goodly fashion. Malik said, narrating from Zayd bin Aslam: 4r-&- ft 4Who made everything He has created good} means, He created everything well and in a goodly fashion. When Allah mentions the creation of the heavens and the earth. He follows that by mentioning the creation of man. Allah says: irtf Jb- 4and He began the creation of man from clay.} meaning, He created the father of mankind, Adam, from clay. 4 ft ft X** 'ft} 4Then He made his offspring from semen of despised water.} means, they reproduce in this fashion, from a Nutfah which comes from the loins of men and from between the ribs of women. 4Then He fashioned him in due proportion,} means, when He created Adam from clay. He created him and gave him shape and made him upright. 4&nd breathed into him the soul; and He gave you hearing, sight and the sense of deduction.} means, reason.

610 Tafsir Ibn Kathir 4'ofSZ yJf} iLittle is the thanks you give!} means, for these strengths with which Allah has provided you; the one who is truly blessed is the one who uses them to worship and obey his Lord, may He be exalted and glorified. ^ op't J52 410. And they say : "When we are lost in the earth, shall we indeed be created anew?" Nay, but they deny the meeting with their Lord!} ill. Say: "The angel of death, who is set over you, will take your souls. Then you shall be brought to your Lord."} Refutation of Those Who think the Resurrection is unlikely to happen Allah tells us how the idolaters thought it unlikely that the resurrection would ever come to pass, and how they said: 4*\$ 4 4Wheti we are lost in the earth,} meaning, when our bodies have been scattered and have disintegrated and dispersed in the earth, #JVb 4shall we indeed be created anew?} means, after that, will we come back again? They thought it unlikely that this would happen, and in terms of their own feeble abilities it is indeed unlikely, but this is not the case with regard to the power of the One Who created them from nothing. Who when He wills a thing merely says to it, Be! and it is. Allah says: fro "3 4Nay, but they deny the meeting with their Lord!} Then Allah says: 4f > So 4\$ 4Say: "The angel of death, who is set over you, will take your

' souls...") The a PP ar ent > , ^ meaning of this At/ah is that the angel of death j* a spec f c f ^ ^ ^ x - iZi- personality among the (jp angels, as is also > -- <,i,r< > V' "Ar"i * > <>- ' : ** : apparent from the Vadh of A1 -Bara ^ jij which we quoted in \ ' fa-'* Tafsir f) Sarah Ibrahim . In some p"rts he (the angel " ^ " I " ~ nf apflth is rallpfi ? r ? > 1 I * > -Lr- ' 9 m ~ > - i > ~ of death) is called u-i_? gpUaJ l/- Izrail, which is well rf" - yf"e. t-try je"tr*rvir<^i " i. * known. This is the ^ view of Qatadah and v rc7-~<-^; J view of Qatadah and others. The angel of " " t death has helpers. It was reported in the Hadith that his , y -tX , ^ helpers draw out the soul from the rest of the bod" " j__^_ ' i reaches the throat, then the angel of death takes it. Mujahid said, The earth is brought together for him and it is like a platter from which he takes whenever he wants. 4& iThen you shall be brought to your Lord.) means, on the Day when you are resurrected and brought forth from your graves to receive your reward or punishment. LI^ l. r*i) -e* [y-^ ? P> V&i & jji't "> 33J H tS4 -j) q Ctu See volume live , the Tafsir of Surah Ibrahim (14 : 27) * At-Tabari 20:175. At-Tabari 20:175.

llj bbj* Up& JV" 4\$^ IL ili> . And if you only could see when the criminals shall hang their heads before their Lord (saying) "Our Lord! We have now seen and heard, so send us back that we will do righteous good deeds. Verily, we now believe with certainty."} 413. And if We had willed, surely We would have given every person his guidance, but the Word from Me took effect, that I will fill Hell with Jinn and mankind together.} 414. Then taste because of your forgetting the meeting of this Day of yours. Surely, We too will forget you, so taste you the abiding torment for what you used to do.} The Bad State in which the Idolaters will be on the Day of Resurrection Allah tells us the state of the idolaters on the Day of Resurrection and what they will say when they see the Resurrection and are standing before Allah - may He be glorified - humiliated and brought low, with their heads bowed, i.e., in shame. They will say: XZJ} 40 Our Lord! We have now seen and heard,} meaning, now we hear what You say and we will obey You. This is like the Ayah, 4 How clearly will they see and hear, the Day when they will appear before Us!} (19:38). And they will blame themselves when they enter the Fire, and will say: jj GS" & ,Jiu jl IS" fi} 4 "Had we but listened or used our intelligence, we would not have been among the dwellers of the blazing Fire!"} (67:10) Similarly, here they are described as saying:

As-Sajdah (12 - 14) (Part-21) i Our Lord! We have now seen and heard, so send us back} to the world, Ay 1-that we will do righteous good deeds. Verily, we now believe with certainty.} means, how we are sure and we believe that Your promise is true and that the meeting with You is true. But the Lord, may He be exalted, knows that if He were to send them back to this world, they would behave as they did previously, and they would reject and disbelieve in the signs of Allah and would go against His Messengers, as He says: Vj Lli ijliiM i^jJ Tij fj} iff you could but see when they will be held over the (Hell) Fire! They will say: "Would that we were but sent back! Then we would not deny the AySt of our Lord,"} (6: 27) And Allah says here: 414* y Ci4 \$j} 4 And if We had willed, surely We would have given every person his guidance,} This is like the Ayah, i^Jr cgyVf 4j 4 And had your Lord willed, twse on earth would have believed, all of them together} (10:99). i but the Word from Me took effect, that I will fill Hell with Jinn and mankind together.} i.e., from both classes, so their abode will be Hell and they will have no escape from it and no way out. We seek refuge with Allah and in His perfect Words from that. sSj C i Then taste because of your forgetting the meeting of this Day of yours.} means, it will be said to the people of Hell by way of rebuke:

The State of the People of Faith and Their Reward Allah states: (1\) i Only those believe in Our Aydt,) means, who accept them as true, , 'k ctjty i who, when they are reminded of them, fall down prostrate,) means, they listen to them and obey them in word and deed. icw& V pfi i and glorify the praises of their Lord, and they are not proud.) means, they are not too proud to follow them and submit to them, unlike the ignorant among the rebellious disbelievers. Allah says: i Verily, those who scorn My worship, they will surely enter Hell in humiliation!) (40:60). Then Allah says: ig&J\ ji i Their sides forsake their beds,) meaning, they pray the voluntary night prayer and forego sleep and resting on a comfortable bed. Mujahid and Al-Hasan said that the Ayah i Their sides forsake their beds,) refers to voluntary night prayer.111 Ad-Dahhak said, It refers to Salat Al- lsha in congregation and Salat Al-Fajr in congregation pr,j) i to invoke their Lord in fear and hope,) means, in fear of His punishment and in hope of His reward. iL^j) i and they spend out of what We have bestowed on them.) in At-Jabari 20 :180

616 Tafsir Ibn Kathir means, they do both obligatory and supererogatory acts of worship. Their leader in this world and the Hereafter is the Messenger of Allah jg. Imam

As-Saidah (15 -17) (Part-21) and its pinnacle is Jihad for the sake of Allah. Then he said: iui^ h'J.\ " iShall I not tell you the factor on which all of that depends?" I said, Of course, O Messenger of Allah. He took hold of his tongue and said, JJQp ,1iS "Restrain this.* I said, O Messenger of Allah, will we be accountable for what we say? He said, iU :Ji* jt - 'rrtfrj^ jilJi j It ciui u ^ " > s # .1 ./>*" y>~ "M"]/ your mother be bereft of you, O Mu'adh! Will the people be thrown into Hell - (or he said) on their faces - except because of what their tongues say? It was also recorded by

Then he recorded that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said that the Messenger of Allah said: ill Jli" Vj^ hl\ Nj "_~b JjIp says: "I have prepared for My righteous servants what no eye has seen, no ear has heard, and it has never crossed the mind of man Abu Hurayrah said: Recite, if you wish: 4yd 'C* oifd 4No version knows

what is kept hidden for them of delights of eyes.

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4483-4494]

It was also recorded by Muslim and At-Tirmidhi. At-Tirmidhi said, It is Hasan Sahth.. In another version of Al-Bukhari: u al; jt ^ JU l and no body has ever even imagined of. All that is reserved, besides which, all that you have seen is nothing. It was also reported from Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, that the Prophet jg said: 111 Path Al-Bari 8 :375 Muslim 4 :2174 , Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi9 :56

V u iJip ; yj i2c V t(V p: SJi jij; v; Tj oif ij .oi:^ oWhoever enters Paradise, will enjoy a life of luxury and never feel deprivation, his clothes will never wear out, his youth will never fade. In Paradise there is what no eye has ever seen, no ear has ever heard, and has never crossed the mind of man. This was recorded by Muslim . P+u '>>' i/& 0 V L_L.ll if \jg J 1? jfr ;&Jt* c# ijb'> .aj tfjil jL23' ^ ^ d-U If^ V~iW (ji1 <>*J .jjJ i-j'jji . Js then he who is a believer like him who is rebellious? Not equal are they.) . As for those who believe and do righteous good deeds, for them are Gardens of Abode as an entertainment for what they used to do.) . And as for those who rebel, their abode will be the Fire, every time they wish to get away therefrom, they will be put back thereto, and it will be said to them: "Taste you the torment of the Fire which you used to deny.") . And verily, We will make them taste of the near lighter torment prior to the greater torment, in order that they may return.) . And who does more wrong than he who is reminded of the Ayat of his Lord, then turns aside therefrom? Verily, We shall exact retribution from the criminals.) The Believer and the Rebellious are not equal Allah tells us that in His justice and generosity, on the Day of Judgement He will not judge those who believed in His signs and followed His Messengers, in the same way as He will judge Tabari 20:186, Muslim 4:2181

620 Tafsir Ibn Kathir those who rebelled, disobeyed Him and rejected the Messengers sent by Allah to them. This is like the Ayat lpK Lpfas Jfccc J Up 'f- ^} ' & pr j iOr do those who earn evil deeds think that We shall hold them equal with those who believe and do righteous good deeds, in their present life and after their death? Worst is the judgement that they make.} (45:21), ifliijl fp dfj \ 4 eg .iJK' iShall We treat those who believe and do righteous good deeds as corruptors on earth? Or shall We treat those who

have Taqwa as the wicked?} (38:28) iNot equal are the dwellers of the Fire and the dwellers of the Paradise. . .} (59:20). Allah says: v uL-G ils then he who is a believer like him who is a rebellious? Not equal are they.} i.e., before Allah on the Day of Resurrection. Ata bin Yasar, As-Suddi and others mentioned that this was revealed concerning Ali bin Abi Tahb and TJqbah bin Abi MuTtJ Hence Allah has judged between them when He said: Ji \&j ip: iM &} }Asfar those who believe and do righteous good deeds,} meaning, their hearts believed in the signs of Allah, and they did as the signs of Allah dictate, i.e. righteous good deeds. ifar them are Gardens ofAbode} i.e., in which there are dwellings IM At-Tabari 20:188.

As-Sajdah (18 - 22) (Part-21) and houses and lofty apartments. /N\4^A 4 entertainment means, something to welcome and honor a guest. ill; </br ivfiat they used to do. And as for those who rebel,} means, those who disobeyed Allah, their dwelling place will be the Fire, and every time they want to escape from it, they will be thrown back in, as Allah says: iEvery time they seek to get away therefrom, from anguish, they will be driven back therein} (22:22). Al-Fudayl bin lyad said: By Allah, their hands will be tied, their feet will be chained, the flames will lift them up and the angels will strike them. ii .4.^ ^ iand it will be said to them : "Taste you the torment of the Fire which you used to deny."}" means, this will be said to them by way of rebuke and chastisement. ytiJi sj" vuji << 4And verily, We will make them taste of the near lighter torment prior to the greater torment,} Ibn Abbas said, The near torment means diseases and problems in this world, and the things that happen to its people as a test from Allah to His servants so that they will repent to Him. ' Something similar was also narrated from Ubayy bin KaTa, Abu Al-'Aliyah, Al-Hasan, Ibrahim An-Nakhal, Ad-Dahhak, Alqamah, Atiyah, Mujahid, Qatadah, Abd Al- Karim Al-Jazari and Khusayf. ' [11 At-Tabari 20:189.Tabari 20 : 189 , 190

As-Sajdah (23 - 25) (Part-21) narrated that Abu Al- Aliyah Ar-Riyahi said, The cousin of your Prophet, meaning Ibn Abbas, told me that the Messenger of Allah igs said: Jlij ljuo- {ji hL. J! IrrZ "JL?.jJI3 jllJl OjU- l&U "On the night of Isra', I saw Musa bin Imran, a tall, brown- skinned man with curly hair, looking like the men of Shanii'ah; and I saw 'Isa, a man ofmedium stature and ruddy white skin, and with lank hair. And I saw Malik the Keeper of Hell, and the Dajjal ." Among the signs which Allah showed him were: oi hs, 4 o^-3 <\$So, be not you in doubt of meeting him .} i.e., he saw Musa and met with him on the Night of Isra . 4*&*o} iAnd We made it} means, *theBookwhichWe gave to him, 4a guide to the Children of Israel.} This is similar to what Allah says in Surat Al-Isra 4ff/'^~=.j jJi ot x0, ts j 4And We gave Musa the Scripture and made it a guidance for the Children of Israel (saying) Take none other than Me as Trustee."} (17:2) lijji \y\ = Cj li^l 4And We made from among than, leaders, giving guidance under Our command, when they were patient and used to believe with certainty in OurAyat.} means, because they were patient in adhering to the commands of Allah and avoiding what He prohibited, and they m At-Jabari 20:194.

believed in His Messengers and followed what they brought, there were among them leaders who guided others to the truth by the command of Allah, calling for goodness, enjoining what is right and forbidding what is wrong. Then when they changed [the Words of Allah], twisting and distorting them, they lost that position and their hearts became hard. They change the words from their places, so they do no righteous deeds and have no correct beliefs. Allah says: iAnd We made from among them (Children of Israel), leaders, giving guidance under Our command, when they were patient> Qatadah

and Sufyan said: When they patiently shunned the temptations of this world. This was also the view of Al-Hasan bin Salih. Sufyan said, This is how these people were. A man cannot be an example to be followed unless he shuns the temptation of this world. Allah says: ^{ft&m ^Ar\ i}And indeed We gave the Children of Israel the Scripture, and the understanding of the Scripture and its laws, and the prophethood; and provided them with good things, and preferred them above the nations. And We gave them clear proofs in matters.[>] (45:16-17). And He says here: ^{llj jyj ft i}Verily, your Lord will judge between them on the Day of Resurrection, concerning that wherein they used to differ. meaning, with regard to beliefs and actions. ^{4 ft^r-- &Jr~l & Oi V, =& ft ft ft; ft * ji S0 (Sf ftf \$3 iftk ftSZ~jUi i}26. Is it not a guidance for them: how many generations We have destroyed before them in whose dwellings they do walk about? Verily, therein indeed are signs. Would they not then

As-Sajdah (26 - 27) (Part-21) listen?} 427. Have they not seen how We drive water to the dry land that has no vegetation, and therewith bring forth crops providing food for their cattle and themselves? Will they not then see?} Learning the Lessons of the Past Allah says: will these people who deny the Messengers not learn from the nations who came before them, whom Allah destroyed for their rejection of His Messengers and their opposition to what the Messengers brought them of the straight path? No trace is left of them whatsoever. ⁱCan you find a single one of them or hear even a whisper of them?} (19:98). Allah says: ^{4 VrZ) i}in whose dwellings they do walk about} meaning, these disbelievers walk about in the places where those disbelievers used to live, but they do not see any of those who used to live there, for they have gone - ^{4-As} if they had never lived there} (1 1:68) This is like the Ayat ⁱThese are their houses in utter ruin, for they did wrong} (27:52). ^{j * *- * * <"<}} S mss ⁱAnd many a township did We destroy while they were given to wrongdoing, so that it lie in ruins, and (many) a deserted well and lofty castle! Have they not traveled through the land} until:

As-Sajdah (28 - 30) (Part-21) food for their cattle and themselves? Will they not then see?} This is like the Ayah, ⁱThen let man look at his food: We pour forth water in abundance.} (80:24-25). Allah says here: ^tWill they not then see?} ^{viii tiic-if iii/i mc-M y \xji J;j3' / gLiJ' j> ji ^i=s> o)} . They say: ^Wlien will this Fath be, if you are telling the truth?"} 429. Say: "On the Day of Al-Fath, no profit will it be to those who disbelieve if they (then) believe! Nor will they be granted a respite."} 430. So turn aside from them and await, verily, they (too) are awaiting.}

How the Disbelievers sought to hasten on the Punishment, and what happened to Them Allah tells us how the disbelievers sought to hasten on the punishment, and to bring the wrath and vengeance of Allah upon themselves, because they thought this punishment would never happen, and because of their disbelief and stubbornness. ^{4 _i)('ii& <>)&}} 4They say: "When will this Fath be..."} meaning, *when will you prevail over us, O Muhammad, since you claim that there will be a time when you will gain the upper hand over us and take your revenge on us, so when will that happen? All we see of you and your companions is that you are hiding, afraid and humiliated. Allah says: ⁴Say : "On the Day of Al-Fath..."} meaning, \when the wrath

As-Sajdah (28 - 30) (Part-21) over those who disbelieved (2 :89) if you ask for a judgment, now has the judgment come unto you} (8 :19). Then Allah says: (Hpi ⁴So ^{ft/m} aside from them and await, verily, they (too) are awaiting.} meaning, turn away from these idolators, and convey that which has been revealed to you from your Lord. This is like the Ayah, ⁱFollow what has been revealed to you from your

Lord, there is no God but Him.} (6 :106) Wait until Allah fulfills that which He has promised you, and grants you victory over those who oppose you, for He never breaks His promise. ^i} iverily, they (too) are awaiting.} means, *you are waiting, and they are waiting and plotting against you, p i*f f \K'A <-*
 ** Q*IJ* J*;U OJj iOr do they say : "A poet! We awaitfor him some calamity by time! } (52 :30). You will see the consequences of your patience towards them, and the fulfillment of the promise of your Lord in your victoiy over them, and they will see the consequences of their wait for something bad to befall you and your Companions, in that Allah s punishment will come upon them.' Sufficient unto us is Allah, and He is the Best Disposer of affairs.

Surah 33: Al-Ahzab

PDF pages 4495–4646

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4495–4515]

Opening The Tafslrof SuratAl-Ahzab (Chapter - 33) Jr Whichwas revealed in Al-Madinah P t \A ommmm Pa + 'Ti< "> JT> Y\~15i 1'.It' 41 . 0 Prophet! Have Taqwa of Allah, and obey not the disbelievers and the hypocrites. Ve- rily, Allah is Ever All- Knower, All-Wise.} 42 . And follow that which is revealed to you [from your Lord. Verily, Allah is Well-Acquainted with what you do.} And put your trust in Allah, and sufficient is Allah as a Trustee.} ' + In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful Vj ^il qj^ { *y*f-.A\j tpX4P0 < C Cjil-M Uji u^" P" J^=yb

The Command to defy the Disbelievers and Hypocrites by following the Revelation of Allah and putting One s Trust inHim Here Allah points out something lower by referring to something higher. When He commands His servant and Messenger to do this, He is also commanding those who are lower than him, and the command is addressed to them more so. Talq bin Habib said: Taqwd means obeying Allah in the light ofthe guidance of Allah and in hope of earning the reward of Allah, and refraining from disobeying Allah in the light of the guidance of Allah and fearing the punishment ofAllah. iand obey not the disbelievers and the hypocrites.} means, do not listen to what they say and do not consult them. iCgi \L & sit %} iVerily, Allah is Ever All-Knower, All-Wise} means, He is more deserving of your following His commandments and obeying Him, for He knows the consequences of all things and is Wise in all that He says and does. Allah says: iAndfollow that which is revealed to youfrom your Lord.} meaning, of the Qur an and Sunnah. 4Verily, Allah is Well-Acquainted ivith what you do.} means, nothing at all is hidden from Him, and put your trust in Allah, i.e., in all your affairs and situations. iand sufficient is Allah as a Wakil.} means, sufficient is He as a Trustee for the one who puts his trust in Him and turns to Him.

i iil+j jd Jyj *i'j [i jii C> jjJ' 4 j^=6>^ oji^ J"-j1 && fit 0 12 igJj . * Jiil 'Cj g& J 4 j?W 44. A//"/i has uot made for any man two hearts inside his body. Neither has He made your wives whom you declare to be like your mothers' backs, your real mothers nor has He made your adopted sons your real sons. That is but your saying with your mouths. But Allah says the truth, and He guides to the way.} 45. Call them by their fathers, that is more just with Allah. But if you know not their father's, your brothers in faith and Mawalikum (your freed servants). And there is no sin on you concerning that in which you made a mistake, except in regard to what your hearts deliberately intend. And Allah is Ever Oft- Forgiving, Most Merciful.} Abolition ofAdoption Before Allah discusses ideas and theoretical matters. He gives tangible examples: one man cannot have two hearts in his body, and a man s wife does not become his mother if he says the words of Zihar to her: You are to me like the back of my mother. By the same token, an adopted child does not become the son of the man who adopts him and calls him his son. Allah says: ifrt J-"!- ris li'i u iAllah has not made far any man two hearts inside his body. Neither has He

made your wives whom you declare to be like your mothers' backs, your real mothers...} This is like the Ayah: iThey cannot be their mothers. None can be their mothers except those who gave them birth} (58:2). Cj}

inor has He made your adopted sons your real sons.} This was revealed concerning Zayd bin Harithah, may Allah be pleased with him, the freed servant of the Prophet sgl. The Prophet j had adopted him before prophethood, and he was known as Zayd bin Muhammad. Allah wanted to put an end to this naming and attribution, as He said: Cj} inor has He made your adopted sons your real sons.} This is similar to the Ayah later in this Surah: ill' dff) Oi U -ui \}) iMuhammad is not the father of any of your men, but he is the Messenger of Allah and the last (end) of the Prophets. And Allah is Ever All-Aware of everything.} (33:40). And Allah says here: iThat is but your saying with your mouths.} meaning, your adoption of him is just words, and it does not mean that he is really your son, for he was created from the loins of another man, and a child cannot have two fathers just as a man cannot have two hearts in one body. j>:%} iBut Allah says the truth, and He guides to the way.} Said bin Jubayr said: iBut Allah says the truth,} means, justice. Qatadah said: %} iand He guides to the way} means, the straight path. Imam Ahmad said that Hasan told them that Zuhayr told them from QabUs, meaning Ibn Abi Zibyan, that his father told him: I said to Ibn Abbas, TDo you know the Ayah,

iAllah has not made for any man two hearts inside his body What does this mean? He said that the Messenger of Allah jg stood up one day to pray, and he trembled. The hypocrites who were praying with him said, *Do you not see that he has two hearts, one heart with you and another with them? Then Allah revealed the words: 4 ^ J '*>? iAllah has not made for any man two hearts inside his body.) *" This was also narrated by At-Tirmidhi, who said, It is a Hasan Hadith . It was also narrated by Ibn Jarir and Ibn Abi Hatim from the Hadith of Zuhayr. 131 An Adopted Child should be named after His Real Father If; Jii! fk iCall them (adopted sons) by their fathers, that is more just with Allah> This is a command which abrogates the state of affairs that existed at the beginning of Islam, when it was permitted to call adopted sons after the man who adopted them. Then Allah commanded that they should be given back the names of their real fathers, and states that this was more fair and just. Al-Bukhari (may Allah have mercy on him) narrated that Abdullah bin Umar said: Zayd bin Harithah, may Allah be pleased with him, the freed servant of the Messenger of Allah 5 . was always called Zayd bin Muhammad, until (the words of the) Qur an were revealed: & ifU iCall them (adopted sons) by (the names of) their fathers, that is more just with Allah. Ahmad 1 :267. Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 9 :58 ^ Ahmad, no. 2410 and At-Tabari 20:204. Most of the scholars of Hadith consider the chain of narrators for this text to be defective. Al-Bari 8:377.

Sarah 33 . Al-Ahzab (4 - 5) (Part-21 As for calling a person son as an expression of honor and endearment, this is not what is forbidden in this Ayah, as is indicated by the report recorded by Imam Ahmad and the Sunan compilers - apart from At-Tirmidhi - from Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, who said: We young boys of Banu Abd Al-Muttalib came to the Messenger of Allah sg at the Jamarat, he slapped us on the thigh and said, "O my sons, do not stone the Jamarah until the sun has risen .*" 11 This was during the Farewell Pilgrimage in 10 AH. iCall them by their fathers .> This is concerning Zayd bin Harithah, may Allah be pleased with him. He was killed in 8 AH at the battle of Mu tah. In Sahih Muslim it is reported that Anas bin Malik, may Allah be pleased with him, said: The

Messenger of Allah said: "O my son.* ' It was also reported by Abu Dawud and At- Tirmidhi.¹³ iBut if you know not their father's then they are your brothers in the religion and Mawalikum (your freed servants). Here Allah commands that adopted sons should be given back their fathers names, if they are known; if they are not known, then they should be called brothers in faith or freed servants, to compensate for not knowing what their real lineage is. When the Messenger of Allah^ left Makkah after performing his Umrat Al-Qada , 141 the daughter of Hamzah, may Allah 1:234, Abu Dawud 2:480, An-NasAl 5:271, Ibn MSjah * Muslim 3 :1693 131 Abu Dawud 5 :247 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 8 :120 141 This was the Umrah performed by the Prophet gg in the year following Al-Hudaybiyah (6 H) when he had been prevented from performing Umrah as he had intended

iyour brothers in faith and yourfreed servants. Then Allah says: i.h Li ^And there is no sin on you concerning that in which you made a mistake,} meaning, if you call one of them after someone who is not in fact his father, by mistake, after hying your best to find out his parentage, then Allah will not attach any sin to this mistake. This is like the Ayah in which Allah commands His servants to say: < iOur Lord! Punish us not if we forget or fall into error} (2:286). It was reported in Sahih

Do not exaggerate in praising me as Isa bin Maryam was praised upon him be peace and blessings. I am just a servant of Allah. Say,

bljSj (*r ;4^ r-ih o; cntl-lij -ciL^=" ZJJ J S;-vCjJjl* . The Prophet is closer to the believers than themselves, and his wives are their mothers. And blood relations among each other have closer personal ties in the decree of Allah than the believers and the Muhajirin, except that you do kindness to those brothers. This has been written in the Book.} Loyalty to the Prophet and his wives are Mothers of the Believers Allah tells us how His Messenger is merciful and sincere towards his Ummah, and how he is closer to them than they are to themselves. His judgement or ruling takes precedence over their own choices for themselves, as Allah says: ft ---' tj !>-* j r >*-H! 4But no, by your Lord, they can have no faith, until they make you judge in all disputes between them, and find in themselves no resistance against your decisions, and accept with full submission.} (4:65) In the Sahih it says: 5fi'/j^j In J*- cn& V i-hi Ijr* iSWj "By the One in Whose Hand is my soul, none of you tridy believes until I am dearer to him than his own self, his wealth, his children and all the people.^ It was also reported in the SahVi that Umar, may Allah be pleased with him, said: O Messenger of Allah, by Allah, you are dearer to me than everything except myself. He said, jy. idj bj\ JU- Vjj. u t m Fath Al-Bari 1 :75.

}And blood relations among each other have closer personal ties in the decree of Allah than the believers and the MuhdjirTn,} This is an abrogation of the rule that existed previously, whereby they could inherit from one another by virtue of the oath of brotherhood among them. Ibn Abbas and others said: A Muhajir would inherit from an Ansari even though they were not related by blood, because of the brotherhood established between them by the Messenger of Allah This was also stated by Said bin Jubayr and others among scholars of the earlier and later generations. iexcept that you do kindness to those brothers.} means, the idea of inheriting from one another has gone, but there remains the duty to offer support and kindness, to uphold ties of brotherhood and to offer good advice. iThis has been written in the Book.} This ruling, which is that those who are blood relatives have closer personal ties to one y'}ji (ptpalWL yy y y *"'* ' *"*A\\y*y ./ .': 111 Al-Bukhari nos. 2292, 4580, 6747.

ijyj ftHii LJ Sj)l" \~j -ii ts J 0\$ (yt 4 e,)syti ij ii*' !A\$ 3 4He (Allah) has ordained far you the same religion which He ordainedfar Nuh, and that which We have revealed to you, and that which We ordainedfar Ibrahim, Musa and 'Isa saying you should establish religion and make no divisions in it.} (42:13) This is the covenant which Allah took from them, as He says: J-*j > gj jp <># ' &And when We took from the Prophets their covenant, and from you, and from Nuh, Ibrahim, Musa, and isa son of Maryam .} This Ayah begins with the last Prophet, as a token of respect, may the blessings of Allah be upon him, then the names of the other Prophets are given in order, may the blessings of Allah be upon them. Ibn Abbas said: The strong covenant is Al-'Ahd (the covenant). 0* &3} iThat He may ask the truthful about their truth.} Mujahid said: This refers to, those who convey the Message from the Messengers. ' ^ji} 4And He has prepared far the disbelievers} i.e., among then- nations, iCi| <&.} 4a painful torment.} i.e., agonizing. We bear witness that the Messengers did indeed convey the Message of their Lord and advised their nations, and that they clearly showed them the truth in which there is no confusion, doubt or ambiguity, even though they were rejected by the ignorant, stubborn and rebellious wrongdoers. What theTabari 20:213. 121 Al-Tabari 20:214.

646 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir Messengers brought is the truth, and whoever opposes them is misguided. As the people of Paradise will say: c;& %} 4Indeed , the Messengers of our Lord did come with the truth.} (7:43) p %y& pit ii ^ \jx \$ > j(j ~pt inj pj Jt fit H djtu t ii' ktjy 4tl0S\ pi ojisi j'#2& 4^f j #T y\ - 49. O you who believe! Remember Allah s favor to you, when there came against you hosts, and We sent against them a wind and forces that you saw not. And Allah is Ever All-Seer of what you do.} 410. When they came upon you from above you andfrom below you, and when the eyes grew wild and the hearts reached to the throats, and you were harboring doubts about Allah.} The Campaign ofthe Confederates (Al-Ahzdb) Allah tells us of the blessings and favors He bestowed upon His believing servants when He diverted their enemies and defeated them in the year when they gathered together and plotted. That was the year of Al-Khandaq, in Shawwal of the year 5 AH according to the well-known correct view. Musa bin TJqbah and others said that it was in the year 4 AH. The reason why the Confederates came was that a group of the leaders of the Jews of Banu Nadir, whom the Messenger of Allah jg had expelled from Al-Madinah to Khaybar, including Sallam bin Abu Al-Huqayq, Sailam bin Mishkam and Kinanah bin Ar-Rabr, went to Makkah where they met with the leaders of Quraysh and incited them to make war against the Prophet They promised that they would give them help and support, and Quraysh agreed to that. Then they went to the Ghatafan tribe with the same call, and they responded too. The Quraysh came out with their company of men from various tribes and their followers, under the leadership of Abu Sufyan Sakhr bin Harb. The Ghatafan were led by TJyaynah bin Hisn bin Badr. In all they numbered nearly ten thousand.

Al-Ahzab (9 - 10) (Part-21 When the Messenger of Allah jg heard that they had set out, he commanded the Muslims to dig a ditch (Khandaq) around Al-Madlnah from the east. This was on the advice of Salman Al-Farisi, may Allah be pleased with him. So the Muslims did this, working hard, and the Messenger of Allah sg worked with them, carrying earth away and digging, in the process of which there occurred many miracles and clear signs. The idolators came and made camp to the north of Al-Madinah, near Uhud, and some of them camped on the high ground overlooking Al-Madinah, as Allah says: i'f-t Jt fS&r iWlien they came upon you from above you and from beloiv you) The Messenger of Allah jg came out with the believers, who numbered nearly three thousand, or it was said that they

numbered seven hundred. They had their backs towards (the mountain of) Sal and were facing the enemy, and the ditch, in which there was no water, was between the two groups, preventing the cavalry and infantry from reaching them. The women and children were in the strongholds of Al-Madinah. Banu Qurayzah, who were a group among the Jews, had a fortress in the south-east of Al-Madinah, and they had made a treaty with the Prophet and were under his protection. They numbered nearly eight hundred fighters. Huyay bin Akhtab An-Nadari went to them and kept trying to persuade them until they broke the treaty and went over to the side of the Confederates against the Messenger of Allah ﷺ. The crisis deepened and things got worse, as Allah says: *يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا إِنَّا جَعَلْنَا لَكُمُ الْيَهُودَ وَالنَّصَارَىٰ بَرَثًا كَمَا هُمْ لَكُمُ بَرَثٌ ۚ أُولَٰئِكَ قِطْعٌ مِّنْهُم مَّا لَمْ يَكُن لَّهُمْ بَرَاءَةٌ مِّنَ اللَّهِ وَرَسُولِهِ ۚ فَالَّذِينَ هُمْ يَأْكُلُونَ أَسْهَافًا ۚ وَكَانَ جُنْدُ اللَّهِ يُؤْلِئُونَ إِلَيْهِ أَعْنَافًا ۚ* [33: 11] They besieged the Prophet ﷺ and his Companions for almost a month, but they did not reach them and there was no fighting between them, except for when Amr bin Abd Wadd Al-Amiri, who was one of the most famous and bravest horsemen of the Jahiliyyah, came with some other horsemen, and crossed the ditch to the Muslim side. The Messenger of Allah ﷺ called for the Muslim cavalry, and it was said that no one came forward.

648 *Tafsir Ibn Kathir* Then he called Ali, may Allah be pleased with him, who came forward and they fought in single combat until Ali, may Allah be pleased with him, killed him, and this was a sign of imminent victory. Then Allah sent an intensely cold wind with strong gusts against the Confederates, and they were left with no tents or anything else; they could not light any fires or do anything, and so they departed, disappointed and defeated, as Allah says: *وَإِذْ جَاءَ الْيَهُودُ وَالنَّصَارَىٰ نَجْيًا مِّنْهُم مَّا لَمْ يَكُن لَّهُمْ بَرَاءَةٌ مِّنَ اللَّهِ وَرَسُولِهِ ۚ فَالَّذِينَ هُمْ يَأْكُلُونَ أَسْهَافًا ۚ وَكَانَ جُنْدُ اللَّهِ يُؤْلِئُونَ إِلَيْهِ أَعْنَافًا ۚ* Remember Allah's favor to you, when there came against you hosts, and We sent against them a wind and forces. Mujahid said: This was the easterly wind. This view is supported by another Hadith: *جَاءَ الْيَهُودَ وَالنَّصَارَىٰ نَجْيًا مِّنْهُم مَّا لَمْ يَكُن لَّهُمْ بَرَاءَةٌ مِّنَ اللَّهِ وَرَسُولِهِ ۚ فَالَّذِينَ هُمْ يَأْكُلُونَ أَسْهَافًا ۚ وَكَانَ جُنْدُ اللَّهِ يُؤْلِئُونَ إِلَيْهِ أَعْنَافًا ۚ* was given victory by the easterly wind, and 'Ad were destroyed by the westerly wind. *وَالَّذِينَ هُمْ يَأْكُلُونَ أَسْهَافًا ۚ وَكَانَ جُنْدُ اللَّهِ يُؤْلِئُونَ إِلَيْهِ أَعْنَافًا ۚ* and forces that you saw not.} This refers to the angels who shook them and cast fear and terror into their hearts. The chief of each tribe said, O Banu so-and-so, to me! So they gathered around him, and he said, Let us save ourselves, when Allah cast fear and terror into their hearts. In his *Sahih*,

"Is there any man who will bring me news of the people? He will be with me on the Day of Resurrection." None of us answered him, and he repeated it a second and a third time. Then he said: "O Hudhayfah, get up and bring us news of the people." When he called me by name, I had no choice but to get up. He said, *جِيءَ بِخَبَرٍ مِّنَ الْيَهُودِ وَالنَّصَارَىٰ أَنَّهُمْ جَاءُوا بِمَدِينَةِ الْمَدِينَةِ فَالَّذِينَ هُمْ يَأْكُلُونَ أَسْهَافًا ۚ وَكَانَ جُنْدُ اللَّهِ يُؤْلِئُونَ إِلَيْهِ أَعْنَافًا ۚ* "Bring us news of the people, but do not alarm them." So I went, walking as if I were walking among pigeons, until I came to them. I saw Abu Sufyan warming his back by the fire, and I put an arrow in my bow, wanting to shoot it at him, then I remembered what the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, *أَلَا تَرَوْنَ أَنَّهُمْ يُؤْلِئُونَ إِلَيْهِ أَعْنَافًا ۚ* "Do not alarm them." If I shot the arrow, I would have hit him. So I came back, again walking as if I were walking among pigeons, and I came to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ. After my returning I began to feel very cold. I told the Messenger of Allah ﷺ and he gave me to wear a spare cloak of his which he used to pray in. I slept until morning came, and when morning came, the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, *جِيءَ بِخَبَرٍ مِّنَ الْيَهُودِ وَالنَّصَارَىٰ أَنَّهُمْ جَاءُوا بِمَدِينَةِ الْمَدِينَةِ فَالَّذِينَ هُمْ يَأْكُلُونَ أَسْهَافًا ۚ وَكَانَ جُنْدُ اللَّهِ يُؤْلِئُونَ إِلَيْهِ أَعْنَافًا ۚ* "Get up, O sleepy one!" *وَالَّذِينَ هُمْ يَأْكُلُونَ أَسْهَافًا ۚ وَكَانَ جُنْدُ اللَّهِ يُؤْلِئُونَ إِلَيْهِ أَعْنَافًا ۚ* When they came upon you from above you refers to the Confederates, and from below you.} We have already noted the report from Abu Hudhayfah that these were Banu Qurayzah. 1,1 Muslim 3:1414.

وَالَّذِينَ هُمْ يَأْكُلُونَ أَسْهَافًا ۚ وَكَانَ جُنْدُ اللَّهِ يُؤْلِئُونَ إِلَيْهِ أَعْنَافًا ۚ means, from intense fear and terror. *وَالَّذِينَ هُمْ يَأْكُلُونَ أَسْهَافًا ۚ وَكَانَ جُنْدُ اللَّهِ يُؤْلِئُونَ إِلَيْهِ أَعْنَافًا ۚ* and you were harboring doubts about Allah.} Ibn Jarir said: Some of those who were with the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, had doubts and thought that the outcome would be against the

believers, and that Allah would allow that to happen. Muhammad bin Ishaq said concerning the Ayah & when the eyes grew wild and the hearts reached to the throats, and you were harboring doubts about Allah.} The believers had all kinds of doubts, and hypocrisy emerged to such an extent that Mu'attib bin Qushayr, the brother of Banu Amr bin Awf said: Muhammad was promising us that we would win the treasure of Chosroes and Caesar, but one of us cannot even go and relieve himself. Al-Hasan said concerning the Ayah and you were harboring doubts about Allah.} There were different kinds of thoughts; the hypocrites thought that Muhammad and his Companions would be eliminated, while the believers were certain that what Allah and His Messenger promised was true, and that He would cause the religion to prevail even if the idolators hated it. 2, Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Said, may Allah be pleased with him, said: On the day of Al-Khandaq, we said: O Messenger of Allah, is there anything we should say, for our hearts have reached our throats? He said: 111 Ibn Hisham 1:522. Al-Tabari 20:221.

"Yes, say: O Allah, cover our weak points and calm our fears. Then [Allah] struck the faces of the enemy with the wind, and defeated them with the wind. This was also recorded by Imam Ahmad bin Hanbal from Abu Amir Al-Aqadi. [11 ill. There, the believers were tried and shaken with a mighty shaking.} ill. And when the hypocrites and those in whose hearts is a disease said: Allah and His Messenger promised us nothing but delusion!"} il3. And when a party of them said: O people of Yathrib! There is no position for you. Therefore go back!" And a band of them ask for permission of the Prophet saying: Truly, our homes lie open." And they lay not open. They but wished to flee.}

How the Believers were tested, and the Position of the

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4515-4544]

Hypocrites during the Battle of Al-Khandaq Allah tells us what happened when the Confederates surrounded Al-Madinah and the Muslims were besieged and found themselves in straitened circumstances, with the Messenger of Allah in their midst. They were tried and tested, and were shaken with a mighty shaking. At this time hypocrisy emerged, and those in whose hearts was a disease spoke about what they really felt. / li " ! ti ..y Af , 'of&i& & } i And when the hypocrites and those in whose hearts is a disease said: "Allah and His Messenger promised us nothing but delusion!"} Their hypocrisy became apparent, while the one in whose heart was doubt became weak, and he expressed the ideas that were in his heart because of the weakness of his faith 3 :3

O people of Yathrib meaning Al-Madinah, as it was reported in the ahadith: ty i

Al-Ahzab (14 -17) (Part-21) by others. Ibn Ishaq mentioned that the one who said this was Aws bin Qayzi. 111 They were using as an excuse to go back to their houses the claim that they were lying open and had nothing to protect them from the enemy, so they were afraid for their homes. But Allah said: i And they lay not open meaning, it is not as they claim. i They but wished to flee. \$ means, they wanted to run away from the battlefield. ip iu\$ AiJj b> 1 jii UjLLi! oU-J j i' oig &Vf 5 JJ Oi i 'if 'i o* J" 5 ^' i >^*" -*j-i> uj Xi 6; if Wf. 5j b: jc Is? i < . ft# 3i -if os 4 lW 424. And if the enemy had entered from all sides, and they had been exhorted to Al-Fitnah, they would surely have committed it and would have

hesitated thereupon but little> 425. And indeed they had already made a covenant with Allah in At-Tabari 20 :225

not to him their backs, and a covenant with Allah must be answered for.} 416. Say: "Flight will not avail you if you flee from death or killing and then you will enjoy no more than a little while!"} il7. Say: "Who is he who can protect you from Allah if He intends to harm you, or intends mercy on you?" And they will not find, besides Allah, for themselves any protector or any helper.} Allah tells us about those who said: ' > > 1 is o' ojiyif i Truly, our homes lie open." And they lay not open. They but wished to flee.} If the enemy had entered upon them from every side of Al-Madīnah and from every direction, then demanded that they become disbelievers, they would have promptly done so. They would not have adhered to their faith or remained steadfast in it if they were faced with the slightest fear. This is how it was interpreted by Qatadah, Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd and Ibn Jarir. This is a condemnation of them in the clearest terms. Then Allah reminds them of the promise they had made to Him before this fear struck them, that they would not turn their backs or flee from the battlefield. i' '<&} iand a covenant with Allah must be answered for.} means, Allah will inevitably ask them about that covenant. Then Allah tells them that fleeing from battle will not delay their appointed demise or make their lives any longer; on the contrary, it may be the cause of their being taken sooner, and in a sudden manner. Allah says: iand then you will enjoy no more than a little while!} meaning, after you run away and flee from battle. in At-Tabari 20 :227

Al-Ahzab (18 - 19) (Part-21) iSay: "Short is the enjoyment of this world. The Hereafter is better for him who have Taqwa"} (4:77). Then Allah says: 0A , fi V> ^ \$ iyt* .)1 dj "i' ^ cfjff 'i dr 4Say : Who is he who can protect you from Allah if He intends to harm you, or intends mercy on you?" And they will not find, besides Allah, for themselves any protector or any helper.} meaning, they have no one else except Allah to respond to their cries. VJ (j-tjT OjStj *Jj pi ; ill iu> oi^> Ijji 41S. Allah already knows those among you who keep back (men) from fighting (in Allah's cause), and those who say to their brethren, Come here towards us," while they come not to the battle except a little,} 419. Being miserly towards you. Then when fear comes, you will see them looking to you, their eyes revolving like one over whom hovers death; but when the fear departs, they will smite you with sharp tongues, miserly towards good. Such have not believed. Therefore, Allah makes their deeds fruitless and that is ever easy for Allah.} Allah tells us that His knowledge encompasses those who sought to tell others not to go out and who said to their brethren, meaning their companions, friend and acquaintances, ih 4Come here towards us,} meaning, come to where we are in the shade and enjoying fruits. But in spite of that. 1 Ji VI 3\$ '4\ %}

J zZjj" j JJ ijJji 4>&' '-*-4 p vi^i is (^j iy^=* jL> 0 420. They think that the Confederates have not yet withdrawn; and if the Confederates should come , they would wish they were in the deserts among the bedouins, seeking news about you; and if they were to be among you, they would not fight but little.) This is another aspect of their abhorrent attribute of cowardice and fear: iifr. p&& Sfi^z) iThey think that the Confederates have not yet withdrawn; and that they are still close by and will return. o* j j} 1fkn vb-3-"^^ df}) 4and if the Confederates should come, they would wish they were in the deserts among the bedouins, seeking news about you;) means, if the Confederates should come back, they hope that they will not be present with you in Al-Madīnah, but that they will be in the desert, asking about news of you and what happened to you with your enemy. iU^ u p iand if they were to be among you,

they would not fight but little.) means, If they are among you, they will not fight alongside you very much, because they are so cowardly and weak, and have so little faith, but Allah knows best about them. \$% 'M pJ5 af tJS&A te.&\ U& 4P& % & Sijj ui tjtf Cj CS 421 . Indeed in the Messenger of Allah you have a good example to follow for him who hopes in Allah and the Last Day, and remembers Allah much.)

" si? 32 1: ts; iplfj itsfaf , 1: JjSj ^ 'jljjj o', ^ <*' #- '. *' f it ^Or f/ti/ffc you that you will enter Paradise with- out such (trials) as came to those who passed away before you? They were afflicted with severe poverty and ailments and were so shaken that even the Messenger and those who believed along with him said,"When (will come) the help of Allah?" Yes! Certainly, the help of Allah is near!){2:214} meaning, this is the trial and test that Allah and His Messenger promised us would be followed by the help and victory of Allah that is near. Allah asmstarns tT ' o\$4ii\Xzi CAjSXj-^>(IJ_J^ y > ~y_ ' ^ >> ' Jcy^ob\$ says: 4"n Allah and His Messenger had spoken the truth.) "tU2J &j yi Ji# <\$And if only added to theirfaith and to their submissiveness.) This indicates that faith can increase and strengthen in accordance with people s circumstances, as the majority of scholars stated: faith can increase and decrease. We have stated this at the beginning of our commentary on Al-Bukhari, m Af-Tabari 20 :236

660 TafsTr Ibn Kathir praise be to Allah. iAnd it only added> means, at that time of stress and difficulty i&L\t ty} theirfaith} in Allah, iand to their submissiveness.} means their submission to His commands and their obedience to His Messenger j"1 . O* |*rV t>* >* (*- " i--) U J*rj i5j?P' OiT p-* -k I ill ujixiii iil ijljb |i^\$&& of* U . Among the believers are men who have been true to their covenant with Allah ; of them some have fulfilled their Nahbah; and some ofthem are still waiting, but they have never chimged in the least.} . That Allah may reward the men of truth far their truth, and punish the hypocrites, if He wills, or accept their repentance by turning to them. Verily, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} Praise for the Believers* Attitude, and leaving the ultimate Fate ofthe Hypocrites to Allah When Allah mentions how the hypocrites broke their promise to Him that they would not turn their backs. He describes the believers as firmly adhering to theircovenant and their promise: i[they] have been true to their covenant with Allah; of them some havefulfilled their Nahbah;} Some of them said: Met their appointed time (i.e., death). Al- Bukhari said, Their covenant, and refers back to the beginning of the At/ah. FathAl-B6ri 8:377.

0* (*rond some of them are still waiting, but they have never changed in the least.} means, they have never changed or broken their covenant with Allah.

Al-Ahzab (23 - 24) (Part-21 Their covenant, iand some of them are still waiting} they are waiting for battle so that they can do well. ' Al-Hasan said: iof them some have fulfilled their Nahbah;} They died true to their covenant and loyal, and some are still waiting to die in a similar manner, and some ofthem have never changed in the least. 121 This was also the view of Qatadah and Ibn Zayd. Some ofthem said that the word Nahbah means a vow. ^but they have never changed in the least.} means, they never changed their covenant or were disloyal or committed treachery, but they persisted in what they had promised and did not break their vow, unlike the hypocrites who said: //- ' *, / j > . / .// ^"/ //>" i, V l&i Jt Truly , our homes lie open. And they lay not open. They but wished to flee.} [33:13] c& v iAnd indeed they had already made a covenant with Allah not to turn their backs,} [33:15] iThat Allah may reward the men of truth for their truth, and punish the hypocrites, ifHe wills, or accept their repentance

by turning to them.} Allah tests His servants with fear and shaking so as to tell the evil from the good, as each will be known by his deeds. Although Allah knows what the outcome will be before anything happens, still He does not punish anyone on the Tabari 20:238. Tabari 20:239.

they gained no advantage. Allah sufficed for the believers in the fighting. And Allah is Ever All-Strong, All-Mighty.} Allah drove back the Confederates disappointed and lost Allah tells us how he drove the Confederates away from Al-Madlnah by sending against them a wind and troops of angels. If Allah had not made his Messenger a Mercy to the Worlds, this wind would have been more severe than the barren wind which He sent against Ad, but Allah says: iAnd Allah would not punish them while you are amongst them (8 :33). So, Allah sent them a wind which dispersed them after they had gathered on the basis of their whims. They were a mixture of tribes and parties with a variety of opinions, so it was befitting that a wind should be sent against them that would scatter them and break up their gathering, driving them back disappointed and lost in their hatred and enmity. They did not achieve any worldly good such as the victory and booty that they had hoped for, nor did they achieve any good in the Hereafter, because of their sin of declaring enmity against the Messenger jg and seeking to kill him and destroy his army. Whoever wants and seriously intends to do a thing is the same as one who actually does it. 4J ojrtjii' iii iAllah sufficed for the believers in the fighting.} means, they did not have to fight them in order to expel them from their land, but Allah Alone sufficed them and helped His servant and granted victory to His troops. Hence the Messenger of Allah jg used to say, " ' > ~ - - C- > " - , f ^XS' J-Ulij to Ji*j vi y'i v" ' None has the right to be worshipped but Allah, Alone, He was true to His promise, and He helped His servant, and He gave might to His soldiers and defeated the Confederates alone and there is nothing after Him.

426. And those of the People of the Scripture who backed them, Allah brought them down from their forts and cast terror into their hearts; a group you killed, and a group you made captives. 427. And He caused you to inherit their lands, and their houses, and their riches, and a land which you had not trodden. And Allah is able to do all things. The Campaign against Banu Qurayzah We have already noted that when the Confederates came and camped outside Al-Madlnah, Banu Qurayzah broke the covenant that existed between them and the Messenger of Allah jg. This happened by the agency of Huyay bin Akhtab An-Nadari, may Allah curse him, who entered their stronghold and would not leave their leader, KaTi bin Asad, alone until he agreed to break the covenant. Among the things that he said to him was, Woe to you! This is the opportunity for glory. The Quraysh and their company of men from various tribes, and the Ghatafan and their followers, have come to you, and they will stay here until they eliminate Muhammad and his companions. Kah said to him, No, by Allah, this is the opportunity for humiliation. Woe to you, O Huyay, you are a bad omen. Leave us alone. But Huyay kept trying to persuade him until he agreed to his request. He laid down the condition that if the Confederates went away without doing anything, he [Huyay] would join them in their stronghold and would share their fate. When Banu Qurayzah broke their covenant and news of this reached the Messenger of Allah jg, he and the Muslims were veiy distressed by that. When Allah helped him by suppressing his enemy and driving them back disappointed and lost, having gained nothing, the Messenger of Allah 3g returned to Al-Madlnah in triumph and the people put down their weapons. While the Messenger of Allah sg was washing off the dust of battle in the house of Umm Salamah, may Allah be pleased with her, Jibril,

upon him be peace, came to him wearing a turban of brocade, riding on a mule on which was a cloth of silk brocade. He said, Have you put down your weapons, O Messenger of Allah?

arm vein during the campaign of Al-Khandaq. The Messenger of Allah jgg had had his vein cauterized and had brought him to stay in a tent in the Masjid so that he could keep a close eye on him. One of the things that Sa'd, may Allah be pleased with him, said in his supplication was, O Allah, if there is still anything that has to do with the war against Quraysh, then keep me alive for it, and if You decree that the war between us and them is over, then let the bleeding be renewed, but do not let me die until I get my satisfaction with regard to Banu Qurayzah. Allah answered his prayer and decreed that they would agree to be referred to him for judgement, and this was their own free choice. When this happened, the Messenger of Allah jg called him to come from Al-Madlnah to pass judgement on them. When he arrived, riding on a donkey that had been specially equipped for him to ride, some of the Aws began to urge him not to be too harsh, saying, O Sa'd, they are your clients so be kind to them, trying to soften his heart. But he kept quiet and did not answer them. When they persisted in their request, he said, Now it is time for Sa'd to make sure that no rebuke or censure will divert him from the path of Allah. Then they knew that he would not let them live. When he reached the tent where the Messenger of Allah was, the Messenger of Allah jg said: upfor your leader . " So the Muslims stood up for him, and welcomed him with honor and respect as befitted his status and so that his judgement would have more impact. When he sat down, the Messenger ofAllah said: These people" - and he pointed to them - have agreed to accept your judgement, so pass judgement on them as you wish ." Sa'd, may Allah be pleased with him, said: My judgement will be carried out? The Messenger of Allfih jg said: Yes. He said, And it will be carried out on those who are in this tent? He said, Yes. He said, And on those who are on this side? - and he pointed towards the side where the Messenger

when there came to them that which they had recognized, they disbelieved in it} (2 :89). May the curse of Allah be upon them. ifrom their forts> means, from their strongholds. This was the view of Mujahid, Ikrimah, 'Ata , Qatadah, As-SuddI and others of the Salaf. > .. 4 <-*-*">? 4and cast terror into their hearts;} means fear, because they had supported the idolators in their war against the Messenger of Allah jfe and the one who knows is not like the one who does not know. They had terrified the

rV^ " . / / " / > / "*" J > " / . h V > ^ i * L " a 1 > (C ^ L ? L A l j J Z s) C j ^ j 0 j i U l j [^ L J k ! Z J \ j C i = = j ^ v - * j i i f i y _ - - t - . " . < > ! ^ -- V T f ' r * ' t " " f | I a ^ U ^ J j 4 - * = = * J - f j 4 i t o l X \$ o % = ! j v 5 g g g p g t t ^ Ikrimah said: At that time he was married to nine women, five of them were from Quraysh - A ishah, Hafsa. Umm Hablbah, Sawdah and Umm Salamah, may Allah be pleased with them. And he was also married to Safiyyah bint Huyay An- Nadariyyah, Maymunah bint Al- Harith Al-Hilaliyyah, Zaynab bint Jahsh Al- Asadiyyah and Juwayriyyah bint Al- ii a r i t h A 1 - Mustalaqiyyah, may Allah be pleased with all of them. 0 ^ - i ' r ^ i C y i r * ' i r i ^ . / ^ . > " 5 U ^ v " J o j 4 U * - A t j + j c A j " a ^ c - j U u J 1 i ? i r * ^ - A) 1 4 3 0 . O wives of the Prophet! Whoever ofyou commits an open Fahishah, the torment for her will be doubled, and that is ever easyfor Allah.} . And whosoever of you is obedient to Allah and His Messenger, and does righteous good deeds, We shall give her, her reward twice over, and We have prepared for her a noble provision .} At-Tabari 20 :252

The Wives ofthe Prophet^ are not like OtherWomen This Ayah is addressed to the wives of the Prophet who chose Allah and His Messenger and the Home of the Hereafter, and remained married to the

Messenger of Allah jg. Thus it was befitting that there should be rulings which applied only to them, and not to other women, in the event that any of them should commit open Fahishah. Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said: This means Nushuz (rebellion) and a bad attitude. 111 Whatever the case, this is a conditional phrase and it does not imply that what is referred to would actually happen. This is like the Ay&t jEXj cxi ij* cd '&>} 4And indeed it has been revealed to you, as it was to those before you : "Ifyou join others in worship with Allah, surely your deeds will be in vain. } (39:65) 4'oflZ ijgil &} 4But if they had joined in worship others with Allah, all that they used to do would have been ofno benefit to them.} (6:88) bti jjJ oj 4Say : "If the Most Gracious had a son, then I am the first of (Allah's) worshippers."} (43:81) % J & SS? ji> 4Had Allah willed to take a son, He could have chosen whom He willed out of those whom He created. But glory be to Him! He is Allah, the One, the Irresistible.} (39:4). Because their status is so high, it is appropriate to state that the sin, if they were to commit it, would be so much worse, so as to protect them and their Hijab. Allah says: vtiSit cy} 4Whoever of you commits an open Fahishah, the torment for 111 Al-Baghawi 3:527.

ithe tormentfor her will be doubled, In this world and the next. Something similar was narrated from Ibn Abi Najlh, from Mujahid. iand that is ever easy for Allah. it is veiy easy indeed. Then Allah mentions His justice and His bounty, in the Ayah a h csjfr \$And whosoever of you is obedient to Allah and His Messenger,} i.e., obeys Allah and His Messenger jg, %a! & GJS iWe shall give her, her reward twice over, and We have preparedfor her a noble provision .} i.e., in Paradise, for they will be in the dwellings of the Messenger of Allah jg in the highest reaches of Mpm, 1 above the dwellings of all the people, in Al-WasUah121 which is the closest of the dwellings of Paradise to the Throne. *J5 tfjll yi il' Of ,jv_- S*il> &V' (iv Jz 4 Xj" o > c^r cr^t iit vd *^=*ib\$ oii'" Of 4 4^ . ^ olJi jil 4#*^^ 'i' 0> . O wipes o/ tfie Prophet! You are not like any other women. If you keep you have Taqwd, then be not soft in speech, lest he in wfwise heart is a disease should be moved with desire, but speak in an honorable manner.} [1 ' See the explanation of S&rat Al- Muttafflfin 83 :18. ' See the heading Occasions for saying Salah upon him under the explanation ofAyah no. 56. of this Surah.

6.78 Tafsir Ibn Kathir 433. And stay in your houses, and do not Tabarruj yourselves like the Tabarruj of the times of ignorance, and perform the Salah, and give Zakah and obey Allah and His Messenger. Allah wishes only to remove the Ar-Rijsfrom you, O members of thefamily, and to purify you with a tfwrough purification> 434. And remember, that which is recited in your houses of the Aydt of Allah and Al-Hikmah. Verily, Allah is Ever Most Courteous, Well-Acquainted with all things. Enjoining certain Manners so that the Mothers of the Believers may be an Example; and the Prohibition of Tabarruj These are the good manners which Allah enjoined upon the wives of the Prophet jg so that they would be an example for the women of the Ummah to follow. Allah said, addressing the wives of the Prophet jg that they should fear Allah as He commanded them, and that no other woman is like them or can be their equal in virtue and status. Then Allah says: ithen be not soft in speech As-SuddI and others said, this means, do not be gentle in speech when addressing men. Allah says: ilest he in whose heart is a disease should be moved with desire means, something unclean. 46 1 * " Jijfr 4but speak in an honorable manner.> Ibn Zayd said: Decent and honorable talk that is known to be good. 11 ! This means that she should address non-Mahram men in a manner in which there is no softness, i.e., a woman should not address a non- Mahram man in the sameway that she addresses her husband. At-Tabari 20:258.

4And stay in your houses, means, stay in your houses and do not come out except for a purpose. One of the purposes mentioned in Shari'ah is prayer in the Masjid, so long as the conditions are fulfilled, as the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: *J J&l * jiil "li} IjjwJ V* Do not prevent the female servants of Allah from the Masjids of Allah, but have them go out without wearing fragrance. *"J* According to another report: *'leven though their houses are better for them ."* & *p^ vj* 4and do not Tabarruj yourselves like the Tabarruj of the times of ignorance,4 Mujahid said: Women used to go out walking in front of men, and this was the Tabarruj of Jahiliyyah. [31 Qatadah said: */ ^ "s y t* .*<" </^* iand do not Tabarruj yourselves like the Tabarruj of the times of ignorance,4 When they go out of their homes walking in a shameless and flirtatious manner, and Allah, may He be exalted, forbade that. Muqatil bin Hayyan said: 4and do not Tabarruj yourselves like the Tabarruj of the times of ignorance,4 Tabarruj is when a woman puts a Khimar on her head but does not tie it properly. *** Abu Dfiwud 1 :381 > Abu Dawud 1 :382. * Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 6 :602 > At-Tabari 20:259. * Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 6 :602

So her necklaces, earrings and neck, and all of that can be seen. This is Tabarruj, and Allah addresses all the women of the believers with regard to Tabarruj. iand perform the Salah, and give Zakdh and obey Allah and His Messenger.} Allah first forbids them from evil, then He enjoins them to do good by establishing regular prayer, which means worshipping Allah alone with no partner or associate, and paying Zakah, which means doing good to other people. iand obey Allah and His Messenger.} This is an instance of something specific being followed by something general. The Wives of the Prophet ﷺ are Members of His Household (Ahl Al-Bayt) iAllah wishes only to remove Ar-Rijs from you, O members of thefamily, and to purify you with a thorough purification.} This is a clear statement that the wives of the Prophet are included among the members of his family (Ahl Al-Bayt) here, because they are the reason why this Ayah was revealed, and the scholars are unanimously agreed that they were the

reason for revelation or there was also another reason, which

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4544–4549]

is the correct view. Ibn Jarir recorded that Ikrimah used to call out in the marketplace: iAllah wishes only to remove Ar-Rijs from you, O members of thefamily, and to purify you with a thorough purification.} This was revealed solely concerning the wives of the Prophet. 111 Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn Abbas said concerning the Ayah: m At-Tabari 20 :267

4^ ^ =st^ C^* Sif 4i>. 4Allah wishes only to remove Ar-Rijs from you, O members of thefamily,} It was revealed solely concerning the wives of the Prophet jj . Ikrimah said: Whoever disagrees with me that it was revealed solely concerning the wives of the Prophet jg, I am prepared to meet with him and pray and invoke the curse of Allah upon those who are lying. * So they alone were the reason for revelation, but others may be included by way of generalization. Ibn Jarir narrated that Safiyyah bint Shaybah said: A ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, said, The Prophet went out one morning wearing a striped cloak of black camel s hair. Al- Hasan, may Allah be pleased with him, came and he wrapped him in the cloak with him. Then Al-Husayn, may Allah be pleased with him, came and he wrapped him in the cloak with him. Then Fatimah, may Allah be pleased with her, came and he wrapped her in the cloak with him. Then Ali, may Allah be pleased with him, came and he wrapped him in the cloak with

him, then he jgg said: 4Allah wishes only to remove Ar-Rijs from you, O members of the family, and to purify you with a thorough purification.} This was recorded by

Al-Ahزاب (32 - 34) (Part-22 doubt that the wives of the Prophet are included among those who are referred to in the Ayah: 4Allah wishes only to remove Ar-Rijs from you, O members of the family, and to purify you with a thorough purification.} The context clearly refers to them. Allah then says: k 4& u 4And remember, that which is recited in your houses of the Aydt of Allah and Al-Hikmah.} meaning, act in accordance with that of the Qur an and Sunnah which Allah revealed to His Messenger jg in your houses. This was the view of Qatadah and others. And remember this blessing with which you alone of all the people have been favored, that the revelation comes down in your houses and not those of other people. A ishah As-Siddiqah bint As-Siddlq, may Allah be pleased with them, was foremost among them with in this blessing and was the most fortunate, and the most favored with this mercy. For the revelation did not come to the Messenger of Allah in the bed of any of his wives except hers, as he stated. Some of the scholars, may Allah have mercy on them, said: This was because he did not many any other virgin besides her, and no man slept with her in her bed before him [J], may Allah be pleased with her. So it was befitting that she should be singled out for this blessing and high status. But if his wives are members of his household, then this title is even more fitting for his own relatives. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Jamllah said: Al-Hasan bin Ali, may Allah be pleased with them both, was appointed as Khalifah when Ali was killed. He said: While he was praying, a man leapt on*him and stabbed him with a dagger. Husayn claimed that he heard that the one who stabbed him was a man from Banu Asad, and Al-Hasan, may Allah be pleased with him, was prostrating at the time. He said, They claimed that he received the wound in his hip. He was ill as a [i] At-Tabari 20:268.

result for many months, then he recovered. He ascended the Minbar and said: people of Iraq! Have Taqwa of Allah concerning us, for we are your leaders and your guests, and we are members of the family (AW Al-Bayf) concerning whom Allah said: v-jx}. %j>, 3Allah wishes only to remove Ar-Rijs from you, O members of the family, and to purify you with a thorough purification.}' He kept saying this until there was no one left in the Masjid who was not weeping and sobbing. 'it l\} ^Verily, Allah is Ever Most Courteous, Well-Acquainted with all things.} means, by His kindness towards you, you have reached this status, and by His knowledge of you and that you are qualified for that status, He has given this to you and singled you out for it. Ibn Jarir, may Allah have mercy on him, said: And remember how Allah blessed you by causing the Ayat of Allah and Al-Hikmah to be recited in your houses, so give thanks to Allah for that and praise Him. -it l\} iVerily, Allah is Ever Most Courteous, Well-Acquainted with all things.} means, *He is kind towards you, for He has caused the Ayat of Allah and Al-Hikmah to be recited in your houses, and Al-Hikmah means the Sunnah. And He is Well-Acquainted with you means, *He chose you as wives for His Messenger. 11 ' Qatadah said: Of 4 4 l* Cij^iij} 4And remember, that which is recited in your houses of the Ayat of Allah and Al-Hikmah.} He is reminding them of His favor. This was narrated by Ibn Jarir.,2 Atiyah Al- Awfi commented on the Ayah: At-Tabari 20:268.Tabari 20:268.

\$^S & l\} iVerily, Allah is Ever Most Courteous, Well-Acquainted with all things.} He knows when and where to reveal Al-Hikmah. This was recorded by Ibn Abi Hfitim, then he said: This was also narrated from Ar-Rabl bin Anas from Qat&dah. cjjJ'.Jl i*. ,iY jj Jj oT ai cM:v \$35. Verily, the Muslims:

men and women, the believers: men and women, the QSnit: men and the women, the men and women who are truthful, the men and the women who are patient, the Khashi' : men and the women, the men and the women who give Sadaqdt, the men and the women who fast, the men and the women who guard their chastity and the men and the women who remember Allah much with their hearts and tongues, Allah has prepared for them forgiveness and a great reward.}

The Reason for Revelation

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4549–4556]

iPpb l{ } iVerily, the Muslims: men and women, the believers: men and women... indicates that Iman is something other than Islam, and that it is more specific, because Allah says: 4 && Eti&& \pg \$ ji h: 4The bedouins say: We believe." Say: "You believe not but you only say, We have surrendered (in Islam),' for faith has not yet entered your hearts."} (49:14). In the Two Sahlhs, it says: Ji'k 0~T Jti V "The adulterer does not commit adultery at the time when he is a believer ."(11 For it snatches away his Iman, although that does not mean he is a disbeliever, according to the consensus of the Muslims. This indicates that Iman is more specific than Islam, as we have stated at the beginning of our commentary on Al- Bukhari. 4the Qdnit: men and the women,} Al-Qunutmeans obedience during quite time. Tr-j iyrjfj ijf H y } 4Is one who is (Qanit,) prostrating himself or standing in the middle of the night, fearing the Hereafter and hoping for the mercy ofhis Lord...} (39:9) 4To Him belongs whatever is in the heavens and the earth. All are Ucpmti (Qanitun) to Him.} (30:26) Al-Bdri 10:33, Muslim 1 :77.

iO Maryam! "Uqnuti to your Lord and prostrate, and bow with Ar-RakVin (those who bow)."} (3:43) A boor iAnd stand before Allah QanitTn} (2:238). So, beyond Islam there is a higher level to be reached, which is /man, and Qunut stems from them both. ithe men and women who are truthful, This refers to their speech, for truthfulness is a praiseworthy attribute. Some of the Companions, may Allah be pleased with them, were never known to have lied even once, neither during JahUiyyah nor in Islam. Truthfulness is a sign of faith, just as lying is a sign of hypocrisy. Whoever is truthful will be saved: j^! p i&ii J! * dp *J\ J! JjLUi jjd^" Jiji 'Jj jUi op (jj+j " _4sui j^pii Jij; ^ iiixf xp J>- jxUi ijxiji j "C& 4 xpC& C,&\ 4,iSS You have to be truthful, for truthfulness leads to righteousness and righteousness leads to Paradise. And beware of lying, for lying leads to immorality and immorality leads to Hell. A man will keep telling the truth and striving to do so until he will be recorded with Allah as a truthful. And a man will keep telling lies and will persist in doing so until he will be recorded with Allah as a / iar."|11 And there are many Hadtths on this topic. ithe men and the women who are patient,} This is the attribute of those who are steadfast, which is patience in the face of adversity and knowing that what is decreed will inevitably come to pass. So, they face it with patience and steadfastness. Patience is the most difficult when disaster first strikes, then after that it becomes easier, and til Muslim 4:2013.

ithe men and the women who fast,} According to a Hadith narrated by Ibn M&jah: jjJl i\Sj ^j^alvj "Fasting is the Zakah of the body . In other words, it purifies it and cleanses it of things that are bad in both physical and Shar i terms. Said bin Jubayr said: Whoever fasts Ramadan and three days of each month, is included in the Ayah, ithe men and the women who fast,} Fasting is also one of the greatest means of overcoming one's desires, as the Messenger of Allah jg said: jJjLU 5"OI !v- j a} 31 "0 young men! Whoever among you can afford to get married, let him do so, for it is most effective in lowering

the gaze and protecting the chastity. And whoever cannot get married, then let him fast, for it will be a protection for him. It is quite apt that next should be mentioned: *cji!LeX\j}* the men and the women who guard their chastity} i.e., they protect their private parts from forbidden and sinful things, except for that which is permitted. Allah says: & \$& C i &\ " ^ "4Si 0 iAnd those who guard their chastity. Except from their wives I 1 '

"O Allah, forgive those who shaved their hair. They said, And those who shortened. *And those who shortened ." This was recorded by Imam

The Reason for Revelation

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4556–4595]

Al-Ahzab (36) (Part-22 See whether there is anybody missing .: "They said, *We have lost so-and-so, and so-and-so. He jgg said, J OjJjiij Ja See if there is anybody missing ."

Al-Ahzab (37) (Part-22) This is like the Ayah: (jS iiSi of o6 4A"d lei those who oppose the Messenger's commandment, beware, lest some Fitnah should befall them or a painful torment be inflicted on them^ (24:63). { / / * / / * ,4 // . * // // < < fJtti j 4iil ifiTlf- lie, > 4ji^ |*jwi c5aU Jyu i 5;s a tez j 5 ift J5ar.4? & \5 fft 'jj tj {f?~ Jp ^ if >?* 437. And (remember) when you said to him on whom Allah has bestowed grace and you have done a favor : "Keep your wife to yourself, and have Taqwa of Allah." But you did hide in yourself that which Alliih will make manifest, you did fear the people whereas Allah had a better right that you should fear Him. So, when Zayd had completed his aim with her, We gave her to you in marriage, so that there may be no difficulty to the believers in respect of the wives of their adopted sons when the latter have no desire to keep them. And AllSh's command must befulfilled> Allah s rebuke to His Messenger and the Story of Zayd and Zaynab Allah tells what His Prophet said to his freed slave Zayd bin Harithah, may Allah be pleased with him, who was the one on whom Allah had bestowed grace, i.e., through Islam and following the Messenger jj . ii-S iand you have done a favor [to himft means, by freeing him from slaveiy. And he was a great leader, held in high esteem and beloved by the Prophet 3g&. He was known as the beloved, and his son Usamah was known as the beloved son of the beloved. A ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, said: The Messenger of Allah 2)g never sent him on a campaign but he appointed him as its commander, and if he had lived after him he would have appointed him as his Khalifah. This was recorded by

be pleased with him, said: When Zaynab s 'Iddah finished, may Allah be pleased with her, the Messenger of Allah ;g said to Zayd bin Harithah, Go to her and tell her about me (that I want to marry her). So, he went to her and found her kneading dough. He (Zayd) said, When I saw her I felt such respect for her that I could not even look at her and tell her what the Messenger of Allah Sg had said, so I turned my back to her and stepped aside, and said, O Zaynab! Rejoice, for the Messenger of Allah sg has sent me to propose marriage to you on his behalf. She said, I will not do anything until I pray to my Lord, may He be glorified. So she went to the place where she usually prayed. Then Qur an was revealed and the Messenger of Allah sg came and entered without permission. We were there when she entered upon the Messenger of Allah Sg, and for the wedding feast we offered bread and meat. Then the people left, and some men stayed behind conversing in the house after they had eaten. The Messenger

of Allah jg went out and I followed him. He Sg started to go around all the apartments of his wives, greeting them, and they said, O Messenger of Allah, how did you find your (new) wife? I do not know whether I or someone else told him that those people had left, so he went and entered the house, and I went to enter after him, but he drew the curtain between himself and I. The ruling of Hijab was revealed and he exhorted the people as Allah had exhorted them: ip^ Ji% 1} iEnter not the Prophet's houses, unless permission is given to you}. This was also recorded by

which specifically excludes adopted sons. This custom (of adopting sons) was widespread among them. ^ o&j) iAnd Allah's command must be fulfilled.) means, *this that has happened was decreed by Allah and was inevitable. Allah knew that Zaynab, may Allah be pleased with her, would become one of the wives of the Prophet jg. ol (Jt ij - iL_l< /J ill' U_i ^"- ^ i38. There is no blame on the Prophet in that which Allah has made legal far him. That has been Allah's way with those who have passed away of old. And the command of Allah is a decree determined. 4 it iii iThere is no blame on the Prophet in that which Allah has made legal far him.) means, in that which has been permitted for him and which he has been commanded to do, i.e. his marrying Zaynab, may Allah be pleased with her who had been divorced by his adopted son Zayd bin Harithah, 4 o*, +LL) iThat has beat Allah's way with those who have passed away of old.) means this is the ruling of Allah for the Prophets who came before him. Allah would not command them to do anything for which they might be blamed. This is a refutation of those hypocrites who imagined that there was anything wrong with his marrying the ex-wife of Zayd, his freed slave and adopted son. iAnd the command of Allah is a decree determined.) means, His command which He has decreed must inevitably come to pass; nothing can prevent it or avert it, for whatever He wills happens, and whatever He does not decree, does not happen.

i5 it,^ at -li S if^ <^i & if og I411 ;&j if&&pQ 2 of 439. Those to/io convey the Message of Allah and fear Him, and fear none save Allah. And sufficient is Allah os a Reckoner.) 440. Muhammad is not the father of any of your men, but he is the Messenger of Allah and the last of the Prophets. And Allah is Ever All-Aware of everything.) Praise for Those Who convey the Message Allah says: 4if^ \$) iThose who convey the Message of Allah) meaning, to His creation, and fulfil that with which they have been entrusted. 45S25> 4andfear Him,) means, they fear Him and they do not fear any besides Him, so no threats on the part of anyone can prevent them from conveying the Message of Allah. 4And sufficient is Allah as a Reckoner.) means, sufficient is Allah as a Helper and Supporter. The leader of all people in this regard and in all regards is Muhammad the Messenger of Allah jg, for he undertook to convey the Message to the people of the east and of the west, to all kinds of the sons of Adam, so Allah caused his word, his religion and his law to prevail over all other religions and laws. The Prophets before him were sent only to their own peoples, but he jg was sent to all of mankind, Arabs and non-Arabs alike. 41 \$) 4Say: "O mankind! Verily, I am sent to you all as the Messenger of Allah) (7:158). Then his Ummah inherited the task of conveying from him.

and the greatest of those who undertook this task after him were his Companions, may Allah be pleased with them, who conveyed from him as he had commanded them, describing all his words, deeds and circumstances, night and day, when he was settled and when he was traveling, in private and in public, may Allah be pleased with them. Thereafter each generation inherited from their predecessors until our own time, so those who are guided, follow their example and their way. We ask Allah, the Most

Generous Bestower, to make us among their heirs. The Messenger[^] is not the Father of any Man Allah states: 4 Muhammad is not the father of any of your men,} After this it was not permitted to say Zayd bin Muhammad, i.e., he was not his father even though he had adopted him. No male child of the Prophet lived until puberty. Khadijah, may Allah be pleased with her, bore him Al-Qasim, At-Tayyib and Af-Tahir, but they died in childhood. Mariyah Al-Qibtiyyah bore him Ibrahim, but he also died in infancy. He jgg also had four daughters from Khadijah: Zaynab, Ruqayyah, Umm Kulthum and Fatimah, may Allah be pleased with them all. Three of them died during his lifetime, Fatimah lived long enough to be bereaved of him, then she died six months later. He is the Last of the Prophets & asL# & jjij ibut he is the Messenger of Allah and the last of the Prophets. And Allah is Ever All-Aware of everything.} This is like the Ayah: ik 3 >&} i Allah knows best with whom to place His Message} (6:124). This Ayah clearly states that there will be no Prophet after him. If there will be no Prophet after him then there will surely be no Messenger after him either, because the status of a Messenger is higher than that of a Prophet, for every

"[11 This was also recorded by

earth has been made a Masjid and a means of purification for me; I have been sent to all of mankind; and the Prophets end with This was also recorded by

Allah has told us in His Book, and His Messenger jgg has told us in the Mu.tawd.tir Sunnah, that there will be no Prophet after him, so that it may be known that everyone who claims this status after him is a liar and fabricator who is misguided and is misleading others. Even if he twists meanings, comes up with false claims and uses tricks and vagaries, all of this is false and is misguidance as will be clear to those who have understanding. This is what Allah caused to happen in the case of Al-Aswad Al- Ansi in the Yemen and Musaylimah the Liar in Al- Yamamah, whose false miracles and nonsensical words showed everyone who was possessed of understanding that they were liars who were leading people astray; may the curse of Allah be upon them both. This is the case with every false prophet until the Day of Resurrection, until they end with Al- MasVx Ad-Dajjal (the Antichrist). Each of these liars is given by Allah signs which show the people of knowledge and the believers that his message is false - which is part of the perfect kindness of Allah towards His creation. These liars do not enjoin what is good, nor forbid what is evil, unless they do so by coincidence or because it serves an ulterior purpose. They are the utmost in falsehood and immorality, in all that they say and do, as Allah says: mm m mmw^ i * 'i + c^==tL "L"j *-4*^

{Shall I inform you (O people!) upon whom the Shayatin descend? They descend on every lying, sinful person (26 :221 -222) This is in contrast to the Prophets - may blessings and peace be upon them - for they are the utmost in righteousness, truthfulness, wisdom, uprightness and justice in all that they say and do, command and forbid. In addition to this they are supported with miracles and clear and obvious proof. May the blessings and peace of Allah be upon them always, as long as heaven and earth remain. 24 ' 2 SfroW4& & !\$< ' m& ft s {41 . O you who believe! Remember Allah with much remembrance.} {42. And glorify His praises morning and Astla.} {43. He it is Who sends Saldh on you, and His angels too, that He may bring you out from darkness into light. And He is Ever Most Merciful to the believers.> {44. Their greeting on the Day they shall meet Him will be "Saldm (Peace!)" And He has prepared for them a generous reward.} The Virtue of remembering Allah much Allah commands His

believing servants to remember their Lord much. Who has bestowed upon them all kinds of blessings and favors, because this will bring them a great reward and a wonderful destiny. Imam

and in health, in secret and openly, in all situations and circumstances. And Allah says: {And glorify His praises morning and Asila.} If you do this, He and His angels will send blessings upon you. There are very many Ayat, Hadiths and reports which encourage the remembrance of Allah, and this Ayah, urges us to remember Him much. People such as An-Nasab and Al-Ma'mari and others have written books about the Adhkar to be recited at different times of the night and day. {And glorify His praises morning and Asila in the morning and in the evening. This is like the Ayah: {And glorify Allah, when you come up to the evening, and when you enter the morning. And His are all the praises and thanks in the heavens and the earth; and in the afternoon and when you come up to the time, when the day begins to decline. (30:17-18). 43.4} He it is Who sends Salath on you, and His angels too,} This is encouragement to remember Allah, i.e., He will remember you, so remember Him. This is like the Ayah: {We have sent among you a Messenger of your own, reciting to you Our Ayat and purifying you, and teaching you the Book and the Hikmah, and teaching you that which you used not to know. Therefore remember Me. I will remember [11 At-Tabari 20:280.

that He may bring you out from darkness into lights means, by means of His mercy towards you, His praise of you and the supplication of His angels for you, He brings you forth from the darkness of ignorance and misguidance into the light of guidance and certain faith. {And He is Ever Most Merciful to the believers. means, in this world and in the Hereafter: in this world He guides them to the truth of which others are ignorant, and He shows them the path from which others have gone astray, those who call for disbelief and innovation, and their followers among the wrongdoers. His mercy towards them in the Hereafter means that He will save them from the greater terror (of the Day of Resurrection) and will command His angels to greet them with the glad tidings of Paradise and salvation from the Fire, which will only be because of His love for them and His kindness towards them. Imam

712 Tafstr Ibn Kathir prisoners of war picking up her child, clasping the child to her breast and nursing him. The Messenger of Allah said: {Do you think that this woman would throw her child into the Fire even though she is (physically) able to do so?" They said, No. The Messenger of Allah {said: {By Allah, Allah is more merciful towards His servants than this woman is to her child. {Their greeting on the Day they shall meet Him will be Salam") The apparent meaning - and Allah knows best - is that then- greeting, from Allah on the Day that they meet Him, will be Salam, i.e., He will greet them with Salam, as He says elsewhere: {It will be said to them) : Salam - a Word from the Lord, Most Merciful.) (36:58) Qatadah claimed that the meaning was that they would greet one another with Salam on the Day when they meet Allah in the Hereafter.12 This is like the Ayah: {Their way of request therein will be Glory to You, O Allah,' and 'Salam' will be their greetings therein! and the close of their request will be 'All praise is due to Allah, the Lord of all that exists.') (10:10) {And He has prepared for them a generous reward.) Al-Bari 10 :440Jabari 20:280.

Al-Ahzab (45 - 48) (Part-22) means Paradise and everything in it of food, drink, clothing, dwellings, physical pleasure, luxuries and delightful scenes, such as no eye has seen, no ear has heard and has never entered the mind of man. {You will be there for ever, and you will never be removed from it. (45:26) {And you will be there for ever, and you will never be removed from it. (45:26) {And you will be there for ever, and you will never be removed from it. (45:26)

4tp^s4=y fh j"* (> J^=0b 445. O Prophet! Verily, We Juroe serif you as witness, and a bearer of glad tidings, and a wamer,\$ i46. And as one who invites to Allah by His leave, and as a lamp spreading light. 447. And announce to the believers t\le glad tidings, that they will havefrom Allah a great bounty 448. And obey not the disbelievers and the hypocrites, and harm them not. And put your trust in Allah, and sufficient is Allah as a Trustee The Attributes ofthe Messenger ofAllah sfe Imam

714 Tafstr Ibn Kathir Wahb bin Munabbih said: Allah revealed to one of the Prophets of the Children of Israel whose name was Sha^a (Isaiah); Stand up among your people the Children of Israel and I shall cause your tongue to utter (words of) revelation. I shall send an unlettered (Prophet) from among the illiterate (people). He will not be harsh or severe, or noisy in the marketplaces. If he were to pass by a lamp, it would not be extinguished, because of his tranquillity. If he were to walk on reeds no sound would be heard from under his feet. I will send him as a bearer of glad tidings and as a wamer, who will never utter immoral speech. Through him I will open blind eyes, deaf ears and sealed hearts. I will guide him to do every good deed and I will bestow upon him every noble characteristic. I will make tranquillity his garment, righteousness his banner, piety his conscience, wisdom his speech, truthfulness and loyalty his nature, tolerance and goodness his character, truth his way, justice his conduct, guidance his leader, Islam his nation. Ahmad is his name and through him I will guide people after they have gone astray, teach them after they have been ignorant, raise their status after they were nothing, make them known after they were unknown, increase the number (of followers of the truth) after they have been few, make them rich after they have been poor, and bring them togther after they have been divided. Through him I will bring together different nations and hearts, and reconcile opposing desires. Through him I will save great numbers of people from their doom. I will make his Ummah the best of peoples ever raised up for mankind; they will enjoin good and forbid evil, sincerely believing in Me Alone and accepting as truth all that My Messengers have brought. I shall inspire them to glorify, praise and magnify Me Alone in their places of worship and in their gatherings, when they lie down and when they return home. They will pray to Me standing and sitting. They will fight for the sake of Allah in ranks and armies. They will go forth from their homes by the thousand, seeking My pleasure, washing their faces and limbs, girding their loins. Their sacrifice will be their blood and their holy Book will be in their hearts. They will be like monks by night and like lions by day. Among the members of his family and his offspring I will make those who Eire foremost (in faith)

Al-Ahzab (45 - 48) (Part-22) and believers in the truth and martyrs and righteous people. His Ummah after him will lead people with truth and establish justice therewith. I will give strength to those who support them and help those who pray for them, and I will inflict defeat upon those who oppose them or transgress against them or seek to take something from their hands. I will make them the heirs of their Prophet, calling people to their Lord, enjoining what is good, forbidding what is evil, establishing regular prayer, paying the Zak&h and fulfilling their promises. Through them I will complete the goodness which I started with the first of them. This is My bounty which I bestow upon whomsoever I will, and I am the Possessor of great bounty. 4as witness^ means, a witness to Allah s Oneness, for there is no God except He, and a witness against mankind for their deeds on the Day of Resurrection. iand We bring you as a witness against these people> (4:41). This is like the Ayah: ,3^ iTjLf i that you be witnesses over mankind and the Messenger be a witness over you> (2:143). iand a bearer of glad tidings, and a wamer.\$ means, a bearer of glad tidings to the believers of a great reward, and a warner to

the disbelievers of a great punishment. JI iAnd as one who invites to Allah by His leave,> means, you call mankind to worship their Lord because He has commanded you to do so. *** Ibn Abi Hatim no. 17714.

716 Tafstr Ibn Kathir iand as a lamp spreading light. means, the Message that you bring is as clear as the sun shining brightly, and no one can deny it except those who are stubborn. 'Z&i {And obey not the disbelievers and the hypocrites, and harm them not means, do not obey them and do not pay attention to what they say. iand harm them not.} means, overlook and ignore them, for their matter rests entirely with Allah and He is sufficient for them (to deal with them). Allah says: 4' && ftS iAnd put your trust in Allah, and sufficient is Allah as a Trustee.} 3 j5 " 33 *H} Hr- Cr*t>*~* *-* o? 449. O you who believe! When you marry believing women, and then divorce them before you have sexual intercourse with them, no 'Iddah have you to count in respect of them. So, give them a present, and set them free in a handsome manner.} A Gilt and no [Iddah] for Women Who are divorced before Consummation of the Marriage This Ayah contains many rulings, including the use of the word Nikah for the marriage contract alone. There is no other Ayah in the Qur'an that is clearer than this on this point. It also indicates that it is permissible to divorce a woman before consummating the marriage with her. ibelieving women} this refers to what is usually the case, although there is no difference between a believing (Muslim) woman and a woman of the People of the Book in this regard.

according to scholarly consensus. Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, Said bin Al-Musayyib, Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Ali bin Al-Husayn Zayn-ul- Abidin and a group of the Salaf took this Ayah as evidence that divorce cannot occur unless it has been preceded by marriage, because Allah says. hP' lil< iWhen you marry believing women, and then divorce them The marriage contract here is followed by divorce, which indicates that the divorce cannot be valid if it comes first.111 Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, If someone were to say, every woman I marry will ipso facto be divorced, this does not mean anything, because Allah says: ti! \cX ouH iO you who believe! When you marry believing women, and then divorce them....}." It was also reported that Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said: Allah said, iWhen you marry believing women, and then divorce them.} Do you not see that divorce comes after marriage? A Hadlth to the same effect was recorded from Amr bin Shu'ayb from his father from his grandfather, who said: The Messenger of Allah^ said: Jul; h ft jyi, "There is no divorce for the son of Adam with regard to that which he does not possess This was recorded by

hut bestow on them gift, the rich according to his means, and the poor according to his means, a gift of reasonable amount is a duty on the doers of good.> (2:236) In Sahih

The Women who are Lawful for the Prophet jg Allah says, addressing His Prophet jg that He has made lawful for him of women his wives to whom he has given the dowry, which is what is meant by their due , which is used here, as was stated by Mujahid and others . The dowry which he gave to his wives was twelve and half Uqiyah (measures of gold) so they all received five hundred Dirhams except for Umm Habibah bint Abi Sufyan, to whom An-Najashi, may Allah have mercy on him, gave four hundred Dinars (on behalf of the Prophet jg) Safiyyah bint Huyay, whom he chose from among the prisoners of Khaybar, then he set her free, making her release her dowry. A similar case was that of Juwayriyah bint Al-Harith Al-Mustalaqiyyah - he paid off the contract to buy her freedom from Thabit

bin Qays bin Shammās and married her. May Allah be pleased with them all. {those (slaves) whom your right hand possesses whom Allah has given to you,} means, the slave-girls whom you took from the war booty are also permitted to you. He owned Safiyyah and Juwayriyah, then he manumitted them and married them, and he owned Rayhanah bint Sham'un An-Nadariyyah and Mariyah Al-Qibtiyyah, the mother of his son Ibrahim, upon him be peace; they were both among the prisoners, may Allah be pleased with them. And the daughters of your paternal uncles and the daughters of your paternal aunts and the daughters of your maternal uncles and the daughters of your maternal aunts This is justice which avoids going to either extreme, for the Christians do not marry a woman unless there are seven grandfathers between the man and the woman (i.e., they are very distantly related or not at all), and the Jews allow a man to marry his brother's daughter or his sister's daughter. So the pure and perfect Shari'ah came to cancel out the extremes of them. At-Tabari 20 : 284.

the Christians, and permitted marriage to the daughter of a paternal uncle or aunt, or the daughter of a maternal uncle or aunt, and forbade the excesses of the Jews who allowed marriage to the daughter of a brother or sister which is an abhorrent thing. {If a believing woman offers herself to the Prophet, and the Prophet wishes to marry her - a privilege for you only,} means, also lawful for you, O Prophet, is a believing woman if she offers herself to you, to marry her without a dowry, if you wish to do so. This Ayah includes two conditions. Imam

named the Surahs. So, the Messenger of Allah[^] said: {If a woman offers herself to you with what you know of the Qur'an.} It was also recorded by (

Al-Ahzaab (50) (Part-22) Ikrimah said: This means, it is not permissible for anyone else to marry a woman who offers herself to him; if a woman offers herself to a man, it is not permissible for him (to marry her) unless he gives her something. 11 This was also the view of Mujahid, Ash-Shalji and others. [2 ' In other words, if a woman offers herself to a man, when he consummates the marriage, he has to give her a dowry like that given to any other woman of her status, as the Messenger of Allah ruled in the case of Barwa bint Washiq when she offered herself in marriage; the Messenger of Allah ruled that she should be given a dowry that was appropriate for a woman like her after her husband died. Death and consummation are the same with regard to the confirmation of the dowry, and the giving of a dowry appropriate to the woman's status in the case of those who offer themselves to men other than the Prophet is an established ruling. With regard to the Prophet himself, he is not obliged to give a dowry to a woman who offers herself to him, even if he consummated the marriage, because he has the right to marry without a dowry, Wali (representative) or witnesses, as we have seen in the story of Zaynab bint Jahsh, may Allah be pleased with her. Qatadah said, concerning the Ayah: {a privilege for you only, not for the (rest of) the believers.} no woman has the right to offer herself to any man without a Wali or a dowry, except to the Prophet. (31) Indeed We know what We have enjoined upon them about their wives and those (servants) whom their right hands possess, Ubayy bin Ka'b, Mujahid, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and Ibn Jarir said, concerning the Ayah: Ad-Durr Al-Manthur 6 :63 1 ,2) At-Tabari 20:286, 287. At-Tabari 20:286.

724 Tafsir Ibtī Kathir indeed We know what We have enjoined upon them about their wives} means, concerning the limiting of their number to four free women, 11 and whatever they wish of slave-girls,

and the conditions of a representative, dowery and witnesses to the marriage. This is with regard to the Ummah (the people), but We have granted an exemption in your case and have not imposed any of these obligations upon you. 4\> (JS& 4in order that there should be no difficulty on you. And Allah is Ever Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.) This is the end of volume seven. & Volume eight begins with Surat Al-Ahzab, Verse. 51. Tabari 20:290.

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Important Guidelines About the Authenticity of the Reports and Quotations in the Tafsir of Ibn Kathir Reports from the Companions of the Messenger of Allah Reports that are attributed to the companions of Allah's Messenger are commonly used for additional explanation of the meanings of the Qur'an. As for those quotes that Ibn Kathir mentions in passing, these quotes may, or may not be authentically attributed to them. Wherever it is mentioned that one of them said something, and that statement contradicts other clearly authentic texts, then such statements can not be held as an evidence against what is known to be authentic. Additional information in this regard is found in the Introduction of Ibn Kathir. Incomplete Chains of Narration The following is a list of common incomplete chains of narrations that Al-Hafiz Ibn Kathir often quotes. - Ali bin Abi Talhah (Al-Walibi) reported that Ibn Abbas said... - (Atiyah) Al-Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said... - Ad-Dahhak from Ibn Abbas. - As-Suddi reported from Abu Malik and Abu Salih from Ibn Abbas, Ibn Mas'ud and (or) some men among the companions. - Al-Hasan Al-Basri reporting from or about the Prophet (s). - Qatadah reporting from or about the Prophet (s). All narrations coming from these chains are unauthentic according to the Sciences of Hadith. Their meanings, however, may be correct as understood by authentic texts, and for this reason they are commonly referenced. Reports from the Followers of the Companions and those who Follow them The following is a list of those who did not see the Prophet

but they report from companions of the Prophet j , while often they themselves are quoted for Tafsir. Reports that are attributed to them are used as additional support in understanding certain issues by Ibn Kathlr. Such quotes may, or may not be authentically attributed to them. Wherever it is mentioned that one of them said something, and that statement contradicts other clearly authentic texts, then such statements can not be held as evidence against the authentic evidence. Abu Al- Aliyah, Said bin Jubayr, Said bin Al-Musayib, Ata (bin Abi Rabah), Ata Al-Khurrasani, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Ar- Rabl bin Anas, Ash-Shahbi, Qatadah, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Ad- Dahhak, Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam (Ibn Zayd), Ibn Jurayj. Other Scholars After the Companions The following are some scholars that Ibn Kathlr often quotes from. Since these scholars are not well known to the average English reader, one should beware that their own statements about the Prophet jg, his companions, or circumstances surrounding the Qur an s revelation, are not to be considered as important as authentically narrated texts. Waki , Sufyan Ath-Thawri, Muhammad bin Ishaq, Ibn Atiyyah, Ibn Abi Hatim, Ibn Jarir (At-Tabari).

The Tafsir of SuratAl-Ahzab

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4606–4631]

(Chapter - 33) Continued The Prophet jg has the Choice of either accepting or rejecting Women who offer Themselves to Him Imam

themselves to the Prophet She said, Would a woman not feel shy to offer herself without any dowry? Then Allah revealed the Ayah, 4 Cj4 id} Ztfij 51; j) iYou can postpone whom you will of them, and you may receive whom you will.) She said, I think that your Lord is hastening to confirm your desire. 11 We have already stated that

Qatadah, Abu Razln, Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam and others. Nevertheless, the Prophet sg used to divide his time between them equally, hence a group of the scholars of Fiqh among the Shafilis and others said that equal division of time was not obligatory for him jg and they used this Ayah as their evidence.

do. Therefore if you divide your time between them, this will be your choice, and not a duty that is enjoined upon you, so they will feel happy because of that and will recognize your favor towards them in sharing your time equally among themand being fair to all of them. iAUah knows what is in your hearts.} means, He knows that you are more inclined towards some ofthem than others, which you cannot avoid. Imam

Al-Ahzab (52) (Part-22) 452. It is not lawful far you (to marry other) women after this, nor to change them far other wives even though their beauty attracts you, except those whom your right hand possesses. And Allah is Ever a Watcher over all things. The Reward of His Wives for choosing to stay with the Messenger^ More than one of the scholars, such as Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah, Ibn Zayd, Ibn Jarir and others * stated that this Ayah was revealed as a reward to the wives of the Prophet expressing Allah s pleasure with them for their excellent decision in choosing Allah and His Messenger jgg and the Home of the Hereafter, when the Messenger of Allah gave them the choice, as we have stated above. When they chose the Messenger of Allah their reward was that Allah restricted him to these wives, and forbade him to marry anyone else or to change them for other wives, even if he

was attracted by their beauty - apart from slave-girls and prisoners of war, with regard to whom there was no sin on him. Then Allah lifted the restriction stated in this Ayah and permitted him to marry more women, * but he did not marry anyone else, so that the favor of the Messenger of Allah towards them would be clear. Imam

b\ 'ij liji c ^ ^ .^ .v de Jis*- s^r <"& ' "by5 ol CS^ Cy j^ _/4^ (*^=*i'j yk: sly a; i)jii o) ^Tyll-ke- xc jL^=> j^J'i jl IjJ a"jJu S; /- titjJ \y^i j Vj 4^tU^ ^ t S i 453 . O you who believe! Enter not the Prophet's houses, unless permission is given to you for a meal, (and then) not (so early as) to waitfor its preparation. But when you are invited, enter, and when you have taken your meal, disperse without sitting for a talk. Verily, such (behavior) annoys the Prophet, and he is shy of (asking) you (to go); but Alldh is not shy of (telling you) the truth. And when you ask (his wives) for anything you want, ask them from behind a screen, that is purer for your hearts and for their hearts. And it is not (right) for you that you should annoy Allah's Messenger, nor that you should ever marry his wives after him (his death). Verily, with Allah that shall be an enormity.} 454. Whether you reveal anything or conceal it, verily, Allah is Ever All-Knower ofeverything.} The Etiquette ofentering the Houses ofthe ProphetM and theCommand ofHijab This is the Ayah of Hijab, which includes several legislative rulings and points of etiquette. This is one of the cases where the revelation confirmed the opinion of TJmar bin Al-Khattab, may Allah be pleased with him, as it was reported in the Two Sahihs that he said: My view coincided with that of my Lord in three things. I said, O Messenger of Allah, why do you not take Maqam Ibrahim as a place of prayer? Then Allah revealed: 4fa -j& m 4And take you (people) the Maqam (place) of Ibrahim as a place ofprayer} (2:125) And I said, O Messenger of Allah, both righteous and immoral people enter upon your wives, so why do you not screen

them? Then Allah revealed the Ayah of Hijab. And I said to the wives of the Prophet jg when they conspired against him out ofjealousy, i&t c# 4;^ may be if he divorced you (all) that his Lord will give him instead ofyou, wives better than you> (66:5), and this is what Allah revealed. In a report recorded by

Al-Ahzdb (53 - 54) (Part-22)

4without sitting for a talk.} meaning, as those three people did who stayed behind and chatted, and forgot themselves to such an extent that this caused inconvenience for the Messenger of Allah jg as Allah says: 4 Verily, such (behavior) annoys the Prophet, and he is shy of (asking) you (to go);} It was said that what was meant was, your entering his houses without permission causes him inconvenience and annoyance, but he did not like to forbid them to do so because he felt too shy, until Allah revealed that this was forbidden. Allah says: U^ v%} ibut Allah is not shy of (telling you) the truth.} meaning, this is why He is forbidding and prohibiting you from doing that. Then Allah says: tllf ot tyf} 4And when you ask (his wives) for anything you want, ask themfrom behind a screen,} meaning, just as it is forbidden for you to enter upon them, it is forbidden for you to look at them at all. If anyone of you has any need to take anything from them, he should not look at them, but he should ask for whatever he needs from behind a screen. Prohibition of annoying the Messenger ^ and the Statement that His Wives are Unlawful for the Muslims 4 vJ ijoJi o; J Vj i/j}5 o' Cj} it od==> 4And it is not (right) for you that you slwuld annoy Allah's Messenger, nor that you should ever marry his wives after him Otis death). Verily, with Allah that shall be an enormity.}

Al-Ahzdb (55) (Part-22) rJj mm m ^ ^=&Xa%SjSSjjS&jA&)Hjhf'J\ < A. ,0> jpP 3 Ot^ ^"r H) oty*-i Vj 6ft^ "i> xA % i*rA{ &4 sju c % Itfr & >* f d% St fl& ,a&^ . It is no sin on them before their fathers, or their sons, or their brothers, or their broth- er's sons, or the sons of their sisters, or their own (believing) women, or their (female) slaves. And (O ladies) have Taqwa of Allah. Verily, Allah is Ever All-Wit- ness over everything.^ Relatives before Whom a Woman does not need to observe Hijab When Allah commands women to observe Hijab in front of men to whom they are not related, He explains who are the relatives before whom they do not need to observe Hijab. This is like the exceptions stated in Surat An-Nur, where Allah says: \$ 3' tCp* 'J < *>\$- S J+jSA X# S Jff-i S bftA If* S S+ijH & \$ S SSS & ') jAA -/ SSif Jf Jj* ji- A p j i, ciM'j tj^ru'iar^t^iic. Sc' .K\'-' 'if ^ > * >> . ^X-IW ^ g. w-i, r '"', I. S ' 'suy.' - -i 4And not to reveal their adornment except to their husbands, or their fathers, or their husbands' fathers, or their sons, or their husbands' sons, or their brothers, or their brothers' sons, or

their sisters' sons, or their women, or their right hand possessions, or the Tabi'in among men who do not have desire, or small children who are not aware of the nakedness of women. (24:31). The Ayah contains more detail than this, which we have already discussed in the Tafsir of the Ayah and do not need to repeat here. Ibn Jarir recorded that Ash-Sha bi and Ikrimah said concerning the Ayah, & '4 ^ is no sin on them before theirfathers...) I said, What about the paternal uncle and the maternal uncle - why are they not mentioned? He said: Because they may describe her to their sons, so it is disliked for a woman to remove her covering in front of her paternal uncle or maternal uncle. 4or their own women,) means that they do not have to observe Hijab in front of other believing women. ior their (female) slaves.) Said bin Al-Musayyib said: This means female slaves only. This was recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim. dA ft 4And (O ladies) have Taqwa of Allah. Verily, Allah is Ever All-Witness over everything.) means, and fear Him in private and in public, for He witnesses all things and nothing is hidden from Him, so think of the One Who is always watching. i dS \$4 yjf 3jU. 'frjz ft ll) 456. Allah sends His Salah on the Prophet, and also His angels (do so). O you who believe! Send your Salah on him, and greet hitn with Taslim.) m At-Tabari 20:318.

TheCommand to say Salah upon the Prophetm AI-Bukhari said: Abu Al- Aliyah said: Allah s Salah is His praising him before the angels, and the Salah of the angels is their supplication. Ibn Abbas said: They send blessings. 111 Abu Isa

jT \LSj\j ius ijUU> (j! jUUv* ^jip JJUJ lvbv" Ju-p- JjUl kp "Say; "O Allah, send Your Salah upon Muhammad and upon the family of Muhammad, as You sent Your Salah upon the family of Ibrahim, verily You are the Most Praiseworthy, Most Glorious. O Allah, send Your blessings upon Muhammad and upon the family of Muhammad, as You sent Your blessings upon the family of Ibrahim, verily You are Most Praiseworthy, Most Glorious This Hadith has been recorded by the Group in their books with different chains of narration. Another Hadith

Al-Ahzab (56) (Part-22) You sent Your blessings upon Ibrahim and the family of Ibrahim." This was also recorded by

"Say : O Allah, send Your Salah upon Muhammad and upon the family of Muhammad, as You sent Your Salah upon the family of Ibrahim, and send Your blessings upon Muhammad and upon thefamily

of Muhammad, as You sent Your blessings upon the family of Ibrahim among all people, verily You are Most Praiseworthy, Most Glorious. And the Salam is as you know j ,1) This was also recorded by

The Virtue of saying Salah upon the Prophet^ Another Hadith

Then he said: This is a Hasan Hadith. 1 Another Hadith Imam

p i " . . .and he does not send Salah upon me .o 1 This was also recorded by

the servants of Allah will be entitled, and I hope that I will be the one. Whoever asks Allah for Al-Wastlah for me, it will be permitted for me to intercede for him." This was recorded by

Takbirs, then to conclude by saying Salam silently. * An-Nasab also recorded this from Abu Umamah, who said, This is from the Sunnah, and he mentioned it.[2] According to the correct view, such a statement reported from a Companion carries the ruling of Marfa It is recommended to conclude supplications with Salah upon the Prophet jg.

JJu N *Jlj l jlt- V _* iJijU 1oljl U fcllj" "cJu5j l2j dijlJ tcJSU ""0 Allah, guide me along with those whom You have guided, grant me health along with those to whom You have granted health, be an ally to me along with those to whom You are an ally, and bless me far that which You have bestowed. Protect me from the evil You have decreed, far verily You decree and none can decree over You. Verily, he whom You show allegiance to is never abased and he whom You take as an enemy is never honored and mighty, O our Lord, blessed and Exalted are Yoh."" In his Sunan,

The son of Adam annoys Me by inveighing against time, but I am time, for I cause the alternation of night and day.

The meaning of this Hadith is that in the Jahiliyyah they used

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4631–4646]

* * Ahmad 4:8. * Abu Dawud 1:635, An-Nasa i 3:91, Ibn Majah 1:524, Ibn Khuzaymah 3:118, Ibn Hibban 2:132, An-Nawawi Tabari 20:322. 14 * Fath Al-Bari 8 :437 , Muslim 4 :1762

Sarah 33. Al-Ahzab (57 - 58) (Part-22) 43 to say, How bad time is, it has done such and such to us! They used to attribute the deeds of Allah to time, and inveigh against it, but the One Who did that was Allah, may He be exalted. So, He forbade them from this. Al-Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said that the Ayah, 4Verily, those who annoy Allah and His Messenger,} was revealed about those who slandered the Prophet jg over his marriage to Safiyyah bint Huyay bin Akhtab. The Ayah appears to be general in meaning and to apply to all those who annoy him in any way, because whoever annoys him annoys Allah, just as whoever obeys him obeys Allah. The Threat to Those Who fabricate Slander C _Ai> ciJIS C(Mj} 4And those who annoy believing men and women undeservedly,} means, they attribute to them things of which they are innocent, which they do not know and do not do. 4% } 4they bear the crime of slander and plain sin.} This is the most serious slander, to tell or transmit things about the believing men and women that they have not done, in order to bring shame upon them and accuse them of shortcomings. Among those to whom the description most applies are those who disbelieve in Allah and His Messengers, followed by the Rafidites who accuse the Companions of shortcomings and faults of

which Allah has stated that they are innocent, and describe them as the opposite of what Allah has said about them. Allah, may He be exalted, has told us that He is pleased with the Migrants and Ansar, and has praised them, but these foolish and ignorant people inveigh against them and accuse them of shortcomings, and say |i| At-Tabari 20:323. See the section on reports at the beginning of this book.

things about them that they did not do and could never have done. In reality, their hearts are misguided, for they condemn those who deserve praise and praise those who deserve condemnation.

45Siirah 33. Al-Ahzdb (59 - 62) (Part-22) little while. 462 . Accursed, they shall be seized wherever found, and killed with a (terrible) slaughter.} 462. That was the way of Allah in the case of those who passed away of old, and you will not find any change in the way of Allah.} TheCommand ofHijab Here Allah tells His Messenger &g to command the believing women - especially his wives and daughters, because of then- position of honor - to draw their Jilbabs over their bodies, so that they will be distinct in their appearance from the women of the Jdhiliyyah and from slave women. The Jilbab is a Rida , worn over the Khimar. This was the view of Ibn Mas'ud, Ubaydah, Qatadah, Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Said bin Jubayr, Ibrahim An-Nakha i, Ata Al-Khurasani and others. It is like the Izar used today. Al-Jawhari said: The Jilbab is the outer wrapper. *Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said that Allah commanded the believing women, when they went out of their houses for some need, to cover their faces from above their heads with the Jilbab, leaving only one eye showing. Muhammad bin Sirin said, I asked Ubaydah As-Salmani about the Ayah it Opk 4to draw their Jalabib over their bodies.} He covered his face and head, with just his left eye showing. 4That will be better that they slwuld be known so as not to be annoyed.} means, if they do that, it will be known that they are free, and that they are not servants or whores.Tabari 20:324. * At-Tabari 20:325.

46 Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr 4And Allah is Ever Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful. means, with regard to what happened previously during the days of Jahiliyyah, when they did not have any knowledge about this. A SternWarning to the Evil Hypocrites Then Allah issues a warning to the hypocrites, those who, make an outward display of faith while concealing their disbelief, 4those in whose hearts is a disease,} Ikrimah and others said that this refers to adulterers in this instance. 1 iand those who spread false news among the people in Al Madinah} means, those who say that the enemy has come and war has started, which is a lie and a fabrication. Unless they give up these actions and return to the truth, 4We shall certainly let you overpower them,} Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, We will give you power over them. * Qatadah said: We will incite you against them. As-Suddî said: We will inform you about them. ithen they will not be able to stay in it} means, in Al-Madlnah, ibut a little while. Accursed. . .} this describes their state while they are in Al-Madlnah for this short time before they are expelled and sent far away. At-Tabari 20:326. * At-Tabari 20:328. At-Tabari 20:328.

jAj Cts 0 VuSriisjiSli Qp L^-)4UiJi5(jo^ly ttU-"4Jll' l " ><>"/.< i> "i-x. *. ."^(*V "t "ui's c'l'irfi" *<"iS, <*&" i*" i ".f-r r.r-c"T iiiSSatv^a 41,'J jjjcy" ^tfiey shall be seized wherever found,> means, they will be attacked, because they are so weak and so few, iand killed with a (terrible) slaughter.) Then Allah says: (a !> jj iThat was the way of Allah in the case of those who passed away of old,) meaning, this is how Allah dealt with the hypocrites when they persisted in hypocrisy and disbelief and did not give it up; He incited the believers against them and caused them to prevail over them. f& iLil 3j) iand you will notfind any change in the way ofAllah.) means, the way in which Allah deals with this does

not alter or change. icLlll JJ ty j# Lfiig LiJ Ji i*LJl jc- JXM y* Oj^f. Cd tji uui - pi j4j < i il Ol "C; j#j 0.1; & lOI Eft Sj>; a ,^w-j O' j 25 ^ gJO, T b:T^ OH */ ^ >'

463. People ask you concerning the Hour, say: The knowledge of it is with Allah only. What do you know? It may be that the Hour is near!"} 464. Verily, Allah has cursed the disbelievers, and has prepared for them aflaming Fire.} 465. Wherein they will abide forever, and they will find neither a protector nor a helper.} 466. On the Day when their faces will be turned over in the Fire, they will say: "Oh, would that we had obeyed Allah and obeyed the Messenger."} 467. And they will say: "Our Lord! Verily, we obeyed our chiefs and our great ones, and they misled usfrom the way."} 468. "Our Lord! Give them double torment and curse them with a mighty curse!"} No One knowswhen the Day ofResurrection willcome except Allah Here Allah tells His Messenger jg that he cannot know when the Hour will come, and if people ask him about that, He instructs him to refer the matter to Allah, may He be exalted, as Allah says in Surat Al-A raf even though that was revealed in Makkah and this Surah was revealed in Al-Madinah. Allah continues to tell him to refer this matter to the One Who knows about it, but He tells him that it is at hand, as He says: 4 tfi icLlif Jj Cj} 4What do you know? It may be that the Hour is near!} This is like the Ayat 4S:^ \$} 4The Hour has drawn near, and the moon has been cleft: asunder.} [54:1] 4Draws near for mankind their reckoning, while they turn away in heedlessness .} [21:1]

3} 4The Event (the Hour) ordained by Allah will come to pass, so seek not to hasten it} [16:1). The Curseon the Disbelieversand itsEternityand their Regret Then Allah says: iVerily, Allah has cursed the disbelievers,} means, He has distanced them from His mercy. iand has prepared for them a flaming Fire (Hell).} means, in the Hereafter. iWherein they will abide forever,} means, they will stay there forever and ever, never leaving or finding relieffrom it. 'ij iand they willfind neither a protector nor a helper.} means, they will have no saviour to help them or rescue them from their predicament. Then Allah says: &!; sft uil j -' 40n the Day when their faces will be turned over in the Fire, they will say: "Oh, would that we had obeyed Allah and obeyed the Messenger. } means, they will be dragged into the Fire on their faces and their faces will be contorted in Hell, and in that state they will wish that they had been among those who had obeyed Allah and His Messenger jg in this world. Allah describes how they will be in the Hereafter: jAAj" ojiii pjJi! fjj} j 'laj .UI =y JUu _^==*i)' (f. jjj jjfi

iAnd the Day when the wrongdoer will bite at his hands, he will say: Oh! Would that I had taken a path with the Messenger. Ah! Woe to me! Would that 1 had never taken so- and-so as an intimate friend! He indeed led me astrayfrom the Reminder after it had come to me. And Shaytdn is to man ever a deserter in the hour ofneed."} (25:27-29) iX i \s_ Q>} iHow much would those who disbelieved wish that they had been

but Allah cleared him of that which they alleged, and he was honorable before Allah. The Fabrications ofthe Jews againstMusa

on the rock, three orfour or five. This is what is referred to in the Ayah: {O you who believe! Be not like those wlto annoyed Musa, but Allah cleared him of that which they alleged, and he was honorable before Allah.^n This Hadlth is one of those which were recorded by

Al-Ahzdb (70 - 73) (Part-22)471. He will direct you to do righteous good deeds and will forgive you your sins. And whosoever obeys Allah and His Messenger, he has indeed achieved a great victory.} The Command to the Believers to have Taqwa and speak the Truth Here Allah commands His servants to have Taqwa of Him, worshipping Him as if they can see Him, and to speak (always) the truth.} meaning, to speak in a straightforward manner, with no crookedness or distortion. He promises them that if they do that, He will reward them by making their deeds righteous, i.e., enabling them to do righteous deeds, and He will forgive them their past sins. With regard to whatever sins they may commit in the future. He will inspire them to repent from them. Then He says: \jj Aii /Jyfa iuf g) J*j} 4And whosoever obeys Allah and His Messenger, he has indeed achieved a great victory.} meaning, he will be saved from the fire of Hell and will enjoy everlasting delights (in Paradise). if* iiUVt ce^j> && & 1 472. Truly, We did offer the Amanah to the heavens and the earth, and the mountains, but they declined to bear it and were afraid of it. But man bore it. Verily, he was unjust and ignorant.} 473. So that Allah will punish the hypocrites, men and women, and the men and women who are idolators. And Allah will pardon the believers, men and women . And Allah is Ever Oft- Forgiving, Most Merciful.} m Amanah means trust. Here we see that there are reports that give particular explanations for it in this context.

HowMan bore theAmanah Al- Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said, Al-Amdnah means obedience. This was offered to them before it was offered to Adam, and they could not bear it. Then Allah said to Adam: 1 have offered the Amanah to the heavens and the earth and the mountains, and they could not bear it. Will you take it on? He said, O Lord, what does it involve? He said, If you do good, you will be rewarded, and ifyou do evil, you will be punished. So Adam took the Amanah and bore it, and this is what is referred to in the Ayah 4x4^- Al iBut man bore it. Verily, he was unjust and ignorant.} II] Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, Al-Amdnah means Al-Fara id (the obligatory duties). Allah offered them to the heavens and the earth and the mountains, (on the grounds that) if they fulfilled them, He would reward them; and if they failed, He would punish them. But they did not want to do that, and theywere afraid of it, not because their intentionwas sinful, but because oftheir respect for the religion ofAllah, in case they could not fulfill the obligations involved. Then Allah offered it to Adam, and he accepted it with all that it entailed. This is what is referred to in the Ayah: iBut man bore it. Verily, he was unjust and ignorant.} meaning, he underestimated the command of Allah. This was also the view of Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Ad- Dahhak, Al-Hasan Al-Basri and others that Al-Amdnah means Al-Fara id.. * Others said that it meant obedience. Al-A*mash narrated from Abu Ad-Duha from Masrttq that Ubayy bin Ka*b said: Part of Al-Amdnah means that woman was entrusted with her own chastity. ' Qatadah said: Al-Amdnah means religion, obligatoiy duties and prescribed punishments. Tabari 20:338. |2> At-Tabari 20:337.Tabari 20:337. At-Tabari 20:338. At-Tabari 20:339.

Malik narrated that Zayd bin Aslam said: Al-Amanah means three things: prayer, fasting and performing Ghushl to cleanse oneself from sexual impurity. There is no contradiction between all of these views; they are all in agreement and all refer to responsibility and the acceptance of commands and prohibitions with their attendant conditions, which is that the one who fulfills this responsibility, will be rewarded; while the one who neglects it, will be punished. Man accepted this despite the fact that he is weak, ignorant and unjust - except for those whom Allah helps, and Allah is the One Whose help we seek. One of the reports which deal with Al-Amanah is the Hadlth recorded by Imam Ahmad

from Hudhayfah, may Allah be pleased with him, who said: The Messenger of Allah ﷺ told us two Hadiths, one of which I have seen and the other I am still waiting to see. He told us that Al-Amanah is deeply rooted in the heart of man, then the Qur'an was revealed and they know it from the Qur'an and from the Sunnah. Then he told us that Al-Amanah will be taken away. He said, *ما من قلب منكم إلا طمس عليه شئ مما أمروا به* "A man may sleep and Al-Amanah will be taken from his heart, leaving nothing but a trace like a blister left by a coal if you were to roll it over your leg - you will see it protruding but there is nothing inside. " Then he took a pebble and rolled it over his leg, then he said: *ثم يبتاعونها ويبيعونها* 'Then the people will start buying and selling, and hardly anyone will be paying attention to Al-Amanah, until it will be said that among the tribe of so-and-so there is a trustworthy man, and it will be said of a man, how strong he is, how nice and how wise,' and there is not even a mustard seed of faith in his heart. No doubt, there came upon me a time when I did not mind dealing (bargaining) with anyone of you, for if he was a Muslim, his Islam would compel him to pay me what is due to

and who obey Him. 4 And Allah is Ever Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful. This is end of the Tafsir of Surat Al-Ahzab. Allah's is the praise and thanks.

Module 29

Surah 34: Saba, Surah 35: Fatir, Surah 36: Ya-Sin

Surah 34: Saba

PDF pages 4647–4706

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4647–4652]

Opening The Tafsir of Surah Saba (Chapter - 34) Which was revealed in Makkah In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. the Most Merciful, the Oft-Forgiving.} All Praise and the Knowledge of the Unseen belong to Allah Alone Allah tells us that all praise belongs to Him alone in this world

meaning, He knows the number of raindrops that sink into the depths of the earth, and the seeds that have been sown, and the things that are hidden in it, and He knows what comes forth from that, how many they are, how they grow and what they look like. and that which descends from the heaven) means, of raindrops and provision, and what ascends into it, i.e., righteous deeds and other things. " %) 4 And He is the Most Merciful, the Oft-Forgiving.) means, He is Most Merciful to His servants; He does not hasten to punish them, and He forgives the sins of those who repent to Him and put their trust in Him. jui. m V & ji ItA1 Jtij) = 4 & 253 % j 4# t-ji; U\$ 'jiA /J '4, ^,* I fri yC. iffrj . 77iose who disbelieve say: The Hour will not come to us." Say: "Yes, by my Lord, the All-Knower of the Unseen, it will come to you; not even the weight of a speck of dust or less than that or greater escapes His knowledge in the heavens or in the earth but it is in a Clear Book.") i4. That He may recompense those who believe and do righteous good deeds. Tlwse, theirs is forgiveness and generous provision.) 45. But those who strive against Our Ayat to frustrate them - those, for them will be a severe painful torment.) 46. And those who have been given knowledge see that what is revealed to you from your Lord is the truth, and that it guides to the path of the Exalted in might, Owner of all praise.)

Saba (3 - 6) (Part-22) from Him. ' In other words, everything is encompassed by His knowledge, and nothing is hidden from Him. Even though bones may be scattered and disintegrate, He knows where they have gone and where they have dispersed, then He will bring them back just as He created them in the first place, because He has knowledge of all things. Then Allah tells us of His wisdom in re-creating bodies and bringing about the Hour, as He says: Z& Zg \p: cJ iThat He may recompense those who believe and do righteous good deeds. Those, theirs is forgiveness and generous provision. But those who strive against Our Ayat to frustrate them^ meaning, those who try to turn others away from the path of Allah and who disbelieve His Messengers, pj v>'j pity i those, for them will be a severe painful torment.} This means, He will bestow His favor upon the blessed, who are the believers, and will punish the doomed, who are the disbelievers. This is like the Ayah: lifP) peA ZsfSS iNot equal are the dwellers of the Fire and the dwellers of the Paradise. It is the dwellers of Paradise that will be successful. (59:20) Ini ' ' Jp-j C/jj) s'f jT i Shall V\!e treat those who believe and do righteous good deeds like those who cause mischief on the earth? Or shall We treat those who have Taqwd as the evildoers?}

(38:28) ip\ A C*X - t.l }And those who have been given knowledge see that what is revealed to you from your Lord is the truth,} At-Tabari 20 :350

This is another kind of wisdom, following on from the one before, which is that when those who believed in what was revealed to the Messengers see the onset of the Hour and

how the righteous and the wicked will be rewarded and punished respectively, which they knew of beforehand in this world from the Books of Allah and which they are now seeing with their own eyes, they will say: i\$G& S3> ilndeed, the Messengers of our Lord did come with the truth} (7:43). And it will be said: i3jZf\$ J2j\ j u j mm mmu Vi . -a JeAX.a)(tj X- ><%-' . * .tV f . *^Z X JyvJ 'i3 Z*ul" ifi*L A** y ' 'C /S^> '>* *YC ^ >>/ IXyi^LJb ill 477ris is what the Most Gracious had promised, and the Messengers spoke truth!} (36:52| / "z*z <"/ Z W ' z, zz , " Z "z/. fj 'ji-4* oJj' >*J" ^ (j ^Lj -U)f> ilndeed you have stayed according to the decree of Allah, until

the Day of Resurrection; so this is the Day of Resurrection}

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4652–4661]

(30:56), 4,>? 3jG_> o*J' JI Gv ^ Kjif 'j3jl 4An those ivho have been given knowledge see that what is

revealed to you from your Lord is the truth, and that it guides to the path of the Exalted in might. Owner of all praise. The Exalted in might is the One Who is All-Powerful, Whom none can overwhelm or resist, but He subjugates and controls all things. The Owner of All praise is the One Who, in all His words, deeds, laws and decrees, is deserving of praise, may He be glorified and exalted. \$ 'Jiiy ^ fa 'fSn j& uyft Jui li 4 'j0Tj ;as\^ (4^- t 4l ! j3 4 tli-lif h-4 ft? kz -j jl o^ . Those who disbelieve say : Shall we direct you to a man who will tell you (that) when you have become fully disintegrated into dust with fidl dispersion, then you will be created (again) aneiv? 4 48. Has he invented a lie against Allah, or is there a madness in him? Nay, but those who disbelieve in the Hereafter are (themselves) in a torment, and in far error. 49. See they not what is before them and what is behind them, of the heaven and the earth? IfWe will, We shall sink the earth with them, or cause a piece of the heaven to fall upon them. Verily, in this is a sign for every servant who turns (to Allah) in repentance. The Disbelievers Denial of Life after Death, and the Refutation ofTheirView Here Allah tells us how the disbelievers and heretics denied that the Hour will come, and mocked the Messenger jfc for speaking of it. 4Tlwse who disbelieve say : Shall we direct you to a man who will tell you (that) when you have become fully disintegrated into dust with full dispersion ...?" means, when your bodies have disintegrated into the earth

66 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir and dispersed without a trace, iplt itthen you} means, after this has happened, }ivill be created (again) anew} means, you will be restored to life and will receive provision anew. By telling us this, he is doing one of two things: either he is deliberately fabricating something and saying that Allah has revealed it to him, or he is not doing it deliberately, but he is deluded as crazy and insane people are. They said: 4 "' jil tijii }Has he invented a lie against Allah, or is there a madness in him?} Allah said, refuting their words: jiillJ yljji 4 'ofof, y pi j,} iNay, but those who disbelieve in the Hereafter are (themselves) in a torment, and in far error.} meaning, the matter is not as they claim or as they think; on the contrary, Muhammad is the one who is telling the truth, and is righteous and wise; he

is the one who has brought the truth, and they are the foolish and ignorant liars. iare themselves) in a tonnent,} means, their disbelief, which will lqad them to the torment of Allah. iatid in far error.} far from the truth in this world. Then Allah warns them of His power in the creation of heavens and earth, as He says: b *U'^ |T<&- Uj l* iiJJ li/ \$} }See they not what is before them and what is behind them, of the heaven and the earth?} meaning, wherever they go, in whatever direction, the heavens

are above them and the earth is beneath them. This is like the Ayah iWith Hands did We construct the heaven. Verily, We are Able to extend the vastness of space thereof. And We have spread out the earth; how Excelletit Spreader (thereof) are We/^ (51:47-48) ilfWe will, We shall sink the earth with them, or cause a piece of the heaven to fall upon them .)> means, if We wished, We could do that to them because- of their wrongdoing and Our power over them, but We delay it because We are Patient and Forgiving. Then Allah says: jlj. ^Verily, in this is a sign for every Munib servant.} Ma'mar narrating from Qatadah, said that Al-Murub means every one who repents.! * Sufyan narrated from Qatadah, that Al-Murub is the one who turns to Allah.¹²¹ This means that in looking at the creation of the heavens and the earth, there is a sign for every servant who is intelligent and wise and who turns towards Allah. There is a sign of the Allah s ability to recreate bodies and bring about the Resurrection, because the One Who was able to create these heavens - with their vast reaches of space, and this earth, as deep and vast as it is - is able to recreate bodies and revive decayed bones. This is like the Ayat U J A 4< ils not He Who created the heavens and the earth. Able to create the like ofthem? Yes, indeed!} (36:81) y i&j cA ujuV'j c&LZSi Abdur-Razzaq 3:126.Tabari 20 :356

68 Tafsfr Ibn Kafhir iThe creation of the heavens and the earth is indeed greater than the creation ofmankind; yet, most ofmankind know not.} (40:57) J -kfJj A IjJ'j /L** y.2* iL Ijij ilil 4 .5',jw Lj ij[Udu" j jijj 410 . And indeed We bestowed grace on Dawud from Us (saying) : "O you mountains! Glorify with him! And you birds (also)! And We made the iron softfor him."} ill. Saying: "Make you perfect coats of mail, and balance well the rings of chain armor [Sard], and work you (men) righteousness. Truly, I am All-Seer ofwhat you do."} The Favors which Allah bestowed upon Dawud Here Allah tells us how He blessed His servant and Messenger Dawud (David), peace be upon him, and what He gave him of His great bounty, giving him both prophethood and kingship, and huge numbers of troops. And He blessed him with a mighty voice. Such that when he glorified Allah, the firm, solid, high mountains joined him in glorifying Allah, and the free-roaming birds, who go out in the morning and come back in the evening, stopped for him, and he was able to speak all languages. In the Sahih it is recorded that the Messenger of Allah sH heard the voice of Abu Musa Al-Ash ari, may Allah be pleased with him, reciting at night, and he stopped and listened to his recitation, then he said: ' This man has been given one of the sweet melodious voices of the Prophet Dawud. Abu Uthman An-Nahdi said, I never heard any cymbal, stringed instrument or chord that was more beautiful than the voice of Abu Musa Al-Ash ari, may Allah be pleased with him. ¹²¹ 1 :546. ¹²¹ Fadd il Al-Qur'&n byAbu TJbayd p . 79

iGlorify} means, glorify Allah. This was the view of Ibn Abbas, Mujahid and others. ' The root of this word [Ta'wib] means to repeat or respond, so the mountains and birds were commanded to repeat after him. iAnd Y made the iron soft for him.} Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Qatadah, Al-A mash and others said, He did not need to heat it in the fire or beat it with a hammer; he could simply twist it in his hands, like a

thread. '2 * Allah said: iSaying: "Make you perfect coats of mail..."}, which means chain mail. Qatadah said, He was the first person ever to make chain mail; before that, they used to wear plated armor. 131 ip* j j >} iand balance well the rings ofchain armor [Sard],} This is how Allah taught His Prophet Dawud, peace be upon him, to make coats of mail. Mujahid said concerning the Ayah: ip* j iand balance well the rings ofchain armor [Sard],} Do not make the rivets too loose that the rings (of chain mail) will shake, or make them too tight that they will not be able to move at all, but make it just right. '4 Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, Sard refers to a ring of iron. Some of them said, Chain mail is called Masrud if it is held together with rivets. iPP \ %} iand work you (men) righteousness.} means, with regard to what At-Tabari 20:357. At-Tabari 20:359.Tabari 20:359. |4! At-Tabari 20 :361

Allah has given you of blessings. ^Truly, I am All-Seer of what you do.} means, watching you and seeing all that you do and say; nothing of that is hidden at all. # St;J4 C& yf\ ^ jj} ILij C /J jJIm v'-** o* ("r^^ oil* aJpJI ^ Jjb JL, JJJjj *_ \$ fLrj JjLif C-J-* Cfi 4 l'r.JfChi CtiU. 412. And to Sulayman (We subjected) the ivind, its morning ivas a month's (journey), and its afternoon was a month's (journey). And We caused a fount of Qitr to flow for him, and there were Jinn that worked in front of him, by the leave of his Lord. And whosoever ofthem turned asidefrom Our command, We shall cause him to taste of the torment of the blazing Fire.} 413. They workedfor him as he desired on Maliarib, Tamathil, large basins like Jawab and Qudiir Rasiyat. "Work you, O family of Dawud, with thanks!" But few ofMy servants are grateful.} The Favorswhich Allah bestowed upon Sulayman Having mentioned the blessings with which He favored Dawud, Allah follows this by mentioning what He gave to Dawud s son Sulayman (Solomon), may peace be upon them both. He subjugated the wind to him, so that it would cany his carpet one way for a month, then back again the next month. Al- Hasan Al-Basri said, He set out from Damascus in the morning, landed in Istakhar where he ate a meal, then flew on from Istakhar and spent the night in Rahil."111 Between Damascus and Istakhar is an entire month s travel for a swift rider, and between Istakhar and Kabul is an entire month s travel for a swift rider. Jx. ^ (^j} 4And We caused afount Qitr toflowfor him,} m At-Tabari 20 :362

Ibn Abbas, may Allah be plased with him, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Ata Al-Khurasani, Qatadah, As-Suddi, Malik from Zayd bin Aslam, Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam and others said, Qifr means copper. ' Qatadah said, It was in Yemen. '2' Allah brought forth all the things that people make for Sulayman, peace be upon him. * ./\ ^ > ' ' ' * yv ' iand there were Jinn that worked in front of him, by the leave ofhis Lord.} means, We subjugated the Jinn to work in front of him, by the permission of his Lord, i.e., by Allah s decree and subjugation, they built whatever constructions he wanted, and did other work as well. iftp' of- 4And whosoever of them turned asidefrom Our command,} means, whoever among them tried to rebel and disobey, 4\Ne shall cause him to taste of the torment of the blazing Fire.} which means, burning. / / to JS ofe} 4They workedfor him as he desired on Maharib, Tamdthil,} Maharib refers to beautiful structures, the best and innermost part of a dwelling. Ibn Zayd said, This means dwellings. 13' With regard to Tamdthil, Atiyah Al-Awfi, Ad-Dahhak and As- Suddi said that Tamdthil means pictures.'4 ' 4-6 j/Aj jLf,} 4large basins like Jawdb and Qudur Rasiyat.} Jawab, the plural form of Jabiyah, refers to cisterns or tanksTabari 20:363, 364.Tabari 20 :363 '3| At-Tabari 20:365. ,4' At-Tabari 20:366.

in which water is held, and Qudur Rasiyat are cauldrons that stay in one place and are not moved around because of their great size. This was the view of Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak and others.¹¹¹ 4. jj'o jv i iT> iWork you, Ofamily ofDaïoud, with thanks!} means, We said to them: Work with thanks for the blessings that We have bestowed upon you in this world and the Hereafter. This indicates that thanks may be expressed by actions as much as by words and intentions. Abu Abdur-Rahman Al-Hubuli said, Prayer is thanks, fasting is thanks, every good deed that you do for the sake of Allah is thanks, and the best of thanks is praise. This was recorded by Ibn Jarir. 121 In the Two Sahihs, it is reported that the Messenger of Allah jg said: nili Jjbi > - Z>\ 4il ^)J jin 41)1 JJ ^LjaJl Z.J-\ JY Ijl % ij aThe most beloved of prayer to Allah is the prayer of Daïoud. He used to sleep for half the night, stand in prayer for a third of it and sleep for a sixth of it. The most beloved offasting to Allah is the fasting of Daïoud. He used to fast for a day then notfastfor a day, and he never fled the battlefield ."[3) Ibn Abi Hatim narrated that Fudayl said concerning the Ayah: i. IJC jil j it" iWork you, Ofamily ofDaïoud, ivith thanks!} Dawud said, O Lord! How can I thank you when thanks itself is a blessing from You? He said: Now you have truly given thanks to Me, for you have realized that it is a blessing from Me. ,4 > 1,1 At-Tabari 20:367. At-Tabari 20:369. Fath Al-Bari 6 :525 , Muslim 2 :816 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :680

iBut few of My servants are grateful.} This is a reflection of reality. J>- Di /oLlw ijib *fjy &p t" 0^ i^c. L .[via'i 4;; j CgX j jU v 414. Then when We decreed death for him, nothing informed them (Jinn) of his death except a little worm of the earth which kept (slowly) gnawing away at his stick. So when he fell down, the Jinn saw clearly that if they had known the Unseen, they would not have stayed in the humiliating torment.} The Death ofSulayman Allah tells us how Sulayman, peace be upon him, died and

how Allah concealed his death from the Jinn who were

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4661–4664]

subjugated to him to do hard labor. He remained leaning on his stick, which was his staff, as Ibn Abbas may Allah be pleased with him, Mujahid, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and others said. He stayed like that for a long time, nearly a year. When a creature of the earth, which was a kind of worm, ate through the stick, it became weak and fell to the ground. Then it became apparent that he had died a long time before. It also became clear to Jinn and men alike that the Jinn do not know the Unseen as they (the Jinn) used to imagine and tried to deceive people. This is what Allah says: ,_AiJt 4 iyj L OfiLu inothing informed them (Jinn) of his death except a little worm of the earth which kept (slowly) gnawing away at his stick. So when he fell down, the Jinn saw clearly that if they had known the Unseen, they would not have stayed in the humiliating torment.} meaning, it became clear to the people that they (the Jinn) were lying. [i] At-Tabari 20 :370

His provision and give thanks to Him by worshipping Him alone, and they followed that for as long as Allah willed, then they turned away from that which they had been commanded to do. So they were punished with a flood which scattered them throughout the lands around Saba in all directions, as we will see in detail below, if Allah wills. In Him we put our trust. Ibn Jarir recorded that Farwah bin Musayk Al-Ghutayfi, may Allah be pleased with him, said, A man said, O Messenger of Allah! Tell me about Saba - what was it, a land or a woman? He jg said: Ijiv1* ^ sb** ^ ! I I L ij d)Ll-tj aL"1i'j !

ly**li; - ij I UU i Ij nit was neither a land nor a woman . It was a man who had ten children, six of whom went Yemen and four of whom went Ash-Sham. Those who went Ash-Sham were Lakhm, Judham, 'Amilah and Chassan. Those who went south were Kindah, Al- Ash'ariyyun, Al-Azd, Madhhij, Himyar andAnmdr ." A man asked, *Who are Anmar? He 5g said: nThose among whom are Khath'am and Bajilahy This was recorded by At-Tirmidhi in his Jdmi' [Sunan] in more detail than this; then he said, This is a Hasan Gharib Hadith. The genealogists - including Muhammad bin Ishaq - said, The name of Saba was Abd Shams bin Yashjub bin Ya'rub bin Qahtan; he was called Saba because he was the first Arab tribe to disperse. He was also known as Ar-Ra ish, because he was the first one to take, booty in war and give it to his people, so he was called Ar-Ra ish; because the Arabs call wealth Rtsh or Riyash. They differ over Qahtan, about whom there were three views. (The first) he descended from the line of Iram bin Sam binTabari 20:375. TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi9:88.

Nuh, then there were three different views over how he descended from him. (The second) was that he was descended from Abir, another name for Had, peace be upon him, then there were also three different views over exactly how he descended from him. (The third) was that he was descended from Ismail bin Ibrahim Al-Khalil, peace be upon him, then there were also three different views over exactly how he descended from him. This was discussed in full detail by Imam Al-Hafiz Abu Umar bin Abdul-Barr. An-Namari, may Allah have mercy on him, in his book Al-Musamma. Al-Inbah Ala. Dhikr Usui Al-Qaba il Ar-Ruwat.

The meaning of the Prophet's words,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4664-4665]

JA dl He was a man among the Arabs.# means that he was one of the original Arabs, who were before Ibrahim, peace be upon him, and were descendants of Sam bin Nuh (Shem, the son of Noah). According to the third view mentioned above, he descended from Ibrahim, peace be upon him, but this was not a well-known view among them. And Allah knows best. But in Sahih Al-Bukhari, it is reported that the Messenger of Allah jg passed by a group of people from (the tribe of) Aslam who were practicing archery, and he said, < 11.13^ H J- "Shoot, O sons ofIsma'il, for yourfather was an archer. ""2' Aslam was a tribe of the Ansar, and the Ansar - both Aws and Khazraj - were from Ghassan, from the Arabs of Yemen from Saba , who settled in Yathrib when Saba was scattered throughout the land when Allah sent against them the flood released from the dam. A group of them also settled in Syria, and they were called Ghassan for the name of the water beside which they camped - it was said that it was in the Yemen, or that it was near Al-Mushallal, as Hassan bin Thabit, may Allah be pleased with him, said in one of his poems. The meaning of his words: Ifyou ask, then we are the community of the noble descendants, our lineage is Al-Azd At-Tabari no. 28782. Fath Al-Bari 6 :261

and our water is Ghassan. "He /jfld fen sons among the Arabs. n' 1 means that these ten were of his lineage, and that the origins of the Arab tribes of the Yemen go back to him, not that they were his sons born of his loins. There may have been two or three generations between him and some of them, or more or less, as is explained in detail in the books of genealogy.

The meaning of the words,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 4665]

\>* ' a I " Six ofwhom wait south andfour ofwhom went north . |a| is that after Allah sent against them the flood released from the dam, some of them stayed in their homeland, whilst others left to go elsewhere. TheDam ofMa arib and the Flood

The story of the dam is about the water which used to come

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4665–4684]

to them from between two mountains, combined with the floods from rainfall and their valleys. Their ancient kings built a huge, strong dam and the water reached a high level between these two mountains. Then they planted trees and got the best fruits that could ever be harvested, plentiful and beautiful. A number of the Salaf, including Qatadah, mentioned that a woman could walk beneath the trees, carrying a basket or vessel - such as is used for gathering fruit - on her head. And that the fruit would fall from the trees and fill the basket without any need for her to make the effort to pick the fruit, because it was so plentiful and ripe.¹³ This was the dam of Ma Hrib, a land between which and San a was a journey of three days. Others said that in their land there were no flies, mosquitoes or fleas, or any kind of vermin. This was because the weather was good and the people were healthy, and Allah took care of them so that they would single out and worship Him alone, as He says: At-Tabari no. 28782. AMabari no . 28782Tabari 20:376.

^Indeed there was for Saha' (Sheba) a sign in their dwelling place} Then He explains this by saying: oi*; o* ob^*-two gardens on the right and on the left;} meaning, the two sides where the mountains were, and their land was in between them. ? tK 51# 4(and it was said to them :) "Eat of the provision ofyour Lord, and be grateful to Him. A fair land and an Oft-Forgiving Lord!} means, He would forgive you if you continue to worship Him alone. 4But they turned away,} means, from worshipping Allah alone and from giving thanks to Him for the blessings that He had bestowed upon them, and they started to worship the sun instead of Allah, as the hoopoe told Sulayman, peace be upon him: ;jr- at 4i pi (*-r "f- OfJJ Oj-> <>* Lfj-U-j ^ ^ *> 4 I have come to you from Saba' (Sheba) with true news. I found a woman ruling over them, she has been given all things, and she has a great throne. I found her and her people worshipping the sun instead of Allah, and Shaytan has made their deeds fair seeming to them, and has barred themfrom the way, so they have no guidance. } (27:22-24) iso We sent against them flood releasedfrom the dam,} Some, including Ibn Abbas, Wahb bin Munabbih, Qatadah

and Ad-Dahhak said that when Allah wanted to punish them by sending the flood upon them, he sent beasts from the earth to the dam, large rats, which made a hole in it. ' Wahb bin Munabbih said, They found it written in their Scriptures that the dam would be destroyed because of these large rats. So they brought cats for a while, but when the decree came to pass, the rats overran the cats and went into the dam, making a hole in it, and it collapsed. '2 ' Qatadah and others said, The large rat is the desert rat. They gnawed at the bottom of the dam until it became weak, then the time of the floods came and the waters hit the structure and it collapsed. The waters rushed through the bottom of the valley and destroyed everything in their path - buildings, trees, etc. '3' As the water drained from the trees that

were on the mountains, to the right and the left, those trees dried up and were destroyed. Those beautiful, fruit-bearing trees were replaced with something altogether different, as Allah says: *scgi ^and We converted their two gardens into gardens producing bitter badfruit (ukul khamt),* Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Ikiimah, Ata Al-Khurasani, Qatadah and As-Suddi said, It refers to Arak (Zingiber officinale) and bitter bad fruit. *14' iand Athl,* Al- Awfi and Ibn Abbas said that this means tamarisk. Others said that it means a tree that resembles a tamarisk, and it was said that it was the gum acacia or mimosa. And Allah knows best. *iand somefew lote trees.* Because the lote trees were the best of the trees with which the garden was replaced, there were only a few ofthem. *I1 ' At-Tabari 20:378, 380.Tabari 20:381.Tabari 20:381. (4) At-Tabari 20 : 382 , 383*

80 Tafsir ton Kathir iand some few lote trees.\$ This is what happened to those two gardens after they had been so fruitful and productive, offering beautiful scenes, deep shade and flowing rivers: they were replaced with thorny trees, tamarisks and lote trees with huge thorns and little fruit. This was because of their disbelief and their sin of associating others with Allah, and because they denied the truth and turned towards falsehood. Allah said: *iLike this We requited them because they were ungrateful disbelievers. And never do We requite in such a way except those who are ungrateful. meaning, *We punished them for their disbelief. Mujahid said, He does not punish anyone except the disbelievers. Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, Allah the Almighty has spoken the truth: no one will be punished in a manner that befits the sin except the ungrateful disbelievers. ?A i' 4' S', " iff * ++ V iaO ipse Sc/. ao p &sX&'Z 418. And We placed, between them and the towns which We had blessed, towns easy to be seen, and We made the stages (of journey) between them easy (saying) : Travel in them safely both by night and day. "4 419. But they said: "Our Lord! Make the stages between our journey longer," and they wronged themselves; so We made than as tales (in the land), and We dispersed them all totally. Verily, in this are indeed signs for every steadfast, grateful (person).} The Trade ofSaba* and Their Destruction Allah tells us about the blessings which the people of Saba enjoyed, and the luxuries and plentiful provision which was m Al-Baghawi 3:555.*

83Sarah 34. Saba (20 - 21) (Part-22) Laylah,*** There is a corroborating report in the Two Sahihs, where a Hadith narrated by Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, says: *pd jj id Ij-a- VI tiju ^Jia i V VI JpV Jji plj Ip p tip. oUaf * ii& "How amazing is the affair of the believer! Allah does not decree anything for him blit it is good for him. If something good happens to him, he gives thanks, and that is good far him; if something bad happens to him, he bears it with patience, and that is good far him. This is not far anyone except the believeryW It was reported that Qatadah said: p,pv iVerily, in this are indeed signs far every steadfast, gratefal.} It was Mutarrif who used to say: How blessed is the grateful, patient servant. If he is given something, he gives thanks, and if he is tested, he bears it with patience. *^ yd ti^i A p jli yji pU pL jJLi xi}j} ^ ^ pi A " 420. And indeed Iblis did prove true his thought about them, and theyfallowed him, all except a group of true believers.} 422. And he had no authority over them, - except that We might test him who believes in the Hereafter, from him who is in doubt about it. And your Lord is Watchful over everything.} How Iblis' thought about the DisbelieverprovedTrue Having mentioned Saba and how they followed their desires, and the Shaytan, Allah tells us about their counterparts *** An-Nasal in Al-Kubrd 6 :263 Al-Bari 10:107. * Muslim 4:1992.*

among those who follow Iblis and their own desires, and who go against wisdom and true guidance. Allah says: jli j%) 4And indeed Iblis did prove true his thought about them,) Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, and others said that this Ayah is like the Ayah where Allah tells us about how Iblis refused to prostrate to Adam, peace be upon him, then said: 4*' jy. ciiA oJ ' & jii lift 4See this one whom You have honored above me, if You give me respite to the Day of Resurrection, I will surely seize and mislead his offspring all but a few!) (17:62) ^ rrr^' ry*' & < jr) 4Then I will come to them from before them and behind them, from their right and from their left, and You will not find most of them as thankful ones.) (7:17) And there are many Ayat which refer to this matter. Jt |*^lc /J 0^=" 4And he (Iblis) had no authority over them,) Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him said, This means, he had no proof. ^ J* O+t j & j> cy (except that We might test him wlv believes in the Hereafter, from him who is in doubt about it.) means, We gave him power over them only to show who believes in the Hereafter and that it will come to pass. The people will be brought to account and rewarded or punished accordingly, so that he will worship his Lord properly in this world - and to distinguish these believers from those who are in doubt about the Hereafter. At-Tabari 20 :392

tCA & 4And your Lord is a Watchful over everything.} means, despite His watching, those who follow Iblis go astray, but by His watching and care, the believers who follow the Messengers are saved. oj" oj fAj i jj'i Jli j oy&t!Uj y 4ill ii fc \$ % ^^ y; ^ & a Ia jli 'it. ijlli j-Vj* j pi jij tfu if:#' ill. Say: "Call upon those whom you assert besides Allah, they possess not even the weight of a speck of dust, either in the heavens or on the earth, nor have they any share in either, nor there is for Him any supporter from among them."} }23 . Intercession with Him profits not except for him whom He permits. So much so that when fear is banished from their hearts, they say: "What is it that your Lord has said?" They say the truth. And He is the Most High, the Most Great.} The Helplessness of the gods of the Idolators Here Allah states clearly that He is the One and Only God, the Self-Sufficient Master, Who has no peer or partner; He is independent in His command and there is no one who can

4 jili cJ Jju V *i^y* rJ^ ^ \$f} 4\$'Sfc5 4And there are many angels in the heavens, whose intercession will avail nothing except after Allah has given leave to whom He wills and is pleased with.} (53:26) y/ > . a (**j p. iand they cannot intercede except to him with whom He is pleased. And they stand in awe of him} (21:28). It was reported in the Two Sahih through more than one chain of narration that the Messenger of Allah who is the leader of the sons of Adam and the greatest intercessor before Allah, will go to stand in Al-Maqam Al-Mahmud (the praised position) to intercede for all of mankind when their Lord comes to pass judgement upon them. He said: V)i l" (jif-Jj PU i 4U * jLU jJ.\ kLjo (j-'j t j Jiilj ^ijl : JllJ ii)VI Then I will prostrate to Allah, may He be exalted, and He will leave me (in that position), as long as Allah wills, and He will inspire me to speak words of praise which I cannot mention now. Then it will be said, "O Muhammad, raise your head. Speak, you will be heard; ask, you will be given; intercede, your intercession will be accepted..."(1 ' & Ji !#pj ISC U gi ui&} iSo much so that when fear is banished from their hearts, they say: "What is it that your Lord has said?" They say the truth.} This also refers to the great degree of His might and power. When He speaks words of revelation, the inhabitants of the heavens hear what He says, and they tremble with fear (of Allah) so much that they swoon. This was the view of Ibn Mas'ud, may Allah be pleased with him, Masruq and others.12' Fath Al-Bari 8 :248 , Muslim 1 :185 Al-Tabari 20:396.

88 Tafstr Ibn Kathir / m .w / /"> / J/ V u* ' & } iSo much so that when fear is banished from their hearts,} means, when the fear leaves their hearts. Ibn Abbas, Ibn Umar, Abu Abdur-Rahman As-Sulami, Ash-Sha'bi, Ibrahim An-Nakha i, Ad-Dhahhak, Al-Hasan and Qatadah said concerning the Ayah, ^ ^ g 4 4So much so that when fear is banished from their hearts, they say: "Wltat is it that your Lord has said? They say the truth.} When the fear is lifted from their hearts. When this happens, some of them say to others, What did your Lord say? Those (angels) who are carrying the Throne tell those who are next to them, then they in turn pass it on to those who are next to them, and so on, until the news reaches the inhabitants of the lowest heaven. Allah says, iThey say the truth.} meaning, they report what He said, without adding or taking away anything. if -p' 4And He is the Most High, the Most Great.} In his Tafstr of this Ayah in his Sahth,

When Allah decrees a matter in heaven, the angels beat their xwings in submission to His Words, making a sound like a chain striking a smooth rock. When the fear is banished from their hearts, they say, "Wlmt is it that your Lord has said? They say the truth, and He is the Most High, the Most Great. Then the one who is listening out hears that, and those who are listening out are standing one above the other" - Sufyan [one of the narrators] demonstrated with his hand, holding it vertically with the fingers outspread. "So he hears what is said and passes it on to the one below him, and that one passes it to the one ivho is beloiv him, and so on until it reaches the lips of the soothsayer or fortune-teller. Maybe a meteor will hit him before he can pass anything on, or maybe he will pass it on before he is hit. He tells a hundred lies alongside it, but it toill be said, "Did he not tell us that on such and such a day, such and such would happen? So they believe him because of the one thing which zuas heardfrom heavenj This was recorded by

90 Tafstr Ibn KathTr partners. Nay! But He is Allah, the Almighty, the All-Wise."} Allah has no partner in anythingwhatsoever Allah tells us that He is unique in His power of creation and His giving of provision, and that He is unique in His divinity also. As they used to admit that no one in heaven or on earth except Allah gave them provision, i.e., by sending down water and causing crops to grow, so they should also realize that there is no god worthy of worship besides Him. iAnd verily, (either) we or you are rightly guided or in plain error.} One of the two sides must be speaking falsehood, and one must be telling the truth. There is no way that you and we could both be following true guidance, or could both be misguided. Only one of us can be correct, and we have produced the proof of Tawhid which indicates that your Shirk must be false. Allah says: ^ j' tyj} iAnd verily, (either) we or you are rightly guided or in plain error.} Qatadah said, The Companions of Muhammad jg said this to the idolators: By Allah, we and you cannot be following the same thing, only one of us can be truly guided. Ikrimah and Ziyad bin Abi Maryam said, It means: we are rightly guided and you are in plain error. iSay : You will not be asked about our sins, nor shall we be asked ofwhat you do."} This indicates disowning them, saying, you do not belong to us and we do not belong to you, because we call people to Allah, to believe that He is the Only God and to worship Him alone. If you respond, then you will belong to us and we toTabari 20:401.Tabari 20:401.

you, but ifyou reject our call, then we have nothing to do with you and you have nothing to do with us. This is like the Ayat 14 %& % Sj% iil fiz p; 4 jg iijjir 4And // they deny you, say: For me are my deeds andfor you are your deeds! You are innocent of what 1 do, and 1 am innocent ofwhat you do!"} (10:41)

iyj\$ Z Sjtit .3 Vj 1TJ^JLt 6 iic <(Say; "O disbelievers! I worship not that which you worship, Nor will you worship that which I worship. And I shall not worship that which you are worshipping. Nor will you worship that which I worship. To you be your religion, and to me my religion.") (104:1-6). iSay: "Our Lord will assemble us all together..."} means, on the Day of Resurrection, He will bring all of creation together in one arena, then He will judge between us with truth, i.e., with justice. Each person will be rewarded or punished according to his deeds; if they are good, then his end will be good, and if they are bad, then his end will be bad. On that Day they will know who has attained victory, glory and eternal happiness, as Allah says: j Z4J ijUis-j i^l. 'fyj} tfUJj i \j& Ifjii UjJ lr~ iAnd on the Day when the Hour will be established - that Day shall (all men) be separated. Then as far those who believed and did righteous good deeds, such shall be honored and made to enjoy luxurious life (forever) in a Carden ofDelight. And asfar those wlv disbelieved and denied Our Ayat, and the meeting of the Hereafter, such shall be brought forth to the torment.} (30:14-16).

Allah says: V& tr3' -&> iAnd He is the Just Judge, the All-Knower of the true state of affairs .} iSay: "Show me those whom you have joined with Him as partners..."} means, show me those gods whom you made as rivals and equals to Allah. t 0} }Nay} means, He has no peer, rival, partner or equal. Allah says: \$But He is Allah,} meaning, the One and Only God Who has no partner. ithe Almighty, the All-Wise.} means, the Owner of might with which He subjugates and controls all things, the One Who is Wise in all His Words and deeds. Laws and decrees. Blessed and exalted and sanctified be He far above all that they say. And Allah knows best. f o;0' Jk=^ \ {t o-M. &) tj} ait V fy_ iCS, > .: -=" o[428. And We have not sent you except as a giver of glad tidings and a wamer to all mankind, and most of men know not.} 429 . And they say: "When is this promise if you are truthful?"} 430 . Say: "The appointment to you is for a Day, which you cannot put backfor an hour nor putforward."} The Prophet \$gg was sent to all ofMankind Allah says to His servant and Messenger Muhammad s= : 4**i4> UA. ofA <&=> vj S tj}

4And We have not sent you except as a giver of glad tidings and a wamer to all mankind, i.e., to all of creation among those who are accountable for their deeds. This is like the Ayah 4^ ii; ji" 4Say: "O mankind! Verily, I am sent to you all as the Messenger ofAllah."} (7:158) i&i \$> j> 4' iBlessed be He Who sent down the Criterion to His servant that he may be a wamer to the all creatures.} (25:1) 4a giver of glad tidings and a wamer} means, to bring the glad tidings of Paradise to those who obey you and to warn of the fire of Hell to those who disobey you. This is like the Ayah 4and most ofmen know not.} 4 -if. 3b Z'f} 4And most of mankind will not believe even if you desire it eagerly.} (12:103) 4 cr \$ j } 4And ifyou obey most of those on the earth, they will mislead youfar awayfrom Allah's path} (6:16). Muhammad bin Ka*b said concerning the Ayah: 4oM iSSbm Zj} 4And We have not sent you except to all mankind} meaning, to all the people. Qatadah said concerning this Ayah, Allah, may He be exalted, sent Muhammad jg to both the Arabs and the non-Arabs, so the most honored of them with Allah is the one who is most obedient to Allah. m At-Tabari 20:405.

Saba (28 - 30) (Part-22) Jj trr mump %, / ^ # ^ ^ * / / (v- kJy%j*r_>^~^ ? s< * ^ . " - "/ * l/VO . '/ i I t " t 5j(JJ l 3? cgjjj t2ii! \$M ,1)jiiiiiJsflcJ'G^b -^'- .rx'^^T''''^s" ^ "" * t' JLL-jjUj^ o^L^"ylSl* a^O^~^Jjb IjjScJjjJjaij ".L7J(j-J '_k_jj(Jjjji j oi^:v ^ (>*^t> 5#vCttf, r" ,/ * >*^ ' > ' . :-,r-7 >~* - '<, " . '\{>"/:'> ' > ,j - >; ;< IAJ Jiy'_jA_)*^Jd# Allah says: iThose who believe not therein seek to hasten it, while

those who believe are fearful of it, and know that it is the very truth...} (42:18) Then Allah says: M X* & & C Z * > " " iSay : "The appointment to you is for a Day, in which you cannot for an hour move back nor forward."} meaning, you have an appointed time which is fixed and cannot be changed or altered. When it comes, you will not be able to put it back or bring it forward, as li iVerily, the term of Allah when it comes, cannot be delayed} (71:4). % "i ot fj, jf.ijjSZ J~X 'Jj }And We delay it only Jbr a term (already) fixed. On the Day when it comes, no person shall speak except by His leave. Some among them will be wretched and (others) blessed.} (11:104- 105).

jy-;--1 Jy-i " <^ : q/ x~Ji uk %&.' 1\$ jti &5 ft % \ZS& vA ijjiij \y* .'n' .1 JIS) J? SA*r ^ -*j*> !&S Kul / i j^J ii Ji b l ii ^ i] &3 kk ^ j V< iii^~j 4ask ft ' L'CSif 4A-e 432. And those who disbelieve say: "We believe not in this Qur'an nor in that which was before it." But if you could see when the wrongdoers are made to stand before their Lord, how they will cast the (blaming) word one to another! Those who were deemed weak will say to those who were arrogant: "Had it not been for you, we should certainly have been believers!"} 432. And those who were arrogant will say to those who were deemed weak: "Did we keep you back from guidance after it had come to you? Nay, but you were criminals."} 433. Those who were deemed weak will say to those who were arrogant: "Nay, but it was your plotting by night and day, when you ordered us to disbelieve in Allah and set up rivals to Him!" And each of them (parties) will conceal their own regrets, what they behold the torment. And We shall put iron collars round the necks of those who disbelieved. Are they requited aught except what they used to do?}

How the Disbelievers have agreed in this World to deny

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4684-4697]

the Truth, and how They will dispute with One Another on the Day of Resurrection Allah tells us about the excessive wrongdoing and stubbornness of the disbelievers, and their insistence on not believing in the Holy Qur'an and what it tells them about the Resurrection. Allah says: 4*Jj *>. Vj J lifoS' jlij4 4And those who disbelieve say: "We believe not in this Qur'an nor in that which was before it."} Allah threatens them and warns them of the humiliating

Saba (31 - 33) (Part-22) position they will be in before Him, arguing and disputing with one another: Jy-> Jji' 4hmv they will cast the (blaming) word one to another! Those who were deemed weak} this refers to the followers - 4to those who were arrogant} - this refers to the leaders and masters - 44s &Had it not been for you, we should certainly have been believers!} meaning, if you had not stopped us, we would have followed the Messengers and believed in what they brought. Their leaders and masters, those who were arrogant, will say to them: i; j. &} 4Did we keep you back from guidance after it had come to you?} meaning, we did nothing more to you than to call you, and you followed us without any evidence or proof, and you went against the evidence and proof which the Messengers brought because of your own desires; it was your own choice. They will say: ^ S. jjL^Lir Sfif jiiij 'fi ...Nay, but you were criminals." Those who were deemed weak will say to those who were arrogant: "Nay, but it was your plotting by night and day..."} meaning, you used to plot against us night and day, tempting us with promises and false hopes, and telling us that we were truly guided and that we were following something, but all of that was falsehood and manifest lies. Qatadah and Ibn Zayd said:

4Nay, but it was your plotting by night and day, means, You plotted by night and day. ,1, Malik narrated something similar from Zayd bin Aslam.¹² iY/J a ^ iwhen you ordered us to disbelieve in Allah and set up rivals to Him!} means, to set up gods as equal to Him, and you created doubts and confusion in our minds, and you fabricated far- fetched ideas with which to lead us astray. 4And each of them (parties) will conceal their own regrets, when they behold the torment.} means, both the leaders and the followers will feel regret for what they did previously. 4}if& cjif -j jiS/i [&rj} 4And We shall put iron collars round the necks of those who disbelieved.} This is a chain which will tie their hands to their necks. ix -n&& &} 4Are they requited aught except what they used to do?} means, they will be punished according to their deeds: the leaders will be punished according to what they did, and the followers will be punished according to what they did. 4X& 4He will say: "For each one there is double (torment), but you know not."} (7:38). Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said, The Messenger of Allah said: ip* ", ' - j*Jl At-Tabari 20:408.Tabari 20:408.

uWhen the people of Hell are driven towards it, it will meet them with its flames, then the Fire will bum theirfaces and the flesh will all fall to their hamstrings .n jjllij jS if IfijitA' Jli frlr* ^ jjij illJ JJ ilf; dj j i j* Cj 'oJjl) _A^=" 4lM ? Jv \$ vj^ Uj :*;\$: v^ &U > ?- . ("-*> l*" > ilvil' 'fr ijliJjii UX"o J <> ! ** f'lf ^ >*" - , ! >*" > <- 1 * S. 'S . ****' O+i 133/' ">" tl)^ .yT^vilL/va^ <_ \$ o>* /> / > . > -> < . :.t t^ y' * .*/ X jy ' /A"-^s j4* of ->~4Aj ' vj fi ** '-? o^ *W 434. And We did not send a wamer to a toivnship but those who were given the worldly wealth and luxuries among than said: "We believe not in what you have been salt with."} 435. And they say : "We are more in wealth and in children, and we are not going to be punished."} 436. Say: "Verily , my Lord expands the provision to whom He wills and restricts, but most men know not. } 437. And it is not your wealth, nor your children that bring you nearer to Us, but only he who believes, and does righteous deeds; as for such, there will be multiple rewards for what they did, and they will reside in the high dwellings (Paradise) in peace and security.} 435. And those who strive against Our Ayat, to frustrate them, they will be brought to the torment.} 439. Say: "Truly, my Lord expands the provision for whom He wills of His servants, and (also) restricts (it) for him, and whatsoever you spend of anything, He will replace it. And He is the Best ofproviders."} HowThoseWho lived a Life ofLuxury disbelieved in the Messengers and were misledby Their pursuit ofWealth and Children Allah is consoling His Prophet jg and commanding him to I 1 * Hilyat Al-Awliya' 4:363, where Abu Nu'aym indicates that it is probably Mawquf.

200 Tafslr Ibn Kathir follow the example of the Messengers that came before him. He tells him that no Prophet was ever sent to a township but those among its people who lived a life of luxury disbelieved in him, and the weaker people of the town followed him. The people of Nuh, peace be upon him, said to him: /< if ' " p" V ^ cef} iShall we believe in you, when the weakest (of the people) follow you?} (26:110) 4nor do we see any follow you but the meanest among us and they (too) followed you without thinking} (1 1:27). The leaders among the people of Salih said: q Qg Iff Js i fa itk 4to those who were counted weak - to such ofthem as believed "Know you that Salili is one sent from his Lord." They said : "We indeed believe in that with which he has been sent." Those who were arrogant said: "Verily, we disbelieve in that which you believe in."} (7:75-76). And Allah said: 'if is ^ 'if i&a 5 diUk^j} iThus We have tried some of them with others, that they might say: "Is it these (poor believers) that Allah has favored from among us?" Does not Allah know best those who are gratefil?} (6:53), 4^+r* iir^= . fr 4 ii&'&j} 4And thus We have set up in every town great ones of its wicked people to plot therein}

(6:123), and t>-j IfJ J liijl ljl <(And when We decide to destroy a town (population), We (first) send a definite order to those among them who lead a life

of luxury. Then, they transgress therein, and thus the Word (of torment) is justified against it (them). Then We destroy it with complete destruction} (17:16). And Allah says here: 4.J& Crt Mr^^ iAnd We did not send a wamer to a township} meaning a Prophet or a Messenger, /- / ><*> /< \ Jtt^ ibut those who were given the worldly wealth and luxuries among them} means, those who enjoyed a life of riches and luxury, and positions of leadership. Qatadah said, They are their tyrants, chiefs and leaders in evil. -if iL &{ } iWe believe not in the (Message) with which you have been sent.} means, we do not believe in it and we will not follow it. Allah tells us that those who enjoyed a life of luxury and who disbelieved the Messengers said: iAnd they say: "We are more in wealth and in children, and we are not going to be punished."} meaning, they were proud of their great wealth and great numbers of children, and they believed that this was a sign that Allah loved them and cared for them, and that if He gave them this in this world, He would not punish them in the Hereafter. This was too far-fetched. Allah says: \ / c r vff . A * w y.*"< iDo they think that in wealth and children with which We enlarge them? We hasten unto them with good things. Nay, but Urey perceive not.} (23:55-56) [i] At-Tabari 20 :409

dr JJ CjJI si-' 4 'rj ^ -V/ Q Vj 'P'P &, let not their wealth nor their children amaze you ; in reality Allah's plan is to punish them with these things in the life of this world, and that their souls shall depart while they are disbelievers.} (9:55), and A n- jvj VU /<! oili- yj iLeave Me Alone (to deal) with whom I created lonely. And then granted him resources in abundance. And children to be by his side. And made life smooth and comfortable for him. After all that he desires that I should give more. Nay! Verily, he has been opposing Our Aydt. I shall oblige him to face a severe torment!} (74:11-17) And Allah has told us about the story of the owner of those two gardens, that he had wealth and crops and children, but that could not help him at all when all of that was taken from him in this world, before he reached the Hereafter. Allah says here: 4 -kLy. 4j 5) iSay: Verily , my Lord expands the provision to whom He wills and restricts..."} meaning, He gives wealth to those whom He loves and those whom He does not love, and He makes poor whom He wills and makes rich whom He wills. He has complete wisdom and clear proof, 1 jS\ &{ } ibut most men know not.} Then Allah says: iAnd it is not your xoealth, nor your children that bring you nearer to Us,} meaning, these things are not a sign that We love you or care

104 Tafslr Ibn Kathir &i'* c5 ojZi iAnd those who strive against Our Ayat, to frustrate them,} means, those who try to block people from the path of Allah and from following His Messengers and believing in His signs, ithey will be brought to the torment.} means, they will all be punished for their deeds, each one accordingly. \$ cx 52 ill X iSay: Truly, my Lord expands the provision for whom He wills ofHis servants, and (also) restricts (it)for him..."} means, according to His wisdom, He gives a lot of provision to one, and gives very little to another. He has great wisdom in doing so, which cannot be comprehended by anyone but Him. This is like the Ayah iSee how Wefavor one above another, and verily, the Hereafter will be greater in degrees and greater infavor.} (17:21). This means that just as there are differences between them in this world - where one may be poor and in straitened circumstances while another is rich and enjoys a life of plenty - so they will be in the Hereafter. There one will reside in apartments in the highest levels of Paradise, whilst another will be in the lowest levels

of Hell. As the Prophet [^] said, describing the best of people in this world: "W Lii j UU5 3jjj pt-l 4 He truly succeeds who becomes

Surah 34, Saba (40 - 42) (Part-22) trr r. > >>>- # i/ "y / *> A>" "*" '/' >> 5^"J) ij^i^oySLJSjciAi^ciUjV]\ >. ?' . >?~ ,,"Z" ? t# vMITV *,* " -M" 1JA7 }'AJbO;|V* *-w^ '~.,jT' r' ' .1? \$J&'i&sk V ,/ /f >^, /"/^ > ^^> ^ / "*" ' { > t- j^..n^~1'^ (,4 1 j J.^ S J,V0 >"*a /lt\.^ *j2j mmmx,means, whatever you spend in the ways that He has commanded you and permitted you, He will compensate you for it in this world by giving you something else instead, and in the Hereafter by giving you reward. It was reported that the Prophet said: I i_jjjuij -Uj-i}A "i)l (J^b "itif- "A//a/i says: "Spend, I will spend on you." In another Hadlth it is reported that every morning, two angels come, and one says, O Allah, bring destruction upon the one who withholds (does not spend). The other one says, O Allah, give compensation to the one who spends. And the Messenger of Allah jg said: W*i) ^>]|&^ Vj cJ% jiib "Spend, O Bilal, and do not fear that the One Who is on the Throne will withlwdfrom you.i A Ju^i \) \} \Z=" % \$ \ JIU; 'J fjji j^r Cifx.u jylT j? LJ> 4 1 IVj>- jA j!f jDl vUc jjijj ojji Jyuj I fja (1 * Muslim 1 : 700. At-Tabarani 10:191.

440. And (remember) the Day when He will gather them all together, then He will say to the angels : Was it you that these people used to worship?"} 441 . They (the angels) will say : "Glorified be You! You are our Protector instead of them. Nay, but they used to worship the Jinn; most ofthem were believers in them."} 442. So Today, none of you can profit or harm one another. And We shall say to those who did wrong : "Taste the torment of the Fire which you used to deny."} TheAngels willdisown TheirWorshippers on theDay of Resurrection Allah tells us that on the Day of Resurrection, He will rebuke the idolators before all of creation. He will ask the angels whom the idolators used to worship, claiming that their idols were in the form of these angels and that they could bring them nearer to Allah. He will ask the angels: s*.%mi it you that these people used to worship?} meaning, did you command them to worship you? Allah says in Surat Al-Furqarc 4Was it you who misled these My servants or did they (themselves) strayfrom the (right) path?} (25:17). And He will say to Isa, peace be upon him: Jji) J OjKj UA.**. /. Jta jjj J* (j\ djjicf 'Jliu ci" d*} 4Did you say unto men : "Worship me and my mother as two gods besides Allah?,' He will say: "Glory be to You! It was not for me to say what I had no right (to say)."} (5:116). Similarly, the angels will say: 4Glorified be You!} meaning, exalted and sanctified be You above the notion that there could be any god besides You.

4You are our Protector instead of them.) means, *we are Your servants and we disown these people before You. J>) 4Nay, but they used to worship the jinn;) meaning, the Shayatin, because they are the ones who made idol worship attractive to them and who misguided them. imost ofthem were believers in them This is like the Ayah: iThey invoke nothing but females besides Him, and they invoke nothing but Shaytan, a persistent rebel! Allah cursed him (4:117-118). Allah says: Y*& Y {\$) 4So Today, none ofyou can profit or harm one another. means, none of those idols and rivals whom you hoped would benefit you, will be of any avail to you, those whom you worshipped in the hope that they would help you at times of stress and calamity. Today they will have no power either to benefit you or to harm you. ah &*>) 4And We shall say to those who did wrong:) - meaning the idolaters - jiif i 4"Taste the torment of the Fire which you used to deny.") meaning, this will be said to them by way of rebuke. Y't Til c |# &:\$\$ %)

Saba (43 - 45) fPart-22) meaning, Allah did not reveal any Book to the Arabs before the Qur'an, and He did not send any Prophet to them before Muhammad. They used to wish for that and say, if only a Warner comes to us or a Book is revealed to us, we would be more guided than others, but when Allah blessed them with that, they disbelieved him and stubbornly rejected him. Then Allah says: 'And those before them denied;' meaning, other nations. 'And these have not received even a tenth of what We had granted to those (of old);' Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, Of the power of this world. 111 This was also the view of Qatadah, As-Suddi and Ibn Zayd. 2) This is like the Ayat. 'And We had firmly established them with that wherewith We have not established you! And We had assigned them the hearing, seeing, and hearts; but their hearing, seeing, and their hearts availed them nothing since they used to deny the Ayat of Allah, and they were completely encircled by that which they used to mock at!' (46:26) 'Have they not traveled through the earth and seen what was

the end of those before than? They were more in number than

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4697-4701]

them and mightier in strength} (40:82). but that did not protect them from the punishment of Allah, Jabari 20:416. Tabari 20:416, 417.

no Tafsir Ibn Kathir and Allah destroyed them because they denied His Messengers. Allah says: 'And they denied My Messengers. Then how (terrible) was My denial!' meaning, how severe was My wrath and how great was My avenging of My Messengers. & [kscei i'SKf-t) (ls- y^ i-'i (jj? VJ . Say: 'I exhort you to one (thing) only, that you stand up for Allah's sake in pairs and singly, and reflect, there is no madness in your companion. He is only a Warner to you in face of a severe torment. } Refutation of Their Accusation that the Prophet was Insane Allah says: Say, O Muhammad, to these disbelievers who claim that you are crazy, 'I am only telling you to one (thing) only, that you stand up for Allah's sake in pairs and singly, and reflect, there is no madness in your companion. } meaning, stand sincerely before Allah, without being influenced by your own desires or tribal feelings, and ask one another, is Muhammad crazy? Advise one another, and reflect } means, let each person look within himself concerning the matter of Muhammad, and ask other people about him if he is still confused, then let him think about the matter. Allah says:

Ill Surah 34. Saba (46) (Part-22) 'that you stand up for Allah's sake in pairs and singly, and reflect, there is no madness in your companion. } This meaning was stated by Mujahid, Muhammad bin Ka'b, As-Suddi, Qatadah and others. ' This is what is meant by the Ayah. 'He is only a Warner to you in face of a severe torment. }

112 Tafstr Ibn Kathir J mm > * > . trt */ /> "J 0? -^rL? Cp V*/^ g* ^(/jLill^ ^U-"U i^IUj^ <_* . JiJ^a ^Z ^ JL-"ol -S f ' S&i ' v"*qjy/^iA*J^i>(S^J -Uj?o&^"Cj*jv ^iS^CK4"t^S!i2iti4rt32l 02^&0\$ss t^\$ji&i V>>/ i^*"" ^ * ,^ >|i"f /^I3^>|> 4JA 4UiC". &" OrfXiJ Tc^vj/ r- / 1 JL 447. Say: 'Whatever wage I might have asked of you is yours. My wage is from Allah only, and He is a Witness over all things.' } 448. Say: 'Verily, my Lord sends down the truth, the All-Knower of the Unseen.' } 449. Say: 'The truth has come, and the falsehood can neither create anything nor resurrect. } 450. Say: 'If (even) I go astray, I shall

stray only to my own loss. But if I remain guided, it is because of the Revelation of my Lord to me. Truly, He is All-Hearer, Ever Near."} I do not ask for any Reward for conveying the Message Allah commands His Messenger to say to the idolaters: ip C} 4Whatever wage I might have asked of you is yours.} meaning, I do not want anything for conveying the Message of Allah to you, advising you and telling you to worship Allah. 4My wage is from Allah only,} means, rather I will seek the reward for that with Allah.

and He is a Witness over all things .} means, He knows all things, and He knows everything about me and the manner in which I am conveying the Message to you, and He knows all about you. 4Sm/: Verily, my Lord sends down the truth, the All-Knower of the Unseen."} This is like the Ayah: \$Zi. & -ip & qIP iHe sends the Revelation by His command to any of His servants He zoills} (40:15). meaning, He sends the angel to whomsoever He wills of His servants among the people on earth, and He is the All-Knower of the Unseen; nothing whatsoever is hidden from Him in the heavens or on earth. 4'*: ; ir. 4Say: "The truth has come, and the falsehood can neither create anything nor resurrect."} means, truth and the great Law have come from Allah, and falsehood has gone and has perished and vanished. This is like the Ayah: }Nay, We fling the truth against the falsehood, so it destroys it, and behold, it is vanished} (21:18). When the Messenger of Allah jg entered Al-Masjid Al-Haram on

the day of the conquest of Makkah, and found those idols

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4701–4706]

standing around the Ka'bah, he started to hit the idols with his bow, reciting, iif of k SS&K }And say: "The truth has come and the falsehood has vanished. Surely, the falsehood is ever bound to vanish."} (17:81), and:

114 Tafsir Ibrt Kathlr ^Suy: The truth has come, and the falsehood can neither create anything nor resurrect."} This was recorded by

451. And if you could but see, when they will be terrified with no escape, and they will be seized from a near place 452. And they will say: We do believe (now); but how could they receive (Tanawush) from a place so far off.} 453. Indeed they did disbelieve before (in this world), and they (used to) conjecture about the Unseen, from a far place. 454. And a barrier will be set between them and that which they desire, as was done in the past with the people of their kind. Verily, they have been in grave doubt.} Here Allah says: if only you could see, O Muhammad, when these deniers are terrified on the Day of Resurrection, and they have no way of escape and nowhere to run to and no refuge. and they will be seized from a near place.} means, they will not even be given the slightest chance of escape, but they will be seized from the first instant. Al-Hasan Al-Basri said: When they come forth from their graves. iAnd they will say: "We do believe (now);"} means, on the Day of Resurrection, they will say, *we believe in Allah and His angels, Books and Messengers. This is like the Ayah: iAnd if you only could see when the criminals shall hang their heads before their Lord (saying) : "Our Lord! We have now seen and heard, so send us back that we will do righteous good deeds. Verily, we now believe with certainty."} (32:12) Allah says: ibut how could they receive from a place so far off?} Af-Tabari 20:423.

Saba (51 - 54) (Part-22) iwe do not think it but as a conjecture, and we have no firm convincing belief. (45:32). Qatadah and Mujahid said, Their belief that there would be no resurrection, no Paradise and no Hell was based on mere conjecture. ^And a barrier will be set between them and that which they desire, Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Ad-Dahhak and others, This means faith. '2 ' As-Suddi said: iAnd a barrier will be set between them and that which they desire,} means Repentance. '3 ' This was also the view of Ibn Jarir, may Allah have mercy on him. Mujahid said: iAnd a barrier will be set between them and that which they desire,} means, This world and its wealth, luxuries and people. 14' Something similar was narrated from Ibn Umar, Ibn Abbas and Ar-Rabl bin Anas, may Allah be pleased with him. It is also the opinion of Al-Bukhari and the Group. The correct view is that there is no contradiction between the two views, for a barrier will be set between them and what they desire in this world, and what they seek in the Hereafter will be denied from them. 4 J*" (S } 4as was done in the past with the people of their kind.} means, as happened to the nations of the past who disbelieved in the Messengers; when the punishment of Allah came upon At-Tabari 20:429. |2' At-Tabari 20:430. 13' Ad-DurrAl-Manthur6 :7 15Tabari 20:431.

them, they wished that they had believed, but this was not accepted from them. " ^ f-brj jit li*t* IjJli CX Ij A'vi tj oJi- j5 ,j1f iii C,t ijtj Q 4So, to/ien they saw Our punishment, they said: 'We believe in Allah Alone and reject (all) that we used to associate with Him as (His) partners. "Then their faith could not avail them when they saw Our punishment. (Like) this has been the way of Allah in dealing with His servants. And there the disbelievers lost utterly. (40:84-85). 4Verily, they have been in grave doubt. means, in this world they had doubts, so their faith will not be accepted from them when they behold the punishment with their own eyes. Qatadah said, Beware of doubt. For whoever dies doubting, will be raised doubting; and whoever dies believing, with certainty will be raised believingwith certainty.

Surah 35: Fatir

PDF pages 4707–4753

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 4707]

Opening The TafslrofSurah Fatir (Chapter - 35)

Which was revealed inMakkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4707–4752]

i-sgflP In the Name ofAllah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. 42 . A// praise is due to Allah, Fatir of the heavens and the earth, Who made the angels messengers with wings, two or three or four. He increases in creation what He wills. Verily, Allah is Able to do all things.) The Power ofAllah Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, I did not know what Fatir As-Samawati wal-Ard meant until two bedouins came to me disputing over a well. One of them said to his companion, Ana Fatartuha, meaning, 1 started it. 111 Ibn AbbSs, may Allah be pleased with him, also said, 0^ iFatir of the heavens and the earth,) means, The Originator of the heavens and the earth. 121 Ad- Dahhak said, Every time the phrase Fatir As-Samaw&ti wal- Ard. is used in the Qur an, it means the Creator of the heavens and the earth. iWho made the angels messengers) means, between Him and His Prophets. 1,1 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur7 :3 * Ad-DurrAl-Manthur7 :3 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur7 :3

4with wings} means, with which they fly to convey quickly that which they have been commanded to convey. I??*' ' 4two or three or four.} means, among them are some who have two wings, some have three and some who have four. Some have more than that, as stated in the Hadith mentioning that the Messenger of Allah jfe saw Jibril, peace be upon him, on the Night of the Isra with six hundred wings. Between each pair of wings was a distance like that between the east and the west. Allah says: }& if&M c4 *h" 1*He increases in creation what He wills. Verily, Allah is Able to do all things.} As-Suddi said, He increases their wings and creates them as He wills. 121 k % *eU 1 5 ^*uu -on 42 . Whatever of mercy, Allah may grant to mankind, none can withhold it; and whatever He may withhold, none can grant it thereafter. And He is the Almighty, the All-Wise.} None can withhold the Mercy ofAllah Allah tells us that what He wills, happens, and what He does not will, does not happen. None can give what He withholds, and none can withhold what He gives. Imam

k i vLj^Ji- N qJl>-j)1 Vj iJj "1J| iL IJi li ^ Vj U Vj U U N ^ili There is no god (worthy of worship) except Allah alone, with no partner or associate. To Him be praise and dominion, and He is able to do all things. 0 Allah, there is none who can withhold what You give, and none can give what You ivithhold, and and good fortune and richness in anything cannot benefit one against Your will . And I heard him forbid gossiping, asking too many questions and wasting money, burying girls alive,

disobeying one's mother, and withholding from others while asking from them. 111 This was also recorded by

And there are many similar Ayat. &^ J.& *li> Jf. gi- > V "U' O' VI 4 43 . O mankind! Remember the grace of Allah upon you! Is there any creator other than Allah who provides for you from the sky (rain) and the earth? La ilaha ila Huwa. How then are you turning away (from Him)?} The Evidence of Tawhid Allah shows His servants that they should worship Him Alone, for just as He is Independent in His power of creation and provision, so He should be worshipped Alone with no partners or associates such as idols and false gods. So Allah says: cm J tr" vmm ' -i.t ,""i 1 > ' ** ?"" > ' ht ' " (_ IjyiJ v'7 , r- // * * x u // C y//- # ""V iifiy 4^j3? % vi% v> } La ilaha ila Huwa. How then are you turning away (from Him)?} meaning, *how can you turn away from Him after this has been made clear and this proof has been made obvious, but you still worship idols and false gods? And Allah knows best. a^ \&& gu jf>& j.& &&& i0

44. And if they deny you, so were Messengers denied before you. And to Allah return all matters . 45. O mankind! Verily, the promise of Allah is true. So, let not this present life deceive you, and let not the chief deceiver deceive you about Allah. 46. Surely, Shaytan is an enemy to you, so take (treat) him as an enemy. He only invites his followers that they may become the dwellers of the blazing Fire. Consolation in the fact that the previous Messengers were denied, and a reminder of the Resurrection Allah says: Even if these idolators who associate others with Allah disbelieve in you, O Muhammad, and go against the Message of Tawhid that you have brought, you have an example in the Messengers who came before you. They also brought a clear Message to their people and told them to worship Allah alone, but their people denied them and went against them. g-y fd fy} 4And to Allah return all matters (for decision).} means, We will requite them for that in full. Then Allah says: 4 j"- jai oj. 40 mankind! Verily, the promise of Allah is true.} meaning the Resurrection will undoubtedly come to pass. 4Qtf > *} 4So, let not this present life deceive you,} means, this life is as nothing in compare to the great good that Allah has promised to His close friends and the followers of His Messengers, so do not let these transient attractions distract you from that which is lasting. 4and let not the chief deceiver deceive you about Allah.}

This refers to Shaytan, as stated by Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him. Meaning, do not let the Shaytan tempt you and divert you away from following the Messengers of Allah and believing what they say, for he is the chief deceiver and arch-liar. This Ayah is like the Ayah that appears at the end of Surah Luqmdn: o it ato ilet not then this (worldly) present life deceive you, nor let the chief deceiver deceive you about Allah^ (31:33). Then Allah tells us of the enmity of Iblis towards the sons of Adam: iSurely, Shaytan is an enemy to you, so take (treat) him as an enemy. meaning, he has declared his enmity towards you, so be even more hostile towards him, oppose him and do not believe the things with which he tries to tempt you. Q>\\$ 4He only invites his followers that they may become the dwellers of the blazing Fire.} means, he only wants to misguide you so that you will enter the blazing Fire with him. This is a manifest enemy, and we ask Allah, the All-Powerful and Almighty to make us enemies of Shaytan and to make us followers of the Book of Allah and of the way of His Messengers. For He is able to do whatever He wills and He will respond to all supplication. This is like the Ayah: ip Ip Crt^ awtdiU Ji !)J j&J (Uj ot 4And (remember) when We said to the angels: "Prostrate yourselves

unto Adam." So they prostrated themselves except Iblis. He was one of the Jinn; he disobeyed the command of his Lord. Will you then take him (Iblis) and his offspring as m At-Tabari 20 :438

protectors and helpers rather than Me while they are enemies to you? What an evil is the exchange for the wrongdoers .> (18:50) ^ (3 ""* jjb Xil Z>\% jii 05 * * J* if\$ "to .< 2 ^ .A.0 U. tSc. ILl 47. Those who disbelieve, theirs will be a severe torment; and those who believe and do righteous good deeds, theirs will be forgiveness and a great reward 48. Is he, then, to whom the evil of his deeds is made fairseeming, so that he considers it as good? Verily, Allah sends astray whom He wills, and guides whom He wills. So destroy not yourself in sorrowfor them. Truly, Allah is the All-Knower ofwhat they do!} The Punishment of the Disbeliever and the Reward of the Believer on the Day ofResurrection Having stated that the ultimate destiny of the followers of Iblls will be the blazing Fire, Allah then tells us that for those who disbelieve there will be a severe punishment. This is because they obeyed the Shaytan and disobeyed Ar-Rahman. And He tells us that those who believed in Allah and His Messengers 4"and do righteous good deeds, theirs will be forgiveness^ meaning, from whatever sins they did, 4and a great reward for the good deeds that they did. Then Allah says: 4IO- "U> .4^ >* /J& 41s he, then, to whom the evil ofhis deeds is made fairseeming, so that he considers it as good?\$ meaning, such as disbelievers or immoral persons who do evil deeds and believe that they are doing something good, i.e., a person who is like that has been misguided by Allah, so what

can you do for him? You cannot help him at all. 4 ij* J {j* Verily, Allah sends astray whom He wills and guides whom He wills. means according to His decree. 4< >/"* ctLOi 4So destroy not yourself in sorrozofor them.\$ means, do not grieve about that, for Allah is Wise in His decree and He leaves astray whomsoever He leaves astray, and He guides whomsoever He guides, and in doing so He has perfect knowledge and wisdom. Allah says: 4o 1m C pie iif iTrui, Allah is the All-Knower ofwhat they do!\$ Xffy. Am J>)i\ * LvJi cIS JI. '(Xef jiZi ^fff\ 3ji' ,P5 iiii %i\ Ilf '!' 4* of 45 ^ *j5 Jli? c r ,1 .-f' 't - * -4 -- rf* i{ ,i - ly *J ip' 0} J*- IkU 1 kj 4jJco yy Ip >*' < ^ oj, 4 ^ oj 49. And it is Allah Who sends the winds, so that they raise up the clouds, and We drive them to a dead land, and revive therewith the earth after its death. As such (will be) the Resurrection!} 420. Whosoever desires Al- Izzah then to Allah belongs Al- Izzah. To Him ascend the good words, and the righteous deeds exalt it, but those who plot evils, theirs will be a severe torment. And the plotting ofsuch will perish 422 . And Allah did create youfrom dust, then from Nutfahf then He made you pairs. And nofemale conceives or gives birth but with His knowledge. And no aged man is granted a length of life nor is a part cut offfrom his life, but is in a Book. Surely, that is easyfor Allcihf See volume six, the explanation of Surat Al-Hajj22 :4, and Surat Al- Mu minun 23 :13 in volume six.

Fatir (9-11) (Part-22) Evidence of Life after Death Often Allah refers to the Resurrection by using the analogy of the earth coming back to life after it has died, as in the beginning of Surat Al-Hajj, where He urges His servants to draw the lesson of the former from the latter. For the earth is dead and lifeless, with nothing growing in it, then He sends to it clouds which bring water, which He sends down upon it, iit is stirred (to life), and it swells and puts forth every lovely kind (ofgrowth)} (22:5). So too, when Allah wishes to resurrect the bodies, He will send rain from beneath the Throne which will cover the whole earth, and the bodies will grow in their graves like seeds grow in the earth. It says in the Sahih: > Z + > >* / ' . * * Every part of the son ofAdam will disintegrate apartfrom the coccyx, from which he

was created and from him he will be made anew.*^ Allah says: li iAs such (will be) the Resurrection!} According to the Hadith of Abu Razln: I said, O Messenger of Allah, how will Allah bring the dead back to life? What is the sign of that in His creation? He^ said: aj Ojy Ui O Abu Razin, do you not pass through the valley of your people (and see it) arid and barren, then you pass through it (and see it) stirred (to life) and green? I said, Yes. He said: "77ius will Allah bring the dead back to life . 12) ,1] Muslim 4:2271. ^ Ahmad 4: 12.

Honor, Power and Glory in this World and in the Hereafter come only by obeying Allah 4Whoever desires Al-'Izzah then to Allah belongs all Al- 'Izzah.} means, whoever desires honor, power and glory in this world and the next, let him be obedient towards Allah, may He be exalted. This will help him reach his goal, for Allah is the Sovereign of this world and the Hereafter, and to Him belong all honor, power and glory. This is like the Ayat. k \Jf\ oji lyti jyi m iThose who take disbelievers for protectors instead of believers, do they seek Al-'Izzah with them? Verily, then to Allah belongs all honor, power and glory. (4:139) iIU*. k k && iAnd let not their speech grieve you, for all Al-'Izzah belongs to Allah (10:65). Al-'Izzah belongs to Allah, and to His Messenger, and to the believers, but the hypocrites know not} (63:8). Mujahid said: iWlwsoever desires Al-'Izzah means, by worshipping idols. }then to Allah belongs Al-'Izzah}. ^Whoever desires Al-'Izzah then to Allah belongs Al-'Izzah.} means, let him seek honor, power and glory through obeying Tabari 20:443.

Allah, may He be glorified. 1 Righteous Deeds ascend to Allah i' 4To Him ascend the good words,} means, words of remembrance, recitation of Qur an, and supplications. This was the view of more than one of the Salaf. Ibn Jarir recorded that Al-Mukhariq bin Sulaym said that Abdullah bin Mas*ud, may Allah be pleased with him, said to them, If we tell you a Hadith, we will bring you proof of it from the Book of Allah. When the

This was also recorded by Ibn Majah.' {and the righteous deeds exalt it}. Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, The good word is the remembrance of Allah, may He be exalted, which is taken up to Allah, and the righteous deed is the performance of obligatory duties. Whoever remembers Allah when doing an obligatory duty, his deed carries his remembrance of Allah and takes it up to Allah, may He be exalted. Whoever remembers Allah and does not perform the obligatory duties, his words will be rejected, as will his deed. 121 {but those who plot evils,} Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr and Shahr bin Hawshab said, This refers to those who show off by their actions, '3 ' i.e., they deceive the people by giving the impression that they are obeying Allah, when in fact they are hated by Allah for showing off. Allah says: theirs will be severe torment. And the plotting of such will perish.} meaning, it will fail and vanish, for their reality is apparent from up close to those who have insight and wisdom. No one conceals a secret but Allah will cause it to become known, on his face or by a slip of the tongue, or He will cause the person to wear it like a cloak (so that everyone will see it). If it is good, then the consequences will be good, and if it is bad, then the consequences will be bad. The person who shows off cannot continue to deceive anyone but the fool, but the believers who have insight are not deceived by that; from up close, they soon discover it. And nothing at all can be hidden from the Knower of the Unseen (Allah). m Ibn Majah 2:1252. At-Tabari 20 :445 Pl At-Tabari 20 :447

Fatir (9-11) (Part-22) Allah is the Creator and Knower of the Unseen 4And Allah did create you from dust, then from Nutfah,} means. He initiated the creation of your father Adam from dust, then He

created his offspring from semen of worthless water. i then He made you pairs means, male and female, as a kindness and a mercy from Him, He gave you partners from your own kind, that you may find repose in them. i And no female conceives or gives birth but with His knowledge. means, He knows about that and nothing is hidden from Him at all, but, 4n 4 inot a leaffalls, but He knows it. There is not a grait in the darkness of the earth nor anything fresh or dry, but is written in a Clear Record (6:59) We have already discussed in this respect in the Ayah: U) JaJu Cj Jil fcjc li 0/jL, i Allah knows what every female bears, and by how much the wombs fall short or exceed. Everything with Hint is in (due) proportion . All-Knower of the unseen and the seen, the Most Great, the Most High.} (13:8-9). Oi X> _/ *" oi _r^i k" / ^And no aged man is granted a length of life nor is a part ait offfrom his life, but is in a Book.\$ means, some of those sperm are granted a long life, which He knows and it is recorded with Him in the First Book.

it 'ij} inor is a part cut offfrom his life,} Here the pronoun (his) refers to mankind in general, not to a specific person, because the long life which is recorded in the Book and is known by Allah will not be cut off. It was reported via Al- Awfi that Ibn Abbas said concerning the Ayah, t> *s&i oj. cl 4And no aged man is granted a length of life nor is a part cut off from his life, but is in a Book. Surely, that is easy for Allah .} There is no one for whom Allah has decreed a long life but he will reach the age that has been decreed for him. When he reaches the time that has been decreed for him, he will not surpass it. And there is no one for whom Allah has decreed a short life but it will end when he reaches the age that has been decreed for him. Allah says: itf . \$ i> o\ L&" 4\ it "ifr inor is a part ait offfrom his life, but is in a Book. Surely, that is easyfor Allah.} He said, That is recorded in a Book with Him. This was also the view of Ad-Dahhak bin Muzahim. On the other hand, some of them said, The phrase 4And no aged man is granted a length of life} means, what He decrees for him of life, and - f-. it inor is a part cut offfrom his life} means, his time is constantly decreasing. All of this is known to Allah year after year, month after month, week after week, day after day, hour after hour. Everything is written with Allah in His Book. This was reported by Ibn Jarir from Abu Malik, * and was also the view of As- I At-Jabari 20:447. At-Tabari 20:447.

Fatir (12) (Part-22 Suddi and Ata Al- Khurasani. In the Tafsir of this Ayah,

bitter. And from them both you eat fresh tender meat (fish), and derive the ornaments that xjou wear. And you see the ships cleaving, that you may seek of His bounty, and that you may give thanks. The Blessings and Signs ofAllah Allah says, pointing out His mighty power in creating different things, how He has created the two seas (kinds of water). The fresh, palatable sea (kind of water) refers to the rivers which flow among people, rivers great and small according to people s needs in all regions and areas and lands. This water is sweet and palatable for whoever wants to drink it. i and that is salty and bitter.} means, unpalatable. This is the ocean in which the big ships sail, and is salty and undrinkable. Allah says: i^ i and that is salty and bitter.} Then Allah says: i And from them both you eat fresh tender meat,} meaning, fish. i and derive the ornaments that you wear.} This is like the Ayah: i% sc\$ p} i Out of them both come out pearl and coral. Tlten which of the blessings of your Lord will you both (Jinn and men) deny?} (55 :22-23). ijSfro dSif JjJ} i And you see the ships cleaving,} means, they travel through it, plowing through the water with their beak-shaped bows. Mujahid said, The wind drives the ships, and the wind cannot drive any ships except the big ones.

that you may seek of His bounty,} means, through your journeys to engage in trade from one land to another. and that you may give thanks.} means, that you may give thanks to your Lord for subjugating this mighty creation - the sea - to you, so that you can travel through it as you wish and go wherever you want, and nothing stops you; His power has subjugated for you whatever is in the heavens and on earth, and all of this is by His grace and mercy. iifk Jill!! J Qyj 4 . iss jj;^ gtsact# jg #3B yz* ji " 34 a?. 553 . He merges the night into the day, and He merges the day into the night. And He has subjected the sun and the moon, each runs its course for a term appointed. Such is AUah, your Lord; His is the kingdom. And those, whom you invoke or call upon instead of Him, own not even a Qihmr.} \$14. If you invoke them, they hear your call; and if (in case) they were to hear, they could not grant it to you. And on the Day of Resurrection, they will disown your xvorshipping them. And none can inform you like Him Who is the All-Knower.} The gods of the Idolaters do not even own a Qipnir Another aspect of His perfect power and might is that He has subjugated the night with its darkness and the day with its light. He takes from the length of the one and adds it to the shortness of the other, until they become equal. Then He takes from the latter and adds to the former, so one becomes long and the other becomes short, so they take from one another in summer and in winter. 4And He has subjected the sun and the moon,}

136 TafcTr Ibn Kathir and the stars and planets, with their light. All of them run in their appointed courses and in the manner prescribed for them, as decreed by the Almighty, All-Knowing. ieach runs its course for a term appointed.) means, until the Day of Resurrection. iSuch is Allah, pour Lord?) means, the One Who has done all this is the Almighty Lord besides Whom there is no other true God. Aj-> cn oy-j. iAnd those, whom you invoke or call upon instead of Him,) means, the idols and false gods whom you claim to be in the form of angels who are close to Allah, iown not even a Qitmir.) Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Ata , Atiyah Al- Awfi, Al-Hasan, Qata- dah and others said, This is the thread that is attached to the pit of a date. 11 * In other words, they do not possess anything in the heavens or on earth, not even anything equivalent to this Qitmir. Then Allah says: ilfyou invoke them, they hear not your call;) means, the gods upon whom you call instead of Allah, do not hear your supplication, because they are inanimate and have no soul in them. 4 i t cLj C \jj) iand if (in case) they were to hear, they could not grant it to you.) means, they are not able to do any of the things that you ask them for. hi At-Tabari 20 :453

4And on the Day of Resurrection, they will disown your worshipping them} means, they will disown you. This is like the Ayat 4 i'-'jf !?. 4 & J. V ir 1 "j>' jjJ Ji !>* ** j 4 I 1 sOJULS. 4And who is more astray than one who calls on besides Allah, such as will not answer him till the Day of Resurrection, and who are (even) unaware of their calls to them? And when mankind are gathered, they (false deities) will become their enemies and will deny their worshipping .} (46:5-6), and 4And they have taken gods besides Allah, that they might give them honor, power and glory. Nay, but they will deny their worship of them, and become opponents to them.} (19:81-82) 4jS& 4And none can inform you like Him Who is the All-Knower.} means, no one can tell you about the consequences of things and how they will end like the One Who is the All-Knower of them. Qatadah said, He is referring to Himself, may He be blessed and exalted, for He undoubtedly tells the truth. JCj -X 4 iJrji-P ' \$s> ci[tub Xy ^ * Cjfc ^ C2l &S 6\$ J12 V l^L 415. O mankind! it is you who stand in need of Allah. But Allah is the Rich, Worthy of all praise.} 416. If He willed, He could destroy you and bring about a new creation.} 417. And that is not hard for Allah.} IM At-Tabaii 20 :454

138 Tafslr Ibn Kathlr 418. And no bearer of burdens shall bear another's burden; and if one heavily laden calls another to (bear) his load, nothing of it will be lifted even though he be near of kin. You can roam only those who fear their Lord unseen and perform the Salah. And he who purifies himself (from all kinds of sins), then he purifies only for the benefit of himself. And to Allah is the Return (of all).} Mankind is in need of Allah, and each Person will carry His own Burdens on the Day of Resurrection Allah tells us that He has no need of anyone or anything else, but all of creation is in need of Him and is in a position of humility before Him. He says: 4 \4% &% \$ > 40 mankind! it is you who stand in need of Allah.} meaning, they need Him in all that they do, but He has no need of them at all. Allah says: 4UJ' >%} 4But Allah is the Rich, Worthy of all praise.} meaning, He is unique in His being Free of all needs, and has no partner or associate, and He is Worthy of all praise in all that He does, says, decrees and legislates. 4If He willed, He could destroy you and bring about a new creation .} means, if He wanted to, He could destroy you and bring forth another people, and this is not difficult or impossible for Him. He says: j?&&O 4And that is not hard for Allah.} Allah s saying: & % Ji 4And no bearer of burdens shall bear another's burden;} means, on the Day of Resurrection.

zmsm Vi j.4jCj3iiG 3fo;jJSsSoKs! ,jK., v-UlC-^ , ></' % . ^ ' i-sC '\C'S- s' > "- ^ -i^r- drt/ '><.e"C" 4S&: <^l 5 i and if one heavily laden calls another to (bear) his load,} means, if the person who is carrying a heavy burden calls someone else to help him carry his load, all or part of it, 6 6f j # . 0 4nothing of it will be lifted even though he be near of kin. means, even if he is closely-related to him, even if he is his father or son, for each person will be preoccupied with his own self and his own situation. Then Allah says: 4p\$\$\$v4^ r& t\$.& 4Yoh can warn only those who fear their Lord unseen and perform the Salah.} means, *the only ones who will draw a lesson from what you have brought are those .who are possessed of insight and wisdom, who fear their Lord and who do as He commands. 0 iAnd he who purifies himself, then he purifies only for the benefit of himself.} means, who does righteous deeds, the benefit of that will come back to him.

4And to Allah is the Return .} means, to Him everything will ultimately return, and He is swift in bringing to account. He will reward or punish everyone according to his deeds: if they are good, then the end will be good, and if they are bad, then the end will be bad. G %W ii 0\$ O* bi SW o! ^/1 jylj 5; u!j iwjj LO cftlLyi lj[S-fr^ i +'Aj (*r*t (**M ^iy}' .jIT -di 4^^? 4\$^jss&r y"*is !i . Not alike are the blind and the seeing.} 420. Nor ore (depths of) darkness and light.} 421 . Nor are the shade and the sun's heat.} 422. Nor are the living and the dead. Verily, Allah makes whom He wills to hear, but you cannot make hear those who are in graves.} 423. You are only a wamer.} 424. Verily, We have sent you with the truth, a bearer of glad tidings and a wamer. And there never was a nation but a wamer had passed among them.} 425. And if they deny you, those before them also denied. Their Messengers came to them with clear signs, and with the Scriptures, and with the Book giving light.} 426. Then I took hold of those who disbelieved, and how terrible was My denial!} The Believer and the Disbeliever are not equal Allah says that these antonyms are clearly not equal, the blind and the seeing are not equal, there is a difference and a huge gap between them. Darkness and light are not equal, neither are shade and the sun s heat. By the same token, the living and the dead are not equal. This is the parable Allah makes of the believers who are the living, and the disbelievers who are

Fatir (19 - 26) (Part-22 the dead. This is like the Ayat k 4 & * ft o4 41s he who was dead and We gave him life and set for him a light (of belief) whereby he can walk amongst men - like him who is in the (depths of) darkness from which he can never come out?) (6:122), J* sft 4The parable of the two parties is as that of the blind and the deaf and the seer and the hearer. Are they equal when compared?) (11:24) The believer sees and hears, and walks in the light upon a straight path in this world and the Hereafter, until he comes to settle in Gardens (Paradise) wherein is shade and springs. The disbeliever is blind and deaf, walking in darkness from which he cannot escape, he is lost in his misguidance in this world and the Hereafter, until he end', up in fierce hot wind and boiling water, and shadow of black smoke, neither cool nor good. ^ jjT j\} iVerily, Allah makes whom He wills to hear,} means. He guides them to listen to the proof and accept it and adhere it. 4 O' gv ibut you cannot make hear those who are in graves.} means, just as the dead cannot benefit from guidance and the call to truth after they have died as disbelievers and ended up in the graves, so too you cannot help these idolators who are decreed to be doomed, and you cannot guide them. 4You are only a wamer} means, all you have to do is to convey the Message and warn them, and Allah leaves astray whomso- ever He wills and guides whomsoever He wills.

242 Tafslr Ibn KathJr Ijfria dllSijl TSl^ iVerily, We have sent you with the truth, a bearer of glad tidings and a ivamer.} means, a bearer of glad tidings to the believers and a wamer to the disbelievers. i ji & 4\ ,1 f/iere newer was a nation but a wamer had passed among them.} means, there was never any nation among the sons of Adam but Allah sent wamers to them, and left them with no excuse. This is like the Ayat. iYou are only a wamer, and to every people there is a guide (13:7). iSYk o* ii' biic' iSl ^ (JZ j3\j} iAnd verily, We have sent among every Ummah a Messenger (proclaiming): Worship Allah, and avoid all false deities." Then of them were some whom Allah guided and of them were some upon whom the straying was justified} (16:36). And there are many similarAyat |-by "i js iAnd if they deny you, those before them also denied. Their Messengers came to them with clear signs,} means, clear miracles and definitive proofs. iand with the Scriptures,} means, the Books. iand with the Book giving light.} means, clear and obvious.

iThen I took hold of those who disbelieved,\$ means, despite all of this, they denied the Messengers and the Message they brought, so I seized them, i.e., with My punishment. iand how terrible zoas My denial means, how great and intense and terrible do you think My punishment was? And Allah knows best. j- *"r Cftj a. j* jjji ill' 3 <(27. Sec i/o" not that Allah sends down water from the sky/, and We produce therewith fruits of various colors, and among the mountains are judad, white and red, ofvarying colors and (others) Gharabib black,f i28 . And likewise, men and moving creature and cattle are of various colors. It is only those among His servants who have knozoledge that fear Allah. Verily, Allah is Almighty, Oft- Forgiving.] The Perfect Power ofAllah Allah tells us of His complete and perfect power of creation. He tells us how He makes different kinds of things from one thing, which is the water that He sends down from the heaven. From water He brings forth fruits of various colors, yellow, red, green, white and other colors, as we can see in the immense variety of their colors, tastes and scents. This is like another Ayah where Allah says: yy? cy, (Xt jff ^Cl* ol j . jo AAnd in the earth are neighbouring tracts, and gardens of vines, and green crops, and date palms, growing into two or three from a single stem root, or otherwise, zoatered with the same zuater; yet some of them We make more excellent than others to eat. Verily, in these things there are Ayat for the

people who understand.} (13:4) 4<?i" ' ' " f-*" jf ' -). *-J o'*. Jj*- Ovn' crl iand among the mountains are Judad, white and red, of varying colors} means. He created the mountains like this, with different colors, as we also see that there are indeed white and red mountains, and in some of them there are streaks which are also of varying colors. Ibn Abbas said Al-Judad means pathways. This was also the view of Abu Malik, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and As-Suddi. And there are some mountains which are very black. Ikrimah said, u Al-Gharabtb means mountains which are high and black. This was also the view of Abu Malik, Ata Al-Khurasani and Qatadah. 111 Ibn Jarir said, When the Arabs describe something as being very black, they say Ghirbib." iAnd likewise, men and moving creatures and cattle are of various colors.} means, the same is true of living creatures too, humans and animals, all creatures which walk on their feet, and cattle. Here something general is followed by something specific. These are all different too, for among mankind there are Berbers, Ethiopians and some non-Arabs who are very black, and Slavs and Romans who are very white, and the Arabs who are in between, and the Indians. Allah says in another Ayah: iand the difference of your languages and colors. Verily, in that are indeed signsfor men ofsound knowledge} (30:22). Similarly, animals and cattle vary in their colors, even within one species, and a single animal may have patches of different colors. Blessed be Allah, the Best of creators. Allah then says: (i| At-Tabari 20:461

Fdtir (27 - 28) (Part-22 ilt is only those who have knowledge among His servants that fear Allah. meaning, only those who have knowledge truly fear Him as He should be feared, because the more they know about the Almighty, All-Powerful, All-Knowing Who has the most perfect attributes and is described with the most beautiful Names, the more they will fear Him. Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas commented on the Ayah: ilt is only those who have knowledge among His servants that fear Allah.} those who know that Allah is able to do all things.' ' Ibn Abbas said, The one among His servants who knows about Ar-Rahman, is the one who does not associate anything in worship with Him; the one who accepts as lawful that which He has permitted and accepts as unlawful that which He has prohibited. He obeys His commands and is certain that he will meet Him and be brought to account for his deeds. Said bin Jubayr said, Fear is what stands between you and disobeying Allah, may He be glorified. Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, The knowledgeable person is the one who fears Ar-Rahman with regard to the Unseen, who likes that which Allah wants him to like, and who shuns that which angers Allah. Then Al-Hasan recited: Si* . lj &* it Si* tj&. ilt is only those among His servants who have knowledge that fear Allah. Verily, AllHh is Almighty, Oft-Forgiving.} Sufyan Ath-Thawri narrated from Abu Hayyan At-Taymi from a man who said, It used to be said that the knowledgeable are of three types: (first) one who knows Allah and the command of Allah, (second) one who knows Allah but does not know the command of Allah, and (third) one who knows the command of Allah but does not know Allah. The one who knows Allah and the command of Allah is the one who fears m At-Tabari 20 :462

Allah and knows the limits (Hudud) and the obligatory duties {Fara id). The one who knows Allah but does not know the command of Allah is the one who fears Allah but does not know the limits (Hudud) and the obligatory duties (Fara'id). The one who knows the command of Allah but does not know Allah is the one who knows the limits (Hudud) and the obligatory duties (Fara id) but does not fear Allah. U fab 1 \$ Of &A fa& fat j Z4. <& 129. Verily, those who recite the Book of Allah, and perform the Saldh, and spend out of what We have provided for them, secretly and openly, they hope for a (sure) trade-gain that will never perish.. That He may pay them their wages in foil, and give them (even) more, out of His

grace. Verily, He is Oft-Forgiving, Most Ready to appreciate. The Muslims will be the Ones Who gain in the Hereafter Here Allah tells us that His believing servants, who recite and believe in His Book, and do the deeds prescribed in it such as establishing regular prayer at the prescribed times, night and day, spending (in charity) out of that which Allah has provided for them secretly and openly, they hope for a (sure) trade-gain that will never perish.)> means, they hope for a reward from Allah which will inevitably be theirs. Allah says: iThat He may pay them their wages in full, and give them (even) more, out of His grace. meaning, that He may give them a reward for what they have done, and multiply it by adding more, such as has never occurred to them. ijfa

dA^JzJ L^L>^ { "AI t^I(jul^ jS> ujLoiA "Jkc^-*" ?o i^t> " > ^ > <- if-% :ti (jyL^l^yi-Ju(ljJ^O*liiJ- fl p_A-^=L)IJ^il4JI ^JfCi D&SBB& %, He is Oft- Forgiving, means, He forgives their sins, Sf",e A 0^lc..^fli t ^ *.. s r .' -J-' p^a. >. '-As '1 'nf.'tv' I<" J^yL^== ' s v^ij V-'if-v . -ft"? i* i . " T" * _/^^=aj^jC ^ ^ ^ ^ I ^ ^ Z f> l^^?IC --Xffr - : iMost Ready to appreciate. means, He appreciates even a lit- tle of their good deeds. Crt tlLS[b-^ c 3j^ q > J&i 1a- *oLjU 4jil oi Jo 431 . And what We have revealed to you of the Book, it is the (very) truth confirming that which was (revealed) be- fore it. Verily, Allah is indeed All-Aware and All-Seer of His servants The Qur an is The true Book of Allah 4&i Vf4 4And what We have revealed to you\$ - O Muhammad, of the Book, i.e., the Qur an, 4%z*qi&&" iit is the (very) truth confirming that which was (revealed) before it.\$ means, of the previous books. It confirms them just as they bore witness to the coming of the Qur an and that it would be sent down from the Lord of the worlds.

these are the ones who do obligatory actions and things which are encouraged, and who avoid doing unlawful and disliked actions, and avoid some actions which are permissible. Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas commented on the Ayah: iThen We gave the Book as inheritance to such of Our servants whom We chose.} This refers to the Ummah of Muhammad jg. Allah caused it to inherit every Book that He had revealed; those who wrong themselves will be forgiven, those who follow a middle course will have an easy accounting, and those who are foremost in good deeds will enter Paradise without being brought to account. ' 1 Abu Al-Qasim At-Tabarani reported from Ibn Abbas that the Messenger of Allah jg said one day: ^f It JX&\ ji.ui. Mi/ intercession will be for those among my Ummah who commit major sins Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, Those who are foremost in good deeds will enter Paradise without being brought to account; those who follow a middle course will enter Paradise by the mercy of Allah; and those who wrong themselves and Ashab Al-A'raf2 * will enter Paradise by the intercession of Muhammad 2s. It was also reported from a number of the Salaf that those among this Ummah who wrong themselves are still among those whom Allah has chosen, even though they are imperfect and fell short [by not adhering to the straight path]. Others said that those who wrong themselves are not part of this Ummah and are not among those whom Allah has chosen and who inherited the Book. The correct view is that they are also part of this Ummah.Tabari 20:465. ' See volume four, the Tafsir of Surat Al-A'raf\7 :46| ' At-Tabarani 11 :189.

The Virtues of the Scholars The scholars are the most fortunate of people with regard to this blessing, and the most entitled to this mercy. Imam

433. Adn (Gardens) zuill they enter, therein will they be adorned zoith bracelets of gold and pearls, and their garments therein will be of silk. 434. And they will say: All praise and thanks be to Allah, Wlw has

removed from us (all) grief. Verily, our Lord is indeed Oft-Forgiving, Most Ready to appreciate."} 435. Who, out of His grace, has lodged us in a home that will last forever, where toil will touch us not nor weariness will touch us."} Allah tells us that those whom He chose among His servants, those who inherited the Book which was revealed from the Lord of the worlds, will, on the Day of Resurrection, have an abode in Everlasting Gardens which they will enter on the Day when they are raised anew and meet Allah. ^ yi . ^ #/> v yjrj Cfi 4therein will they be adorned with bracelets of gold and pearls,} It was recorded in the Sahih from Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, that the Messenger of Allah% said: u & ' The ornaments of the believer will reach as far as his Wudu'jW 4and their garments therein will be of silk.} For this reason it is forbidden for them (the males) in this world, but Allah will permit it for them in the Hereafter. It was recorded in the Sahih that the Messenger of Allah0 said: Jt Jip iJ Whoever wears silk in this world, will not wear it in the Hereafter. 1:219. ^ Fath Al-Bari 10 :296. This applies only to males.

Silrah 35. Fdtir (36 - 37) (Part-22) 153 neither their bodies nor their souls will become exhausted; and Allah knows best. They used to exhaust themselves in worshipping this world, but their obligations will come to an end when they enter Paradise, where they will enjoy eternal rest and repose. Allah says: 4:< ijti) l iEat and drink at ease for that which you have sent on before you in days past!} (69:24) Z' - . > ' >?'> ' *> . VV j^+ "- cjl-uL"r tfjj' jjc L, 'H, oUjiu a& Jijlt a^ ^ J.- 436. But those who disbelieve, for them will be the fire of Hell. Neither will it have a complete killing effect on them so that they die nor shall its torment be lightened for them. Thus do I've requite every disbeliever !} 437. Therein they will cry : "Our Lord! Bring us out, we shall do righteous good deeds, not that we used to do." (Allah will reply:) "Did We not give you lives long enough, so that whosoever would receive admonition could receive it? And the warmer came to you . So taste you . For the wrongdoers there is no helper."} The Punishment of the Disbeliever and what Their State will be in Hell Having told us how the blessed will be (in Paradise), Allah now starts to tell us what the state of doomed will be. He says: x\ tVI4) .^ - n .IA 1 -V"ili 4But those who disbelieve, for them will be the fire of Hell. Neither will it have a complete killing effect on them so that they die} This is like the Ayah: & *> 4V\herein he will neither die nor live} (20:74).

iThus do We requite every disbeliever!} meaning, this is the recompense of everyone who disbelieved in his Lord and denied the truth. ^Therein they will cry means, they will call out in the Fire, beseeching Allah with their voices: ife ^z jii 'c; i Our Lord! Bring us out, we shall do righteous good deeds, not that we used to do."} which means, they will ask to go back to the worldly life so that they can do something different to the first deeds they did. But Allah, may He be glorified, knows that if He sent them back to this world, they would go back to what they had been forbidden to do, and He knows that they are lying, so He will not respond to their plea. This is like the Ayah where Allah tells us that they will say: iThen is there any way to get out (of the Fire). (It iwill be said) : This is because, when Allah Alone was invoked you disbelieved (denied), but when partners were joined to Him, you believed!} (40:11,12) i.e., There will be no response for you because you were like that; if you were to return to this world, you would just go back to that which you had been forbidden to do. Allah says here: iDid We not give you lives long enough, so that whosoever would receive admonition could receive it? And the warmer came to you.} meaning, did you not live for long enough in the world that if you were to be

among those who would benefit from the truth, you would have benefited from it during your lifetimes?
Imam

Jill UZf jUJ Jr-? iff oll>-l xS- Lif jJlpf jUJ> *-3} Jtij t IaJ "Allah has left no excuse for the person who lives to be sixty or seventy years old ; Allah has left no excuse for him; Allah has left no excuse for him.
Imam

O Malik! Let your Lord make an end of us.

Fdtir (39 - 40) (Part-22) iHe it is Who has made you successors generations after generations in the earth,} meaning, all people succeed one another, generation after generation. This is like the Ayah: iand makes you inheritors of the earth, generations after generations {27:62}. 4* &&S 4so whosoever disbelieves, on him will be his disbelief.} means, he and no one else will have to bear the consequences of that. iAnd the disbelief of the disbelievers adds nothing but hatred of their Lord.} means, the longer they persist in their disbelief, the more Allah hates them, and the longer they persist in it, the more they and their families will lose on the Day of Resurrection. This is in contrast to the believers, for the longer they live and do good deeds, the higher their status in Paradise will be, the greater their reward, and the more beloved they will be to their Creator. Umj S. jvf~T ^ ol U'j odJ 'ijy cfyddh 4\$;& Cx.\$ Ail If, 440. Say: "Have you considered your partners whom you call upon besides Allah? Show Me, what they have created of the earth. Or have they any share in the heavens? Or have We given them a Book, so that they act on clear proof therefrom? Nay, the wrongdoers promise one another nothing but delusions."} 441. Verily, Allah grasps the heavens and the earth lest they should move away from their places, and if they xoere to move

VI jc u' 4He withholds the heaven from falling on the earth except by His leave} (22:65), and }And among His signs is that the heaven and the earth stand by His command} (30:25). 'Ji fJ ot ul, Ub jdj} iand if tliey were to move away from their places, there is not one that could grasp them after Him.} means, no one can make them stay and preserve them except Him. He is Ever Most Forbearing and Oft-Forgiving because He sees His servants disbelieving in Him and disobeying Him, yet He is patient and gives them time, He waits and does not hasten the punishment, and He conceals the faults of others and forgives them. He says: * Qf- {Truly, He is Ever Most Forbearing, Oft-Forgiving.} pi tjQ at j-y |C-pJ jl^>- \fijf,} i \jp^ Sd % j jfji a y ps &% y ci-J Jj VjJ-? y oib JjC jii C/Sjfi C*IL V 442. And they swore by Allah their most bindirtg oath that ifa ivamer came to them, they would be more guided than any of the nations; yet what a wamer came to them, it increased in than nothing butflight (from the truth).} {43. (They took to flight because of their) arrogance in the land and their plotting of evil. But the evil plot encompasses only him who makes it. Then, can they expect anything (else) but the Sunnah (way of dealing) of the peoples of old? So, no change will you find in Allah's Sunnah, and no himing offwill you find in Allah's Sunnah.}

Fatir (42 - 43) (Part-22) means, they only increased in their disbelief. Then Allah explains this further: i(They took to flight because of their) arrogance in the land} means, they were too arrogant to follow the signs of Allah. iand their plotting of evil.} means, they plotted to prevent people from following the path of Allah. iBut the evil plot encompasses only him who makes it means, the evil consequences of that will come back upon them and not on others. iThen, can they expect anything (else) but the Sunnah

(way of dealing) of the peoples of old?} meaning, the punishment of Allah for disbelieving in His Messengers and going against His command. and no turning off will you find in Allah's Sunnah .} means, it does not change or alter, and this is what happens to every disbeliever. and no turning off will you find in Allah's Sunnah.} means, if* ill iBut when Allah wills a people's punishment, there can be no turning back of it} (13:11). This means, no one can remove that from them or ward it off from them. And Allah knows best. >/ / ifff irfjfi

164 Tafsir Ibn Kathir ia - 444. Hflue they not traveled in the land, and seen what was the end of those before them - though they were superior to them in power Allah is not such that anything in the heavens or in the earth escapes Him. Verily, He is All- Knowing, All-Able.> 445. And if Allah were to punish men for that which they earned. He would not leave a moving creature on the surface of the earth ; but He gives them respite to an appointed term, and when their term comes, then verily, Allah is Ever All-Seer of His Remember the Bad Consequences of disbelieving in the Prophets Allah says: say, O Muhammad, to these people who disbelieve the Message you have brought: travel in the land and see what was the punishment of those who disbelieved the Messengers,

how Allah destroyed them completely, and a similar (end awaits)

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4752–4753]

the disbelievers. See how their homes were emptied of them and how they lost everything after living in luxury and being so numerous and so well equipped, and having so much wealth and so many children. All of that was of no avail to them and could not protect them in the slightest from the punishment of Allah when the command of the Lord came. Nothing is impossible for u&m it- ^j>-y.o^==4j ot jja 'mm fire ,-C^ > ' it >? . iCiri rr -1 ^p-fJul J J * 'rrt- -r ^ s> S . -i * t servants .>

Him when He wants it to happen in the heavens or on earth. &\ft iVerily, He is All-Knowing, All-Ableft means, He knows all that exists and is able to do all things. The Wisdom behind delaying the Punishment Then Allah says: 4} Z Jidlf& if Allah were to punish men for that which they earned, He would not leave a moving creature on the surface of the earthft meaning, if He were to punish them for all of their sins, He would destroy all the people of the earth and all that they own of livestock and crops. Said bin Jubayr and As-Suddi commented on the Ayah: 4&Z Cxi 4He would not leave a moving creature on the surface of the earthft This means, He would have stopped sending rain to them, and all the animals would have died as a result. ibut He gives them respite to an appointed termft means, but He is delaying until the Day of Resurrection, when He will bring them to account and will reward or punish each one according to his deeds: He will reward those who obeyed Him and will punish those who disobeyed Him. He says: cX Si'^ iand when their term comes, then verily, Allah is Ever All- Seer of His servantsft

Surah 36: Ya-Sin

PDF pages 4754–4816

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 4754]

Opening Surah 36, Yd Sin (1 - 7) (Part-22) 167 The Tafsir of Surah Yd Sin (Chapter - 36)

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4754–4765]

The Virtues of Surah Yd Sin Al-Hafiz Abu Yala recorded that Abu Hurayrah, may Allah be pleased with him, said, The Messenger of Allah jg said: jU-oJl Ljj JX 'y yj i"J by** j. j-i '3* a "Whoever recites Ya Sm in the night, will wake up forgiven, and ivhoever recites Ha Mim in which Ad-Dukhan (the Smoke) is mentioned, will wake up forgiven ." Its chain of narration is good (Jayyid) Ibn Hibban recorded in his Sahih that Jundub bin Abdullah, may Allah be pleased with him, said, The Messenger of Allah jte said: aJ 'yi- Ji-j y- yrj jlJ '3* y ^Whoever recites Yd Sin in the night, seeking the Face of Allah, will be forgiven 2] In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. H CP***# r >*" * J/t V'ff J/ ^ . < > > , ' , { Tj ' . *| f 1'- I'l Musnad Abi Ya la, 11 :93. These two narrations are not authentic. As for Ibn Kathir saying that the chain from Abu Hurayrah is good it is narrated by him from Al-Hasan, which is a link that is not verified by the scholars of Hadith. So Ibn Hajar (At-Taqrib) said, Al- Hasan did not hear from Abu Hurayrah. Perhaps Ibn Kathir was of the opinion that it was possible that he did Ibn Hibban 4:121.

168 Tafsir Ibtisam Kathir il. Yd Sin .} 42. By the Qur'an, full of wisdom,} 43. Truly, you are one of the Messengers,} 44. On the straight path.} 45. Sent down by the Almighty, the Most Merciful,} 46. In order that you may warn a people whose forefathers were not warned, so they are heedless 47. Indeed the Word has proved true against most of them, so they will not believe.} The Messenger jg was sent as a Warner We have already discussed the individual letters at the beginning of Surat Al-Baqarah. J-%} 4By the Qur'an, full of wisdom} means, Al-Muhkam (perfect) which falsehood cannot come to from before it or behind it. 4Truly, you} means, O Muhammad, 4are one of the Messengers, on the straight path.} means, following a straight methodology and religion, and an upright Law. 4Sent down by the Almighty, the Most Merciful.} means, this path which you have brought is a revelation from the Lord of might Who is Most Merciful to His believing servants. This is like the Ayah: 4 bj vj1' 4 b A l)j} 4 < f 'A 4And verily, tjou are indeed guiding (mankind) to the straight ' See Surah Fussilat 4 1 :42

Yd Sin (8 - 12) (Part-22) path . The path of Allah to Whom belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is on the earth . Verily, to Allah all matters return .} (42:52-53). In order that you may warn a people whose forefathers were not warned, so they are heedless.} This refers to the Arabs, for no Warner had come to them before him. The fact that they alone are mentioned does not mean that others are

excluded, just as mentioning some individuals does not mean that all others are excluded. We have already mentioned the Ayat and Mutawatir Hadiths which state that the mission of the Prophet is universal, when we discussed the meaning of the Ayah us r-lill 4Say: "O mankind! Verily, I am sent to you all as the Messenger of Allah." (7:158). Indeed the Word has proved true against most of them,} Ibn Jarir said, The punishment has become inevitable for most of them, because Allah has decreed in the Mother of the Book (Al-Lawh Al-Mahfu\$ that they will not believe. V& iso they will not believe.} in Allah, or in His Messengers. 11 (*+* tjteivl ,, J) iil ^ (Lr &[] t A > * >< . ,rr - - ,<^ji s' Jyj 't'itrfe. J (*-4-* s~Y&~ 'a < ;' "" '--if '> ^,r "-r - > *. s > Jl/-***i 'r~eih j-'V ,> *? . "I 'it -s'.i" " i*!r *>. " ? 18. Verily, We have put on their necks iron collars reaching to the chins, so that their heads are raised up.} 19. And We have put a barrier before them, and a barrier At-Tabari 20 :492

behind them, and We have covered them up, so that they cannot see. 410. It is the same to them whether you warn them or you warn than not, they will not believe. 411- You can only warn him who follows the Reminder, and fears the Most Gracious unseen . Bear you to such one the glad tidings offorgiveness, and a generous reward.4 412. Verily, We give life to the dead, and We record that which they send before (than), and their traces and all things We have recorded with numbers in Imam Mubin (a Clear Book). The State of Those Who are decreed to be among the Doomed Allah says: In the case of those who are decreed to be among the doomed, when it comes to the matter of being guided, We have made them like a person who has a chain around his neck and whose hands are tied together beneath his chin so that his head is lifted up. As Allah says: ioJ^S) iso that their heads are raised up.} Mentioning the chains around the neck is sufficient and there is no need to mention the hands, although they are referred to by implication. Al- Awfi said, narrating from Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, concerning the Ayah: 4Verily, We have put on their necks iron collars reaching to the chins, so that their heads are raised up. This is like the Ayah til 4And let not your hand be tied (like a miser) to your neck4(17:29). meaning that their hands are tied to their necks and they cannot stretch them forth in order to do any good deedsJ m At-Tabari 20 :494

iso that their heads are raised up.} according to Mujahid it means their heads are raised, and their hands are placed over their mouths,111 so they are restrained from doing anything good. St iAnd We have put a barrier before than,} Mujahid said, Between them and the truth. iand a barrier behind than,} Mujahid said, Between them and the truth, so they are confused. 121 Qatadah said, They move from one form ofmisguidance to another. iand We have covered than up,} means, *We have blinded their eyes to the truth. iso that they cannot see.} means, they cannot benefit from goodness or be guided to it. Ibn Jarir said, It was narrated from Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, that he used to recite Fa a'shaynahum" [instead ofFa aghshaynahum], from Al-'Asha (weakness of the sight, blindness), which is a complaint of the eye. 141 Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, Allah placed this barrier between them and Islam and Iman, so that they will never reach it, and he recited: iTruly, those, against whom the Word (wrath) of your Lord has been justified, will not believe. Even if every sign should come to them, until they see the painful torment.} (10:96-97). m At-Jabari 20:494. AMabari 20:495. At-Tabari 20:495. Hl At-Jabari 20:496.

sees him except Allah, may He be blessed and exalted, he knows that Allah is watching him and sees what he does. y *' iBearyou to such one theglad tidings offorgiveness,\$ i.e., of his sins, * " s iand a

generous reward.} means, one that is vast and great and beautiful. This is like the Ayah: * > & iVerily, those who fear their Lord unseen, theirs will be forgiveness and a great reward.} (67:12). iVerily, We give life to the dead,} means, on the Day of Resurrection. This also indicates that Allah gives life to the heart of whomever He wills among the disbelievers, those whose hearts have died in misguidance, by guiding them after that to the truth. As Allah says after mentioning hardness of the heart: i&i&Zp2 p% 1 SZ j\$f\ & %2X} iKnow that Allah gives life to the earth after its death! Indeed We have made clear the Ayat to you, that you may understand.} (57 :17) iand We record that which they send before (them),} means, their deeds. iand their traces} means, We write down the deeds which they used to do themselves, and. the legacy they left behind, so We will requite them for that: if it is good, then We will reward them, and if it is evil, then We will punish them. This is like the Hadith: Ir! i'tZ Ir! '4: J** j^ Cf! 'j' fA

: f ,Lr- 0- JI Ji i4*! ir! Jy^ jjjj VV/ioeuer starts (or sets an example of) something good in Islam, will have a reward for it, and a reward equal to that of everyone who does it after him, without that detracting from their reward in the slightest. \Nhoeuer starts (or sets an example of) something evil in Islam, will bear the burden for that, and a burden equal to that of everyone who does it after him, without that detracting from their burden in the slightest. This was recorded by

2 C op' Pi i5i> 4Verily, We give life to the dead, and We record that which they send before (them), and their traces What they left behind of misguidance. Ibn Abi Najih and others said, narrating from Mujahid: ithat which they send before (them),} Their deeds. iand their traces}. He said, Their footsteps. 111 This was also the view of Al-Hasan and Qatadah. iand their traces} means their footsteps. 121 Qatadah said, If Allah were to have neglected anything with regard to you, O son of Adam, He would have neglected what the wind could remove of these footsteps. * But He takes into account the footsteps of the son of Adam and all his deeds; He even takes into account these footsteps and whether they are for the purpose of obeying Allah or disobeying Him. So, whoever can have his footsteps recorded for the purpose of obeying Allah, let him do that. Imam

(J& disj !ia_ ^ u;" 0 Barn/ Salamah, stay where you are, and your footsteps will be recorded, stay where you are, and your footsteps will be recordedy] This was also recorded by

Jr U\ z&m' Si Gjyi_isyjLiili^L" _to)JjSo il Ijl^rUoLjyy 0<^ - ^T0 W(i?ilj^ csiljlx.1 0jJS4% -Aaf-t* > '.^ i . <"&, i ,<' ,1(' , rfS>" > - j-s\$ more likely to be recorded. And Allah knows best. M ti iand all things We have recorded with numbers (as a record) in Imam Mubin (a Clear Book).} means, everything that exists is precisely dictated in a record in Al-Lawh Al-Mahfuz. Al-Imam Al-Mubin here refers to the source of all records. This was the view of Mujahid, Qatadah and Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam.l * Similarly, Allah also says: & 3^=* (Ji i(And remember) the Day when We shall call together all human beings with their (respective) Imam (record of good and bad deeds)} (17:71). meaning the Book of their deeds which will testify as to their deeds, whether they were good or bad. This is like the Ayat y \ \jefi} iand the Book will be placed (open), and the Prophets and the witnesses will be brought forward} (39:69), and Ua i)U \il^i ({/i *?of}Tabari 20 :499

178 Tafslr Ibn Kathir 4 ML* V> jjL*- IfUaa-1 V) ijff V, Ujj Je iAnd the Book (one's Record) will be placed, and you will see the criminals, fearful of that which is (recorded) therein. They will say : "Woe

to us! What sort of Book is this that leaves neither a small thing nor a big thing, but has recorded it with numbers! And they will find all that they did, placed before them, and your Lord treats no one with injustice.} (18:49). L-ajfiSo Ojff UL.JI jjr" U"U- 3) A fi ^ir^ij} " \$ Ej vip z ijii p&i \ 5uS cfjii, ip giT VI c; VI 1 4 * ^'x'oa-D' . And putforward to them a similitude; the Dwellers of the Town, when there came Messengers to them.} 414. When We sent to them two Messengers, they denied them both; so We reinforced them with a third, and they said: "Verily, we have been sent to you as Messengers."} 415. They said: "You are only human beings like ourselves, and the Most Gracious has revealed nothing. You are only telling lies."} 416. The Messengers said: "Our Lord knows that we have been sent as Messengers to you,"} 417. "And our duty is only to convey plainly."}

The Story of the Dwellers of the Town and Their

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 4765–4816]

Messengers, a Lesson that Those Who belied Their Messengers were destroyed Allah says, O Muhammad, tell your people who disbelieve in you, 4&.p 3i i\$& } 4a similitude; the Dwellers of the Town, when there came Messengers to them.} In the reports that he transmitted from Ibn Abbas, Ka*b Al- Ahbar and Wahb bin Munabbih - Ibn Ishaq reported that it was the city of Antioch, in which there was a king called

Antiochus the son of Antiochus the son of Antiochus, who used to worship idols. Allah sent to him three Messengers, whose names were Sadiq, Saduq and Shalum, and he disbelieved in them. It was also narrated from Buraydah bin Al-Husayb, Ikrimah, Qatadah and Az-Zuhri that it was Antioch. 121 Some of the Imams were not sure that it was Antioch, as we shall see below after telling the rest of the story, if Allah wills. 4zijS&&\$ny& 4When We sent to them two Messengers, they denied them both;} means, they hastened to disbelieve in them. 4so We reinforced them with a third,} means, *We supported and strengthened them with a third Messenger. Ibn Jurayj narrated from Wahb bin Sulayman, from Shu'ayb Al-Jaba i, The names of the first two Messengers were Sham an and Yuhanna, and the name of the third was Bulus, and the city was Antioch (Antakiyah). iand they said} means, to the people of that city, 4Verily, we have been sent to you as Messengers.} meaning, from your Lord Who created you and Who commands you to worship Him Alone with no partners or associates. This was the view of Abu Al- Aliyah. Qatadah bin Di'amah claimed that they were messengers of the Messiah, peace be upon him, sent to the people of Antioch. % VJ Z>" iThey said: You are only human beings like ourselves..."} means, so how could you receive revelation when you areTabari 20:500.Tabari 20:500.

lying, He would have taken the utmost vengeance against us, but He will cause us to prevail and will make us victorious against you, and you will come to know whose will be the happy end in the Hereafter. This is like the Ayah: l *'" J Si - 'S "J' (*-* jilj ==") 4Say: Sufficient is Allah for a witness between me and you. He btows what is in the heavens and on earth." And those who believe in falsehood, and disbelieve in Allah, it is they who are the losers .} (29:52) IS Uj> 4And our duty is only to convey plainly.} means, all we have to do is to convey to you the Message with which we have been sent; if you obey, then happiness will be yours in this world and the Hereafter, and if you do not respond, you will soon know the consequences of that. And Allah knows best. *. **? ? >' t Tt<-" 418. They (people) said : For us, we see an evil omen from you ; if you cease not, we will surely stone you,

and a painful torment will touch you from us."} 419. They (Messengers) said: Your evil omens be with you! Because you are admonished? Nay, but you are a people mischievous."} Then the people of the city said to them, 4For us, we see an evil omen from you;} meaning, *we do not see in your faces any sign of good for our lives. Qatadah said, They were saying, if something bad befalls us, it will be because of you. ,l) Mujahid said, They were saying: People like you never enter a town, but its people are punished. m At-Tabari 20 :502

<& 4'/ you cease not, we will surely stone you,} Qatadah said, By throwing stones at you. 111 ifr it: iand a painful torment will touch you from us.} means, a severe punishment. Their Messengers said to them: \$Your evil omens be with you!} meaning, they are thrown back at you. This is like the Ayah where Allah describes the people of Firawn: Vt ,11: *- *l U ijlii a;'X\ Hj.ll liji}i' is 4Bwf whenever good came to them, they said: "Ours is this." And if evil afflicted them, they ascribed it to evil omens connected with Musa and those with him. Be informed! Verily, their evil omens are with Allah (7:131). And the people of Salih said: 4' i* JS 4We augur ill omen from you and those with you. He said: Your ill omen is with Allah."} (27:47) And Allah said: : V " *>. > \ J* bt (^ Oi^ ^ ^ *>/ i 4A"d i/ some good reaches them, they say, "This is from Allah," but if some evil befalls them, they say, "This is from you." Say: "All things are from Allah," so what is wrong with these people that they fail to understand any word?} (4:78) 4oArli (J j? 0\$) i(Do you call it "evil omen") because you are admonished? At-Tabari 20 :502

Nay, but you are a people mischievous.} means, because of us, because we admonished you and told you to worship Allah Alone and with all sincerity, and in return you said what you said and threatened us. Nay, but you are a mischievous people. Qatadah said, This means, Because we reminded you about Allah, you saw an evil omen in us. Nay, but you are a mischievous people . Ot lai L\$jjl -Ufrl V t Kk " i <* i T "*" >*"h > . */ 1 1" X-*> V _r^" 6^y o[4 i! jiu 420. And there came a man running from the farthest part of the town. He said, O my people! Obey the Messengers."} 421 . "Obey those who ask no wages of you, and who are rightly guided."} 422. "And why should I not worship Him Who has created me and to Whom you shall be returned."} 423. "Shall I take besides Him gods? If the Most Gracious intends me any harm, their intercession will be of no use for me whatsoever, nor can they save me."} 424. "Then verily, I should be in plain error."} 425. "Verily, I have believed in your Lord, so listen to me! } Quoting what reached him from Ibn Abbas, Ka*b Al-Ahbar and Wahb bin Munabbih - Ibn Ishaq reported that, The people of the city resolved to kill their Messengers, then a man came running to them from the farthest part of the town, i.e., to help them against his people. They said, his name was Habib, and he used to work with ropes. He was a sickly man who suffered from leprosy, and he was very charitable, giving half of his earnings in charity, and his Fitrah (natural inclination) was sound. * Shabib bin Bishr said, narrating from Ikrimah, from Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, that the name of the man mentioned in Yd Sin was Habib An-Najjar, At-Tabari 20:504. 2| At-Tabari 20:504.

and he was killed by his people. faj iHe said: O my people 1 . Obey the Messengers > - he urged his people to follow the Messengers who had come to them. 40 & v * \Jt) iObey those who ask no wages of you,) means, For the Message which they convey to you, and they are rightly-guided in what they are calling you to, the worship of Allah Alone with no partner or associate. 4SJ& ilcl v 3, 4And why should I not worship Him Who has created me) means, and what is there to stop me from sincerely

worshipping the One Who has created me, and worshipping Him Alone, with no partner or associate? and to Whom you shall be returned.) means, on the Day of Resurrection, when He will requite you for your deeds: if they are good then you will be rewarded and if they are evil then you will be punished. 4*^f at 4 Shall I take besides Him gods?) This is a rhetorical question intended to rebuke and chastise. j . > . . * ./x -ri Ur" ^ ji. CjIJ, If the Most Gracious intends me any harm, their intercession will be of no use for me whatsoever, nor can they save me.) means, These gods whom you worship instead of Him possess no power whatsoever, if Allah wills me some harm, 4% VJ. /<! %) 4none can remove it but He) (6:17). These idols can neither cause any harm nor bring any benefit, and they cannot save me from the predicament I am in.

iThen verily, I should be in plain error.^ means, if I were to take them as gods instead of Allah. iVerily, I have believed in your Lord, so listen to me!} Ibn Ishaq said, quoting from what had reached him from Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, Ka*b and Wahb, He said to his people: i'Veerily, I have believed in your Lord} in Whom you have disbelieved, iso listen to me!} means, listen to what I say. 111 Or it may be that he was addressing the Messengers when he said: rIAI^ iVerily, I have believed in your Lord,} meaning, Who has sent you, iso listen to me!} meaning, *bear witness to that before Him. This was narrated by Ibn Jarir, who said, And others said that this was addressed to the Messengers, and he said to them: *Listen to what I say and bear witness to what I say before my Lord, that I have believed in your Lord and have followed you. This interpretation is more apparent, and Allah knows best. Ibn Ishaq said, quoting from what had reached him from Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, Ka*b and Wahb, When he said that, they turned on him as one, and killed him at once, and he had no one to protect him from that. 121 Qatadah said, They started to stone him while he was saying, O Allah, guide my people for they do not know, and they kept stoning him until he died a violent death, and he was still praying for At-Jabari 20:507. At-Tabari 20:508.

them. May Allah have mercy on him. > 2# djfr , *I" Uj J Uj tj oj^ ui ;:***" Jt *Ay" Uj 4#4^ S' Uj .13? 3; |^t ^j Is aJ^j 4*^,^,^ . " 1 -i > ' * 'T 4,^,JJ.U1*. 426 . It was said: Enter Paradise. He said: "Would that my people knew."} 427 . That my Lord (Allah) has forgiven me, and made me of the honored ones!"} 428. And We sent not against his people after him an army from the heaven, nor was it need- ful for Us to said (such a thing).} 429. It was but one Sayhah and lo! they (all) were still.} Muhammad bin Ishaq reported from some of his companions from Ibn Mas'ud, may Allah be pleased with him, that they stamped on him until his intestines came out of his back passage. Allah said to him: 4%l i Enter Paradise."} so he entered it with all its bountiful provision, when Allah had taken away from him all the sickness, grief and exhaustion of this world. 2) Mujahid said, It Tabari 20:501. Tabari 20 :508

was said to Habib An-Najjar, Enter Paradise. This was his right, for he had been killed. When he saw the reward, 4He said: "Would that my people knew Qatadah said, You will never find a believer but he is sincere and is never insincere. When he saw with his own eyes how Allah had honored him, he said: ot > J jj* "/j 4He said: "Would that my people knew that my Lord has forgiven me, and made me of the honored ones!"} He wished that his people could know about what he was seeing with his own eyes of the honor of Allah. 12 * Ibn Abbas said, He was sincere towards his people during his lifetime by saying, 40 my people! Obey the Messengers} , and after his death by saying: iWould that my people knew that my Lord (Allah) has forgiven me, and made me of the honored ones!} This was recorded by

Ibn Abi Hatim. Sufyan Ath-Thawri narrated from Asim Al-Ahwal from Abu Mijlaz: 4 j ju- &} 4That my Lord has forgiven me, and made me of the honored ones!} Because of my faith in my Lord and my belief in the Messengers. He meant that if they could see the great reward and everlasting blessings that he had attained, this would lead them to follow the Messengers. May Allah have mercy on him and be pleased with him, for he was so keen that his people should be guided. ^ iLJi cy, j* i} At-Tabari 20:509. At-Tabari 20 :509

people sifter they killed him, ilt was but one Sayhah and lo! they (all) were still} Ibn Jarir said, The former view is more correct, because the Message does not need to be brought by an army. * The scholars of Tafsir said, Allah sent Jibril, peace be upon him, to them, and he seized the pillars at the gate of their city, then he hurled one Sayhah upon them and lo! they (all) were still, to the last man among them, and no soul was left in any body. We have already referred to the reports from many of the Salaf that this city was Antioch, and that these three Messengers were messengers sent from the Messiah Isa bin Maryam, peace be upon him, as Qatadah and others stated. This is not mentioned by any of the later scholars of Tafsir besides him, and this issue must be examined from a number of angles. (The first) is that if we take this story at face value, it indicates that these men were Messengers from Allah, may He be glorified, not from the Messiah, peace be upon him, as Allah says: iWhen We sent to them two Messengers, they denied them both; so We reinforced them with a third, and they said: "Verily, we have been sent to you as Messengers. } up to: gif% Cj ipjt# &} i"Our Lord knows that we luroe been sent as Messengers to you. And our duty is only to convey plainly (the Message)."} If they had been from among the Disciples, they would have said something to indicate that they had come from the Messiah, peace be upon him. And Allah knows best. Moreover, if they had been messengers sent by the Messiah, why would the people have said to them, Hi}Tabari 20:510.Tabari 20:511.

190 Tafstr Ibn Kathir i"You are only human beings like ourselves"^(The second) is that the people of Antioch did believe in the messengers sent by the Messiah to them. Antioch was the first city to believe in the Messiah, and it is one of the four cities in which there are Christian patriarchs. These cities are: Jerusalem, because it is the city of the Messiah; Antioch, because it was the first city where all of the people believed in the Messiah; Alexandria, because it was in that city that they agreed to reform the hierarchy of patriarchs, metropolitans (archbishops), bishops, priests, deacons and monks; and Rome, because it is the city of the Emperor Constantine who supported and helped to establish their religion. When he adopted Constantinople as his city, the Patriarch of Rome moved there, as has been mentioned by several historian, such as Said bin Batrfq and others, both People of the Book and Muslims. If we accept that, then the people of Antioch were the first to believe, but Allah tells us that the people of this town rejected His Messengers and that He destroyed them with one Sayhah and lo! they (all) were still. And Allah knows best. (The third) is that the story of Antioch and the Disciples of the Messiah happened after the Tawrah had been revealed. Abu Said Al-Khudri, may Allah be pleased with him, and others among the Salaf stated that after revealing the Tawrah, Allah, may He be blessed and exalted, did not destroy an entire nation by sending a punishment upon them. Rather, He commanded the believers to fight the idolators. They mentioned this when discussing the Ayah: iAtid indeed We gave Musa - after We had destroyed the generations ofold - the Scripture (28:43). This implies that the city mentioned in the Qur an is a city other than Antioch, as also stated by more than one of the Salaf. Or, ifwe wish to keep the same name, it is possible that it is another Antioch, not the one which is well-

known, for it is not known that it (the famous Antioch) was destroyed, either during Christian times or before. And Allah knows best. && 'J iVi\$.aj \j& V] Jjij ^ JUAM

A*- 3 .X ^ (*t^j j2\$ <\$30. A/as /or mankind! There never came a Messenger to them but they used to mock at him.} 431. Do they not see how many of the generations We have destroyed before than? Verily, they will not return to them.} 432. And surely, all - everyone of them will be brought before Us.} Woe to the Disbelievers! Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas commented on the Ayah: 4Alas for mankind!}, this means, woe to mankind! 1 Qatadah said: 4Alas for mankind!} means, Alas for mankind, who have neglected the command of Allah. 12 The meaning is that they will feel regret and sorrow on the Day of Resurrection. When they see the punishment with their own eyes; they will regret how they disbelieved the Messengers of Allah and went against the commands of Allah, for they used to disbelieve in them in this world. o' 4There never came a Messenger to them but they used to mock at him.} means, they disbelieved him and made fun of him, and rejected the message of truth with which he had been sent. The Refutation of the Belief in the Transmigration of Souls Then Allah says: (4S&&S -M At-Tabari 20:512.Tabari 20:512.

433. And a sign for them is the dead land. We give it life, and We bring forth from it grains, so that they eat thereof.} 434. And We have made therein gardens of date palms and grapes, and We have caused springs of water to gush forth therein .} 435. So that they may eat of the fruit thereof- and their hands made it not. Will they not then give thanks?} 436. Glory be to Him Who has created all the pairs of that which the earth produces, as well as of their own kind, and of that which they know not.} Proof of the Creator of the Universe and of Life after Death Allah, may He be glorified and exalted, says: 4And a sign for them} means, evidence for them of the existence of the Creator and His perfect power and ability to resurrect the dead, 4/s the dead land.} means, when it is dead and arid, with no vegetation, then Allah sends water upon it, it is stirred (to life), and it swells and puts forth every lovely kind (of growth). Allah says: 4#*-fc 4We give it life, and We bring forth from it grains, so that they eat thereof.} meaning, We have made it a provision for them and their cattle. iin' O ..Ik It 1 . 4And We have made therein gardetts of date palms and grapes, and We have caused springs ofwater to gush forth therein.} means, *We have created therein rivers which flow to the places where they are needed, so that they may eat of their fruits. When Allah reminds them of the blessing that He bestows upon His creation by creating crops and plants, He

mentions the different types and kinds of fruits. Allah says: 4^j? iiL* j} iand their hands made it not.} means, all of that could only come about by the mercy of Allah towards them, not by their own efforts and labor and strength. This was the view of Ibn 'Abbas and Qatadah. Allah says: iWitl they not then give thanks?} meaning, will they not then give thanks for the innumerable blessings that He has bestowed upon them. Ibn Jarir, however, understood the word Ma to mean Alladhi (i.e., a relative pronoun). In this case the meaning of the Ayah would be that they eat from the fruits provided by Allah s bounty and from what their own hands have done, i.e., by planting the seeds and tending the plants. Ibn Jarir mentioned other possible interpretations in his Tafsir, but this is the interpretation that he favored. This interpretation also fits with the recitation of Ibn Mas'ud: ^J J (So that they may eat of the fruit thereof- andfrom what their own hands have done.) Then Allah says: 4 U-j ulfe yU- cfjif if} iGlory he to Him Who has created all the pairs of that which the earth produces,} meaning, of crops and fruits

and plants. if+jd If,}ias well as of their own (human) kind,} means, He made them into male and female. iand of that which they know not.} means, different kinds of creatures ofwhich they know nothing. This is like the Ayah: ffXb rJL) Lili J^==" oi

{And of everything We have created pairs, that you may remember (51:49) V Jj' yfj^ eft? Sf\$% & c5 'Q" g u^> 437. And sign /or them is the night. We withdraw therefrom the day, and behold, they are in darkness.) 438. And the sun runs on its fixed course for a term (appointed). That is the decree of the Almighty, the All- Knowing.. And the moon, We have decreed for it stages, till it returns like the old dried curved date stalk. 440. It is not for the sun to overtake the moon, nor does the night outstrip the day. They all float, each in an orbit.) Amongthe Signs ofthe MightandPowerofAllah arethe Night and Day, and the Sun andMoon Allah tells us of further proof of His great might and power, which is His creation of the night and day, the one with its darkness and the other with its light. He has caused them to follow one another, so that one comes and the other goes, and so on, as He says: 4He brings the night as a cover over the day, seeking it rapidly (7:54). Allah says here: 4And a sign for them is the night. We withdraw therefrom the day,) meaning, *We take it away from it, so it goes away and the night comes. Allah says: pi iand behold, they are in darkness .) As it says in the Hadlth:

iii JI I Ilf* 'y" j[} \ jzVj t ll^A y* Jill Jjt til " ilA/hen the night comes from here, and the day departs from here, and the sun has set, then the fasting person should break his fast . This is the apparent meaning of the AyahJ Allah s saying: LiO'j s',J iAnd the sun runs on its fixed course for a term (appointed). That is the decree of the Almighty, the All-Knowing There are two views over the meaning of the phrase ion its fixed course for a tern (appointed).} (The first view) is that it refers to its fixed course of location, which is beneath the Throne, beyond the earth in that direction. Wherever it goes, it is beneath the Throne, it and all of creation, because the Throne is the roof of creation and it is not a sphere as many astronomers claim. Rather it is a dome supported by legs or pillars, carried by the angels, and it is above the universe, above the heads of people. When the sun is at its zenith at noon, it is in its closest position to Throne, and when it runs in its fourth orbit at the opposite point to its zenith, at midnight, it is in its furthest position from the Throne. At that point it prostrates and asks for permission to rise, as mentioned in the Hadiths.

Yd Sin (37 - 40) (Part-23 alt goes and prostrates beneath the Throne, and that is what Alldh says : iAnd the sun runs on its fixed course for a term That is the decree of the Almighty, the All-Knowing It was also reported that Abu Dharr, may Allah be pleased with him, said, I asked the Messenger of Allah jg about the Ayah iAnd the sun runs on itsfixed coursefor a term.} He said: altsfixed course is beneath the Throne.s 12 (The second view) is that this refers to when the sun s appointed time comes to an end, which will be on the Day of Resurrection, when its fixed course will be abolished, it will come to a halt and it will be rolled up. This world will come to an end, and that will be the end of its appointed time. This is the fixed course of its time. Qatadah said: ion its fixed course for a term (appointed).} means, It has an appointed time and it will not go beyond that. It was also said that this means, it keeps moving in its summer orbit for a certain time, and it does not exceed that, then it moves to its winter orbit for a certain time, and it does not exceed that. This was narrated from Abdullah bin Amr, may Allah be pleased with him. Ibn Mas'ud and Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with them, recited this Ayah as: 0"J (And the sun runs with no fixed course for a term,) meaning that it has no destination and it does not

settle in one place, rather it keeps moving night and day, never slowing down or stopping, as in the Ayah: Al-Bari 8 :402Al-Bari 8:402. Al-Tabari 20:517.

198 Tafslr Ibn Kathir ^OHp He has made the sun and the moon, both constantly pursuing their courses, to be ofservice to you} (14:33). which means, they will never slow down or stop, until the Day of Resurrection. ijffo jy iThat is the decree of the Almighty, means, which none oppose or prevent. can ithe All-Knowing Who knows every movement and every cessation ofmovement, Who has decreed that and Who has set it in motion following a pattern in which there are no differences or inversions, as Allah says: i(He is the) Cleaver of the daybreak. He has appointed the night for resting, and the sun and the moon for reckoning. Such is the measuring of the Almighty, the All-Knowing (6:96) And this is how this Ayah ends: jrjfoi JXU iThat is the decree of the Almighty, the All-Knowing> Then Allah says: iJjC isa iAnd the moon, We have decreedfor it stages, meaning, *We have caused it to run in a different orbit, from which passing of the months can be deduced, just as night and day are known from the sun. This is like the Ayah: Jl 3* yfr iThey ask you about the crescent moons. Say: "These are signs to markfixed periods of timefor mankind andfor the pilgrimage (Hajj)."i[2:189), ffix, faf.% rcj j-m " ilt is He Who made the sun a shining thing and the moon as a

light and measured out for it stages that you might know the number ofyears and the reckoning> (10:5), and ,ji -L " Ajl* llLur} ,1 / rj> / * / >> / / t. / ?< / / * / // > "/. .V.i iAnd We have appointed the night and the day as tivo Ayat (signs). Then, We have obliterated the sign of the night while We have made the sign of the day illuminating, that you may seek bounty from your Lord, and that you may know the number of the years and the reckoning. And We have explained everything with full explanation .\$(17:12) So, He has given the sun its own light, and the moon its (reflection of) light, and has given each its own orbit. So the sun rises each day and sets at the end of the day, giving one kind of light all the time, but it moves, rising and setting at different points in the summer and winter, thus making the days and nights longer or shorter alternatively according to the season. Its authority is in the daytime, for it is the heavenly body that dominates the day. As for the moon, Allah has decreed that it should pass through different phases. At the beginning of the month, the moon appears small when it rises. It gives off little light, then on the second night its light increases and it rises to a higher position, and the higher it rises the more light it gives - even though it is reflected from the sun - until it becomes full on the fourteenth night of the month. Then it starts to wane until the end of the month, until it appears like the old dried curved date stalk. Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, This is the original stem (which connects the bunch of dates to the tree). 111 The Arabs have a name for each set of three nights in a month, according to the phases of the moon. They call the first three nights Ghurar, the next three nights Nufab, the next three nights Tusa' (nine) - because the last of them is the ninth. The next three nights are called Ushar (ten) - because the first of them is the tenth. The next three nights are called Al-Bld (white) - because of the light of the moon which shines U1 At-Tabari 20 :518

200 Tafslr Ibn Kathtr brightly throughout these three nights. The next three nights are called Dura , the plural of Dar a , because on the first of them the night is dark from the moon rising late. Dar'a refers to the black sheep, i.e., the one whose head is black; the next three nights Zulam; then Hanadis, then Da adv, then Mihdq, because of the absence of moonlight at the beginning of the month. Abu TJbayd did not recognize the names 'Tusa' and Ushar, in the book Gharxb Al-Musannaf. ij^ iJ 1 li J.l * ! ' ilt is

not for the sun to overtake the moon,) Mujahid said, Each of them has a limit which it does not transgress or fall short of. When the time of one comes, the other goes away, and when the time for one to prevail comes, the time of the other ceases. Ikrimah said concerning the Ayah, ﴿U ilt is not for the sun to overtake the moon,﴾ this means that each of them has its time when it prevails. So it is not appropriate for the sun to rise at night. ﴿Inor does the night outstrip the day﴾ means, after night has passed, it is not right for another night to come until it has been day. The authority of the sun is during the day and the authority of the moon is at night. Ad-Dahhak said, The night does not depart from here until the day comes from here - and he pointed to the east. 21 Mujahid said: ﴿ij& Sf\$ inor does the night outstrip the day.﴾ They seek one another rapidly. The meaning is that there is no gap between night and day; each of them follows the other with no interval, because they have been subjugated and are both constantly pursuing one another. At-Tabari 20:520. At-Tabari 20:520. At-Tabari 20:519.

J tisfes tir '***.* riv // S s* +>* ***"+ s /4Sv / *+ + % 1jJ__jtjp ;C !3 itr-*^=sacjjJ'(pjiJJ1 ^ ^ . * > > " * ? ' * r ^ \ K " ^ - f / j . / ' " / Mif ^ i / A | - A " - u 0 4 ^ L : 4 * : r H ^ a A) / ^ / * * ^ Op - " . i . T - i They all float, each in an orbit.} means, night and day, the sun and the moon, all of them are floating, i.e., revolving, in their orbits in the heaven. This was the view of Ibn Abbas, Ikrimah, Ad-Dahhak, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and Ata Al- Khurasani. Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, and others among the Salaf said, In an orbit like the arc of a spinning wheel. 4 a p. Iff} fi bi > yj&fi ^ ub ,? > oy~ty_ l- ot T"S*\$es dt 441 . And an Ayah for them is that We bore their offspring in the laden ship.} 442 . And We have created for them of the like thereunto, on which they ride.} 443. And if We will, We shall drown them, and there will be no shout for them, nor will they be saved.} -. Unless it be a mercy from Us, and as an enjoyment for a while.} hi At-Jabari 20 :520

refers to? We said, No. He said, This refers to the ships which were made after the ship of Nuh, peace be upon him, which was similar to it. ' This was also the view of Abu Malik, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah, Abu Salih and As-Suddi, that the Ayah oi tdl-j} iAnd We have created for them of the like thereunto, on which they ride.} refers to ships. 12 ' iAnd if We will. We shall drown them,} means, those who are on board the ships. iand there will be no shout for them} means, there will be no one to save them from their predicament. 'Jj} inor will they be saved.} means, from what has befallen them. it illnless it be a mercy from Us,} means, *but by Our mercy We make it easy for you to travel on land and sea, and We keep you safe until an appointed time. Allah says: iand as an enjoyment for a while.} meaning, until a time that is known to Allah, may He be glorified and exalted. i45 . And when it is sdid to them : "Beware of that which is before you, and that which is behind you, in order that you may receive mercy."} 111 AMabari 20:523. At-Tabari 20:522-524.

204 Tafsir Ibn Kathlr 446. And never came an Ayah from among the Ayat of their Lord to them, but they did turn away from it.} 447 . And when it is said to them: "Spend of that with which Allah has provided you," those who disbelieve say to those who believe: "Shall we feed those whom, if Allah willed, He would have fed? You are only in a plain error."} The Misguidance of the Idolators Allah tells us how the idolators persisted in their misguidance and in not paying attention to the sins that they had committed in the past or what was to happen to them in the future, on the Day of Resurrection. Ltf J}| U iyjt |vi Si 4And when it is said to them : "Fear of that which is before you, and that which is behind you..."} Mujahid said, This refers to sins. Others said it is the opposite. 4&&} iin order that you may receive

mercy.} means, so that, if you fear such things Allah will have mercy on you and will save you from His punishment. The wording implies that they would not respond. Rather that they would turn away and ignore that, as Allah says: 4And never came an Ayah from among the Ayat of their Lord to them,} meaning, signs of Tawhid and the truth of the Messengers, 4but they did turn away from it,} means, they did not accept it or benefit from it. lit 'fr Si 4And when it is said to them : "Spend of that with which Allah has provided you, } means, when they are told to spend of that which Allah has provided to them on the poor and needy among the Muslims,

cJi iM ju4 it those who disbelieve say to those who believe means, about the believers who are poor, i.e., they say to those believers who tell them to spend on the needy, ii' iui ji ^\$} i Shall we feed those whom, if Allah willed, He (Himself) would have fed?} meaning, those whom you are telling us to spend on, if Allah had wanted to, He would have made them independent and fed them from His provision, so we are in accordance with the will of Allah with regard to them. 4You are only in a plain error.} means, *by telling us to do that. { ' C -C' ' v?i f ^ i' / . *-u t'S // " \ Y. p-*) ii ^ . W13 CA>-J 1* ;^ Oft. "k'Jr' 448. And they say: "When will this promise be fulfilled, if you are truthful?"} 449. They await only but a single Sayhah which will seize them while they are disputing!} 450. Then they will not be able to make bequest, nor they will return to their family.} The Disbelievers thought that the Day of Resurrection would never come to pass Allah tells us how the disbelievers thought that the Day of Resurrection would never come to pass, as they said: 4)2\$.} 4 "When will this promise be fulfilled ... } ^ i Those who believe not therein seek to hasten it} (42:18). Allah says: ('A) -U-b aJ^j 1

454. This Day, none will be wronged in anything, nor will you be requited anything except that which you used to do. The Trumpet Blast of the Resurrection This will be the third blast of the trumpet ^ ' the trumpet blast of the resurrection when people will come forth from their graves. Allah says: 4^>^i frej d[vWV i 4and behold from the graves they will come out quickly to their Lord. Yansilun means they will be walking quickly. This is like the Ayah: C > > J) 4The Day when they will come out of the graves quickly as racing to a goal. (70:43). iW 4They will say: Woe to us! Who has raised us up from our place of sleep."} meaning, their graves, which in this world they thought they would never be raised from. When they see with their own eyes that in which they had disbelieved, 4 iii b " l> 4They will say: Woe to us! Who has raised us up from our place of sleep This does not contradict the fact that they will be punished in their graves, because in comparison to what is to come afterwards, that will seem like a nap. Ubayy bin Ka*b, may Allah be pleased with him, Mujahid, Al-Hasan and Qatadah said, They will sleep before the Resurrection. Qatadah See volume seven, the Tafsir of Surat An-Naml [27:87], The reference to the third blast is based upon a narration that is not authentic as explained there At-Tabari 20 :533

457. They will have therein fruits and all that they ask for 458. (It will be said to them) : "Salam (Peace!)" - a Word from the Lord, Most Merciful The Life of the People of Paradise Allah tells us that on the Day of Resurrection, when the people of Paradise have reached the arena of judgement, and have settled in the gardens of Paradise, they will be too preoccupied with their own victory and new life of eternal delights to worry about anyone else. Al-Hasan Al-Basri and Ismail bin Abi Khalid said, They will be too busy to think about the torment which the people of Hell are suffering. Mujahid said:

will be busy with joyful things> With the delights which they are enjoying. 111 This was also the view of Qatadah. Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, This means that they will be rejoicing. iThey and their wives> Mujahid said, Their spouses, iwill be in pleasant shade,) means, in the shade of trees. 121 ireclining on thrones.) Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Muhammad bin Ka b, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, As-Suddi and Khusayf said: ithrone) means beds beneath canopies.131 iThey will have therein fruits) means, of all kinds. 4&% g iand all that they ask for.) means, whatever they ask for, they will find it, all kinds and types. yJ ik& jfet i"Salam (Peace!)" - a Word from the Lord (Allah), Most Merciful.) Ibn Jurayj said, Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, concerning this Ayah, Allah Himself, Who is the Peace (As-Salam) will grant peace to the people of Paradise. This view of Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, is like the Ayah: At-Tabari 20:535. At-Tabari 20:538. At-Tabari 20:539, 540.

4Their greeting on the Day they shall meet Him will be SalSm"} (33:44). fS\ l&M ijJuS J pi ^^ aid jl \$ \$! \$" Lli iji Jj ; J <:,ypj4ju . (It will be said): "And O you the criminals! Get you apart this Day."} . "Did I not command you, O Children of Adam, that you should not worship Shaytan? Verily, he is a plain enemy to you. } . "And that you should worship Me. That is the straight path."} . "And indeed he did lead astray a great multitude of you. Did you not then understand?"} The Isolation of the Disbelievers and Their Rebuke on the Day of Resurrection Allah tells us what the end of the disbelievers will be on the Day of Resurrection, when He commands them to get apart from the believers, i.e., to stand apart from the believers. This is like the Ayat < &rn)8&" 2S ife'A& ' ? <+pat<& 4And the Day whereon We shall gather them all together, then We shall say to those who did set partners in worship with Us : "Stop at your place! You and your partners." Then We shall separate than} (10:28). fja }yj} 4And on the Day when the Hour will be established - that Day shall they be separated.} (30:14) that Day they shall be divided} (30:43) which means, they will be divided into two separate groups. 4 -krt 51 & oj> jj

212 TafsTr Ibn Kathir 4(It will be said to the angels): Assemble those who did wrong, together with their companions and what they used to worship, instead of Allah, and lead them on to the way of flaming Fire (Hell).") (37:22-23). M k [d\ j^1 \$) iDid I not command you, O Children of Adam, that you should not worship Shaytan? Verily, he is a plain enemy to you.) This is a rebuke from Allah to the disbelievers among the sons of Adam, those who obey the Shaytan even though he was a plain enemy to them, and they disobeyed Ar-Rahman Who created them and granted them provision. Allah says: i 'vV'jLiLli Ui Jjxfc.) Jj) iAnd that you should worship Me. That is the straight path.) meaning, I commanded you in the world to disobey the Shaytan, and I commanded you to worship Me, and this is the straight path, but you followed a different path and you followed the commands of the Shaytan. Allah says: 'kf;^ iAnd indeed he did lead astray a great multitude ofyou.) meaning, a large number of people. This was the view of Mujahid, Qatadah, As-Suddi and Sufyan bin TJaynah. t (dify iDid you not then understand?) means, did you not have any understanding, when you went against the command of your Lord to worship Him alone, with no partner or associate, and you preferred to follow the Shaytan? &\$ & h\$ lijU ^) its jfj\$& iX^ #SJ frJWJ & 163. This is Hell which you were promised!) 164. Bum (enter) therein this Day, for that you used to

Yd Sin (63 - 67) (Part-23) disbelieve.} i65. This Day, We shall seal up their mouths, and their hands will speak to Us, and their legs will bear witness to what they used to earn.} 466. And if it had been Our will. We would surely have wiped out their eyes, so that they would struggle for the path, how then would they see?} 467. And if it had been Our will, We could have transformed them in their places. Then they would have been unable to go forward (move about) nor they could have turned back.} On the Day of Resurrection, it will be said to the disbelievers among the sons of Adam, after Hell has been shown to them as a rebuke; and warning: 4This is Hell which you were promised!} meaning, *this is what the Messengers warned you about, and you did not believe them. 4Bum (enter) therein this Day, for that you used to disbelieve}. This is like the Ayah: r 4The Day when they will be pushed down by force to the fire of Hell, with a horrible, forceful pushing. Tins is the Fire which you used to belie. Is this magic or do you not see?} (52:13-15) TheMouths ofthe Disbelievers willbe sealedon theDay ofResurrection 4 'jf-4*-^! 1 (443 -v4> pr.A) 4This Day, We shall seal up their mouths, and their hands will speak to Us, and their legs will bear witness to what they used to earn.} This will be the state of the disbelievers and hypocrites on the Day of Resurrection, when they deny the sins they committed in this world and swear that they did not do that. Allah will

I will not accept any witness against me except from myself.

Your glory, this angel has written down things that I did not do. The angel will say to him, *Did you not do such and such on such a day and in such a place? He will say, No, by Your glory, I did not do that. When he says this, Allah will seal his mouth. Abu Musa Al-Ash'ari, may Allah be pleased with him, said, I think that the first part of his body to speak will be his right thigh. Then he recited: iThis Day, We shall seal up their mouths, and their hands will speak to Us, and their legs will bear witness to what they used to earn} J 1] \$And if it had been Our will. We would surely have wiped out their eyes, so that they would struggle for the path, how then would they see?} Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, explained it: Allah says, If We willed, We could have misguided them all away from true guidance, so how could they be guided? And on one occasion he said, We could have blinded them. 121 Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, If Allah willed, He could have covered their eyes and made them blind, stumbling about. Mujahid, Abu Salih, Qatadah and As-Suddi said, So that they would struggle for the path, i.e., the right way. Ibn Zayd said, The meaning of path here is the truth - *How could they see when We have covered their eyes? Al- Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him said: ihow then would they see?} They would not see the truth. ff} \$And if it had been Our will, We could have transformed them in their places.} [I > At-Tabari 20:544. At-Tabari 20:545. At-Tabari 20:547.

t "i S. C. 1 * -rll < V 'V(**" % =*} 3l -tn O' |*^=vyf iAnd among you there is he who is brought back to the miserable old age, so that he blows nothing after having blown) (22:5). The meaning here - and Allah knows best - is that Allah is telling us that this world is transient and will come to an end, it is not eternal and lasting. Allah says: \$) iWill they not then understand?) meaning, will they not think about how they were created, then they become gray-haired, then they become old and senile, so that they may know that they were created for another world that is not transient and will not pass away, and from which there is no way out, which is the Hereafter. Allah does not teach His Messenger^ Poetry 4\$ Cj Jiili iAnd We have not taught him poetry, nor is it suitable for him.) Allah tells us that He has not

taught His Prophet Muhammad poetry. j) inor is it suitable for him.) means, he did not know how to compose it, he did not like it and he had no natural inclination towards it. It was narrated that he jg never memorized a stanza of poetry with the correct meter or rhyme - he would transpose words or memorize it incompletely. In Ad-Dald il, Al-Bayhaqi recorded that the Messenger of Allah said to Al-Abbas bin Mirdas As-Sulami, may Allah be pleased with him: "Yom are the one who said: "Do you distribute my booty and the booty of the servants between Al-Aqra and 'Uyainah He said, It is TJyainah and Al-Aqra . He jg said:

sit is all the same ." i.e., it means the same thing. 1 1 And Allah knows best. This is because Allah taught him the Qur'an, which oi Jm' Si Vj YA oj ^ ^Falsehood cannot come to it from before it or behind it; sent down by the All-Wise, Worthy of all praise.) (41:42). This is not poetry, as some of the ignorant disbelievers of the Quraysh claimed; neither is it sorcery, a fabrication or a magic spell, as the misguided and ignorant people variously suggested. The Prophet & was naturally disinclined to compose verse, and was forbidden to do so by Divine Law. 4SJ iThis is only a Reminder and a plain Qur'an .) means, it is clear and self-explanatory to the one who ponders and comprehends its meanings, Allah says: dT d iThat he or it may give warning to him who is living,) meaning, so that this plain Qur'an might warn every living person on the face of the earth. This is like the Ayat. 4that I may therewith warn you and whomsoever it may reach] (6:19). YY& ->[>"V' cfj) ibut those of the sects that reject it, the Fire will be their promised meeting place) (11:17). Those who will benefit from his warning will be those whose hearts are alive and who have enlightened insight, as Qatadah said, Alive of heart and alive of insight. 121 Ad-Dahhak said, 111 Dala il An-Nubuwwah 5:181, this was also recorded by Muslim no.Tabari 20:550.

\$ tiSSS tl" This means wise. 111 [jj1 iuj&ji& jjiii ^ o j^ (fiat Word may be i^!j\$ justified against the ' > , ' '<&*> , >.s disbelievers.) -b*;V '--^Vp means, it is a mercy to the believers and _ -T' \ evidence against the Lji o ^ & disbelievers. juLLj^A^llU. tiSii- bi s r# ' *C *<>\ 1 i'.1i""i virri 471. Do they not see y ^ J 54^^ f,wf We have created fir c \\\ diem ofwhat Our Hands spp e fa ion f' the cat- tl^bUallj&y tie, so that they are their 471. Do they not see fpdy^~sdlU^TJjk&...il. c iif^.; them ofwhat Our Hands fBPp e fits tion f- the cat- tl^bUajij&y f/e, so that they are their t. = - I owners .) 472. And We have subdued them unto them so that some of them they havefor riding and some they eat.) 473. And they have (other) benefits from them, and (they get to) drink. Will they not that be grateful?) There is a Sign and a Blessing in Cattle Allah mentions the blessing that He has bestowed upon His creation by subjugating these cattle for their use. 4^& 4so that they are their owners.) Qatadah said, They are their masters. Meaning, He has made them subdue them. So they At-Tabari 20 :550

are submissive towards them and do not resist them; even if a young child comes to a camel he can make it kneel down, and if he wants to, he can make it stand up and can drive it, and it will meekly be led by him. Even if the train consists of a hundred or more camels, they could all be led by a young child. 4some of them they havefor riding and some they eat.} means, some of them they ride on their journeys, and use them to carry their burdens to all regions. 4and some they eat.} means, if they want to, and they slaughter and sacrifice them. }And they have (other) benefitsfrom them,} means, from their wool, fur, and hair, furnishings and articles of convenience, comfort for a time. iand (they get to) drink.} means, their milk, and their urine for thosewho need it as medicine, and so on. io &} iWill they

not then be grateful?} means, will they not worship the Creator and Subduer of that, without showing gratitude to others? A* > u; up i!i }74. And they have taken besides Allah, gods, hoping that they might be helped.} 475. They cannot help them, blit they will be brought forward as a troop (against those who worshipped them).} 476. So, let not their speech then grieve you. Verily, We know what they conceal and what they reveal.}

The gods of the Idolators are not able to help Them Allah denounces the idolators for taking the idols as gods alongside Allah, hoping that those gods will help them and provide for them and bring them closer to Allah. Allah says: iThey cannot help them,) meaning, those gods cannot help their worshippers; they are too weak, too insignificant and too powerless. Rather they cannot even help themselves or take revenge on those who want to harm them, because they are inanimate and can neither hear nor comprehend. Allah s saying: i^CiUU ,) ibut they will be brought forward as a troop.) means, at the time of Reckoning according to the view of Mujahid. 111 This means that those idols will be gathered together and will be present when their worshippers are brought to account, as this will add to their grief and will be more effective in establishing proof against them. Qatadah said: iThey cannot help them,) means the gods. ibut they will be brought forward as a troop.) The idolators used to get angry for the sake of their gods in this world, but they could not do them any benefit or protect them from any harm, for they were merely idols. This was also the view of Al-Hasan Al-Basri. This is a good opinion, and was the view favored by Ibn Jarir, may Allah have mercy on him. Consolation for the Mercy to the Worlds i'U\$ UyZ "&) 4So, let not their speech then grieve you.) means, their denying |l) At-Tabari 20 : 552

you and their disbelief in Allah. 4\$M Cj U p,&} \$Verily, We know what they conceal and what they reveal.} means, We know everything about them, and We will punish them for their false claims and deal with them accordingly on the Day when none of their deeds, great or small, major or minor, will be overlooked, and every deed they did throughout their worldly lives will be laid open for examination. 5U* U vl _>* bji Aik: j* AjSiL. iSl jJ 2\$} j l> fkj JLa JjS laLlil uSjii ji (A) [" !"" ufd ji Jli fSL- aJ TjjJ (> Jju- LfjS' 477. Does not man see that We have created him from Nutfah. Yet behold he (stands forth) as an open opponent.} 478. And he puts forth for Us a parable, and forgets his own creation . He says : Who will give life to these bones after they are rotten and have become dust?"} 479. Say: "He will give life to them Who created them for the first time! And He is the All-Knower of every creation!"} 480. He Who produces for you fire out of the green tree, when behold you kindle therewith.} The Denial of Life after Death, and the Refutation of this Idea Mujahid, Ikrimah, TJrwah bin Az-Zubayr, As-Suddi and Qatadah said, Ubayy bin Khalaf, may Allah curse him, came to the Messenger of Allah ig with a dry bone in his hand, which he was crumbling and scattering in the air, saying, O Muhammad! Are you claiming that Allah will resurrect this? He j ; said: tJVC Sit "Yes, Allah, may He be exalted, will cause you to die, then He will resurrect you and will gather you into the Fire." Then these Ayat at the end of Surah Yd Sin were revealed: 4iu (LSI

Yd Sin (77 - 80) (Part-23 4Does not man see that We have created him from Nutfah.} - until

the end of the Surah. Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him, said, Al-As bin Wa il took a bone from the bed of a valley and crumbled it in his hand, then he said to the Messenger of Allah jg: Will Allah bring this back to life after it has disintegrated? The Messenger of

Allah sg said: Yes, Allah will cause you to die, then He will bring you back to life, then He will make you enter Hell. Then the Ayat at the end of Surah Yd Sin were revealed. This was recorded by Ibn Jarir from Said bin Jubayr.² Whether these Ayat were revealed about Ubayy bin Khalaf or Al- As bin Wa'il, or both of them, they apply to all those who deny the resurrection after death. The definite article Al in 4Does not man (Al-Insan) see...} is generic, applying to all those who deny the Resurrection. liU oi 4that We have created him from Nut/ah. Yet behold he (stands forth) as an open opponent.} means, the one who is denying the resurrection, cannot see that the One Who initiated creation can re-create it. For Allah initiated the creation of man from semen of despised fluid, creating him from something insignificant, weak and despised, as Allah says: - > <: ' v 4Did We not create you from a despised water? Then We placed it in a place of safety, for a known period?} (77:20-22) ilkVerily, We have created man from Nutfah} (76:2). [1 * At-Tabari 20:554. This is a Mursal narration, however, the next narration provides authentic support for the Hadith. At-Tabari 20:554.

of the earth, where they have gone when they disintegrated and dispersed. Imam

means, the One Who initiated the creation of this tree from water, when it has become green and beautiful, bearing fruit, then He changes it until it becomes dry wood with which fires are lit. For He does whatever He wills and He is able to do whatever He wills, and none can stop Him. Qatadah said concerning the Ayah: 54&M AM&p Ar 4He Who produces for you fire out of the green tree, xvhen behold you kindle therewith. this means, the One Who brought forth this fire from this tree is able to resurrect him. It was said that this refers to the Markh tree and the 'Afar tree, which grow in the Hijaz. If one wants to light a fire but has no kindling with him, then he takes two green branches from these trees and rubs one against the other, and fire is produced from them. So they are just like kindling. This was reported from Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him. sM jtij o' & A l&K A Jyk o' z'y .J -i.u 4 AA cop Is not He Who created the heavens and the earth, able to create the like of them? Yes, indeed! He is the All-Knowing Supreme Creator. 482. Verily, His command, when He intends a thing, is only that He says to it, Be!" - and it is!\$ 483. So glorified be He and exalted (above all that they associate with Him), and in Wlwse Hand is the dominion of all things, and to Him you shall be returned Allah points out His great might and power in that He created the seven heavens with all their stars and planets, and the seven earths with everything in them of mountains, sands, oceans and wildernesses, and everything in between. He tells us to find the proof that He will re-create our bodies in His creation of these mighty things. This is like the Ayah: 4o^M A- 0? ofjVfj

Yd Sin (81 - 83) (Part-23) iThe creation of the heavens and the earth is indeed greater than the creation of mankind} (40:57). And Allah says here: its not He IA7jo created the heavens and the earth, able to create the like of them?} meaning, the like of mankind. So, He will re-create them as He created them in the first place. Ibn Jarir said, This Ayah is like the Ayah iDo they not see that Allah, Who created the heavens and the earth, and was not ivearied by their creation, is able to give life to the dead? Yes, He surely is able to do all things.} (46:33) And Allah says here: g \$& 4 T i ,#l 5i jli' 4Yes, indeed! He is the All-Knowing Supreme Creator. Verily, Hjs command, when He intends a thing, is only that He says to it, "Be!"- and it is!} meaning, He only needs to command a thing once; it does not need to be repeated or confirmed. When Allah wants a thing to happen, He only says to it: Be! once, and it is. Imam

t-si:s pstuqv hi uiojj psaq siq pasrej aq uaqyyv sqv,qvx uaAas ui syvuns 3uoj uaAas aq; pa;paj aq pus ;q3iu auo q?nv J JaSuassajM aip q;iM jaXBJd ui poop pres unq iptAV pasojd aq qBjjy Xbui ubuiba-iv uiq qBjXBqpnff ;sq; papjooaj pBUiqv ureuq sjaqjo puBms/v jo sjBioqos aq;jo "uofeui aqi jo uoiuido aq; si siq; pxre paxioa si qoiqM auo aq; si mbia jauuoj aq; ;ng mpai [Brquids oqi qjtM op o; ssq m^tqvjv-jy puB uqsaj [BoisXqd aq; ipiM op o; SBq rypWJV l qi urrep ajdoad auios qSnoqjiB 3uiqj aures aq; ireaui jrofujapi-jy pire 3{lnH-IV (VL9) i(HlnW-JV) umututop dip si puvp asoi^vi w" 3ff aq p3ss3jg> it-X jp 7 (88=83) i iSuiip/uaaa fo (inyvivw) fquSpuaaos dip si puvjq asopM wj : five;} if f T Xf? v*> jvfiy aq; oqn si is8unp pv fo (pjyvivw) fyuStdjaaos dip si puvpj asoijM ui puv '(miff iptm. dfvpossv /hip jmp pv aooqo) papvxa puv apj aq paifuofi 05^ ittlfiJp 7 s* qpfiy stj jo Sunreaui aqj, pasodsiQ iCpnoioBJo aq; ja/iAo;sag snojaauaQ aq; ;srtp aq; si 3H pu spaap siq o; Suipjooob auo qoBa qsiund jo pjBAiaj qiAv 3H uaqi uoipajjnsay jo j(bq aq; uo lutqaj yon puppreui jp ui?H 0} pire puBUiuiOD pire apajo o; jaMod aq; si sig 'Ujn;aj sjajpui jp uioqyw o; qjJBa aq; puB suaABaq aq; jo pjjuoa aq^ si ptreq asoqyw ui ;uapyjng-jlag aq; SuiAiq J3Ag aq; aq fiAa Xub aAoqB payrpires pus pa;pxa puB payuofS susaui i'pauutpau aq //m/s noR uitjj oj puv 'sSuiip pv fo uoiunuop dtp si puvjq asoqM ui puv '(miff ipicn ajvpossv /hip imp pv aojoqv) papvxa puv 3fj aq patfuofi o > tirr / P' [,19,/si ft puv paq, p 0} Rvs fipuaui mpuy uqi Msfvp SZZ

Yd Sin (81 - 83) (Part-23 bowing, he said, > * - ' \ > | < * , JL^>" \ **_*->' lAllah hears the one who praises Him.* Then he said; j O Juo-J Praise be to Allah, the Owner of Malakiit, might, pride and greatness ." His bowing was as long as his standing position, and his prostration was as long as his bowing. Then he finished and my legs were nearly broken.